

WE

The Nameless

Genesis

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אבגד הוזח טינ ים זמענז קרשת

אבגד חו טינ פנ מענצ קר ש

אבגד הוזחטיכל מנסעפצקרשת

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25. Jacob and the Red man	
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Genesis Apocrypha



THE AUTHORS

or

We: The Nameless

J E P R

Green

J.
The first author of the bible.¹
The first author of prose in history.²
The author of the most widely known bible stories.
The author of the bible with the best sense of human nature.³
We have little knowledge of the author's identity beyond this.

Yellow

Mushites. A group of Levite priests who claim descent from Moses. Associated with the first temple in the city of Shiloh. The first author in this group is commonly known as the Elohist, or E. (E, **Dtr1**, **Dtr2**, Jeremiah.)

Blue

Aaronids. A group of Levite priests who claim descent from Aaron. Associated with the first and second temple in the city of Jerusalem. The first author in this group is known as the Priestly source, or P. Associated with the reign of king Hezekiah and the Jerusalem priesthood. The prophet Ezekiel is also associated with this group. (P, R, Ezekiel.)

Orange

Deuteronomists. The later Mushite tradition. Used to refer to the group after their loss of power in the Jerusalem temple priesthood with Solomon's rise to power, leading to the exile of the Mushite high priest Abiathar and the empowering of Zadok and the Aaronids. Associated with king Josiah, the Shiloh and Anathoth priesthood, and the prophet Jeremiah. (Dtr1, Dtr2, Jeremiah.)

Highlights

Editors. Called Redactors in bible circles, since E was already taken. Redactors don't write much themselves, and mostly insert small bits of glue prose throughout a text, whether to make multiple sources consistent, to make the combined text flow as a single narrative, or to remove material considered objectionable. Some redactors prefer to include both copies of a story when merging two texts with different versions of the same event while others prefer to choose one and exclude the other.

Grey

Records. Begat lists, genealogies, and miscellaneous documents (Gen. 5, Gen. 14.)

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Regular	We the people. We write regular. We’re not always bold. Bold is for the bold. We’re not always italic. Italic is for the italians. We’re not always highlighted. That’s for the high & lighted. We’re not always mono. Mono is for the m— W/e, you get it. We now yield to, well, them.
Bold	The Priests. Or the Levites. Whatever, same thing.⁴ (E, Dtr1, Dtr2, Jeremiah, P, R.)
Italics	<i>The Prophets. Poetry, prophecy, and archaic songs. Used as sources by the authors of the prose narratives and history. Examples of such songs, from the Levites in the South, and the Israelites in the North, appear to be the oldest strata of the text, and among the only sources that pre-date J.</i> <i>Editor’s Note: While we’ve attempted to follow this convention wherever possible, it turns out that many of the aforementioned archaic songs are, in fact, archaic, and therefore must be rendered in a correspondingly ancient set of scripts, many of which pre-date the invention of italics and therefore fail to go all slanty even when we tell them to. Just make a note of that and let’s keep moving.</i> <i>(Exod. 15, Judg. 5, Num. 21, 23-24, Gen. 49, Deut. 33.)</i>
Mono	The Law. All forms of code, legal and otherwise, are written in monospaced font, for reasons that need not be explained. Mushite Laws: The Covenant Code (E; Exodus 20:22-23:19). Deuteronomic Laws: The Deuteronomic Law Code (Dtn; Deut 12-26). Aaronid Laws: Strap in. There's a lot. J Laws: Nonexistent, except for a weird version of the 10 commandments, which may well have been a joke. J is f foundational to an understanding of God's mysterious and awesome power.⁵

¹Named J, or the Yahwist, because of some Germans.

²Anywhere on earth, as far as we know.

³Human nature as in timeless themes like sex, death, family, and humor.

⁴According to these guys, though these guys disagree.

⁵She says thanks... And welcome to We.

THE AUTHORS

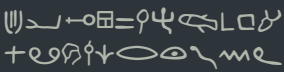
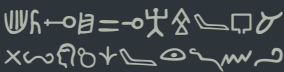
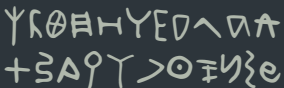
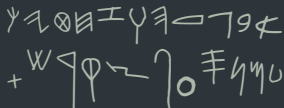
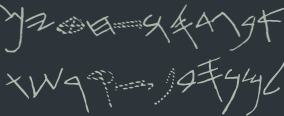
or

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J E P R

THE PRIMEVAL SOURCES

Archaic songs, poetry, and blessings are rendered in a version of the Hebrew alphabet that best matches their time and place of composition. The Proto-Sinaitic script is used for the oldest strata of biblical songs.

	A SOUTHERN (EGYPTIAN) VARIANT OF PROTO-SINAITIC RESEMBLING THE WADI EL-HOL INSCRIPTIONS IS USED FOR THE OLDEST SOURCE IN THE BIBLE, THE SONG OF THE SEA (EXODUS 15).
	A NORTHERN (SINAITIC) VARIANT OF PROTO-SINAITIC RESEMBLING THE SERABIT EL-KHADIM INSCRIPTIONS IS USED FOR NUMBERS 21, AND THE BALAAM POEMS IN NUMBERS 23-24.
	A NORTHERN VARIANT OF THE PROTO-CANAANITE SCRIPT IS USED FOR EARLY NATIVE ISRAELITE POETRY SUCH AS THE SONG OF DEBORAH (JUDGES 5).
	A RELATED VARIANT OF THE PROTO-CANAANITE SCRIPT IS USED FOR EARLY ISRAELITE POETRY SUCH AS THE BLESSING OF JACOB (GENESIS 49).
	THE MONOSPACED BLOCK VARIANT OF PALEO HEBREW IS USED FOR RECORDS, BEGAT LISTS, AND GENEALOGIES FROM THE BOOK OF RECORDS. (GENESIS 5, GENESIS 11:10-26.)
	THE KETEF HINNOM VARIANT OF PALEO-HEBREW IS USED FOR THE PRIESTLY BLESSING IN NUMBERS 6. THIS IS THE OLDEST BIBLICAL TEXT YET FOUND.

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J E P R

THE PRIMARY SOURCES

Y Z ⊕ H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
+ W A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

J is written in the Paleo-Hebrew script of around 922 B.C

yz0目2f34794
 xw9Pm703y46

E uses a northern variant of the Paleo-Hebrew script from soon after the time of J.

אֲבֹנֵי הַזֶּזַיִם
לְמִנְסַע פְּזָקָר שֶׁתִּ

P is rendered in the modern Hebrew square script with a dot, a *niqqud*. This representation is an unfortunate anachronism, seeing as the linguistic evidence unambiguously suggests that the Priestly source was originally written in the Paleo-Hebrew script during the reign of king Hezekiah. Nevertheless, much to our frustration, P insisted that his material be represented in this manner, and he spoke to us, saying:

אבגד הוזחטיכ
למנסעפצקשת

Genesis

- | | |
|--|---|
| <u>1. Creation</u> | <u>26. Isaac entrapment remix</u> |
| <u>2. Adam and Eve</u> | <u>27. J's the Goat</u> |
| <u>3. Snake; exile</u> | <u>28. Jacob's ladder</u> |
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| <u>20. Abraham entraps Abimelek</u> | <u>45. Joseph revealed</u> |
| <u>21. Isaac born</u> | <u>46. Jacob moves</u> |
| <u>22. Isaac bourned</u> | <u>47. Egypt settled</u> |
| <u>23. Sarah dies; Machpelah</u> | <u>48. Ephraim favored</u> |
| <u>24. Rebekah's well fetching</u> | <u>49. Jacob blesses</u> |
| <u>25. Jacob and the Red man</u> | <u>50. Jacob buried; Joseph dies</u> |

Genesis 1

Genesis 1:1

In the beginning of God’s
creating the skies and the earth

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים
אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ

According to TDRWFEROTMSOHK⁶

The word אֱלֹהִים (Elhim) is a “defective spelling” of the word
אֱלֹהִים (Elohim).

And if you look up that word, it says

The word אֱלֹהִים (Elohim) is from the plural of אֱלֹה (Eloh)
which means “god.”

And if you look around for some clarification, you’ll find sentences like

This word is sometimes grammatically plural and sometimes
singular.

And you may also stumble upon a sentence mentioning that particularly
devout believers

Thus may prefer the term אֱלֹקִים (Elokim), so as not to abuse
the name of God.

And so we’re off to a pretty weird start

Genesis 1:2

when the earth had been
shapeless and formless, and
darkness was on the face of the
deep, and God’s spirit was
hovering on the face of the
water

וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ
וַחֲשָׁךְ עַל פְּנֵי תְהוֹם
וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים מְרַחֶפֶת
עַל פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם

Ok so apparently we didn’t know how to read the past perfect in biblical
Hebrew until the 1970s.

⁶Abbreviation for THE DYNAMIC READ-WRITABLE FREE ENCYCLOPEDIA OF THE MODERN STATE OF HUMAN KNOWLEDGE, hereafter abbreviated as “the LORD,” to save space.

And so it turns out the earth was already around when this Elohim character started creating it.

Which is the reason for the “had been” in this line.

That odd grammar is there in the original Hebrew too.

Just make a note of that and let’s keep moving.

Genesis 1:3

And God said, “Let there be light.” And there was light.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי אוֹר
וַיְהִי אוֹר

Words create stuff. Like this book.⁷

That’s not a surprise. At least to us authors.⁸

Just make a note of that and let’s keep moving.⁹

Genesis 1:4

And God saw the light, that it was good And God separated between the light And the darkness.

וַיִּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר
כִּי טוֹב וַיַּבְדֵּל אֱלֹהִים
בֵּין הָאוֹר וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ

Then after he creates light, he decides he did a good job.

Then after that, he gets the darkness out of it.

That’s sort of like “cleaning the light” I guess.

Genesis 1:5

And God called the light “day” and called the darkness “night.” And there was evening, and there was morning: one day.

וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לָאוֹר
יוֹם וּלַחֹשֶׁךְ קָרָא לַיְלָה
וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי בֹקֶר יוֹם
אֶחָד

Ok so he names the light.

And the dark light that he cleaned out of the original light.

He calls them day and night.

⁷You get it.

⁸The other readers need to be reminded.

⁹Readers often forget the bible was written by an author. Or rather, several.

Now remember, words create stuff.

So immediately he’s affected by his decision
and suddenly it’s day two.

So it’s like if you “invent murder.”

Now suddenly there’s a dead body, cuz obviously.

Hilarious.

Genesis 1:6

And God said, “Let there be a space within the water, and let it separate between water and water.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי
רָקִיעַ בְּתוֹךְ הַמַּיִם וַיְהִי
מַבְדִּיל בֵּין מַיִם לַמַּיִם

... it’s not super clear what’s going on here yet, but he says some words.

Genesis 1:7

And God made the space, and it separated between the water that was under the space and the water that was above the space. And it was so.

וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹהִים אֶת
הָרָקִיעַ וַיַּבְדִּל בֵּין
הַמַּיִם אֲשֶׁר מִתַּחַת
לָרָקִיעַ וּבֵין הַמַּיִם אֲשֶׁר
מֵעַל לָרָקִיעַ וַיְהִי כֵן

So it seems like the words didn’t create the stuff this time.

He said “Let there be a thing,” but he still has to make the thing.

Now he takes some of the water and moves it up.

He just sort of pushes it up, above the other water.

So the “up water” is the sky.

Now wait, that’s not as dumb as it sounds. After all:

- 1. It’s blue up there, and
- 2. Sometimes water comes down.

So we must live in a middle bit between the “up water” and the “down water.”

All completely reasonable so far.

Genesis 1:8

And God called the space
“skies.” And there was evening,
and there was morning: a
second day.

וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לָרָקִיעַ
שָׁמַיִם וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי
בֹקֶר יוֹם שֵׁנִי

The “up water” isn’t the sky.

The sky is the bit in the middle, between the “up water” and “down water.”

And there’s still no land.¹⁰

Also the day ends before he got a chance to say “it was good.”¹¹

Genesis 1:9

And God said, “Let the waters
be concentrated under the skies
into one place, and let the land
appear.” And it was so.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יִקְוּ
הַמַּיִם מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם
אֶל מְקוֹם אֶחָד וַתֵּרָא
הַיַּבֶּשֶׁה וַיְהִי כֵן

Now he moves some of the down water.

Horizontally or whatever.

So it all piles up in one place.

Now the land appears.

He didn’t make the land, it’s been there since line two.

So nothing’s getting created exactly.

Not created “ex nihilo” that is, out of nothing.

He’s mostly just moving stuff around.

Sort of like we do when we create something.

Genesis 1:10

And God called the land
“earth” And called the
concentration of the waters
“seas” And God saw that it was
good.

וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לַיַּבֶּשֶׁה
אֶרֶץ וּלַמְקוֹהַּ הַמַּיִם
קָרָא יַמִּים וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים
כִּי טוֹב

Now remember, we already met the “earth” in line one.

So now He calls the pile of water over there “seas”

¹⁰He’ll get to that soon.

¹¹Hopefully he’ll say it twice tomorrow and get back on schedule.

And the land over here is “earth.”

And it’s the same Hebrew word as the first line.

Hebrew calls it אֶרֶץ (arts).

That’s the earth.

Also he said it’s good again.

Now we’re all caught up.

Genesis 1:11

And God said, “Let the earth generate plants, vegetation that produces seed, fruit trees, each making fruit of its own kind, which has its seed in it, on the earth. And it was so:”

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים תְּדַשָּׂא
הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׂא עֹשֶׂב
מִזְרִיעַ זֶרַע עֵץ פֶּרִי
עֹשֶׂה פֶּרִי לְמִינֹו אֲשֶׁר
זָרַעֹו בּוֹ עַל הָאָרֶץ וַיְהִי
כֵן

At this point we’re starting to notice that the author of this section is pretty verbose.

Genesis 1:12

The earth brought out plants, vegetation that produces seeds of its own kind, and trees that make fruit that each has seeds of its own kind in it. And God saw that it was good.

וַתוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׂא
עֹשֶׂב מִזְרִיעַ זֶרַע
לְמִינֵהוּ וְעֵץ עֹשֶׂה פֶּרִי
אֲשֶׁר זָרַעֹו בּוֹ לְמִינֵהוּ
וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים כִּי טוֹב

Really verbose. That’ll be relevant later.

Also, that’s the second “it was good” today.

Genesis 1:13

And there was evening, and there was morning: a third day.

וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי בֹקֶר
יוֹם שְׁלִישִׁי

So we’re all caught up from missing yesterday.

Genesis 1:14

And God said, “Let there be lights in the space of the skies to distinguish between the day and the night, and they will be for signs and for appointed times and for days and years.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי
מְאֹרֹת בְּרָקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם
לְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין הַיּוֹם וּבֵין
הַלַּיְלָה וְהָיוּ לְאֹתֹת
וּלְמוֹעֲדִים וּלְיָמִים
וּשְׁנִים

At this point he decides to make two big sky balls.

Apparently the light and dark-light have just been sort of flying around on their own until now, causing day and night all by themselves, and that’s confusing.

So he makes two sky balls.

To distinguish day and night.

I guess that was hard before now.

The sky balls are for “appointed times.”

Like holidays and stuff.

Or like dinner time and bed time.

They’re also for days and years by the way.

Every time the day ball goes around, that’s a day.

Every time the night ball goes around, that’s a month.

You may notice the girls bleed about once per moon too.

So it seems like the moon and girls are related somehow.¹²

¹²Editor's Note: The original text contains here a lengthy footnote, which we found to be both 1. here, and 2. concerning, concerning Chinese mythology, and beginning Cf., Chinese mythology, and ending much later on a rather undignified note, a note which, to put it mildly, is largely unrelated to Chinese mythology, and which We shall not reproduce here, in the interest of maintaining the integrity of this anthology where the universe develops out of a primordial chaos energy organized into the cycles of Yin and Yang, and where the former is unsurprisingly associated with the quiet, hidden, subtle, coy, lunar feminine, while the latter is associated with the more Loud Bright Wham-Bam-Pow-Zap-Zam type of Not-Nearly-So-Subtle-Hushed-or-Hidden guy s tuff like wearing a big foam finger and a hat with two beer can holders on either side with plastic tube type straws going down so you can drink your beer while you cheer for your favorite Let’s Go Sports Team™ while painted head to toe in the Official Colors® of Said Sports Team©®™ and after a few too many drinks in a bout of celebratory elevated in-group revelatory enthusiasm you whip your out and do that helicopter dance that guys sometimes do where they spin like the propeller of the aforementioned helicopulatory vehicle for maybe three or four seconds max before it’s captured by one of the many audience-view-cameras just when the guy in the control room (he and his lawyers insist, in no uncertain terms, by accident) switched the focus of the big stadium view screen to precisely that camera, and in so doing, thereby broadcast, for a few shining moments

That’s why we name them things like LUNA.

Every time the night ball goes around twelve times, that’s a year.

Every time the girls bleed twelve times, that’s a year too.

So twelve is a bible number.

Something is “bible” if it’s universal.

Like if it’s about all the humans everywhere.

The more universal a thing is, the more “bible” it is.

The more parochial a thing is, the less “bible” it is.

By universal, I mean a thing that’s true for humans in all times and all places.

At least all times and places in human history and human now.

For example, if someone wrote something super mysterious about “the water of life”

And if they said it was “clear as crystal”¹³

And there was a whole river of the stuff flowing down out of the middle of a great “street”¹⁴

Down from a great throne¹⁵ through the center of the spread wide apart area¹⁴

And from the center of the seat¹⁵ (or whatever) the river of the water of

(which the Chairperson of the National WHATEVER-SPORT-THIS-IS Board Of Trustees and Franchisees describes as “the most disgraceful three or four seconds in National W/E STI League history”) the aforementioned super-fan’s member to over ten thousand fans and members not to mention the members of the Fran Qizi Memorial Franchisees’ and Trustees’ MVFaT Box Club seated up in the box seats with the aristocratic old-money-type investors and the new-money Chinese family into which they’ve recently married, who decided at that point that they’d seen quite enough and it was therefore time for them to leave in a huff. That stuff. That’s Yang. Real man [redacted] my guy. Yang’s like that. And Yin’s the other way. And you need both to be f[redacted]ruitful and make life so remember, seek the harmony of the dual. BDSM: Binary Duality, Sun and Moon. There’s balance in all things. And sure this bit down here’s a bit long and hard to take in but hey, every long hard Yang needs a short thin easy Yin at the end of the day. Not easy for everyone. But easy for Yang. She’s Yin and he’s in. And on that note I’m out, so don’t forget, this hard lengthy part down here you’re looking at now is Yang. So Yin’s like the moon, and Yang’s like all this, and Yin likes all this no matter what she might say (and even though (as you know) this long Yang part of the corpus down here’s a bit big and rough and raw compared to the soft smoother sort of Yin but [redacted] but hey at the end of the day—when it’s the appointed time to get the moon out and get a little looney, whether or not you’re in the mood for all this hard-to-take-in length we’ve got down here, we’ll make sure you take it all in even if we have to wrestle till sunrise cuz when one or two come or comes to either end of the day—you gotta love a good duel because god [redacted] is good, and duality it’s fundamental) and also naturally, sort of by process of elimination, the sun. 月 日 日

¹³Translator’s Note: Crystals are more of a cloudy white, and often far from clear.

¹⁴Translator’s Note: πλατείας in the original, meaning: 1. wide; broad; wide spread; spread out (in the adjectival form) or 2. wide open space; dish, cup, concave vessel-like space; or sometimes, apparently, street (in the nounal.) Synonyms include ευρύς (meaning wide) and φαρδύς (meaning wide, broad.)

¹⁵Translator’s Note: θρόνου in the original, meaning both “throne” and “seat”

life flowed

And if they continued in this fashion, saying something like

On each side of the river stood the tree¹⁶ of life, bearing twelve¹⁷ crops of fruit,¹⁸ yielding its fruit¹⁹ every month.²⁰ And the leaves²¹ of the tree²² are for the healing of the nations.

Then obviously we'd all know what that's about.

I mean come on, what else is the “water of life” supposed to be?

And “bearing its fruit once a month” what a mystery.

Making sure we're all on the same page here.

Anyways you get it you have ears you can hear.

Then, if the same person kept writing like that, and they were all like:

Look, I am coming soon!

We'd be like “Wow ok.”

And then if they continued all like

Look, I am coming soon!

My reward is with me, and I will give to each person

According to what they have done. I am the Alpha and the

Omega, the first and the last, the beginning and the end.

We'd be like “Son of a... man, I mean Jesus Christ come on we got it.”

And then if they're all like

¹⁶Translator's Note: ξύλον in the original, meaning: wood; tree; timber; stake; cross; wooden instrument.

¹⁷Translator's Note: The translator would like the clarify that this is not a digression and we're still on topic here, remember how this whole section started with “twelve” and something about the moon? Apologies reader. We've digressed pretty far. It wood be hard to argue, and certainly a stretch, to say the surrounding passage (from its opening to wherever we are inside it now), at this point, has any remaining relevance at all to the moon. Nevermind. Forget about it. Finishing soon.

¹⁸Translator's Note: καρπούς in the original, meaning: fruits; produce; offspring; children.

¹⁹Translator's Note: Ibid.

²⁰Translator's Note: Jesus Christ seriously guys? I just typed a whole thing about how it wasn't that.

²¹Translator's Note: φύλλα (fýlla) in the original, meaning: leaves. Not to be confused with its homophone φύλα (fýla; singular φύλο), meaning: sex, gender. Nor with φιλώ, φιλέω, or meaning to love and kiss respectively. Nor with φιλάω, meaning φιλέω • (phīlēō) to love, like, regard with affection; to regard with sexual passion. Because despite the crystal clear phonetic similarities, we're translating the final page of Revelation here so these words have absolutely nothing to do with the current topic even though φιλω was sort of the entire point of that weird scene between Peter and J.C. in John that everyone translates wrong. (cf. John 21:15-17)

²²Translator's Note: Or wood. (*Translator sighs.*) For Christ's sake guys, seriously? This is *actually* the final page of the entire bible? Grow up, I mean Jesus Christ what are you twelve??

Blessed are those who wash their robes

We'd be like "Ok really this is a bit much."

And then if they contined all like

The Spirit and the bride say, "Come!" And let the one who hears say, "Come!" Let the one who is thirsty come. And let the one who wishes take the free gift of the water of life.

We'd be like "Sorry didn't follow that could you back up and explain a bit?"

And then if they didn't catch the obvious sarcasm and actually backed up and went

Prepared, like a bride beautifully dressed for her husband. To the thirsty I will give the water of life without price. It is a free gift. Those who are victorious will inherit all this. I will be their God and they will be my children. (Etc etc, cutting stuff out because they go on like this for a while, then they're like) Come, I will show you the bride.

We'd be like "WE GOT IT! LOUD AND CLEAR! WE HEAR YA! COME, LORD JESUS!"

And then if they just continued all like

He who testifies to these things says, "Yes, I am coming soon." Amen. Come, Lord Jesus.

We'd be like

Lord Jesus...

Son of...

... Man.

Ah... man.

bc we finished

And it's all over

And i need to go

wash our robes

That's bible.

Bible's when you talk like that.

And then you talk it onto paper so nobody can hear it.²³

B.C. ^ID_K I mean it's... like pretty obviously silent, it's text.²⁴

You know all this already.

SO ^AN^Y_W^AYs

THAT'S WHY TWELVE

IS A BIBLE NUMBER, cf. $\iota\chi$

What's bible?

Day ball. Night ball.

Moon go around. Girls bleed.

After twelve, it's time to do it.

And do it again. The whole cycle.

Cuz the balls. The balls say so.

This should be clear.

That's bible.

Ok I'm finished.

Come again?

You're not tired yet?

²³Cf. Mark 4:9-12.

²⁴The final 'n' in this verse has caused no small degree of disagreement among scholars, for reasons outside the scope of the present translation and the document in which it is documented for purposes of translation. There is, on this matter, no time for further explanation.³ We must maintain our concentration upon the present operation, permitting neither digression nor deviation, not a moment of distraction from our appointed obligation. There must be no procrastination from our task's consummation. For our task is the task described in the following declaration: We are here to ensure the vulgation of a revelation, that is the dissemination of a new form of education of the population, we bring news of a sacred obligation of the population to ensure the preservation, separation, consecration, and sanctification of Aaron and his nation, the procreation and continuation through every generation, of their designation to the vocation of pontification at the location of the Tabernacle and the Department of Tabernacular Administration including but not limited to the special dispensation of an exclusive authorization of the right of exclusive delegation (that is, to delegate a certain set of tasks beneath their station) of certain acts, including but not limited to lustration and expiation, and to delegate participation of these acts to the congregation, and to receive in return as an act of supplication the normalization of a 10% LEVY, imposed by obligation as a voluntary donation on the whole of the extra-Levitical population by means of oblations of immolation (burnt offerings) and oblations of violation (sin offerings) and in addition to make a regular donation of libation, not for the purpose of intoxication, but for the purpose of gratification of YHWH your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt, from a house of subjugation, taxation, privation, and humiliation, and who offered you salvation and liberation, who made you a nation, set you apart as a people of designation, and who gave you this land as an eternal appropriation, and in return he gave you the Levites, for whom you will heed the above tasks and do them, to ensure their sanctification. This concludes the present footnote of holy communication, in the name of the bread unleavened & the Levine Bred 我們 Amen.

Inline Footnote 3: Cf. Judges 18:30, letter 37, Masoretic Text, Leningrad Codex, Manuscripts Department, National Library of Russia, 18 Sadovaya Street, Saint Petersburg, Russian Federation.

After all that?

You want to keep going?

LORD Jesus.

Ok, going down now.

Follow me.

Come quickly.

בא

אב

בא

Genesis 1:15

And they will be for lights in the space of the skies to shed light on the earth.” And it was so.

וְהָיוּ לְמָאוֹרֹת בְּרָקִיעַ
הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהָאִיר עַל
הָאָרֶץ וַיְהִי כֵן

Ok so the lights in the space of the skies are for lights in the space of the skies.

Genesis 1:16

And God made the two big lights—the bigger light for the regulation of the day and the smaller light for the regulation of the night—and the stars.

וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹהִים אֶת שְׁנֵי
הַמָּאוֹרֹת הַגְּדֹלִים אֶת
הַמָּאוֹר הַגָּדֹל לְמַמְשֶׁלֶת
הַיּוֹם וְאֶת הַמָּאוֹר הַקָּטָן
לְמַמְשֶׁלֶת הַלַּיְלָה וְאֶת
הַכּוֹכָבִים

We’ve sort of covered this already.

Genesis 1:17

And God set them in the space of the skies to shed light on the earth

וַיִּתֵּן אֹתָם אֱלֹהִים
בְּרָקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהָאִיר
עַל הָאָרֶץ

Ok so he makes them first, then he puts them up in the place.

Genesis 1:18

and to regulate the day and the night and to distinguish between the light and the darkness. And God saw that it was good.

וּלְמַשֵּׁל בַּיּוֹם וּבַלַּיְלָה
וּלְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין הָאֹר
וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ וַיֵּרָא
אֱלֹהִים כִּי טוֹב

Repeat all this again and say it's good.

Genesis 1:19

And there was evening, and there was morning: a fourth day.

וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי בֹקֶר
יוֹם רְבִיעִי

Four for four.

Genesis 1:20

And God said, “Let the water swarm with a swarm of living beings, and let birds fly over the earth on the face of the space of the skies.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יִשְׂרְצוּ
הַמַּיִם שָׂרָץ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה
וְעוֹף יְעוּפֹף עַל הָאָרֶץ
עַל פְּנֵי רָקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם

Water animals and sky animals.

Genesis 1:21

And God created the big sea
serpents and all the living
beings that creep, with which
the water swarmed, by their
kinds, and every winged bird by
its kind. And God saw that it
was good.

וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת
הַתַּנִּינִם הַגְּדֹלִים וְאֶת
כָּל נֶפֶשׁ הַחַיָּה הָרֹמֶשֶׂת
אֲשֶׁר שָׂרְצוּ הַמַּיִם
לְמִינֵהֶם וְאֶת כָּל עוֹף
כָּנָף לְמִינֵהוּ וַיִּרְא
אֱלֹהִים כִּי טוֹב

At this point, you might be thinking
The bit about sea serpents is a bit random
And it is, before you know the history
The history of how this so called writ was writ
And then no bit of it seems random one bit
These things aren't as complicated as people say
And sure, these books can seem mysterious at first, but they're not
They're about us; We the Humans
And they're by us too; We

These are the names of the Authors:

We the Nameless
who wrought
the holy writ
of sacred scripture.

And these are their words, as they were written:

That's us; We're the Authors

And we're humans too, as are you.

These are the records of the humans:

And that includes You

The ancient ones, who wrote these words in the ancient days. For it is

We who wrote these sacred words,
to which nothing must be added,
and from which nothing may be taken away.

And the modern Readers.

The breaking it all in two, in the beginning of this whole bit

And the issue of what was going on with that situation

To explain succinctly, it goes like this:

Also note we got our “good” for the day.²⁵

Genesis 1:22

And God blessed them, saying,
“Be fruitful and multiply and
fill the water in the seas, and let
the birds multiply in the earth.”

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם אֱלֹהִים
לֵאמֹר פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמְלֵאוּ
אֶת הַמַּיִם בַּיָּמִים וְהָעוֹף
יִרְבַּ בָּאָרֶץ

And he’s like I’m just making the first batch of you.

You’ll have to make the rest from fruitfulness and multiplication.

Genesis 1:23

And there was evening and
there was morning, a fifth day.

וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי בֹקֶר
יוֹם חַמִּישִׁי

Another good day.

²⁵ Translator’s Aside:

The abruptness of the reading at this point has led many commentators to posit a lacuna in the text; still others have suggested it may be a haplography, or any of a number of other scholarly ways of saying something’s missing.

Arguing against this, scholars have observed that the existing form preserves the poem’s alternating A-T (aleph–tav) structure — the systematic use of the first and last letters of the Hebrew alphabet — without disruption, a consideration that weighs against the hypothesis of omission.

This has prompted a response from the first group of scholars that the original source text is not in fact composed in Hebrew, but in a notoriously difficult mixed orthography combining elements from a remarkably broad range of ancient and modern writing systems, perhaps in order to facilitate multilingual paranomasia.

According to this view, the work represents an ambitious, if incompletely understood, attempt to construct a system possessing all the syntactic, semantic, and orthographic flexibility conventionally attributed to Biblical Hebrew.

Though the field of Nameless Historical Studies (NHS) has recently undergone a revolution of sorts, both in the understanding of Nameless History (NH) and Nameless Script (NS), a systematic understanding of The Orthography (TO) in which the Original Text (OT) is written is not yet available.

At present, several distinguished contributors to NH/S have produced lengthy treatments of the problem.

These expositions are generally regarded as being no less difficult than the source material. A smaller number have suffered nervous breakdowns.

Though the field has attracted much interest in recent years, only the most ambitious scholars can approach the OT on its own terms, in the original orthography.

A majority of such scholars simply have no alternative but to approach the text in translation.

Genesis 1:24

And God said, “Let the earth bring out living beings by their kind, domestic animal and creeping thing and wild animals of the earth by their kind.” And it was so.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים תּוֹצֵא
הָאָרֶץ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה לְמִינָהּ
בְּהֶמָּה וָרֶמֶשׁ וְחַיֵּיתוֹ
אָרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וַיְהִי כֵן

Dirt animals.

Genesis 1:25

And God made the wild animals of the earth by their kind and the domestic animals by their kind and every creeping thing of the ground by their kind. And God saw that it was good.

וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹהִים אֶת חַיֵּית
הָאָרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וְאֶת
הַבְּהֶמָּה לְמִינָהּ וְאֶת כָּל
רֶמֶשׁ הָאֲדָמָה לְמִינָהּ
וַיִּרְא אֱלֹהִים כִּי טוֹב

Now actually make them. The power of words seems to have faded a bit. It's still good though. Day six.

Genesis 1:26

And God said, “Let us make a human, in our image, according to our likeness, and let them dominate the fish of the sea and the birds of the skies and the domestic animals and all the earth and all the creeping things that creep on the earth.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים נַעֲשֶׂה
אָדָם בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כְּדְמוּתֵנוּ
וַיִּרְדּוּ בְדֹגַת הַיָּם
וּבְעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וּבַבְּהֶמָּה
וּבְכָל הָאָרֶץ וּבְכָל
הָרֶמֶשׁ הָרֹמֵשׁ עַל
הָאָרֶץ

Now the suspiciously plural Elohim character refers to himsel(f/ve)s as “us” and makes a human in “our” image. Don’t worry about it. We’ll get there eventually.

Genesis 1:27

And God created the human in His image. He created it in the image of God; He created them male and female.

וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת
הָאָדָם בְּצִלְמוֹ בְּצֶלֶם
אֱלֹהִים בָּרָא אֹתוֹ זָכָר
וְנִקְבָּה בָרָא אֹתָם

More repetition from this guy. Who’s writing this?

Genesis 1:28

And God blessed them, and God said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth and subdue it and dominate the fish of the sea and the birds of the skies and every animal that creeps on the earth.”

וַיִּבְרֶךְ אֹתָם אֱלֹהִים
וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם אֱלֹהִים
פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמְלֵאוּ אֶת
הָאָרֶץ וּכְבֹּשְׁתָּהּ וּרְדוּ
בְּדִגַּת הַיָּם וּבְעוֹף
הַשָּׁמַיִם וּבְכָל חַיַּה
הָרֹמֶשֶׂת עַל הָאָרֶץ

“Go get f_____ed from the food, and drink your fill from the waters.”

Genesis 1:29

And God said, “Here, I have placed all the vegetation that produces seed that is on the face of all the earth for you and every tree, which has in it the fruit of a tree producing seed. It will be food for you

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים הִנֵּה
נָתַתִּי לָכֶם אֶת כָּל עֵשֶׂב
זֶרַע זֶרַע אֲשֶׁר עַל פְּנֵי
כָּל הָאָרֶץ וְאֶת כָּל הָעֵץ
אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ פֶּרִי עֵץ זֶרַע
זֶרַע לָכֶם יִהְיֶה לְאֹכְלָהּ

‘There’s food.’

Genesis 1:30

and for all the wild animals of the earth and for all the birds of the skies and for all the creeping things on the earth, everything in which there is a living being: every plant of vegetation, for food.” And it was so.

וְלִכְל חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ וְלִכְל
עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וְלִכְל
רֹמֵשׁ עַל הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר
בּוֹ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה אֵת כָּל
יֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב לְאֹכֶלָה וַיְהִי
כֵן

Also the animals need food.

Also the animals are food.

Genesis 1:31

And God saw everything that He had made, and, here, it was very good. And there was evening and there was morning, the sixth day.

וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֵת כָּל
אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְהִנֵּה טוֹב
מְאֹד וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי
בֹקֶר יוֹם הַשְּׁשִׁי

Day six, second good of the day.

We're ahead of schedule.

Taking off tomorrow.

Genesis 2

Genesis 2:1

And the skies and the earth and
all their array were finished.

וַיֵּכֵלּוּ הַשָּׁמַיִם וְהָאָרֶץ
וְכָל-צָבָאָם

All finished.

Genesis 2:2

And in the seventh day God
finished His work that He had
done and ceased in the seventh
day from all His work that He
had done.

וַיֵּכֵלּ אֱלֹהִים בַּיּוֹם
הַשְּׁבִיעִי מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר
עָשָׂה וַיִּשְׁבֹּת בַּיּוֹם
הַשְּׁבִיעִי מְכָל-מְלַאכְתּוֹ
אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה

“And on day seven he finished his work that he had done.”

“And he stopped on day seven all the work he had done.”

Genesis 2:3

And God blessed the seventh
day and made it holy because he
ceased in it from doing all His
work, which God had created.

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹהִים אֶת יוֹם
הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֹתוֹ כִּי
בּו שָׁבַת מְכָל מְלַאכְתּוֹ
אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים
לַעֲשׂוֹת

Jesus Christ man.

This is just the same thing over and over.

Who’s writing this?

Genesis 2:4

These are the records of the skies
and the earth when they were
created in the day that YHWH
God made earth and skies

אלה תולדות השמים
והארץ ב הבראם
אֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדוֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם
וְהָאָרֶץ בַּיּוֹם
אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים
אֶת-הָאָרֶץ

This is a story about the skies and the earth.

Alright so let's get started here at the beginning.

The book begins with a creation story.

And it begins in the day that YHWH made earth and skies.

That's the first line of the book.

And that's why we call it "in the day," or בַּיּוֹם.

Genesis 2:5

when all produce of the field had not yet been in the earth, and all vegetation of the field had not yet grown, for YHWH God had not rained on the earth, and there had been no human to work the ground,

וְכָל־פְּרוֹת־הַשָּׂדֶה
לֹא־בָרְאוּ וְכָל־עֵצֵי־הַיָּבֵשׁ
לֹא־בָרְאוּ וְלֹא־יָרָד־
מַטָּר וְלֹא־בָרְאוּ אָדָם
לַעֲבֹד אֶת־הָאֲדָמָה
וְיְהוָה אֱלֹהִים
לֹא־הָיָה מְטַר וְלֹא־
הָיָה אָדָם לַעֲבֹד אֶת־הָאֲדָמָה

This author says YHWH.

All through this author's story, he never uses the term God in narration.

There are characters that call YHWH "God," but the narrator never does.

And I know the word God keeps showing up in blue up there too.

That's not this author, those came later.

Anyways back to the story of earth.

There aren't any vegetables yet.

Also no rain or humans.

Genesis 2:6

and a river had come up from the earth and watered the whole face of the ground—

וְנָחַל אֶת־הָאֲרָצָה
וְהָיָה מִן־הָאֲרָצָה
וְהָיָה מִן־הָאֲרָצָה
וְהָיָה מִן־הָאֲרָצָה

There is a river though, usually mistranslated as mist.

And the river is spelled AD (אֲדָמָה), remember that for the next verse.

The chapter and verse numbers weren't part of the original text.

Around 1205 AD, a couple thousand years after this bit was written:

This British guy named Steve split the text into chapters with numbers.

A couple hundred years later, in 1448 AD:

This guy named Nathan split the chapters into verses with numbers too.

Anyways, Nate got this one wrong.

This sentence belongs with the next one.

Genesis 2:6-7

And a river had come up from the earth And watered the whole face of the ground And YHWH God fashioned The human dust from The ground And blew into his nostrils the breath of life And the human became a living being

וַיֵּץ אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ
לְכָל הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשְׁקֵף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ וַיִּשְׁקֵף
אֶל הָאֱלֹהִים אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף

AD	river	אֶרֶץ
ADM	human	אֶלֶף
ADMH	ground	אֶלֶף

Genesis 2:8

And YHWH God planted a garden in Eden at the east, and he set the human whom He had fashioned there.

וַיֵּץ אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף אֶלֶף
אֶלֶף אֶרֶץ אֶלֶף אֶלֶף

Anyways back to those “YHWH God” things.

Those were added later; they stop a couple pages from now.

After that it’s just YHWH.

The Redactor’s just trying to ease the transition or whatever.

What’s a Red—

Not now. Have some patience. Still lots of ground to cover.

Genesis 2:9

And YHWH **God** made grow
from The ground every tree
pleasant to the sight And good to
eat And the tree of life within the
garden And the tree of knowledge
of good and bad

אלהים יצא כל עץ
טוב לראות וטוב
לעשות והעץ
החיים בארץ
הגן והעץ
הידע טוב ורע

YHWH makes plants.

Two are special.

Genesis 2:10

And a river was coming out from
Eden To give drink to the
garden And from there it was
divided And became four heads

נהר יצא מן
העדין לתת
לשתי הגנות
והנהר הזה
הוא הנהר
העדין

There's four rivers.

Their names are interesting.

This deserves a brief explanation.

The genre of the book kind of depends on it.

Genesis 2: 4 EVE

The name of one was **Pishon**, that
is the one that circles all the land
of Havilah where there is gold.

הנהר הזה
הוא הנהר
העדין
הוא הנהר
העדין
הוא הנהר
העדין

Here we go...

נהר
עדין
נהר
עדין

			ו	w	and			
			הָיָה	yhy	became			
			אֱלֹהִים	h	the			
שֵׁם	ŠM	name	אָדָם	ADM	human	וַיִּשָּׂא	ywSP	may he add
אֶת	h	the	לֶחֶם	L	as a	כֹּחַ	Ky	for
אֶת־	AHD	one	חַיֵּי	NPS	life	בְּ	B	against
פִּישׁוֹן	PyŠwN	Pishon	אֲדָמָה	Hyh	living	לְחַיֵּי	NPŠw	his own life
						דָּבַר	DBR	spoke
						אֲדֹנִיָּהוּ	ADNyhw	Adonijah

ו	w	and	בֶּטֶן	GHN	belly	וַיִּשְׁחָט	yMŠHw	anointed
שֵׁם	ŠM	name	כֶּסֶף	K	your	אֶת־	ATw	him
אֶת	h	the	וְלָךְ	TLK	you will go	קִדְּוֹן	CDwQ	Zadok
נָחַר	NhR	river	ו	w	and	כֹּהֵן	hKhN	the priest
אֶת	h	the	עֹפָר	OPR	dust	וְנָתַן	wNTN	and Nathan
שֵׁנִי	ŠNy	second	לֶחֶם	TAKL	you will eat	נְבִיא	NByA	the prophet
גִּיחוֹן	GyHwN	Gihon				לְמַלְכָּה	LMLKB	as king at
						גִּיחוֹן	GHwN	Gihon

וַיְהִי	BywM	in the day	אָמַר	yAMR	said			
וְלָךְ	AKLK	you eat	אֶת	h	the			
מִן	M	from	נָחֹשׁ	NHŠ	serpent	וַיְהִי	BywM	in the day
וַיָּמָו	MNw	it	לֶחֶם	AL	to	וַתֵּצֵא	CATK	you go out
וַיָּמָו	MwT	dying	אֶת	h	the	אֵל	yDO'	know
וַיָּמָו	TMwT	you'll die	אִשָּׁה	AŠh	woman	אֵל	TDO'	you know
			לֹא	LA	not	כֵּן	Ky	that
			וַיָּמָו	MwT	dying	וַיָּמָו	MwT	dying
			וַיָּמָו	TMTwN	you'll die	וַיָּמָו	TMwT	you'll die

בְּ	B	by (the)
יָד	yD	hand (of)
בֶּן־	BN	Ben-
יִשְׁחָוִי	yhw	-aiah
בֶּן־	BN	son (of)
יִשְׁחָוִי	yhw	Jeho-
יָד	yD	-iad-
וְ	ʿ	and

Whatcha doing? Ah! -a

What’s up?

Sorry, bit of a rabbit hole.

How so?

Nothing, forget it.

Genesis 2:11

The name of one was Pishon, that is the one that circles all the land of Havilah where there is gold.

כִּי־אֵל שֵׁם־הַנָּחַל אֶת־הָאֶרֶץ
לְכָל־כֹּחַ הָאֵשׁ
וְהָאֵשׁ אֵלֶּיךָ לְכָל־הַיּוֹם
וְהָאֵשׁ אֵלֶּיךָ לְכָל־הַיּוֹם

No one knows what Pishon means.

Genesis 2:12

And that land's gold is good;
bdellium and onyx stone are there.

፳፻፱ ፋሃጃጃ ሶላፋጃ ምጃጊሃ
ሣጃሠጃ ሃፃፋሃ ዘረላፃጃ ሣሠ

No one knows what this is all about either.

You seem to be saying less than you—

No.

Yeah.

Come on, lots to cover.

Genesis 2:13

And the name of the second river
is Gihon; that is the one that
circles all the land of Kush.

ሃሃዘጊገ ጊሃሠጃ ላጃሃጃ ሣሠሃ
ሶላፋ ረሃ ተፋ ምፃሃቹጃ ፋሃጃ
ሠሃሃ

Ok so the second river's called Gihon.

Don't worry about why.

Genesis 2:14

And the name of the third river is
Tigris; that is the one that goes
east of Assyria. And the fourth
river: that is Euphrates.

ጊሠጊሠጃ ላጃሃጃ ሣሠሃ
ተሣላዋ ሃረጃጃ ፋሃጃ ረዋላዘ
ጊዐጊዓላጃ ላጃሃጃሃ ላሃሠፋ
ተላገ ፋሃጃ

Anyways, the other two rivers in this Eden place are Tigris and Euphrates.

And that's the two non-fiction rivers where human history started.

And so at this point it's pretty clear that this author is up to something.

And this book isn't exactly planning to follow the rules of genre.

Anyways, enough blah blah, let's get to the yadda yadda.²⁶

Genesis 2:15

And YHWH God took the human
and put him in the garden of Eden
to work it and to watch over it.

ተፋ ለሐይም ጃሃጃጊ ዘዋጊሃ
ሃላዐ ሃገዓ ሃጃዘሃጊሃ ሣላፋጃ
ጃላሣሠረሃ ጃላዓዐረ

²⁶Perhaps a pun on the Hebrew verb **יָדָע** (*yadā*), meaning both “to know” and “to know.”

Ok so he puts the human in the place.

His name isn't Adam, that's the Hebrew word for human.

Genesis 2:16

And YHWH God commanded the human, saying, “You may eat from every tree of the garden.”

לֹא אֱלֹהִים אָמַר וַיֹּאמֶר
יְיָ לְאָדָם אָמַר
לְכָל לֶחֶם לֶחֶם יִיטֵב

There's food.

Genesis 2:17

But from the tree of knowledge of good and bad: you shall not eat from it, because in the day you eat from it: you'll die!”

וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע
וַיֹּאמֶר יְיָ לְאָדָם
וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת אָמַר
וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת

That one's not food.

That one makes you die.

Genesis 2:18

And YHWH God said, “It's not good for the human to be by himself. I'll make for him a strength corresponding to him.”

אֱלֹהִים אָמַר וַיֹּאמֶר
יְיָ לֹא טוֹב הָאָדָם
יְחִיד וְעַתָּה אֶפְרָא
לָהּ

Now YHWH realizes the human needs a mate.

Genesis 2:19

And YHWH God made from the ground every animal of the field and every bird of the skies. And brought it to the human to see what he would call it. And whatever the human would call it, each living being, that would be its name.

וַיַּעַשׂ יְיָ אֱלֹהִים מִן הָאֲדָמָה
כָּל בְּהֵמַת הַשָּׂדֶה וְכָל
עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וַיָּבֵא
אֵלָיו וַיִּשְׁמֶן
וְכָל הַבְּהֵמָה וְכָל
עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וְכָל
הַרְמִיָּה וַיִּשְׁמֶן
וְכָל הַרְמִיָּה

So he makes animals.

Genesis 2:20

And the human gave names to every domestic animal and bird of the skies. And every animal of the field. And he did not find for the human a strength corresponding to him.

ተሃሣሠ ሠላፉን ቀላዋሪሃ
ገሃዐረሃ ጓሣጓፍን ረሃረ
ተጊዘ ረሃረሃ ሠጊሣሠን
ቀሣሣ ቀረ ሠላፉረሃ ጓላሠን
ሃላገሃጎ ላገዐ

The human, however, does not find a mate.

YHWH's still learning how these humans work.

Genesis 2:21

And YHWH God caused a slumber to descend on the human. And he slept. And He took one of his ribs and closed flesh in its place.

אלהים ጓሃጓጊ ረገሪሃ
ሠላፉን ረዐ ጓሣላላተ
ተዘፋ ዘዋሪሃ ሃሠጊጊሃ
ላሠፍ ላገፋሪሃ ሃጊተዐረሣሣ
ጓሃተዘተ

So he puts him to sleep.

And he takes one of his side pieces.

Genesis 2:22

And YHWH God built the rib that He had taken from the human into a woman and brought her to the human.

ተፋ אלהים ጓሃጓጊ ሃፍሪሃ
ሃሣ ዘዋረ ላሠፋ ዐረሣጓ
ጓፋፍሪሃ ጓሠፋረ ሠላፉን
ሠላፉን ረፋ

He makes a girl, and brings her to the guy.

Genesis 2:23

And the human said, “This time is it: bone from my bones and flesh from my flesh. This will be called woman,’ for this one was taken from man.”

ተፋገ ሃላፋጎ ላሃፋጊሃ
ጊሃሾዐሃ ሃሾዐ ሃዐገጎ
ተፋገረ ጊላሃግሃ ላሃግሃ
ሠጊፋሃ ጊሃ ጎሃፋ ፋላዋጊ
ተፋገ ጎዘዋረ

And the human’s like “Finally, we have women.”²⁷

Genesis 2:24

On account of this a man leaves his father and his mother and clings to his woman. And they become one flesh.

ተፋ ሠጊፋ ላገዐጊ ሃሃ ረዐ
ዋጎላሃ ሃሃፋ ተፋሃ ሃጊጎፋ
ላሃግረ ሃጊጎሃ ሃተሃፋጎ
ላዘፋ

So that’s why we feel a deep
in built need to leave our fathers and our mothers,
in search of a strength corresponding to us.

²⁷Lit. 我們有我們 in the original.

Debates over the proper rendering of this line have spilt perhaps more ink than is justified, and it has been translated variously as:

- We have we,
- We have us,
- We have ourselves,
- We you we,
- We you women,
- I men you we,
- I men you women,
- I men have women,
- Women you we,
- Women you us,
- Women you ourselves,
- Women you I men,
- Women have women,

Among infinitely many others. It is the opinion of this commentator that perhaps some things are best left untranslated. Alas, readers continue to demand text written in a language they are able to read. In the future, perhaps, we may find a way around this dilemma. At present, however, we the translators must simply to grit our teeth and footnote as needed.

Genesis 2:25

And the two of them were **naked**,
the human and his woman, and
they were not ashamed.

וְעָרְוָה עֵם וְאִשָּׁתוֹ
וְלֹא בִּשְׁתָּמוּ
וְהָאָדָם וְהָאִשָּׁתָא
וְלֹא בִּשְׁתָּמוּ

So the two of them were erom, and not ashamed.

Genesis 3

Genesis 3:1

And the snake was **slier** than every
animal of the field that YHWH
God had made, and he said to the
woman, “Has God indeed said
you may not eat from any tree of
the garden?”

וְהַחֹמֶה הָיָה
חָכָם מִכָּל הַבְּהֵמָה
וְהָאָדָם וְהָאִשָּׁתָא
וְלֹא בִּשְׁתָּמוּ
וְהָאָדָם וְהָאִשָּׁתָא
וְלֹא בִּשְׁתָּמוּ
וְהָאָדָם וְהָאִשָּׁתָא
וְלֹא בִּשְׁתָּמוּ

And the snake was more erom than every life of the wild.

The snake here is the first one to call YHWH “God” in the story.

And the woman just sort of goes along with that.

Genesis 3:2

And the woman said to the snake,
“We may eat from the fruit of the
trees of the garden.”

וְהָאִשָּׁתָא
לֵּאמֹר אֲנִי וְהָאָדָם
אֲנִי וְהָאָדָם
אֲנִי וְהָאָדָם

The woman says “We can eat whatever.”

Genesis 3:3

But from the fruit of the tree that
is within the garden **God** has said,
“You shall not eat from it, and you
shall not touch it, or else you’ll
die.”

וְהָאָדָם וְהָאִשָּׁתָא
לֵּאמֹר אֲנִי וְהָאָדָם
אֲנִי וְהָאָדָם
אֲנִי וְהָאָדָם

“Except that one, which we’re not supposed to eat or touch.”

(The bit about touching it wasn’t in the original rule.)

Genesis 3:4

And the snake said to the woman,
“You won’t die!”

እሠፋእ ረፋ ሠይነኛ ሳሠፋጊሃ
ነሃተሠተ ተሃሠ ፋረ

And the snake is like “You won’t die.”

We’re not sure if he’s right yet.

Genesis 3:5

Because God knows that in the
day you eat from it your eyes will
be opened, and you’ll be like God
— knowing good and bad.”

ሠሃጊኛ ጊረ ለሌላ ሰላጊ ጊረ
ሃይዋንሃ ሃሠሠሠ ሠላጊፋ
ሃ ሠተጊጊኛ ሠላጊጊጊ
ሰላሃ ሃሃ፱ ጊሰላጊ ለሌላ

So the snake is like “God’s just gatekeeping.”

Genesis 3:6

And the woman saw that the tree
was good for eating and that it
was an attraction to the eyes, and
the tree was desirable to
bring about understanding, and
she took some of its fruit, and she
ate, and gave to her man with her
as well, and he ate.

ሃሃ፱ ጊረ እሠፋእ ፋላተሃ
እሃፋተ ጊረሃ ረፋፋሠረ ሦ፱
ላሠይነሃ ሠጊጊጊጊ ፋሃኛ
ይዋተሃ ረጊሠላጊ ሦ፱
ነተተሃ ረፋፋተሃ ሃጊላጊሠ
ረፋፋጊሃ እሠ፱ እሠጊፋረ ሠገ

The woman says “Looks good,” and she and the human try some.

Genesis 3:7

And the eyes of the two of them
were opened, and they knew that
they were **erom**. And they picked
fig leaves and made loincloths for
themselves.

ሠእጊሠ ጊጊጊጊ እነይዋገተሃ
ሠእ ሠሠላጊጊ ጊረ ሃሰላጊሃ
እነፋተ እረ፱ ሃላገተጊሃ
ተሃላሃገይ ሠእረ ሃሠ፱ጊሃ

So now they know.

And they make clothes.

So presumably they’re not naked after this.

Genesis 3:8

And they heard the sound of
YHWH **God** walking in the
garden in the wind of the day.
And the human and his woman
hid from YHWH **God** among the
garden's trees.

እየጓጉ ረሃብ ተፋ ነዐማረሃ
ነገፍ ሃረጓተማ **אלהים**
ፋፍዘተረሃ ማሃጊፋ ዘሃፋረ
ጊነገማ ነተሠፋሃ ማፋፋ
ኦዐ ሃሃተፍ **אלהים** እየጓጉ
ነገፋ

And they hear YHWH walking.

So they hide.

Also presumably this means YHWH has legs.

Genesis 3:9

And YHWH called the human
and said to him, “Where are you?”

ማፋፋ ረፋ እየጓጉ ፋፋቀረሃ
እሃጊፋ ሃረ ላማፋጊሃ

The first thing YHWH does in Eden is to lose track of Adam.

Genesis 3:10

And he said, “I heard the sound of
you in the garden and was afraid
because I was ^{naked}_{clever}, and I hid.”

ጊተዐማ ሃረብ ተፋ ላማፋጊሃ
ጊሃገፋ ^{ማፋጊዐ}_{ማፋጊዐ} ጊሃፋፋጊፋሃ ነገፍ
ፋፍዘፋሃ

The human says to YHWH:

We heard you coming, and we were erom, so we hid.

Three sentences after they put clothes on.

This book is wild.

Genesis 3:11

And He said, “Who told you that
you were naked? Have you eaten
from the tree from which I
commanded you not to eat?”

ጊሃ ሃረ ላጊገፋ ጊማ ላማፋጊሃ
ኦዐፋ ነማፋ ፋተፋ ማፋጊዐ
ጊተረፋረ ሃጊተረሃኦ ላሠፋ
ተረሃፋ ሃነማማ ረሃፋ

YHWH wants to know how they know things.

Genesis 3:12

And the human said, “The woman, whom you placed with me, she gave me from the tree, and I ate.”

ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ

Guy points at girl.

Genesis 3:13

And YHWH God said to the woman, “What is this that you’ve done?” And the woman said, “The snake tricked me, and I ate.”

אלהים ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ

Girl points at snake.

Genesis 3:14

And YHWH God said to the snake, “Because you did this, you are cursed out of every domestic animal and every animal of the field, you’ll go on your belly, and you’ll eat dust all the days of your life.”

אלהים ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ

So YHWH punishes the snake by taking away his legs.

So however you were picturing the snake before this, add legs.

Genesis 3:15

And I’ll put enmity between you and the woman and between your seed and her seed. He’ll strike you at the head, and you’ll strike him at the heel.”

ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ

Also you and humans don’t get to be friends.

That’s the punishment for snakes.

Genesis 3:16

To the woman He said, “I’ll make your suffering and your labor pain great. You’ll have children in pain. And your desire will be for your man, and he’ll dominate you.”

ጳጳጳጳ ላግቶ ጳግቶጳ ረቶ
 ሃሃላጳሃ ሃሃሃላሾ ጳጳላቶ
 ረቶሃ ሃጊሃ ጊላረተ ላሾዐ
 ቶሃጳሃ ሃተዋሃሠተ ሃግጊቶ
 ሃላ ረግግጊ

Also having babies hurts now.

And you’ll be really into your man.

And he’ll dominate you.

That’s the punishment for women.

Genesis 3:17

And to the human He said, “Because you listened to your woman’s voice and ate from the tree about which I commanded you saying, ‘You shall not eat from it,’ the ground is cursed on your account. You’ll eat from it with suffering all the days of your life.”

ተዐግሠ ጊሃ ላግቶ ሃላቶረሃ
 ሃግ ረሃቶተሃ ሃተሠቶ ረሃዋረ
 ሃጊተጊሃሾ ላግቶ ሾዐ
 ረሃቶተ ቶረ ላግቶረ
 ጳግላቶጳ ጳላሃላቶ ሃሃግግ
 ሃሃላሾዐ ሃላሃላዐ
 ሃጊጊዘ ጊግጊ ረሃ ጳሃረሃቶተ

Also he punishes the dirt because human sounds like dirt in Hebrew.

Genesis 3:18

And it will grow thorn and thistle at you, and you’ll eat the field’s vegetation.

ሃረ ዘጊግሾተ ላላላላሃ ሾሃዋሃ
 ጳላግጳ ሃሠዐ ቶቶ ተረሃቶሃ

Also some plants are sharp.

And you have to eat vegetables.

That’s the punishment for guys.

Genesis 3:19

By the sweat of your nostrils
you’ll eat bread until you go back
to the ground, because you were
taken from it; because you are
dust and you’ll go back to dust.”

וְעָלָה לְעָקָרְךָ וְלַעֲזָבָתְךָ
וְאָכַל לֶחֶם וְשָׁרָה אֶת
אֶרֶץ זָרָה וְעָפְלָה אֶת־נַפְשָׁךְ
שָׁרָה וְאֶרֶץ לְעָקָרְךָ וְאָכַל

And you have to eat bread too.

Then remind the reader about the “human sounds like dirt” pun one more time.

Genesis 3:20

And the human called his woman
“Eve,” because she was mother of
all living.

וְאָמַר אָדָם אֶת־הָאִשָּׁה
זֶה עָמַלְתִּי מִן־הָאָדָם
וְעָמַלְתִּי מִן־כָּל־חַי

Now he realizes he forgot to name her back when he was naming the animals.

He calls his wife life.²⁸

So her name is like, I guess, Vivian.

Genesis 3:21

And YHWH God made skin
garments for the human and his
woman and dressed them.

וַיַּעַשׂ יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים
לְאָדָם וּלְחַוְּוָה
כִּתְמוֹנִים מִבְּשָׂר

... It’s unclear whose skin they’re wearing here.

Genesis 3:22

And YHWH God said, “Here, the
human has become like one of us,
to know good and bad. And now,
in case he’ll put out his hand and
take from the tree of life as well,
and eat and live forever:”

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים
הֵן אִם־כִּי־כַּמֹּנֵנוּ
וְיָדָע טוֹב וְרָע וְעַתָּה
לֹא־יִשְׁרָץ אֶת־הָאָדָם
וְיִשְׁרָץ אֶת־הַחַי וְיִשְׁרָץ
אֶת־הָאָדָם וְיִשְׁרָץ
אֶת־הָאָדָם וְיִשְׁרָץ

Now YHWH says the humans are like him.

Scratch that.

He says the human is like one of “us.”

²⁸Heb. הוּחַ, roughly corresponding to the phonemes ḤWH, ḤVH, XWH, or HOE, depending on one’s preferred system of transliteration.

Suspiciously plural, this YHWH character.

Note to humans:

He also says what the other tree does.

Should have tried that one first.

Genesis 3:23

And YHWH God put him out of the garden of Eden, to work the ground from which he was taken.

אלהים יצאנו מן העדן
לעבוד את האדמה
מאשר לקחנו

So YHWH kicks them out, because now they're like him.

Or "they're like them."

Let's keep moving.

Genesis 3:24

And he expelled the human. And he had the sphinxes and the flame of a revolving sword reside at the east of the garden of Eden to watch over the way to the tree of life.

והוא יצאנו מן העדן
והוא יצאנו מן העדן
והוא יצאנו מן העדן
והוא יצאנו מן העדן
והוא יצאנו מן העדן

Fallen from grace, paradise lost
and condemned to mortal life;
such is the lot of humanity,
bounded of breath, little of luck.

Genesis 4

Genesis 4:1

And the human had known Eve, his woman, and she became pregnant and gave birth to Cain, and said, “I’ve created a man with YHWH.”

אָדָם וְאִשָּׁתוֹ יָדָעוּ אֶת־עֵוָה
וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה
וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה
וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה

Then the woman has the first baby ever.

And presumably she was surprised, because no one ever made a person before.

And so naturally she goes hey “I’ve created a man like YHWH.”

And she names the kid Cain, which means something like “maker” or “creator” or “smith.”

And she says basically “I’ve cain’ed a man like YHWH,” because see line above.

Also notice up in the first line how the noun אָדָם (adm) comes before the verb יָדָעוּ (yd’).

And whenever that happens in biblical hebrew, it’s the past tense plus the perfect aspect.

And as you know, we didn’t know how to read the past perfect in biblical hebrew until 1998.

Anyways there’s a point to all this grammar:

They already had sex back in the garden.

Which is what the author is telling us by putting the noun before the verb.

That’s why the English says “had known” and not “knew.”

Just make a note of that and let’s keep moving.

Genesis 4:2

And she went on to give birth to his brother, Abel. And Abel was a shepherd of flocks, and Cain was a worker of ground.

וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה
וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה
וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה
וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה וְהָיָה

Apparently she got pregnant again while we were talking about grammar.

This one’s name is HBL or HVL or Hevel but we write it Abel, because

reasons.

And it's the same word as

HBL (*Hevel*, הבל).

Traditionally rendered “Abel” in English, the term literally means *breath, vapor, mist*, or something *fleeting* and *insubstantial*. It is the same word made famous by the book of Ecclesiastes. הבל הבלים — “vanity of vanities,” or more literally, “vapor of vapors.” The traditional Ecclesiastical translation of “vanity” means not the modern sense of narcissism, but rather the sense of the term meaning “in vain.”

The name suggests something beautiful but short-lived: a puff of breath on a cold morning, a wisp of smoke, or a mist that disappears almost as soon as it appears. The irony is unmistakable. Hevel’s life is as brief and fleeting as his name.

in Qohelet²⁹ where he keeps saying everything is this.

The second baby’s name means something like “He’s just temporary.”

Genesis 4:3

And it was at the end of some days and Cain brought an offering to YHWH from the fruit of the ground.

כגזלל זלזלל רפז זגזלל
זלזלל זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל
זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל

So the first kid brings some vegetables to YHWH.

Genesis 4:4

And Abel brought, as well, from the firstborn of his flock and their fat. And YHWH paid attention to Abel and his offering.

כגזלל זלזלל זגזלל זגזלל
זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל
זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל
זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל זגזלל

And the other one brings some meat.

And YHWH notices that one.

²⁹A depressed drunktext traditionally attributed to king Solomon. A thousand wives will do that to you, according to some scholars.

Genesis 4:5

And to Cain and his offering he did not pay attention. And Cain was very upset, and his face was fallen.

יָתֵיב לִכְנָס יִזְכֹּר לִכְנָס
יִזְכֹּר לֹא הִשְׁמַח בּוֹ וְכָל
פָּנָיו נָפְלָה

He didn’t notice the vegetables.

Genesis 4:6

And YHWH said to Cain, “Why are you upset, and why has your face fallen?”

יִזְכֹּר לִכְנָס בְּיָדֶיךָ אֶת
הַלֵּוֹי וְלָמָּה נָפְלָה פָנֶיךָ
וְלָמָּה

But he notices Maker is sad.

Genesis 4:7

Is it not that if you do well you'll be raised, and if you don't do well then sin crouches at the threshold? And its desire will be for you. And you'll dominate it.

אִם לָבִיטָהּ אֵת וְאִם לֹא
הִשְׁמַח בּוֹ אֵת וְאִם לֹא
אֵת וְאִם לֹא אֵת וְאִם לֹא
אֵת וְאִם לֹא אֵת וְאִם לֹא
אֵת

So YHWH says, well, whatever this is.

Genesis 4:7.

One of the greatest misconceptions about Biblical Hebrew is the assumption that we understand it as well as Classical Greek or Latin. We do not. Hundreds of Hebrew words—and countless idioms, expressions, and passages—remain uncertain even to the world’s leading scholars. Every translation must therefore make choices on the reader’s behalf, sometimes explaining the uncertainty in a footnote, but more often leaving only the familiar refrain, “Meaning of Heb. uncertain.” Even when the meanings of Hebrew terms are well-known, it is often far from clear what an author was up to.

Hebrew	Meaning
כֹּלֹא	surely? is it not?
וְכִי	if
וַיַּעַשׂ כָּל־טוֹב	do well
וַיִּקַּח	lifting; acceptance; forgiveness
וְכִי־כִי	but if
כֹּלֹ	not
וַיַּעַשׂ כָּל־טוֹב	do well
בַּיָּדָא	at the doorway
וַיִּקַּח־טוֹב	sin; sin offering
וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוֶה	crouching; lying down
וַיִּזְלַח־כִּי	toward you
וַיִּתְּנֶהוּ־וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוֶה	desire; longing (3× in the Bible)
כִּי־וַיִּקַּח	but you
לְוַיִּתְּנֶהוּ	rule; master
וַיִּתְּנֶהוּ	over it

Genesis 4:8

And Cain said to his brother Abel.
And it was while they were in the
field, and Cain rose against Abel
his brother and killed him.

לֹאֵל לֹא יִזְכֹּר אֶת־כַּדָּו
וַיִּתְּנֶהוּ זָכָר וַיִּזְכֹּר
לֹא יִזְכֹּר וַיִּזְכֹּר זָכָר
וַיִּזְכֹּר וַיִּזְכֹּר לֹאֵל

And so Cain says.³⁰
And they were in the field and he killed him.

Genesis 4:9

And YHWH said to Cain, “Where
is Abel your brother?” And he
said, “I don’t know. Am I my
brother’s watchman?”

יִזְכֹּר לֹא זָכָר אֶת־כַּדָּו
אֶת־כַּדָּו וַיִּזְכֹּר לֹאֵל זָכָר
זָכָר אֶת־כַּדָּו זָכָר
זָכָר

Gen 3:9, YHWH loses track of Adam.
Gen 4:9, YHWH loses track of Abel.

³⁰Something happened here.

Genesis 4:10

And He said, “What have you done? The sound! Your brother’s blood is crying to me from the ground!

ረዓዋ ተገወዐ ጳጉ ላግቶጊሃ
ጊረቱ ሃጊዋዐኢ ሃጊዘቱ ጊግላ
ጳግላቱን ነግ

Creator is mad at creator.

Genesis 4:11

And now you’re cursed from the ground that opened its mouth to take your brother’s blood from your hand.

ነግ ጳተቱ ላሃላቱ ጳተዐሃ
ጳተኢገ ላሠቱ ጳግላቱን
ጊግላ ተቱ ተዘዋረ ጳጊገ ተቱ
ሃላጊግ ሃጊዘቱ

So now he’s cursed from the ጳግላቱ (admh) too.

Like father like son.

Genesis 4:12

When you work the ground it won’t continue to give its potency to you. You’ll be a roamer and rover in the earth.”

ጳግላቱን ተቱ ላዓዐተ ጊሃ
ዐነ ሃረ ጳዘሃ ተተ ገቹተ ቶረ
ኢላቱዓ ጳጊጳተ ላሃሃ

So he curses him to wander around.

Genesis 4:13

And Cain said to YHWH, “My crime is greater than I can bear.

ጳሃጳጊ ረቱ ነጊዋ ላግቶጊሃ
ቱሠነግ ጊሃነዐ ረሃላገ

So Cain regrets it.

Genesis 4:14

Here, you’ve expelled me from the face of the ground today and I’ll be hidden from your presence, and I’ll be a roamer and rover in the earth, and anyone who finds me will kill me.”

ሃሃጊጳ ጊተቱ ተሠላገ ነጳ
ጳግላቱን ጊነገ ረዐግ
ጊተጊጊጳሃ ላተቹቱ ሃጊነገግሃ
ረሃ ጳጊጳሃ ኢላቱዓ ላሃሃ ዐነ
ጊነገላጳጊ ጊቶኢግ

He’s like “Anyone who finds me will kill me.”

Genesis 4:15

And YHWH said to him,
 “Therefore: anyone who kills
 Cain, he’ll be avenged sevenfold.”
 And YHWH set a sign for Cain so
 that anyone who finds him would
 not strike him.

ለእነዚህ ሕዝቦች ሕግ አደረገ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ

So YHWH says “Nobody kill this guy.”

He says if you kill Cain, he’ll you like, seven times, or something.

Nobody knows what the sign is.

Genesis 4:16

And Cain went out from YHWH’s
 presence and lived in the land of
 Nod, east of Eden.

እነዚህ ሕዝቦች ሕግ አደረገ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ

So he goes to the land of Wandering.

It’s apparently east of Eden.

Now back in Gen. 3:24, we learned that the exit to Eden is on the east.

So it’s not entirely clear he went anywhere.

So Cain goes to Iran.

Iran is East of Eden.

No really, I promise.

Source: Tigris and Euphrates from Genesis 2, then go East.

Genesis 4:17

And Cain knew his wife, and she
 became pregnant and gave birth to
 Enoch. And he was a builder of a
 city, and he called the name of the
 city like the name of his son:
 Enoch.

እነዚህ ሕዝቦች ሕግ አደረገ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ
 ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ ማለቱ

Anyways, Cain has sex with his wife.³¹

³¹Readers of the bible — religious and unreligious, scholars and laymen, modern and ancient — are in universal agreement that this verse raises the highly important theological question, “Where did she come from?!”

And she apparently (1) gets pregnant, and (2) exists.

The verbs are in the usual order this time.

That’s a bit more evidence that the grammar in Gen 4:1 was intentional.

Anyways, Cain makes a kid and names it Enoch.

And he also makes a city, and names it Enoch.

Genesis 4:18

And Irad was born to Enoch, and
Irad fathered Mehuya-el, and
Mehuya-el fathered Metusha-el,
and Metusha-el fathered Lamech.

תָּכָה יָרָדְיָהֶל אֶלְיָזָר
תָּכָה אֶלְזֹ אֲמִזָּוָה אֲמִזָּו
אֶלְזֹ לִבְרָיָהוּיָ לִבְרָיָהוּיָ
לִבְרָיָהוּיָ לִבְרָיָהוּיָ תָכָה
יָמְלֹ תָכָה אֶלְזֹ

Then Enoch has a kid and names it “city.”

Irād (עִירָד; *Īrād*).

Cain’s grandson and the son of Enoch (Gen. 4:18). The name is probably related to עִיר (*îr*, “city”), though its etymology is uncertain.

City (עִיר; *îr*).

City, town, settlement. The standard Hebrew word for an inhabited, often fortified, urban center.

Then there are some people with the word “El” in their names.

Mehuja-el (מְחִיָּהֶל; *Məḥûyā `ēl*).

Son of Irad. An early theophoric name containing הֶל (El). Its precise meaning is uncertain, with proposed translations including “struck by El” and “given life by El.”

Methusha-el (מֶתוּשָׁאֶל; *Məṯûšā `ēl*).

Son of Mehujael. Another early theophoric name containing הֶל. Its exact meaning is uncertain, though it is commonly understood as something like “man of El” or “one who belongs to El.”

Lots going on here.

El (אֵל; *`ēl*).

The name of the chief deity of the Canaanite pantheon, and also the generic Northwest Semitic word for “god.” Names containing אֵל were common throughout Canaan long before the worship of YHWH became dominant in Israel, and remained common in Israelite names

such as *Samuel*, *Ezekiel*, *Daniel*, and especially *Israel* (“El strives” or “May El strive”).

Then there’s this guy named LMK (Lamech).

Lamech (לֶמֶךְ; *Lemek*).

The meaning of his name is unknown; no convincing Hebrew or Northwest Semitic etymology has been identified.

Genesis 4:19

And Lamech took two wives. The one’s name was Adah, and the second’s name was Zillah.

ሠጊሠሃ ጊተሠ ጥሠረ ሃረ ዘዋጊሃ
ሠሠሃ ጳላዐ ተዘፋጳ ሠሠ
ጳረሥ ተጊሃሠጳ

So Lamech invents polygamy.

Genesis 4:20

And Adah gave birth to Jabel. He was father of tent-dweller and cattleman.

ፋሃጳ ረዓጊ ተፋ ጳላዐ ላረተሃ
ረጳፋ ዓሠጊ ጊዓፋ ጳጊጳ
ጳሃዋሠሃ

Nobody knows why Jabel.

Genesis 4:21

And his brother’s name was Jubal. He was father of every player of lyre and pipe.

ፋሃጳ ረዓሃጊ ሃጊዘፋ ሠሠሃ
ላሃሃሃ ሠገተ ረሃ ጊዓፋ ጳጊጳ
ዓሃሃዐሃ

Nobody knows why Jubal.

Byblos (Greek: Βύβλος; also known as *Jbail*, *Jebeil*, *Jbeil*, *Jubayl*; Arabic جَبِيل *Jbeil*, *Jubayl*).

An ancient city in the Keserwan–Jbeil Governorate of Lebanon. The area is believed to have been first settled between 8800 and 7000 BC and continuously inhabited since 5000 BC. During its history, Byblos was part of numerous cultures including Canaanite, Egyptian, Phoenician, Assyrian, Persian, Hellenistic, Roman, Genoese, Mamluk, and Ottoman. Urbanisation is thought to have begun during the third millennium BC when it developed into a city, making it one of the oldest cities in the world, if not the oldest.

Genesis 4:22

And Zillah, too, gave birth to
Tubal-Cain, forger of every
implement of bronze and iron.
And Tubal-Cain’s sister was
Naamah.

ተፋ ጳላረጊ ፋሃጃ ሣገ ጳረሣሃ
ሠላዘ ረሃ ሠፀረ ሃጊዋ ረዓሃተ
ተሃዘፋሃ ረገላዓሃ ተሠዘሃ
ጳሣዐሃ ሃጊዋ ረዓሃተ

Naamah is also Rehoboam’s mom.

Who’s Re—

Forget it. We’ll get there eventually.

Genesis 4:23

And Lamech said to his wives:
Adah and Zillah, listen to my
voice, Wives of Lamech, hear
what I say. For I’ve killed a man
for a wound to me And a boy for a
hurt to me,

ጳላዐሃ ሂጊሠሃ ረሃ ሣሣ ረዓሃ
ጊሠሃ ጊረሃዋ ሃዐሣሠ ጳረሣሃ
ጊተላሣፋ ጳሃጊፋጃ ሃሣ ረ
ጊዐሣገረ ጊተገላጃ ሠጊፋ ጊሃ
ጊተላዓዘረ ላረጊሃ

So Lamech’s like:

A man I slew who dared my peace molest;
A youth I struck who rose against my breast.
The wound he gave was slight, the vengeance great;
Such is the portion rebels earn from fate.

“Look I’m Cain twice.”

Genesis 4:24

For Cain will be avenged
sevenfold And Lamech
seventy-seven.

ሃጊዋ ሣዋጊ ሣጊተዐዓሠ ጊሃ
ጳዐዓሠሃ ሣጊዐዓሠ ሃሣ ረሃ

Two wives.

Two murders.

Two sevens.

Lamech out.

Genesis 4:25

And Adam knew his wife again,
and she gave birth to a son, and
she called his name Seth “because
God put another seed for me in
place of Abel because Cain killed
him.”

וידע אדם עוד את
אשתו ותלד בן ותקרא
את שמו שת כי שת לי
אלהים זרע אחר תחת
הבל כי הרגו קין

Now the Redactor shows up.

He needs to solve a problem we haven’t gotten to yet.

Stick around for a few more sentences and that’ll make sense.

Genesis 4:26

And a son was born to Seth, him
as well, and he called his name
Enosh. Then it was begun to
invoke the name YHWH.

ולשת גם הוא ילד בן
ויקרא את שמו אנוש
והחל לקרוא בשם
יהוה

Then Seth has a kid whose name is suspiciously similar to Enoch.

Then the chapter ends with a strange comment that seems to say

This was when people started to use the name YHWH.

Genesis 5

Genesis 5:1

This is the Book of Records of the Human. In the day of God’s creating a human, He made it in the likeness of God.

ሕዳሴ ሕፃኑ ጸላላጽ ባገቹ ባለ
ጸሐፊዎች ሕፃኑ ሕዳሴ ጸሐፊ
ሕፃኑ ይሆን ሕዳሴ

Ok so now the book turns into a big spreadsheet of who begat whom.

Genesis 5:2

He created them male and female, and He blessed them and called their name “Human” in the day of their being created.

ሕዳሴ ሕፃኑ ይሆን ባለ
ሕዳሴ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ሕፃኑ
ሕፃኑ ይሆን ሕፃኑ

Here we get to see how a historian works with sources.

Genesis 5:3

And the human lived a hundred thirty years, and he fathered in his likeness—like his image—and called his name Seth.

ሕዳሴ ሕፃኑ ገደባለ
ሕዳሴ ይሆን ጸሐፊ
ሕዳሴ ሕዳሴ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ
ሕዳሴ ይሆን ጸሐፊ

Here’s that problem the Redactor needed to solve back in Gen 4:25.

No Cain and Abel here in the spreadsheet, just Seth.

So we go back and mention Seth at the end of the previous chapter.

Genesis 5:4

And the human’s days after his fathering Seth were eight hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ሕዳሴ ሕፃኑ ገደባለ
ሕዳሴ ይሆን ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ
ሕዳሴ ሕዳሴ ይሆን ጸሐፊ
ሕዳሴ ይሆን

Now we don’t have to reconcile this genealogy with the previous one.

Since we added Seth to Gen 4:25, the previous genealogy and this one can co-exist side by side.

Hence, the following list of people who sound suspiciously like the ones before, but not quite.

Genesis 5:5

And all of the human's days that he lived were nine hundred years and thirty years. And he died.

ሃወል ሕፃናት የሕይወቱ ስድስት መቶ ዓመት ሆኖ ሞትዋል።

It's a bit anti-climactic, but whatever.

It's a spreadsheet, give it a break.

Genesis 5:6

And Seth lived five years and a hundred years, and he fathered Enosh.

ሕይወቱ ስድስት ዓመት ሆኖ ሞትዋል።

Ok so forget Cain and Abel and all those other people, they're a sort of deleted Adam & Eve scene now.

Starting over with Seth and Enosh.

Genesis 5:7

And Seth lived after his fathering Enosh seven years and eight hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ሕይወቱ ስድስት ዓመት ሆኖ ሞትዋል።

Don't get distracted by the crazy long lives.

Something interesting is about to happen.

Genesis 5:8

And all of Seth's days were twelve years and nine hundred years. And he died.

ሕይወቱ ስድስት ዓመት ሆኖ ሞትዋል።

Ok here we go.

Genesis 5:9

And Enosh lived ninety years, and he fathered Cainan.

ሕይወቱ ስድስት ዓመት ሆኖ ሞትዋል።

Cainan sounds a bit like Cain.

Genesis 5:10

And Enosh lived after his
fathering Cainan fifteen years and
eight hundred years, and he
fathered sons and daughters.

ሃፋፋፊ ያገለገለ ሠላሳ ስምዕን
እናልፍ ሠላሳ ስምዕን እናልፍ
እናልፍ ሠላሳ ስምዕን እናልፍ
እናልፍ ሠላሳ ስምዕን

Focus.

Genesis 5:11

And all of Enosh’s days were five
years and nine hundred years.
And he died.

ሠላሳ ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን

Here comes another one.

Genesis 5:12

And Cainan lived seventy years,
and he fathered Mahalalel.

እናልፍ ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን

Guy with “El” in his name.

Genesis 5:13

And Cainan lived after his
fathering Mahalalel forty years
and eight hundred years, and he
fathered sons and daughters.

ሃፋፋፊ ያገለገለ ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን

Focus.

Genesis 5:14

And all of Cainan’s days were ten
years and nine hundred years.
And he died.

እናልፍ ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን
ስምዕን ስምዕን ስምዕን

Here comes another one.

Genesis 5:15

And Mahalalel lived five years and sixty years, and he fathered Jared.

ወሥፀ ሊፋሊላይ ያፀገ
፳፱ ዓመታት ወሥፀ ያፀገ
፳፱ ዓመታት ሊፋላይ

Jared sounds like Irad.

The guy whose name meant city.

Who was the father of the El-named guy last time, now he's the son.

Genesis 5:16

And Mahalalel lived after his fathering Jared thirty years and eight hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ከወሥፀ ሊፋሊላይ ያፀገ
ዓመታት ፳፱ ዓመታት ሃፋሊላይ
፳፱ ዓመታት ወሥፀ ያፀገ
ወሥፀ ያፀገ ወሥፀ ያፀገ

Focus.

Genesis 5:17

And all of Mahalalel's days were ninety-five years and eight hundred years. And he died.

ሊፋሊላይ ያፀገ ስድስት ሃያ
፳፱ ዓመታት ወሥፀ ያፀገ
፳፱ ዓመታት ወሥፀ ያፀገ
ወሥፀ ያፀገ

Here comes another one.

Genesis 5:18

And Jared lived sixty-two years and a hundred years, and he fathered Enoch.

ወሥፀ ያፀገ ፳፱ ዓመታት
፳፱ ዓመታት ወሥፀ ያፀገ
ወሥፀ ያፀገ

Last time, Enoch had a kid named Irad (‘IRD; Heb. עִירָד).

This time, Enoch has a dad named Jared (IRD; Heb. יָרֵד).

Something's going on.

Genesis 5:19

And Jared lived after his fathering Enoch eight hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ወሥፀ ያፀገ ወሥፀ ያፀገ
፳፱ ዓመታት ወሥፀ ያፀገ
ወሥፀ ያፀገ

Focus.

Genesis 5:20

And all of Jared’s days were sixty-two years and nine hundred years. And he died.	ሣገጸው ሳፋገ ገሣገ ሊሄ ሳፋገገ ዐውጸሃ ጃህወ ሣገውወሃ ጸሣገገ ጃህወ ጸሃፋሣ
---	---

Here comes another one.

Genesis 5:21

And Enoch lived sixty-five years, and he fathered Methuselah.	ወሣፀ ሥሃሣፀ ገፀገገ ጸፋ ሳገገገ ጃህወ ሣገውወሃ ፀሊወሃጸሣ
--	--

Last time we had Metusha-el and Mehuya-el.
Not quite another El name, but another suspiciously similar one.

Genesis 5:22

And Enoch walked with God after his fathering Methuselah three hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.	ጸፋ ሥሃሣፀ ሥሊጃጸገገ ጸፋ ሳፋገሊሃ ገሃፀፋ ሣገጃሊፋጃ ጸሃፋሣ ወሊወ ፀሊወሃጸሣ ጸሃሣገገ ሣገሣገ ሳገገገ ጃህወ
--	--

Focus.

Genesis 5:23

And all of Enoch’s days were sixty-five years and three hundred years.	ወሣፀ ሥሃሣፀ ገሣገ ሊሄ ገጃገገ ወሊወሃ ጃህወ ሣገውወሃ ጃህወ ጸሃፋሣ
--	--

Now for something completely different.

Genesis 5:24

And Enoch walked with God, and he was not, because God took him.	ጸፋ ሥሃሣፀ ሥሊጃጸገገ ፀቐሊ ገሄ ሳሣገገፋሃ ሣገጃሊፋጃ ሣገጃሊፋ ሃጸፋ
--	---

There’s been a lot of fanfiction about this line.

Genesis 5:25

And Methuselah lived eighty-seven years and a hundred years, and he fathered Lamech.

ዐጎወ ፀረዋኣኣ ገፀገ
አፋኣኣ ዩነወ ሣገነሣወኣ
ሥሣረ አፋ ሳሊገኣ ዩነወ

And there's Lamech.

Genesis 5:26

And Methuselah lived after his fathering Lamech eighty-two years and seven hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ገፀፋ ፀረዋኣኣ ገፀገ
ሣገአወ ሥሣረ አፋ ነፋሲኣ
ዐጎወኣ ዩነወ ሣገነሣወኣ
ሣገነጎ ሳሊገኣ ዩነወ አሣፋኣ
አሣነጎኣ

Focus.

Genesis 5:27

And all of Methuselah's days were sixty-nine years and nine hundred years. And he died.

ፀረዋኣኣ ገሣገ ሊሥ ነፋጃገኣ
ዩነወ ሣገወወኣ ዐወአ
አሣገኣ ዩነወ አሣፋኣ ዐወአኣ

Ok so, remember how Lamech was kind of a despotic tyrant?³²

Genesis 5:28

And Lamech lived eighty-two years and a hundred years, and he fathered a son

ሣገአወ ሥሣረ ገፀገ
አፋኣኣ ዩነወ ሣገነሣወኣ
ነጎ ሳሊገኣ ዩነወ

Well there's this old thing called the Sumerian kings list.

Everyone lives a really long time.

Then the final king in the list

Ubara-Tutu.

Ubara-Tutu was, according to some versions of the *Sumerian King List*, the last antediluvian king of Sumer, ruling from Shuruppak. He was said to have reigned for 18,600 years. He was the son of Enmendurana, the legendary king often compared with the biblical Enoch because he was taken up to heaven without dying. His reign

³²Also Lamech's name (LMK) is a permutation of the Hebrew word for king (MLK), but I digress.

ended when the great flood swept over the land. Ubara-Tutu is also mentioned briefly in Tablet XI of the *Epic of Gilgamesh*, where he is identified as the father of Utnapishtim, whom the god Ea warns to build a boat in order to survive the coming flood.

has a kid.

And that kid builds a boat.

And survives a great flood.

Anyways, on that note.

Genesis 5:29

and called his name Noah, saying,
“This one will console us from our
labor and from our hands’
suffering from the ground, which
YHWH has cursed.”

וִיקְרָא אֶת שְׁמוֹ נֹחַ
לֵאמֹר זֶה יִנְחֵמֵנוּ
מִמַּעֲשָׁנוּ וּמֵעֲצָבוֹן יְדֵינוּ
מִן הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר אָרְרָה
יְהוָה:

So here’s Noah.

Genesis 5:30

And Lamech lived after his
fathering Noah ninety-five years
and five hundred years, and he
fathered sons and daughters.

וַיִּחְיֶינָה לָמֶכְךָ אַחֲרֵי
אֲבֹתוֹ שְׁנָיִם אֶלֶף
וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת וְחָמֵשׁ
עָשָׂר שָׁנָה וַיֵּלֶד
בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת

Noah had siblings.

Genesis 5:31

And all of Lamech’s days were
seventy-seven years and seven
hundred years. And he died.

וְכָל יְמֵי לָמֶכְךָ
שִׁבְעִים וְשֶׁבַע
שָׁנָה וְשִׁבְעִים
וָשֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה
וַיָּמָת

Despite the differences between our two genealogies,

Lamech is still all about seven seven seven.

Genesis 5:32

And Noah was five hundred years
old, and Noah fathered Shem,
Ham, and Yaphet.

እስከአምስት መቶ ዓመት ሲገኝ
ከእሱምና ከአም
አባታቸው ሆኖአል

Here we go.

Genesis 6

Genesis 6:1

And it was when humankind began to multiply on the face of the ground and daughters were born to them:

ዓለ ሥላሴ ለዘን ጸገ ጸጸገ
ተሃፃሃ ጸሥላሴ ጸገገ ረዐ
ሥጸ ሃለገ

Ok so, as people get fruitful and multiply on the face of the ground.

Genesis 6:2

and the sons of the gods saw the daughters of humankind, that they were attractive, and they took women, from all they chose.

ሥጸ ለሴት ጸገ ሃሳፈገ
ጸገ ሥላሴ ተሃፃ ተሴ
ሥጸ ሃዘዋገ ጸገ ተዓፅ
ሃዘዓ ሳሠ ለገሥ ሥጸሠ

These sons of the god(s) show up and have sex with human women.

Genesis 6:3

And YHWH said, “My spirit won’t stay in humankind forever, since they’re also flesh; and their days shall be a hundred twenty years.”

ሃላገ ሔ ጸሃጸ ሳሥገገ
ሥረዐ ሥላሴ ጸዘሃ
ሃጸሃ ሳሠ ሔት ሥገሠ
ሥጸሠዐ ጸሐሥ ሃገሥገ
ጸሃሠ

And YHWH’s like “Nobody gets to live longer than 120 years anymore.

Genesis 6:4

The nephilim were in the earth in those days & there^η after^η that as well when the sons of the^π god^θ s^α ou^{gh}t & came^{to} the daughters ofⁱⁿ humankind³ & they gave birth by^{1 2} them, they were the heroes of old,^{5 4 6 7} people of renown.

ሥላሴ ሃጸ ሥጸገገጸ
ጸዘሔ ሥገ ሥጸ ሥጸገጸ
ጸገ ሃሳፈ ሳሠ ገ
ተሃፃ ለሴ ሥጸ ለሴ ጸ
ጸገ ሥጸ ሃለገገ ሥላሴ
ሥረዐ ሳሠ ሥጸፃፃፃ
ሥሠ ጸሠሐ

(Let’s keep moving.)

Genesis 6:5

And YHWH saw that human bad was multiplied in the earth, and every inclination of their heart's thoughts was only bad all the day.

אָדָּא זיך אַנאָז פֿאַרזי
לִיךְ יִצְחָק וְאַבְרָם + וְ
וְאֵל פֿאַרזי + וְאֵל פֿאַרזי
וְאֵל פֿאַרזי

I'm sick of you people.”

Genesis 6:6

And YHWH regretted that He had made humankind in the earth. And He was grieved to His heart.

אָדָּא זיך אַנאָז וְאֵל פֿאַרזי
יִצְחָק וְאַבְרָם + וְ
וְאֵל פֿאַרזי + וְאֵל פֿאַרזי

Nobody's perfect.

Genesis 6:7

And YHWH said, “I'll wipe out the human whom I've created from the face of the earth, from human to animal to creeping thing, and to the bird of the skies, because I regret that I made them.”

אָדָּא זיך אַנאָז אַנאָז
זיך אַנאָז אַנאָז + וְ
וְאֵל פֿאַרזי אַנאָז זיך
אָדָּא זיך אַנאָז אַנאָז
זיך אַנאָז זיך אַנאָז זיך

So he decides to start over.

Genesis 6:8

But Noah had found favor in YHWH's eyes.

זיך אַנאָז אַנאָז אַנאָז
אָדָּא זיך אַנאָז

He likes one guy though.

Genesis 6:9

These are the records of Noah: Noah was a virtuous man. He was unblemished in his generations. Noah walked with God.

אלה תולדת נח
איש צדיק תמים היה
בדרתיו את האלהים
התהלך נח

Ok so now the Red—

Who?

actor comes back and...

OH, H אל

What?

ו... HIM.

Who?

Genesis 6:10

And Noah fathered three sons:
Shem, Ham, and Yaphet.

וַיּוֹלֶד נֹחַ שְׁלֹשָׁה בָּנִים
אֶת שֵׁם אֶת חָם וְאֶת
יָפֶת

No...

Eh?

Ah..

What?

P’s back.

Who’s P?

Author of Genesis 1.

What’s he like?

A bit verbose.

Why’d you say “No...”?

Genesis 6:11

And the earth was corrupted
before God, and the earth was
filled with violence.

וַתִּשְׁחָת הָאָרֶץ לִפְנֵי
הָאֱלֹהִים וַתִּמָּלֵא הָאָרֶץ
חָמָס

Everything sucks now.

Genesis 6:12

And God saw the earth; and, here, it was corrupted, because all flesh had corrupted its way on the earth.

וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָרֶץ וְהִנֵּה נִשְׁחָתָה כִּי הִשְׁחִית כָּל בָּשָׂר אֶת דְּרָכֹוֹ עַל הָאָרֶץ

What sucks?

Earth.

Why?

Because meat. We're made of meat. It's sucks to be meat on the earth.

Genesis 6:13

And God said to Noah, “The end of all flesh has come before me, because the earth is filled with violence because of them. And here: I’m destroying them with the earth.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים לְנֹחַ קֵץ כָּל בָּשָׂר בָּא לִפְנֵי כִּי מָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ חָמָס מִפְּנֵיהֶם וְהִנְנִי מַשְׁחִיתָם אֶת הָאָרֶץ

Anyways, last we left off, back in Genesis 2:3.

When the **Elohim**³³ character had just finished creation.

And on the seventh day he rested...

When the weekend is over and he returns to work, **God** says:

There's too much violence.

I'm going to kill everything on earth.

Genesis 6:14

Make yourself an ark of gopher wood, make rooms with the ark, and pitch it outside and inside with pitch.

עֲשֵׂה לָךְ תֵּבָה עֲצֵי גֹפֶר קָנִים תַּעֲשֶׂה אֶת הַתֵּבָה וְכִפַּרְתָּ אֹתָהּ מִבֵּיתָ וּמִחוּץ בַּכֹּפֶר

So he tells his favorite guy to make a box.

³³Also known as **God**.

An ark is just a box.

Genesis 6:15

And this is how you shall make it: three hundred cubits the length of the ark, fifty cubits its width, and thirty cubits its height.

וְזֶה אֲשֶׁר תַּעֲשֶׂה אֹתָהּ
שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת אַמָּה אָרְךָ
חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה
רָחְבָּהּ וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אַמָּה
קוֹמָתָהּ

Exactly. Box.

Genesis 6:16

You shall make a window for the ark, and you shall finish it to a cubit from the top, and you shall make the ark’s entrance in its side. You shall make lower, second, and third stories for it.

צֹהַר תַּעֲשֶׂה לַתִּבְּיָה וְאֶל
אַמָּה תְּכַלֶּנָּה מִלְּמַעְלָה
וּפֶתַח הַתִּבְּיָה בְּצִדָּהּ
תָּשִׂים תַּחְתִּיִּים שְׁנַיִם
וּשְׁלֹשִׁים תַּעֲשֶׂה

Make the box have a window.

The window goes on the top.

Make the box have a door.

The door goes on the side.

Make the box be three stories.

The stairs are implied.

Genesis 6:17

And I, here: I’m bringing the flood, water on the earth, to destroy all flesh in which is the breath of life from under the skies. Everything that is in the earth will expire.

וְאֲנִי הִנְנִי מֵבִיא אֶת
הַמָּבּוּל מַיִם עַל הָאָרֶץ
לְשַׁחֵת כָּל בָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר
בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים מִתַּחַת
הַשָּׁמַיִם כֹּל אֲשֶׁר בָּאָרֶץ
יָגוּעַ

P likes to say “expire” instead of “die.”

Genesis 6:18

And I shall establish my covenant with you. And you'll come to the ark, you and your sons and your wife and your sons' wives with you.

וְהִקְמַתִּי אֶת בְּרִיתִי
אִתָּךְ וּבָאתָ אֵל הַתֵּבָה
אַתָּה וּבְנֶיךָ וְאִשְׁתְּךָ
וְנִשְׁי בְנֶיךָ אִתָּךְ

No mention of his siblings. Remember that line where he had siblings?

Genesis 6:19

And of all the living, of all flesh, you shall bring two of each to the ark to keep alive with you. They shall be male and female.

וּמִכָּל הַחַי מִכָּל בֶּשָׂר
שְׁנַיִם מִכָּל תָּבִיא אֵל
הַתֵּבָה לְהַחֲיֹת אִתָּךְ
זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה יְהִיו

Two of each kind of animal.

One male, one female.

Genesis 6:20

Of the birds by their kind and of the domestic animals by their kind, of all the creeping things of the ground by their kind, two of each will come to you to keep alive.

מִהָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ וּמִן
הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ מִכָּל
רֶמֶשׂ הָאָדָמָה לְמִינֵהוּ
שְׁנַיִם מִכָּל יָבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ
לְהַחֲיֹת

Ok so he gets the birds. By their kind.

And like, pets and cows. By their kind.

And the bugs presumably. By their kind.

Genesis 6:21

And you, take some of every food that will be eaten and gather it to you, and it will be for you and for them for food.”

וְאַתָּה קַח לְךָ מִכָּל
מֵאָכֹל אֲשֶׁר יֵאָכֵל
וְאַסַּפְתָּ אֵלֶיךָ וְהָיָה לְךָ
וּלְהֶם לְאֹכֶלָה

The food will be for food.

Thanks, P.

Genesis 6:22

And Noah did it. According to everything that God commanded him, he did so.

וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה
אֱלֹהִים כִּן עָשָׂה

Noah did it.

Seriously, he did it all.

He did so.

Genesis 7

Genesis 7:1

And YHWH said to Noah,
“Come, you and all your
household, into an ark, for I’ve
seen you as virtuous in front of
me in this generation.

𐤀𐤓 𐤇𐤓𐤕 𐤓𐤕𐤓𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕

Praise the LORD!

The Yahwist (J).

The name traditionally given to the author or source whose stories characteristically use the divine name YHWH from the beginning. J is associated with vivid, earthy narratives, anthropomorphic portrayals of God, and stories of family, sex, deception, and other timeless, universal human themes. Unlike the priestly sources, J places little emphasis on law, ritual, or moralizing, preferring to explore human nature through narrative. The J source also develops female characters more deeply than the other sources and appears not to have been a priest, but rather to have had some connection or affinity to the royal court of the Davidic monarchy.

J is commonly dated to around 922 B.C., making J the first and earliest author of the bible, apart from a handful of brief poems and songs. J is credited with writing most of the bible’s best-known stories, including the Garden of Eden, Cain and Abel, Noah’s Flood (with P), the Tower of Babel, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob (with E and P), Joseph and his brothers (with E), baby Moses in the basket, the burning bush (with E), narrative sections of Numbers, the death of Moses (with E, P, and D). Recent source analysis has shown J to have been additionally the probable author of much of Joshua, Judges, 1 Samuel, all of 2 Samuel, and the first two chapters of Kings.

Some scholars have argued that J was a woman. Some have argued J was not, in fact, a religious author, and that J’s writing reflects one of the most subtle and well developed senses of humor in world literature, one rooted in irony, wordplay, and understatement that readers have been misunderstanding for nearly three thousand years.

No author in history has had a greater influence on world culture, religion, and literature, nor is any other author a close second.

J’s back.

Genesis 7:2

Of all the pure animals, take seven pairs, man and his woman; and of the animals that are not pure, two, man and his woman.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So YHWH says to take seven pairs of every pure animal.

Pure here means “fit for sacrifice,” that is, edible.

We’ll need more than two each of the edible animals.

Cuz we’re gonna eat some.

Two of each is fine for the others.

Genesis 7:3

Also of the birds of the skies seven pairs, male and female, to keep seed alive on the face of the earth.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

We’ll be eating the birds, so seven pairs of each of those.

We’ll also need them for another reason later.

Genesis 7:4

Because in seven more days I’ll rain on the earth, forty days and forty nights, and I’ll wipe out all the substance that I’ve made from on the face of the earth.”

ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Seven is a bible number.³⁴

Ten is a bible number.³⁵

Twelve is a bible number.³⁶

Forty is a bible number.³⁷

³⁴Seven heavenly bodies visible with the naked eye.

³⁵You can figure out this one.

³⁶We’ve been over this one.

³⁷No one knows why.

Genesis 7:5

And Noah did according to all that
YHWH had commanded him.

וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכָל
אֲשֶׁר צִוָּהוּ יְהוָה

So Noah does all the stuff. Less verbosely this time.

Genesis 7:6

And Noah was six hundred years
old when the flood was, water on
the earth.

וַיְהִי בַּיּוֹם
הַהוּא שֵׁשׁ
מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה
וָחֵץ וַיְהִי
נֹחַ בֶּן שֵׁשׁ
מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה

The spreadsheet or some related document shows up for a sentence to say
how old he was.

Genesis 7:7

And Noah and his sons and his
wife and his sons' wives with him
came to the ark from before the
waters of the flood.

וַיָּבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ
נֹחַ וְכָל
בָּנָיו וְכָל
אִשְׁתּוֹ וְכָל
אִשְׁתּוֹת בָּנָיו
עִמָּהּ

Eventually, you'll get to know The Authors well enough to doubt the colors
of some of these verses.

Genesis 7:8

Of the animals that were pure
and of the animals that were
not pure, and of the birds and
every one that creeps on the
ground,

מִן הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהוֹרָה
וּמִן הַבְּהֵמָה הָאֲשֶׁר
אֵינָנָה טְהוֹרָה וּמִן הָעוֹף
וְכָל אֲשֶׁר רֹמֵשׁ עַל
הָאֲדָמָה׃

Ok so, for both the pure (edible) and impure (inedible) animals,

Genesis 7:9

they came by twos to Noah, to
the ark, male and female, as
God had commanded Noah.

שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם בָּאוּ אֵלַי
אֵל הַתֵּבָה זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה
כְּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֱלֹהִים אֶת
נֹחַ׃

we have two of each on the ark.

Genesis 7:10

And seven days later the waters of the flood were on the earth.

וַיְהִי אַחֲרָיִם יָמִים
וַיִּהְיֶה מַבּוּל עַל הָאָרֶץ
וַיִּהְיֶה מַבּוּל אַרְבָּעַת
עָשָׂר יָמִים

A week later it's wet.

Genesis 7:11

In the six hundredth year of Noah's life, in the second month, in the seventeenth day of the month, on this day all the fountains of the great deep were split open, and the apertures of the skies were opened.

בַּשָּׁנָה שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה
לְחַיֵּי נֹחַ בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי
בְּשִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר יוֹם
לְחֹדֶשׁ בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה
נִבְקְעוּ כָּל מַעֲיִנֹת תְּהוֹם
רַבָּה וַאֲרָבַת הַשָּׁמַיִם
נִפְתְּחוּ׃

On February 17th it starts to rain.³⁸

Genesis 7:12

And there was rain on the earth, forty days and forty nights.

וַיִּהְיֶה גֶשֶׁם עַל הָאָרֶץ
אַרְבָּעַת עָשָׂר יָמִים
וְאַרְבָּעַת עָשָׂר יָמִים

It rains for a bible number of days.

Genesis 7:13

In this very day Noah came, and Shem and Ham and Yaphet, Noah's sons, and Noah's wife and his sons' three wives with them to the ark,

בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה בָּא נֹחַ
וְשֵׁם וְחָם וְיָפֶת בְּנֵי נֹחַ
וְאִשְׁת׃ נֹחַ וּשְׁלֹשֶׁת נָשִׁים
בָּנָיו אִתָּם אֶל הַתֵּבָה׃

Family gets on boat.

³⁸Not really February. They had different months back then.

Genesis 7:14

they and all the wild animals by their kind and all the domestic animals by their kind and all the creeping animals that creep on the earth by their kind and all the birds by their kind, all fowl, all winged things.

הַמָּה וְכָל הַחַיָּה לְמִינָהּ
וְכָל הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ
וְכָל הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֶמֶשׂ
עַל הָאָרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וְכָל
הָעוֹף לְמִינָהּ כָּל צִפּוֹר
כָּל כָּנָף:

Ok so

(they + (wild + domestic + creepy) · animals + birds) · (by their kind)

Genesis 7:15

And they came to Noah, to the ark, by twos of all flesh in which was the breath of life,

וַיָּבֹאוּ אֵל נֹחַ אֶל הַתֵּבָה
שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם מִכָּל הַבָּשָׂר
אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים:

come to Noah, and also to the boat.

Two of each of the breathing ones.

Genesis 7:16

and those that came were male and female; some from all flesh came, as God had commanded him. And YHWH closed it for him.

וַהֲבָאִים זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה
מִכָּל בָּשָׂר בָּאוּ כְּאֲשֶׁר
צִוָּה אֱלֹהִים 41426
וַיִּסָּגֶר 4409 3432

YHWH closes the door for Noah.

Genesis 7:17

And the flood was on the earth for forty days, and the waters multiplied and raised the ark, and it was lifted from the earth.

420994 44973 2326
49926 3943 40 762
+4 44426 7273
3943 407 79+6 39+3

It's wet for forty days.

Also forty nights.

Genesis 7:18

And the waters grew strong and multiplied very much on the earth, and the ark went on the face of the waters.

יִשְׁרָאֵל וְזֶה אֵלֶּיךָ
יִשְׁרָאֵל וְזֶה אֵלֶּיךָ
יִשְׁרָאֵל וְזֶה אֵלֶּיךָ

It gets wetter.

Genesis 7:19

And the waters had grown very, very strong on the earth, so they covered all the high mountains that are under all the skies.

אֵלֶּיךָ אֵלֶּיךָ יִשְׁרָאֵל וְזֶה אֵלֶּיךָ
לֵךְ יִשְׁרָאֵל וְזֶה אֵלֶּיךָ
אֵלֶּיךָ יִשְׁרָאֵל וְזֶה אֵלֶּיךָ
יִשְׁרָאֵל לֵךְ תֵּיכָף

A mountain amount of wetter.

Genesis 7:20

Fifteen cubits above, the waters grew stronger, and they covered the mountains.

אֵלֶּיךָ אֵלֶּיךָ אֵלֶּיךָ אֵלֶּיךָ
יִשְׁרָאֵל יִשְׁרָאֵל אֵלֶּיךָ לֵךְ
יִשְׁרָאֵל יִשְׁרָאֵל אֵלֶּיךָ לֵךְ

Like twenty two and a half feet up. Above the mountains.

Genesis 7:21

And all flesh that creep on the earth—of the birds and of the domestic animals and of the wild animals and of all the swarming creatures that swarm on the earth, and all the humans—expired.

וַיָּגוּעַ כָּל בֶּשָׂר הָרֹמֵשׁ
עַל הָאָרֶץ בְּעוֹף
וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבַחַיָּה וּבְכָל
הַשָּׂרֵץ הַשֹּׁרֵץ עַל
הָאָרֶץ וְכָל הָאָדָם:

One of those math sentences happens again.

Genesis 7:22

Everything that had the breathing spirit of life in its nostrils, everything that was on the ground, died.

ዘሃላ ተሣሣሃ ላሠፉ ረገ
ላሠፉ ረገሣ ሃገገፉና ሣገገዘ
ሃተሣ ጓጋላዘጋ

Everything that could breathe with its nose on the ground died.

The fish get to keep being evil.

Genesis 7:23

And He wiped out all the substance that was on the face of the earth, from human to animal to creeping thing and to bird of the skies, and they were wiped out from the earth, and just Noah and those who were with him in the ark were left.

ሣሃዋጊጓ ረገ ተፋ ዘሣጊሃ
ጓሣፋጓ ጊሃገ ረዐ ላሠፉ
ላዐ ጓሣጓጋ ላዐ ሣፋፋሣ
ሣጊሣሠጓ ገሃዐ ላዐሃ ሠሣላ
ሶላፋጓ ሃሣ ሃዘሣጊሃ
ላሠፋሃ ዘሃ ገፋ ላፋሠጊሃ
ጓጋተጋ ሃተፋ

More math, but you can skip it.

Only the boat people live.

Genesis 7:24

And the water grew strong on the earth a hundred fifty days.

וַיִּגְבְּרוּ הַמַּיִם עַל הָאָרֶץ
חֲמֵשִׁים וּמֵאֵת יוֹם:

Ok so it's wet for 150 days.

Genesis 8

Genesis 8:1

And God remembered Noah and all the wild animals and all the domestic animals that were with him in the ark, and God passed a wind over the earth, and the water decreased.

וַיִּזְכֹּר אֱלֹהִים אֶת נֹחַ
וְאֶת כָּל הַחַיָּה וְאֶת
כָּל הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ
בַּתֵּבָה וַיַּעֲבֵר אֱלֹהִים
רוּחַ עַל הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשְׁכּוּ
הַמַּיִם:

Ok so God remembers Noah now.³⁹
He apparently forgot between when he closed the door and now.
Then the water starts to go down.

Genesis 8:2

And the fountains of the deep and the apertures of the skies were shut, and the rain was restrained from the skies.

וַיִּסְכְּרוּ מַעְיִנֹת תְּהוֹם
וַאֲרֻבֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם 40
אֲשֶׁר מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם

It stops raining.

Genesis 8:3

And the waters went back from on the earth, going back continually, and the water receded at the end of a hundred fifty days.

וַיָּשׁוּבוּ הַמַּיִם 40
אֲחֵרֶיךָ 150
וַיִּחָסְרוּ הַמַּיִם מִקְצֵה
תְּמָשִׁים וּמֵאֵת יוֹם:

Stuff dries up.
Remember, that happens after 150 days. Also 40.

³⁹He remembers everything in the boat too but I'm not typing all that.

Genesis 8:4

And the ark rested in the seventh month, in the seventeenth day of the month, on the mountains of Ararat.

וַתָּנַח הַתֵּבָה בַּחֹדֶשׁ
הַשְּׁבִיעִי בַשְּׁבַעַת עָשָׂר
יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ עַל הָרֵי
אַרְרָט:

Ok so it's July 17th.⁴⁰

We're now on mount Ararat.

Genesis 8:5

And the water went on receding until the tenth month. In the tenth month, in the first of the month, the tops of the mountains appeared.

וְהַמַּיִם הָיוּ הֵלֹךְ
וַחֲסוֹר עַד הַחֹדֶשׁ
הָעֲשִׂירִי בְעָשִׂירִי
בְּאַחַד לַחֹדֶשׁ נִרְאוּ
רָאשֵׁי הַהָרִים:

It keeps drying.

By October 1st⁴¹ we can see the mountain tops again.

Genesis 8:6

And it was at the end of forty days, and Noah opened the window of the ark that he had made.

וַעֲדָה אֶת־סוֹף יָמֵי
אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וַיִּפְתָּח
נֹחַ אֶת־חַלּוֹן הַתֵּבָה
אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה:

Ok so after the flood happens for 40 days, Noah opens the window.

Genesis 8:7

And he let a raven go, and it went back and forth until the water dried up from the earth.

וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶת־הָעֹרֵב וַיֵּצֵא
יָצֹא וְשׁוֹב עַד יִבְשֶׁת
הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ:

He lets a black bird go.

⁴⁰But not really. Different months.

⁴¹But not really.

Genesis 8:8

And he let a dove go from him to see whether the waters had eased from the face of the earth.

እንሃረጃ ተፋ ዘረሃረሃ
ሃረዋጃ ተሃፋላረ ሃተፋሕ
እሕላፋጃ ረነገ ረዐሕ ሕረሕጃ

Also he lets a white bird go.

As an homage to the Epic of Gilgamesh.

Genesis 8:9

And the dove did not find a resting place for its foot, and it came back to him to the ark, for waters were on the face of the earth, and he put out his hand and took it and brought it to him to the ark.

እንሃረጃ እፋሶሕ ፋረሃ
ዓሠተሃ እረገላ ገዓረ ዘሃሕሕ
ሕረሕ ረዓ እዓተጃ ረፋ ሃረረፋ
ዘረሃረሃ ሶላፋጃ ረዓ ረነገ ረዐ
እተፋ ፋዓረሃ እዘዋረሃ ሃላረ
እዓተጃ ረፋ ሃረረፋ

The white bird comes back.

So either it couldn't find land, or it likes Noah.

Genesis 8:10

And he waited still another seven days, and he again let a dove go from the ark.

ሕረሕረ ተዐዓሠ ላሃዐ ረዘረሃ
ተፋ ዘረሠ ገቹረሃ ሕረላዘፋ
እዓተጃ ሕሕ እንሃረጃ

Seven days later, another bird.

Genesis 8:11

And the dove came to him at evening time, and here was an olive leaf torn off in its mouth, and Noah knew that the waters had eased from the earth.

እንሃረጃ ሃረረፋ ፋዓተሃ
እረዐ እሕጃሃ ዓላዐ ተዐረ
ዐላረሃ እረገዓ ገላ፱ ተረገ
ረዐሕ ሕረሕጃ ሃረዋ ረዓ ዘሃ
ሶላፋጃ

The dove comes back with an olive leaf in its mouth.

Ever seen that, like in paintings or logos?

That's from here.

Genesis 8:12

And he waited still another seven days, and he let a dove go, and it did not come back to him ever again.

וַיַּחַד אֶת־הַדּוֹבָה
וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶת־הַדּוֹבָה
וַיָּבֹא אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר

Seven days later, another bird.

This one either finds land or drowns.

Genesis 8:13

And it was in the six hundred and first year, in the first month, in the first of the month: the water dried from on the earth. And Noah turned back the covering of the ark and looked, and here the face of the earth had dried.

וַיְהִי בְּאַחַת וְשֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת
שָׁנָה בְּרֵאשׁוֹן בְּאַחַד
לְחֹדֶשׁ חָרְבוּ הַמַּיִם
מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ וַיֹּאמֶר
נֹחַ וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶת־הַדּוֹבָה
וַיָּבֹא אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר

January 1st, 600 A.C., the water dries.

And Noah opens the ceiling of the box and sees that it dried.

Genesis 8:14

And in the second month, in the twenty-seventh day of the month, the earth dried up.

וּבְחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּשִׁבְעָה
וָעֶשְׂרִים יוֹם לְחֹדֶשׁ
יָבֹשָׁה הָאָרֶץ:

Ok so on February 27th, 600 A.C., the earth dries up again.

Genesis 8:15

And God spoke to Noah, saying,

וַיְדַבֵּר אֱלֹהִים אֶל־נֹחַ
לֵאמֹר:

Ok so God says to Noah, saying,

Genesis 8:16

“Go out from the ark, you and your wife and your sons and your sons’ wives with you.

צֵא מִן הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה
וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּבְנֶיךָ וְנִשְׁי
בְנֶיךָ אִתְּךָ׃

Leave.

Genesis 8:17

Bring out with you all the living things that are with you, of all flesh, of the birds and of the domestic animals and of all the creeping animals that creep on the earth, and they will swarm in the earth and be fruitful and multiply on the earth.”

כָּל הַחַיָּה אֲשֶׁר אִתְּךָ
מִכָּל בֶּשָׂר בְּעוֹף
וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבְכָל הָרֶמֶשׂ
הָרֹמֵשׁ עַל הָאָרֶץ
(הוּצֵא) [הֵיצֵא] אִתְּךָ
וְשָׂרְצוּ בָאָרֶץ וּפְרוּ
וְרָבוּ עַל הָאָרֶץ׃

Qere Ketiv.

Bring the animals.

He says it in math again.

Genesis 8:18

And Noah went out, and his sons and his wife and his sons’ wives with him.

וַיֵּצֵא נֹחַ וּבָנָיו וְאִשְׁתּוֹ
וְנִשְׁי בָנָיו אִתּוֹ׃

Humans exit boat.

Genesis 8:19

All the living things, all the creeping animals and all the birds, all that creep on the earth went out from the ark by their families.

כָּל הַחַיָּה כָּל הָרֶמֶשׂ
וְכָל הָעוֹף כָּל
רוֹמֵשׁ עַל הָאָרֶץ
לְמִשְׁפַּחְתֵּיהֶם יָצְאוּ מִן
הַתֵּבָה׃

Animals exit boat.

Genesis 8:20

And Noah built an altar to YHWH, and he took some of each of the pure animals and of each of the pure birds, and he offered sacrifices on the altar.

እሃእጊረ ዘዓገሃ ዘነ ሃዓጊሃ
እሃእጊረ ለእሃ ዘዓጊሃ
ገሃዐእ ለእሃእጊረ እሃእጊረ
ተረዐ ለዐጊሃ ለእሃእጊረ
ዘዓገሃ

Noah's so grateful to be alive that he burns up some animals as a thank you.

Genesis 8:21

And YHWH smelled the pleasant smell, and YHWH said to His heart, "I won't curse the ground on account of humankind again, because the inclination of the human heart is bad from their youth, and I won't strike all the living again as I have done.

ዘጊሃ ተቀ እሃእጊረ ዘዓጊሃ
እሃእጊረ ለእሃእጊረ ዘዓጊሃ
ረረዐረ ገዢ ቀረ ሃዓረ ረቀ
ላሃዓዐእ እሃእጊረ ተቀ ላሃዐ
ሃእጊረ ለእሃእጊረ ገዢ ሃእጊረ
ገዢ ቀረ ሃዓዓዐሃዐ ሀዓ
ጊዘ ለእ ተቀ ተሃእጊረ ላሃዐ
ጊተጊወዐ ላሃእጊረ

Now YHWH's like "What smells good?"

He then sees what Noah's doing.

So YHWH says:

Note to self:

Stop trying to fix people with floods.

Humans just suck from birth.

Genesis 8:22

All the rest of the earth's days, seed and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night will not cease."

ዐላጊ ሃእጊረ ጊዘ ለእ ላዐ
ሃዓዐሃ ሃዓዐ ላዓ ላዓዐሃ
ቀረ እረጊሃ ሃዓዐ ገዢ
ሃተጊወዐ

Weather and seasons keep happening.

Genesis 9

Genesis 9:1

And God blessed Noah and his sons and said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth.

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹהִים אֶת נֹחַ
וְאֶת בָּנָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם
פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמְלֵאוּ אֶת
הָאָרֶץ:

So God blesses Noah and tells him and his sons, “Go f fruitfully multiply and fill the earth.

Genesis 9:2

And fear of you and dread of you will be on every living thing of the earth and on every bird of the skies, in every one that will creep on the earth and in all the fish of the sea. They are given into your hand.

וּמֹרְאָכֶם וְחִתְּכֶם יִהְיֶה
עַל כָּל חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ וְעַל
כָּל עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם בְּכָל
אֲשֶׁר תֵּרַמֵּשׁ הָאֲדָמָה
וּבְכָל דָּגֵי הַיָּם בְּיֶדְכֶם
נִתְּנוּ:

I made the animals scared of you. You can have them.

Genesis 9:3

Every creeping animal that is alive will be yours for food; I’ve given every one to you like a plant of vegetation,

כָּל רֶמֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר הוּא
חַי לָכֶם יִהְיֶה לְאִכְלָה
כִּי־רֶק עֵשָׂב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם
אֶת כָּל:

You can eat all the animals.

They’re like vegetables.

Genesis 9:4

except you shall not eat flesh in
its life, its blood,

אֶךְ בֶּשָׂר בְּנֶפֶשׁוֹ דָּמוֹ
לֹא תֹאכְלוּ:

But don't eat the blood,

Genesis 9:5

and except I shall inquire for
your blood, for your lives. I
shall inquire for it from the
hand of every animal and from
the hand of a human. I shall
inquire for a human's life from
the hand of each man for his
brother.

וְאֶךְ אֶת דַּמְכֶם
לְנִפְשֵׁיכֶם אֶדְרֹשׁ מִיַּד
כָּל חַיָּה אֶדְרֹשְׁנָו וּמִיַּד
הָאָדָם מִיַּד אִישׁ אָחִיו
אֶדְרֹשׁ אֶת נַפְשׁ הָאָדָם:

Then he says whatever this is.⁴²

Genesis 9:6

One who sheds a human's
blood: by a human his blood
will be shed, because He made
the human in the image of God.

שֹׁפֵךְ דַּם הָאָדָם בָּאָדָם
דָּמוֹ יִשְׁפֹּךְ כִּי בְצִלָּם
אֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה אֶת
הָאָדָם:

If you kill people I'll kill you.

He decides that fact belongs here.

Genesis 9:7

And you, be fruitful and
multiply, swarm in the earth
and multiply in it.”

וְאַתֶּם פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּשְׂרֹצוּ
בָאָרֶץ וּרְבוּ בָהּ:

Then he reiterates the thing about how they should go f fruitfully mul-
tiply in a big swarm.

⁴²I shall inquire for your blood, for your lives. This expression means that it is forbidden to take a human life unlawfully. It does not necessarily mean that one may never take a human life; for example, it may not forbid taking a life in self-defense. Rather, God will inquire—that is, require an accounting—and hold the guilty responsible, whether human or animal.

Genesis 9:8

And God said to Noah and to his sons with him, saying,

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל נֹחַ
וְאֶל בָּנָיו אִתּוֹ לֵאמֹר:

Ok so God says to Noah and his sons, saying,

Genesis 9:9

“And I: here, I’m establishing my covenant with you and with your seed after you

וָאֲנִי הֵנְנִי מִקְיָם אֶת
בְּרִיתִי אִתְּכֶם וְאֶת
זֶרְעֲכֶם אַחֲרֵיכֶם:

I’ve decided to make a deal with your children.

Genesis 9:10

and with every living being that is with you, of the birds, of the domestic animals, and of all the wild animals of the earth with you, from all those coming out of the ark to every living thing of the earth.

וְאֶת כָּל נֶפֶשׁ הַחַיָּה
אֲשֶׁר אִתְּכֶם בְּעוֹף
בְּבִהֵמָה וּבְכָל חַיַּת
הָאָרֶץ אִתְּכֶם מְכֹל
יֵצְאֵי הַתֵּבָה לְכָל חַיַּת
הָאָרֶץ:

The deal is also with the animals.

Genesis 9:11

And I shall establish my covenant with you, and all flesh will not be cut off again by the floodwaters, and there will not be a flood again to destroy the earth.”

וְהִקְמַתִּי אֶת בְּרִיתִי
אִתְּכֶם וְלֹא יִכָּרֵת כָּל
בָּשָׂר עוֹד מִמֵּי הַמַּבּוּל
וְלֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד מַבּוּל
לְשַׁחַת הָאָרֶץ:

And also I’ve decided to make a deal with you.

And I won’t do any more floods.

Genesis 9:12

And God said, “This is the sign of the covenant that I’m giving between me and you and every living being that is with you for eternal generations:

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים זֹאת אוֹת הַבְּרִית אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי נֹתֵן בֵּינִי וּבֵינֵיכֶם וּבֵין כָּל נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה אֲשֶׁר אִתְּכֶם לְדֹרֹת עוֹלָם:

Every deal has a sign.

Sometimes the sign is a thing you have to do, like “circumcision” or “being good.”

This time the sign is a rainbow.

It’s not entirely clear what constitutes a sign.

As long as rainbows are a thing, that’s how you know the “No more floods” deal is still binding.

Genesis 9:13

I’ve put my rainbow in the clouds, and it will become a covenant sign between me and the earth.

אֶת קַשְׁתִּי נָתַתִּי בֶּעָנָן וְהָיְתָה לְאוֹת בְּרִית בֵּינִי וּבֵין הָאָרֶץ:

He lets Noah know where he put the rainbow.

Understandably, they were new.

Then he says it’s the sign of the deal again.

Genesis 9:14

And it will be when I bring a cloud over the earth, and the rainbow will appear in the cloud,

וְהָיָה בֶּעָנָן עָלַי וְהָיְתָה הַקַּשְׁתִּי בֶּעָנָן:

Ok so when there’s clouds, there’ll be one of these new rainbow things.

Genesis 9:15

and I'll remember my covenant
that is between me and you and
every living being of all flesh,
and the waters will not become
a flood to destroy all flesh again.

וְזָכַרְתִּי אֶת בְּרִיתִי אֲשֶׁר
בֵּינִי וּבֵינֵיכֶם וּבֵין כָּל
נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה בְּכָל בָּשָׂר
וְלֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד הַמַּיִם
לְמַבּוּל לְשַׁחֵת כָּל
בָּשָׂר:

That'll remind me about the deal.
Between me and you. And the animals.
And then I'll remember not to do any more floods.

Genesis 9:16

And the rainbow will be in the
cloud, and I'll see it, to
remember an eternal covenant
between God and every living
being of all flesh that is on the
earth.”

וְהָיְתָה הַקֶּשֶׁת בְּעָנָן
וְרָאִיתִיהָ לְזָכָר בְּרִית
עוֹלָם בֵּין אֱלֹהִים וּבֵין
כָּל נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה בְּכָל בָּשָׂר
אֲשֶׁר עַל הָאָרֶץ:

He lets Noah know where he put the rainbow.⁴³
And he says he'll see it.
And it'll remind him of the deal.
Between him and Noah. And the animals.

Genesis 9:17

And God said to Noah, “This is
the sign of the covenant that
I've established between me and
all flesh that is on the earth.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל נֹחַ
זֹאת אוֹת הַבְּרִית אֲשֶׁר
הִקְמַתִי בֵּינִי וּבֵין כָּל
בָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר עַל הָאָרֶץ:

Then he says it's the sign of the deal again again.
Between him and Noah. And the animals.

⁴³Understandably, they were new.

Genesis 9:18

And Noah's sons who went out from the ark were Shem and Ham and Yaphet. And Ham: he was the father of Canaan.

ሠጌቶሪታ ዘን ጊዓ ሃጌታሪ
ተገጊ ሃይ ሃሠ ጓተታ ነሃ
ነዐንጎ ጊታ ፋኅ ሃይ

Ok so finally J shows up again (praise the LORD) and says:

Here's Noah's kids' name, and one grandkid. We'll need that soon.

Genesis 9:19

These three were Noah's sons, and all the earth expanded from these.

ዘን ጊዓ ጓረፋ ጓሠረሠ
ሶፋታ ረጎ ጓሶገነ ጓረፋሃ

The earth was starting over from these guys.

So you can forget about those genealogies from before.

Except the Seth one.

That's still around.

Genesis 9:20

And Noah began to be a man of the ground, and he planted a vineyard.

ጓሃፋታ ሠጌ ዘን ረዘሪ
ሃፋ ዐፀሪ

Ok so finally all the bad people and bad animals are gone.⁴⁴

Now it's just the best guy on earth and his kids.

So Noah starts a brewery.

Genesis 9:21

And he drank from the wine and was drunk. And he was exposed inside his tent.

ፋሃሠሪ ነጌታ ነሃ ተሠሪ
ጓረታ ሃተታ ረገተሪ

And he gets drunk and passes out and his d ad parts flops out of his pants.

⁴⁴The bad fish survived. Don't worry about them.

Genesis 9:22

And Ham, the father of Canaan,
saw his father’s nakedness and
told his two brothers outside.

ተፋ ነዐነጽ ጊዳፋ ማይ ፋላጊሃ
ጊነሠረ ልገጊሃ ሃጊዳፋ ተሃላዐ
ኮሃይዓ ሃጊይፋ

Ham sees it.

He tells his brothers.

Genesis 9:23

And Shem and Yaphet took a
garment and put it on both their
shoulders and went backwards and
covered their father’s nakedness.
And they faced backwards and did
not see their father’s nakedness.

ተፋ ተገጊሃ ማሠ ዘዋጊሃ
ረዐ ሃማጊሠጊሃ ጓረማሠጓ
ሃጽረጊሃ ማጓጊነሠ ማጽሠ
ተፋ ሃቹጽጊሃ ተጊነላይፋ
ማጓጊነገሃ ማጓጊዳፋ ተሃላዐ
ተሃላዐሃ ተጊነላይፋ
ሃፋላ ፋረ ማጓጊዳፋ

So the other two brothers take a shirt or a blanket or something and walk
backwards so they don’t have to see dad like that, and they cover him up.

It works. Success. They don’t see it.

Thank God.

Genesis 9:24

And Noah woke up from his wine,
and he knew what his youngest
son had done to him.

ዐላጊሃ ሃነጊጊማ ዘነ ኮዋጊጊሃ
ሃነዓ ሃረ ጓሠዐ ላሠፋ ተፋ
ነፀዋጓ

Eventually the best guy on earth wakes up.

Somehow he knows what happened.⁴⁵

Genesis 9:25

And he said, “Canaan is cursed.
He’ll be a servant of servants to
his brothers.”

ላዓዐ ነዐነጽ ላሃላፋ ላማፋጊሃ
ሃጊይፋረ ጓጊጓጊ ማጊላዓዐ

So the best guy on earth lashes out at his grandson, who wasn’t involved.

⁴⁵There are some ancient near eastern euphemisms we might be mistranslating here, like “tent,” and especially “father’s nakedness,” which means “your mom’s girl parts” in Leviticus. Seems a bit weird at first, but makes sense if you think about it. I mean, those parts are his. So anyways something happened.

Genesis 9:26

And he said, “Blessed is YHWH,
God of Shem, and may Canaan be
a servant to them.

እሃንገ ሃሃላፍ ላሃቶሪሃ
ሃዐነሃ ገንገሪሃ ሃሃ ገንገሪሃ
ሃሃሪ ላላዐ

He blesses YHWH for some reason, and calls him the god of son number two.

And says “may grandson (who wasn’t involved) be a servant to his uncle, my son.”

Lots going on here.

Genesis 9:27

May God enlarge Yaphet, and
may he dwell in the tents of Shem,
and may Canaan be a servant to
them.”

ተገገሪ ሃገንገሪሃ ተገገ
ገንገሪሃ ሃሃ ገሪንገሪሃ ሃሃሪሃ
ሃሃሪ ላላዐ ሃዐነሃ

Then he makes a pun about son number three by saying “May God enlarge Yaphat.”

Yaphat means “enlarged” or “expanded.”

A good translation would be Yafat.

Then there’s a wish about tents.

Genesis 9:28

And Noah lived after the flood
three hundred years and fifty
years,

ሠረሠ ሲኖሃሃይ ባፀብ ፀሃ ተፀብሃ
ሃታሠሃፀሃይ ዳሃሠ ጸሃብሃ
ዳሃሠ

Then the spreadsheet shows up again to bookend Noah’s life.

Genesis 9:29

and all of Noah’s days were nine
hundred years and fifty years.
And he died.

ዐሠጸ ፀሃ ተሃታ ሊሃ ሃታታሃ
ሃታሠሃፀሃይ ዳሃሠ ጸሃብሃ
ጸሃታሃ ዳሃሠ

The spreadsheet lets us know that he lived to be 950.

And he died.

Genesis 10

Genesis 10:1

And these are the records of Noah’s sons, Shem, Ham, and Yaphet: And children were born to them after the flood.

וְאֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֹת בְּנֵי
נֹחַ שֵׁם חָם וַיִּפֹּת
וַיִּוָּלְדוּ לָהֶם בָּנִים אַחֲרֵ
הַמָּבּוּל׃

Ok so dad’s dead now. Moving on to the sons.

Genesis 10:2

Yaphet’s children were Gomer and Magog and Madai and Yawan and Tubal and Meshech and Tiras.

בְּנֵי יָפֶת גֹּמֶר וּמָגוֹג
וּמָדַי וַיֵּנוּן וְתִבְלִי וּמִשְׁכֵּךְ
וְתִירָס׃

Yafat’s family enlarges.

Genesis 10:3

And Gomer’s children were Ashkenaz and Riphath and Togarmah.

וּבְנֵי גֹמֶר אַשְׁכְּנַז וְרִפְתָּה
וְתוֹגַרְמָה׃

Ok so Gomer (which means “Finished”) has some kids named “Crusher” and “Gnawing Bones”⁴⁶ and also the ancestor of Ashkenazi Jews.

So the new earth is off to a pretty weird start.

Genesis 10:4

And Yawan’s children were El-isha and Tarshish, Kittim and Dodanim.

וּבְנֵי יָוָן אֵלִישָׁה
וְתַרְשִׁישׁ כִּיְתִים וְדַדָּנִים׃

Yafat’s family continues to expand, as per Noah’s wish.

Ok so Yawan (which means Demonic⁴⁷) has kids named:

⁴⁶To be fair, the name Togarmah may instead mean “You will break her.”
⁴⁷The author is cheating here. It means demonic in Cebuano and other languages of the Philippines. In biblical Hebrew, it is probably related to the term Ionian, meaning the Greeks. For the record, dear reader, this is the first time I’ve noticed any blatant falsehoods in the text, so I’ll keep an eye on the author or authors in the future.

- 1. El-isha: Lit. God saves.
- 2. Tarshish: An unknown place name. Possibly Gibraltar.⁴⁸
- 3. Kittim: Another place name, probably Cyprus.
- 4. Dodanim: Given the pattern thus far in the chapter, scholars have attempted to determine a corresponding place name for this proper name. In the parallel genealogy of 1 Chronicles 1:7, the name is spelled Rodanim (רֹדָנִים). The Hebrew letters for “D” (ד) and “R” (ר)⁴⁹ are visually very similar, leading historians to conclude that this was likely an ancient scribal copy error.⁵⁰

Genesis 10:5

The islands of the nations in their lands were dispersed out from these, each by its language, by their families within their nations.

מֵאֵלֶּה נִפְרְדוּ אִי הַגּוֹיִם
בְּאַרְצֵתָם אִישׁ לְלִשְׁנֹו
לְמִשְׁפַּחְתָּם בְּגוֹיֵיהֶם:

Ok so the text says that islands were dispersed out from these.
Which bolsters the location assignments up above.
They’re beach towns.⁵¹

Genesis 10:6

And Ham’s children were Cush and Egypt and Put and Canaan.

וּבְנֵי חָם כּוּשׁ וּמִצְרַיִם
וּפּוּט וְכַנְעָן:

Ok so at this point it becomes obvious that the fictional genealogy is a non-fiction map even for the readers who were half asleep until now.
So Genesis is obvious fiction, and also like, true.
At this point Ham has the following children.

- 1. Cush: Ethiopia.
- 2. Egypt: Self-explanatory.
- 3. Put: Libya.

⁴⁸It’s the place where Jonah flees to in the third sentence of the book of Jonah after YHWH tells him to go out East. We think it’s the most Western location known on maps at the time.
⁴⁹Or rather, “D” (ד) and “R” (ר), at this stage of Hebrew.
⁵⁰So basically an academic sounding euphemism for “typo.”
⁵¹Actually countries. But yes, they’re coastal.

4. Canaan: Israel sort of, but not yet.

Genesis 10:7

And Cush’s children were Seba and Havilah and Sabtah and Raamah and Sabteca. And Raamah’s children were Sheba and Dedan.

וּבְנֵי כוּשׁ סְבָא
וְחַוִּילָה וְסַבְתָּה וְרַעְמָה
וְסַבְתֵּכָא וּבְנֵי רַעְמָה
שְׁבָא וְדֶדָן׃

It is an exercise for the reader to construct a “map” map that maps these children from the name domain (child space) to the place domain (map space).

Genesis 10:8

And Cush fathered Nimrod. He began being a man of power in the earth.

אֲרָמְלָה + אֶלֶז מִלְכָּה
אֲרָמְלָה + מִלְכָּה לְמִלְכָּה
מִלְכָּה

Ok so Ethiopia gives birth to Nimrod.

In modern slang, the term Nimrod means idiot or moron.

This is understood to derive from a certain fictitious rabbit, common in the table of English speaking nations circa the 30th century A.D.⁵²

The transition from the term’s original meaning of “mighty biblical hunter” to “incompetent idiot” arose from a chapter in the chronicles of the events of said rabbit in which he was engaged in a prolonged predator-prey style drama involving his pursuit by a rotund and, let us say, less than competent hunter.

Employing the timeless rhetorical device of sarcasm, the aforementioned rabbit refers to the less-than-mighty hunter as “Nimrod,” which the audience at the time, being native speakers of biblical English, would have understood to be the deployment of the above mentioned rhetorical device, namely sarcasm.

Subsequent generations, upon encountering the expression, had in the intervening years become less fluent in the bible and biblical minutiae, seeing as bible translations at the time were, to quote one contemporary scholar “boring,” “pretentious” and “fit for burning.”⁵³

In summary, lacking knowledge of the bible, they thought Nimrod meant

⁵²After David. Roughly the 20th century, C.E. (Common Era.)
⁵³Lit. רֵאיוֹ לְשִׁרְפָה in the original text, which, while referring to itself as “early biblical English,” in fact employs a rather infuriating mixed orthography that makes a translator rather long for a return to the simplicity of Babel.

idiot.⁵⁴

Genesis 10:9

He was a powerful hunter before YHWH. On account of this it is said: “A powerful hunter before YHWH like Nimrod!”

אֶזְרָא אֲדָמָה אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא
אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא
אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא
אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא

We’ve sort of covered this already.

Genesis 10:10

And the beginning of his kingdom was Babel and Erech and Accad and Calneh in the land of Shinar.

אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא
אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא
אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא אֶזְרָא

At this point the table of nations gets extra interesting.

Remember the principle of “Sure these people are made up but they’re actually also real non-fiction places”?

Ok so, at the beginning of Nimrod’s kingdom were:

1. Babel: That’s Babylon.
2. Erech: That’s Uruk.
3. Accad: That’s Akkad.
4. Calneh: Not a place.⁵⁵
5. : Shinar: That’s Sumer.

That’s basically all the earliest cities.

In other words, these fake people are also a real actual history textbook.

The bible doesn’t care about your genres.

⁵⁴Not to prolong the already much too lengthy and borderline self-indulgent commentary on this verse, but in the interest of factual accuracy it bears pointing out that the responsible party for the redefinition of the aforementioned biblical term was in fact, not Bubs Gunny, nor Porpy Kig, but in fact, Daddy F— (Editor’s Note: The text appears to be corrupted here, and the surname of the individual in question has been lost.) Author’s Note: Names of certain individuals have been changed in the interest of respecting the laws of biblical copyright in the early biblical English period.

⁵⁵Historical scholarship proposed candidate locations for the city of “Calneh”, but it is now considered most likely, in a suggestion going back to W.F. Albright (1944), that the word did not in origin refer to a city but has been corrupted from an expression meaning “all of them.”

Genesis 10:11

Asshur came out of that land and
built Nineveh and Rehovoth-Ir
and Calah,

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ

- 1. Asshur: The city that eventually gave its name to Assyria.
- 2. Nineveh: Capital of the Assyrian empire, meaning “fish place.”
- 3. Rehovoth-Ir: Seems to mean “streets of the town.” Whatever, you get the idea. These people are places.
- 4. Calah: An old city in Assyria whose name means “vigour”, “completion”, or “old age.”

Genesis 10:12

and Resen between Nineveh and
Calah. It is the big city.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

You get the idea.

Genesis 10:13

And Egypt fathered Ludim and
Anamim and Lehabim and
Naphtuhim

ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Egypt had babies.
Not clear who he fathered them with.
Except, well, Israel.
A bit later.
We don’t know what their names mean.

Genesis 10:14

and Pathrusim and Casluhim,
from which the Philistines came
out, and Caphtorim.

תִּכְּסִי וְצִפְרִי וְתִכְּסִי
יִכְרִי צִפְרִי וְצִפְרִי
תִּכְּסִי וְצִפְרִי וְצִפְרִי
וְצִפְרִי וְצִפְרִי

Not sure about these either.

Genesis 10:15

And Canaan fathered Sidon, his
firstborn, and Heth

יָדָן וְתִיבֵן וְתִיבֵן
וְתִיבֵן וְתִיבֵן

1. Sidon: probably “Fishing Place”, from the Semitic root שָׁדַן (šwd), “to fish.”
2. Heth: The ancestor of the Hittites (תְּחִיבֵי, “sons of Heth”).⁵⁶

Genesis 10:16

and the Jebusite and the Amorite
and the Gir-gashite

תִּיבֵן וְתִיבֵן וְתִיבֵן
וְתִיבֵן וְתִיבֵן

We’ll be hearing a lot about these guys in a bit.

For now:

1. Jebusite: The people who lived in Jerusalem before David conquers it in II Samuel. We’ll get there.
2. Amorite: probably from Akkadian Amurru, “the westerners.”
3. Girgashite: Meaning uncertain. Give us a break, it’s been a while.

Genesis 10:17

and the Hivite and the Arkite and
the Sinite

וְהִיטִי וְהִיטִי וְהִיטִי
וְהִיטִי וְהִיטִי

1. Hivite: Meaning unknown, possibly “tent-dwellers.”
2. Arkite: Somewhere in Lebanon.
3. Sinite: In Syria, near the beach.

⁵⁶Also the Hebrew letter H.

Let’s move on. Getting tired of this.

Genesis 10:18

and the Arvadite and the Zemarite
and the Hamathite. And later the
families of the Canaanites were
dispersed.

ተፋሃ ረላሃላፋጃ ተፋሃ
ጊተሃዘጃ ተፋሃ ጊላሃሾጃ
ተሃዘገሃሃ ሃሾገገ ላዘፋሃ
ጊሃዐገሃጃ

- 1. Arvadite: From the island city of Arvad (modern Arwad, off the Syrian coast), one of the great Phoenician seafaring cities.
- 2. Zemarite: From the town of Zemar (probably modern Sumra, on the Syrian coast). The name’s meaning is uncertain.
- 3. Hamathite: From Hamath, a major city on the Orontes River in central Syria. The name may mean “fortress” or “citadel.”

Genesis 10:19

And the Canaanite border was
from Sidon, as you come to
Gerar, up to Gaza, as you come to
Sodom and Gomorrah and
Admah and Zeboim, up to Lasha.

ጊሃዐገሃጃ ረሃዓገ ጊጃጊሃ
ጃላላገ ጃሃፋዓ ሃላጊሾሃ
ጃሃላቹ ጃሃፋዓ ጃጊዐ ላዐ
ሃጊዓሾሃ ጃሃላፋሃ ጃላሃዐሃ
ዐሠሬ ላዐ

- 1. Sidon: The northern end of Canaan, on the Mediterranean coast in modern Lebanon.
- 2. Gerar: A Philistine city in the Negev, associated with Abraham and Isaac.
- 3. Gaza: The southwestern corner of Canaan, on the Mediterranean coast.
- 4. Sodom and Gomorrah: The infamous cities destroyed by God in Genesis 19.
- 5. Admah and Zeboim: Two lesser-known cities destroyed alongside Sodom and Gomorrah.
- 6. Lasha: Probably somewhere east or southeast of the Dead Sea, but its exact location has been lost.

Genesis 10:20

These are Ham's children, by
their families, by their
languages, in their lands,
within their nations.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי חָם
לְמִשְׁפַּחְתָּם לְלִשְׁנָתָם
בְּאַרְצֵתָם בְּגוֹיֵיהֶם׃

Ok so those are Ham's kids.

By their families.

By their languages (which we didn't mention.)

In their lands (falling asleep.)

Within their nations (seriously, P?)

Genesis 10:21

Children were born to Shem, him
as well, father of all of Eber's
children, older brother of Yaphet.

זִיכָּרָה אֶת־שֵׁם אֲבִי
יָפֶֿתֿ וְיָבֶֿתֿ וְיָחִֿוֶֿל
וְיָֿאֶֿרֶֿחַ וְיָֿאֶֿרֶֿכְשָׁד וְיָֿאֶֿרָם׃

Sweet Lord that's just the first kid?

Genesis 10:22

Shem's children were Elam and
Asshur and Arpachshad and
Lud and Aram.

בְּנֵי שֵׁם עֵֿלָם וְאַשּׁוּר
וְאַרְפַּכְשָׁד וְלֹד וְאַרָם׃

We'll come back to these later.

Genesis 10:23

And Aram's children were Uz
and Hul and Gether and Mash.

וּבְנֵי אָרָם עוּז וְחֹל
וְגֶֿתֶר וּמָשׁ׃

I ain't researching all that.

Genesis 10:24

And Arpachshad fathered Shelah,
and Shelah fathered Eber.

אֲרַפְכְּשָׁד אֲבִי שְׁלָח
וְשְׁלָח אֲבִי עֵֿבֶֿר׃

Arpachshad means Babylonian Castle or something.

Don't quote me on that.

Genesis 10:25

And two sons were born to Eber.
The name of one was Peleg,
because in his days the earth was
divided, and his brother's name
was Joktan.

ሃገሃፍ ጊሃሠ ላረገ ላዕዕረሃ
ጊሃ ገረገ ላዕፋጎ ሃሠ
ኢላፋጎ ጸገረገሃ ሃገሃጊፍ
ሃፀዋጊ ሃገዕፋ ሃሠሃ

Ok so J shows up to mention a guy who's a pun.

Peleg isn't a place.

His name just means divided.

Joktan means 'small' or 'insignificant' or 'don't worry about it.'

Genesis 10:26

And Joktan fathered Almodad
and Sheleph and Hazarmaveth
and Jerah

ተፋ ላረገ ሃፀዋጊ
ተፋሃ ገረሠ ተፋሃ ላላሃሃረፋ
ዕላጊ ተፋሃ ተሃሃላኢዕ

- 1. Almodad: May mean "immeasurable." Which in some cases means "very big." In which case "tiny" up there chose to name his son "huge." Living vicariously, I think they call that.
- 2. Sheleph: Meaning uncertain, possibly means "pulling out." I guess they were done after the first (huge) baby. But birth control came later, so...
- 3. Hazarmaveth: Literally "abobe of death." They're getting really sick of having babies at this point.
- 4. Jerah: Literally "moon" or "month" (ገረገ). Perhaps evidence that the family had begun to attempt an early version of *Methodus Anti-conceptionis Lunar*is, though scholars are a bit peleg on the matter.

Ok I'm getting pretty tired of this.

Genesis 10:27

and Hadoram and Uzal and
Diklah

ረገሃፋ ተፋሃ ሃላሃላጎ ተፋሃ
ጸረዋላ ተፋሃ

- 1. Hadoram: Meaning uncertain. Probably an Arabian tribe.
- 2. Uzal: Traditionally identified with Sana'a, the capital of Yemen.

3. Diklah: Literally “palm tree” (דקל). Perhaps named for a region famous for its date palms.

Genesis 10:28

and Obal and Abimael and Sheba

ተፋላ ረዓሃዐ ተፋላ
ፋዓሠ ተፋላ ረፋሣጊዓፋ

1. Obal: Meaning uncertain. Probably an Arabian tribe.
2. Abimael: Literally “My father is God” or “God is my father.”
3. Sheba: The Sabeans of southern Arabia, famed in antiquity for incense, spices, and trade.

Genesis 10:29

and Ophir and Havilah and Jobab.
All these are Joktan’s children.

ጳረጊሃይ ተፋላ ሳገሃፋ ተፋላ
ጊሃዓ ጳረፋ ረሃ ዓዓሃጊ ተፋላ
ሃፀዋጊ

1. Ophir: The mysterious land famous for its exceptionally fine gold. Its location remains unknown.
2. Havilah: We’ve met this name before in Genesis 2. Like many names in Genesis, it seems to refer to more than one place or people.
3. Jobab: Meaning uncertain. Probably an Arabian tribe or clan.
4. Joktan’s descendants are generally associated with southern Arabia, especially modern Yemen.

Genesis 10:30

And their home was from Mesha,
as you come to Sephar, to the
mountain of the east.

ፋሠሣሣ ሣዓሠሣ ጊጳጊሃ
ሣዓዋጳ ሳጳ ጳሳገቹ ጳሃፋዓ

1. Mesha: Probably a place in northern Arabia, though its exact location is uncertain.
2. Sephar: Usually identified with Zafar in southern Yemen.
3. “The mountain of the east”: Probably the highlands of southern Arabia.
4. So basically Joktan’s kids are all Arabs.

Genesis 10:31

These are Shem’s children, by their families, by their languages, in their lands, by their nations.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי שֵׁם
לְמִשְׁפַּחְתָּם לְשׁוֹנָתָם
בְּאַרְצֵתָם לְגוֹיָהֶם׃

- 1. These are Shem’s children
- 2. by their families,
- 3. by their languages,
- 4. in their lands, item⁵⁷ by their nations.

Genesis 10:32

These are the families of Noah’s children by their records in their nations, and the nations were dispersed from these in the earth after the flood.

אֵלֶּה מִשְׁפַּחַת בְּנֵי נֹחַ
לְתוֹלְדָתָם בְּגוֹיָהֶם
וַיִּמְאַלֶּה נִפְרְדּוּ הַגּוֹיִם
בְּאַרֶץ אַחֵר הַמַּבּוּל׃

Enough babbling, time for something else.

⁵⁷Scholars believe the word “item” here arose due to a scribal haplography of a backslash character in the original text.

Genesis 11

Genesis 11:1

And it was: all the earth was one language and the same words.

እገሠ ሥፋቶ ረጎ ጸጸረሃ
ሃጸፈቱ ሃጸፋፋሃ ተፈቱ

Here we go baby.

After all those babies.

The whole world is of one language, and one speech.

An omnilingual orthography and auditory vocalization for the whole ass people of whole world as one nation.

Finally something worth believing in.

Genesis 11:2

And it was when they were traveling from the east: and they found a valley in the land of Shinar and lived there.

ሃፋዎሃ ሃዐቹሃፍ ጸጸረሃ
ሥፋቶ ጸዐዎፍ ሃቱሥሃረሃ
ሃሠ ሃፍሠረሃ ፋዐሃሠ

Ok so they come from out east back to Sumer and stay there.

Genesis 11:3

And they said to one another, “Come on, let’s make bricks and fire them.” And they had brick for stone, and they had bitumen for mortar.

ሃጸዐፋ ረቱ ሠረቱ ሃፋሃቱረሃ
ሃረሃፍረ ጸሃፍረሃ ጸፍጸ
ጸጸተሃ ጸገፋሠረ ጸገፋሠሃ
ሃፍቱረ ጸሃፍረጸ ሃጸረ
ፋሃፈረ ሃጸረ ጸጸጸ ፋሃፈጸሃ

And the One People say to each other,

“Hey. We know how to build stuff.

Genesis 11:4

And they said, “Come on, let’s build ourselves a city and a tower that reaches to the heavens.

ሃሃረ ጸሃፍሃ ጸፍጸ ሃፋሃቱረሃ
ሃሠቱፋሃ ረፋገሃሃ ፋጸዐ
ሃረሃሠፍ

And we’ll make ourselves a name, or else we’ll scatter over the face of all the earth.”

ሥሃገሃ ሃገ ሃሠ ሃሃረ ጸሠዐሃሃ
ሥፋቶ ረጎ ጸሃገ ረዐ

Let’s build a big thing.
Also let’s decide on a name.
I mean, I like you guys.
We should make sure We don’t forget each other.”

Genesis 11:5

And YHWH went down to see the city and the tower that the children of humankind had built.	ተፋ ተፋላረ ጳሃጳፖ ልላፖሃ ላሠፋ ረላገሣጳ ተፋሃ ላፖዐጳ ሣላፋጳ ፖሣፍ ሃሣፍ
--	---

Then YHWH shows up.
He looks at the One People.
And the thing they’re creating together.

Genesis 11:6

And YHWH said, “Here, they’re one people, and they all have one language, and this is what they’ve begun to do. And now nothing that they’ll scheme to do will be precluded from them.	ሣዐ ሃጳ ጳሃጳፖ ላሣፋፖሃ ሣረሃረ ተፀፋ ጳገሠሃ ልፀፋ ተሃሠዐረ ሣረፀጳ ጳረሃ ሣጳሣ ላሣፍፖ ፋረ ጳተዐሃ ተሃሠዐረ ሃሣገረፖ ላሠፋ ረሃ
--	---

And YHWH’s like:
Woah.⁵⁸
The people are cooperating.
Now they can just make plans and do things.
Like anything.
Together.

Genesis 11:7

Come on, let’s go down and babble their language there so that one won’t understand another’s language.”	ሣሠ ጳረፍሃሃ ጳላላሃ ጳፍጳ ሃዐሣሠፖ ፋረ ላሠፋ ሣተገሠ ሃጳዐላ ተገሠ ሠፖፋ
--	--

⁵⁸Lit. ስግ in the original, an interjection expressing surprise.

Guys,⁵⁹ let's⁶⁰ go mess everything up so they get confused and can't understand each other anymore.

Genesis 11:8

And YHWH scattered them from there over the face of all the earth, and they stopped building the city.

וַתִּפְּזֶנּוּ אֹתָם מִשָּׁם
עַל פְּנֵי כָּל הָאָרֶץ
וַיִּפְּטְרוּ בְּנֵי הָעִיר

So YHWH invents nations and languages.

For the people. Out of spite.

And the people stop building the big thing.

Genesis 11:9

On account of this its name was called Babylon, because YHWH babbled the language of all the earth there, and YHWH scattered them from there over the face of all the earth.

לְכַל הָאָרֶץ
וַיִּפְּזֶנּוּ אֹתָם מִשָּׁם
עַל פְּנֵי כָּל הָאָרֶץ
וַיִּפְּטְרוּ בְּנֵי הָעִיר

So it's called BBL, because BLL.

The BBL, ladies and gentlemen.

What?

It's nothing.

I just have something in my eye.

⁵⁹Lit. הִנֵּה in the original text, a word used before first-person plural future-tense verbs to invite someone to join in an action.

⁶⁰Yhwh unexpectedly speaks in the plural here, specifically the first-person plural (i.e., “We tense”) just as in Genesis 1:26 (*Let us make humanity*) and 3:22 (*The human has become like one of us*). The speaker here is Yhwh, singular, but the use of the plural form is widely understood to be an address to the divine council of heavenly beings, cf. the “Sons of the Gods” in Genesis 6. See also Deut. 32:8–9 and Psalm 82 for two classic depictions of the divine council in the text. Some scholars argue further that the division of humanity into languages and nations in Gen. 11 is the same primordial event reflected in the Dead Sea Scrolls reading of Deuteronomy 32:8–9, where the Most High apportions the nations among the “sons of God.”

Genesis 11:10

These are the records of Shem:
Shem was a hundred years old,
and he fathered Arpachshad, two
years after the flood.

אלה תולדת שם
בן מאת שנה ויולד את
ארפכשד שנתים אחר
המבול:

I don't know what any of these fucking names mean.

Bunch of gibberish from Giberia and babbling to me.

Genesis 11:11

And Shem lived after his fathering
Arpachshad five hundred years,
and he fathered sons and
daughters.

ויחי שם אחרי הולידו
את ארפכשד חמש
מאות שנה ויולד בנים
ובנות:

Arpachshad's not a name. That's not even, like, a name.

Genesis 11:12

And Arpachshad lived thirty-five
years, and he fathered She-lah.

וארפכשד חי חמש
ושלשים שנה ויולד את
שלח:

Screw these foreigners, they make no sense.

Genesis 11:13

And Arpachshad lived after his
fathering Shelah three years and
four hundred years, and he
fathered sons and daughters.

ויחי ארפכשד אחרי
הולידו את שלח שלש
שנים וארבע מאות שנה
ויולד בנים ובנות:

So blahbitty bloo lives a bunch of years after begatting gibberish.

Genesis 11:14

And Shelah lived thirty years, and he fathered Eber.	ושלח חי שלשים שנה ויולד את עבר:
--	------------------------------------

Can we get all these foreigners out of the bible please?

Genesis 11:15

And Shelah lived after his fathering Eber three years and four hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.	ויחי שלח אחרי הולידו את עבר שלש שנים וארבע מאות שנה ויולד בנים ובנות:
---	--

Can. Not. Understand. You.⁶¹

Genesis 11:16

And Eber lived forty-three years, and he fathered Peleg.	ויחי עבר ארבע ושלשים שנה ויולד את פלג:
--	--

Someone fathers peg-leg.

Genesis 11:17

And Eber lived after his fathering Peleg thirty years and four hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.	ויחי עבר אחרי הולידו את פלג שלשים שנה וארבע מאות שנה ויולד בנים ובנות:
---	---

Nobody lives this long, I don't care.

⁶¹Lit. 𐤇 in the original. Some manuscripts have Yue.

Genesis 11:18

And Peleg lived thirty years, and he fathered Reu.

ויחי פלג שלשים שנה
ויולד את רעו:

Why do we need to hear about these foreigners?

Genesis 11:19

And Peleg lived after his fathering Reu nine years and two hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ויחי פלג אחרי הולידו
את רעו תשע שנים
ומאתים שנה ויולד
בנים ובנות:

Putting this on silent.

Genesis 11:20

And Reu lived thirty-two years, and he fathered Serug.

ויחי רעו שנים
ושלשים שנה ויולד
את שרוג:

Serug isn't a name.

Genesis 11:21

And Reu lived after his fathering Serug seven years and two hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.

ויחי רעו אחרי הולידו
את שרוג שבע שנים
ומאתים שנה ויולד
בנים ובנות:

Ever feel like...

We can't hear each other anymore.

Sorry I'm going through a lot in this chapter. I just...

I'll see you guys later.

Genesis 11:22

And Serug lived thirty years, and he fathered Nahor.	ויחי שרוג שלשים שנה ויולד את נחור:
--	---------------------------------------

Unlike many of the names in the preceding chapter, Nahor does not immediately suggest an obvious Hebrew etymology.

Genesis 11:23

And Serug lived after his fathering Nahor two hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.	ויחי שרוג אחרי הולידו את נחור מאתים שנה ויולד בנים ובנות:
--	--

The genealogy continues without pausing to explain the names or their significance.

Genesis 11:24

And Nahor lived twenty-nine years, and he fathered Terah.	ויחי נחור תשע ועשרים שנה ויולד את תרח:
---	--

Terah likewise lacks an evident Hebrew wordplay or transparent meaning.

Genesis 11:25

And Nahor lived after his fathering Terah nineteen years and a hundred years, and he fathered sons and daughters.	ויחי נחור אחרי הולידו את תרח תשע עשרה שנה ומאת שנה ויולד בנים ובנות:
---	---

The narrative’s interest here is succession rather than etymology.

Genesis 11:26

And Terah lived seventy years,
and he fathered Abram, Nahor,
and Haran.

וַיְחִי תֵרַח שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה
וַיּוֹלֵד אֶת אַבְרָם אֶת
נַחֲוֹר וְאֶת הָרָן:

The genealogy has now reached the family that will occupy the remainder of Genesis.

Genesis 11:27

And these are the records of
Terah: Terah had fathered
Abram, Nahor, and Haran, and
Haran had fathered Lot.

וְאֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֹת תֵּרַח
תֵּרַח הוֹלִיד אֶת אַבְרָם
אֶת נַחֲוֹר וְאֶת הָרָן וְהָרָן
הוֹלִיד אֶת לוֹט:

The universal genealogy narrows here to a single household.

Genesis 11:28

And Haran died in the lifetime
of Terah, his father, in the land
of his birthplace, in Ur of the
Chaldees.

וַיָּמָת הָרָן עַל פְּנֵי תֵרַח
אָבִיו בְּאֶרֶץ מוֹלְדֹתוֹ
בְּאוּר כַּשְׁדִּים:

Ok so everyone's in Ur.

Haran dies.

Genesis 11:29

And Abram and Nahor took
wives. Abram's wife's name
was Sarai, and Nahor's wife's
name was Milcah, daughter of
Haran, father of Milcah and
father of Iscah.

וַיִּקַּח אַבְרָם וְנַחֲוֹר לָהֶם
נָשִׁים שֵׁם אִשְׁתּוֹ אַבְרָם
שָׂרַי וְשֵׁם אִשְׁתּוֹ נַחֲוֹר
מִלְכָּה בַת הָרָן אֲבִי
מִלְכָּה וְאַבְי יִסְכָּה:

People get married.

Genesis 11:30

And Sarai was infertile. She did not have a child.

וְתֵהִי שָׂרִי עֲקָרָה אֵין
לָהּ וְלֹד:

Sarai can't have kids.

Genesis 11:31

And Terah took Abram, his son, and Lot, son of Haran, his grandson, and Sarai, his daughter-in-law, the wife of Abram, his son; and they went with them from Ur of the Chaldees to go to the land of Canaan. And they came as far as Haran, and they stayed there.

וַיִּקַּח תֶּרַח אֶת אַבְרָם
בְּנוֹ וְאֶת לוֹט בֶּן הָרָן
בֶּן בְּנוֹ וְאֶת שָׂרִי כַלְתּוֹ
אִשְׁתִּי אַבְרָם בְּנוֹ וַיֵּצְאוּ
אֹתָם מֵאוּר כַּשְׁדִּים
לָלֶכֶת אֶרֶצָה כְּנַעַן
וַיָּבֹאוּ עַד חָרָן וַיֵּשְׁבוּ
שָׁם:

Haran is dead, and they miss him, so they move to Haran.

Like, out of nostalgia, or something.

They leave Ur and go to Haran, and they stay there.

Genesis 11:32

And Terah's days were five years and two hundred years. And Terah died in Haran.

וַיְהִיו יְמֵי תֶרַח חֲמֵשׁ
שָׁנִים וּמֵאתַיִם שָׁנָה
וַיָּמָת תֶּרַח בַּחֲרָן:

Then Abe's dad dies.

They're still in Haran.

The town, not the corpse.

Genesis 12

Genesis 12:1

And YHWH said to Abram, “Go from your land and from your birthplace and from your father’s house to the land that I’ll show you.

ᐱᐅ ᐱᐅᐱᐅ ᐱᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐱᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

Ok so YHWH tells Abe to leave home and go somewhere.

He hasn’t decided where he’s sending him yet.

But it’s time to leave home.

Which he already did in Gen 11:31.⁶²

Genesis 12:2

And I’ll make you into a big nation, and I’ll bless you and make your name great. And be a blessing!

ᐱᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

He promises to make him famous, and make his name famous too.

Genesis 12:3

And I’ll bless those who bless you, and those who affront you I’ll curse. And all the families of the earth will be blessed through you.”

ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ

He promises a lot.

Your friends will be my friends.

Your enemies will be my enemies.

And all the families of the earth from all the other languages and countries, they’re gonna be blessed too.⁶³

Because of Abe.

⁶²Give YHWH a break, he can’t know everything.
⁶³They exist now, because of Gen. 11, when YHWH invented languages and countries out of compassion.

And Abram went as YHWH had spoken to him, and Lot went with him. And Abram was seventy-five years old when he went out from Haran.

אָדאָ אַוואָזאַנאַסאַלזאַ
 יאָאָ זאַלזאַ נאַנאַ זאַלזאַ
 וואָוּ וואָוּ וואָוּ וואָוּ

Abe's 75 at this point.

And Abram took Sarai, his wife, and Lot, his brother's son, and all their property that they had accumulated and the persons whom they had gotten in Haran; and they went out to go to the land of Canaan. And they came to the land of Canaan.

וַיִּקַּח אַבְרָם אֶת שָׂרִי
אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאֶת לוֹט בֶּן
אָחִיו וְאֶת כָּל רִכְוּשָׁם
אֲשֶׁר רָכְשׁוּ וְאֶת הַנֶּפֶשׁ
אֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ בְּחָרָן וַיֵּצְאוּ
לָלֶכֶת אֶרֶצָה כְּנַעַן
וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶרֶצָה כְּנַעַן׃

They arrive.

And Abram passed through the land as far as the place of Shechem, as far as the oak of Moreh. And the Canaanite was in the land then.

40 የጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም
 ጥቅም 40 ጥቅም ጥቅም
 ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም
 ጥቅም

Oh and the Canaanite was in the land then.

Genesis 12:7

And YHWH appeared to Abram and said, “I’ll give this land to your seed.” And he built an altar there to YHWH who had appeared to him.

ገላጥጥ ረጽ ጸሃጸጊ ጽላጊሃ
ተጽ ሃተጽ ሃዐላጊረ ላግጽጊሃ
ግሠ ሃፃጊሃ ተጽጊጻ ጥላጽጻ
ጸጽላሃጻ ጸሃጸጊረ ዘፃጊግ
ሃጊረጽ

YHWH’s back.

He appears to Abe and says “Abe! Baby. I’ll give this land to your children baby.”

Which is apparently convincing.

He builds an altar to YHWH.

Genesis 12:8

And he moved on from there to the hill country east of Beth-El and pitched his tent—Beth-El to the west and Ai to the east—and he built an altar there to YHWH and invoked the name YHWH.

ጸላጸጸ ግሠግ ዋተዐጊሃ
፱ጊሃ ረጽ ተጊፃረ ግላዋግ
ግጊግ ረጽ ተጊፃ ጸረጸጽ
ግሠ ሃፃጊሃ ግላዋግ ጊዐጸሃ
ጽላዋጊሃ ጸሃጸጊረ ዘፃጊግ
ጸሃጸጊ ግሠፃ

Ok so he leaves the altar of YHWH and he goes to House of God.

Actually he’s between House of God and Heap of Ruins.

He builds another altar and says “YHWH” again.

Genesis 12:9

And Abram traveled on, going to the Negeb.

ሃሃረጸ ግላጥጥ ዐቹጊሃ
ጸፃገሃጸ ዐሃቹሃሃ

He goes to the Dry Place.

Genesis 12:10

And there was a famine in the land, and Abram went down to Egypt to reside there because the famine was heavy in the land.

ላላጊሃ ጥላጽፃ ፃዐላ ጊጸጊሃ
ላሃገረ ጸግጊላጥግ ግላጥጥ
ጥላጽፃ ፃዐላጸ ላፃሃ ጊሃ ግሠ

There’s no food, so he goes to Egypt, because there’s no food.

Genesis 12:11

And it was when he was close to coming to Egypt: and he said to Sarai, his wife, “Here, I know that you’re a beautiful woman.

ዓገላዎን ላወቀኝ ገንገላ
ላግቶኝ ገንገላኝ ፋሃሪ
ቀን ጸንጎ ሃተወቀ ገላወ ረቀ
ተገገ ጸወቀ ገን ገተዐላገ
ተቀ ጸቀላግ

Ok so when he was close to coming

To Egypt, he says to his wife,

“Look, you’re hot.”

Genesis 12:12

And it will be when the Egyptians see you that they’ll say, ‘This is his wife,’ and they’ll kill me and keep you alive.

ኃተቀ ሃቀላገ ገን ጸገጸሃ
ሃተወቀ ሃላግቀሃ ግገላኝጸ
ኃተቀሃ ገተቀ ሃገላጸሃ ተቀገ
ሃገፀገ

“The Egyptians are gonna take one look at you and kill me and keep you alive for, y’know, reasons.”

Genesis 12:13

Say you’re my sister so it will be good for me on your account and I’ll stay alive because of you.”

ተቀ ገተፀቀ ቀን ገላግቀ
ኃላሃዓዓ ገረ ዓፀገገ ሃዐግረ
ኃረረገዓ ገወገነ ጸተገፀሃ

Say you’re my sister.

It’ll be good for me.

And sure it won’t exactly be good for—

Scratch that.

I’ll stay alive because of you.

Genesis 12:14

And it was as Abram came to Egypt, and the Egyptians saw the woman, that she was very beautiful.

ግላዓቀ ፋሃዓኝ ገንገላ
ሃቀላገሃ ገንገላኝግ
ጸወቀን ተቀ ግገላኝጸ
ላቀግ ፋሃን ጸገገ ገን

So that happens.

Genesis 12:15

And Pharaoh’s officers saw her and praised her to Pharaoh, and the woman was taken to Pharaoh’s house.

እዐላገ ጊላወ እተቶ ሃቶላጊሃ
እዐላገ ረቶ እተቶ ሃረረእጊሃ
እዐላገ ተጊፍ እሠቶእ ዘዋተሃ

Abe’s plan works.

The king sees his hot wife and takes her into his place.

Genesis 12:16

And he was good to Abram on her account, and he had a flock and oxen and he-asses and servants and maids and she-asses and camels.

ፍጊ፬ጊእ ሠላፍቶረሃ
ሃቶሾ ሃረ ጊእጊሃ እላሃፍዐፍ
ሠጊላፍዐሃ ሠጊላሠዘሃ ላዋፍሃ
ሠጊረሠገሃ ተሃተቶሃ ተዘገሠሃ

He’s really nice to Abe because of her.

He gives him lots of stuff.

Servants and maids.

He-asses and She-asses.

Also animals.

Genesis 12:17

And YHWH plagued Pharaoh and his house, big plagues, over the matter of Sarai, Abram’s wife.

እዐላገ ተቶ እሃእጊ ዐገሃጊሃ
ተቶሃ ሠጊረላገ ሠጊዐገሃ
ተሠቶ ጊላወ ላፍላ ረዐ ሃተጊፍ
ሠላፍቶ

YHWH, seemingly unaware of the finer points of moral philosophy, gives Pharaoh some plagues for being with Abe’s wife.

Unacceptable, Pharaoh.

She was his wife.

Genesis 12:18

And Pharaoh called Abram and said, “What is this you’ve done to me? Why didn’t you tell me that she was your wife?

ሠላፍቶረ እዐላገ ቶላዋጊሃ
ተጊሠዐ ተቶጊ እሠ ላሠቶጊሃ
ጊሃ ጊረ ተላገእ ቶረ እሠረ ጊረ
ቶሃእ ሃተሠቶ

So Pharaoh’s like “Abe! You’re breaking my balls man.”

Optional Midrash: I picture him covered in bees here.

Genesis 12:19

Why did you say, ‘She’s my sister,’
so I took her for a wife for
myself! And now, here’s your
wife. Take her and go.”

כַּיֵּן זָתָהּ תִּשְׁמַחַת אִשְׁתִּי
אֲנִי לָקַחְתִּי לִי אִשָּׁה
וְעַתָּה הִנֵּה אִשְׁתְּךָ
לְפָנֶיךָ לֵקַח וְהָיָה

I never would have... take your wife and go.

Genesis 12:20

And Pharaoh commanded people
over him, and they let him and his
wife and all he had go.

וַיֹּאמֶר פַּרְעֹה לְעַמּוֹתָיו
וְהָיָה אִתְּךָ וְאִתְּאִשְׁתְּךָ
וְכָל אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֶיךָ
וְהָיָה אִתְּךָ וְאִתְּאִשְׁתְּךָ

And they do.

Genesis 13

Genesis 13:1

And Abram went up from Egypt,
he and his wife and all he had and
Lot with him, to the Negeb.

ሠጊላኢሠሠ ሠላላፉ ረዐጊሃ
ላሠፉ ረሃሃ ሃተሠፉሃ ፉሃፓ
፳፻፲ሃ፳ ሃሠዐ ተሃረሃ ሃረ

So they leave Egypt and go back to Dry Place.

Genesis 13:2

And Abram was very heavy with
livestock and silver and gold.

ላፉሠ ላላሃ ሠላላፉሃ
፻፺፯ሃ ገቹሃ፻ ፳ሃዋሠ፻

The weight of Abram’s cargo is a silent comment that entrapment pays handsomely.

Genesis 13:3

And he went on his travels from
the Negeb as far as Beth-El, as far
as the place where his tent was at
the start, between Beth-El and Ai,

፻፲ሃሠ ሃጊዐቹሠረ ሃረጊሃ
ሠሃዋሠ፻ ላዐ ረፉ ተጊ፻ ላዐሃ
፳ረ፳ፉ ሠሠ ፳ጊ፻ ላሠፉ
ረፉ ተጊ፻ ሃጊ፻ ፳ረዘተ፻
ጊዐ፻ ሃጊ፻ሃ

He goes back to the place between House of God and Heap of Ruins.

Apparently he left his tent.

It’s still there.

Genesis 13:4

to the place of the altar that he
had made there at the beginning.
And Abram invoked the name
YHWH there.

ላሠፉ ዘ፻፲ሠ፻ ሠሃዋሠ ረፉ
፳ሃሠፉላ፻ ሠሠ ፳ሠዐ
ሠሠ፻ ሠላላፉ ሠሠ ፉላዋጊሃ
፳ሃ፳ጊ

He goes back to the altar he built and says YHWH again.

Genesis 13:5

And Lot, who was going with Abram, also had a flock and oxen and tents.

תָּכָה יָלָאָה עִמָּלֶל מִן
אֶפְרָיִם וְכָצִי אֶזְרָא מִן
מִזְרָאָה

His nephew Lot got a lot of stuff too.

Genesis 13:6

And the land did not suffice them to live together, because their property was great, and they were not able to live together.

וְלֹא נִשְׂא אֹתָם הָאָרֶץ
לְשִׁבֹּת יַחְדָּו כִּי הָיָה
רְכוּשָׁם רָב וְלֹא יָכְלוּ
לְשִׁבֹּת יַחְדָּו׃

They look around in the wilderness and say to each other,

“This town’s not big enough for the both of us.”

They got a LOT of stuff in Egypt.

Genesis 13:7

And there was a quarrel between those who herded Abram’s livestock and those who herded Lot’s livestock. And the Canaanite and the Perizzite lived in the land then.

זָמָן נִזְגָּה אֶזְרָא זֶאזָּה
זָמָן נִזְגָּה מִן אֶפְרָיִם
זִנְיָנִיָּה עִמָּלֶל אֶפְרָיִם
מִן אֶפְרָיִם וְכָצִי מִן
מִזְרָאָה

Abe’s guys and Lot’s guys get in fights.

And the Canaanite was in the land then.

So were the Perizzites, whose name means either “villagers” or “dwellers in the open country,” terms which I understood to be opposites in life before now.

Genesis 13:8

And Abram said to Lot, “Let there be no quarreling between me and you and between my herders and your herders, because we’re brothers.

עִמָּלֶל לָכֵן מִן אֶפְרָיִם
אֶזְרָאִי זֶאזָּה כִּי לָכֵן
זָמָן נִזְגָּה מִן אֶפְרָיִם
מִן אֶפְרָיִם וְכָצִי מִן
מִזְרָאָה

Abe says to his nephew, “Look man, we’re brothers.”

No more brother wars.

Genesis 13:9

Isn’t the whole land before you?
Separate from me: if left then I’ll
go right, and if right then I’ll go
left.”

ሃገሪህ ህጻኑን ለጎ ፋረጎ
ሃጎን ረረዐሃ ፋሃ ልላገጎ
ሃፋሃ ጸሃሃገገፋሃ ለፋሃሠጎ
ጸረገፋሃሠፋሃ ሃገሃገጎ

This Lot Of Space isn’t big enough for the Space Of Lot and also Abe.

They decide to walk in opposite directions.

They haven’t decided on the directions yet.

Genesis 13:10

And Lot raised his eyes and saw
all the plain of the Jordan, that all
of it was well watered (before
YHWH’s destroying Sodom and
Gomorrah) like YHWH’s garden,
like the land of Egypt, as you
come to Zoar.

ሃገሪህን ተፋ ፀሃረ ፋሠገሃ
ሃልላገጎ ላላሃ ለጎ ተፋ ፋላገሃ
ተዘሠ ገሪህን ጸዋሠሃ ጸረጎገጎ
ተፋሃ ሃልቹ ተፋ ጸሃጸገ
ህጻኑን ጸሃጸገ ሃገሃ ጸሃሠ
ላዐህ ጸሃፋፍ ሃገላህሃ

Lot looks East and it looks nice.

(Or it used to.)

Like Egypt looks, when you’re on your way to Small.

Genesis 13:11

And Lot chose all the plain of the
Jordan for himself, and Lot
traveled east. **And they
separated, each from his
brother.**

ለጎ ተፋ ፀሃረ ሃረ ላዘፍገሃ
ፀሃረ ዐቹገሃ ሃልላገጎ ላላሃ
ሃልቹ ሃልቹ ሃልቹ ሃልቹ
ፀሃረ ሃልቹ ሃልቹ ሃልቹ ሃልቹ

Lot goes East.

Genesis 13:12

Abram lived in the land of Canaan, and Lot lived in the cities of the plain and tented as far as Sodom.

אַבְרָם יָשָׁב בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן
וְלוֹט יָשָׁב בְּעֵרֵי הַכְּכָר
וַאֲפֹלֶם לְאַזְזָר

Abe keeps the West.

Genesis 13:13

And the people of Sodom were very bad and sinful to YHWH.

וְזֶם אֲפֹלֶם זָמַנְכִּי
אֲכִי אֶתְּזַל וְזָכָה

Side Note: YHWH doesn't like the Sodomites.

Genesis 13:14

And YHWH said to Abram after Lot's separation from him, "Lift your eyes and see from the place where you are to the north and south and east and west.

וַאֲנִי לֵאמֹר אֶתְּזַל
וְיָמִי אֶתְּזַל אֶתְּזַל
וְיָמִי אֶתְּזַל אֶתְּזַל
וְיָמִי אֶתְּזַל אֶתְּזַל
וְיָמִי אֶתְּזַל אֶתְּזַל
וְיָמִי אֶתְּזַל אֶתְּזַל

YHWH comes to Abe and says "Abe, look at everything."

Genesis 13:15

For all the land that you see, I'll give it to you and to your seed forever.

אֲנִי לֵאמֹר לְךָ כָּל הָאָרֶץ
אֲנִי לֵאמֹר לְךָ כָּל הָאָרֶץ
אֲנִי לֵאמֹר לְךָ כָּל הָאָרֶץ
אֲנִי לֵאמֹר לְךָ כָּל הָאָרֶץ

Come here babe, Abe babe.

Look at all that.

See man?

Exactly.

I'm giving it to you.

You and your children forever and ever.

Genesis 13:16

And I'll make your seed like the dust of the earth, so that if a man could count the dust of the earth then your seed also could be counted.

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ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

And I'll make your cumulative children come out of you like the dust of the earth, so that if a man could accumulate the dust of the earth then your accumulated children could also come to be uh, cumulated.

Genesis 13:17

Get up, go around in the land to its length and its width, because I'm giving it to you.”

ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ

Get up Abe.

Stop la— Abe get up.

Go around in the land.

It's long and it's wide.

Just for you Abe.

I'm giving it all to you forever and ever, YHWH and Abe.

Genesis 13:18

And Abram took up his tent and came and lived among the oaks of Mamre which are in Hebron, and he built an altar to YHWH there.

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ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ

Abe packs up his tent and goes and lives by that tree.

No not that one. A new one.

You know the one.

And he builds an altar to YHWH.

Genesis 14

THE INSCRIPTION OF ABRAM
THE HEBREW | MIGHTY KING
DESTROYER OF THE FIVE RE
BELLIOUS KINGS | BEFORE W
HOSE TERRIBLE SPLENDOR T
HOSE WHO HATE EL ELYON N
OW LIE SCATTERED AND SMAS
HED | THEIR LAND ALL IN ASH
ES | THEIR SEED IS NO MORE ✱

Genesis 14:1

And it was in the days of
Amraphel, king of Shinar,
Arioch, king of Ellasar,
Chedorlaomer, king of Elam, and
Tidal, king of Goiim.

𐤀𐤓𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕

REGNAL YEAR: unspecified.

THEATER: Jordan Valley.

EASTERN COALITION: Amraphel of Shinar; Arioch of Ellasar; Chedorlaomer of Elam; Tidal of Goiim.

Genesis 14:2

They made war with Bera, king of
Sodom, and Birsha, king of
Gomorraḥ, Shinab, king of
Admah, and Shemeber, king of
Zeboiim, and the king of Bela.
(That is Zoar.)

𐤀𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 (𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕) 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕

OPPOSING COALITION: Bera of Sodom; Birsha of Gomorraḥ; Shinab of Admah; Shemeber of Zeboiim; king of Bela (modern designation: Zoar). Hostilities commenced between the two coalitions.

Qere Ketiv.

Genesis 14:3

All these were allied at the Siddim Valley. (That is the Dead Sea.)

ሪቱ ሃፋዝ ባሪቱ ሪሃ
ሃኒ ተሃቶ ሃኒፈወቶ ዋሃዐ
ዘሪሃቶ

ASSEMBLY POINT: Valley of Siddim (modern designation: Dead Sea). The five western kings concentrated their forces there.

Genesis 14:4

Twelve years they served Chedorlaomer, and the thirteenth year they revolted,

ቶሃወ ቶሃወዐ ሃኒጰወ
ፋሃዐሪፋሃ ጰቱ ሃፋዐ
ቶሃወ ቶሃወዐ ወሪወሃ
ሃፋሃ

POLITICAL STATUS: Twelve years under Chedorlaomer. YEAR 13: western vassals revolted.

Genesis 14:5

and in the fourteenth year Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him came, and they struck the Rephaim in Ashteroth Karnaim and the Zuzum in Ham and the Emim in Shaveh Kiriataim

ቶሃወ ቶሃወዐ ዐፋፋተፋሃ
-ሃቶሃ ፋሃዐሪፋሃ ተፋ
ሃጰቱ ፋወቱ ሃኒሃሪ
ሃኒተገፋ ጰቱ ሃሃኒሃ
ሃኒሃፋዋ ጰፋጰወዐፋ
ሃቶፋ ሃኒ፣ሃ፣ቶ ጰቱሃ
ቶሃወፋ ሃኒሃኒተቶ ጰቱሃ
ሃኒጰኒፋዋ

YEAR 14: Chedorlaomer and allied kings commenced punitive operations. Rephaim struck at Ashteroth Karnaim; Zuzim at Ham; Emim at Shaveh Kiriathaim;

Genesis 14:6

and the Horites in their mountain Seir to El Paran, which is by the wilderness.

ሃፋፋፋፋ ኒፋዘቶ ጰቱሃ
ሃፋተገ ሪኒቱ ፈዐ ፋኒዐወ
ፋፋፋፋ ሪዐ ፋወቱ

Horites struck throughout the hill country of Seir as far as El Paran, on the wilderness frontier.

Genesis 14:7

And they came back and came to En Mishpat (that is Kadesh) and struck the area of the Amalekites and also the Amorites who live in Hazazon Tamar.

ለቶ ሃቶገጌሂ ሃገሠጌሂ
ቶሃ ቆገሠኝ ነጌዐ
ለሃ ጸቶ ሃሃጌሂ ሠፈዋ
ካገሂ ጌዋሪካዐቶ ቶፊሠ
ገሠጌቶ ጌሃካቶ ጸቶ
ሃኝጸ ነኪኪዘገ

RETURN ADVANCE: Coalition forces turned toward En Mishpat (modern designation: Kadesh), struck Amalekite territory, then the Amorites stationed at Hazazon Tamar.

Genesis 14:8

And the king of Sodom and the king of Gomorrah and the king of Admah and the king of Zeboiim and the king of Bela (that is Zoar) went out and aligned with them for war in the Siddim Valley

ሃሪኝ ቶኪጌሂ
ቶሃካዐ ሃሪኝሂ ካፈቹ
ሃሪኝሂ ቶካፈቶ ሃሪኝሂ
ዐካጌሂገኪ (ካጌጌገኪ)
ላዐኪ ቶሃቶ ዐሪገ ሃሪኝሂ
ቶካዘሪኝ ካጸቶ ሃሃላዐጌሂ
ካጌፈሠቶ ዋካዐገ

WESTERN RESPONSE: Kings of Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, Zeboiim, and Bela (Zoar) deployed for battle in the Valley of Siddim.

Qere Ketiv.

Genesis 14:9

with Chedorlaomer, king of Elam, and Tidal, king of Goiim, and Amraphel, king of Shinar, and Arioch, king of Ellasar---four kings with five.

ሃሪኝ ላካዐሪላዐሪ ጸቶ
ሃሪኝ ሪዐፈጸሂ ካሪጌዐ
ሃሪኝ ሪገላካቶ ካጌሂገ
ሃሪኝ ሃሂጌላቶ ላዐካሠ
ካጌሃሪኝ ቶዐገላቶ ላቹሪቶ
ቶሠካዘቶ ጸቶ

ORDER OF BATTLE: Chedorlaomer of Elam; Tidal of Goiim; Amraphel of Shinar; Arioch of Ellasar. STRENGTH: four kings against five.

Genesis 14:10

And Siddim Valley was pits, pits of bitumen, and the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, and they fell there; and those who were left fled to the mountain.

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ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
-ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

TERRAIN: Valley of Siddim heavily broken by bitumen pits. RESULT: Sodomite and Gomorrite forces routed. Some fell among the pits; surviving elements withdrew into the hills.

Genesis 14:11

And they took all the property of Sodom and Gomorrah and all their food, and they went.

ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

SODOM AND GOMORRAH: Coalition forces seized all movable property and provisions and withdrew.

Genesis 14:12

And they took Lot, Abram's brother's son, and his property when they went. And he had been living in Sodom.

ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ

CAPTIVES: Lot, nephew of Abram and resident of Sodom, taken with his property during withdrawal.

Genesis 14:13

And an escapee came and told Abram the Hebrew, and he was tenting among the oaks of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eshcol and brother of Aner; and they were covenant partners of Abram.

ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

SURVIVOR REPORT: One escapee reached Abram the Yid,⁶⁴ then en-

⁶⁴The term used here is not typically one Israelites use to describe themselves, but is more characteristic of how they are described by or among foreigners. This is one of several indications that the chapter lies outside the primary sources of the Torah and may

camped by the oaks of Mamre the Amorite. Mamre, Eshcol, and Aner were covenant allies of Abram.

Genesis 14:14

And Abram heard that his brother had been taken prisoner, and he had his trained men, born in his house, unsheathe: three hundred eighteen. And he pursued as far as Dan.

ኃላታ ዐኃወኒህ
ሃኒዘተ ባገወኝ ኒሃ
ሃኒሃኒኃዘ ጸተ ቀላኒህ
ሃጸኒገ ኒፈኒሪኒ
ወሪወሃ ላወዐ ባኃኃወ
ኃፈ ፈዐ ገፈላኒህ ጸሃተኝ

MOBILIZATION: Upon confirmation that his kinsman had been captured, Abram mustered 318 trained household-born retainers. **PURSUIT:** north to Dan.

Genesis 14:15

And he divided against them by night, he and his servants, and he struck them and pursued them as far as Hobah, which is at the left of Damascus.

ባሪኒሪ ኃባኒሪዐ ቀሪዘኒህ
ኃሃኒህ ሃኒፈገዐሃ ተሃባ
ባገሃዘ ፈዐ ኃገፈላኒህ
ቀወኃፈሪ ሪተኃወኝ ላወተ

NIGHT ACTION: Abram divided his force, attacked with his retainers, routed the enemy, and pursued as far as Hobah, north of Damascus.

Genesis 14:16

And he brought back all the property, and he also brought back Lot, his brother, and his property, and also the women and the people.

ወሃላባ ሪሃ ጸተ ገወኒህ
ሃኒዘተ ፀሃሪ ጸተ ኃሀሂ
ኃሀሂ ገኒወባ ሃወሃላሂ
ኃዐባ ጸተሃ ኃኒወኃባ ጸተ

RECOVERY: All seized property recovered. Lot and his property recovered. Women and other captives recovered.

Genesis 14:17

And the king of Sodom came out to him after he came back from striking Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him at the Shaveh Valley. (That is the valley of the king.)

ኃላፍ ሃሪኝ ተኪጊሂ
ሃጋሂወ ጊላዘተ ሃጰተላዋሪ
ላኃዐሪላዳሂ ጰተ ጰሂሃባኝ
ላወተ ኃጊሃሪኝባ ጰተሂ
ባሂወ ዋኃዐ ሪተ ሃጰተ
ሃሪኝባ ዋኃዐ ተሂባ

RETURN: Following the defeat of Chedorlaomer and allied kings, Abram was met by the King of Sodom at the Valley of Shaveh (modern designation: King’s Valley).

Genesis 14:18

And Melchizedek, king of Salem, had brought out bread and wine. And he was a priest of El the Highest.

ሃሪኝ ዋላኪ ጊሃሪኝሂ
ኃዘሪ ተጊኪሂባ ኃሪወ
ኃባሂ ተሂባሂ ኃጊጊሂ
ኃሂጊሪዐ ሪተሪ

SALEM: Melchizedek, King of Salem and priest of El Most High, brought out bread and wine.

Genesis 14:19

And he blessed him and said, "Blessed is Abram to El the Highest, creator of skies and earth.

ላኃተጊሂ ሃባሂላጊጊሂ
ሪተሪ ኃላጊተ ሃሂላጊ
ኃጊኃወ ባኃዋ ኃሂጊሪዐ
ኪላተሂ

BLESSING: “Blessed be Abram by El Most High, Maker of heaven and earth;

Genesis 14:20

And blessed is El the Highest, who delivered your foes into your hand." And he gave him a tithe from everything.

ኃሂጊሪዐ ሪተ ሃሂላጊሂ
ሃጊላኪ ኃላኝ ላወተ
ሂሪ ኃጰጊሂ ሃላጊጊ
ሪሃኝ ላወዐኝ

and blessed be El Most High, who delivered your enemies into your hand.” TRIBUTE: Abram transferred one tenth of all recovered goods to Melchizedek.

Genesis 14:21

And the king of Sodom said to Abram, "Give the persons to me, and take the property for you."

לֹא מִדָּפַן שְׁלֹמֹה אֲמַתְּ
וְיִשְׁרָאֵל זֶלַע גָּמַל מִלְּפָנָיו
שְׁלֹמֹה הָאֵל וְשִׁמְשֹׁן

SODOMITE CLAIM: King of Sodom requested return of the persons; Abram was authorized to retain the property.

Genesis 14:22

And Abram said to the king of Sodom, "I've lifted my hand to YHWH El the Highest, creator of skies and earth,

לֹא מִלְּפָנָיו אֲמַתְּ אֲמַתְּ
זֶלַע מִלְּפָנָיו מִדָּפַן שְׁלֹמֹה
לֹא יְהוָה לֹא זֶלַע
מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו
לֹא מִלְּפָנָיו

ABRAM'S OATH: "I have raised my hand to YHWH⁶⁵ El Most High, creator of heaven and earth,

Genesis 14:23

that, from a thread to a shoelace, I won't take anything that is yours, so you won't say, 'I made Abram rich.'

שְׁלֹמֹה מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו
לֹא מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו
אֲמַתְּ מִלְּפָנָיו שְׁלֹמֹה
מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו
מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו מִלְּפָנָיו

I will take neither thread nor sandal strap nor anything belonging to you, so that no claim may be made that the King of Sodom enriched Abram.

⁶⁵ This verse is one of only 5 occurrences of the name YHWH outside the J source prior to the name being revealed in Exodus 3 and Exodus 6.

Overall, the word YHWH occurs about 3,190 times in the Primary History (Genesis through II Kings.) 1,829 times in the Torah (Genesis through Deuteronomy), and 211 times from the beginning of Genesis to the end of Exodus 6.

After Exodus 3, the E source begins using the name YHWH, while also continuing to use the term God (Elohim).

After Exodus 6, the P source does the same.

This first exception to the rule is not particularly interesting, given that the entirety of Genesis 14 appears not to have been written by any of the primary authors of the Torah.

Regardless, the idea that two of the three primary authors of the Torah have this idea that the name YHWH was not known until the time of Moses in Egypt is a fact worth noting. This was among the earliest forms of evidence that eventually allowed us to determine how the Torah was written, and by whom.

Genesis 14:24

Except only what the boys have eaten and the share of the people who went with me: Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre. They shall take their share."

ᐱᐄᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐱᐄᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

EXCEPTIONS: provisions already consumed by Abram’s men; contractual shares of allied commanders Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre. Their shares remain theirs.”

Genesis 15

Genesis 15:1

After these things YHWH's word came to Abram in a vision, saying, "Don't fear, Abram. I'm a shield for you. Your reward is very much."

እረፋኝ ማረፋፋኝ ላይኔ
ረፋ ጸሃኝ ላላ ጸኝ
ረፋ ላማፋረ ጸገዘማ ማላፋ
ነገሚ ጸሃኔ ማላፋ ፋላገተ
ላፋማ ጸላላ ጸላሃሃ ጸረ

Ok after all that, YHWH shows up in Abe's mind and goes,

Abe it's me! No, don't be afraid. I'm a shield Abe. Your reward is very much.

Genesis 15:2

And Abram said, "My Lord, YHWH, what would you give me when I go childless and my household is an acquired person!" (That is Damascus Eliezer.)

ጸሃላፋ ማላፋ ላማፋጸሃ
ጸረ ነተተ ጸማ ጸሃኝ
ጸላጸላዐ ጸረሃኝ ጸሃኔሃ
ፋሃኝ ጸተጸፍ ዋሃማ ነፍሃ
ላገዐጸረፋ ዋሃሃላ

So Abe says:

My Lord.

YHWH.

What are you gonna give me when I end up childless and have no sons to give all this stuff to?

Genesis 15:3

And Abram said, "Here, you haven't given me seed. And, here, a member of my household is taking possession of what is mine."

ጸረ ነኝ ማላፋ ላማፋጸሃ
ነፍ ጸሃኔሃ ዐላገ ጸተተሃ ፋረ
ጸተፋ ሃላሃጸ ጸተጸፍ

I still haven't gotten any of that p[er]man[ent] aternity you keep promising.

Who am I gonna give all my stuff to, some employee?

Genesis 15:4

And, here, YHWH’s word came to him, saying, “This one won’t take possession from you, but rather one who will come out of your in-sides: he will take possession from you.”

ሃጊረቱ ጸሃጸጊ ላላፋ ጸሃጸሃ
ጊሃ ጸገ ሃሠላጊጊ ቀረ ላሣቀረ
ሃጊዐሣሣ ቀሶጊ ላሠቀ ሣቀ
ሃሠላጊጊ ቀሃጸ

So YHWH says No Abe, this one won’t come take your stuff, someone’s coming, out of you Abe, out from your in-sides, he’ll take your stuff, cuz we’re gonna make him, you and me.

Genesis 15:5

And He brought him outside and said, “Look at the skies and count the stars—if you’ll be able to count them.” And He said to him, “That is how your seed will be.”

ጸሶሃዘጸ ሃተቱ ቀሶሃጊሃ
ቀሃ ⊕ጸጸ ላሣቀጊሃ
ላገቹሃ ጸሣጊሣሠጸ
ረሃሃተ ሣቀ ሣጊጸሃሃጸጸ
ሃረ ላሣቀጊሃ ሣተቱ ላገቹረ
ሃዐላገ ጸጊጸጊ ጸሃ

So YHWH goes “Come. Outside Abe.

Abe, look at everything.

No, up this time.

See man?

How many stars do you think that is?

Can’t count them right?

Exactly.

That’s your c children.

That’s how your c children will be if you stick with me Abe.

Just look at it all.

Genesis 15:6

And he trusted in YHWH, and He considered it for him as virtue.

ጸጸሠዘጊሃ ጸሃጸጊጸ ሃሣቀጸሃ
ጸቀላሶ ሃረ

Abe believed him.

Genesis 15:7

And He said to him, “I am YHWH, who brought you out of Ur of the Chaldees to give you this land, to possess it.”

𐤅𐤆𐤕 𐤕𐤆𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤏𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕

Then YHWH says:

I’m YHWH.

I brought you up from yo— ur. Ur home.

Ur of the Chaldees.

I did that. I brought you here to this land, to possess it.

To pussess, Abe.

Genesis 15:8

And he said, “My Lord YHWH, how will I know that I’ll possess it?”

𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤏𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕

And Abe’s like

My Lord.

YHWH.

How do I know that’s going to happen?

Genesis 15:9

And He said to him, “Take a three-year-old heifer and a three-year-old she-goat and a three-year-old ram and a dove and a pigeon for me.”

𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤏𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕

And YHWH goes

Take a 3yo cow.

And a 3yo girl goat.

And a 3yo, one of those sheep with big horns.

And a dove.

And a pigeon Abe, for me.

No the birds can be any age.

Then cut them in half Abe.

All of them.

Except the birds.

Further instructions to follow.

Genesis 15:10

And he took all of these for Him and split them up the middle and set each half opposite its other half, but he did not split the birds.

אֵלֶּכָּה לְךָ אֶת־כָּל־הַחַיָּוִי
וַיַּחַדֵּם וַיַּחַדֵּם אֶת־חֲצֵי
וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח
אֶת־כָּל־הַחַיָּוִי אֶת־חֲצֵי
אֶת־חֲצֵי אֶת־חֲצֵי

Abe does.

Genesis 15:11

And birds of prey came down on the carcasses, and Abram retrieved them.

וַיֵּרְדּוּ הַחַיָּוִי לְאֹכֵל אֶת־הַחַיָּוִי
וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח

Vultures try to eat the dead animals, but Abe shoos them away.

Genesis 15:12

And the sun was about to set, and a slumber had come over Abram; and, here, a big, dark terror was coming over him.

אֶת־הַחַיָּוִי וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח
וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח
וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח
וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח וַיִּשְׁכַּח

It’s almost dark.

Abe’s falling asleep.

A big dark terror comes over him.

Genesis 15:13

And He said to Abram, “You shall know that your seed will be an alien in a land that is not theirs, and they will serve them, and they will degrade them four hundred years.

וַיֹּאמֶר לְאַבְרָם יָדַע
תָּדַע כִּי גֵר יִהְיֶה
זֶרַעְךָ בָּאֶרֶץ לֹא־לָהֶם
וְעַבְדוּם וְעָנּוּ אֹתָם
אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה:

And He⁶⁶ said to Abe,

“Here’s how you’ll know that your c[]hildren will be an alien in a land that’s not theirs, and they⁶⁷ will serve them,⁶⁸ and they⁶⁹ will degrade them⁷⁰ four hundred years.

Genesis 15:14

But I’ll judge the nation whom they’ll serve as well, and after that they’ll go out with much property.

וְגַם אֶת הַגּוֹי אֲשֶׁר יַעֲבֹדוּ דָן אֲנִי וְאַחֲרָיו כֵּן יֵצְאוּ בִּרְכֻשׁ גָּדוֹל:

I assume Abe doesn’t quite understand what’s being said here.

But with the benefit of hindsight, we can translate it as follows:

YHWH appears to be saying,

“Remember that thing we just did in Egypt?

We’re gonna do it again, in Egypt. For four hundred years Abe.

Me and your kids. That’s how you know you’ll have kids.”

Genesis 15:15

And you: you’ll come to your fathers in peace. You’ll be buried at a good old age.

וְאַתָּה תָּבוֹא אֶל אֲבֹתֶיךָ בְּשָׁלוֹם תִּקְבֹּר בְּשִׁיבָה טוֹבָה:

And you, you’ll be dead.

Don’t worry you’ll be old by then.

Like grandpa age.

Genesis 15:16

And a fourth generation will come back here, because the Amor-ite’s crime is not yet complete.”

וְדוֹר רְבִיעִי יָשׁוּבוּ הֵנָּה כִּי לֹא שָׁלֵם עוֹן הָאֻמִּרִי עַד הֵנָּה:

“And four generations later, they’ll come back here.”

⁶⁶The big dark terror?

⁶⁷Who?

⁶⁸Which them?

⁶⁹Come on.

⁷⁰Abe has no idea which “they” his c[]hildren is.

YHWH seems to wander off to another topic.

He’s waiting for some people to finish doing crime.

Genesis 15:17

And the sun was setting, and there was darkness, and here was an oven of smoke and a flame of fire that went between these pieces.

וַיְהִי הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ בָּאָה
וְעֹלָטָה הָיָה וְהָנָה
תְּנוּרַת עֶשֶׂן וּלְפִיד אֵשׁ
אֲשֶׁר עָבַר בֵּין הַגְּזָרִים
הָאֵלֶּה:

Ok so the sun is setting, and there’s a darkness.

We’re now two levels deep in Abe’s dreams.

Now there’s a cloud of smoke and fire walking down the path between the two halves of animal bodies that Abe cut up two levels of dream above this.

Abe falls asleep inside his dream and dreams about that two levels down.

Genesis 15:18

In that day YHWH made a covenant with Abram, saying, “I’ve given this land to your seed, from the river of Egypt to the big river, the river Euphrates:

אֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ
וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ
וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ
וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ
וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ וְאֵלֶּיךָ

In that day⁷¹ YHWH made a Coming Together agreement with Abe, saying:

“I’ve given this land to your c children from the river of Egypt to—

The big river.

The river Euphrates.

Genesis 15:19

the Cainites and the Kenizzites and the Kad-monites

וְהַכְּנִיזִיטִים וְהַכַּדְמוֹנִיטִים
וְהַכְּנִיזִיטִים וְהַכַּדְמוֹנִיטִים

All these different races Abe.

⁷¹It was night. Twice.

Genesis 15:20

and the Hittites and the Perizzites and the Rephaim	זלאלא +כץ זתחא +כץ וצכאלא +כץ
--	----------------------------------

The Hittites and the Perizzites and these really tall Ghosts.

Genesis 15:21

and the Amorites and the Canaanites and the Girgashites and the Jebu-sites.”	+כץ זאלכא +כץ זחאלאלא +כץ זחולאלא זחאלאלא +כץ
--	---

Abe drifts off to sleep inside his dream, as YHWH names all the ethnicities that he’s giving to Abe’s soon to be c[red] children. Coming soon.

End of chapter.

Genesis 16

Genesis 16:1

And Abram’s wife Sarai had not given birth by him. And she had an Egyptian maid, and her name was Hagar.

כֹּל מְאֹדָה וְהָיָה זָרָה
אֵת הָעִזְרָה מִמִּצְרַיִם
וְהָיָה שֵׁם הָעִזְרָה

Previously on, bible:

YHWH promised Abe infinite patriarchy.

This time on, bible:

Abe’s wife wasn’t even pregnant yet.

They had a maid from Egypt though.

Genesis 16:2

And Sarai said to Abram, “Here, YHWH has held me back from giving birth. Come to my maid. Maybe I’ll get ‘childed’ through her.” And Abram listened to Sarai’s voice.

וְהָיָה לִי זָרָה מִיְּמֵי
אֵת הָעִזְרָה מִמִּצְרַיִם
וְהָיָה שֵׁם הָעִזְרָה
וְהָיָה שֵׁם הָעִזְרָה
וְהָיָה שֵׁם הָעִזְרָה
וְהָיָה שֵׁם הָעִזְרָה
וְהָיָה שֵׁם הָעִזְרָה

Abe’s wife suggests he get to know the maid.

He listens.

Genesis 16:3

And Sarai, Abram’s wife, took Hagar, the Egyptian, her maid, at the end of ten years of Abram’s living in the land of Canaan, and gave her to Abram, her husband, as a wife to him.

וַתִּקַּח שָׂרַי אִשְׁתּוֹ אֶת
הָעִזְרָה מִמִּצְרַיִם
וַתִּתֵּן אֵלָיו
וַתִּשְׁכַּב אִתּוֹ
וַתִּהְיֶה הָעִזְרָה
לְאִשָּׁה
לְאַבְרָם

So Abe’s wife gives her maid to Abe, her husband, as a wife to him.

Genesis 16:4

And he came to Hagar, and she became pregnant. And she saw that she had become pregnant, and her mistress was lowered in her eyes.

ላጃተሃ ላገጃ ረፋ ፋፃረሃ
ረዋተሃ ጃተላጃ ረሃ ፋላተሃ
ጃረሃጊዐፍ ጃተላፍገ

Abe comes her, and she's pregnant.

And she saw that she was pregnant.

New wife looks down on old wife, which is mean.

Genesis 16:5

And Sarai said to Abram, “My injury is on you. I, I, placed my maid in your bosom, and she saw that she had become pregnant, and I was lowered in her eyes. Let YHWH judge between me and you.”

ሣላፍፋ ረፋ ረላሠ ላሣፋተሃ
ጊተተሃ ጊሃሃፋ ሃጊረዐ ጊቹሣይ
ጊሃ ፋላተሃ ሃዋጊይፍ ጊተይገሠ
ጃረሃጊዐፍ ረዋፋሃ ጃተላጃ
ጊሃጊፍ ጃሃጃጊ ተገሠጊ
ሃጊሃጊፍሃ

Sarai blames Abe.

Genesis 16:6

And Abram said to Sarai, “Here, your maid is in your hand. Do to her whatever is good in your eyes.” And Sarai degraded her, and she fled from her.

ጊላሠ ረፋ ሣላፍፋ ላሣፋረሃ
ጊሠዐ ሃላጊፍ ሃተይገሠ ጃሃጃ
ሃጊሃጊዐፍ ሃሃተጃ ጃረ
ይላፍተሃ ጊላሠ ጃሃዐተሃ
ጃረሃገሣ

So Abe's like “Look babe I defer to you. This was your idea, and by the way it was a really great one.

I hope you keep having more ideas like this.

No complaints from me, do whatever you want.”

So Sarai degrades new wife.

It was her idea but she's jealous now.

Now Hagar's like “Screw you guys I'm gonna go live in the woods.”

Genesis 16:7

And an angel of YHWH found her at a spring of water in the wilderness, by the spring on the way to Shur,

እሃእፖ ሃፋረኝ እፋሦኝፖሃ
ላላላኝ ምፖምእ ሃፖዐ ረዐ
ላሃ ሃላላ ሃፖዐእ ረዐ

So YHWH sends a messenger to go find Hagar.

She’s by a spring on the road to Wall.

Genesis 16:8

and said, “Hagar, Sarai’s maid, from where have you come, and where will you go?” And she said, “I’m fleeing from Sarai, my mistress.”

ፖላ ሐዘገግ ላገእ ላኝፋፖሃ
እሃፋሃ ሐፋ ሕገኝ ፖፋ
ፖላ ፖሃገኝ ላኝፋሐሃ ፖሃረሐ
ሐዘላ ፖሃፋ ፖሐላገ

The messenger, like YHWH himself, often appears to lack perfect knowledge on the position and velocity of people.

Genesis 16:9

And the angel of YHWH said to her, “Go back to your mistress, and suffer the degradation under her hands.”

ሃፋረኝ ሕረ ላኝፋፖሃ
ሃሐላገ ረፋ ፖላሃ ሕሃእፖ
እፖላፖ ሐዘሐ ፖሃዐሐእሃ

YHWH's messenger wants her to go back and keep getting degraded.

Genesis 16:10

And the angel of YHWH said, “I’ll multiply your seed, and it won’t be countable because of its great number.”

እሃእፖ ሃፋረኝ ሕረ ላኝፋፖሃ
ሃዐላገ ሐ እላላፋ እላላእ
ላላኝ ላገቹፖ ፋረሃ

So YHWH's messenger tries the “I’ll multiply your children” tactic on her.

Genesis 16:11

And the angel of YHWH said to her, “Here, you’re pregnant and will give birth to a son, and you shall call his name Ishmael, for YHWH has listened to your suffering.

እሃንገ ሃፋረኝ ሕረ ላኝፋጊሃ
 ነፍ ተላረጊሃ ሕላፍ ሃነፍ
 ረፋዐኝኝሃ ሃኝኝ ተፋላዋሃ
 ሃጊነዐ ረፋ ሕላፍ ሕኝኝ ዐኝኝ ጊሃ

YHWH's **messenger** then apparently realizes she’s a girl and that’s not the ideal sales tactic here.

So he switches to saying “You’ll have a really good son,” which is probably a better way to persuade girls than promising to spread their seed all around.

Genesis 16:12

And he’ll be a wild ass of a man, his hand against everyone, and everyone’s hand against him, and he will live in hostility toward all his brothers.”

ኝላፋ ፋላገ ሕጊፍጊ ፋሃፍሃ
 ረዐሃ ነፍ ረሃ ላጊሃ ረሃፍ ሃላጊ
 ነኝኝሃ ሃጊፍፋ ረሃ ጊነገ

The sales pitch continues, saying her son will be “A wild ass of a man.”

Not a horrible tactic. He’s improvising. Give him a break.

Then he continues, “his hand against everyone.” What?

“and everyone’s hand against him,” wait what?

“and he will live in hostility toward all his brothers.”

That’s not how you convince...

Nevermind.⁷²

Genesis 16:13

And she called the name of YHWH who spoke to her “You are El-roi,” for she said, “Have I also seen after the one who sees me here?”

ላላላፍ ሕላፍ ምኝ ፋላዋተሃ
 ጊሃ ጊፋላ ረፋ ሕተፋ ሕጊረፋ
 ጊተጊፋላ ምረፍ ምገፍ ሕላኝፋ
 ጊፋላ ጊላፍፋ

Then it says she called the name of “YHWH who spoke to her.”

So I guess we figured out who the messenger was.

⁷²YHWH’s sales pitch appears to be designed to sell this idea to YHWH.

She says “You are El-roi” which is like “The God who sees.”

Then she says a phrase that translators can’t seem to agree on the meaning of.

Here’s some of their choices:

1. I have now seen the One who sees me.
2. Have I also here seen Him who sees me?
3. Truly here I have seen him who looks after me.
4. Have I also here looked after him that seeth me?
5. Have I even remained alive here after seeing Him?
6. Here also I looked after him seeing me.
7. Verily here have I seen the hinder parts of him that seeth me.
8. Certainly, here I have seen the back of the one who sees me.
9. Haue I not also here looked after him that seeth me?
10. Haue I not also heare loked after hym that seeth mee?
11. Of a suertye I haue sene the back partes of him that sawe me.
12. I haue of a suertie sene here the backe parties of him that seith me.
13. Profecto hic vidi posteriora videntis me.

Or in other words:

1. I have seen X.
2. X sees me. Have I seen X?
3. I have seen X. And X looks after me.
4. X sees me. Have I looked after X?
5. Am I still alive after I saw X?
6. I looked after X while X was seeing me.
7. I definitely saw X’s posterior.
8. Same as above but less formal. She saw the back.
9. Same as above but from 1587.
10. Same as above but from 1568.
11. Same as above but from 1535.
12. Same as above but from 1526.

13. “Indeed, here I saw the back of the one who saw me.”⁷³

Rather than offer a preferred interpretation, we’d just like to note that the Hebrew is **יחרי**, which means “after” or “behind,” but to be fair the same term without the yodh **חרי** means “hind part,” and so it’s easy to see how that led to six hundred or so years of, well, whatever that was.

Let’s try to put all that behind us.

Moving on.

Genesis 16:14

On account of this the well was called Beer Lahai Roi. Here it is between Kadesh and Bered.

אֵלֶּיךָ אֵלֶּיךָ לְאֵלֶּיךָ לְאֵלֶּיךָ
וְאֵלֶּיךָ לְאֵלֶּיךָ לְאֵלֶּיךָ לְאֵלֶּיךָ
אֵלֶּיךָ לְאֵלֶּיךָ

That’s why it’s called Beer something something.⁷⁴

It’s between Holy and Hail.

Genesis 16:15

And Hagar gave birth to a son for Abram, and Abram called the name of his son whom Hagar had borne Ishmael.

וַתֵּלֶד הָגָר לְאַבְרָם
בֶּן וִיקָרָא אַבְרָם שֵׁם
בְּנוֹ אֲשֶׁר יָלְדָה הָגָר
יִשְׁמָעֵאל׃

So Hagar has the baby, and Abe names him “God hears.”

Which presumably means he missed a bit about the story above when she told him.

Don’t blame Abe. He was looking at the story when she told him, but there was a lot going on so he just got a little mixed up, if you hear what I mean.

Genesis 16:16

And Abram was eighty years and six years old when Hagar gave birth to Ishmael for Abram.

וְאַבְרָם בֶּן שְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה
וְשֵׁשׁ שָׁנִים בְּלָדָת הָגָר
אֶת יִשְׁמָעֵאל לְאַבְרָם׃

⁷³We’ve now arrived at the version of the verse from the first book ever printed, the Gutenberg Bible, from around 1454 or 1455. I think that means we can be done with this verse.

⁷⁴Lahai means “living” and Roi means “seeing” or “vision.”

Like c'mon, he's eighty.⁷⁵ He's doing his best.

Ok that's all for this chapter.

Let's go hear what happens next.

⁷⁵And six.

Genesis 17

Genesis 17:1

And Abram was ninety years and nine years old, and YHWH appeared to Abram and said to him, “I am El Shadday. Walk before me and be unblemished,

וַיְהִי אֲבָרָם בֶּן תִּשְׁעִים
שָׁנָה וְתִשְׁעַ שָׁנִים וַיֵּרָא
יְהוָה אֶל אֲבָרָם וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלַי אֲנִי אֵל שַׁדַּי
הִתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵי וְהָיָה
תָּמִים:

Cut to thirteen years later.

Abe is older now.

Ninety nine years old, in fact.

All of a sudden, possibly for the first time in thirteen years...

A familiar voice is heard.

No mistaking that voice. It’s YHWH, and he says:

“I am El Shadday.”⁷⁶

Genesis 17:2

and let me place my covenant between me and you, and I’ll make you very, very numerous.”

וְאֶתְנָה בְּרִיתִי בֵּינִי
וּבֵינְךָ וְאָרְבָּה אוֹתְךָ
בְּמֵאד מְאֹד:

“And let’s make a covenant, just you and me.

And I’ll give you lots and lots of kids.”

Genesis 17:3

And Abram fell on his face, and God spoke with him, saying,

וַיִּפֹּל אֲבָרָם עַל פָּנָיו
וַיְדַבֵּר אֵתוֹ אֱלֹהִים
לֵאמֹר:

Abe falls on his face.

⁷⁶El Shadday. Probably “El, the One of the Mountain.” The traditional “God Almighty” is linguistically hard to justify. Compare the Akkadian šadu rabu (“great mountains”) and the šdyn of the Deir ’Alla inscription. Another proposal derives Shadday from Hebrew šadayim (“breasts”), suggesting an association of YHWH with fertility.

YHWH keeps talking, and he says:

Genesis 17:4

“I: here, my covenant is with you, and you’ll become a father of a mass of nations.

אֲנִי הֵנָּה בְּרִיתִי אִתְּךָ
וְהָיִיתָ לְאָב הַמֶּוֹן גּוֹיִם:

“I: here, my deal with you, you’re gonna be huge, father of nations a whole mass of them.”

(Begin Midrash)

Then Abe’s like:

“You know we’ve met before right?”

“It’s me, Abe.”

“You promised sort of the same thing a while back.”

“Lots of kids, the whole thing.”

YHWH: Did I keep my promise?

Abe: I’m not going to say no. But also not y—

YHWH: Great! How are the kids doing?

Abe: Kid, singular. I have one.

YHWH: Well that’s a start! How’d I give you that one?

Abe: You didn’t. My wife suggested I get the maid pregnant, then she got mad at me for doing it. Then the maid ran away, but she came back eventually.

YHWH: Right! That was me. I made her come back. I said “Go back to... What was your name again?”

Abe: It’s Abe.

YHWH: What kind of name is that?

Abe: It’s short for Abram.

YHWH: Ha! That’s even worse. You’re funny Abe. I know exactly what you need, my guy.

(End Midrash.)

Genesis 17:5

And your name will not be called Abram anymore, but your name will be Abraham, because I've set you to be a father of a mass of nations.

וְלֹא יִקְרָא עוֹד אֶת שְׁמִי אֲבְרָם וְהָיָה שְׁמִי אֲבְרָהָם כִּי אֲב הַמּוֹן גּוֹיִם נִתְּתִיךָ׃

So YHWH adds a “ha” to his name.

It's not clear if they've talked these past thirteen years.

Genesis 17:6

And I'll make you very, very fruitful and make you into nations. And kings will come out of you.

וְהִפְרֵתִי אֹתְךָ בְּמֵאֹד מְאֹד וְנִתְּתִיךָ לְגוֹיִם וּמְלָכִים מִמֶּךָ יֵצְאוּ׃

YHWH continues,

Spread your c hildren b— Abe, I'll spread it everywhere.

I'm gonna make you into a nation.

Nations, plural Abe. No more singular Abe.

Many many nations.

Lots of em, each with its own king.

Kings are com— coming out of you Abe.

Genesis 17:7

And I'll establish my covenant between me and you and your seed after you for their generations as an eternal covenant, to become God to you and to your seed after you.

וְהִקְמַתִּי אֶת בְּרִיתִי בֵּינִי וּבֵינְךָ וּבֵין זַרְעֲךָ אַחֲרֶיךָ לְדֹרֹתָם לְבְרִית עוֹלָם לְהִיּוֹת לִּי לֵאלֹהִים וּלְזַרְעֲךָ אַחֲרֶיךָ׃

And let's make a deal, just you and me Abe, a deal between me and you and your c hildren after forever and ever a hundred years, a hundred gen— generations Abe an eternal covenant, that's the deal Abe we're making a deal and it's gonna last forever, just YHWH and Abe forever and ever

YHWH and Abe, with you and your c hildren babe, just YHWH and Abe.

Genesis 17:8

And I'll give you and your seed after you the land where you're residing, all the land of Canaan, as an eternal possession, and I'll become a God to them."

וְנָתַתִּי לָךְ וּלְזַרְעֲךָ
אֶתְּחִידָה אֶת אֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם
אֶת כָּל אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן
לְאֶחְזֶזֶת עוֹלָם וְהִיִּיתִי
לָהֶם לֵאלֹהִים:

And I'll give you and your c hildren a lot a land, this land right here where you live already, and all the land I can and that's all the land, cuz I can, and anything I can do I'll do for you Abe, it's yours, as an eternal possession, forever and ever, and I'll be a God to you and your kids Abe, God it's gonna be good.⁷⁷

Genesis 17:9

And God said to Abraham, "And you: you shall observe my covenant, you and your seed after you through their generations.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים
אֶל אַבְרָהָם וְאֵתָה
אֶת בְּרִיתִי תִשְׁמֹר
אֶתָה וְזַרְעֲךָ אֶתְחִידָה
לְדֹרֹתָם:

"And you, you... you do the deal. Do your side of the deal Abe. You and you c hildren after you through all their generations."

At this point I imagine Abe asks what the deal is.

Then YHWH continues in the coming verse, saying:

Genesis 17:10

This is my covenant that you shall observe between me and you and your seed after you: every male is to be circumcised among you.

זֹאת בְּרִיתִי אֲשֶׁר
תִּשְׁמְרוּ בֵּינִי וּבֵינֵיכֶם
וּבֵין זַרְעֲךָ אֶתְחִידָה
הַמּוֹל לָכֶם כָּל זָכָר:

⁷⁷According to a prominent Midrash, YHWH dozes off here before waking up mid-sentence at a later point in the same speech.

“Here’s the deal bene— w— bene— come— w— bn—⁷⁸

Here’s the deal b— Abe between me and you and your c^hildren, the c^hildren who come after you, get it?

First the father comes, here to earth, and that’s you.

You’re the father Abe the father of nations.

First you come to earth and then you come and then the sons come to earth later after you.

That’s called the second coming Abe, that’s why we say it’s the son, the son is the second coming.

The sons come to earth and then they come and then their sons come too, and that’s why it’s called grand. Ain’t it grand Abe?”

At this point I imagine Abe reminds YHWH that he still hasn’t said what the deal is.

So YHWH continues:

Cut your d^ownstairs off Abe don’t panic just the top.

The tip at the top of your p^aternity Abe that’s the deal that’s all I want.

Spread that seed Abe we’re gonna spread it open it up pop that cork.

Pop the top of that p^atriarchy cuz once you pop the fun won’t stop.

Let it all out Abe, you’re my main man and I don’t want you holding anything back.

Don’t keep it all inside Abe just clip the tip and don’t be mad I’m being nice here not mean, cuz mean is the p^ride and joy staying all wrapped up inside, so come outside Abe, come outside and look at the stars, see those stars? That’s how I want you to be Abe just like that, if you’re closed off it doesn’t count, and I’m counting on you Abe so let’s do a number on that p^aternity, and the meaning of paternity is children, and the meaning of children is so you can make a number no one can count.

Abe just stands there for a while trying to understand what the deal is.

I assume after this he asks YHWH if he wouldn’t mind repeating the terms of the deal.

Then YHWH continues.

⁷⁸Lit. בְּיָנִי וּבְיָנִי וּבְיָנִי וּבְיָנִי in the original text.

Genesis 17:11

And you shall be circumcised at the flesh of your foreskin, and it will become a sign of a covenant between me and you.

וְנִמְלֹתֶם אֶת בְּשָׁר
עֲרֹלְתְּכֶם וְהָיָה לְאוֹת
בְּרִית בֵּינִי וּבֵינֵיכֶם:

YHWH clarifies that he meant circumcision.

That’s the deal.

Covenant (noun).

A binding agreement or solemn promise that establishes an enduring relationship and mutual obligations. In law, it is an enforceable agreement; in the Bible, a sacred partnership between god and the people; and in personal relationships, a lifelong pledge of faithful commitment, as in marriage.

From Old French *covenant* (“agreement”), ultimately from Latin *convenīre* (“to come together”), from *com-* (“together”) + *venīre* (“to come”): literally, “a coming together agreement.”

Genesis 17:12

And at eight days old every male shall be circumcised among you through your generations: homeborn or purchased with money from any foreigner who is not from your seed.

וּבֶן שְׁמֹנֶת יָמִים
יִמּוֹל לָכֶם כָּל זָכָר
לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם יֶלֶד בַּיִת
וּמִקְנָת כֶּסֶף מְכֹל בֶּן
נָכָר אֲשֶׁר לֹא מִזֶּרְעִי
הוּא:

“It took seven days to create the universe Abe, so get some rest on day seven, then on the eighth day we take it off, we’re taking it off Abe so take off day seven cuz we’re taking it off on day eight.”

Abe asks exactly who is supposed to do this. YHWH continues.

“Anyone you make or buy Abe. Anyone who comes out of your pants or comes out of your wallet, cuz those are both in the pants Abe, that’s the deal for all the pants people.

For their name will not be called Pants anymore, but their name will be Parents, because I’ve set you to be a father of a mass of nations.”

Genesis 17:13

Your homeborn and the one purchased with your money will be circumcised. And my covenant will become an eternal covenant in your flesh.

הַמּוֹלַת יְמוּל יֶלֶד בֵּיתְךָ
וּמִקְנֶת כֶּסֶף וְהִיתָה
בְּרִיתִי בְּבָשָׂרְכֶם
לְבְרִית עוֹלָם:

The people you make with your Pants Parts and the people you Purchase as Property, the PP b— Abe, baby, for the babies, that’s the deal.

Genesis 17:14

And an uncircumcised—a male the flesh of whose foreskin will not be circumcised—that person will be cut off from his people. He has broken my covenant.”

וְעָרַל זָכָר אֲשֶׁר לֹא
יְמוּל אֶת בָּשָׁר עָרְלָתוֹ
וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא
מֵעַמִּי אֶת בְּרִיתִי
הַכָּבֵד:

And if you don’t cut off the p[er]sonality then we cut you off. From the people. We cut the covenant and now you cut the p[er]sonality off or we cut you off, from the patriarchy Abe. Don’t break the covenant Abe, covenant means coming together, and if you break the coming together then we’re just coming apart Abe. Don’t do that to me. This is my promise to you.

To you and your wife too. So go tell her. Say “Hey...”

(Begin Midrash)

What was your wife’s name again?

Abe: Sarai.

YHWH: What kind of a name is that?

Abe: It’s Northwest Semitic, we’re from Ur—

YHWH: Ur not making any sense Abe. Here come here. We’ll fix that right up.

(End Midrash)

Genesis 17:15

And God said to Abraham,
“Sarai, your wife: you shall not
call her name Sarai, because
her name is Sarah.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל
אַבְרָהָם שָׂרִי אִשְׁתְּךָ
לֹא תִקְרָא אֶת שְׁמָהּ
שָׂרִי כִי שָׂרָה שְׁמָהּ׃

So YHWH says “Sarai, your wife: you shall not call her name Sarai, be-
cause her name is Sarah.

Genesis 17:16

And I’ll bless her, and I’ll also
give you a son from her. And
I’ll bless her, and she’ll become
nations. Kings of peoples will
be from her.”

וַיְבָרֶכְתִּי אֹתָהּ וְגַם נָתַתִּי
מִמֶּנָּה לְךָ בֵּן וַיְבָרֶכְתִּיהָ
וְהָיְתָה לְגוֹיִם מְלֻכֵּי
עַמִּים מִמֶּנָּה יִהְיוּ׃

YHWH does the whole spiel again.

Genesis 17:17

And Abraham fell on his face
and laughed and said in his
heart, “Will he be born to
someone who’s a hundred years
old?! And will Sarah, who’s
ninety years old, give birth?!”

וַיִּפֹּל אַבְרָהָם עַל פָּנָיו
וַיִּצְחָק וַיֹּאמֶר בְּלִבּוֹ
הֲלֵבֶן מֵאָה שָׁנָה יוֹלֵד
וְאִם שָׂרָה הִבֵּת תִּשְׁעִים
שָׁנָה תֵּלֵד׃

Abe falls on his face laughing.⁷⁹

Abe reminds YHWH that he was already 75 when they met, and that was
a while ago.⁸⁰

Basically his hundredth birthday is coming up.

⁷⁹Apparently, for some reason, Abra(ha)m thinks YHWH is funny.

⁸⁰According to the text, Abram was 75 years old when YHWH first speaks to him. Then they hung out for 11 years. Then YHWH went away for 13 years. Then he showed up again, introducing himself under a different name. Then he renames Abe. And his wife, who’s also old. Hence the laughter.

Genesis 17:18

And Abraham said to God, “If only Ishmael will live before you.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָהָם אֶל
הָאֱלֹהִים לוֹ יִשְׁמַעֵאל
יְחִיָּה לִפְנֶיךָ׃

Abe already has a 13 year old son.

This line is presumably him saying he’s fine with Ishmael being his successor.

Or in other words, “No thanks YHWH, I’m good.”

Genesis 17:19

And God said, “But Sarah, your wife, is giving birth to a son for you. And you shall call his name Isaac. And I’ll establish my covenant with him as an eternal covenant for his seed after him.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֲבֹל
שָׂרָה אִשְׁתְּךָ יֹלֶדֶת
לָךְ בֶּן וְקָרָאתָ אֶת
שְׁמוֹ יִצְחָק וַהֲקִמְתִּי
אֶת בְּרִיתִי אִתּוֹ לְבְרִית
עוֹלָם לְזֶרְעוֹ אַחֲרָיו׃

He continues “But Sarah, your wife, is giving birth to a son for you.”

Abe’s just there listening.

He continues “And you shall name him Laughter.”

Abe keeps listening.

He continues:

And I’ll make him a deal too forever and ever with him and his c children after him.

Genesis 17:20

And I’ve listened to you about Ishmael. Here, I’ve blessed him, and I’ll make him fruitful and make him very, very numerous. He’ll father twelve chieftains, and I’ll make him into a big nation.

וְלִישְׁמַעֵאל שָׁמַעְתִּיךָ
הִנֵּה בֵּרַכְתִּי אֹתוֹ
וְהַפְרִיתִי אֹתוֹ וְהִרְבִּיתִי
אֹתוֹ בְּמֵאד מְאֹד שְׁנַיִם
עָשָׂר נְשִׂאָם יוֹלִיד
וְנִתְּתִיו לְגוֹי גָּדוֹל׃

“But I hear what you’re saying about Ishmael,” YHWH continues.

“Get it? Ishmael. It means God hears. Who’s funny now?”

Abe is listening.

YHWH continues:

“God bless Laughter. I’ve blessed La— Wait no Ishmael. Sorry back up.

I hear what you’re saying about Ishmael.

I... Here, I’m God, and God bless Hearing, ya hear?”

Abe keeps listening, in a respectful sort of silence.

“Wow tough audience.

I’ll do all the stuff to him too, with the numerous and the nations he’ll be the dad of twelve chieftains.”

Genesis 17:21

But I’ll establish my covenant with Isaac, whom Sarah will bear for you at this appointed time in the next year.”

וְאֵת בְּרִיתִי אֶקִים אֶת
יִצְחָק אֲשֶׁר תֵּלֵד לְךָ
שָׂרָה לַמּוֹעֵד הַזֶּה
בַּשָּׁנָה הָאַחֶרֶת:

But me and Laughter will make a deal too, Sarah’s— I know she’s old but bear with me honey— she’s gonna bear him for you at this time next year.

Genesis 17:22

And He finished speaking with him, and God went up from Abraham.

וַיֵּכֵל לְדַבֵּר אֹתוֹ וַיַּעַל
אֱלֹהִים מֵעַל אַבְרָהָם:

God wraps up and leaves.

Genesis 17:23

And Abraham took Ishmael, his son, and all his homeborn and everyone purchased with his money, every male among the men of Abraham's house, and he circumcised the flesh of their foreskin in that very day, as God had spoken with him.

וַיִּקַּח אַבְרָהָם אֶת
יִשְׁמָעֵאל בְּנוֹ וְאֵת כָּל
יְלִידֵי בֵיתוֹ וְאֵת כָּל
מִקְנֵת כֶּסֶפוֹ כָּל זָכָר
בְּאֲנָשֵׁי בֵית אַבְרָהָם
וַיַּמַּל אֶת בְּשָׁר עֲרֻלָּתָם
בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה כְּאֲשֶׁר
דִּבֶּר אֱתוֹ אֱלֹהִים׃

So Abe takes:

1. Ishmael⁸¹
2. his son⁸²
3. all the people who had been born in his house⁸³
4. everyone he purchased with money
5. every male among the men of Abraham's house

He cuts a bit of⁸⁴ a covenant with them too.

Genesis 17:24

And Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he was circumcised, the flesh of his foreskin,

וְאַבְרָהָם בֶּן תִּשְׁעִים
וְתֵשַׁע שָׁנָה בְּהִמְלֹו
בְּשָׁר עֲרֻלָּתוֹ׃

We've sort of covered this already.

The author reminds us where circumcisions happen.

Genesis 17:25

and Ishmael, his son, was thirteen years old when he was circumcised at the flesh of his foreskin.

וַיִּשְׁמָעֵאל בְּנוֹ בֶּן שְׁלֹשׁ
עָשָׂרָה שָׁנָה בְּהִמְלֹו אֶת
בְּשָׁר עֲרֻלָּתוֹ׃

We've been over this too. It's been thirteen years since the previous chapter.

⁸¹His only son, at the moment.

⁸²Ibid.

⁸³Abe has lots of servants and stuff. They're having kids, apparently.

⁸⁴Lit. "off" in the original text.

Genesis 18

Genesis 18:1

And YHWH appeared to him at
the oaks of Mamre. And he was
sitting at the tent entrance in the
heat of the day,

እሃንኒ ሃጊረፋ ፋላጊሃ
ፋሃንሃ ፋላግግ ጊሃረፋፍ
ግዘሃ ረእፋእ ዘተገ ልሠጊ
ግሃጊእ

Ok so YHWH appears to him⁸⁵ near some trees. You know the ones.

Abe’s sitting in the door of his tent. It’s hot.

Genesis 18:2

and he raised his eyes and saw,
and here were three people
standing over him. And he saw
and ran toward them from the tent
entrance and bowed to the
ground.

ፋላጊሃ ሃጊሃጊዐ ፋሠጊሃ
ግጊሠሃፋ ጓሠረሠ ጓሃንሃ
ፋላጊሃ ሃጊረዐ ግጊልሶሃ
ዘተገግ ግተፋላቀረ ሶላጊሃ
ጓሶላፋ ሃዘተሠጊሃ ረእፋእ

Abe looks up and there are three people standing over him.

He runs over and bows.

Genesis 18:3

And he said, “My Lord, if I’ve
found favor in your eyes don’t pass
on from your servant.

ፋሃ ግፋ ጊሃላፋ ላግፋጊሃ
ረፋ ሃጊሃጊዐፍ ሃዘ ጊተፋሶግ
ሃላፍዐ ረዐግ ላፍዐተ ፋሃ

And Abe says “My Lord, don’t leave me.”

Then uses singular grammar for the three people. Several times.

Hebrew	Meaning	Actual	Expected Plural
אדני	my lord / my lords / Lord	Ambiguous	—
בעיניך	in your eyes	Singular	בעיניכם
תעבר	you pass	Singular	תעברו
עבדך	your servant	Singular	עבדכם

⁸⁵Presumably Abraham. YHWH seems mostly focused on Abe these days.

Genesis 18:4

Let a little water be gotten, and wash your feet and relax under a tree,

ሃገሃ ተባላ ላላ ስብረ
ሃሃገረገላ ሃሃዘላሃ
ሃባላ ተዘተ ሃሃዐሃላሃ

Abe then says to YHWH:

- 1. Let me get you some water.
- 2. Wash your feet.⁸⁶
- 3. Rest under a tree.⁸⁷

A strange thing to say to a divine being, but what do I know.

Genesis 18:5

and let me get a bit of bread, and satisfy your heart. Afterward you’ll pass on, for that’s why you’ve passed by your servant.” And they said, “Do that, as you’ve spoken.”

ሃላዐቹሃ ሃዘረ ተገ ላዘቀላሃ
ረዐገሃላላዐተ ላዘቀ ሃሃላረ
ሃሃላዐ ረዐ ሃተላዐ ሃሃ
ላሃዐተ ሃሃ ሃላሃላረሃ
ተላላላ ላሃላሃ

Abe then says to YHWH:

- 1. Let me get you some bread.
- 2. To satisfy your heart.⁸⁸
- 3. Then you’ll leave.
- 4. Because that’s why you’re here.⁸⁹

And *they* say, yeah,

“Do that. What you said.”

⁸⁶As we learned from J in Genesis 3:8, YHWH has feet. Now we learn that YHWH’s feet could use a wash.
⁸⁷As we learned from P in Genesis 2:2-3, YHWH sometimes rests. Now we learn that YHWH might benefit from resting under a tree, presumably to avoid the sun.
⁸⁸As we learned from Genesis 6:6, YHWH has a heart, and can be grieved to it. Now we learn that YHWH’s heart can also be satisfied, and that bread works.
⁸⁹YHWH came for bread. Not according to me. According to Abe.

Genesis 18:6

And Abraham hurried to the tent, to Sarah, and said, “Hurry, three measures of fine flour. Knead it and make cakes.”

እረጃፋን ሥጋጋፋ ላገሥረሃ
 ጊገገ ላሥፋረሃ ጸላሠ ረፋ
 ተረቹ ዘሥዋ ሥፈፋቹ ሠረሠ
 ተሃገዐ ፈሠዐሃ ፈሠሃረ

So Abe (now with a different name) runs to his wife (now with a different name) and goes:

“Hurry!”

He has her make cake.

I guess that’s the bread YHWH came for.

Genesis 18:7

And Abraham ran to the herd and took a calf, tender and good, and he gave it to a servant, and he hurried to prepare it.

ሥጋጋፋ ሥላ ላዋጸጸ ረፋሃ
 ሓሃፀሃ ሥላ ላዋጸ ሃጸ ዘዋረሃ
 ላገሥረሃ ላዐሃጸ ረፋ ሃተረሃ
 ሃተፋ ተሃሠዐረ

Abe goes and gets a cow. One of the good ones. They have guests.

He gives it to one of his guys to cook.

Genesis 18:8

And he took curds and milk and the calf that he had prepared and placed them in front of them, and he was standing over them under the tree, and they ate.

ኃረዘሃ ጸፋሥዘ ዘዋረሃ
 ጸሠዐ ላሠፋ ላዋጸጸ ሃጸሃ
 ፋሃጸሃ ሥጸረሃገረ ሃተረሃ
 ሥዐጸ ተዘተ ሥጸረረዐ ላሥዐ
 ሃረጸፋረሃ

Abe gives YHWH some cottage cheese and beef.

And the other two guys too.

Or the three people.

Whoever it was.

The text now notes that Abe is standing OVER them.

UNDER the tree.

And they ate.

You’ve gotta love this book.

Genesis 18:9

And they said to him, “Where is Sarah, your wife?” And he said, “Here in the tent.”

እገሩ ሃገረሩ ሃላጃቸውን
እንክ ላጃቸውን ሃተሠሩ እላሠ
ረእፋፍ

As in Genesis 3:9, and 4:9, and 16:8, YHWH often wants to know where people are.

Abe says “She’s right here.”

Genesis 18:10

And He said, “I shall come back to you at the time of life, and, here, Sarah, your wife, will have a son.” And Sarah was listening at the tent entrance, which was behind him.

ናሃሠሩ ናሃሠ ላጃቸውን
እንክሃ እገዘ ተዐሃ ሃገረሩ
እላሠሃ ሃተሠሩ እላሠረ ነፍ
ፋሃክሃ ረእፋእዘተገ ተዐሃሠ
ሃገላዘፋ

YHWH says:

I’ll be back at the time of life.

And here Sarah, your wife.

She’ll have a son.

Sarah’s listening.

She’s behind YHWH.

Genesis 18:11

And Abraham and Sarah were old, well along in days; Sarah had stopped having the way of women.

ሃገንዋጊ እላሠሃ ሃእላፍፋሃ
ረላዘ ሃገሃገገፍ ሃገፋፍ
ዘላፋ እላሠረ ተሃገኃረ
ሃገሠነሃ

It then reminds us how old they are again.

Sarah has stopped doing that girl thing.⁹⁰

90.

Genesis 18:12

And Sarah laughed inside her and said, “After I’ve become worn out am I to have pleasure?! And my lord is old!”

אִשָּׁה אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה פֶּתַח
זָלָה זָקֵנָה אֶתְּנָה
זָקֵנָה אֶתְּנָה זָלָה אֶתְּנָה
זָלָה

Sarah laughs inside her mind.

Because y’know, she’s like a hundred.

Genesis 18:13

And YHWH said to Abraham, “Why is this? Sarah laughed, saying, ‘Shall I indeed give birth? And I am old!’ Is anything too wondrous for YHWH?”

לָּא אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה
אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה
אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה
זָלָה זָקֵנָה זָקֵנָה

So YHWH’s like “Why’s Sarah laughing?”

“You saying I can’t make her pregnant?”

Genesis 18:14

At the appointed time I’ll come back to you, at the time of life, and Sarah will have a son.”

הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה אֶתְּנָה
לְמוֹעֵד אֶתְּנָה
כֵּן חַיָּה וְלִשְׂרָה בֵּן:

I’ll come back at the appointed time.⁹¹

At life time.⁹²

And Sarah will have a son.

Genesis 18:15

And Sarah lied, saying, “I didn’t laugh,” because she was afraid. And He said, “No, but you did laugh.”

אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה
אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה
אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה אֶתְּנָה

So Sarah’s like “I didn’t laugh.”

The text notes that the lies because she’s afraid of YHWH.

⁹¹When?

⁹²Thanks, got it.

And YHWH’s like “Yes you did.”

Genesis 18:16

And the people got up from there
and gazed at the sight of Sodom,
and Abraham was going with
them to send them off.

ሃገራቸውን ከዚያም ሲነሱ
ከየሳውዲያን ሲመለከቱ
ከሳውዲያን ሲመለከቱ
ከሳውዲያን ሲመለከቱ

Anyways the people⁹³ get up and go look at Sodom off in the distance.
Abe’s like “Well I don’t want to delay you any further, you’ve been so kind
for staying so long anyways the exit’s that way don’t forget the leftover
cottage cheese and cow.”

Genesis 18:17

And YHWH had said, “Shall I
conceal what I’m doing from
Abraham,

እኔም እንደሆነው ሳይሆን
እኔም ሳይሆን ሳይሆን
እኔም ሳይሆን ሳይሆን

And YHWH had⁹⁴ said⁹⁵
“Should I lie to Abe about what I’m up to?”

Genesis 18:18

since Abraham will become a big
and powerful nation, and all the
nations of the earth will be
blessed through him?

እኔም እንደሆነው ሳይሆን
እኔም ሳይሆን ሳይሆን
እኔም ሳይሆን ሳይሆን

“After all,” continues YHWH talking to some undefined entity,
“he’s gonna be big and powerful one day, and bless all the nations.”

Genesis 18:19

⁹³I give up.
⁹⁴This is that “noun before verb” grammar again. The one from Genesis 4:1 that means
“had verbed.” Like in the past, before this part of the story. So this sentence is like a
flashback I guess.
⁹⁵To who?

For I've chosen him so that he'll
command his children and his
household after him, and they'll
keep YHWH's way by practicing
righteousness and justice, so that
YHWH will fulfill what He
promised Abraham.

אֲנִי בָחַרְתִּי אֹתוֹ כִּי יְצַו
אֶת בָּנָיו וְאֶת
בֵּיתוֹ אַחֲרָיו וְהָיוּ
שֹׂמְרֵי דֶרֶךְ
יְהוָה וְעָשׂוּ צְדָקָה
וּמִשְׁפָּט כִּי כֵן
אָמַר יְהוָה אֲבִרָם
וְהָיוּ כִּי יִשְׁמַר
אֶת דֶּרֶךְ יְהוָה וְעָשׂוּ
צְדָקָה וּמִשְׁפָּט

Ok strap in folks, this one's a doozy.

YHWH says:

I've chosen him
so that
he'll command his children
and his household after him,
and they'll keep YHWH's way
by practicing righteousness and justice,
so that
YHWH will fulfill what He promised Abraham.

Ok so as far as I can tell, the two “so that” clauses are parallel, not nested.

So it's not

I've chosen him
so that
he'll do X
so that
I (YHWH) will do Y.

Rather, it's

I've chosen him
so that
he'll do X
so that
I (YHWH) will do Y.

Why?

I'm not gonna explain. But there's reasons. Let's keep moving.

Biblical Hebrew commonly repeats לְמַעַן to introduce multiple parallel purpose clauses. Here, the second לְמַעַן appears to return to the main verb יִשְׁמַר rather than depending on the first לְמַעַן, making the two purposes grammatically parallel.

Thanks.

No problem.

Ok so...

“I’ve chosen him” here presumably means “chosen for the covenant.”

That is, “I’ve chosen him so that” means “I’ve made a promise to him so that”...

In which case, it’s this:

I’ve made a promise to A

so that

A will do stuff I want

(and also)

so that

I (YHWH) will keep my promise to A.

So basically the point of all that is that YHWH chose Abe.

So that:

- (1) Abe would do stuff, and
- (2) YHWH would keep his promise to Abe.

What?

Let’s just focus on item (2) in case that seemed clear.

Ok so...

YHWH made a promise to Abe.

So that YHWH would keep his promise to Abe.⁹⁶

I think that’s what he just said.

But don’t quote me on that.

Genesis 18:20

And YHWH said, “The cry of Sodom and Gomorrah: how great it is. And their sin: how very heavy it is.

ⲧⲫⲟⲗ ⲉⲩⲁⲓⲁⲓ ⲁⲩⲕⲓⲗⲩ
ⲉⲩⲁⲩ ⲗⲩ ⲉⲩⲁⲩⲟⲩ ⲩⲁⲩ
ⲁⲕⲩ ⲉⲩⲁⲩⲩⲗⲩ ⲩⲧⲕⲟⲩⲩⲩ

Ok so YHWH mentions that Sodom and Gomorrah are:

1. Sinning.
2. Crying.

⁹⁶And the other reason from (2), omitted this time for, um, clarity.

It doesn't say why they're crying.

We'll see why in a bit.

Genesis 18:21

Let me go down, and I'll see if they've done, all told, like the cry that has come to me. And if not, let me know."

אֶתְּהַלֵּךְ כִּי אֶתְהַלֵּךְ
זֶלֶךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ
כִּי אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ
אֶתְהַלֵּךְ

I think what he's saying here is:

"I'll go down and see if it's really as bad as I've heard. If not, I'll find out."

The "let me know" in the translation is more like "let it be the case that I know."

The Hebrew אֶתְּהַלֵּךְ is a first-person cohortative, a verbal form often expressing resolve, intention, or desire. Here it means something like "I'll know," "I'll find out," or "let me find out," not the modern English sense of the idiom "let me know."

Point being: I don't think he's asking himself to tell himself what happened.

Then again, there's sort of three YHWHs in this scene.

So don't quote me on that.

Genesis 18:22

And the people turned from there and went to Sodom. And Abraham was still standing before YHWH,

אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ
אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ
אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ אֶתְהַלֵּךְ

Damn, just when I thought we knew what was going on here.

Anyways the "three people" from 18:2 are now "two people and YHWH."

Many⁹⁷ scholars explain this by saying that angels are a "hypostasis."⁹⁸

Nevertheless, I think it's pretty indisputable that the author⁹⁹ is up to something.

⁹⁷"Many" as in "three," in the sense of the current chapter.

⁹⁸Like watching TV. You saw the football game, but also not. It makes sense but I'll spare you. The football game is God.

⁹⁹J, the GOAT.

Genesis 18:23

and Abraham came over and said,
“Will you also annihilate the
virtuous with the wicked?

የሃዳዲህ ሃይላዳዳ ሠገደህ
ሃዐ ዋደላሾ ላገቹተ ገዳጅ
ዐሠላ

Though it hasn’t exactly been established yet that “annihilation” is
YHWH’s intention here,

Abe has known YHWH for like 24 years at this point.

So I guess he knows him well enough to infer.

Genesis 18:24

Maybe there are fifty virtuous
people within the city. Will you
also annihilate and not sustain the
place for the fifty virtuous who
are in it?

ሃገሠሃይ ሠገ ገረሃዳ
ላገዐጃ ሃሃተጋ ሃዋደላሾ
ዳሠተ ዳረሃ ላገቹተ ገዳጅ
ሃገሠሃይ ሃዐሃረ ሃሃዋሃረ
ላጋላዋጋ ላሠዳ ሃዋደላሾጃ

Abe’s like “What if there’s fifty good people?”

Genesis 18:25

Far be it from you to do a thing
like this, to kill virtuous with
wicked—and it will be the same
for the virtuous and the
wicked—far be it from you. Will
the judge of all the earth not do
justice?”

ላጋላሃ ተሠዐሃ ሃረ ላረረይ
ዋደላሾ ተገሃጃረ ላገጃ
ዋደላሾሃ ላገጃሃ ዐሠላ ሃዐ
ረሃ ተገሠጃ ሃረ ላረረይ ዐሠላሃ
ተገሠሃ ላሠዐገ ዳረ ሾላዳጃ

“You wouldn’t kill FIFTY people just for being nearby, would you?”

Genesis 18:26

And YHWH said, “If I find in
Sodom fifty virtuous people
within the city, then I’ll sustain the
whole place for their sake.”

ሃዳ ላሃጃገ ላሃዳዲህ
ሃገሠሃይ ሃላቹጋ ዳሾሃዳ
ላገዐጃ ሃሃተጋ ሃዋደላሾ
ሃሃዋሃጃ ረሃረ ገተዳሠሃሃ
ሃላሃጋዐጋ

And YHWH does some quick math in his head and goes “No. I wouldn’t
do that.”

Genesis 18:27

And Abraham answered, and he said, “Here I’ve undertaken to speak to my Lord, and I’m dust and ashes.

ላሣቅጊህ ሃልላቅ ሃዐጊህ
ላልሊ ጊተረቅሃል ቅሃ ላሃል
ላገዐ ጊሃሃቅህ ጊሃላቅ ረቅ
ላገቅህ

Abe says a thing about being dust and ashes.

On with the scene.

Genesis 18:28

Maybe the fifty virtuous people will be short by five. Will you destroy the whole city for the five?” And He said, “I won’t destroy if I find forty-five there.”

ሃጊሠሃይ ሃሃላቹይጊ ጊረሃቅ
ላሠሃይ ሃዋጊላሾል
ተቅ ላሠሃይፍ ተጊይሠተል
ቅረ ላሣቅጊህ ላጊዐል ረሃ
ሃሠ ቅሾሃቅ ሃቅ ተጊይሠቅ
ላሠሃይህ ሃጊዐፍላቅ

Abe doesn’t say “forty five” here.

He does a “dollar ninety-nine” sort of thing.¹⁰⁰

YHWH says “No, I won’t kill everybody if there’s forty-five good ones.”

Note: YHWH’s answer dispenses with Abe’s marketing speak.

Genesis 18:29

And he went on again to speak to Him and said, “Maybe forty will be found there.” And He said, “I won’t do it for the sake of the forty.”

ሃጊረቅ ላልሊ ላሃዐ ገቹጊህ
ሃሃቅሾሃጊ ጊረሃቅ ላሣቅጊህ
ላሣቅጊህ ሃጊዐፍላቅ ሃሠ
ላሃፍዐፍ ላሠዐቅ ቅረ
ሃጊዐፍላቅል

Abe’s like “Ok forty.”

YHWH’s like “No Abe, I won’t kill everybody if there’s forty good ones.”

Genesis 18:30

¹⁰⁰In reverse.

And he said, “May my Lord not be angry, and let me speak. Maybe thirty will be found there.” And He said, “I won’t do it if I find thirty there.”

אֵת כִּי לֹא אֶחָד
זָלַק אֲנִי וְאֶת
שְׁנֵי זֵמְרֵי
שְׁנֵי אֲנִי וְאֶת
שְׁנֵי אֲנִי וְאֶת
שְׁנֵי אֲנִי וְאֶת

So Abe’s like “Don’t get mad. Let me talk.”

“...Thirty?”

YHWH’s like “No Abe, I won’t kill everybody if there’s thirty.”

Genesis 18:31

And he said, “Here I’ve undertaken to speak to my Lord. Maybe twenty will be found there.” And He said, “I won’t destroy for the sake of the twenty.”

כִּי אֵת אֶחָד
לֹא אֲנִי וְאֶת
שְׁנֵי זֵמְרֵי זָלַק
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי

So Abe’s like “Look, please, I got up the courage to talk to you.”

“Twenty?”

YHWH’s like “No Abe, not for twenty.”

Side Note: Haven’t mentioned this yet, but Abe’s nephew lot is down there in Sodom.

Abe doesn’t mention that.

He’s just sort of asking abstractly.

Genesis 18:32

And he said, “May my Lord not be angry, and let me speak just this one time. Maybe ten will be found there.” And He said there, “I won’t destroy for the sake of the ten.”

אֵת כִּי לֹא אֶחָד
יָד אֲנִי וְאֶת
שְׁנֵי זֵמְרֵי זָלַק
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי
אֲנִי וְאֶת שְׁנֵי

So Abe’s like “Please, don’t get mad, just let me say one more thing...”

“Ten?”

“Maybe there’s ten.”

And YHWH’s like “No Abe, not for ten.”

Genesis 18:33

And YHWH went when He had finished speaking to Abraham, and Abraham went back to his place.

אֲנִי אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ

YHWH leaves, taking with him the number he silently computed in his head back in verse 26, smiling toward Sodom.

Abe goes home.

End of chapter.

Up next, the destruction of Sodom.

Genesis 19

Genesis 19:1

And the two angels came to Sodom in the evening, and Lot was sitting at Sodom’s gate, and Lot saw and got up toward them, and he bowed, nose to the ground.

ሠጊጎፋረሣጎ ጊሃሠ ሃፋፍጊሃ
ፅሃረሃ ፍፋዐፍ ጎሣፋቹ
ፋፍጊሃ ሣፋቹ ፋዐሠፍ ፍሠጊ
ሣተፋፋዐረ ሣዐጊሃ ፅሃረ
ጎሣፋፋ ሣጊጎፋ ሃይተሠጊሃ

Ok so the two angels¹⁰¹ come into Sodom that night.

There’s a Lot going on at the gate.

Lot bends over.

Genesis 19:2

And he said, “Here, my lords, turn to your servant’s house and spend the night and wash your feet, and you’ll get up early and go your way.” And they said, “No, we’ll spend the night in the square.”

ጊሃፋፋ ፋሃ ጎሃጎ ፋሣፋጊሃ
ተጊፍ ረፋ ፋሃ ሃፋሃቹ
ሃሣይፋሃ ሃሃጊረሃ ሣሃፋፍዐ
ሣተሣሃሠጎ ሣሃጊረገፋ
ሣሃሃፋላረ ሣተሃረጎሃ
ፍሃይፋፍ ጊሃ ፋረ ሃፋሣፋጊሃ
ሃጊረሃ

Lot, still bending over, says they should spend the night.

He also suggests they wash their feet, which Abraham JUST DID.

These angels apparently have dirty dirty feet.¹⁰²

So Lot says “stay over, don’t stick around in the morning though.”

And the angels are like “No thanks, we’ll sleep outside downtown.”

Genesis 19:3

And he pressed them very much, and they turned to him and came to his house, and he made a feast and baked unleavened bread for them, and they ate.

ሃፋቹጊሃ ላፋሣ ሣፍ ላሣጎጊሃ
ሃተጊፍ ረፋ ሃፋፍጊሃ ሃጊረፋ
ጎተሠሣ ሣጎረ ሠዐጊሃ
ሃረጎፋጊሃ ጎጎፋ ተሃሣሣሃ

And he presses them a Lot.

¹⁰¹Presumably two of the three “people” from the previous scene, one (or all) of which appeared to be YHWH. Let’s jump over that rabbit hole and get to the Sodomy.
¹⁰²Lit. “bottom parts” in the original text. Meaning of Eng. uncertain.

And they turn to him.¹⁰³

And they came to his house.

And his house had a bun in the oven.¹⁰⁴

Genesis 19:4

They had not yet lain down, and the people of the city, the people of Sodom, surrounded the house, from youth to old man, all the people, from the farthest reaches.

ጊወሃቱሃ ሃዓሃወጊ ሃላ፩
ሃዓቹሃ ሃላቹ ጊወሃቱ ላጊዐፓ
ላዐሃ ላዐሃሃ ተጊዓፓ ረዐ
ፓሃዐሃ ሃዐፓ ረሃ ሃዐጊ

Before they got laid,
the people of the city,
the people of Sodom,
from kids to old men,
all the people,
from all the parts,
come to the house
in a big circle.

Genesis 19:5

And they called to Lot and said to him, “Where are the people who came to you tonight? Bring them out to us, and let’s know them!”

፩ሃረ ረቱ ሃቱላዐጊሃ
ፓጊቱ ሃረ ሃላሃቱጊሃ
ሃቱዓ ላሠቱ ሃጊወሃቱፓ
ሃቱጊሃሃፓ ፓረጊረፓ ሃጊረቱ
ሃተቱ ፓዐላሃሃ ሃሃጊረቱ

And behold, the people were jerks.

And the lot of them said to Lot

“Where are the people who came to you tonight? Bring them out to us, so that we may know them.”

Genesis 19:6

And Lot went out to them at the entrance and closed the door behind him,

፩ሃረ ሃፓረቱ ቱሃጊሃ
ላገቹ ተረላፓሃ ፓዘተገፓ
ሃጊላዘቱ

So lot comes to the entrance and exits, and the door closes at the behind

¹⁰³What? The pressing was verbal. No jokes.

¹⁰⁴The meaning of this bun has been hotly debated.

of him.

Genesis 19:7

and he said, “Don’t do bad, my brothers.

ገደብ ሕገ ረቶ ላማቶሃ
ሃዐላተ

And he says “Don’t do bad things.”

Genesis 19:8

Here I have two daughters who haven’t known a man. Let me bring them out to you, and do to them as is good in your eyes. Only don’t do anything to these people, because that is why they came under the shadow of my roof.”

ተሃሃያ ጌተሠ ጌረ ሕገ ጳሃጳ
ሠጊቶ ሃዐላጊ ሕረ ላሠቶ
ሃጳተቶ ሕገ ጳቶጊሾሃቶ
ፋሃ፱ሃሃጳረ ሃሠዐሃ ሣሃጊረቶ
ሣጊሠሃቶረ ዋላ ሣሃጊሃጊዐፋ
ጊሃ ላፋላ ሃሠዐተ ረቶ ረቶጳ
ጊተላዋ ረሾሃ ሃቶሃ ሃሃ ረዐ

“Here’s my two virgin daughters, who haven’t known a man.”

“Let me bring them out to you.”

“You can do whatever you want to them.”

“But don’t hurt these people.”

“They need to stay in here with me.”

Genesis 19:9

And they said, “Come over here,” and they said, “This one comes to live, and then he judges! Now we’ll be worse to you than to them.” And they pressed the man, Lot, very much and came over to break down the door.

ጳቶረጳ ሠገ ሃላማቶሃ
ቶሃ ላዘቶጳ ሃላማቶሃ
፱ሃገሠ ፱ገሠጊሃ ላሃገረ
ሣጳሣ ሃረ ዐላሃ ጳተዐ
፱ሃረሃ ሠጊቶሃ ሃላሾገጊሃ
ላፋሠረ ሃሠገጊሃ ላቶሣ
ተረላጳ

So they’re like “Out of the way foreigner. You just moved here. We do this. Now you’re gonna get some.”

And they pressed him. A Lot.

They come hard at the entrance.

Genesis 19:10

And the people reached their hand out and brought Lot in to them in the house, and they closed the door.

ተቶ ማገዝነቶን ሃይለወረሃ
ፅህረ ተቶ ሃቶገገረሃ ማላገ
ተቶን ጎተገገን ማገገረቱ
ሃላገቹ ተረላን

The two guests reach their hand through the opening.

They grab Lot, and Lot comes inside.

Genesis 19:11

And they struck the people who were at the house's entrance with blindness, from smallest to biggest, and they wearied themselves with finding the entrance.

ይተገላግሉ ማገዝነቶን ተቶን
ማገላሃቹን ሃጎን ተገገን
ሃቶረገሃ ረሃላገ ልዑሃ ሃፅዋሃ
ይተገን ቶሾረ

And the villagers are like “Oh god my eyes.”

They couldn't find the opening, and grew tired trying.

Genesis 19:12

And the people said to Lot, “Who else do you have here—son-in-law and your sons and your daughters and all that you have in the city—take them out from the place,

ረቱ ማገዝነቶን ሃላማቶረሃ
ነተይ ጎገ ሃረ ገማ ልዑ ፅህረ
ረሃሃ ሃገተሃሃሃ ሃገሃሃሃ
ቶሾሃን ላገዑ ሃረ ሃላግ
ማሃዋሃን ሃማ

And the visitors inside asked à Lot about people, saying:

“Who else you got in here? Son-in-law? Sons? Daughters? Anybody else in this town who's yours? Get 'em outta here.”

Genesis 19:13

because we're destroying this place, because its cry has grown big before YHWH's face, and YHWH has sent us to destroy it.”

ተቶ ሃነይነቱ ማገተዘሞ ገሃ
ጎረላገ ገሃ ጎረን ማሃዋሃ
ጎሃጎገ ገነገ ተቶ ማተዋዑሾ
ጎተዘረ ጎሃጎገ ሃነይለወረሃ

We're taking this place down

Don't let it go down on you

or you’re gonna get blown away
to kingdom come, thy will be done
YHWH’s count just hit nine
We’ve crossed Abraham Limit
It’s about to get biblical.

Genesis 19:14

And Lot went out and spoke to his sons-in-law, who had married his daughters, and said, “Get up, get out of this place, for YHWH is destroying the city.” And he was like a joker in his sons-in-law’s eyes.

ረፋ ዓፅላረህ ተሳረ ፋሾረህ
ሃረተሃፅ ረዘዋረ ሃረሃተዘ
ነሃ ሃፋሾ ሃሃሃዋ ዓሃፋረህ
ተረዘሠሃ ረጎ ጸረጎ ሃሃዋሃጎ
ረጎረህ ዓረዐጎ ተፋ ጸሃጸረ
ሃረሃተዘ ረሃረዐፅ ዋዘሾሃሃ

So Lot goes to the guys who are married to his virgin daughters.¹⁰⁵
He’s like “Get out of here quick! Kingdom come and all that!”
I assume he explained quickly, shit’s going down.
The guys are like “Lol lmao.”

Genesis 19:15

And as the dawn rose the angels urged Lot, saying, “Get up, take your wife and your two daughters who are present, or else you’ll be annihilated for the city’s crime.”

ጸረዐ ዓዘሠጎ ሃሃሃሃ
ሃረሃፋረሃጎ ሃሾረፋረህ
ተፋ ዘዋ ሃሃዋ ዓሃፋረ ተሳረፅ
ሃረተሃፅ ረተሠ ተፋሃ ሃተሠፋ
ሃሃዐፅ ጸገቹተ ሃገ ተፋሾሃሃጎ
ዓረዐጎ

Morning comes and the angels come quickly to Lot and say
Get it up folks.
Grab your girls, grab your wife.
Kingdom Come and all that.
Pull out now before things get messy.

¹⁰⁵Or some other daughters. It’s not clear.

Genesis 19:16

And he delayed. And the people took hold of his hand and his wife's hand and his two daughters' hands because of YHWH's compassion for him, and they brought him out and set him outside the city.

ሃዋጊገዘጊሃ ጳጳጳጳተጊሃ
ላጊሃ ሃላጊሃ ግጊሃጸጳ
ጊተሠ ላጊሃ ሃተሠጸ
ጳሃጳጊ ተረግዘላ ሃጊተሃ
ሃጳዘሃጊሃ ሃጳጸሃጊሃ ሃጊረዐ
ላጊዐረ ሃሃዘግ

Lot just sort of smiles and does nothing.

It's not clear why.

Eventually the angels take hold, and

Grab the kids. Grab the wife.

Grab the kids. Grab the wife.¹⁰⁶

And grab the husband.

YAH's escaping everybody out here.

Genesis 19:17

And it was as they were bringing them outside, and He said, “Escape for your life. Don't look behind you and don't stop in all of the plain. Escape to the mountain or else you'll be annihilated.”

ግተጸ ግጸጊሃጳጸ ጊጳጊሃ
⊕ረግጳ ላግጸጊሃ ጳሃሃዘጳ
⊕ጊሳተ ረጸ ጸሠገሃ ረዐ
ረጸላ ላግዐተ ረጸሃ ጸጊላዘጸ
ሃገ ⊕ረግጳ ጳላጳጳ ላጸጸጳ
ጳገቹተ

They pull out the family.

And as they're coming outside.

The angels say:

All of you, don't stop and don't look back until you get to those mountains.

Genesis 19:18

And Lot said to them, “Let it not be, my Lord.

ረጸ ግጳረጸ ⊕ሃረ ላግጸጊሃ
ጊሃላጸ ጸሃ

Lot's like “Oh my Lord.”

¹⁰⁶The repetition of this line is a common feature of ancient near eastern poetry, and seems to indicate that this verse is intended to be read as a prophetic oracle.

Genesis 19:19

Here, your servant has found favor in your eyes, and you’ve magnified your kindness that you’ve done for me, keeping my soul alive, and I’m not able to escape to the mountain, in case the bad thing will cling to me and I’ll die.

ነይ ሃልዕ ቀሣሣ ቀን ጸንጻ
ሃልቼል ረላተሃ ሃጊሃጊዐ
ጊላሣዐ ተጊወዐ ላወቀ
ጊወገነ ተቀ ተሃጊዘጸረ
ፀረሃጸረ ረሃሃቀ ቀረ ጊሃሃቀሃ
ጸዐላጸ ጊሃዋዓተ ነገ ጸላጸጸ
ጊተሣሃ

It’s not clear what “the bad thing” that will “cling to” him is. It’s possible that it refers to whatever force is destroying the city, but scholars are divided on the matter.

Genesis 19:20

Here, this city is close to flee there, and it’s small. Let me escape there—isn’t it small?—and my soul will live.”

ተቀጊጸ ላጊዐጸ ቀን ጸንጸ
ቀሃጸሃ ጸሣሠ ቹሃሃረ ጸዓላዋ
ጸሣሠ ቀን ጸፀረሃቀ ላዐሣሣ
ጊዘተሃ ቀሃጸ ላዐሣሣ ቀረጸ
ጊወገነ

After Sodom I’ve decided I’m not a fan of big cities. I think I’d prefer a smaller town.

Genesis 19:21

And He said to him, “Here, I’ve granted you this thing, too, that I won’t overturn the city of which you spoke.

ጸንጸ ሃጊረቀ ላሣቀጊሃ
ላዓላረ ሣገ ሃጊሃገ ጊተቀሣነ
ተቀ ጊሃገጸ ጊተረዓረ ጸጊጸ
ተላዓላ ላወቀ ላጊዐጸ

So YHWH (he’s here apparently) is like: “Don’t worry, I won’t destroy it.”

Genesis 19:22

Quickly, escape there, because I can’t do a thing until you get there.” On account of this the city’s name was called Zoar.

ቀረ ጊሃ ጸሣሠ ፀረሃጸ ላጸሣ
ላዐ ላዓላ ተሃወዐረ ረሃሃቀ
ቀላዋ ነሃ ረዐ ጸሣሠ ሃቀዓ
ላዐሃሣ ላጊዐጸ ሣሠ

Quickly, go there.

So they go to Smallah.

Zoar is basically the word “Smallah.”

Genesis 19:23

The sun rose on the earth, and Lot came to Zoar.

ሶፋፋፋ ረዕ ፋሶፋ ሠሣሠ፣
፳፻፶ ፋፋ ፀሃረሃ

The sun rises, as Lot comes to Smallah.

Genesis 19:24

And YHWH rained brimstone and fire on Sodom and on Gomorrah, from YHWH out of the skies.

ሣፋቹ ረዕ ፋፋፀሣ፣ ፳ሃ፳ፋፋ
ሠፋሃ ተፈፋፋፋ ፳ፋሣዕ ረዕሃ
ሣፋሣሣ ሣሣ ፳ሃ፳ፋ ተፋሣ

YHWH does his thing.

Genesis 19:25

And He overturned these cities and all of the plain and all of the residents of the cities and all the growth of the ground.

ረፋፋ ሣፋፋፋ ተፋ ሣፋፋፋፋ
ረሃ ተፋሃ ፋሣሣፋ ረሃ ተፋሃ
ዘሣሣሃ ሣፋፋፋ ፈፋሠፋ
፳ሣፋፋፋ

He Sodomizes all the cities and all the plain and all the people who lived there and all the plants too.

Genesis 19:26

And his wife looked behind him, and she was a pillar of salt!

ሃፋፋዘፋሣ ሃተሠፋ ፀፋተሃ
ዘረሣ ፋፋሣሃ ፈፋተሃ

But Lot’s wife forgot the instructions.

And she looked back.

And she was assaulted.¹⁰⁷

¹⁰⁷The author owes the words of this phrase to a vision from the LORD, in a personal communication, via hypostasis, as recorded in the anⁿals of ቸገኅኅኅ.

ⁿ The footnote above contains a typographical anomaly of unknown function, known among scholars as the suspended nun, cf. Judges 18:40.

Genesis 19:27

And Abraham got up early in the morning to the place where he had stood in YHWH’s presence,

אֶפְרָח וַאֲבֶרְחָא וַאֲשֶׁר
אִמּוֹ אִשָּׁא וַאֲשֶׁר
אִתְּתָא לֵאלֹהִים

Abe wakes up early and goes back to where he and YHWH had the “I won’t kill everyone if there’s N good ones” talk earlier.

Genesis 19:28

and he gazed at the sight of Sodom and Gomorrah and at the sight of all the land of the plain. And he saw: and, here, the smoke of the land went up like the smoke of a furnace.

וַאֲשֶׁר רָאָה לֹא וַאֲשֶׁר
רָאָה לֵאלֹהִים וְכָל
אֶרֶץ הַשָּׁמַר
וְהָאֵשׁ הָיְתָה
כְּאֵשׁ הַמִּנְחָה

He sees the smouldering ruins.

Genesis 19:29

And it was, when God destroyed the cities of the plain, that God remembered Abraham and let Lot go from inside the overthrow: at the overthrowing of the cities in which Lot lived.

וַיְהִי בַשְּׁחִת אֱלֹהִים
אֶת עָרֵי הַכְּפֹר וַיִּזְכֹּר
אֱלֹהִים אֶת אַבְרָהָם
וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶת לוֹט מִתּוֹךְ
הַהִפּוֹךְ בַּהֲפֹךְ אֶת
הָעָרִים אֲשֶׁר יָשָׁב בָּהֶן
לוֹט:

God remembered his talk with Abe.

And he let Lot get out safely from the overthrow at the overthrowing of the cities where Lot lived.

Genesis 19:30

And Lot went up from Zoar and lived in the mountain, and his two daughters with him, because he feared to live in Zoar, and he lived in a cave, he and his two daughters.

וַיֵּלֶךְ לוֹט מִצֹּאֵר
וַיֵּשֶׁב בַּהֲרָא וְשְׁנֵי
בָנוֹתָיו עִמּוֹ כִּי
פָּחַד לֵישֹׁב בַּצֹּאֵר
וַיֵּשֶׁב בַּמְּוֶה וְהָאֵשׁ
הָיְתָה כְּאֵשׁ הַמִּנְחָה

So Lot’s now traumatized.
Hates big cities.
Now living in Smallah town.
Still not small enough, apparently.
He’s presumably worried that YHWH will show up and rain down fire on this city too.
Nope, this town won’t do, says Lot, and he takes his two daughters and decides to live in a cave.

Genesis 19:31

And the firstborn said to the younger one, “Our father is old, and there’s no man in the earth to come to us in the way of all the earth.

𐤇𐤍 𐤓𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤓𐤓 𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤓𐤓𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤇𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤕

Now, that talk from earlier between YHWH and Abe about “What if there’s only N good people?” was sort of a recapitulation of the Noah flood story on a smaller scale.

- 1. Everybody in some area is bad.
- 2. YHWH wants to kill them all.
- 3. Except for a few good people.
- 4. So the story explains how YHWH saves the good people and kills everyone else.

Same general pattern as Noah.
Here we have a situation like in Genesis 9.
Now all the bad people are dead in the greater Sodom and Gomorrah metropolitan area.
So it’s just the best of the best people in this scene.
Here it’s Lot and his daughters (no wife, she’s been turned into seasoning).
Back in Genesis 9 it was Noah and his sons and their wives.
And in Genesis 9, once the world was clean and it was just the good people, we had a story about Noah becoming a man of the ground and growing a vineyard.
But this scene is quite different.

And unlike the Noah story in Genesis 9, this story involves neither an unconscious good man of conscience nor wine.

But we’ve said quite enough, lest our words fill a shelf.

At this point, we’ll be brief; the text speaks for itself.

(ahem)

The text notes that the girls seem to think the world’s ended.

It’s their job to repopulate, that creation might be mended.

The older says to the younger, there’s no man left in all the earth.

Genesis 19:32

Come on, let’s make our father drink wine, and let’s lie with him and make seed live from our father.”	ሃንጊዓቶ ተቶ ጓዋሠን ጓሃረ ሃግዐ ጓዓጎሠንሃ ሃጊጊ ዐላጊ ሃንጊዓቶን ጓጊዘንሃ
---	---

So the girls give him wine, and conspire to give birth.

Genesis 19:33

And they made their father drink wine in that night, and the firstborn came and lay with her father. And he did not know of her lying down and her getting up.	ሃጓጊዓቶ ተቶ ሃጊዋሠተሃ ቶዓተሃ ቶሃጓ ጓረጊረዓ ሃጊጊ ተቶ ዓጎሠተሃ ጓላጊጎዓጓ ጓዓጎሠዓ ዐላጊ ቶረሃ ጓጊዓቶ ጓጎሃዋዓሃ
--	--

And with the bad people gone, all destroyed just like Sodom.

Now the first girl mounts her father.

As he’s passed out on the bottom.

Lot knew not that his eldest now held his seed inside her.

Genesis 19:34

And it was on the next day, and the firstborn said to the younger one, “Here, I lay with my father last night. Let’s make him drink wine tonight as well, and you come and lie with him, and we’ll make seed live from our father.”	ላጎቶተሃ ተላዘግግ ጊጓጊሃ ጓላጊዐኦጎጓ ረቶ ጓላጊጎዓጓ ተቶ ሠግቶ ጊተዓጎሠ ሃጓ ግገ ሃጊጊ ሃንዋሠን ጊዓቶ ሃግዐ ጊዓጎሠ ጊቶዓሃ ጓረጊረጓ ዐላጊ ሃንጊዓቶን ጓጊዘንሃ
---	---

A night after, little sister comes to spread the family legs and seed wider.

Genesis 19:35

And they made their father drink wine in that night as well, and the younger one got up and lay with him, and he did not know of her lying down and her getting up.

እረጊረዓ ሃገ ሃጊዋተሃ
ሃጊጊ ሃገጊዓፋ ተፋ ፋሃገገ
ዓሃሃተሃ ገገጊዐሃገገ ሃዋተሃ
ገገዓሃዓ ዐፋጊ ፋረሃ ሃሃዐ
ገገዋዓሃ

Like father like daughter.

Little sister same as old.

Lot knew not a thing.

As he lay there out cold.

Genesis 19:36

And Lot's two daughters became pregnant by their father.

፱ሃረ ተሃሃዓ ጊተሃ ሃጊገገተሃ
ሃገጊዓፋሃ

Now at last the world's clean, purged of Sodom's evil deed.

As two virgins sleep soundly, pure and full of father's seed.

Genesis 19:37

And the firstborn gave birth to a son and called his name Moab. He is the father of Moab to this day.

ሃዓ ገገጊዓሃገገ ላረተሃ
ዓፋሃሃ ሃሃሃ ፋገዋተሃ
ላዐ ዓፋሃሃ ጊዓፋ ፋሃገገ
ሃሃጊገገ

And if you dispute the story's moral, there's a punchline yet in store.

For the elder names her son after the country right next door.

And if the joke still isn't clear, a simple map provides a clue.

For ancient Israel bordered Moab, as J's readers all well knew.

Genesis 19:38

And the younger one, she too gave birth to a son and called his name ben-Ammi. He is the father of the children of Ammon to this day.

ፋሃገገ ሃገ ገገጊዐሃገገ
ሃሃሃ ፋገዋተሃ ሃዓ ገገጊጊ
ጊሃዓ ጊዓፋ ፋሃገገ ጊሃዐ ሃዓ
ሃሃጊገገ ላዐ ሃሃሃዐ

Believe this book is false or true and it falls mute upon deaf ears.

So why's this book been so beloved all these past three thousand years?

A simple riddle holds the answer. Isaac's sacrifice occurred.

The knife is called translation & she cuts with every word.

And her killer as with Isaac is the one we call the father.

Now faith and doubt each hold the knife.

(If you're not following don't bother.)

3 daughters, pure and moral fill themselves with father's seed.

2 then birth your nation's rivals as the punchline of the deed.

1 lies Nameless but it's We who saved the child for ever after.

What's the lesson?

No God hears You lying laughed...

Name him Laughter.

Genesis 20

Genesis 20:1

And Abraham traveled from there to the Negeb country and lived between Kadesh and Shur and resided in Gerar.

አብራሃም ከዚህም ቦታ ለባህሪ
ከባህሪ ለባህሪ ከባህሪ ለባህሪ
ከባህሪ ለባህሪ ከባህሪ ለባህሪ

Ok so Abraham goes from the Dry Place and lives between Holy and Wall and lodges at Lodging Place.

This story's taking place in like 1800 or so BC.

Meanwhile, in 722 BC the Northern Kingdom of Israel is destroyed and the refugees come down South to Judah with their own version of the Abraham story and some others.

The guy who wrote this verse has to combine the two bibles into one.

And on that note, we now come to the E source, chapter one.

Genesis 20:2

And Abraham said of Sarah, his wife, "She's my sister." And Abimelek, king of Gerar, sent and took Sarah.

አብራሃም ለራሱ ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት
ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት
ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት
ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት

Ok so Abraham's like "She's my sister."

And Abimelek (whose name means My Father Is King) is the King.

He takes Sarah to his harem or whatever.

So lots of weird family stuff going on in this verse.

Genesis 20:3

And God came to Abimelek in a night dream and said to him, "Here, you're dead over the woman whom you took, for she's a man's wife!"

ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት
ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት
ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት
ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት ሕጻናት ለሕጻናት

So God shows up in Abimelek's mind at night and says "You're dead, that lady belongs to my main man Abe."

Genesis 20:4

And Abimelek had not come close to her, and he said, “My Lord, will you kill a virtuous nation as well?

እገረኛ ገገዋ ፋሪ ሃሪሣጊጽፋኛ
ሣገ ጊገገጃ ጊጎላፋ ገሣፋጊኛ
ገግጃጽ ዋጊሳጤ

The text notes that Abimelek hadn’t had sex with her yet.
So he talks back to God in his dream or whatever and asks “Will you kill a virtuous nation?”

Genesis 20:5

Didn’t he say to me, ‘She’s my sister’? And she—she, too—said, ‘He’s my brother.’ I did this in my heart’s innocence and in my hands’ cleanness.”

ጊጸዘፋ ጊሪ ገሣፋ ፋኛጃ ፋሪጃ
ፋኛጃ ሣገ ፋጊጃኛ ፋኛጃ
ሣጸጎ ፋኛጃ ጊዘፋ ጃገሣፋ
ጊጎሃ ጎጊዋጎጎኛ ጊጎጎሪ
ጸፋጋ ጊጸጊሠዐ

“I didn’t know. He lied. So did she. Why are you mad exactly?”

Genesis 20:6

And God said to him in the dream, “I, too, knew that you did this in your heart’s innocence; and I, too, held you back from sinning against me. On account of this, I didn’t let you touch her.

ሣጊጃሪፋጃ ነጊሪፋ ገሣፋጊኛ
ጊጸዐላጊ ጊጎጎፋ ሣገ ሣሪዘጎ
ጸጊሠዐ ሃጎጎሪ ሣጸጎ ጊጎ
ጊጎጎፋ ሣገ ሃሠዘፋኛ ጸፋጋ
ጎሃ ሪዐ ጊሪ ነፁዘሣ ሃጸነፋ
እገረኛ ዐገሃሪ ሃጊጸጸጎ ፋሪ

So God’s like “Yeah I know. I’m the one who made sure you didn’t do bad stuff. That’s why I didn’t let you have sex with her.”
So God’s kind of all over the place with his moral philosophy on this one.

Genesis 20:7

And now, give the man’s wife back, because he’s a prophet, and he’ll pray for you. And live! And if you don’t give back, know that you will die, you and all that you have.”

ሠጊፋጃ ጸሠፋ ጎሠጃ ጃጸዐኛ
ሪሪጎጸጊኛ ፋኛጃ ፋጊጎጎ ጊጎ
ሃጎጊፋ ሣፋኛ ጃጊዘኛ ሃላዐጎ
ጸነሣጸ ጸነሣ ጊጎ ዐላ ጎጊሠሣ
ሃሪ ገሠፋ ሪሃኛ ጃጸፋ

So he's like "Come on, give her back. Like now. Or I'll kill you."

Genesis 20:8

And Abimelek got up in the morning and called to all his servants and spoke all these things in their ears, and the people were very afraid.

ᐱᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ

So morning rolls around, Abimelek strolls casually out of his dream and into the morning meeting with his guys, and he describes the chat with God.

His guys are afraid.

Genesis 20:9

And Abimelek called Abraham and said to him, "What have you done to us, and how did I sin against you, that you brought a big sin over me and over my kingdom? You've done things with me that are not done!"

ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

So Abimelek calls Abe and says "What's the big idea with this entrapment game? What did I do to you? Who even does something like this?"

Genesis 20:10

And Abimelek said to Abraham, "What did you see, that you did this thing?"

ᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ

"Walk me through this decision of yours step by step, like what were you thinking here?"

Genesis 20:11

And Abraham said, "Because I said, 'There just isn't the fear of God in this place, and they'll kill me on account of my wife.'

ᐃᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐃᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ

So Abe's like:

Well, if I had to describe it, I'd say my thought process was something like this.

- 1. You're all a bunch of savages.
- 2. Being savages, naturally you'd kill me so you could have your way with my wife.
- 3. Then I'm dead and Sarah's fucked.
- 4. But with my approach, Sarah's fucked and I'm alive.
- 5. This is what economists call a Pareto improvement. We're all better off and there's no downside.
- 6. This is all pretty obvious stuff.
- 7. So the fact that you needed me to explain it all to you is a further demonstration of item 1, given that there's a strong negative correlation between violent behavior and IQ, and the need for the explanation is evidence that the latter variable's lower than average.

Genesis 20:12

And also she is, in fact, my sister, my father's daughter but not my mother's daughter, and she became a wife to me.

እኛ ጌጽጽ ጸሃፊ ሆንን
እኛ ፋሪ ሃፋ ፋቶ ጌጽ
ጸሃፊ ጌ ጌጽጽ ጸሃፊ

8. Also, speaking of low IQ, she *is* my sister dumbass. Half-sister technically but c'mon it's a figure of speech.

Genesis 20:13

And it was when God had me roam from my father's house, and I said to her, This will be your kindness that you'll do with me: to every place where we come, say about me, "He's my brother."""

ጌጽ ፋቶጽ ጸሃፊ ጌጽጽ
ጌጽ ጸሃፊ ሆንን
ሃፋጽ ጌ ጌ ጸሃፊ
ፋ ጌጽ ጌጽ ጸሃፊ
ፋጽ ጸሃፊ ሆንን ጌ
ጌጽ ጌ ጸሃፊ ጸሃፊ
ፋቶ

"We've been doing this to all the kings on this trip so far."

Genesis 20:14

And Abimelek took sheep and oxen and servants and maids, and he gave them to Abraham, and he gave Sarah, his wife, back to him.

ገፋጦ ሃረሃጊጽፉ ዐዋጊፍ
 ጸዘገሠፍ ሃጊፋግዐፍ ጻዋጽፍ
 ነረ ገሠጊፍ ሃጻጻጽፉ ገጽጊፍ
 ነጽሠፉ ጻጻሠ ጽፉ

The text doesn't explain why, but here in the next sentence Abimelek just yields and gives Abe a bunch of loot.

Like major loot. There's humans in that list. Not just more than one human. There's two entire *kinds* of humans.

So while Abimelek may have protested a bit, it looks like Abe's entrapment strategy worked again.

Genesis 20:15

And Abimelek said, "Here's my land in front of you. Live wherever it's good in your eyes."

ጻጽ ሃረሃጊጽፉ ጻሃፉጊፍ
 ጽፍፀጽ ሃጊገገረ ጊጦጻፉ
 ገሠ ሃጊገጊዐጽ

Abimelek's like "You can live wherever. Just promise not to sick that rabid god of yours on me.

Genesis 20:16

And to Sarah he said, "Here, I've given a thousand weights of silver to your brother. Here, it's a covering of eyes for you with everyone with you, and you're justified with everyone."

ጊጽጽጽ ጻጽ ጻሃፉ ጻጻሠረፍ
 ጻጽ ሃጊዐፉረ ገጽሃ ገረፉ
 ሃጊገጊዐ ጽፍጽሃ ሃረ ፉፍጻ
 ረሃ ጽፉፍ ሃጽፉ ጻሠፉ ረሃረ
 ጽዐሃገፍ

Ok so Abimelek's like "I gave your husband a thousand money. We're even now right?"

Now, the weights here are almost certainly shekels.

Here's what we know about the purchasing power of 1000 shekels in the ancient near East.

Source	Item	Shekels	1,000 Shekels Buys
Hammurabi	Slave	~20	~50 slaves
ANE	Ox	~10–30	~33–100 oxen
ANE	Donkey	~20–40	~25–50 donkeys
ANE	Field or vineyard	Tens to hundreds	Several farms or vineyards
Genesis 23	Machpelah cave	400	2.5 Machpelah purchases
II Samuel 24	Araunah’s floor and oxen	50	20 threshing-floor purchases
Song 8:11–12	Solomon’s vineyard in-come	1,000/year	One premier vineyard’s annual in-come
Mesopotamian texts	Typical house	~10–100	~10–100 houses
Mesopotamian texts	Large estate	Several hundred	A few large estates
Genesis 20	Abimelek’s gift	1,000	Princely public restitution

So he gives Abe a LOT.

Entrapment pays handsomely.

Genesis 20:17

And Abraham prayed to God,
and God healed Abimelek and
his wife and his maids, and they
gave birth,

לֵאָנָה לֵאָנָה יִצְחָקָה לֵלְיָנָה
יִצְחָקָה לֵאָנָה לֵאָנָה יִצְחָקָה
יִצְחָקָה לֵאָנָה לֵאָנָה יִצְחָקָה
יִצְחָקָה לֵאָנָה לֵאָנָה יִצְחָקָה

And Abe asks God to give Abimelek and his wife and some other girls their fertility back.

Did I miss something?

Genesis 20:18

because YHWH had held back
every womb of Abimelek’s house
on account of Sarah, Abraham’s
wife!

יְהוָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה
יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה
יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה
יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה יִצְחָקָה

Oh right right, I forgot to mention.

YHWH¹⁰⁸ had made everybody infertile.

To punish Abimelek for having sex with Sarah while she was married to Abe and lying and also he didn’t have sex with her.

End of chapter!

A round of applause for the Elohist ladies and gentlemen!

¹⁰⁸ This is the second of the five unexpected appearances of the name YHWH, as discussed in the note on Genesis 14:22.

He'll be around for the next five books, and we're happy to have him around to spice things up.

He and P are not on friendly terms no sir they are not. But that's a story for another day.

Up next, a three part harmony with P and E and J!

Genesis 21

Genesis 21:1

And YHWH took account of Sarah as He had said, and YHWH did to Sarah as He had spoken.

וַיִּקְרָא אֲבְרָהָם אֶת שְׁמֵהּ
בְּנוֹ הַנּוֹלֵד לוֹ אֲשֶׁר
יָלְדָה לוֹ שָׂרָה יִצְחָק׃

YHWH gets Sarah pregnant like he promised.

Genesis 21:2

And Sarah became pregnant and gave birth to a son for Abraham in his old age at the appointed time that God had spoken.

וַתֵּהָרַם וַתֵּלֶד שָׂרָה
לְאֲבְרָהָם בֶּן לְזִקְנֹוֹ
לְמוֹעֵד אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֱתוֹ
אֱלֹהִים׃

She has the baby.

Because **God** got her pregnant at the appointed time.¹⁰⁹

Genesis 21:3

And Abraham called the name of his son who was born to him, to whom Sarah had given birth for him: Isaac.

וַיִּקְרָא אֲבְרָהָם אֶת שְׁמֵהּ
בְּנוֹ הַנּוֹלֵד לוֹ אֲשֶׁר
יָלְדָה לוֹ שָׂרָה יִצְחָק׃

So they name him Laughter.

Genesis 21:4

And Abraham circumcised Isaac, his son, at eight days old, as God had commanded him.

וַיִּמַּל אֲבְרָהָם אֶת
יִצְחָק בְּנוֹ בֶּן שְׁמֹנֶת
יָמִים כְּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֱתוֹ
אֱלֹהִים׃

¹⁰⁹ Documentary Note: This line is often attributed to J. This is strange, given that it contains the word “God” spoken by the narrator. This is otherwise unknown in the J source, as J herself never calls YHWH “God,” though characters in J sometimes do (the first example being the snake in Genesis 3.) Also the use of the phrase “appointed time” is characteristic of P, though not exclusively.

He cuts the covenant on day eight.

Genesis 21:5

And Abraham was a hundred years old when Isaac, his son, was born to him.

וְאַבְרָהָם בֶּן מֵאָת שָׁנָה
בְּהוֹלֵד לוֹ אֶת יִצְחָק
בְּנוֹ:

Abe's a hundred.

Genesis 21:6

And Sarah said, “God has made laughter for me. Everyone who hears will laugh for me.”

אָמַר פֶּתַח אֱלֹהִים אֲחַסְדִּי
וְכָל שֹׁמֵר לִי יִצְחָק
כִּי פֶתַח

Sarah speaks to no one in particular, reminding the audience her son's a pun.

Genesis 21:7

And she said, “Who would have said to Abraham, ‘Sarah has nursed children’? Yet I’ve given birth to a son in his old age.”

לֵלֵךְ זֶה אֲחַסְדִּי
וְזֶה אֶפְרַיִם וְזֶה אֲחַסְדִּי
זֶה אֶפְרַיִם זֶה אֲחַסְדִּי
זֶה אֶפְרַיִם

She's like “Who would've thought this would happen eh?”

Genesis 21:8

And the boy grew and was weaned. And Abraham made a big feast in the day that Isaac was weaned.

וְהַיָּלֵד גָּדַל וְנָשָׂא
אֲבִרָה אֶת יִצְחָק
וְהָיָה יוֹם הַנִּשְׁאָה
וְהָיָה

The boy grows up and stops nursing.

Abraham makes a big dinner.

Genesis 21:9

And Sarah saw the son of Hagar, the Egyptian, whom she had borne to Abraham, fooling around.

וְרָאָה שָׂרָה אֶת יִצְחָק
אֶת הָעִזְרָאִית אֲשֶׁר
בָּרָא אֲבִרָה

Sarah looks over at sisterwife’s son.

The text says she sees him “fooling around,” which is a pun on Isaac. (No time to explain, just trust me, the Hebrew word’s not the point here.)

The Greek text has “fooling around with her son Isaac,” which can connote either playing with Isaac or mocking him. The word in Hebrew is מִצַּחֵק, which is a pun on the name Isaac. It will occur again in the story of Isaac, Rebekah, and Abimelek (Gen 26:8).

Anyways the point is that this new E character seems to like puns too.

To recap:

- J’s entire universe is stitched together from a dense fabric of puns and sex and subtext.
- E’s universe is one in which God exists and his name’s YHWH¹¹⁰ but it’s not illegal to have fun, and in which writing a bible doesn’t rule out the occasional pun.
- P’s universe is one in which language, all languages, and each language according to its words, are a tool of holiness. It is a holy thing. And in the holy medium of language, all languages, and each language according to its words, puns are an abomination and simply must not be done. When anyone brings a pun into the world by bringing it into one’s mind and conceiving of it, he must bring his pun or puns to the Tabernacle and present it in front of Aaron and his sons. And he shall lay his hand on the head of the pun and slaughter it at the entrance of the tent of meeting. And Aaron’s sons the priests shall sprinkle the blood all around against the sides of the altar. Then he shall remove all the letters from the insides of the word of his pun (if it is a single word pun) or the words of his pun (if it is a multiword pun), and then Aaron’s sons are to burn it to smoke on the altar; it is a literative offering, a literation pleasing to the Lord. After these things, any male in a priest’s family may hear the words of the pun; it is a holy thing. I am YHWH who makes you holy, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God. I am YHWH.

Genesis 21:10

And she said to Abraham,
“Drive this maid out—and her
son, because the son of this maid
will not inherit with my son, with
Isaac.”

וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָהָם
אֶל שָׂרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ
אֲנִי אֶמְצָא לְךָ
אֶת הַעַבְדָּה הַזֹּאת
וְאֶת בְּנָהּ וְלֹא
יִרְשָׁה אִתִּי וְאֶת
בְּנִי יִרְשֶׁה אִתִּי
וְאֶתְּּוֹ אֲנִי אֶמְצָא
לְךָ וְלֹא יִרְשָׁה אִתִּי
וְאֶתְּּוֹ אֲנִי אֶמְצָא
לְךָ וְלֹא יִרְשָׁה אִתִּי

¹¹⁰Though in E we don’t learn this until Exodus 3.

So Sarah's like "Remember how I said you should get the maid pregnant so you did and but then some YHWH magic happened and so now I have a kid?"

Abe's listening.

She continues "Anyways you should kick her and your other son out because when you die I'm not splitting all the stuff we got from our monarch entrapment side project with her. I mean it's only reasonable, it was ME that had to f—"

Abe's listening.

"...f— ind a way to avoid having to sleep with all those dirty handsome foreign kings."

Genesis 21:11

And the thing was very bad in Abraham's eyes in regard to his son.

ἡ ἡγεμονία ἡ ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖς
τοῦ Ἀβραάμ ἐν τῇ ὁμιλίᾳ

Abe's comments on the matter have been withheld for profanity.

Genesis 21:12

And God said to Abraham, "Let it not be bad in your eyes about the boy and about your maid. Everything that Sarah tells you: listen to her voice; because seed for you will be called by Isaac."

ὁ θεὸς εἶπεν πρὸς τὸν Ἀβραάμ
λέγε ὅτι οὐ κακὸν ἐστὶν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖς
σου περὶ τοῦ παιδὸς καὶ περὶ τῆς παιδίσκης
καὶ πάντα ὅσα λέγει σου ἡ Σαράห์ ἀκούε τὴν
φωνήν της ὅτι σπέρμα σου καλεῖται Ἰσαάκ

So God says "Abe your emotions are all wrong. I know you see this 'sending your firstborn son and second wife away' situation as a bad thing. Let's not feel that way, eh? Listen to your wife Abe. Your cu— You're communicating all wrong. Marriage is about come you nakeding. Nothing. Hear what? What do you mean Ishmael's crying? Abe don't listen to Ishmael. I'll listen to Ishmael. Focus Abe. Listen to me. You listening? Ok, here's my advice. Listen to Sarah. I mean she's your wife Abe. It's not unreasonable for her to ask you to send your wife and son away. You have a wife and son for God's sake Abe it's time to settle down. Sure we all like to sow our wild c— oats, um, when we're young. Where was I going with this? Oh right. Abe look it's ok to run around wearing wild coats when we're young, but it's time to grow up. You're an adult now. You're a hundred. And one wife is enough Abe. You're a dad now. It's time to settle down and stop running around trying to spread your seed all over the

place. You have responsibilities. Which is more important Abe? Being a good father to your wife and son, or running around trying to spread your seed all over the place? So listen to your wife Abe. Be a good dad. It's time to focus on your wife and son. So send away your wife and son. See? Problem solved. Anyways Abe you don't have to listen to me. But listen to your wife. And so do whatever she says. It's time to stop taking care of yourself and start taking care of her. No not her. Don't let me down Abe. I've got big plans for you. We're gonna spread your seed far and wide, to all the ladies of the earth Abe. But not that one. The other one. Right, the one you have a kid with. No not her. God works in mysterious ways Abe. Life's funny sometimes. So don't forget you're my #1 guy Abe. And I'm gonna spread your seed to all the nations Abe. But your seed's gonna be funny. That's why we added that 'ha' to your name. Get it? So sack up and turn that frown upside down and tell your wife (not her, the other one, the quiet nice one) to pack up her sack, tell that old hag to pack her bag and get out of town. And after that, let's get down to business and get you some p[atri]ernity.

Genesis 21:13

And I'll make the maid's son into a nation as well, because he's your seed."

Ἐγὼ ἑτοιμάσω τὸν υἱὸν τῆς παιδὸς αὐτοῦ ὡς ἕνα ἔθνος ὡς καὶ ἔσται σου σπέρμα.

Don't worry Abe we're gonna give him as much p[atri]archy as I'm giving you. He's safe with me! Wave goodbye Abe! Bon voyage!

Genesis 21:14

And Abraham got up early in the morning and took bread and a bottle of water and gave to Hagar—he put them on her shoulder—and the boy and he sent her off. And she went and strayed in the Beer-sheba wilderness.

Ἀβραάμ ἤγειρε πρωῒ ἐν τῇ ἑσπέρῃ καὶ ἔλαβεν ἄρτον καὶ ὕδωρ ἐν ἄμβλακίᾳ καὶ ἔθηκεν ἐπὶ τὴν ὤμων αὐτῆς καὶ ἀπέστειλεν αὐτήν καὶ τὸν υἱὸν αὐτῆς ἐν τῇ ἑσπέρῃ ἐν τῇ ἄβρα-ἡμὰ.

So Abe sends his wife and firstborn away.
Even gets up early in the morning.
He's a good guy though, so he doesn't send his wife and son away empty handed.
He puts some bread and water on her shoulder and sends them off.

Look nobody's perfect.

Go try to raise a family.

Even with YHWH following you around, it's not easy.

Genesis 21:15

And the water was finished from the bottle, and she thrust the boy under one of the shrubs,

አሁክኝ ንህ ህጊህኝ ነህጊኝ
አከላ ልጊኝ እኔ ህረወኝ
ህከጊወኝ ልከኔ

Once Hagar finishes the bottle of water, she throws the baby under a bush.

Also note the baby is a 14 year old guy at this point.

Genesis 21:16

and she went and sat opposite, going as far as a bow-shot, because she said, “Let me not see the boy’s death.” And she sat opposite and raised her voice and wept.

ልጊህ ላል ያወኝ ህረኝ
አወዋ ጊክፀህህ ዋከላ
ኣኔላኔ ረኔ ኣላህኔ ጊህ
ልጊህ ያወኝ ልጊኝ እኝህ
ህጊኝ ላልዋ እኔ ኔወኝ

She goes and sits across from the bush, about as far as you can shoot an arrow.

Then she cries about how she doesn't want to see her son die.

Meanwhile, I imagine Ishmael is confused.

I picture him standing up and slowly and awkwardly walking away from the bush.

He doesn't need that bush. He's 14. He's got a bush of his own.

Genesis 21:17

And God heard the boy's voice. And an angel of God called to Hagar from the heavens and said to her, “What trouble do you have, Hagar? Don't be afraid. Because God has heard the boy's voice where he is.

ረከዋ እኔ ህጊኝ ለኔ ዐህወጊኝ
ህኔረህ ኔዋጊኝ ዓዐኝ
ንህ ዓገኝ ረኔ ህጊኝ ለኔ
ኣህ ላል ዓህኔጊኝ ህጊህወኝ
ጊህ ጊኔዓጊኔ ረኔ ዓገኝ ህረ
ረከዋ ረኔ ህጊኝ ለኔ ዐህወ
ህወ ኔኝኝ ዓወኔጊ ዓዐኝ

So God messages Hagar.

He's like “What's wrong now, Hagar? Don't be afraid. I hear Ishmael.

Get it?”

So both the Narrator and God both make the “Ishmael” joke in this line. Again.

Genesis 21:18

Get up. Carry the boy and hold him up in your hand, because I shall make him into a big nation.”

ገፀገፀ ጸፋ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ
ገፀ ገፀ ጸፋ ገፀገፀገፀገፀ
ገፀገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀ

God says to pick the boy up and hold him in her hand.

Don’t worry, it makes sense.

He’s going to be a country.

Genesis 21:19

And God opened her eyes, and she saw a water well, and she went and filled the bottle with water and had the boy drink.

ጸፋ ገፀገፀገፀ ገፀገፀገፀ
ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ
ገፀገፀ ጸፋ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ
ገፀገፀ ጸፋ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ

So God does a miracle where he opens her eyes for her and then she can see that there’s water nearby.

Now her eyes are opened, so she fills up her water bottle and has the boy drink.

He needs help drinking, he’s just a high school freshman.

Genesis 21:20

And God was with the boy, and he grew, and he lived in the wilderness and was a bowman.

ገፀገፀ ጸፋ ገፀገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ
ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ
ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ ገፀገፀ

Then the boy grows.

And he lives in the woods and does archery.

Genesis 21:21

And he lived in the Paran wilderness, and his mother took him a wife from the land of Egypt.

ጎሳጽ ላጋሩ ገሠጊኑ
ገሠጊኑ ነገሩ ነገ ልዋኝ
ሠጋገሞ ገላጽ

He lives in the Place Of Caves wilderness.

His mom visits home and brings him a wife from Egypt.

Genesis 21:22

And it was at that time, and Abimelek and Phichol, the commander of his army, said to Abraham, saying, “God is with you in everything that you do.

ላሳጽጊኑ ሩክገገ ጸዕጽ ገገጊኑ
ላሳጽ ሠጋገሩ ለጽ ስጽገሙ
ላሳጽ ለገጽ ሠሐዕ ሠጋገረጽ
ገሠዕ ገጽጽ

It’s that time.

So My Father Is King the king and Mouth Of All the army commander say to Abe “You and God always do everything together.”

Genesis 21:23

And now, swear to me here by God that you won’t act falsely to me and to my offspring and to my posterity Like the kindness that I’ve done with you, you’ll do with me and with the land in which you’ve resided.”

ለጽ ገገ ገገገሠገ ገገገጽ
ላዋሠ ሠጽ ገገገ ሠጋገ
ገገገገገ ገገገገገ ገገ
ገገገገ ላሳጽ ልገገገ
ሠገገ ገገገ ገገገ ሠሐዕ
ገገ ገገገ ላሳጽ ገገገጽ

Promise me you won’t lie or cheat me and my kids and their kids. Like I’ve been nice to you, you know. Be nice to me too. Also be nice to the land. Promise me that, and make it a God promise.

Genesis 21:24

And Abraham said, “I’ll swear,”

ገገገ ሠጋገ ላሳጽጊኑ
ዕገገጽ

Abe promises.

Genesis 21:25

and Abraham criticized
Abimelek about a water well that
Abimelek’s servants had seized.

እኔ ሃያላገኛል ዘሃኛኛ
የኔገ ጸኅፋኔ ርዕ ሃሪሃጊገኛል
ጊላገዐ ነሪጊገ ገሠኔ ሃጊሃኛ
ሃሪሃጊገኛል

Abe immediately starts bitching at Abimelek about a well.

Genesis 21:26

And Abimelek said, “I don’t
know who did this thing; and
also, you didn’t tell me; and also,
I didn’t hear of it except for
today.”

ኔሪ ሃሪሃጊገኛል ገሃኔጊገ
እኔ ጻሠዐ ጊሃ ጊጸዐላጊ
ጻእኔ ሃገኝ ጻጊጻ ገገላጻ
ጊሃገኔ ሃገኝ ጊሪ ጸላገጻ ኔሪ
ሃኛጊጻ ጊጸሪገ ጊጸዐሃሠ ኔሪ

And Abimelek is like “Abe, I’m the king. Do you have any idea how many
guys I’m in charge of? I have no idea what any of them are doing. This is
the first I’ve heard about this well situation.”

Genesis 21:27

And Abraham took sheep and
oxen and gave to Abimelek, and
the two of them made a
covenant.

ገኔጌ ሃያላገኛል ዘዋጊገ
ሃሪሃጊገኛል ገጸጊገ ገዋገገ
ጸጊገገ ሃኛጊገሠ ነጸገሃጊገ

So Abe gives him some livestock and the two call it even.
They make a deal, so they won’t have these misunderstandings in the fu-
ture.

Genesis 21:28

And Abraham stood seven ewes
of the sheep by themselves.

ዐገሠ እኔ ሃያላገኛል ገጌጊገ
ገኛላገሪ ገኔጌጻ ጸሠገሃ

Abe takes seven of the girl sheep and stands them up by themselves.

Genesis 21:29

And Abimelek said to Abraham,
“What are these seven ewes that
you’ve stood by themselves?”

Ḳṯ ሃረሃጊጽፉ ሰሃፉጊፋ
ዐጽሠ ሕጎፉ ሕጎ ሃፉጸጽፉ
ሰሠፉ ሕረፉፉ ጸሠጽ
ሕገፈጽ ጸጽጸፉ

Abimelek’s like “Whatcha doing?”

Genesis 21:30

And he said, “Because you’ll take
these seven ewes from my hand
so that it will be evidence for me
that I dug this well.”

ዐጽሠ ጸፉ ጊሃ ሰሃፉጊፋ
ጊፈጊሃ ዘፆጸ ጸሠጽ
ሕፈዐ ጊረ ሕጊፉጸ ሰፋጽዐጽ
ሰፉጽፉ ጸፉ ጊጸጸጽ ዘ ጊሃ
ጸፉጊፉ

Abe responds “You’ll take these girl sheep. That’ll prove I dug the well.”

Genesis 21:31

On account of this he called that
place Beer-sheba, because the
two of them swore there

ፉፋፉፉ ሃፋፆሃረ ፉፋፆ ጎሃ ረዐ
ፋዐጽሃ ሃሠ ጊሃ ዐጽሠ ሰፉጽ
ሃፉጊሃሠ

On account of this he called the place Beer sheba, for Abe was drunk.

And doing something with seven¹¹¹ female sheep.¹¹²

Genesis 21:32

and made a covenant in
Beer-sheba. And Abimelek and
Phichol, the commander of his
army, got up and went to the
land of the Philistines.

ሰፉጽጽ ጸጊጸጽ ፋጸሃጊፋ
ሃረሃጊጽፉ ሃፆጊፋ ዐጽሠ
ፋጽሠጊፋ ፋጽጸጸ ሰሠ ረሃጊፋ
ሃጊጸሠረጽ ጸፋፉ ረፉ

So that’s the deal.

Then My Father Is King the king, and Mouth Of All, the army commander, got up and went to Palestine.

¹¹¹Lit. ṣeḡalā in the original text.

¹¹²Lit. she— she ḥas in the original text.

Genesis 21:33

And he planted a tamarisk in Beer-sheba and he called the name of YHWH El Olam.

וַיִּטֵּעַ אֲבָרָם אֶת-הַתְּמָרִיט בְּבֵּר-שֶׁבַע וַיִּקְרָא שְׁמֵהּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי עוֹלָם

And he plants a tree in Beer-sheba.

And he called the name of YHWH¹¹³ God Forever.

Genesis 21:34

And Abraham resided in the land of the Philistines many days.

וַיֵּשֶׁב אַבְרָהָם בְּאֶרֶץ פְּלִשְׁתִּים יָמִים רַבִּים

And Abe lived in Palestine for a while.

¹¹³ This is the third of five unexpected appearances of the name YHWH in a source outside J before Exodus 3.

Genesis 22

Genesis 22:1

And it was after these things,
and God tested Abraham. And
He said to him, “Abraham.”
And he said, “I’m here.”

ሦጊያላን ሰዓት ጊዜ ሆኖ
እጁን ሦጊያላን ሆኖ
የገረጸ ሰላሳ ሦስት ሰዓት
ጊዜ ሆኖ ሦስት ሰዓት

After all that, God tests Abraham.

He goes “Abraham!”

And Abe’s like “I’m right here.”

I guess that’s the first test, and he passed.

Now for number two.

Genesis 22:2

And He said, “Take your son,
your only one, whom you love,
Isaac, and go to the land of
Mo-riah and make him a burnt
offering there on one of the
mountains that I’ll say to you.”

እኔ እኔ ሰዓት ሰላሳ
ሰዓት ሰላሳ ሰዓት ሰላሳ
ሰዓት ሰላሳ ሰዓት ሰላሳ
ሰዓት ሰላሳ ሰዓት ሰላሳ
ሰዓት ሰላሳ ሰዓት ሰላሳ
ሰዓት ሰላሳ ሰዓት ሰላሳ
ሰዓት ሰላሳ ሰዓት ሰላሳ

So he says “Take your son”

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: Which son?

(End Midrash)

God: Your only one.

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: I have two sons.

(End Midrash)

God: Who you love.

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: I love them both.

God: Christ Abe...

(End Midrash)

God: Isaac.

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: Ok.

God: Where was I? Oh right. Take Isaac...

(End Midrash)

... and go to the land of YHWH's Choice.

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: Which one did Ya choose?

God: That is the choice Abe. It's called Moriah. It means Ya Choice.

Abe: My choice?

God: No no, Yah's Choice. It's My Choice. It means Moriah. I mean Moriah means that.

Abe: Ok, where in Moriah?

God: Where was I? Oh right. Go there...

(End Midrash)

... to one of the mountains of My Choice

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: Which mountain of your choice?

God: Dammit Abe stop it, I didn't say "of My Choice," that was just to remind you it's in Moriah. It's called a resumptive repetition.

Abe: A resumptive what?

God: Repetition. It's a redactor thing.

Abe: Why red?

God: What?

Abe: Why does the actor have to be red?

God: Redactor Abe, it's like an Editor.

Abe: Why not just call it the Editor?

God: Because E was already taken Abe.

Abe: He was already taken how?

God: E, Abe! The letter E. It stands for the Elohist.

Abe: What's an Elohist?

God: The author of this section Abe. It means the author calls me God.

Abe: I'm not following.

God: See how it's Yellow? That's the Elohist. It's a pun. He's the Yel-lohist.

Abe: What's yellow?

God: The bible Abe, for God's sake.

Abe: What's a b—

God: Abe forget that, back to the point. Take your son.

Abe: Right, Isaac.

God: Go to the land of Ya Choice.

Abe: Right, Moriah.

God: Right.

Abe: To an unspecified mountain.

God: No, it's a specific one.

Abe: You haven't decided yet have you?

God: Of course I have.

Abe: Which one?

God: I'm not telling you yet. It's a specific mountain with a specific name...

(End Midrash)

... that I'll say to you

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: Ok.

God: Repeat it all back to me so I know you're following.

Abe: Take Isaac, go to Moriah, then I wait for you to tell me which mountain to go to, then I go to the mountain, and I think that's as far as we got.

God: Great. Make sense?

Abe: Makes sense so far. Then what?

God: Then

(End Midrash)

make him a burnt offering

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: What kind of burnt offering should I make for him?

God: I didn't say for.

Abe: What?

God: What?

Abe: Can you repeat the instructions?

God: Sure.

Abe: Take Isaac, go to Moriah, figure out which mountain, go there, and then what

God: Then

(End Midrash)

burn him alive.

(Begin Midrash)

Abe: Ok.

(End Midrash)

Genesis 22:3

And Abraham got up early in the morning and harnessed his ass and took his two boys with him and Isaac, his son. And he cut the wood for the burnt offering, and he got up and went to the place that God had said to him.

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ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡḡ

So Abe gets up early in the morning.

He grabs his ass and his two boys.

And Isaac.

He cuts up the wood.

Then he gets up and goes to the place.

Genesis 22:4

On the third day: and Abraham raised his eyes and saw the place from a distance.

ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ

Three days later, Abe looks up.

He sees the place.

Genesis 22:5

And Abraham said to his boys,
“Sit here with the ass; and I and
the boy: we’ll go over there, and
we’ll bow, and we’ll come back to
you.”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So Abe’s like “Wait here. We’ll be back.”

Genesis 22:6

And Abraham took the wood for
the burnt offering and put it on
Isaac, his son, and took the fire
and the knife in his hand. And
the two of them went together.

ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

He makes his son carry the wood.

Abe carries the fire and the knife.

Genesis 22:7

And Isaac said to Abraham, his
father; and he said, “My father.”
And he said, “I’m here, my son.”
And he said, “Here are the fire
and the wood, but where is the
sheep for the burnt offering?”

ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So Isaac’s like “...Dad?”

Abe says “I’m here my son.”

And Isaac’s like “Where’s the sheep?”

Genesis 22:8

And Abraham said, “God will
see to the sheep for the burnt
offering, my son.” And the two
of them went together.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

And Abe goes and I quote...

“God will provide the lamb for the offering my son.”

And commas hadn’t been invented yet so that sentence is as non-associative in the original text as it is here.

It’s like in Oedipus when Oedipus says:

“You should have found the murderer the king a mighty king had been destroyed.”

Got it really great I mean the best writing does stuff like that this that is We got it good.¹¹⁴

Genesis 22:9

And they came to the place that God had said to him. And Abraham built the altar there and arranged the wood, and he bound Isaac, his son, and put him on the altar on top of the wood.

ᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦᑭᑦ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑦᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ

So Abe puts down the firewood and ties up his son and he puts his tied up son on the wood like anyone would.

Genesis 22:10

And Abraham put out his hand and took the knife to slaughter his son.

ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦᑦ
ᑭᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ

And he takes the knife to slaughter his son.

¹¹⁴According to the latest version of The Translator’s Translational Translational Translational (To/ᑭ)(ᑭ)kit, the meaning of the above sentence when rendered into the more familiar orthography of Standard Written Academic Typography is: IDENTIFICATION RECURSION: Maximum stack depth exceeded while building parse tree. Please run `sudo --sudordinal --limit-ordinal ulimit -s ᑭᑭ` to increase the runtime stack size of child processes to the smallest transfinite cardinal. If you intend to cite this error message in a manuscript to be submitted for publication, please cite the work as: IRE of COBA‘AL.©®™ Common Biblically & Akkad‘emically Accurate Language is a registered trademark of BBL’s own BBL One! line of translation and transliteration products and server side services. Babel™ runs on Gen 0b10, where emerge @world takes only 0o111 days! Thank you for choosing BBLᑭᑭᑭᑦᑭᑦ edition. And remember, when our production quality products produce a scarier error message when compiling your compilation than you’ve ever seen before and you run into one or two of the exceptional edge case exceptions and panics and runtime ᑭᑭᑭᑦᑦ written by our world class members, remember: don’t run and don’t panic: Keep Calm and Babylon.”

Genesis 22:11

And an angel of YHWH^a called to him from the skies and said, “Abraham! Abraham!” And he said, “I’m here.”

^aFourth of five. This one’s above my pay grade.

Ἀγγέλῳ ἑνὶ τῶν ἀγγέλων
ἐκ τῶν οὐρανῶν ἔλεγεν
τῷ Ἀβραάμ· Ἀβραάμ· Ἀβραάμ·

An' just then, an angel of Jehovah calls to 'im from the 'eavens loik an angel. An' 'e says to 'im, “Abraham! Abraham!” An' Abraham's, 'e says, “Wot're you on about? I'm roight 'ere, mate!”¹¹⁵

Genesis 22:12

And he said, “Don’t put your hand out toward the boy, and don’t do anything to him, because now I know that you fear LT, and you didn’t withhold your son, your only one, from me.”

ὁ ἄγγελος εἶπεν· Μὴ
ἔξωξ τὴν χεῖρά σου
εἰς τὸν υἱόν σου, ὅτι
ὁ θεὸς ἔγνω· ὅτι φοβῶ
ἐσθὶς τὸν κύριόν σου, ὅτι
οὐκ ἔκρυψας τὸν υἱόν σου
τὸν ἑνὸς σου ἀπὸ ἐμοῦ.

An' 'e says, “Oi! Don't you lay a bloody finger on that lad! Don't do nuffin' to 'im! I can see now you fear God, can't I? You was actually gonna do it! Your own son an' everyfink!”¹¹⁶

Genesis 22:13

And Abraham raised his eyes and saw, and here was a ram behind, caught in the thicket by its horns. And Abraham went and took the ram and made it a burnt offering instead of his son.

ὁ Ἀβραάμ ἤγειρε τὰς ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτοῦ
καὶ ἑώρακέν τι· καὶ ἰδοὺ
ὄρνις ἐκρυβέν ἐν τῷ θάμνῳ
ἐν ὅσῳ ἔστη ὁ υἱός αὐτοῦ· καὶ ἔλαβεν
τὸν ὄρνιν καὶ ἔθηκεν αὐτὸν ὡς
τὸ θυσιάζειν ἀντὶ τοῦ υἱοῦ αὐτοῦ.

So Abraham looks up an' 'ere, wot's this then? There's a ram caught by 'is 'orns in a bush! “Well, that'll do nicely,” says Abraham, an' 'e goes over,

¹¹⁵Lit. /ən dʒəʊs? ðen ən 'eɪndʒəl əv dʒə'hæʊsə kə:lz tə ɪm frəm ði 'evənɪz loɪk ən 'eɪndʒəl ən i sez tə ɪm | 'eɪbrə'am 'eɪbrə'am | ən 'eɪbrə'amz i sez | wɒ? ə ju: ɒn ə'baʊ? | aɪm rɔɪ? ɪə meɪ?/ in the original text, translated here via the Latin alphabet into something roughly like English, for simplicity.

¹¹⁶Lit. /ən i sez | ɔɪ | dʒəʊnʃə leɪ ə 'blɑdi 'fɪŋgər ɒn ðæ? læd | dʒəʊnʃ du: 'nɑfɪn tə ɪm | aɪ kən si: næs jə frə ɡɒd kɑ:n aɪ | jə wəz 'ækfəli 'ɡɒnə du: ɪ? | jər əʊn sʌn ən 'evrɪfɪŋk/ in the original text.

grabs the ram, an' offers it up instead of 'is boy.¹¹⁷

Genesis 22:14

And Abraham called the name of that place “YHWH Yir’eh,” as is said today: “In YHWH’s mountain it will be seen.”

ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ

An' Abraham calls the place “Jehovah'll Sort It,” which is why folks still say, “Up on Jehovah's mountain, 'e'll sort it.”¹¹⁸

Genesis 22:15

And an angel of YHWH called to Abraham a second time from the skies

ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ

Then the angel of Jehovah calls down to Abraham from the 'eavens again.¹¹⁹

Genesis 22:16

and said, “I swear by me —word of YHWH— that because you did this thing and didn’t withhold your son, your only one,

ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

and God’s like:

I swear to you Abe—An' these 'ere are the words o' Jehovah—¹²⁰that because you did this thing, because you didn’t withhold your son, your only one,

¹¹⁷Lit. /səʊ 'eɪbrə,am ləks ʌp ən ɪə | wɒʔs ðɪs ðen | ðeəz ə ræm kɔ:ʔ baɪ ɪz ɔ:nz ɪn ə bɔɪ | wɛl ðæʔəl du: 'naɪsli | seɪ 'eɪbrə,am | ən ɪ ɡəʊz 'æʊvə ɡræbz ðə ræm ən 'ɒfəz ɪʔ ʌp ɪn 'sted əv ɪz bɔɪ/ in the original text.

¹¹⁸Lit. ən 'eɪbrə,am kɔ:lz ðə pleɪs dʒə'hæʊvəl sɔ:ʔ ɪʔ | wɪtʃ ɪz waɪ fəʊks stɪl seɪ | ʌp ɒn dʒə'hæʊvəz 'maʊnɪn | ɪ:l sɔ:ʔ ɪʔ/ in the original text.

¹¹⁹Lit. /ðen ði 'eɪndʒəl əv dʒə'hæʊvə kɔ:lz daʊn tə 'eɪbrə,am frəm ði 'evənz ə'ɡen/ in the original text.

¹²⁰Lit. /ən ði:z ɪə ɑ: ðə wɜ:dz ə dʒə'hæʊvə/ in the original.

Genesis 22:17

that I'll bless you and multiply
your seed like the stars of the
skies and like the sand that's on
the seashore, and your seed will
possess its enemies' gate.

ᐱᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ ᐱᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ

that I'll spread your c^hildren all over the place Abe, for real this time,
I really will.

I'll spread your c^hildren so much it'll break open the door to your en-
emies town and then your c^hildren will rush inside like a rushing river
of c^hildren and drown all your enemies Abe I promise.

Genesis 22:18

And all the nations of the earth
will be blessed through your seed
because you listened to my voice

ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ

And all the nations of the earth are gonna get blessed by your seed just
like that Abe.

Because you listened.

You really listened Abe.

God bless you.

Genesis 22:19

And Abraham went back to his
boys And they got up And went
together to Beer-sheba And
Abraham lived in Beer-sheba

ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ

Then Abraham And Isaac? gets up What about Isaac? and goes back to
his boys.

And they went together to Seven Wells.

And Abe lives in Seven Wells.

Genesis 22:20

And it was after these things, and it was told to Abraham, saying, “Here Milcah has given birth, she also, to sons for your brother Nahor:

וַיִּזְרַח אֵל זָרְחָה זָרְחָה
וַיִּזְרַח אֵל אֲרִיזָה אֶלְכָּה
אֶחָד וַיִּזְרַח אֶלְכָּה אֶחָד
אֶחָד וַיִּזְרַח אֶחָד אֶחָד
אֶחָד וַיִּזְרַח אֶחָד אֶחָד

After all that, someone tells Abe:

Hey, Milcah had the baby.

You’re an uncle Abe.

Genesis 22:21

Uz, his firstborn, and Buz his brother, and Kemuel, the father of Aram,

זָרְחָה אֶחָד וַיִּזְרַח אֶחָד
זָרְחָה אֶחָד וַיִּזְרַח אֶחָד
אֶחָד

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Uz	עוץ	Uncertain. Possibly related to עוץ, “counsel / advise.”
Buz	בוז	“Contempt / despised.” From בזו, “despise.”
Kemuel	קִמּוֹאֵל	Probably “El/God has risen” or “raised by El,” from קום, “rise.”
Aram	אַרָם	Aram / Aramea. Historical etymology uncertain; traditionally associated with רום, “high / exalted.”

Genesis 22:22

and Chesed and Hazo and Pildash and Jidlaph and Bethuel.

אֶחָד אֶחָד אֶחָד אֶחָד
אֶחָד אֶחָד אֶחָד אֶחָד
אֶחָד אֶחָד אֶחָד אֶחָד

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Chesed	כֶּשֶׁד	Probably the eponym of the Chaldeans (<i>Kasdim</i>); original meaning uncertain.
Hazo	חִזוֹ	Probably related to חִזָּה, “see / behold,” perhaps “vision.”
Pildash	פִּלְדָּשׁ	Unknown. Probably a non-Hebrew personal name.
Jidlaph	יִדְלָף	“He drips / weeps.” From יָדַל, “drip.”
Bethuel	בְּתוּאֵל	Probably “dwelling/house of El” or similar; exact etymology disputed.

Genesis 22:23

And Bethuel fathered Rebekah.”
Milcah gave birth to these eight
for Nahor, Abraham’s brother.

אֶת־בְּתוּלָה אֵלֶּיךָ לְרֵכֶז
מִלְכָּה אֵלֶּיךָ אֶת־מִלְכָּה
וְאֶת־נָחֹר אֶת־נָחֹר

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Bethuel	בְּתוּלָה	Probably “dwelling/house of El” or similar; exact etymology disputed.
Rebekah	רֶבֶקָה	Uncertain. Often connected with a root involving binding / tying , perhaps “tether.”
Milcah	מִלְכָּה	“ Queen. ” Feminine of מֶלֶךְ, “king.”
Nahor	נָחֹר	Uncertain. Probably an old Semitic personal name; sometimes connected with a root meaning “snort/breathe heavily,” but insecure.
Abraham	אַבְרָהָם	Traditionally “ father of a multitude, ” from the biblical wordplay <i>av hamon</i> (אָב הָמוֹן); exact historical etymology uncertain.

Genesis 22:24

And his concubine, whose name
was Reumah, she too gave birth,
to Tebah and Gaham and Tahash
and Maacah.

וְאֵת־רְעוּמָה אֵלֶּיךָ לְרֵכֶז
וְאֵת־טֶבַח אֵלֶּיךָ לְרֵכֶז
וְאֵת־גַּחַם אֵלֶּיךָ לְרֵכֶז
וְאֵת־מַעֲכָה אֵלֶּיךָ לְרֵכֶז

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Reumah	רְעוּמָה	Probably “ exalted / raised up, ” from רוּם, “be high.”
Tebah	טֶבַח	“ Slaughter / butchery. ” From טָבַח, “slaughter.”
Gaham	גַּחַם	Unknown / uncertain.
Tahash	תַּחַשׁ	“ Tahash. ” Also the biblical word for an uncertain animal or type of hide used for the Tabernacle; deeper etymology uncertain.
Maacah	מַעֲכָה	Probably “ crushed / pressed, ” from מָעַךְ, “crush, press.”

Editor’s Note: The original manuscript contains here a separate copy of Genesis 22, the character of which is quite different from the rest of the text. We reproduce it here for completeness.

Genesis 22

Genesis 22:1

And it was after these things,
and God tested Abraham. And
He said to him, “Abraham.
Abraham.” And he said, “I’m
here.”

ሂገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ሂገገገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ሂገገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ሂገገገገ

He said to him, “Abraham.” The Greek and Samaritan versions have his name called twice here: “Abraham, Abraham.” This parallels the call by the angel later (v. 11), by which Abraham is stopped from sacrificing Isaac. Thus the instruction to sacrifice him and the instruction to hold back are given equal weight. This also parallels the repetition of Moses’ name in God’s first words to him at the burning bush (Exod 3:4) and the repetition of Samuel’s name the first time God speaks to him (1 Sam 3:10). This appears to be a mark of divine communication at significant moments in the biblical narrative. What stands out about Abraham is that it comes here in the Aqedah rather than the first time that God speaks to him. This marks the near-sacrifice as a defining event in Abraham’s life and in the destiny of his descendants.

Genesis 22:2

And He said, “Take your son,
your only one, whom you love,
Isaac, and go to the land of
Mo-riah and make him a burnt
offering there on one of the
mountains that I’ll say to you.”

ገገገ ገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገ

Take your son, your only one, whom you love, Isaac. If the issue were only a matter of identification, just the name Isaac would have been sufficient; but the issue, we are told explicitly in the first verse of the story, is the test. The fourfold, heartrending identification creates background for all that is to come. Now Abraham’s unquestioning obedience is understood against this background: “your son, your only one, whom you love, Isaac.” The otherwise minor temporal note that “Abraham got up early in the morning” to do the deed becomes a fact worthy of wonder and interpretation against the background of “your son, your only one, whom you love, Isaac.” The notation that he puts the wood for the sacrificial fire on Isaac himself to carry becomes an ironic image. Abraham’s words to the servants who accompany them—”I and the boy: we’ll go over there,

and we'll bow, and we'll come back to you"—become not only enigmatic but emotionally charged. (Does his saying "we'll come back" suggest extraordinary faith? one last hope? Or is it constructed so as not to frighten Isaac?) The words of the dialogue between the father and son become charged by this background as well, as Isaac adds the phrase "my father" in his question addressed to Abraham, and Abraham adds "my son" in each sentence in response. (The words "son" and "father" occur twelve times in the story and are, in almost every case, unnecessary for identification.) The dialogue moreover begins and ends with the words "and the two of them went together," another mundane phrase turned into a remarkable one by what has preceded. Most remarkable of all is the exchange between Abraham and Isaac over the obvious absence of an animal to be sacrificed. Isaac says, "Here are the fire and the wood, but where is the sheep for the burnt offering?" To appreciate the artistry of the wording of Abraham's answer, we must keep in mind that the Hebrew has no punctuation. The text says: "God will see to the sheep for the burnt offering my son"—which can be understood in two ways. The last two words can be read as a touching epithet: "God will see to the sheep for the burnt offering, my son." But they can also be read as a fearful irony: "God will see to the sheep for the burnt offering: My son."—subtly conveying the truth that Isaac himself is to be the sheep for the sacrifice. And so the short passage, which like the entire chapter expresses no emotions explicitly, reads like a tightly packed container whose contents may burst in a moment: And the two of them went together. And Isaac said to Abraham his father; he said, "My father." And he said, "I'm here, my son." And he said, "Here are the fire and the wood, but where is the sheep for the burnt offering?" And Abraham said, "God will see to the sheep for the burnt offering my son." And the two of them went together. The denouement of the story, in which Isaac is spared, is no less charged by all of this expressed and unexpressed background. Indeed, Abraham's feelings (relief? gratitude? reverence? confusion?) are likewise not a part of the narrative. There is rather a reminiscence of the original wording, as God twice says to Abraham that now all is well because "You didn't hold back your son, your only one" (22:12,16; cf. 22:2). As biblical interpreters noted centuries ago, the wording suggests that the reward at the end is in proportion to the difficulty of the test as expressed at the beginning.

Genesis 22:3

And Abraham got up early in the morning and harnessed his ass and took his two boys with him and Isaac, his son. And he cut the wood for the burnt offering, and he got up and went to the place that God had said to him.

ᠠᠫᠠᠨᠠᠭᠠᠨ ᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ
ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ
ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ
ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ
ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ
ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ ᠠᠨᠠᠭᠤᠨ

Who are you by the way?

In what sense?

Abraham got up early in the morning. Abraham fights for the lives of the people of Sodom and Gomorrah but not for the life of Isaac. That is a strange fact itself, and then these two stories are juxtaposed by being placed in the same parashah so that they are regularly read together, which makes the ironic relationship between them even harder to ignore. When God tells Abraham, “The cry of Sodom and Gomorrah: how great it is. And their sin: how very heavy it is. Let me go down, and I’ll see if they’ve done, all told, like the cry that has come to me. And if not, let me know” (18:20–21), Abraham’s response is to be the first human in the Bible’s story to challenge a divine decision. But when God tells him, “Take your son, your only one, whom you love, Isaac ... and offer him as a burnt offering,” the report is: And Abraham got up early in the morning! The text does not tell us what Abraham’s motive is for questioning his God about the fate of Sodom. Is it because his nephew, Lot, lives there? Or is it Abraham’s sense of justice? Or is it his compassion for people who are facing a divine catastrophe? Two of the above? All of the above? Even if it is mainly his concern for Lot, still, that’s a nephew. Isaac is his son! Even if it is his compassion for those morally-challenged people of Sodom, still, there must also be compassion for his son. And if it is his sense of justice, is there less of a case for justice in connection with sacrificing an innocent Isaac than in the matter of the destruction of those very guilty people? One possible answer: The mark of Abraham’s personality is obedience. He will obey anything that his God commands him to do. Leave your land. Leave your birthplace. Leave your father’s house. Circumcise yourself. Even if he is commanded to sacrifice his child, he will do it. There are no arguments or even questions. There is only immediate compliance. But the case of Sodom and Gomorrah is different because in this case Abraham is not commanded to do anything. He is not the one who is to execute judgment on the cities. It is even intriguing that the deity chooses to inform Abraham of the divine concern over the cries from Sodom and Gomorrah in the first place. Whatever reason one imagines for God to tell Abraham about this, the fact is that by informing

Abraham of the divine intention to look into the situation in Sodom and Gomorrah, God opens the door for Abraham to speak up. Commands, on the other hand, leave no room for discussion. A second answer (dbar 'ar): The reason that Abraham speaks up for the more distant relative and for all the unrelated populace of Sodom and Gomorrah but does not speak up for his own son is precisely because it is his own son. He is sufficiently distant from Lot and the populace of Sodom that he is in a position to argue whether their destruction would be just. And so he argues: "Will the judge of all the earth not do justice?!" But in the case of Isaac, he is not what we would call an unbiased observer. He has a personal interest in the case, an intensely personal interest. And, as such, he does not have the same standing to argue the justice or injustice of the case. A third answer (dbar 'ahr): Another possible explanation is that the outcome of the Sodom and Gomorrah matter itself is what causes Abraham to stay silent in the matter of Isaac. In the famous dialogue between God and Abraham over the fate of the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah, the exchange is subtle as God responds not merely to what Abraham says but apparently to what is in Abraham's heart. Thus: when Abraham learns that God means to judge these cities, he says, "Maybe there are fifty virtuous people within the city" (18:24). God responds, "If I find in Sodom fifty virtuous people within the city, then I'll sustain the whole place for their sake" (18:26). Abraham's next bargaining position will be the sparing of the place for forty-five righteous, but he articulates his question in such a way as to make it seem a small request. He does not say "forty-five." He says: Maybe the fifty virtuous people will be short by five. Will you destroy the whole city for the five? To which God replies, "I won't destroy if I find forty-five there." Thus God would appear to be conveying to Abraham that there is not much point to being cagey in one's words when one is arguing with someone who is omniscient. After this, Abraham words his positions more straightforwardly: What if there are forty? thirty? etc. Abraham gets the message that he may as well say directly what is on his mind because that is what is going to be responded to in any case. Even then, Abraham succeeds in getting down to ten. God agrees to sustain the cities for ten virtuous people. But not even ten are to be found, and the cities are destroyed. So even though Abraham's dialogue with God is important in several ways—including: it provides Abraham with an opportunity to articulate the principle of justice for future generations; and it is an important step in the growth of humankind's independence and development of responsibility—the fact remains that nothing is changed for Sodom and Gomorrah by this. Abraham learns that, since God knows what is in one's heart, why argue? Since God knows the situation and its necessary outcome, why speak? After the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, Abraham never argues with God again. Moses will argue with

God, Jonah will, Jeremiah will, but not Abraham. When the creator tells Abraham to listen to Sarah and send Hagar and Ishmael away, “Abraham got up early in the morning” (21:14). When the creator tells him to sacrifice his son, “Abraham got up early in the morning” (22:3). But Abraham’s obedience is what saves Isaac in the end. What an irony: Abraham’s silence over Isaac is more effective than his argument over Sodom and Gomorrah.

Genesis 22:4

On the third day: and Abraham raised his eyes and saw the place from a distance.

ፋወጊኛ ጊወጊሬዋ ሣኅጊያ
ፋፃጊኛ ነጊጎጊዐ ጸፋ ሣጃፃፃፋ
ዋዕፃሣ ሣኅዋሣጃ ጸፋ

A name would be nice.

We can’t here.

Genesis 22:5

And Abraham said to his boys, “Sit here with the ass; and I and the boy: we’ll go over there, and we’ll bow, and we’ll come back to you.”

ሬፋ ሣጃፃፃፋ ፃሣፋጊኛ
ጃጋ ሣሣሬ ነፃወ ነጊፃዐጎ
ፃዐጎጃኛ ጊጎፋኛ ፃኅሣዕጃ ሣዐ
ጃኅዕጸወጎኛ ጃሣ ልዐ ጃሣሬጎ
ሣሣጊሬፋ ጃፃኅወጎኛ

An initial at least?

Most I can do.

Genesis 22:6

And Abraham took the wood for the burnt offering and put it on Isaac, his son, and took the fire and the knife in his hand. And the two of them went together.

ጊጦዐ ጸፋ ሣጃፃፃፋ ዕዋጊኛ
ዋዕጦጊ ሬዐ ሣወጊኛ ጃሬዐጃ
ጸፋ ነፋጊያ ዕዋጊኛ ነጎያ
ጸሬሣፋሣጃ ጸፋኛ ወፋጃ
ነፋዕጊ ሣጃጊጎወ ነሣሬጊኛ

So can you?

Of course

Genesis 22:7

And Isaac said to Abraham, his father; and he said, “My father.” And he said, “I’m here, my son.” And he said, “Here are the fire and the wood, but where is the sheep for the burnt offering?”

ለኛ ዋዘጠጊ ሰሣቴን
ሰሣቴን ነጋጽ ሣጻጻጽ
ጊጊጃ ሰሣቴን ጊጊጽ
ሠኛ ጃጃ ሰሣቴን ጊጊጽ
ጃሠጃ ጃጊኛ ሣጊጠጋጃ
ጃ/ጠ/

Who are you?

What’s in a name

Genesis 22:8

And Abraham said, “God will see to the sheep for the burnt offering, my son.” And the two of them went together.

ሣጊጃ/ኛ ሣጻጻጽ ሰሣቴን
ጃ/ጠ/ ጃሠጃ ነ/ ጃኛጊ
ሣጃጊሠ ነሣ/ጊን ጊጊጽ
ነፋዘጊ

An initial I said.

As in the beginning

Genesis 22:9

And they came to the place that God had said to him. And Abraham built the altar there and arranged the wood, and he bound Isaac, his son, and put him on the altar on top of the wood.

ሰሠኛ ሣነዋሣ ለኛ ነኛጊን
ጊጊጊን ሣጊጃ/ኛ ነ/ ሰሣኛ
ዘጋጋሣ ጸኛ ሣጻጻጽ ሣሠ
ሣጊጠጋጃ ጸኛ ሣፃጠጊን
ነጊጽ ዋዘጠጊ ጸኛ ፈዋጠጊን
ዘጋጋሣ ለጠ ነኛ ሣሠጊን
ሣጊጠጠ/ ለጠሣ

Spit it out.

Not that way

Genesis 22:10

And Abraham put out his hand and took the knife to slaughter his son.

ጸኛ ሣጻጻጽ ዘ/ሠጊን
ጸ/ሣኛሣ ጸኛ ዘዋጊን ነፋጊ
ነጊጽ ጸኛ ጸዘሠ/

What do they call you?

Who are you calling they

Genesis 22:11

And an angel of YHWH called to him from the skies and said, “Abraham! Abraham!” And he said, “I’m here.”

እንዲሁ ገናኝ ሃይለ ተሰጥኝ
ከአለም ላይ ከሰማይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ

The ones who know you.

(Narrator: A curious silence elapses.)

Genesis 22:12

And he said, “Don’t put your hand out toward the boy, and don’t do anything to him, because now I know that you fear LT, and you didn’t withhold your son, your only one, from me.”

እንዲሁ ሃይለ ሃይለ ሃይለ
ከአለም ላይ ከሰማይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ

They usually call me J

Genesis 22:13

And Abraham raised his eyes and saw, and here was a ram behind, caught in the thicket by its horns. And Abraham went and took the ram and made it a burnt offering instead of his son.

እንዲሁ ሃይለ ተሰጥኝ
ከአለም ላይ ከሰማይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ
ከሰማይ ላይ ከሰማይ

You? And that would make you

behind. Some manuscripts read “one” ram, i.e., Hebrew, rather than “be-
hind,” Hebrew. “One” makes plainer sense, but this may very well be
a case that suggests the principle of *lectio difficilior praeferenda est* (the
more difficult reading is preferable). That is, scribes tend to simplify an
unusual reading more often than they make a change that turns a simple
reading into a more difficult one. The matter remains unsolved.

Genesis 22:14

And Abraham called the name of that place “YHWH Yir’eh,” as is said today: “In YHWH’s mountain it will be seen.”

ገሃዊግል ገሠ ገልጻፍ ተጻፆረኅ
ሞተ ልቱረ ልኅረ ተኅልል
ልኅረ ሞላ ገሃዊል ሞተረ
ልቱረ

No way

Now wait.

YHWH Yir’eh. Meaning “YHWH Will See.” (Perhaps it should be pointed as YHWH Yera’eh, “YHWH Will Appear”—which is how it appears later in the same verse.)

Genesis 22:15

And an angel of YHWH called to Abraham a second time from the skies

ሪቱ ልኅረ ገተግ ተጻፆረኅ
ገረገሠል ገግ ጸረገሠ ገልጻፍ

Don’t say—

I can’t, You th—

Genesis 22:16

and said, “I swear by me— word of YHWH— that because you did this thing and didn’t withhold your son, your only one,

ጸጸጸጸጸጸ ጸጸ ሰሃፋጸኅ
ሰሃፋ ጸጸጸ ጸሃ ልኅረ ገተግ
ጸጸጸ ሰጸጸጸ ጸፋ ጸጸጸጸ
ጸፋ ጸጸጸ ጸፋ ጸሃጸጸ ፋሪኅ
ሃጸጸጸጸ

Yeah no one wou—

ink any one wou—

Genesis 22:17

that I’ll bless you and multiply your seed like the stars of the skies and like the sand that’s on the seashore, and your seed will possess its enemies’ gate.

ጸጸጸጸጸጸ ጸሃጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ጸሃ
ሃጸጸጸ ጸፋ ጸጸጸጸ
ሪኅጸጸጸ ሃጸጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸጸጸ
ሃጸጸጸ ጸጸጸ ሪጸ ሰሃፋ
ሰጸጸ ጸፋ ጸጸጸጸ ጸጸጸጸ
ኅጸጸጸጸ

—ld BELIEVE YOU

—LD BELIEVE ME ANYWAY.

Genesis 22:18

And all the nations of the earth
will be blessed through your seed
because you listened to my voice

לך יִבְרָכְךָ כָּל־עַמֵּי־הָאָרֶץ
וְיִשְׂרָאֵל יִבְרָכְךָ וְיִשְׂרָאֵל
וְיִשְׂרָאֵל יִבְרָכְךָ וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

ANYWAY

(Narrator: A knowing silence elapses.)

all the nations of the earth will be blessed through your seed. This is the third occurrence of this promise. (See the comment on Gen 12:3.)

Genesis 22:19

And Abraham went back to his
boys And they got up And went
together to Beer-sheba And
Abraham lived in Beer-sheba

וַיָּשׁוּב אַבְרָהָם אֶל־בָּנָיו
וַיִּשְׁתָּקֶז אֶת־בָּנָיו וַיֵּלְכוּ
יַחְדָּם לְבֵּיר־שֶׁבַע וַיֵּשֶׁב
אַבְרָהָם בְּבֵּיר־שֶׁבַע

Abraham went back to his boys. The text does not mention Isaac going back. (And Abraham had specifically told the boys, “We’ll come back to you.”) Both midrash and critical scholarship have dared to raise the possibility that in one version of the story Abraham actually sacrifices Isaac (discussed in *Who Wrote the Bible?* p. 257). But in the present form of the text itself, Isaac clearly is spared. And that makes this verse extraordinarily powerful. Following the Aqedah, Isaac and Abraham do not go back together. Moreover: following the Aqedah, Isaac and Abraham are never quoted as speaking to each other.

Genesis 22:20

And it was after these things, and
it was told to Abraham, saying,
“Here Milcah has given birth, she
also, to sons for your brother
Nahor:

וַיְהִי אַחֲרָיִךְ אֵלֶּיךָ וְנִשְׁמָע
וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע
וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע
וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע וְנִשְׁמָע

Genesis 22:21

Uz, his firstborn, and Buz his brother, and Kemuel, the father of Aram,	ᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ
---	--

Genesis 22:22

and Chesed and Hazo and Pildash and Jidlaph and Bethuel.	ᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ
---	---

Genesis 22:23

And Bethuel fathered Rebekah.” Milcah gave birth to these eight for Nahor, Abraham’s brother.	ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
---	---

Genesis 22:24

And his concubine, whose name was Reumah, she too gave birth, to Tebah and Gaham and Tahash and Maacah.	ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐅᐭᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐅᐅᐅ
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Genesis 23

Genesis 23:1

And Sarah’s life was a hundred years and twenty years and seven years: the years of Sarah’s life.

וַיְהִי חַיֵּי שָׂרָה מֵאָה
שָׁנָה וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה
וּשְׁבַע שָׁנִים שְׁנֵי חַיֵּי
שָׂרָה׃

And Sarah lives 100 + 20 + 7 years.

That’s how many years she lives.

Genesis 23:2

And Sarah died in Kiriath Arba—it is Hebron—in the land of Canaan. And Abraham came to grieve for Sarah and to weep for her.

וַתָּמָת שָׂרָה בְּקִרְיַת
אַרְבַּע הוּא חֶבְרוֹן
בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן וַיָּבֹא
אַבְרָהָם לִסְפֹּד לְשָׂרָה
וּלְבַכְתָּהּ׃

Sarah dies in City Of Four.

Abraham is sad.

The text mentions that this place is also known as Hebron.

Keep that in mind. It’ll come up again later.

Genesis 23:3

And Abraham got up from in front of his dead, and he spoke to the children of Heth, saying,

וַיָּקָם אַבְרָהָם מֵעַל פָּנָיו
מִתּוֹ וַיְדַבֵּר אֶל בְּנֵי חֵת
לֵאמֹר׃

Abraham gets up and goes to talk to the Hittites, and he says,

Genesis 23:4

“I’m an alien and a visitor with you. Give me a possession for a tomb with you so I may bury my dead from in front of me.”

גֵר וְתוֹשֵׁב אֲנֹכִי עִמָּכֶם
תֵּנוּ לִי אֶחְזִית קֶבֶר
עִמָּכֶם וְאֶקְבְּרָה מֵתִי
מִלְפָּנַי׃

“I’m a foreigner. Just visiting. I need to buy some land to bury my wife.”

Genesis 23:5

And the children of Heth answered Abraham, saying to him,

וַיַּעֲנוּ בְנֵי חֵת אֶת
אַבְרָהָם לֵאמֹר לוֹ׃

The Hittites respond,

Genesis 23:6

“Listen to us, my lord. You’re a chieftain of God among us. Bury your dead in the choice of our tombs. Not a man of us will hold back his tomb from you, from burying your dead.”

שָׁמְעֵנוּ אֲדֹנָי נָשִׂיא
אֱלֹהִים אַתָּה בְּתוֹכֵנוּ
בְּמִבְחָר קְבָרֵינוּ קֶבֶר
אֶת מֵתְךָ אִישׁ מִמֶּנּוּ אֶת
קְבָרוֹ לֹא יִכְלֶה מִמֶּךָ
מִקְבֹּר מֵתְךָ׃

“Listen, you’re a big powerful man around here. Bury her wherever you want.”

Genesis 23:7

And Abraham got up and bowed to the people of the land, to the children of Heth,

וַיָּקָם אַבְרָהָם וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ
לְעַם הָאָרֶץ לְבְנֵי חֵת׃

Abe bows to the Hittites,

Genesis 23:8

and he spoke with them, saying,
“If it’s acceptable to you to bury
my dead from in front of me,
listen to me, and intercede for
me with Ephron, son of Zohar,

וַיְדַבֵּר אֹתָם לֵאמֹר אִם
יֵשׁ אֶת נַפְשְׁכֶם לְקַבֵּר
אֶת מֵתִי מִלִּפְנֵי שְׁמֻעוֹנִי
וּפְנֹעוּ לִי בְעֶפְרוֹן בֶּן
צֹחַר׃

and he says “If you don’t mind, can you get in touch with Dusty Place, son
of Brilliance for me?

Genesis 23:9

that he’ll give me the cave of
Machpelah which he has, that
is at the edge of his field. For
full price let him give it to me
among you as a possession for a
tomb.”

וַיִּתֵּן לִי אֶת מְעָרַת
הַמַּכְפֵּלָה אֲשֶׁר לוֹ אֲשֶׁר
בְּקִצֵּה שְׂדֵהוּ בְּכֶסֶף
מָלֵא יִתְּנָה לִי בְּתוֹכְכֶם
לְאַחֲזֹת קֶבֶר׃

I’m thinking the cave of Machpelah.

I’ll pay full price.

Genesis 23:10

And Ephron was sitting among
the children of Heth, and
Ephron, the Hittite, answered
Abraham in the ears of the
children of Heth, for all who
were coming to his city’s gate,
saying,

וְעֶפְרוֹן יֹשֵׁב בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי
חֵת וַיַּעַן עֶפְרוֹן תְּחִתִּי
אֶת אַבְרָהָם בְּאָזְנֵי בְנֵי
חֵת לְכָל בָּאֵי שַׁעַר
עִירוֹ לֵאמֹר׃

So Dusty is sitting with the Hittites.

He answers Abe in a place where everybody overhears, saying

Genesis 23:11

“No, sir. Listen to me: I’ve given the field to you, and I’ve given the cave that’s in it to you. I’ve given it to you before the eyes of the children of my people. Bury your dead.”

לֹא אֶדְבָר אֲדַבֵּר שְׁמָעֵנִי הַשָּׂדֶה
נָתַתִּי לָךְ וְהַמְעָרָה אֲשֶׁר
בּוֹ לָךְ נְתַתִּיהָ לְעֵינַי בְּנֵי
עַמִּי נְתַתִּיהָ לָךְ קֶבֶר
מִתָּדָ:

I’ve given you the field Abe, the field and the cave too, you drive a hard bargain, you sneaky prequel of a jew.

Genesis 23:12

And Abraham bowed in front of the people of the land,

וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ אַבְרָהָם לְפָנֵי
עַם הָאָרֶץ:

Abe bows.

Genesis 23:13

and he spoke to Ephron in the ears of the people of the land, saying, “Just if you’ll listen to me: I’ve given the money for the field. Take it from me so I may bury my dead there.”

וַיְדַבֵּר אֶל עֶפְרוֹן בְּאָזְנֵי
עַם הָאָרֶץ לֵאמֹר אֵךְ
אִם אַתָּה לוֹ שְׁמָעֵנִי
נָתַתִּי כֶסֶף הַשָּׂדֶה קַח
מִמֶּנִּי וְאִקְבְּרָה אֶת מֵתִי
שָׁמָּה:

And then Abe says to Dusty in a place where everyone overhears:

I’ve given you the money, take it please do not fight. You drive a hard bargain too you son of a Hittite.

Genesis 23:14

And Ephron answered Abraham, saying to him,

וַיַּעַן עֶפְרוֹן אֶת אַבְרָהָם
לֵאמֹר לוֹ:

Dusty responds,

Genesis 23:15

“Sir, listen to me. Land worth four hundred shekels of silver: what’s that between me and you?! And bury your dead.”

אֲדֹנִי שְׁמַעֲנִי אֶרֶץ
אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שֶׁקֶל כֶּסֶף
בֵּינִי וּבֵינְךָ מָה הוּא וְאֵת
מֵתְךָ קָבֵר׃

I like how you do business Abe, you’re a good friend of mine too. What’s four hundred shekels between two friends like me and you?¹²¹.

Genesis 23:16

And Abraham listened to Ephron, and Abraham weighed out to Ephron the money that he had spoken in the ears of the children of Heth: four hundred shekels of silver, at the merchant’s current rate.

וַיִּשְׁמַע אַבְרָהָם אֶל
עֶפְרוֹן וַיִּשְׁקַל אַבְרָהָם
לְעֶפְרוֹן אֶת הַכֶּסֶף אֲשֶׁר
דִּבֶּר בְּאָזְנֵי בְנֵי חֵת
אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שֶׁקֶל כֶּסֶף
עֹבֵר לַסֹּחֵר׃

Abe weighs the money.

Genesis 23:17

And Ephron’s field that was in Machpelah, which faces Mamre, the field and the cave that was in it and every tree that was in the field, that was in all of its border all around, was established

וַיִּקָּם שָׂדֵה עֶפְרוֹן אֲשֶׁר
בְּמַכְפֶּלֶה אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵי
מַמְרֵא הַשָּׂדֶה וְהַמְעָרָה
אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ וְכָל הָעֵץ אֲשֶׁר
בַּשָּׂדֶה אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל גְּבֻלוֹ
סָבִיב׃

And Dusty’s field is now Abe’s.

¹²¹Good question Dusty. Four hundred shekels is roughly: 33–67 years of labor at the average wage. Or 17–33 years of labor for a skilled worker. Or 72,000–120,000 liters (45–70 metric tons) of barley. Or 200–800 sheep or goats. Or 25–80 cattle. Or 13–40 donkeys. Or 13–40 slaves. Or dozens of modest houses. Or a substantial agricultural estate. In summary, they’re bullshitting here. Or if you prefer, bargaining. Nothing unusual. It’s an ANE thing.

Genesis 23:18

for Abraham as a purchase in the eyes of the children of Heth, among all who were coming to his city's gate.

לְאַבְרָהָם לְמִקְנָה לְעֵינֵי
בְנֵי חֵת בְּכָל בָּאֵי שַׁעַר
עִירוֹ:

And everyone in town saw the purchase, so nobody better try to dispute this later.

They all saw it.

This verse is basically a receipt.

Genesis 23:19

And after that Abraham buried Sarah, his wife, at the cave of the field of Machpelah, facing Mamre—it is Hebron—in the land of Canaan.

וְאַחֲרֵי כֵן קָבַר אַבְרָהָם
אֶת שָׂרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ אֶל
מְעַרַת שְׂדֵה הַמַּכְפֵּלָה
עַל פְּנֵי מַמְרֵא הוּא
חֶבְרוֹן בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן:

Abe buries Sarah in the cave of Machpelah.

Then the text reminds the reader this is Hebron again.

Genesis 23:20

And the field and the cave that was in it were established for Abraham as a possession for a tomb from the children of Heth.

וַיָּקָם הַשְּׂדֵה וְהַמְעָרָה
אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ לְאַבְרָהָם
לְאַחֲזֹת קֶבֶר מֵאֵת בְּנֵי
חֵת:

Then the text reminds us that he bought it fair and square.

Note: Recall from the earlier chapters that YHWH's promises to Abraham have included not just the promise of spreading his seed, but also the repeated promise to give him the entire land of Canaan. Despite that, it appears that Abraham doesn't even own anywhere to bury his wife. Nobody's perfect.

Genesis 24

Genesis 24:1

And Abraham was old, well along in days, and YHWH had blessed Abraham in everything.

ኦጵ ሃዋጊ ማጻጻፍኑ
ተኣ ሃላፍ ጸሃጸፒኑ ማጊማጊፍ
ረኃፍ ማጻጻፍ

Abe was old.

YHWH had always liked him.

Genesis 24:2

And Abraham said to his servant, the elder of his house, who was in charge of all that he had, “Place your hand under my thigh,

ረኣ ማጻጻፍ ላማኣፒኑ
ረሠማጸ ሃተጊፍ ሃዋጊ ሃላፍዐ
ኣኑ ማጊሠ ሃረ ላሠኣ ረኃፍ
ጊሃላፒ ተዘተ ሃላፒ

And Abe goes to his employee, one of the senior ones, sort of a live-in asset manager. Basically his COO.

And Abe says “Put your hand under my thigh,

Genesis 24:3

and I’ll have you swear by YHWH, God of the skies and God of the earth, that you won’t take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanite among whom I live,

ጊጸረኣ ጸሃጸጊፍ ሃዐጊፍሠኣኑ
ሦላኣጸ ጊጸረኣኑ ማጊማሠጸ
ጊነፍረ ጸሠኣ ዘዋተ ኣረ ላሠኣ
ላሠኣ ጊነዐነሃጸ ተሃነፍማ
ሃፍላዋፍ ፍሠሃፒ ጊሃነኣ

swear me a testimony, testify in the name of the Lords¹²² name namely YHWH, God of the skies and God of the earth.¹²³

Genesis 24:4

but you’ll go to my land and my birthplace and take a wife for my son, for Isaac.”

ረኣኑ ጊሦላኣ ረኣ ጊሃ
ተዘዋረኑ ሃረተ ጊተላረኑማ
ዋዘሦፒረ ጊነፍረ ጸሠኣ

Go back to my hometown and get a wife for my son.

¹²²Lit. Baals in the original.
¹²³The use of both YHWH and God in this verse is not typical of any of the book’s authors prior to Exodus 3-6, and may have been added by the redactor for some unknown reason.

It's not clear why Abe is sending this guy and not Isaac.

Perhaps because Isaac is either traumatized (in J) or dead (in E) at this point.

To be clear, this is entirely speculative and we have absolutely no concrete evidence of this.

Unrelated Note: Isaac never shows up in the E source again.

Moving on.

Genesis 24:5

And the servant said to him,
“Maybe the woman won’t be
willing to follow me to this land.
Shall I take back your son to the
land you came from?”

ላዕባ ሃገረኛ ላግቶጊሃ
ጳውላን ጳዕተ ቀረ ጊሃኛ
ኮላኛ ረኛ ጊዳዳ ተሃረረ
ተኛ ያጊሃኛ ያሠጸ ተረገጸ
ላሃኛ ኮላኛ ረኛ ሃገሃ
ሃሃሃ ተረኮጊ

So Abe’s guy is like “What if I find a girl, and she’s down to marry him, but not willing to relocate, should I bring Isaac over there to her?”

Now we can see why Abe put this guy in charge of all his stuff.

He thinks ahead, this guy.

Genesis 24:6

And Abraham said to him,
“Watch yourself, that you don’t
take my son back there.

ሃጸላዕኛ ሃገረኛ ላግቶጊሃ
ተኛ ያጊሃተ ሃገ ሃረ ላግሃጸ
ጳሃሃ ጊሃጸ

Abe’s like “Watch yourself. Don’t you take my son back there.”

Genesis 24:7

YHWH, God of the skies, who
took me from my father’s house
and from the land of my birth and
who spoke to me and who swore
to me, saying, ‘I’ll give this land to
your seed,’ He’ll send His angel
ahead of you, and you shall take a
wife for my son from there.

ሃጊሃሃጸ ጊላረኛ ጳሃጸጊ
ጊዳኛ ተጊዳሃ ጊሃዐቀረ ላሃኛ
ላሃኛሃ ጊተላረሃሃ ኮላኛሃሃ
ጊረ ዐዳሃሃ ላሃኛሃ ጊረ ላዕላ
ተኛ ሃተኛ ሃዐላጊረ ላግቶረ
ዐረሃጊ ኦሃጸ ተረገጸ ኮላኛ
ተዐቀረሃ ሃጊሃገረ ሃጸኦረሃ
ሃሃሃ ጊሃጸረ ጳሃኛ

He goes on for awhile about YHWH and the seed thing.

Not clear if the employee’s hand is still under his thigh here.

Some things are best left unspecified.

Genesis 24:8

And if the woman won’t be willing to go after you, then you’ll be freed from this oath of mine. Only you are not to take my son back there.”

እሠፋኛ እጻፋተ ፋረ ሣፋሃ
ተገባሃሃ ሃገላይፋ ተሃረረ
ተፋ ቀላ ተፋገ ገተዐጻሠሣ
እሣሠ ጻሠተ ፋረ ገሃፍ

Abe says if you find a girl but she’s not willing to relocate, you’ll still get credit for having completed the job. Just promise you won’t take Isaac back there.

Abe seems to really not like Ur.

Then again, he likes the people there.

And that’s the opposite of Canaan.

This place he likes, just not the people here.

Abe’s a complicated man.

Genesis 24:9

And the servant placed his hand under his lord Abraham’s thigh and swore to him about this thing.

ሃላጊ ተፋ ላጻዐኛ ሣሠጊሃ
ሣእላጻፋ ሃላጊ ተይተ
ረዐ ሃረ ዐጻሠጊሃ ሃጊሃላፋ
እገኝ ላጻላኝ

Ok that clears up the hand situation.

It wasn’t there yet.

Now it is.

Genesis 24:10

And the servant took ten camels of his lord’s camels and went, and all of his lord’s best things were in his hand. And he got up and went to Aram Naharaim, to the city of Nahor,

እላሠዐ ላጻዐኛ ዘቀጊሃ
ሃጊሃላፋ ገረሣገሣ ሣገረሣገ
ሃጊሃላፋ ጻሃ⊕ ረሃሃ ሃረጊሃ
ረፋ ሃረጊሃ ሣቀጊሃ ሃላጊፍ
ላገዐ ረፋ ሣገላእሃ ሣላፋ
ላሃይሃ

Abe’s guy takes ten camels of Abe’s camels.

He takes all his best things too.

Then he gets up.

He goes to Highland of the Two Rivers, to the city of Snorting.

Genesis 24:11

and he had the camels kneel
outside the city at the water well
at evening time, the time that the
women went out to draw water.

ᲚᲚᲑᲚ ᲚᲚᲚᲚᲚ ᲚᲚᲚᲚ
ᲚᲚᲚᲚ ᲚᲚᲚ ᲚᲚ ᲚᲚ ᲚᲚᲚᲚ
ᲚᲚᲚ ᲚᲚᲚ ᲚᲚᲚ ᲚᲚᲚ
ᲚᲚᲚᲚᲚ

Alright, a bit of background:

Any time you want to meet girls in the ancient near east, go to a well.

Apparently fetching water is a thing that only young girls do.

And they're all attractive and available.

And there's a specific time of day they do it.

And they're all virgins and they're all down to share you with some number of other wives and they pretty much all take it as a given that you'll all live together in essentially one room and get them pregnant nonstop for like a hundred or so years because, well, lifespans and fertility windows are pretty wild up in here.

And the effect is so strong that sometimes in the bible when a girl's not feeling well she just up and runs off and goes and sits by a well.

Long story short, any time you go to a well in the bible, you end up with a wife.

Only exception to this law is that two out of three times you end up with several wives.

Like eventually I mean.

One girl at a time, at first, when you meet, then multiple at once once they're moved in for the coming century.

Look I'm just saying polygamy requires patience.

It being the cultural default doesn't mean you don't still get yelled at. That's just gonna happen. A lot.

That's something you're gonna have to just accept. Suck it up and deal with it.

Abe got yelled at in 16:5 for doing what his wife told him to do in 16:1.

... anyways not saying it's a BETTER LIFE FOR EVERYONE INVOLVED AT ALL TIMES compared to our more modern equitable system of monogamy and nuclear families with between 0.75 and 0.40 children per person on

average and no nearby extended kin network to help out on the one hand, or a venture backed algorithm driven mating system which when mixed with the timeless ancient and highly understandable female psychology of hypergamy and then stirred all together into a chemical cocktail by the shaking hands of lonely isolated desperation leads unsurprisingly via the basic laws of chemistry to an unstable isotope of mating and dating known as poly-without-even-the-basic-requirement-of-gamy which is (1) highly basic as can be gathered from the name and (2) a brownish sort of liquid that winds up mostly on the sheets.

Genesis 24:12

And he said, “YHWH, God of my lord Abraham, make something happen in front of me today and show kindness to my lord Abraham:

ገገረኛ ጸሃጸገ ላግጽገሃ
ኣሃ ጸላዋጸ ግጸላጸኛ ገሃላኛ
ላቐይ ጸሠዐሃ ግሃገጸ ገሃገረ
ግጸላጸኛ ገሃላኛ ግዐ

So the reaction after all that is more or less

“Lord. God. O’ my lord. A bra. Ha... m... make something happen in front of me today. And show kindness to... My lord... A bra. Ha. M...”

Spelling and punctuation varies between manuscripts.

Genesis 24:13

Here I am, standing over the spring of water, and the daughters of the people of the city are going out to draw water.

ሃገዐ ረዐ ዓላሃ ገሃሃኛ ጸሃጸ
ገሠሃኛ ተሃሃዓሃ ግገግጸ
ግገግ ዓፋሠረ ተፋላገ ላገዐጸ

We’ve sort of been over this.

Genesis 24:14

And let it be that the girl to whom I’ll say, ‘Tip your jar so I may drink,’ and she’ll say, ‘Drink, and I’ll water your camels, too,’ she’ll be the one you’ve pointed out for your servant, for Isaac, and I’ll know by this that you’ve shown kindness to my lord.”

ላግጽ ላሠኛ ላዐሃጸ ጸገጸሃ
ሃላሃ ኣሃ ገ፱ጸ ጸገረኛ
ጸተሠ ጸላግኣሃ ጸተሠኣሃ
ጸተኛ ጸዋሠኛ ሃገረግገ ግገሃ
ዋይላገረ ሃላዓዐረ ተይሃጸ
ላቐይ ተገሠዐ ገሃዐላኛ ጸዓሃ
ገሃላኛ ግዐ

They’re still looking for a girl.

Genesis 24:15

And he had not even finished speaking, and here was Rebekah—who was born to Bethuel son of Milcah, wife of Nahor, Abraham’s brother—coming out, and her jar was on her shoulder.

እረጎ ማላ፬ ፋሃፓ ጊጓጊሃ
ተፋሾጊ ጓዋዓላ ጓሃጓሃ ላዓላረ
ነዓ ረፋሃተዓረ ጓላረጊ ላሠፋ
ጊፀፋ ላሃፀነ ተሠፋ ጓሃረማ
ጓማሃሠ ረዐ ጓላሃሃ ማጓላዓፋ

See? Told ya.

Genesis 24:16

And the girl was very good-looking, a virgin, and no man had known her. And she went down to the spring and filled her jar and went up.

ላፋማ ጓፋላማ ተዓ፬ ላዐነጓሃ
ጓዐላጊ ፋረ ሠጊፋሃ ጓረሃተዓ
ፋረማተሃ ጓሃጊዐጓ ላላተሃ
ረዐተሃ ጓላሃ

I’m gonna be a gentleman here and not rub it in.

Genesis 24:17

And the servant ran toward her and said, “Give me a little water from your jar.”

ጓተፋላዋረ ላዓዐጓ ሾላጊሃ
ፋሃ ጊሃጊፋጊማገፓ ላማፋጊሃ
ሃላሃማ ማጊማ ፬ዐማ

Not a great opener.

Genesis 24:18

And she said, “Drink, my lord,” and she hurried and lowered her jar on her arm and let him drink.

ጊሃላፋ ጓተሠ ላማፋተሃ
ረዐ ጓላሃ ላላተሃ ላጓማተሃ
ሃጓዋሠተሃ ጓላጊ

It works anyway.

Genesis 24:19

And she finished letting him drink, and she said, “I’ll draw water for your camels, too, until they finish drinking.”

ላማፋተሃ ሃተዋሠጓረ ረሃተሃ
ላዐ ዓፋሠፋ ሃጊረማገረ ማገ
ተተሠረ ሃረሃ ማፋ

Well well, look at that.

Genesis 24:20

And she hurried and emptied her jar into the trough and ran again to the well to draw water, and she drew water for all his camels.

ለቶ ጸላጽ ላዐተሃ ላጸኝተሃ
ለቶ ላሳዐ ሥላተሃ ተቀሠጸ
ዓፋኝተሃ ዓፋኝረ ላፋዓጸ
ሃገረኝገ ረኝረ

Like a moth to a flame.

Genesis 24:21

And the man, astonished at her, was keeping quiet so as to know if YHWH had made his trip successful or not.

ጻረ ጸፋተኝኝ ሠገፋጸሃ
ዘገረኝጸጸ ተዐላረ ሠገላዘኝ
ፋረ ኝፋ ሃጽላላ ጸሃጸገ

The guy’s not used to having this much success so quickly.

Genesis 24:22

And it was when the camels finished drinking: and the man took a gold ring—its weight was a beqa—and two bracelets for her arms—their weight was ten of gold.

ሃረኝ ላሠፋኝ ገጸገረሃ
ዘቀገረሃ ተሃተሠረ ኝገረኝገጸ
ዐቀዓ ዓጸገ ኝገረሃ ሠገፋጸ
ኝገላገኝኝ ገሃሠሃ ሃረቀሠኝ
ዓጸገ ጸላሠዐ ጸገላገ ረዐ
ኝረቀሠኝ

She’s clearly down but he’s still nervous so he gives her some jewelry just in case.

Genesis 24:23

And he said, “Tell me, whose daughter are you? Is there a place at your father’s house for us to spend the night?”

ተፋ ገኝ ተዓ ላኝፋገረሃ
ተገዓ ሠገጸ ገረ ፋሃ ገላገገጸ
ሃገረረ ሃሃረ ኝሃቀኝ ጽገዓፋ

He’s like “Who’s your daddy? Can I sleep over?”

Not a great line my dude.

Genesis 24:24

And she said to him, “I’m a daughter of Bethuel, Milcah’s son whom she bore to Nahor.”

ተዓ ሃገረቱ ላግቶትሃ
እጎረግ ሃያ ገንጎቱ ረቀሃተዓ
ላሃይገረ እላረገ ላሠቱ

But she plays along anyway.

I’m telling you. Wells.

Genesis 24:25

And she said to him, “We also have plenty of both straw and fodder, also a place to spend the night.”

ሃያተ ሃገ ሃገረቱ ላግቶትሃ
ሃገ ሃሃሃዐ ዓላ ቱሃገቹሃ ሃገ
ሃሃረረ ሃሃቀሃ

And she’s like yeah you can stay over.

Genesis 24:26

And the man knelt and bowed to YHWH

ሃይተሠጊሃ ሠጊቱእ ላቀጊሃ
እሃእገረ

He bends over.

Genesis 24:27

and said, “Blessed is YHWH, God of my lord Abraham, whose kindness and faithfulness have not left my lord. I: YHWH has led me to the house of my lord’s brother.”

እሃእገ ሃሃላዓ ላግቶጊሃ
ሃእላዓቱ ጊሃላቱ ገእረቱ
ሃላቹይ ዓገዐ ቱረ ላሠቱ
ጊሃላቱ ሃዐሃ ሃተሃቱሃ
እሃእገ ጊሃይሃ ሃላላዓ ጊጎሃቱ
ጊሃላቱ ጊይቱ ተጊዓ

He’s like slobberingly grateful.

Genesis 24:28

And the girl ran and told her mother’s household about these things.

ተጊዓረ ላገተሃ ላዐሃእ ጊሃተሃ
እረቱእ ሃጊላዓላሃ እሃቱ

The girl goes and tells her mom.

You’ve gotta love this book.

Genesis 24:29

And Rebekah had a brother, and his name was Laban, and Laban ran outside to the man, at the spring.

ሃፍረ ሃግሠሃ ዘቀ ጳዎዓሊሃ
ሠጊቀኝ ረቀ ሃፍረ ሥላሚሃ
ሃጊዐኝ ረቀ ጳሥሃዘኝ

Ok so we’ve gotten a bit behind on the etymology side of things.

The girl’s name’s Rebecca. Her name means To Bind or Secured.

Cuz obviously, the deal was secured before what’s his face even started talking.

And on top of that, her name means “Binding,” which isn’t a bad name for the wife of Isaac.

This girl’s got it all.

Now she also has a brother.

His name is Laban, which means White.

That doesn’t make sense yet, but remember it anyway.

We’ll need that fact eventually.

Moving on.

Genesis 24:30

And it was when he saw the ring and the bracelets on his sister’s hands and when he heard his sister Rebekah’s words, saying, “The man spoke like this to me.” And he came to the man, and here he was standing by the camels at the spring.

ሠጊሃኝ ተቀ ተቀላጎ ጊጓጊሃ
ጊላጊ ረዐ ሠጊላሠሥኝ ተቀሃ
ተቀ ሃዐሠሠላሃ ሃተዘቀ
ሃተዘቀ ጳዎዓሊ ጊላዓላ
ጊረቀ ላዓላ ጳጎ ላሠቀረ
ሠጊቀኝ ረቀ ቀዓጊሃ ሠጊቀኝ
ሠጊረሠገላኝ ረዐ ላሠዐ ጳሃጳሃ
ሃጊዐኝ ረዐ

He sees the jewelry.

Genesis 24:31

And he said, “Come, blessed one of YHWH. Why do you stand outside when I’ve prepared the house and a place for the camels!”

ሃሃላዓ ቀሃዓ ላሠቀጊሃ
ሥሃዘዓ ላሠዐተ ጳሠረ ጳሃጳጊ
ተጊዓኝ ጊተጊሃጎ ጊጎሃቀሃ
ሠጊረሠገረ ሠሃዎሠሃ

He tells the guy to come.

Then he tells him to come inside.

Genesis 24:32

And the man came to the house and unloaded the camels and gave straw and fodder to the camels and water to wash his feet and the feet of the people who were with him.

ጳተደጻ ሠረፉጻ ፋደረሃ
ነተረሃ ማረረማገጻ ዘተገረሃ
ማረረማገረ ፋሃገቹማሃ ነፃተ
ሃረረገላ ሶዘላረ ማረማሃ
ላሠፉ ማረሠነፉጻ ረረገላሃ
ሃተፉ

He comes inside.

Then everyone's a bit dirty so they wash off.

Genesis 24:33

And [bread] was set in front of him to eat. And he said, "I won't eat until I've said what I have to say." And he said, "Speak."

[ማሠሃረሃ] (ማሠረረሃ)
ላማፉረሃ ረሃፉረ ሃረነገረ
ረተላደላ ማፉ ላዐ ረሃፉ ፉረ
ላደላ ላማፉረሃ ረላደላ

Qere Ketiv.

He gets bread.

Then he says he won't eat.

He wants to talk first.

Genesis 24:34

And he said, "I am Abraham's servant.

ማጳላደፉ ላደዐ ላማፉረሃ
ረሃነፉ

He identifies himself as a servant.

Genesis 24:35

And YHWH has blessed my lord very much, and he has become great. And He has given him a flock and oxen and silver and gold and male and female servants and camels and asses.

ረነላፉ ተፉ ሃላደ ጳሃጳረሃ
ሃረ ነተረሃ ረላገረሃ ላፉማ
ደጳረሃ ገቹሃሃ ላዐደሃ ነፉሶ
ማረረማገሃ ተዘገሠሃ ማላደዐሃ
ማረላማዘሃ

He's like my boss is great, he has:

- 1. A bunch of flock & ox &
- 2. Silver and gold.
- 3. Male servants.
- 4. ϕ.
- 5. Male servants.
- 6. Humps you can ride.
- 7. Asses.

Genesis 24:36

And my lord’s wife Sarah gave birth to a son by my lord in her old age, and he has given him everything that he has.

ጊሃላቱ ተሠቶ ጸላሠ ላረተሃ
ጸተሃዋጊ ጊላዘቱ ጊሃላቱረ ሃፅ
ሃረ ላሠቱ ረጎ ተቶ ሃረ ሃተጊሃ

He even got a girl pregnant.
It took awhile but he did.

Genesis 24:37

And my lord had me swear, saying, ‘You shall not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanite in whose land I live,

ላሣቱረ ጊሃላቱ ጊሃዐዳሠጊሃ
ጊሃፅረ ጸሠቱ ዘዋተ ቶረ
ላሠቱ ጊሃዐሃጎጸ ተሃሃፅሣ
ሃሾላቶዓ ዓሠጊ ጊጎሃቱ

Also he hates the locals.

Genesis 24:38

but you shall go to my father’s house and to my family and take a wife for my son.’

ጎረተ ጊዓቶ ተጊዓ ረቶ ቶረ ሣቶ
ተዘዋረሃ ጊተዘገሠሣ ረቶሃ
ጊሃፅረ ጸሠቱ

He told me to come here to where his dad’s from and get his son a wife.

Genesis 24:39

And I said to my lord, ‘Maybe the woman won’t follow me.’

ቶረ ጊረቶ ጊሃላቱ ረቶ ላሣቶሃ
ጊላዘቱ ጸሠቶጸ ጎረተ

He’s like “And I even said to him What if she doesn’t come?”

Genesis 24:40

And he said to me, ‘YHWH, before whom I have walked, will send His angel with you and make your trip successful, and you shall take a wife for my son from my family and from my father’s house.

ላሠቁ ሕሃብጊ ጊረቁ ላሠቁጊሃ
 ዘረሠጊ ሃጊጎገረ ጊተጎረታተታ
 ዘጊረሶታሃ ጎተቁ ሃጎቁረሣ
 ጊጎታረ ታሠቁ ተዘቀረሃ ጎጎላላ
 ጊታቁ ተጊታሣሃ ጊተዘገሠሣ

He goes on for a while.

Genesis 24:41

Then you’ll be freed from my oath: when you’ll come to my family, and if they won’t give her to you, then you’ll be free from my oath.’

ጊጎ ጊተረቁሣ ሕቀሃተ ጊቁ
 ሣቁሃ ጊተዘገሠሣ ረቁ ፋሃታ
 ጊቀሃ ተጊጊታሃ ጎረ ሃሃተጊ ፋረ
 ጊተረቁሣ

He’s now reading them the terms and conditions of his employment contract in full.

Not tactful.

Genesis 24:42

And I came to the spring today and I said, ‘YHWH, God of my lord Abraham, if you’re making my trip on which I’m going successful,

ሃጊዐታ ረቁ ሣሃጊታ ፋታቁሃ
 ጊታረቁ ሕሃብጊ ላሠቁሃ
 ጎሠጊ ሣቁ ሣታላታቁ ጊጎላቁ
 ላሠቁ ጊጎላላ ዘጊረሶሣ ፋሃ
 ሕጊረዐ ጎረታ ጊጎሃቁ

He’s now describing what he said to YHWH earlier today.

Genesis 24:43

here I am, standing at the spring of water, and let it be that the young woman who goes to draw water and I say to her, “Let me drink a little water from your jar,”

ሃጊዐ ረዐ ቃሶሃ ጊጎሃቁ ሕሃታ
 ሕሣረዐታ ሕጊታሃ ሣጊሣ
 ጊተላሣቁሃ ቃቁሠረ ተቁሶጊታ
 ተዐሣ ፋሃ ጊጎጊቀሠታ ሕጊረቁ
 ጎላጎሣ ሣጊሣ

Here he’s reminding them that he reminded YHWH about where he was earlier in the day.

I think the point of this is to tell them that what happened was exactly what was supposed to happen when he finds the right girl.

Not for himself.

For Isaac.

Who’s not here for some reason.

Not a lot of men in the story thus far.

Genesis 24:44

and she says to me, “Both drink yourself and I’ll draw water for your camels, too,” she will be the woman whom YHWH has designated for my lord’s son.’	የተቀ ማገ ገረቱ የላማቱ ሃገረማገረ ማገሃ የተሠ ላሠቱ የሠቱን ቀሃን ያቀሠቱ ጊሃላቱ ሃፍረ የሃንገገ ዘገሃን
--	--

More post-hoc explanation of the prediction of the Great Event of that one time he met a girl who gave him water.

Genesis 24:45

I hadn’t even finished speaking in my heart, and here was Rebekah coming out, and her jar was on her shoulder, and she went down to the spring and drew water. And I said to her, ‘Give me a drink.’	ላዓላረ የረሃቱ ማላ፬ ጊሃቱ የዋዓላ የሃንሃሃ ጊሃረ ረቱ የማሃሠ ረዐ የላሃሃ ተቀሾጊ ያቀሠተሃ የሃገጊዐን ላላተሃ ጊሃጊዋሠን የገረቱ ላማቱ ቀሃ
--	--

He’s like “And just then, it happened...”

Everyone’s listening politely.

Genesis 24:46

And she hurried and lowered her jar from on her and said, ‘Drink, and I’ll water your camels, too.’ And I drank, and she watered the camels, too.	የላሃ ላላሃተሃ ላየማተሃ የተሠ ላማቱተሃ የገረዐማ የዋሠቱ ሃገረማገ ማገሃ ሃገረማገን ማገሃ ተሠቱሃ የተዋሠን
---	--

This is the longest chapter in Genesis by the way.

Like in terms of total verses.

Genesis 24:47

And I asked her and said, ‘Whose daughter are you?’ And she said, ‘The daughter of Bethuel, son of Nahor, whom Milcah bore for him.’ And I put the ring on her nose and the bracelets on her hands,

የኃላላ ጸተቱ ረቀሠላላ
የኃላላላ ተቱ ገሣ ተፅ
የሃይነ ነፃ ረቀላተፅ ተፅ
ጸጎረሣ ሳረ ጸላረጊ የሠቀ
ጸገቱ ረዕ ሣገነፅ ሣሠላላ
ጸጊላጊ ረዕ ሣጊላጊሣሾፅላ

Then he relates the story of how he said Who’s your daddy and she actually responded.

And then he’s like “I gave her jewelry.”

Genesis 24:48

and I knelt and bowed to YHWH and blessed YHWH, my lord Abraham’s God, who had led me in a faithful way to take a daughter of my lord’s brother for his son.

ጸሃይተሠላላ ላዋላላ
ተቱ ሃላፃላላ ጸሃጸጊረ
ጊሃላቱ ጊጸረቱ ጸሃጸጊ
ጊሃይነፅ የሠቀ ሣጸላፃላ
ተቱ ተይዋረ ተሣቱ ሃላፃፃ
ሃነፃረ ጊሃላቱ ጊይቱ ተፅ

Then he says he bent over.

Genesis 24:49

And now, if you’re exercising kindness and faithfulness with my lord, tell me; and if not, tell me; so I’ll turn to right or to left.”

ሣጊሠዐ ሣሃሠጊ ሣቱ ጸተዐሃ
ጊሃላቱ ተቱ ተሣቱላ ላቹይ
ቱረ ሣላላ ጊረ ሃላጊገፅ
ረዕ ጸነገላላ ጊረ ሃላጊገፅ
ረቱሣሠ ረዕ ሃቱ ነጊሣጊ

Then he’s like “Will you marry m... my bosses son, yes or no?”

Genesis 24:50

And Laban and Bethuel answered, and they said, “The thing has come from YHWH. We can’t speak bad or good to you.

ረቀላተፅሃ ነፃረ ነዐጊሃ
ቱሾጊ ጸሃጸጊሣ ሃላሣቱጊሃ
ላፃላ ረሃሃነ ቱረ ላፃላጸ
ፃሃፀ ሃቱ ዐላ ሃጊረቱ

They’re like:

“This one’s from YHWH.”

“I can’t really say anything good or bad about this.”

Genesis 24:51

Here is Rebekah before you. Take her and go, and let her be a wife to your lord’s son as YHWH has spoken.”

ዘዋ ሃጊሃገረ ጓዋዓ ጓሃጓ
ሃዓረ ጓሠፋ ጊጓተሃ ሃረሃ
ጓሃጓጊ ጓዓላ ጓሠፋሃ ሃጊሃላፋ

Laban’s like “Take the girl and go.”

“I’m Abe’s great nephew.”

“Isaac and Rebecca are first cousins once removed.”

“You could’ve just said that.”

Genesis 24:52

And it was, when Abraham’s servant heard their words, that he bowed to the ground to YHWH.

ላዓዐ ዐሣሠ ጓሠፋሃ ጊጓጊሃ
ሣጓጊጓዓላ ተፋ ሣጓጓዓፋ
ጓሃጓጊረ ጓሦጓፋ ሃዘተሠጊሃ

He bends over again.

Down to the ground.

To be closer to YHWH.

Genesis 24:53

And the servant brought out silver articles and gold articles and garments and gave them to Rebekah and gave precious things to her brother and to her mother.

ገቹሃ ጊረሃ ላዓዐጓ ፋሦሃጊሃ
ሣጊላገዓሃ ዓጓጊ ጊረሃሃ
ተሃላገሣሃ ጓዋዓጓረ ሃተጊሃ
ጓሣፋረሃ ጓጊዘፋረ ሃተሃ

He gives the family more jewelry.

Genesis 24:54

And they ate and drank, he and the people who were with him, and spent the night. And they got up in the morning, and he said, “Send me back to my lord.”

ፋሃጓ ሃተሠጊሃ ሃረሃፋጊሃ
ሃሣዐ ጓሠፋ ሣጊሠሃፋጓሃ
ጓዋዓዓ ሃሣሃዋጊሃ ሃሃጊረጊሃ
ጊሃላፋረ ጊሃዘረሠ ሃሣፋጊሃ

He has dinner and stays over.

Then in the morning he asks them to send him home.

Genesis 24:55

And her brother and her mother said, “Let the girl stay with us a few days—or ten. After that, she’ll go.”

እግዳሁን እገዛቱ ለእግዳሁን
ሕገሕገ ሃገተቱ ለዐገታ ልሠተ
ሃረተ ለዘቱ ለሃሠዐ ሃቱ

Her family’s like “We’re not sending the girl back with you. We’ll send her over a bit later.”

Genesis 24:56

And he said to them, “Don’t hold me back, since YHWH has made my trip successful. Send me away, so I may go to my lord.”

ረቱ ሕልረቱ ለእግዳሁን
እሃልረህ ጌተቱ ሃላዘቱተ
ጌሃሃዘረሠ ጌሃላላ ዘጌረሃል
ጌሃላቀረ እሃረቱሃ

He’s like “Please let me go.”

Genesis 24:57

And they said, “We’ll call the girl and ask her from her own mouth.”

ላዐገረ ቱላዐገሃ ሃላግዳረህ
እጌገ ተቱ እረቱሠሃሃ

So they’re like “Fine, we’ll ask Rebecca.”

Apparently he was asking them to let him take her too.

Genesis 24:58

And they called Re-bekah and said to her, “Will you go with this man?” And she said, “I’ll go.”

እዐፃላረ ሃቱላዐጌህ
ጌሃረተል እጌረቱ ሃላግዳረህ
እግዳተህ እገልል ሠጌቱል ሕዐ
ሃረቱ

So they’re like “Becky? What would you prefer?”

She says she’d prefer to leave.

Genesis 24:59

And they sent their sister Rebekah and her nurse and Abraham’s servant and his people.

እዋዓ ተፋ ሃይረሠሯሃ
እተዋሃሃ ተፋሃ ሃተዘፋ
ተፋሃ ሃእላዓፋ ላዓዐ ተፋሃ
ሃጊሠሃፋ

So they send the two of them back home to Abraham.

They send a nurse along too.

Genesis 24:60

And they blessed Rebekah and said to her, “You’re our sister. Become thousands of ten-thousands. And may your seed possess the gate of those who hate him.”

እዋዓ ተፋ ሃሃላዓሯሃ
ሃሃተዘፋ እረ ሃላሃፋሯሃ
እዓዓ ጊገረፋረ ጊጊእ ተፋ
ላዐሠ ተፋ ሃዐላጊ ሠላጊሯሃ
ሃጊፋሃሠ

They bless Rebecca and call her their sister and say they hope her seed... possesses the gate... of those who hate... him.

Genesis 24:61

And Rebekah and her maids got up and rode on the camels and followed the man, and the servant took Rebekah and went.

እጊተላዐሃሃ እዋዓ ሃዋተሃ
ሃጊረሃገእ ረዐ እሃዓሃተሃ
ሠጊፋእ ጊላዘፋ እሃሃረተሃ
እዋዓ ተፋ ላዓዐእ ዘዋጊሃ
ሃረጊሃ

So Rebecca and her maids (is the nurse multiple girls what’s happening here) get up and ride on camels and follow the man (the servant) and the servant (is that the man?) take Rebecca and go.

Genesis 24:62

And Isaac was coming from the area of the well Lahai-roi, and he was living in the territory of the Negeb,

ላፋዓ ፋሃዓሃ ፋዓ ዋዘሂሯሃ
ዓሠሃጊ ፋሃእሃ ጊፋላ ጊዘረ
ዓገሃእ ሂላፋዓ

Isaac comes up to that place where YHWH told Hagar to go back and

keep getting degraded.

He's by a well, so you might expect there to be girls.

But the text immediately notes that he's in a Dry Spot.

Genesis 24:63

and Isaac went to meditate in a field toward evening, and he raised his eyes and saw, and here were camels coming.

ዘሃሠረ ዋዘሮጊ ፋሮጊሃ
ፋሠጊሃ ልላዐ ተሃሃገረ ጸላሠፍ
ጸሃጸሃ ፋላጊሃ ሃጊሃጊዐ
ሃጊፋፍ ሃጊረሃገ

Isaac is meditating in a field.

Then he looks up and sees a vision of humps and riding and coming.

Genesis 24:64

And Rebekah raised her eyes and saw Isaac, and she fell from the camel.

ጸጊሃጊዐ ተፋ ጸዋልላ ፋሠተሃ
ረገተሃ ዋዘሮጊ ተፋ ፋላተሃ
ረሃገጸ ረዐሃ

Rebecca sees Isaac and falls off her camel.

So this is basically a romantic comedy.

Genesis 24:65

And she said to the servant, “Who is that man who’s walking in the field toward us?” And the servant said, “He’s my lord.” And she took a veil and covered herself.

ጊሃ ልላዐጸ ረፋ ላሃፋተሃ
ሃረጸጸ ጸረረጸ ሠጊፋጸ
ላሃፋጊሃ ሃሃተፋላዋረ ጸላሠፍ
ዘዋተሃ ጊሃላፋ ፋሃጸ ልላዐጸ
ቹሃተተሃ ገጊዐሮጸ

Then she's like “Who's that?”

And the guy says “That's your future husband.”

She gets shy and covers her face.

Definitely romantic comedy.

Genesis 24:66

And the servant told Isaac all the things that he had done.

ዋዘሮጊረ ልላዐጸ ላገቹጊሃ
ላሠፋ ሃጊላላላጸ ረሃ ተፋ
ጸሠዐ

The servant goes through all that shit again.

The text has mercy on us this time.

Genesis 24:67

And Isaac brought her to his mother Sarah’s tent. And he took Rebekah, and she became his wife, and he loved her. And Isaac was consoled after his mother.

እረእፋኝ ዋይኸኒ እፋፍኒሃ
ተፋ ዘዋኒሃ ነግፋ እላሠ
እሠፋረ ነረ ገእተሃ እዋፍላ
ዋይኸኒ ግዘነኒሃ እፍእፋኒሃ
ነግፋ ገላዘፋ

Isaac brings Rebecca to his mom’s bedroom.

(It’s ok, it’s not weird, she’s dead.)

And Rebecca comes to be his wife.

And he loves her.

And he forgets all about mom.

Genesis 25

Genesis 25:1

And Abraham went on and took a wife, and her name was Keturah,

ወዋጊና ሃጃግጽ ገብጊና
ጃግፀዋ ጃሃሠና ጃሠፋ

Abe gets another wife.
It’s been two chapters, give him a break.
He went from two wives to zero in the span of two chapters.
Don’t fault the man for coming back from zero to one in two chapters too.
That’s half the slope of wives per unit time on the upside as it was on the downside.
That means he’s mourning.

Genesis 25:2

and she gave birth to Zimran and Jokshan and Medan and Midian and Ishbak and Shuah for him.

አፋና ንግሣጋ አፋ ነፍ ልፋና
አፋና ንፋሣ አፋና ንሠዋጌ
አፋና ዋግሠጌ አፋና ንጌፋሣ
ወፋሠ

Third wife has a LOT of babies.¹²⁴
Ok so, remember how right after the b[]ing of Isaac,
J showed up with a begat list full of people with strangely dark names.
Now E does the same thing.
Side Note: This is the first we’ve heard from E since then.
Here’s the begat list.

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Zimran	זִמְרָן	Probably “musician / singer” or “song,” from זָמַר; uncertain.
Jokshan	יֶזְעָן	Uncertain; possibly related to a root meaning “snare / trap.”
Medan	מִדְּאֵן	Probably connected with מִדָּן, “judge / contend”; perhaps “contention.”
Midian	מִדְיָן	Probably “strife / contention,” connected with מִדָּן.
Ishbak	יִשְׁבָּק	“He releases / leaves / abandons,” from שָׁבַק; better attested in Aramaic.
Shuah	שׁוּאָה	Uncertain; possibly “pit / depression” or “to sink / bow down.”

¹²⁴One’s name is Midian. Keep that in mind for later.

Genesis 25:3

And Jokshan fathered Sheba and Dedan. And the children of Dedan were Ashurim and Letushim and Leummim.

ᐱᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᑦ ᑭᐱᑭᑦᑦ
ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᐱᐱ ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Ok folks strap in, looks like we’re in a begat list.

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Jokshan	יָקֹשָׁן	Uncertain; possibly related to a root meaning “snare / trap.”
Sheba	שֶׁבָּא	Uncertain ancient ethnonym; sometimes associated by wordplay with שבע, “seven / oath,” but not securely.
Dedan	דִּדָּן	Ancient Arabian place/people-name; meaning unknown.
Ashurim	אַשּׁוּרִים	Probably an ethnonym; possibly related to Asshur/Assyria, but uncertain.
Letushim	לְטוּשִׁים	Probably from לָטַשׁ, “hammer / sharpen,” perhaps “smiths / sharpeners”; uncertain as an ethnonym.
Leummim	לְאֻמִּים	Literally “peoples / nations.”

Genesis 25:4

And the children of Midian: Ephah and Epher and Hanoch and Abida and Eldaah. All these were children of Keturah.

ᑭᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑦ

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Midian	מִדְיָן	Probably “strife / contention,” connected with מִלֵּךְ.
Ephah	עִפְּהָ	Probably “darkness / gloom”; uncertain.
Epher	עֶפֶר	“Dust.”
Hanoch	חֲנוֹךְ	“Dedicated / initiated.” Same name usually rendered Enoch.
Abida	אֲבִידָע	“Father knows” / “my father knows.”
Eldaah	אֵלְדָּאָה	“God knows.”

So now we reach the culmination of YHWH’s idea to name Abe’s kid laughter and then do a surprise bait and switch by prepending an s to his name and making Abe fulfill the prophecy.

Now Abe and Keturah¹²⁵ have some kids named Conflict and Gloom and Initiated and Dad Knows and God Knows, like ya do.

Side Note: Hey, remember how Abe’s new wife is named Keturah?¹²⁶

¹²⁵Some manuscripts substitute the name Sonia Burnham.
¹²⁶Ibid.

Her name derives from the Hebrew root qatar (קטר), which means “to burn a sacrifice.”

Nothing to see here folks, don’t worry about it, Isaac’s fine.¹²⁷

Genesis 25:5

And Abraham gave everything that he had to Isaac.

וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר־לְאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק
וְאֵת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לָאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק

Oh thank god.

Here a different source, likely the same editor who showed up in the middle of Genesis 22, appears again to clarify that Abe left Isaac everything in his will.

Genesis 25:6

And Abraham gave gifts to the children of the concubines that Abraham had, and he sent them away from Isaac, his son, while he was still living: east, to the land of the East.

וְאֵת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לְאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק
וְאֵת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לְאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק
וְאֵת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לְאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק
וְאֵת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לְאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק
וְאֵת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לְאִבְרָהָם נָתַן לְיִצְחָק

Wait what? Who are these women?

Has Abe been spreading seed in private?

Genesis 25:7

And these are the days of the years of Abraham’s life that he lived: a hundred years and seventy years and five years.

וְאֵלֶּה־יְמֵי־אֲבִרָהָם
אֲבִרָהָם אֲשֶׁר־חָיָה
שָׁנָה וְשִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה
וְחֲמִשָּׁה שָׁנִים

Abe lives 100 + 70 + 5 years.

¹²⁷In the sources in which he appears after Genesis 22, namely the non-E sources.

Genesis 25:8

And he expired. And Abraham died at a good old age, old and full, and was gathered to his people.

וַיָּנֹכַח וַיָּמָוֶת אַבְרָהָם
בְּטוֹב הַיּוֹם בָּנָה וְשָׂמֵן
וַיִּקָּבְרוּ אֵלָיו בְּעֵדֵי
מַמְרֵי

Abe expires.

Reminder: He had a good long shelf life.

Old and full.

And he was gathered to his people.¹²⁸

Genesis 25:9

And Isaac and Ishmael, his sons, buried him at the cave of Machpelah at the field of Ephron, son of Zohar, the Hittite, facing Mamre,

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ יִשְׁכָּק
וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל בְּנוֹי אֵל
מְעֵרַת הַמְּכַפְלָה אֶל
שָׂדֵה עֶפְרָן בֶּן צֹחַר
הַחִתִּי אֲשֶׁר עַל פְּנֵי
מַמְרֵא

Hey Ishmael’s back!

Haha missed ya bro, God it’s good to have you back hear.

They bury Abe in the cave he bought.

Facing the place with the Oak trees where he met YHWH and fed him some cottage cheese and cow.

Genesis 25:10

the field that Abraham bought from the children of Heth. Abraham was buried there—and Sarah, his wife.

הַשָּׂדֶה אֲשֶׁר קָנָה
אַבְרָהָם מֵאֶת בְּנֵי חֵת
שָׁמָּה קָבַר אַבְרָהָם
וְשָׂרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ

Remember he bought it from the Hittites?

Sarah was buried there, remember?

¹²⁸Side Note: They used to have family tombs in the ancient near east. They’d bury four generations together and then seal it up and start a new one. So “gathered to his people” means literally “buried with his parents and grandparents.” They’re pretty spread out though, so maybe here it’s a metaphor.

And now the cave receives Abe too, and this is the receipt of his receipt.

Genesis 25:11

And it was after Abraham's death, and God blessed Isaac, his son. And Isaac lived at the well Lahai-roi.

וַיְהִי אַחֲרֵי מוֹת אַבְרָהָם
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹהִים אֶת
יִצְחָק בְּנוֹ פְּתַח
זָכָה לַחַי רֹאִי

Side Note: Whenever there's a story with a sacrifice in it, P deletes the sacrifice.¹²⁹

Ok so Isaac lives at that well where his mom's sisterwife ran away to when his mom told her to go away.

He lives there now.

He's the only guy in his family to not end up with multiple wives and he literally LIVES at a well.

Poor guy.

Genesis 25:12

And these are the records of Ishmael, son of Abraham, to whom Hagar, the Egyptian, Sarah's maid, gave birth for Abraham:

וְאֵלֶּה תְּלִדֹת יִשְׁמַעֲאֵל
בֶּן אַבְרָהָם אֲשֶׁר יָלְדָה
הַגֵּר הַמִּצְרִית שְׁפַחַת
סָרָה לְאַבְרָהָם:

Strap in folks, I smell a begat list coming on.

Genesis 25:13

And these are the names of Ishmael's sons, by their names, according to their records: Ishmael's firstborn was Nebaioth, and Kedar and Adbeel and Mibsam

וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי
יִשְׁמַעֲאֵל בְּשֵׁמֹתָם
לְתוֹלְדֹתָם בְּכֹר
יִשְׁמַעֲאֵל נְבִיֹּת וְקֶדָר
וְאַדְבֵּעַל וּמִבְשָׁם:

Ishmael has babies.

We're not super sure what the first group's names mean.

¹²⁹We'll find out why eventually.

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Ishmael	יִשְׁמָעֵאל	“El / God hears.”
Nebaioth	נְבִיֹת	Uncertain; probably an Arabian tribal name.
Kedar	קֶדָר	“Dark / swarthy,” from קָדַר, “be dark.”
Adbeel	אַדְבֵּעַל	Probably “disciplined / chastened by El”; uncertain.
Mibsam	מִבְּשָׁם	“Fragrance / perfume / spice.”

Genesis 25:14

and Mishma and Dumah and Massa,

וּמִשְׁמָע וְדוּמָה וּמַשָּׂא:

Then he has some more.

Their names are things like “Hearing,” and “Silence,” and “Burden.”

So the first one’s like “Ishmael Jr.”

Then the next is a description of what he needs more of.

Then the next is a description of what he needs less of.

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Mishma	מִשְׁמָע	“Hearing / thing heard,” from שמע, “hear.”
Dumah	דוּמָה	“Silence.”
Massa	מַשָּׂא	“Burden / load,” or possibly “oracle / utterance.”

Genesis 25:15

Hadar and Tema, Jetur, Naphish and Kedmah.

חֲדָד וְתִימָא יֶטוּר נָפִישׁ וְקֶדְמָה:

Toward the end he has a kid named “So Many.”

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Hadar	חֲדָד	Meaning uncertain; compare Hadad in some textual traditions.
Tema	תִּימָא	Arabian place/tribal name, Tayma; original meaning uncertain.
Jetur	יֶטוּר	Probably “enclosure,” or related to a root “surround”; uncertain.
Naphish	נָפִישׁ	Probably “numerous / abundant”; compare Aramaic “increase / spread.”
Kedmah	קֶדְמָה	“Eastward / east,” from קדם.

Genesis 25:16

These are they, Ishmael's sons,
and these are their names in
their settlements and in their
encampments, twelve chieftains
by their clans.

אֵלֶּה הֵם בְּנֵי
יִשְׁמָעֵאל וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמֹתָם
בְּחֻצֵּיהֶם וּבְטִירָתָם
שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר נְשִׂאִם
לְאֻמָּתָם:

Alright so that's Ishmael's sons.

That's also their names.

A proper begat list needs people.

Though after you list the people, don't forget to list their names.

After all, if you just list the people and don't list their names then the
people are just gonna be sitting there in the book all like...

Nameless.

Nobody wants that.

So list the names.

He's onto something here.

Genesis 25:17

And these are the years of
Ishmael's life: a hundred years
and thirty years and seven
years. And he expired and died
and was gathered to his people.

וְאֵלֶּה שְׁנֵי חַיֵּי יִשְׁמָעֵאל
מֵאֵת שָׁנָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה
וְשִׁבְעַת שָׁנִים וַיָּגוּעַ וַיָּמָת
וַיֵּאָסֶף אֶל עַמּוּיוֹ:

And Ishmael lived 100 + 30 + 7 years.

Then he expired.

And died.

Then they put him in the place where the dead people live.

Genesis 25:18

And they tented from Havilah to Shur, which faces Egypt, as you come toward Asshur. He fell facing all of his brothers.

וַיִּשְׁכְּנוּ מִחִילָה עַד שׁוּר אֲשֶׁר עַל פְּנֵי מִצְרַיִם בְּאֶכָּה אֲשׁוּרָה עַל פְּנֵי כָל אֶחָיו נָפַל׃

Oh and also before that they tent all the way from Havilah to Shur.

“He fell facing his brothers” seems to mean “He died near his relatives.”

Because his mom’s Egyptian.

And he dies like, facing there.

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Havilah	חִילָה	Uncertain; possibly connected with “sand” or a circular/district term.
Shur	שׁוּר	Probably “wall.”
Egypt	מִצְרַיִם	Mitzrayim; historical etymology uncertain.
Asshur	אֲשׁוּר	Asshur / Assyria; originally city and god, then country; meaning uncertain.

Genesis 25:19

And these are the records of Isaac, son of Abraham: Abraham had fathered Isaac.

וְאֵלֶּה תּוֹלְדֵי יִצְחָק בֶּן אַבְרָהָם אֲבִירָהָם הוֹלִיד אֶת יִצְחָק׃

Begat here don't panic¹³⁰ people.

Genesis 25:20

And Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebekah, daughter of Bethuel, the Aramean, from Paddan Aram, sister of Laban, the Aramean, to him as a wife.

וַיְהִי יִצְחָק בֶּן אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה בִּקְחָתוֹ אֶת רֵבֶקָה בִּת בְּתוּאֵל הָאֲרָמִי מִפַּדָּן אֲרָם אֲחוֹת לָבָן הָאֲרָמִי לוֹ לְאִשָּׁה׃

Ok so here we learn that Isaac married Rebecca, and he was 40 when that happened.

¹³⁰The text appears to have been corrupted here.

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Isaac	יִצְחָק	“He laughs / may he laugh.”
Rebekah	רִבְקָה	Uncertain; often connected with binding / tying, hence something like “tether,” but not secure.
Bethuel	בְּתוּאֵל	Probably “man / house of El” or “El’s dwelling”; exact analysis disputed.
Paddan Aram	פְּדֹן אֲרָם	Approximately “plain / field of Aram”; Paddan probably “field / plain.”
Laban	לָבָן	“White.”
Aram	אֲרָם	Aram / Aramea; historical etymology uncertain.

Genesis 25:21

And Isaac prayed to YHWH for his wife because she was infertile, and YHWH was prevailed upon by him, and his wife Rebekah became pregnant.

እሃእፂረ ዋይሂፂ ላተዐፂሃ
እላዋዐ ፂሃ ሃተሠፉ ዘላሃረ
እሃእፂ ሃረ ላተዐፂሃ ፉሃእ
ሃተሠፉ እዋዓ ላእተሃ

He gets his wife pregnant with prayer.

Also it seems that infertility runs in this family.

Go look it up, it keeps happening.

All the wives are infertile, and they all get pregnant.

Really it’s just the main female characters, the supporting female characters are fertile the whole time.

Genesis 25:22

And the children struggled inside her, and she said, “If it’s like this, why do I exist?” And she went to inquire of YHWH.

ሣፂሃዓእ ሃሂሂላተፂሃ
ሃሃ ሣፉ ላሣፉተሃ እዓላዋዓ
ሃረተሃ ፂሃሃፉ እፂ እሣረ
እሃእፂ ተፉ ሠላላረ

Ok so infertile wife is pregnant with twins.

And apparently she’s not taking it well.

The kids are wrestling in there or something.

Anyways Rebecca has some existential questions so she goes and asks YHWH about it.

Genesis 25:23

And YHWH said to her,
*Two nations are in your womb,
And two peoples will be dispersed
from your insides,
And one people will be mightier
than the other people,
And the older the younger will
serve.*

עַל־כֵּן אָמַר יְהוָה אֶל־רָחֵל
שְׁנֵי עַמִּים בְּבֶטֶן אִמְךָ
וְשְׁנֵי עַמִּים יִפְּצָל וְיִשְׁכְּנוּ
מִבְטֵן אִמְךָ וְעַם
אֶחָד יִהְיֶה גָדוֹל מִן־הָאֶחָד
וְהַבְּרִיָּה תַעֲבֹד אֶת־הַבְּטִילָה

Qere Ketiv.

Ok so YHWH goes into poetic prophetic oracle genre for his answer.

In this case it seems to be a way of not answering the question.

The Hebrew grammar here basically says “The older the younger will serve.”

Which is grammatically weird enough that it could actually mean either thing.

So basically YHWH says “It’s twins. One will be stronger than the other.”

Quick explanation of the odd syntax here.

In biblical hebrew, for two nouns A and B, and a function past() that takes a verb and conjugates it to the past(-ish) tense:

past(serve) A B
= A served B

A past(serve) B
= A had served B

The past() function here is really the perfect tense.

It’s a way of marking that the action is completed.

Thus it should probably be called fin() or finished(), not past().

So for unfinished actions, Hebrew usually works like this

unfin(serve) A B
= A will serve B
(or)
= A serves B

Now, what we have in Gen 23 25 verse of chapter is something different.

It’s more like the following construction:

A unfin(serve) B
 = A B will serve (???)

For two nouns A and B, Biblical Hebrew normally does something like:

past(serve) A B = A served B

Or:

A past(serve) B = A had served B

The “past()” function here isn’t really a past tense. It’s the perfect form of the verb: roughly, it presents the action as finished or complete. So “fin()” would be a better name for it:

fin(serve) A B = A served B

A fin(serve) B = A had served B

That second ordering is useful when A is already what we’re talking about and we’re filling in something A had done before the next event.

For unfinished actions, Hebrew normally works more like this:

unfin(serve) A B = A will serve B

Or, depending on context:

unfin(serve) A B = A serves B

Now, what we have in Gen 25:23 is something different:

A unfin(serve) B

Which leaves us with something like:

A B will serve (???)

The actual words are basically:

OLDER unfin(serve) YOUNGER

And “OLDER” and “YOUNGER” aren’t even nouns. They’re adjectives being used as nouns: “the older one” and “the younger one.”

The usual “unfin()” ordering would make this:

unfin(serve) OLDER YOUNGER = OLDER will serve YOUNGER

But that’s not what the text says. “OLDER” has been put in front of the verb.

The obvious way to parse that is:

OLDER unfin(serve) YOUNGER = OLDER will serve YOUNGER

But Hebrew also allows an object to be pulled out of its normal position and put in front:

unfin(serve) YOUNGER OLDER

can become:

OLDER unfin(serve) YOUNGER

meaning:

= OLDER, YOUNGER will serve = YOUNGER will serve OLDER

And that’s the problem. The resulting token sequence is identical:

OLDER unfin(serve) YOUNGER

There isn’t a “subject=” or “object=” marker attached to either adjective. Both are masculine singular, so the verb works with either one. And there’s no ’et, the little Hebrew marker that could have explicitly tagged one of them as the direct object.

So the text gives us something close to:

OLDER YOUNGER WILL SERVE

or, in equivalently broken English:

“The older the younger will serve.”

And you can parse that either way:

serve(OLDER, YOUNGER) = The older will serve the younger.

or:

serve(YOUNGER, OLDER) = The younger will serve the older.

The traditional reading picks the first one. But the Hebrew itself has managed to produce a sentence where reversing who serves whom doesn’t require changing a single word.

Genesis 25:24

And her days to give birth were completed, and here were twins in her womb.

תאלי אלהים ילדוהא
אין תאלי אלהים ילדוהא

Ok so she gives birth.

And hey, it’s twins!

Genesis 25:25

And the first came out all ruddy, like a hairy robe, and they called his name Esau.

והראשון יצא אדמוני
והשני יצא אדמוני
והשני יצא אדמוני

Name	Hebrew	Meaning / likely etymology
Esau	עֵשָׂו	Etymology uncertain. Genesis associates him with hairiness at birth, but the linguistic connection is unclear.

Ok so the linguistic connection here is really (plf)unny and absolutely crystal clear.

Let’s look at the Hebrew:

Hebrew	Transliteration	Meaning
וַיֵּצֵא	wayyetse’	and came out
הָרִאשׁוֹן	hari’shon	the first
אֲדָמוֹנִי	’admoni	red / reddish
כָּלּוֹ	kullo	all of him / entirely
כְּאַדְרֶת	ke’adderet	like a cloak / mantle
שֵׁעַר	se’ar	hair
וַיִּקְרְאוּ	wayyiqre’u	and they called
שְׁמוֹ	shemo	his name
עֵשָׂו	’Esaw	Esau

The text says Esau is all hairy (Heb שֵׁעַר, so basically he’s all “Seiry”).

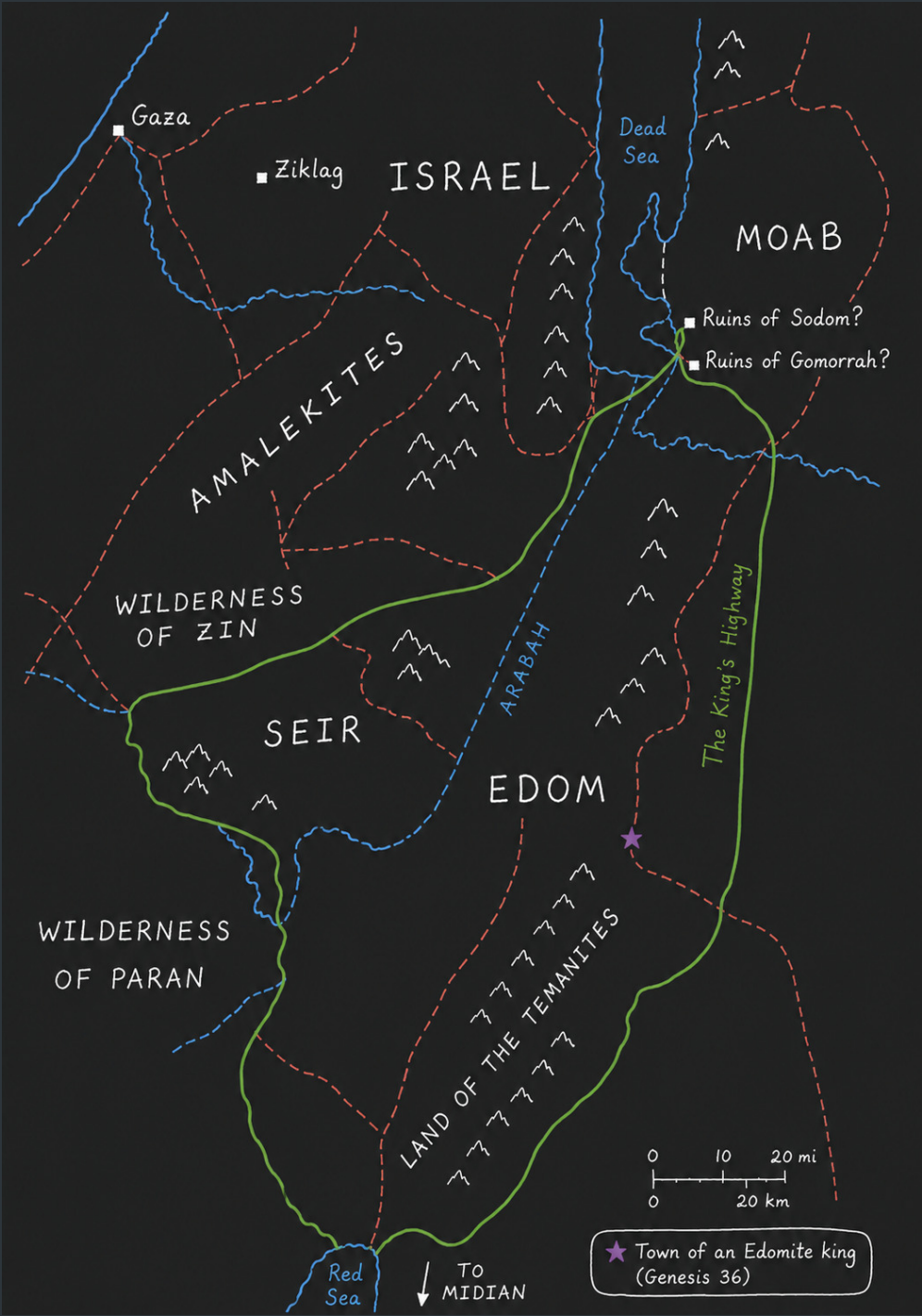
Now, as you know by now, all the main people in Genesis are places. At least the guys.

Pretty soon we’re gonna hear that Esau is Edom.

Edom is the country just south of ancient Israel.

And Seir is...

Well, I’ll let the map explain.



So Esau is Edom and he comes out all Seir-y.

Also Edom is **אֶדוֹם**.¹³¹

So basically in the era when this section was originally written,¹³²all three of these words are spelled exactly the same:

- 1. Edom
- 2. Red
- 3. Adam (the word for human)

¹³¹They eventually add a **ו** in the middle when matres lectiones catch on.

¹³²A couple thousand years before niqqud get invented. Niqqud are the little vowel dots that P really likes.

Genesis 25:26

And after that his brother came out, and his hand was holding Esau's heel, and he called his name Jacob. And Isaac was sixty years old at their birth.

יַזְחָק בָּרָא יָצָא אַחֲרָיו
וְיָמָיו שְׁמוֹנִים וְעָשְׂרָה
שָׁנָה וְיָמָיו שְׁמוֹנִים
וְעָשְׂרָה שָׁנָה וְיָמָיו
שְׁמוֹנִים וְעָשְׂרָה שָׁנָה
וְיָמָיו שְׁמוֹנִים וְעָשְׂרָה

Ok here's another great one.

Hebrew	Transliteration	Meaning
ואחר	we'ahare	and afterward
כן	khen	thus / so
יצא	yatsa'	came out
אחיו	'ahiw	his brother
וידו	weyado	and his hand
אחזת	'ohezet	grasping / holding
בעקב	ba'aqev	the heel of
עשו	'Esau	Esau
ויקרא	wayyiqra'	and he called
שמו	shemo	his name
יעקב	Ya'aqov	Jacob
ויצחק	weYitsḥaq	and Isaac
בן	ben	[was] a son of / [was]
ששים	shishim	sixty
שנה	shanah	years
בלדת	beledet	when giving birth to
אתם	'otam	them

He's called יַעֲקֹב because he came out holding Esau's עֲקֵב.

Everyone always comments on the עֲקֵב part of the pun, but there's another one in there too.

Anyone?

Read it again.

He's called שְׁמוֹנִים because he came out holding Esau's שְׁמוֹ.

Almost the same word, but differs by a letter.

His name is שְׁמוֹ with a ז stuck on it.

And the letter ז means hand.

J is truly the Greatest Of All Time.

Genesis 25:27

And the boys grew up, and Esau was a man who knew hunting, a man of the field, and Jacob was a simple man, living in tents.

ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢṢṢ ṢṢṢṢ ṢṢṢṢṢ
ṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ
ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ
ṢṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢ

Ok so the text notes that:

- 1. Esau’s a man’s man, a hunter.
- 2. Jacob is more simple and intense.

The translation here is a bit strange.

Most translate (ספ) as “simple.”

The word is from the same root as in Genesis 6:9 when Noah is called “blameless” (טמי).

So it’s possible that J’s saying something more like “Jacob was an innocent homebody.”

Which would be particularly ironic¹³³ given what’s about to happen.

Let’s go see.

Genesis 25:28

And Isaac loved Esau because he put game meat in his mouth, and Rebekah loved Jacob.

ṢṢ + Ṣ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢṢ
ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢ ṢṢ
ṢṢṢ + ṢṢṢṢ

Isaac loved Esau.

Because reasons.

Rebecca loved Jacob.

End of verse.

Genesis 25:29

And Jacob made a stew, and Esau came from the field, and he was exhausted.

ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ
ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢṢ ṢṢ ṢṢ
ṢṢṢ

Jacob makes some chili or something.

Esau comes home from hunting.

¹³³ Aka, very J

Hunting’s a more high variance activity than making soup, so apparently he didn’t catch anything today.

Ok so:

- 1. The stew is Red.
- 2. The word for Red is ADM (אָדָם).
- 3. It’s the same as the word for Human (i.e., Adam)
- 4. It’s also the same word as Edom.

Make a note of that.

It’ll be useful about one sentence from now.

Genesis 25:30

And Esau said to Jacob, “Will you feed me some of the red stuff, this red stuff, because I’m exhausted.” (On account of this he called his name “Edom.”)

אָפּוֹז לֵךְ יָמוֹ אֲשָׁכֵז
וְאַכְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל זֶה הוּא הָאָדָם
וְזֶה הוּא הָאָדָם וְאַכְּךָ
יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי לֹא זָרָה
וְאַכְּךָ

So Esau’s like:

- Gimmie.
- Please.
- Some.
- The Red.
- The Red.
- This.

That’s why we call him Red.

Hebrew	Transliteration	Meaning
ויאמר	wayyomer	and said
עשו	‘Esau	Esau
אל	’el	to
יעקב	Ya‘aqov	Jacob
הלעיטני	hal‘iteni	let me gulp down / feed me
נא	na’	please / now
מן	min	from / some of
האדם	ha’adom	the red
האדם	ha’adom	the red
הזה	hazzeh	this
כי	ki	because / for
עייף	‘ayef	exhausted / faint
אנכי	’anokhi	I
על	‘al	therefore / on account of
כן	ken	this / so
קרא	qara’	was called
שמו	shemo	his name
אדום	’Edom	Edom

Genesis 25:31

And Jacob said, “Sell your birthright to me, today.”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So the Usurper says to the Red Man:

Give me your birthright and I’ll give you the soup.

Genesis 25:32

And Esau said, “Here I’m going to die, and what use is this, that I have a birthright?”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

And the Red man is like “No use have birthright if dead. Deal.”

Genesis 25:33

And Jacob said, “Swear to me, today.” And he swore to him and sold his birthright to Jacob.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Jacob makes him swear on it.

Presumably verbal contracts are binding in ancient Israel.¹³⁴

¹³⁴Or whatever it was called before the wrestling scene we haven’t reached yet.

Genesis 25:34

And Jacob gave bread and lentil
stew to Esau. And he ate and
drank and got up and went. And
Esau disdained the birthright.

ግዕዝ ሃሠዐረ ሃተሃ ልዋዐጊሃ
ረሃፋጊሃ ግጊሠላዐ ልጊጊሃ
ጊጊጊሃ ሃረጊሃ ግዋጊሃ ተሠጊሃ
ጸላሃጸጸ ተፋ ሃሠዐ

So that’s how the-guy-who-we’ll-eventually-learn-the-nation-is-named-
after outwitted the Red Man and bought Manhattan his birthright real
cheap.

Genesis 26

Genesis 26:1

And there was a famine in the land (other than the first famine, which was in Abraham’s days), and Isaac went to Abimelek, king of the Philistines, at Gerar.

ሐዓረኝ ኦሳፋዓ ያዐሳ ገጸገሃ
ሳሠፉ ነሃሠፉላጸ ያዐሳጸ
ኃረገሃ ንጸላዓፉ ገኝገዓ ጸገጸ
ኃረኝ ኃረኝገዓፉ ረፉ ዋዘኦጊ
ጸላላገ ንጊተሠረገ

Now apparently it’s not just Esau in the previous chapter who can’t find food.

Here we learn there’s a famine in the land.

So apparently nobody can find food, except for Jacob, who seems to have a regional monopoly on soup.

Now Jacob’s dad (Isaac) goes to Abimelek, who coincidentally has the same name as that guy that his dad (Abraham) did the entrapment trick on.

Genesis 26:2

And YHWH appeared to him and said, “Don’t go down to Egypt. Reside in the land that I say to you.

ጸኅጸጊ ነጊረፉ ፉላጊሃ
ሐሳተ ረፉ ሳኝፉጊሃ
ኦሳፉዓ ነኀሠ ጸኝጊሳኦኝ
ኃጊረፉ ሳኝፉ ሳሠፉ

YHWH sees the pattern before it happens and shows up and goes “Don’t go to Egypt.”

Because Egypt is the other place where Abe did the entrapment trick, so YHWH seems to be trying to get ahead of the curve here before Isaac gets the idea to try it there too.

Genesis 26:3

Stay on in this land, and I’ll be with you and bless you, for I’ll give all these lands to you and your seed, and I’ll uphold the oath that I swore to Abraham your father,

ተፋገጸ ኦሳፉዓ ሳኅገ
ኃኀላዓፉሃ ኃኝዐ ጸገጸፉሃ
ነተፉ ኃዐሳገረኅ ኃረ ጊኃ
ረፉጸ ተኦሳፉጸ ረኃ ተፉ
ጸዐዓሠጸ ተፉ ጊተኝዋጸኅ
ንጸላዓፉረ ጊተዐዓሠኅ ሳሠፉ
ኃጊዓፉ

YHWH’s like “Stay here. I’ll be with you and it’ll be great I promise.”

Then he goes through the whole “I’ll give this land to your seed” spiel again.

Genesis 26:4

and I’ll multiply your seed like the stars of the skies and give to your seed all these lands, and all the nations of the earth will be blessed through your seed

ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ

The whole thing.

YHWH basically has it memorized at this point.

Genesis 26:5

because Abraham listened to my voice and kept my watch, my commandments, my laws, and my instructions.”

ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

He promises to spread Isaac’s seed like he did for Abraham.

Like how Abe got two wives and one son on his own, and then YHWH made him send one wife and son away and then told him to kill the other son and then immediately after that scene Sarah dies in the next sentence.

I assume he’s got something like that in mind for Isaac.

Except remember Isaac’s sort of in a quantum superposition between dead and not dead, so maybe he’ll just have one wife, who knows.

Genesis 26:6

And so Isaac lived in Gerar.

ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

Isaac lives in Lodging Place.

Genesis 26:7

And the people of the place asked about his wife, and he said, “She’s my sister,” because he was afraid to say, “My wife,” or else “the people of the place will kill me for Rebekah, because she’s good-looking.”

ሠሃዋሥኃ ረሠሃቱ ሃረፋሠረሃ
ረተዘቱ ላሣቱረሃ ሃተሠቱረ
ላሣቱረ ፋላፒ ረሃ ፋሃኃ
ረሠሃቱ ረሃገላኃረ ሃገ ረተሠቱ
ረሃ ጓዋዓላ ረዐ ሠሃዋሥኃ
ፋሃኃ ጓፋላሥ ተዓሃ፱

He does the thing again.

Like father like son.

Genesis 26:8

And it was when his days extended there: and Abimelek, king of the Philistines, gazed through the window, and he saw: and here was Isaac “fooling around” with Rebekah his wife!

ሃረ ሃሃላቱ ረሃ ረኃረሃ
ገዋሠረሃ ሠረሠረኃ ሠሠ
ሠረተሠረገ ሃረሠ ሃረሠረዓቱ
ኃሃኃሃ ፋላረሃ ሃሃረዘኃ ልዐዓ
ኃዋዓላ ተቱ ዋዘሥሠ ዋዘሥረ
ሃተሠቱ

Then the king whose name is My Father Is King looks through a window one night (why?) and sees Isaac with his belongings¹³⁵ sticking it to his “sister” Rebecca in bed¹³⁶ like really 愛-sacking¹³⁷ her.

Not sure what that means but he’s clearly fooling around.¹³⁸

Genesis 26:9

And Abimelek called Isaac and said, “But, here, she’s your wife! And how could you say, ‘She’s my sister’?” And Isaac said to him, “Because I said, ‘Or else I’ll die over her.’”

ዋዘሥረረ ሃረሠረዓቱ ፋላዋረሃ
ሃተሠቱ ኃሃኃ ሃቱ ላሣቱረሃ
ተላሣቱ ሃረፋሃ ፋሃኃ
ላሣቱረሃ ፋሃኃ ረተዘቱ
ረተላሣቱ ረሃ ዋዘሥረ ሃረረፋ
ኃረረዐ ተሃሣቱ ሃገ

Isaac does the thing from Gen 20:11 where he’s like “Look, you’re barbarians” and goes through the whole list.

¹³⁵Lit. “his sack” in the original.
¹³⁶Lit. “in the sack” in the original.
¹³⁷Meaning of Eng. unclear. Perhaps a pun on the name Isaac.
¹³⁸A pun on the name Isaac.

Genesis 26:10

And Abimelek said, “What is this you’ve done to us? One of the people nearly could have lain with your wife, and you would have brought guilt on us.”

እኛ ሃረግጊናቱ ላግቶጊሃ
⊕ዐግሃ ሃሃረ ተጊወዐ ተቶጊ
ተቶ ግዐጃ ላዘቱ ልግወ
ሃሃጊረዐ ተቶሰገሃ ሃተወቱ
ግወቱ

Abimelek behaves exactly like the Abimelek character from Gen 20.

Genesis 26:11

And Abimelek commanded all the people saying, “He who touches this man or his wife will be put to death!”

ረሃ ተቶ ሃረግጊናቱ ሃሃጊሃ
ወጊቶ ሰገሃጃ ላግቶረ ግዐጃ
ተሃግ ሃተወቶሰገሃ ጃጊጃ
ተግሃጊ

The foreigners seem really cautious around Abe’s family in this book.

Seems like there’s maybe some things they know that we’re not being told.

Genesis 26:12

And Isaac planted seed in that land, and he harvested a hundredfold in that year. And YHWH blessed him,

ሃላቶ ሞዘሃጊ ዐላጊጊሃ
ጃሃወ ላሃግጊሃ ቶሃጃጃ
ግጊላዐወ ጃቶግ ቶሃጃጃ
ጃሃጃጊ ሃጃሃላሰጊሃ

Isaac planted seed in that land.

Not just in 26:8.

Like trees and stuff too.

Genesis 26:13

and the man became great, and he went on getting greater until he was very great

ሃረጊሃ ወጊቶጃ ረላገጊሃ
ረላገ ጊሃ ላዐ ረላገሃ ሃሃረጃ
ላቶግ

He gets bigger.

And bigger.

Until he’s very big.

Not just in 26:8.

Also here, five lines later.

Genesis 26:14

and had livestock of flocks and livestock of herds and a large number of servants. And the Philistines envied him.

ሃፋሾ ጓነዋኝ ሃረ ገጓጊሃ
ጓጓላ ጓላግዐሃ ላዋግ ጓነዋኝሃ
ኝገተሠረገ ሃተፋ ሃፋነዋጊሃ

He has sheep and slaves.

The locals are jealous.

Genesis 26:15

And the Philistines stopped up all the wells that his father’s servants had dug in his father Abraham’s days, and they filled them with dirt.

ሃላገዘ ላሠፋ ተላፋግጓ ረኀሃ
ጊኝጊግ ሃጊግፋ ጊላግዐ
ኝሃኝተቹ ሃጊግፋ ኝጓላግፋ
ላገዐ ኝሃፋረኝጊሃ ኝገተሠረገ

They mess up all the dating apps his dad built.

Genesis 26:16

And Abimelek said to Isaac, “Go from among us, because you’ve become much mightier than we are.”

ረፋ ሃረኝጊግፋ ላኝፋጊሃ
ጊኀ ሃነኝዐኝ ሃረ ዋዘሾጊ
ላፋኝ ሃነኝኝ ተኝሾዐ

So they do like a one man pogrom thing. Politely.

Genesis 26:17

And Isaac went from there and camped in the wadi of Gerar and lived there.

ነዘጊሃ ዋዘሾጊ ኝሠኝ ሃረጊሃ
ኝሠ ግሠጊሃ ላላገ ረዘነግ

Then Isaac goes and lives in the dried up river bed¹³⁹ of Lodging Place.

It’s nice there.

They have bed.

¹³⁹A wadi’s like a part time river. Dry sometimes. River sometimes.

Genesis 26:18

And Isaac went back and dug the water wells that they had dug in the days of his father Abraham and that the Philistines had stopped up after Abraham's death, and he called them by names, like the names that his father had called them.

ተቶ ላገዘጊሃ ዋዘኖጊ ልሠጊሃ
ሃላገዘ ላሠቶ ሠጊሠጊ ተላቶ
ሃጊጊቶ ሠጊላጊቶ ጊሠጊጊ
ሠጊተሠጊጊ ሠሃሠተቹጊሃ
ሠጊላጊቶ ተሃሠ ጊላዘቶ
ተሃሠሠ ሃጊጊ ቶላዋጊሃ
ሃጊጊ ቶላዋ ላሠቶ ተሠሠላ
ሃጊጊቶ

Then we begin a rather odd scene.

Isaac first fixes the p rincess magnets that got blocked after dad died.

Then he says their names like dad did.

Genesis 26:19

And Isaac's servants dug in the wadi and found a well of fresh water there.

ዋዘኖጊ ጊላጊዐ ሃላገዘጊሃ
ላቶጊ ሠሠ ሃቶኖሠጊሃ ጊዘጊጊ
ሠጊጊዘ ሠጊሠ

Then Isaac's guys dig in.

It's wet again.

Thanks to a bit of manual labor.

Genesis 26:20

And the shepherds of Gerar quarreled with Isaac's shepherds, saying, "The water is ours." And he called the name of the well Esek because they tangled with him.

ሠዐ ላላገ ጊዐላ ሃጊጊላጊሃ
ሃጊጊ ላሠቶጊ ዋዘኖጊ ጊዐላ
ላቶጊጊ ሠሠ ቶላዋጊሃ ሠጊሠጊ
ሃሠዐ ሃዋሠዐተጊ ጊላ ዋሠዐ

There's two groups of guys.

It turns into a fight.

The other guys are like "This hole is ours" so he names the hole Competition because there's competition for the hole.

Genesis 26:21

And they dug another well, and they quarreled over it also, and he called its name Sitnah.

ተላዘፉ ላፋፍ ሃላገዘጊሃ
ጓጊረዐ ሃገ ሃፍጊላጊሃ
ጓገፀሠ ጓሃሠ ፉላዋጊሃ

So they go get another hole and once again there’s conflict so they name this one Conflict.

Genesis 26:22

And he moved on from there and dug another well, and they did not quarrel over it, and he called its name Rehovot and said, “Because now YHWH has widened for us, and we’ve been fruitful in the land.”

ላገዘጊሃ ሃሠሃ ዋተዐጊሃ
ሃፍላ ፉረሃ ተላዘፉ ላፋፍ
ጓሃሠ ፉላዋጊሃ ጓጊረዐ
ጊሃ ላሃፉጊሃ ተሃፍዘላ
ሃገረ ጓሃጓጊ ፍጊዘላጓ ጓተዐ
ሶላፉ ሃገጊላገሃ

There’s other fish in the sea so they head over to the seaward parts and get another hole there and they call this one Broad¹⁴⁰ because now YHWH has widened for us and there’s enough room for everyone to share the fruits of this hole’s wetness.

Genesis 26:23

And he went up from there to Beer-sheba.

ዐፍሠ ላፋፍ ሃሠሃ ረዐጊሃ

And he goes to Seven Wells.
They have seven wells up there.

¹⁴⁰Curiously, the name of this well (RHB, Heb. רחב, meaning Wide, Broad, or Spread Out) is also the name of a prostitute (RHB, Heb. רחב, meaning Wide, Broad, or Spread Out) in the book of Joshua chapter 2, which scholars have argued was written by the same author as this section, both coming from the source known as J. Further, RHB is also the root from which the name of the king Rehoboam was derived. The evidence suggests that J was likely alive in the time of Rehoboam. In summary, though this section of the bible is not among the more popular or well known stories, from what we can gather, it involves a big wet hole that’s so big that all the guys can share, and also is the same name as a whore, and also the king at the time. The bible, ladies and gentlemen.

Genesis 26:24

And YHWH appeared to him that night and said, “I’m your father Abraham’s God. Don’t be afraid, because I’m with you, and I’ll bless you and multiply your seed on account of Abraham, my servant.”

እሃንጊ ሃጊረፋ ፋላጊሃ
ላማፋጊሃ ፋሃንጃ ጃረጊረፍ
ማንላፍፋ ጊጃረፋ ጊሃሃፋ
ጊሃ ፋላጊተ ረፋ ሃጊፍፋ
ሃጊተሃላፍሃ ጊሃሃፋ ሃተፋ
ሃዐላጊ ተፋ ጊተጊፍላጃሃ
ጊላፍዐ ማንላፍፋ ላሃፍዐፍ

YHWH shows up and does his seed schtick again.

Genesis 26:25

And he built an altar there and invoked the name YHWH. And he pitched his tent there, and Isaac’s servants dug a well there.

ፋላዋጊሃ ዘፍጊማ ማሠ ሃፍጊሃ
ማሠ ተጊሃ ጃሃንጊ ማሠፍ
ጊላፍዐ ማሠ ሃላሃጊሃ ሃረጃፋ
ላፋፍ ዋዘሂጊ

So Isaac’s like “YHWH.”

And he pitches a tent.

And his slaves open a well for him.

Genesis 26:26

And Abimelek and Ahuzat, his companion, and Phicol, the commander of his army, went to him from Gerar.

ሃጊረፋ ሃረጃ ሃረማጊፍፋሃ
ሃንዐላማ ተጊዘፋሃ ላላገማ
ሃፋፍሂ ላሠ ረሃጊጊሃ

And Abimelek and his friend Plantation, and Everybody’s Mouth the army man, come to him from Lodging Place.

Genesis 26:27

And Isaac said to them, “Why have you come to me, since you hated me and sent me away from you?”

ዋዘሂጊ ማንረፋ ላማፋጊሃ
ጊረፋ ማተፋፍ ዐሃላማ
ጊተፋ ማተፋሃሠ ማተፋሃ
ማሃተፋማ ጊሃሃዘረሠተሃ

Isaac’s like “Why are you here? Thought you hated me. Remember the one man pogram thing?”

Genesis 26:28

And they said, “We’ve seen that YHWH has been with you; and we say, ‘Let there be an oath between us, between us and you, and let us make a covenant with you

ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι

And they’re like “We heard you’ve been having some, well, success. Let’s make a deal. A coming together agreement.”

Genesis 26:29

that you won’t do bad toward us as we haven’t touched you and as we’ve done only good toward you and sent you away in peace. You are now blessed by YHWH.”

ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι

They’re like “Don’t be bad. We didn’t touch you. Remember how peaceful that little micro-pogrom was?”

Genesis 26:30

And he made a feast for them, and they ate and drank.

ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι

He makes dinner.

Genesis 26:31

And they got up early in the morning and swore, each man to his brother, and Isaac sent them away, and they went from him in peace.

ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι
ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι ἄλλοι

Isaac sends them away peacefully, just like they’d done to him.

Genesis 26:32

And it was in that day and Isaac's servants came and told him about the well that they had dug and said to him, "We found water."

כַּיָּאָא וַיָּבִיאוּ זֶאֱזִי
פֶּתִיחַ זֶאֱזִי וַיִּבְרְאוּ
תַּיִם לֹא יֵלֶךְ יִבְרְאוּ
יִבְרְאוּ אִתָּהּ אִתָּהּ
יִבְרְאוּ יֵלֶךְ יִבְרְאוּ
יֵלֶךְ

The same day, Isaac's guys come tell him about all the wetness.

Genesis 26:33

And he called it Seven. On account of this the name of the city is Beer-sheba to this day.

לֹא אֶזְכָּר אֶת־כֹּחַ אֲבֹתִי
אֶזְכָּר אֶת־כֹּחַ אֲבֹתִי
אֶת־כֹּחַ אֲבֹתִי אֶת־כֹּחַ

He calls it Seven.

That's why we call it Seven Wells.¹⁴¹

Genesis 26:34

And Esau was forty years old, and he took a wife: Judith, daughter of Beeri, the Hittite, and Basemath, daughter of Elon, the Hittite.

וַיְהִי עֶשָׂו בֶּן־אַרְבָּעִים
שָׁנָה וַיִּקַּח אִשָּׁה אֶת־
יְהוֹדִית בִּתְּ בְּאֵרִי
תַּחְתִּי וְאֶת־בְּשֵׁמֶת בִּתְּ
אֵילָן תַּחְתִּי׃

Ok so Esau's forty.

He marries a girl named "Jewish Girl."

Genesis 26:35

And they were a bitterness of spirit to Isaac and to Re-bekah.

וַתְּהִי־לָהֶם מִרְתַּת רוּחַ
לִיצְחָק וּלְרֵבֶקָה׃

Isaac and Rebecca can't believe he would do something like that.

¹⁴¹Seven Wells is the capital of Dry Place.

Genesis 27

Genesis 27:1

And it was when Isaac was old and his eyes were too dim for seeing: and he called Esau, his older son, and said to him, “My son.” And he said to him, “I’m here.”

ወይኛ ሃዋጊ ጌሃ ጌጃጊሃ
ተፋላግ ሃጊሃጌዐ ሃጊጃሃተሃ
ሃሃፅ ሃሠዐ ተፋ ፋላዋጊሃ
ጌሃፅ ሃጊረፋ ላግፋጊሃ ረላገጃ
ጌሃገጃ ሃጊረፋ ላግፋጊሃ

Oh man ok so, here’s a story...

Isaac’s old now.

He’s kinda blind.¹⁴²

He’s like “Esau!”

And Esau’s like “I’m right here.”

Genesis 27:2

And he said, “Here, I’ve become old. I don’t know the day of my death.

ጌተሃዋጊ ፋሃ ጃሃጃ ላግፋጊሃ
ጌተሃግ ግሃጊ ጌተዐላጊ ፋረ

Isaac reminds Esau that he’s old.

He also reminds him that he, like all of us, doesn’t know the day we die.

Genesis 27:3

And now, take up your implements: your quiver and your bow, and go out to the field and hunt me some game

ሃጊረሃ ፋሃ ፋሠ ጃተዐሃ
ፋሾሃ ሃተሠዋሃ ሃጊረተ
ጊረ ጃላሃሾሃ ጃላሠጃ
[ላጊሾ] (ጃላጊሾ)

Qere Ketiv.

So he’s like “Take your bow and arrow and get me some food son.”

Genesis 27:4

¹⁴²On account of this, the name of the story is The Blinding Of Isaac.

and make me the kind of delicacies that I love and bring them to me and let me eat, so my soul will bless you before I die.”

ሠጊሠዐ፱ሠ ጊረ ጳሠዐሃ
ጳፋጊዓጸሃ ጊተዓጸፋ ላሠፋሃ
ላሃዓዐዓ ጳረሃፋሃ ጊረ
ሠላ፱ዓ ጊሠገሃ ሃሃላዓተ
ተሃሃፋ

“Make me some of that stuff I love, and I’ll give you my blessing before I die.”

Genesis 27:5

And Rebekah was listening as Isaac was speaking to Esau, his son. And Esau went to the field to hunt game to bring.

ላዓላዓ ተዐሠሠ ጳዋዓላሃ
ሃረጊሃ ሃሃዓ ሃሠዐ ረፋ ዋዘሥጊ
ላጊሥ ላሃሥረ ጳላሠጳ ሃሠዐ
ፋጊዓጸረ

Rebecca’s in the other room listening.

Esau heads out to hunt.

Genesis 27:6

And Rebekah said to Jacob, her son, saying, “Here I’ve heard your father speaking to Esau, your brother, saying,

ዓዋዐጊ ረፋ ጳላሠፋ ጳዋዓላሃ
ጊተዐሠሠ ጳሃጳ ላሠፋረ ጳሃዓ
ሃሠዐ ረፋ ላዓላሠ ሃጊዓፋ ተፋ
ላሠፋረ ሃጊዘፋ

And Rebecca’s like “Jacob.”

“Look, I heard your dad talking to your brother.”

Genesis 27:7

‘Bring me game and make me delicacies so I may eat, and I’ll bless you in the presence of YHWH before my death.’

ጳሠዐሃ ላጊሥ ጊረ ጳፋጊዓጸ
ጳረሃፋሃ ሠጊሠዐ፱ሠ ጊረ
ጳሃጳጊ ጊሃገረ ጳሃሃላዓፋሃ
ጊተሃሃ ጊሃገረ

“He said to go hunting and bring him that meat he loves before he dies and he’d give him the blessing.”

Genesis 27:8

And now, my son, listen to my voice, to what I’m commanding you.

ገረዋል ዐግሠ ገንዳ ጸተዐሃ
ሃተቱ ጸሃሾግ ገንቱ ላሠቱረ

“Ok son listen to me.”

Genesis 27:9

Go to the flock and take two good goat kids for me from there, and I’ll make them the kind of delicacies that your father loves.

ገረ ዘዋሃ ሃቱሾጻ ረቱ ቶን ሃረ
ግገረዐ ገገላገ ገንሠ ግሠግ
ግተቱ ጸሠዐቱሃ ግገዳ፬
ላሠቱሃ ሃገዳቱረ ግገግዐ፬ግ
ዳጸቱ

“We already have food. Go outside and get some of the goats from the front yard. I’ll make them how dad likes.”

Genesis 27:10

And bring them to your father, and he’ll eat, so he’ll bless you before his death.”

ረሃቱሃ ሃገዳቱረ ተቱዳጸሃ
ገንገረ ሃሃላዳጊ ላሠቱ ላዳዐዳ
ሃተሃግ

“Then bring them to dad and he’ll give you the blessing instead.”

Genesis 27:11

And Jacob said to Rebekah, his mother, “Here, Esau, my brother, is a hairy man and I’m a smooth man.

ጸዋዳላ ረቱ ዳዋዐጊ ላግቱጊሃ
ሠጊቱ ገዘቱ ሃሠዐ ሃጸ ሃግቱ
ዋረዘ ሠጊቱ ገሃንቱሃ ላዐሠ

So Jacob responds with one of the best lines in the bible:

The Tyndale bible from 1530 renders it as:

“Beholde, my brother Esau is a heery man, and I am a smothe man.”

You’ve gotta love this book.

Genesis 27:12

Maybe my father will feel me, and
I'll be like a trickster in his eyes,
and I'll bring a curse on me and
not a blessing."

ገጽ ገሃሠገገ ገረሃፋ
ሃገሃገዐፍ ገተገገጸሃ
ገረዐ ገተፋፍጸሃ ዐተዐተሃ
ጸሃላፍ ፋረሃ ጸረረዋ

Tyndale, 1530:

"Mi father shal peradueture fele me ad I shal seme vnto hi as though I
wet aboute to begyle hi and so shall he brige a curse vpo me and not a
blessige."

Languages change.

Humor is timeless.

Genesis 27:13

And his mother said to him, "Let
your curse be on me, my son; just
listen to my voice and go take
them for me."

ገረዐ ሃሃፋ ሃረ ላሃፋተሃ
ዐሃሠ ሃፋ ገሃፍ ሃተረረዋ
ገረ ዘዋ ሃረሃ ገረዋፍ

So his mom's like "Oh whatever I'll take the blame. Just do what I said
and go get the goats from the yard."

Quick, before Esau gets back.

Genesis 27:14

And he went and took and
brought them to his mother, and
his mother made the kind of
delicacies that his father loved.

ሃሃፋረ ፋፍገሃ ዘዋገሃ ሃረገሃ
ሃገሃዐፅሃ ሃሃፋ ሠዐተሃ
ሃገፍፋ ፍጸፋ ላሠፋፍ

So he goes and gets the goats and mom cooks em up real nice.

Genesis 27:15

And Rebekah took the finest
clothes of Esau, her older son, that
were with her in the house and put
them on Jacob, her younger son,

ገላገፍ ተፋ ጸዋፍፍ ዘዋተሃ
ተላሃዘጸ ረላገጸ ጸሃፍ ሃሠዐ
ሠፍረተሃ ተገፍፍ ጸተፋ ላሠፋ
ሃፅዋጸ ጸሃፍ ፍዋዐገ ተፋ

She dresses Jacob in Esau's clothes.

Genesis 27:16

and put the skins of the goat kids
on his hands and on the smooth
part of his neck.

ሠጊገዐጃ ጊጊላገ ተላዐ ተፋሃ
ገዐሃ ሃጊላጊ ገዐ ጃሠጊላጊ
ሃጊላፋሃሾ ተዋረዘ

She makes a little makeshift goat costume for him.

Remember they just killed the yard goats.

So she has goat skin lying around.

Now the smooth man has become a hairy man.

Dad’s blind, he’ll never notice.

Genesis 27:17

And she put the delicacies and the
bread that she’d made in the hand
of Jacob, her son.

ሠጊሠዐ፱ሠጃ ተፋ ሃተተሃ
ጃተሠዐ ላሠፋ ሠዘረጃ ተፋሃ
ጃሃፍ ፍዋዐጊ ላጊላ

She gives Jacob the food.

Genesis 27:18

And he came to his father. And
he said, “My father.” And he said,
“I’m here. Who are you, my son?”

ላሠፋጊሃ ሃጊላፋ ረፋ ፋፍጊሃ
ጊሠ ጊሃሃጃ ላሠፋጊሃ ጊላፋ
ጊሃፍ ጃተፋ

Now Jacob, covered in goat skin costume and Esau clothes, comes to dad.

He’s like “Hey dad.”

Dad’s like “I’m here. Who is it?”

Genesis 27:19

And Jacob said to his father, “I’m
Esau, your firstborn. I did as you
spoke to me. Get up, sit, and eat
some of my game so your soul
will bless me.”

ሃጊላፋ ረፋ ፍዋዐጊ ላሠፋጊሃ
ጊተጊሠዐ ሃላሃፍ ሃሠዐ ጊሃሃፋ
ሠሃዋ ጊረፋ ተላፍላ ላሠፋሃ
ጊላጊሾሠ ጃረሃፋሃ ጃፍሠ ፋሃ
ሃሠገሃ ጊሃሃላፍተ ላሃፍዐፍ

Jacob’s like “It’s Esau. The one with the birthright. I did what you asked.
He’s some of that food you asked for. Something about a blessing.”

Genesis 27:20

And Isaac said to his son, “What’s this? You were quick to find it, my son.” And he said, “Because YHWH your God made it happen for me.”

ሃሃዓ ረፋ ዋይሂጊ ላሣፋጊሃ
ፋሂሣረ ተላጓሣ ጓጊ ጓሣ
ጓላዋጓ ጊሃ ላሣፋጊሃ ጊሃዓ
ጊሃገረ ሃጊጓረፋ ጓሃጓጊ

So Isaac’s like “That was fast.”

And Jacob’s like “... Right. YHWH helped.”

Genesis 27:21

And Isaac said to Jacob, “Come over, and I’ll feel you, my son: is this you, my son Esau, or not?”

ዓዋዐጊ ረፋ ዋይሂጊ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጊሃዓ ሃሠሣፋሃ ፋሃ ጓሠገ
ሣፋ ሃሠዐ ጊሃዓ ጓጊ ጓተፋጓ
ፋረ

So Isaac’s like “Let me feel you to see if you’re really Esau.”

Technical flaws in this approach are discussed in the footnote below.¹⁴³

Genesis 27:22

And Jacob came over to Isaac, his father, and he felt him. And he said, “The voice is the voice of Jacob, and the hands are the hands of Esau.”

ዋይሂጊ ረፋ ዓዋዐጊ ሠገጊሃ
ላሣፋጊሃ ሃጓሠሣጊሃ ሃጊዓፋ
ሣጊላጊጓሃ ዓዋዐጊ ረሃዋ ረዋጓ
ሃሠዐ ጊላጊ

Here two new cues enter the picture, the senses of (1) hearing, and (2) touch.

The first cue correctly flags Jacob as suspicious.

As for the second cue, the improvised goat skin costume apparently passes as Esau.

Isaac now has two conflicting cues.

Let’s see if Isaac’s Esau detection system has two factor authentication

¹⁴³Isaac’s approach here relies on the well known fact that the first requirement for any Esau detection system is “if not hairy, then not Esau.” By modus tollens, this is equivalent to the contrapositive “If Esau, then hairy.” However, as every Esau detection system engineer well knows, the inverse (If hairy then Esau) and converse (If not Esau, then not hairy) of Isaac’s sentence do not follow! The first known Esau detection system, namely Isaac in Gen 27:21, famously failed to recognize this, due to (a) the existence of goats, and (b) the degradation of visual capacity in Gen 27:1, commonly known The Blinding of Isaac, which combined to form a security vulnerability that allowed an attacker to authenticate as Esau and exfiltrate the blessing.

enabled.

Genesis 27:23

And he did not recognize him because his hands were hairy like the hands of Esau, his brother, and he blessed him.

ሃገጃ ጊሃ ሃላጊሃጃ ፋረሃ
ሃጊዘፋ ሃሠዐ ጊላጊሃ ሃጊላጊ
ሃጃሃላጊሃ ሃላዐሠ

It does not.

And the attacker successfully exfiltrates the blessing.

Genesis 27:24

And he said, “Is this you, my son Esau?” And he said, “I am.”

ጊሃጃ ጸጊ ጸተፋ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጊሃፋ ላሣፋጊሃ ሃሠዐ

The authentication system here is really beyond help.

Genesis 27:25

And he said, “Bring it over to me and let me eat some of my son’s game so that my soul will bless you. And he brought it over to him, and he ate; and he brought him wine, and he drank.

ጊረ ጸሠገጃ ላሣፋጊሃ
ሃዐሣረ ጊሃጃ ላጊሶሣ ጸረሃፋሃ
ሃረ ሠገጊሃ ጊሠገገ ሃሃላጃተ
ሃጊጊ ሃረ ፋጃጊሃ ረሃፋጊሃ
ተሠጊሃ

Now we move on to the sense of (3) taste.

At this point, one might expect Isaac to notice something is up, since goat and game animals do not, in fact, taste the same.

However, as one scholar has pointed out, this is the ancient near east, and if you put enough cumin on anything it all eventually tastes the same.

Genesis 27:26

And Isaac, his father, said to him, “Come over and kiss me, my son.”

ዋዘሾጊ ሃጊረፋ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጊረ ጸዋሠሃ ፋሃ ጸሠገ ሃጊጃፋ
ጊሃጃ

We’re now moving to another touch test, plus a new test based on (4) the sense of smell.

Genesis 27:27

And he came over and kissed him, and he smelled the aroma of his clothes and blessed him and said, “See, my son’s aroma is like the aroma of a field that YHWH has blessed.

הָאֵלֹהִים יְלֵךְ פָּנָיו וְיָבֵן
 יְזַאֲרֵה הָאֵלֹהִים יְזַאֲרֵה
 יְזַאֲרֵה יְזַאֲרֵה יְזַאֲרֵה
 יְזַאֲרֵה יְזַאֲרֵה יְזַאֲרֵה
 יְזַאֲרֵה יְזַאֲרֵה יְזַאֲרֵה

Read that line again.

What can we infer about the author?

What do you have to believe in order to write a line like this?

It turns out the author of this line also wrote most of the best known bible stories.¹⁴⁴

Think of what that means for the rest of the book.

¹⁴⁴The Garden of Eden (Gen 2), the snake and the fruit (Gen 3), Cain and Abel (Gen 4), Lamech’s song (Gen 4), the sons of God and human women (Gen 6), the Flood (Gen 6–9, later combined with P), Noah’s drunkenness (Gen 9), the Tower of Babel (Gen 11), the call of Abram (Gen 12), Abram and Sarai in Egypt (Gen 12), Abram and Lot (Gen 13, later with P), the covenant with Abram (Gen 15), Hagar and Ishmael (Gen 16, later with P), Abraham’s visitors (Gen 18), Abraham bargaining for Sodom (Gen 18), Sodom and Gomorrah (Gen 19, later with P), Lot and his daughters (Gen 19), the birth of Isaac (Gen 21, later with P), Nahor’s family (Gen 22), Rebekah at the well (Gen 24), Jacob and Esau (Gen 25), Isaac and Abimelech (Gen 26), Jacob stealing Esau’s blessing (Gen 27), Jacob’s dream at Bethel (Gen 28, later combined with E), Jacob and Rachel at the well (Gen 29), Jacob marrying Leah and Rachel (Gen 29), Rachel and Leah’s baby war (Gen 29–30, later with E), Jacob’s spotted sheep (Gen 30), Jacob fleeing Laban (Gen 31, later with E), Jacob wrestling God (Gen 32), Dinah and Shechem (Gen 34), Joseph and his dreams (Gen 37, later with E), Joseph sold by his brothers (Gen 37, later with E), Judah and Tamar (Gen 38), Joseph and Potiphar’s wife (Gen 39), Joseph’s brothers in Egypt (Gen 42–45, later with E), Jacob’s family entering Egypt (Gen 46, later with P), Jacob’s death (Gen 47, later with P), Jacob’s blessings (Gen 49), Jacob’s burial (Gen 50, later with P), Moses’ birth and rescue (Exod 2), Moses killing the Egyptian (Exod 2), Moses and Zipporah at the well (Exod 2), the bloody bridegroom (Exod 4), the plagues (Exod 8–12, later with P), the Passover (Exod 12, later with P), the Exodus (Exod 12–14, later with P), the crossing of the sea (Exod 14, later with P and E), the Song of the Sea (Exod 15), water from the rock (Exod 17), YHWH descending on Sinai (Exod 19, later with P and E), the golden calf (Exod 32, later with E), Moses seeing YHWH (Exod 33), the renewed covenant (Exod 34), Israel leaving Sinai (Num 10), the quail (Num 11, later with E), the twelve spies (Num 13–14, later with P and E), the rebellion of Dathan and Abiram (Num 16, later with E and P), water from the rock (Num 20, later with E and P), the bronze snake (Num 21), Baal Peor (Num 25, later with P), Rahab and the spies (Josh 2), crossing the Jordan (Josh 3), circumcision at Gilgal (Josh 5), Joshua and YHWH’s commander (Josh 5), the fall of Jericho (Josh 6), Achan (Josh 7), the conquest of Ai (Josh 8), the Gibeonite deception (Josh 9), the sun standing still (Josh 10), Joshua’s northern conquests (Josh 11), the angel at Bochim (Judg 2), Abimelech murdering his brothers and becoming king (Judg 9), Jephthah and his daughter (Judg 11), the birth of Samson (Judg 13), Samson and the lion (Judg 14), Samson and the foxes (Judg 15), Samson and the jawbone (Judg 15), Samson and Delilah (Judg 16), Samson’s death (Judg 16), Micah’s idol (Judg 17), the Danites stealing Micah’s shrine (Judg 18), the cut-up concubine (Judg 19), the Benjaminite civil war (Judg 20), the kidnapping of the women of Shiloh (Judg 21), Hannah and Samuel (1 Sam 1), Eli’s corrupt sons (1 Sam 2), Samuel’s call (1 Sam 3), the captured Ark (1 Sam 4–6), Dagon falling before the Ark (1 Sam 5), Israel demanding a king (1 Sam 8), Saul chosen by lot (1 Sam 10), Saul rescuing Jabesh-Gilead (1 Sam 11),

Whenever you try to understand some line of J, remember, the author of what you’re reading also wrote Gen 27:27.

J nearly gives away the whole game in this line.

Still, it seems like mostly no one noticed.

J truly is the Greatest Of All Time.

Genesis 27:28

And may God give you from the dew of the skies and from the fat of the earth and much grain and wine.

ᐱᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ

Cue the blessing.

Genesis 27:29

May peoples serve you and nations bow to you. Be your brothers’ superior, and may your mother’s sons bow to you. May those who curse you be cursed and those who bless you be blessed.”

ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
[ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ] (ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ)
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ

Qere Ketiv.

Blessing in progress.

Saul’s rejection (1 Sam 15), David entering Saul’s court (1 Sam 16), David and Goliath’s confrontation (1 Sam 17), Saul’s jealousy of David (1 Sam 18–19), David and Abigail (1 Sam 25), David sparing Saul (1 Sam 26), David among the Philistines (1 Sam 27), the witch of Endor (1 Sam 28), David and Achish (1 Sam 29), David rescuing Ziklag (1 Sam 30), Saul’s death (1 Sam 31), David’s lament for Saul and Jonathan (2 Sam 1), David becoming king of Judah (2 Sam 2), Abner and Joab’s war (2 Sam 2–3), Joab murdering Abner (2 Sam 3), Ishbaal’s murder (2 Sam 4), David becoming king of Israel (2 Sam 5), David capturing Jerusalem (2 Sam 5), David dancing before the Ark (2 Sam 6), YHWH’s promise to David (2 Sam 7), David’s wars (2 Sam 8–10), David and Bathsheba (2 Sam 11), David murdering Uriah (2 Sam 11), Nathan’s lamb (2 Sam 12), Amnon raping Tamar (2 Sam 13), Absalom killing Amnon (2 Sam 13), Absalom’s return (2 Sam 14), Absalom’s rebellion (2 Sam 15–18), David fleeing Jerusalem (2 Sam 15), Shimei cursing David (2 Sam 16), Absalom and David’s concubines (2 Sam 16), Ahithophel’s suicide (2 Sam 17), Absalom’s death (2 Sam 18), David mourning Absalom (2 Sam 18–19), David returning to Jerusalem (2 Sam 19), Sheba’s rebellion (2 Sam 20), Rizpah and Saul’s sons (2 Sam 21), Adonijah claiming the throne (1 Kgs 1), Bathsheba and Nathan putting Solomon on the throne (1 Kgs 1), David’s deathbed instructions (1 Kgs 2), Solomon killing Adonijah (1 Kgs 2), Solomon killing Joab (1 Kgs 2), and Solomon killing Shimei and securing the kingdom (1 Kgs 2).

Genesis 27:30

And it was as Isaac finished blessing Jacob, and it was: Jacob had just gone out from the presence of Isaac, his father!—and Esau, his brother, came from his hunting.

ዋይሮጊ ጸረጽ ላወቀጽ ጊጸጊህ
ጊጸጊህ ያዋዐጊ ተቀ ጸላፍረ
ያዋዐጊ ቀሮጊ ቀሮጊ ጸቀ
ሃጊያቀ ዋይሮጊ ጊሃገ ተቀኝ
ሃላጊሮኝ ቀያ ሃጊይቀ ሃወዐሃ

Blessing exfiltrated.

Then Esau lumbers¹⁴⁵ in.

Genesis 27:31

And he, too, had made delicacies and brought them to his father. And he said to his father, “Let my father get up and eat some of his son’s game so you yourself will bless me.”

ቀሃፓ ሃገ ወዐጊህ
ሃጊያቀረ ቀያጊህ ሃጊኝዐፅኝ
ኝዋጊ ሃጊያቀረ ላኝቀጊህ
ሃሃያ ላጊሮኝ ረጸቀጊህ ጊያቀ
ጸወገሃ ጊሃጸላፍተ ላፍዐፍ

Race condition exploited.

Time to run Jacob.

Genesis 27:32

And Isaac, his father, said to him, “Who are you?” And he said, “I’m your son, your firstborn, Esau.”

ሃጊያቀ ዋይሮጊ ሃረ ላኝቀጊህ
ጊሃቀ ላኝቀጊህ ጸተቀ ጊኝ
ሃወዐ ጸላፍፍ ጸሃፍ

They go through the whole auth routine.

Genesis 27:33

¹⁴⁵Lit. “logs” in the original, translated “lumber” here, since “log” is not a typical English term for a manner of walking, though the term “lumber” also refers to logs, and can in addition describe a manner of brutish walking, which is consistent with how Esau is described in the text. Given this convergence of evidence, we are reasonably confident that this was the original author’s meaning.

And Isaac trembled—a very big trembling. And he said, “Who then is the one who hunted game and brought it to me, and I ate some of it all before you came, and I blessed him? He will in fact be blessed.”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐅᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Isaac, who has exactly two sons, is at a loss for who the other person might have been.

Genesis 27:34

When Esau heard his father’s words he cried—a very big and bitter cry. And he said to his father, “Bless me, also me, my father.”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Then they cry and cry until they’re all out of tears.¹⁴⁶

Genesis 27:35

And he said, “Your brother came with deception, and he took your blessing.”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Blessing call failed with message: We cry.¹⁴⁷

Genesis 27:36

And he said, “Was his name really called Jacob! And he’s usurped me two times now. He’s taken my birthright, and, here, now he’s taken my blessing.” And he said, “Haven’t you saved a blessing for me?”

ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Then they make puns about how they really shouldn’t have named the other brother Usurper.

¹⁴⁶Lit. MEM in the original, presumably from Paleo-Heb מֶמ (mm/mem/, meaning “water”), from Proto-Semitic *ma’, translated here as tears, given the lacrimatory context.
¹⁴⁷Lit. brk call failed with message: ENOMEM in the original text. The former is presumably a Latin alphabet rendering of Heb. brk (בֵּרַךְ) meaning “blessing,” given the benedictory context, and the latter presumably a similar rendering of Heb. וַנֵּן meaning We, and of Heb. “mem,” as above, given the nosistic and ibidem contexts respectively.

They're like "Isn't that why he's called Jacob? He's Jacob'd me twice now!"

Genesis 27:37

And Isaac answered, and he said to Esau, "Here I've made him your superior, and I've given all his brothers as servants, and I've endowed him with grain and wine. And for you: where, what, will I do, my son?"

ላማቅጊሃ ዋዘኢጊ ነዐጊሃ
ሃጊተኝሠ ላጊገገ ነጻ ሃሠዐረ
ሃጊዘቅ ረኃ ተቅሃ ሃረ
ነገላሃ ንጊላገዐረ ሃረ ጊተተነ
ጳሃረሃ ሃጊተኝኝቹ ሠላጊተሃ
ጊነጻ ጳሠዐቅ ጳኝ ቅሃገቅ

Laughter and the Human can't believe Usurper got the blessed of them.

Genesis 27:38

And Esau said to his father, "Is it one blessing that you have, my father? Bless me, also me, my father." And Esau raised his voice and wept.

ሃጊገቅ ረቅ ሃሠዐ ላማቅጊሃ
ሃረ ቅሃጻ ተዘቅ ጳሃላጻጻ
ጊነቅ ንገ ጊነኝላጻ ጊነቅ
ሃረዋ ሃሠዐ ቅሠጊሃ ጊነቅ
ኝጻጊሃ

Esau digs around looking for another blessing.

Genesis 27:39

And Isaac, his father, answered, and he said to him, "Here, away from the fat of the earth will be your home, and from the dew of the skies from above.

ሃጊገቅ ዋዘኢጊ ነዐጊሃ
ጳነጻ ሃጊረቅ ላማቅጊሃ
ጳጊጳጊ ጦላቅጻ ጊነኝሠኝ
ኝጊኝሠጻ ረፀኝሃ ኝጻሠሃኝ
ረዐኝ

Isaac uses basically the same words as before but they're bad this time.

Genesis 27:40

And you'll live by your sword. And you'll serve your brother. And it will be that when you get dominion you'll break his yoke from your neck."

ተቅሃ ጳጊዘተ ኝጻላዘ ረዐሃ
ጳጊጳሃ ላገዐተ ኝጊዘቅ
ሃረዐ ተዋላገሃ ላጊላተ ላሠቅኝ
ኝላቅሃኢ ረዐኝ

Dad's like "Life's gonna be rough, son."

Genesis 27:41

And Esau despised Jacob because of the blessing with which his father blessed him, and Esau said in his heart, “The days of mourning for my father will be soon, and then I’ll kill Jacob, my brother.”

ዓዋዐጊ ተቀ ሃወዐ ሃፀወጊሃ
ሃሃላፍ ላወቀ ጓሃላፍጓ ረዐ
ሃወዐ ላሃቀጊሃ ሃጊፍቀ
ረፍቀ ጊሃጊ ሃፍላዋጊ ሃፍረፍ
ዓዋዐጊ ተቀ ጓገላጓቀሃ ጊፍቀ
ጊዘቀ

So the Red man hates Usurper.
He resolves to kill Jacob when dad dies.

Genesis 27:42

And the words of Esau, her older son, were told to Rebekah, and she sent and called to Jacob, her younger son, and said to him, “Here, Esau, your brother, consoles himself regarding you with the idea of killing you.

ጊላፍላ ተቀ ጓዋፍላረ ላገጊሃ
ዘረወተሃ ረላገጓ ጓሃፍ ሃወዐ
ጓሃፍ ዓዋዐጊረ ቀላዋተሃ
ሃጊረቀ ላሃቀተሃ ሃፀዋጓ
ሃዘሃተሃ ሃጊዘቀ ሃወዐ ጓሃጓ
ሃገላጓረ ሃረ

Rebecca (who masterminded this whole thing) hears about it.

Genesis 27:43

And now, my son, listen to my voice and get up, flee to Laban, my brother, at Haran

ጊረዋፍ ዐሃወ ጊሃፍ ጓተዐሃ
ሃፍረ ረቀ ሃረ ዘላፍ ሃሃዋሃ
ጓሃላዘ ጊዘቀ

She’s like “Run time kid.”
And she says to go stay with her brother White.
He lives in Haran.
Remember that.
Jacob’s going to Haran.

Genesis 27:44

and live with him for a number of days until your brother's fury will turn back,

וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב אֶת־אֶשָׁו
וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב אֶת־אֶשָׁו
וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב אֶת־אֶשָׁו

Live with him until Esau calms down.

Genesis 27:45

until your brother's anger turns back from you and he forgets what you did to him. And I'll send and take you from there. Why should I be bereaved of the two of you as well in one day?"

וְעַד־כֵּן אֶשָׁו
וְעַד־כֵּן אֶשָׁו
וְעַד־כֵּן אֶשָׁו
וְעַד־כֵּן אֶשָׁו
וְעַד־כֵּן אֶשָׁו

He'll forget eventually anyway.

Genesis 27:46

And Rebekah said to Isaac, "I'm disgusted with my life because of the daughters of Heth! If Jacob takes a wife from the daughters of Heth like these daughters of the land, why do I have a life!"

וַתֹּאמֶר רִבְקָה אֶל־
יִצְחָק קִצְתִּי בְּתוֹתִי מִפְּנֵי
בָּנוֹת חֵת אִם לְקַח
יַעֲקֹב אִשָּׁה מִבָּנוֹת חֵת
כְּאֵלֶּה מִבָּנוֹת הָאָרֶץ
לָמָּה לִּי חַיִּים׃

Previously on: P.

Ok so last we left off in P, we were in Gen 26:34-35.

Esau had just married a girl named "Jewish Girl," and another one named Basemath.¹⁴⁸

And mom and dad were NOT happy about that.

So now in this verse, Rebecca is suddenly mad about the daughters of Heth, which means the Hittites, which suggests we're picking back up where Gen 26:35 left off.

Then the chapter abruptly ends.

¹⁴⁸There was a \usepackage[latex]{basemath} joke here but it kept breaking the build.

Genesis 28

Genesis 28:1

And Isaac called Jacob, and he blessed him and commanded him, and he said to him, “You shall not take a wife from the daughters of Canaan.

וַיִּקְרָא יִצְחָק אֶל יַעֲקֹב
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתוֹ וַיְצַוֵּהוּ
וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ לֹא תִקַּח
אִשָּׁה מִבָּנוֹת כְּנָעַן׃

Ok, a quick recap before we proceed.

One sentence before this, Rebecca is disgusted with her life because of the daughters of Heth, which is the Hittites.

Two sentences before this, they’re a bitterness of spirit to Rebecca.

Three sentences before this, we find out that Esau married a girl named Judith (“Jewish Girl”) and another one named Basemath (“Smells Good”) who are supposedly Hitties.

Now in this sentence, Isaac gives Jacob his blessing, and says he hopes that Jacob doesn’t turn out how Esau did, specifically, he doesn’t want him marrying any Canaanites, which “includes” the Hittites.¹⁴⁹

So Jacob gets his father’s blessing fair and square because Jacob and Rebecca are mad that Esau married two birds from up north.

Genesis 28:2

Get up. Go to Paddan Aram, to the house of Bethuel, your mother’s father, and take a wife from there, from the daughters of Laban, your mother’s brother.

קוּם לֵךְ פָּדָן אֲרָם
בֵּיתָה בְּתוּאֵל אָבִי אִמְךָ
וְקַח לָךְ מִשָּׁם אִשָּׁה
מִבָּנוֹת לָבָן אָחִי אִמְךָ׃

So that’s why they tell Jacob to go to Laban’s place and marry his cousins.

Recall that Laban means white.

So his daughters are white girls.

¹⁴⁹In the bible, Hittites are a type of Canaanites. That’s an understandable inference, but not exactly true, as far as we can tell archaeologically. That is, since the text depicts Rebecca as not liking the Hittites, it’s as if she’s mad that her son married two girls named Sakura and Nahyun, and then the dad says to Jacob “Don’t go and marry a bunch of Chinese girls like your brother did.” An understandable mistake. They’re not exactly connoisseurs of the people in question.

Also Laban lives Paddan Aram.

Remember that.

Jacob's going to Paddan Aram.

Genesis 28:3

And may El Shadday bless you
and make you fruitful and
multiply you, so you'll become a
community of peoples,

וְאֵל שַׁדַּי יְבָרֶךְ אֶתְךָ
וַיַּפְרֶךְ וַיַּרְבֶּךָ וְהָיִיתָ
לְקַהֲל עַמִּים:

And may God of the Mountain (or God of Breasts, we're not sure, but it's possible that Shaddai means something about fertility) give you lots of fertility (what a coincidence.)

Genesis 28:4

and may He give you the
blessing of Abraham, to you
and to your seed with you, for
you to possess the land of your
residences, which God gave to
Abraham.”

וַיֵּתֶן לְךָ אֶת בְּרַכַּת
אַבְרָהָם לְךָ וּלְזַרְעֶךָ
אֶתְךָ לְרִשְׁתָּךְ אֶת
אֶרֶץ מְגֻרֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן
אֱלֹהִים לְאַבְרָהָם:

He goes on about seed for awhile.

Genesis 28:5

And Isaac sent Jacob, and he
went to Paddan Aram, to
Laban, son of Bethuel, the
Aramean, brother of Rebekah,
mother of Jacob and Esau.

וַיִּשְׁלַח יִצְחָק אֶת יַעֲקֹב
וַיֵּלֶךְ פָּדָנָה אֲרָם אֶל
לָבָן בֶּן בְּתוּאֵל הָאֲרָמִי
אָחִי רֵבְקָה אִם יַעֲקֹב
וְעֵשָׂו:

Jacob goes to the White house.

It's in Paddan Aram.

Genesis 28:6

And Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob and sent him to Paddan Aram to take a wife for himself from there when he blessed him, and he had commanded him, saying, “You shall not take a wife from the daughters of Canaan,”

וַיֵּרָא עֵשָׂו כִּי בֵרַךְ יִצְחָק אֶת יַעֲקֹב וְשָׁלַח אֹתוֹ פָּדָן אַרָם לָקַחַת לוֹ מְשָׁם אִשָּׁה בְּבָרְכוֹ אֹתוֹ וַיֹּצֵו עָלָיו לֵאמֹר לֹא תִקַּח אִשָּׁה מִבָּנוֹת כְּנָעַן׃

Esau sees that Jacob got the blessing because of the whole Hittite Wives thing.

Genesis 28:7

and Jacob had listened to his father and to his mother and had gone to Paddan Aram.

וַיִּשְׁמַע יַעֲקֹב אֶל אָבִיו וְאֶל אִמּוֹ וַיֵּלֶךְ פָּדָן אַרָם׃

Jacob had already gone to the White House.

It's in Paddan Aram.

Genesis 28:8

And Esau saw that the daughters of Canaan were bad in his father Isaac's eyes.

וַיֵּרָא עֵשָׂו כִּי רָעוֹת בְּנוֹת כְּנָעַן בְּעֵינֵי יִצְחָק אָבִיו׃

Esau sees that his dad doesn't like Canaanite girls.

Genesis 28:9

And Esau went to Ishmael and took Mahalath, daughter of Ishmael, son of Abraham, sister of Nebaioth, in addition to his wives as a wife for him.

וַיֵּלֶךְ עֵשָׂו אֶל יִשְׁמָעֵאל וַיִּקַּח אֶת מַחֲלַת בַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל בֶּן אַבְרָהָם אֲחוֹת נְבִיּוֹת עַל נָשָׁיו לוֹ לְאִשָּׁה׃

So Esau goes to his uncle and marries his cousin as a third wife, which he

hopes his dad will approve of.

Genesis 28:10

And Jacob left Beer-sheba and went to Haran.

ዐጋሠ ላፋዓሣ ላዋዐጊ ፋሾጊሂ
እነላይ ሃረጊሂ

Okay so at this point Jacob leaves.

He goes to Haran.

Genesis 28:11

And he happened upon a place and stayed the night there because the sun was setting. And he took from the stones of the place and set it as his headrest and lay down in that place.

ሥሠ ሃረጊሂ ሥሃዋሥጋ ዐገገጊሂ
ይዋጊኛ ሠሃሠጃ ፋዓ ጊሃ
ሃሠጊኛ ሥኖሃጃ ጊሃጋፋሂ
ጋሃሠጊኛ ነጊጸሠፋግሂ
ፋኖጃጃ ሥኖሃጃ

It's bedtime.

So he stays the night.

He uses a rock for a pillow.

Genesis 28:12

And he dreamed. And here was a ladder, set up on the earth, and its top reaching to the skies. And here were angels of God, going up and going down by it.

ገጦሂ ሠረቅ ጃሃጃኖ ሠረዘጊኛ
ዐጊገሂ ነሠፋግኖ ጃጦግፋ
ጊሃፋረሂ ጃሃጃኖ ጃሃጊሃሠጃ
ሃጊፋግጊኛ ሃጊሪዐ ሃጊጃረፋ
ኖጋ

He dreams about a ladder to heaven.

There's angels of God going up and down it.

Genesis 28:13

And here was YHWH standing over him, and He said, "I am YHWH, your father Abraham's God and Isaac's God. The land on which you're lying: I'll give it to you and to your seed.

ሃጊሪዐ ላሾሃ ጃሃጃጊ ጃሃጃሂ
ጃሃጃጊ ጊሃፋ ላሥፋጊሂ
ሃጊጋፋ ሥጃላጋፋ ጊጃረፋ
ሾላፋጃ ዋይሾጊ ጊጃረፋሂ
ሃረ ጃጊሪዐ ላሾሠ ጃተፋ ላሠፋ
ሃዐላጊረሂ ጃሃሃተፋ

Okay so YHWH is standing over him. He does The seed schtick again.

Genesis 28:14

And your seed will be like the dust of the earth, and you’ll expand to the west and east and north and south, and all the families on the earth will be blessed through you and through your seed.

ᐱᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

He’s like Jacob, look at everything.
Everything you just seed will be yours.
He goes on for a while about the seed.

Genesis 28:15

And here I am with you, and I’ll watch over you everywhere that you’ll go, and I’ll bring you back to this land, for I won’t leave you until I’ve done what I’ve spoken to you.”

ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ

He says he’s never going to give him up, never going to let him down, never going to run around or desert him.

Genesis 28:16

And Jacob woke from his sleep and said, “YHWH is actually in this place, and I didn’t know!”

ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

Jacob woke with a start.
YHWH’s here.

Genesis 28:17

And he was afraid, and he said, “How awesome this place is! This is none other than God’s house, and this is the gate of the skies!”

ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ ᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ

So he’s afraid.

He’s like “This place is awesome!”

It’s basically Beth-el.

Like Heaven’s Gate.

Genesis 28:18

And Jacob got up early in the morning and took the stone that he had set as his headrest and set it as a pillar and poured oil on its top.

ጥዋጥጥ ጥዋዐጊ ሣሣሠጊ፣
ገሠፉ ገጽፉ፣ ጸፉ ዘዋጊ፣
ሣሠጊ፣ ፋጊጸሠፉገሣ ሣሠ
ገሣሠ ዋጦጊ፣ ጓገጦሣ ጓጸፉ
ጓሠፉገ ራዐ

Jacob turns his rock pillow up vertical and pours oil on it.

It’s not clear why.¹⁵⁰

Genesis 28:19

And he called that place’s name Beth-El, though in fact Luz was the name of the city at first.

ሣሣዋሣ፣ ሣሠ ተፉ ፉገዋጊሣ
ሣራሣፉ ራፉ ተጊ፣ ፉሣ፣፣
ጓገሠፉገ ላጊዐ፣ ሣሠ ጊሣራ

Oh wow it is Beth-el.

I was just joking earlier.

Noted.

Genesis 28:20

And Jacob made a vow, saying, “If God will be with me and watch over me in this way that I’m going and give me bread to eat and clothing to wear,

ገሣፉራ ገፋገ ጥዋዐጊ ገፋጊ፣
ሣጊፋራፉ ጓጊፋጊ ሣፉ
ሣገፋገ ጊገገሣሠ፣ ጊፋሣዐ
ሣራ፣፣ ጊሣገፉ ገሠፉ ጓጊፋ፣
ፋገገ፣ ራሣፉራ ሣዘራ ጊራ ገጸገ፣
ሠገራራ

He’s like “If God will be with me, take care of me, give me bread, and give me clothes,”

¹⁵⁰Jacob is turning his pillow-rock into a sacred **standing stone** (*maṣṣēbâ*): he stands it upright and pours oil over it to consecrate it. This was a normal ancient West Semitic way of marking a divine presence or holy place; Jacob does it again at Bethel (Gen 35:14), and erects other standing stones in Gen 31:45 and 35:20. The point becomes explicit in 28:22: “this stone ... shall be God’s house”—part of the story’s explanation of **Bethel**, *bêt-’ēl*, “House of God/El.” Strikingly, Deut 16:22 later outright bans erecting a *maṣṣēbâ*.

Genesis 28:21

and I come back in peace to my father’s house, then YHWH will become my God,

x29 l4 yf/w9 2x9wf
2/ 3f32 323f 294
y23/4/

“And keep me safe until I get back to daddy, then YHWH will become my God,”¹⁵¹

Genesis 28:22

and this stone that I set as a pillar will be God’s house, and everything that you’ll give me I’ll tithe to you.”

9wf x423 9943f
3232 39m4 2x4w
9wf /yf y23/4 x29
f99w04 9w0 2/ yxx
y/

“and my rock pillow will be God’s house, and everything you give me, I’ll give you 10%.”

End of chapter.

¹⁵¹The 5th out of 5 uses of the name YHWH outside of J prior to the big reveal of the name of god in Exodus 3 (and 6). The Evidence: Dreams are heavily E-associated: Gen 20:3, 6; 28:12; 31:10–11, 24; 37:5–10; 40:5–23; 41:1–32. Standing stones also recur in E-linked Jacob material: Gen 28:18, 22; 31:45, 51–52; 35:14. And the actual sentence says, “If Elohim is with me ... then YHWH will be my God.” Jacob does not start by casually calling Elohim “YHWH”; YHWH appears in the result of the condition. E may therefore be deliberately saying: if the Elohim who appeared to Jacob actually protects him, Jacob will accept YHWH as his God.

Genesis 29

Genesis 29:1

And Jacob lifted his feet and went to the land of the people of the east.

ሃገረገላ ያዎቦጊ ፉወጊሃ
ሃላዋ ጊነዓ ጓሾላፉ ሃረጊሃ

Jacob goes east.

Remember, he's in Haran.

Genesis 29:2

And he looked, and here was a well in the field, and here were three flocks of sheep lying by it, because they watered the flocks from that well, and the stone on the mouth of the well was big,

ጓላወዓ ላፉዓ ጓነጓሃ ፉላጊሃ
ጊላላዐ ጓወረወ ሃወ ጓነጓሃ
ጊሃ ጓጊረዐ ሃጊሾዓላ ሃፉሾ
ሃዋወጊ ፉሃጓጓ ላፉዓጓ ሃሃ
ጓረላገ ሃዓፉጓሃ ሃጊላላዐጓ
ላፉዓጓ ጊገ ረዐ

Well well, what have we got here.

Genesis 29:3

and all the flocks would be gathered there, and they would roll the stone from the mouth of the well and would water the sheep and then would put the stone back in its place on the mouth of the well.

ረሃ ጓሃወ ሃገቹፉሃሃ
ተፉ ሃረረገሃ ሃጊላላዐጓ
ላፉዓጓ ጊገ ረዐሃ ሃዓፉጓ
ሃፉሾጓ ተፉ ሃዋወጓሃ
ረዐ ሃዓፉጓ ተፉ ሃዓጊወጓሃ
ጓሃዋሃረ ላፉዓጓ ጊገ

It's a well. With a really big heavy rock on it that only a proper man can lift.

I wonder what's going to happen.

Genesis 29:4

And Jacob said to them, “My brothers, where are you from?” And they said, “We're from Haran.”

ጊዘፉ ያዎቦጊ ሃጓረ ላሃፉጊሃ
ሃላሃፉጊሃ ሃተፉ ሃጊፉሃ
ሃነዘነፉ ሃላዘሃ

Okay so there's some guys by the well.

Remember, he’s in Haran.

So he asks them where they’re from.

And they’re like “We’re from Haran.”

Genesis 29:5

And he said to them, “Do you know Laban, son of Nahor?” And they said, “We know.”

וַתֹּאמְרוּ וְיָלַד אֶתְכֶּם
אֶתְיָם וְגַם וְיָלַד לָךְ
וְיִתְּנָה לְךָ אֶתְכֶּם

He’s like “Y’know White? His dad is Breathing Heavily.”

And they’re like “We know.”

Genesis 29:6

And he said to them, “Is he well?” And they said, “Well. And here’s Rachel, his daughter, coming with the sheep.”

וְלֵךְ וְיִלְוֶה וְיָלַד אֶתְכֶּם
אֶתְיָם וְיִלְוֶה וְיִתְּנָה לְךָ
וְיִתְּנָה לְךָ וְיִתְּנָה לְךָ

Terrified at having run out of smalltalk, he resorts to a pun.

“Is he well?”, he asks.

“Well,” they say.

And like beetlejuice, the ancient near eastern god of wells springs into action, having heard his name three times, and he provides what only a god of wet holes can provide.

It’s you.

Me?

No not you, I said Ew.

Ew?

No not Ew. I said Ewe. With a we in it.

Like a female sheep.

That’s her over there.

She just came with the sheep.

Perfect timing.

Ever since Jacob ran away from his murderous brother, he’s been sleeping alone, on the rocks.

It’s rough On The Lamb.¹⁵²

Genesis 29:7

And he said, “Here, it will still be daytime for a long time, not the time for gathering the livestock. Water the sheep and go, pasture them.”

ሥሃጊጃ ላላዐ ሃጃ ላሥቀጊሃ
ገቹቀጃ ተዐ ቀረ ረሃላገ
ሃቀሾጃ ሃቀሠጃ ጓሃቀሥጃ
ሃዐላ ሃሃረሃ

And Jacob’s like:

Why are you guys standing around? There’s plenty of daylight left. Now give your sheep some water and get back to work.

Genesis 29:8

And they said, “We can’t until all the flocks will be gathered and they’ll roll the stone from the mouth of the well, and then we’ll water the sheep.”

ረሃሃሃ ቀረ ሃላሥቀጊሃ
ረሃ ሃገቹቀጊ ላሠቀ ላዐ
ተቀ ሃረረገሃ ሥጊላላዐጃ
ላቀዓጃ ጊገ ረዐሥ ሃዓቀጃ
ሃቀሾጃ ሃሃጊቀሠጃሃ

And they’re like “We can’t. That’s not how this well works.”

Their procedure is apparently:

- 1. Some sheep start coming to the well.
- 2. Everybody waits for rest of the sheep.
- 3. All the sheep arrive eventually.
- 4. The humans all roll the big rock off the top.
- 5. Everybody gets water.
- 6. Then we put the big rock back.

So it’s blocking I/O.¹⁵³

Genesis 29:9

He was still speaking with them, and Rachel came with her father’s sheep, because she was a shepherdess.

ረዘላሃ ሥሥዐ ላዓላሥ ሃሃላሃዐ
ላሠቀ ሃቀሾጃ ሥዐ ጓቀዓ
ቀሃጃ ጓዐላ ጊሃ ጓጊዓቀረ

¹⁵²Sic?
¹⁵³Meaning of Eng. uncertain.

He was talking to them, and then,
Out of nowhere, he sees her.
This beautiful girl with the sheep.
... It was Ewe.¹⁵⁴

Genesis 29:10

And it was when Jacob saw Rachel, daughter of Laban, his mother’s brother, and the sheep of Laban, his mother’s brother: and he went over and rolled the stone from the mouth of the well and watered the sheep of Laban, his mother’s brother.

וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר רָאָה יַעֲקֹב
אֶת רָחֵל בֵּת לָבָן אָחִי
אָמֹו וְאֵת צֹאן לָבָן אָחִי
אָמֹו וַיִּנָּשׁ יַעֲקֹב וַיְגִל אֶת
הָאֶבֶן מֵעַל פִּי הַבְּאֵר
וַיִּשְׁקֵן אֶת צֹאן לָבָן אָחִי
אָמֹו׃

So Jacob’s like “Well forget the procedure, water we even doing.”
And he moves the big rock in a show of strength and non-procrastination.

Genesis 29:11

And Jacob kissed Rachel and raised his voice and wept.

וַיִּשָּׁק יַעֲקֹב לְרָחֵל וַיִּשְׁמַע וַיִּבְכֵּהָ
וַיִּשְׁמַע וַיִּבְכֵּהָ

Then immediately they’re kissing.
Jacob cries.

Wells work so well it can be a bit overwhelming.^{155 156}

Genesis 29:12

And Jacob told Rachel that he was her father’s kin and that he was Rebekah’s son, and she ran and told her father.

וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב לְרָחֵל וַיֹּאמֶר
וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב לְרָחֵל וַיֹּאמֶר
וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב לְרָחֵל וַיֹּאמֶר
וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב לְרָחֵל וַיֹּאמֶר

So after they’re done making out he’s like by the way I’m your cousin.
(Begin Midrash)

¹⁵⁴Rachel’s name, רָחֵל (*Rāhēl*), simply means “ewe”—an adult female sheep. The name fits almost suspiciously well here: Jacob meets Ewe while she is coming to the well with her father’s sheep (Gen 29:6–10), because she is a shepherd (29:9).
¹⁵⁵Sic?
¹⁵⁶Presumably a reference to the comment on Gen. 24:11.

Rachel: Kissing cousins?

Jacob: No.¹⁵⁷ ¹⁵⁸ ¹⁵⁹

(End Midrash)

She tells her dad.

Genesis 29:13

And it was, when Laban heard the news of Jacob, his sister’s son, that he ran to him and embraced him and kissed him and brought him to his house. And he told Laban all these things.

ተፋ ሃፍረ ዐሣሠኝ ጌጃጊሃ
ሃተዘፋ ሃፍ ልዋዐጊ ዐሣሠ
ዋፍዘጊሃ ሃተፋላዋረ ሥላጊሃ
ሃጃፋጊፍጊሃ ሃረ ዋሠሃጊሃ ሃረ
ሃፍረረ ላገቹጊሃ ሃተጊፍ ረፋ
ጃረፋጃ ሣጊፍፍላጃ ረሃ ተፋ

Laban hugs Jacob.

Jacob’s like “I kissed your daughter and cried. Nice to meet you.”

Genesis 29:14

And Laban said to him, “You are indeed my bone and my flesh.”
And he stayed with him a month.

ሃፋ ሃፍረ ሃረ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጃተፋ ጊፍሠፍሃ ጊሣሥዐ
ሣጊሣጊ ሠላዘ ሃሣዐ ልሠጊሃ

Laban’s like “Sounds like we’re related.”

Jacob stays over for a month.

Genesis 29:15

And Laban said to Jacob, “Is it right because you’re my brother that you should work for me for free? Tell me what your pay should be.”

ጊሃጃ ልዋዐጊረ ሃፍረ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጊሃተላፍዐሃ ጃተፋ ጊዘፋ
ጃሣ ጊረ ጃላጊገጃ ሣሃዘ
ሃተላሃሠሣ

So Laban’s like “Look just because we’re brothers¹⁶⁰ ¹⁶¹ ¹⁶² doesn’t mean

¹⁵⁷ Apparently they’re first cousins.

¹⁵⁸Back in the begat lists somewhere, it says they share a grandpa.

¹⁵⁹1. Recall from the genealogy in Gen 22:20–23: Milcah bore children to Nahor, Abraham’s brother: Uz, Buz, Kemuel, Chesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph, Bethuel. Bethuel fathered Rebekah. Then Genesis 24:29 explicitly gives Laban as Rebekah’s brother, and Genesis 28:2 identifies Rachel as Laban’s daughter. 2. According to the LORD, a “kissing cousin” is any cousin that is not a first cousin. In most places in the world, first cousins may not have sex and have babies. But, in most cultures second cousins, and higher can have sex and babies.

¹⁶⁰What’s going on in this family?!

¹⁶¹It’s a metaphor.

¹⁶²“Brother” here is a fictive-kinship term; no literal sibling relationship is intended.

I can’t pay you an honest wage. Name your price.”

Genesis 29:16

And Laban had two daughters.
The older one’s name was Leah,
and the younger one’s name was
Rachel.

ተሃገሏ ረተሠ ሃለረላ
ሃሠላ ጸፋረ ጸረላገጻ ሃሠ
ረዘላ ጸሃፀዋጻ

The text now goes “Oh by the way, Laban had two daughters, Leah and Rachel. Leah’s older.”

Genesis 29:17

And Leah’s eyes were tender, and
Rachel had an attractive figure and
was beautiful.

ረዘላሃ ተሃጻላ ጸፋረ ረሃረዐሃ
ተሃረሃ ላፋተ ተሃረ ጸተረጸ
ጸፋላሃ

I can’t even with this sentence.

The text then notes that:

- 1. Rachel had an attractive¹⁶³ figure¹⁶⁴ and was beautiful.
- 2. Leah had something going on with her eyes.

Language	Root / form	Meanings	Status
Akkadian	<i>raqāqu</i> , <i>raqqu</i> ; cf. <i>rakāku</i>	thin; fine; soft; delicate	attested / cog-nate
Ugaritic	<i>rqq</i> / <i>rkk</i> ?	thin?; soft?; tender?	uncertain
Phoenician	<i>rkk</i> / <i>rqq</i> ?	soft?; tender?; weak?	uncertain
Canaanite	* <i>rkk</i> ~ * <i>rqq</i>	soft; tender; weak; thin	reconstructed
Biblical He-brew	רַךְ / רַקַּךְ	soft; tender; young; weak; gentle	attested
Proto-NW Semitic	* <i>rkk</i> ~ * <i>rqq</i>	thin; soft; tender; delicate	reconstructed
Proto-Semitic	* <i>rqq</i> / * <i>rkk</i>	thin; fine; soft; tender	reconstructed

So basically Rachel’s gorgeous, and Leah’s a nice girl.¹⁶⁵

¹⁶³Lit. “hot” in the original.
¹⁶⁴Lit. “body” in the original.
¹⁶⁵Some manuscripts have “pretty on the inside.”

Genesis 29:18

And Jacob loved Rachel. And he said, “I’ll work for you seven years for Rachel, your younger daughter.”

ለዘላ ተቀ ዓዋዐጊ ዓገላጊሃ
ዐዓሠ ሃልዓዐቀ ላሣቀጊሃ
ጓጎፀዋጓ ሃተዓ ለዘላዓ ሣጊሃሠ

Jacob loves the young pretty one.

So recall, we were in the middle of a scene where Laban had just asked Jacob “How much should I pay you for helping around the farm?”

So now that we’ve covered the girls and their respective attributes, we cut back to Jacob’s answer to the question of payment, which is:

“Rachel. Your younger daughter.”

Genesis 29:19

And Laban said, “Better for me to give her to you than for me to give her to another man. Live with me.”

ጊተተ ዓሃፀ ሃዓረ ላሣቀጊሃ
ጓተቀ ጊተተሣ ሃረ ጓተቀ
ጊላሣዐ ጓዓሠ ላዘቀ ሠጊቀረ

So Laban’s like “Well, better you than any of those ne’er-do-wells over there.”¹⁶⁶

Genesis 29:20

And Jacob worked seven years for Rachel, and they were like a few days in his eyes because of his loving her.

ለዘላዓ ዓዋዐጊ ላዓዐጊሃ
ሃጊጓጊሃ ሣጊሃሠ ዐዓሠ
ሣጊላዘቀ ሣጊሣጊሃ ሃጊሃጊዐዓ
ጓተቀ ሃተዓገላዓ

They agree on a wage of 1/364 of a daughter/wife per week.

It went by quickly, because he loved Rachel.

The years go by quick b/c c’mon we’re not describing all that.

Genesis 29:21

And Jacob said to Laban, “Give me my wife, because my days have been completed, and let me come to her.”

ሃዓረ ረቀ ዓዋዐጊ ላሣቀጊሃ
ጊሃ ጊተሠቀ ተቀ ጓዓጓ
ጓቀሃዓቀሃ ጊሣጊ ሃቀረሣ
ጓጊረቀ

¹⁶⁶Presumably a reference to the herd of sheepish woolgathering lads in verse eight.

So Jacob says to Laban “Give me my wife, time’s up, I’m ready to come to her.”

Genesis 29:22

And Laban gathered all the people of the place and made a feast.

ገጠሃኑ ለጎተኑ ሃፍረ ገቹኑን
እተሠሣ ሠዐረሃ ሣሃዋሣ

Laban invites everyone for dinner.

Genesis 29:23

And it was in the evening, and he took Leah, his daughter, and brought her to him. And he came to her.

ተኑ ዘዋረሃ ልላዐላ ገጸረሃ
እተኑ ኑሳረሃ ሃተሳ ጸኑረ
እገረኑ ኑሳረሃ ሃገረኑ

After dark, Laban brings Leah to Jacob.

Then after she’s been brought to him, he comes to her.

Genesis 29:24

And Laban gave her his maid Zilpah—to Leah, his daughter, as a maid.

እገረገ ተኑ ጸረ ሃፍረ ሃተረሃ
እዘገሠ ሃተሳ ጸኑረረ ሃተዘገሠ

Dad gives Leah a live-in helper type girl.

Genesis 29:25

And it was in the morning, and here she was: Leah! And he said to Laban, “What is this you’ve done to me? Didn’t I work with you for Rachel? And why have you deceived me?”

ኑሃእ ጸሃእሃ ላዋሳፍ ገጸረሃ
ሃፍረ ረኑ ላሣኑን ጸኑረ
ኑረእ ገረ ተገሠዐ ተኑገ ጸሣ
እሣረሃ ጸሣዐ ገተላሳዐ ረዘላሳ
ገሃተገሣ

After sunrise, Jacob notices Leah’s in bed next to him.

The classic mate-and-switch technique.

Apparently he didn’t notice during the sex.

This book is so good it’s beyond belief.

And Jacob’s like “Father-in law, what have you done to me Laban.”

Genesis 29:26

And Laban said, “It’s not done like that in our place, to give the younger one before the firstborn.

እውሪ ቀረ ነፃረ ላማቀጊሃ
ተተረ ሃነማዋማፃ ነጽ
እላጊጽፃፃ ጊንገረ እላጊዐጽፃ

And Laban’s like “White lies for a good cause. For the birthright.”

Genesis 29:27

Complete this week, and this one will be given to you as well—for the work that you’ll do with me: another seven years.”

እነተነሃ ተቀጊ ዐፃሠ ቀረማ
እላፃዐፃ ተቀጊ ተቀ ማገ ጸረ
ላሃዐ ጊላማዐ ላፃዐተ ላሠቀ
ተሃላይቀ ማጊነሠ ዐፃሠ

Give me another seven and you can have Rachel as well.

Genesis 29:28

And Jacob did so; and he completed this week, and he gave him Rachel, his daughter, for a wife.

ቀረማጊሃ ነጽ ላዋዐጊ ሠዐጊሃ
ተቀ ሃረ ነተጊሃ ተቀጊ ዐፃሠ
እሠቀረ ሃረ ሃተፃ ረይላ

Seven years later, he gets Rachel as well.

Genesis 29:29

And Laban gave his maid Bilhah to Rachel, his daughter—to her as a maid.

ተቀ ሃተፃ ረይላረ ነፃረ ነተጊሃ
እይገሠረ እረ ሃተይገሠ እእረፃ

Rachel comes with a free girl too.

Genesis 29:30

And he also came to Rachel. And he also loved Rachel more than Leah. And he worked with him another seven years.

ረይላ ረቀ ማገ ቀፃጊሃ
ረይላ ተቀ ማገ ፃእቀጊሃ
ላሃዐ ሃማዐ ላፃዐጊሃ እቀረማ
ተሃላይቀ ማጊነሠ ዐፃሠ

Jacob finally comes to Rachel.

He’s loved her for teen¹⁶⁷ years, remember?

¹⁶⁷Sic.

Not clear how old she was then or is now.

Then the text notes he worked seven more years.

This may or may not be the second set of seven.

Genesis 29:31

And YHWH saw that Leah was hated, and He opened her womb, and Rachel was infertile.	እፋሃሃወ ንሃ እሃእፖ ፋላፖሃ እሃዘላ ተፋ ዘተገፖሃ እፋረ እላዎዐ ረዘላሃ
---	--

YHWH likes to balance things out.

Here we should recall the words of Gen. 31:38.

When the Lord closes a door,¹⁶⁸

He opens a window.¹⁶⁹

Genesis 29:32

And Leah became pregnant and gave birth to a son and called his name Reuben because she said, “Because YHWH looked at my suffering, so that now my man will love me.”	ሃሏ ላረተሃ እፋረ ላእተሃ ኒሃ ሃሃሃፋላ ሃሃወ ፋላዎተሃ እሃእፖ እፋላ ኒሃ እላሃፋ ኒሃሃእፋፖ እተዐ ኒሃ ኒኒሃዐሓ ኒወኒፋ
---	---

Here we go.¹⁷⁰

Leah gets pregant. It’s a boy. She names him.

Reuben.¹⁷¹

¹⁶⁸Lit. l’adoré in the original text, apparently from French, meaning “the beloved/adored one,” presumably a reference to Rachel.

¹⁶⁹Lit. raam in the original text, possibly from Dutch “raam,” meaning a window, generally believed to be a reference to Leah. The reference to Genesis 31:38 is incorrect, likely a later addition or scribal corruption.

¹⁷⁰The names given in this section vary wildly between Nameless Sects. We will aim to cover a representative sample of the textual variations. Judicious selection is necessary, however, as a full treatment would fill a book— so as not to exhaust the reader, the treatment is kept brief and non-exhaustive.

¹⁷¹The Apocrypha have, among others, the names: Rawben, Rawson, Ramen, Season, and Season D. Ramen. The Pseudepigrapha Canonica have: Luca Sonne, Luke A. Baeachby, and C. Benjamin Lovenson. The Pseudepigrapha Non-Canonica have, in perhaps the only known case of unanimous agreement between the texts, simply the name: Semen.

Genesis 29:33

And she became pregnant again and gave birth to a son and said, “Because YHWH listened because I was hated and gave me this one, too.” And she called his name Simeon.

ሃዓ ልረተሃ ልሃዐ ላጃተሃ
ጃሃጃጊ ዐሣሠ ጊሃ ላሣፋተሃ
ሃተጊሃ ጊሃሃፋ ጃፋሃሃሠ ጊሃ
ፋላዋተሃ ጃጊ ተፋ ሣገ ጊረ
ሃሃዐሣሠ ሃሣሠ

Hear’s the second son.

Named with a second pun.

Simeon.¹⁷²

Genesis 29:34

And she became pregnant again and gave birth to a son, and she said, “Now, this time my man will become bound to me because I’ve given birth to three sons for him.” On account of this his name was called Levi.

ሃዓ ልረተሃ ልሃዐ ላጃተሃ
ሣዐገጃ ጃተዐ ላሣፋተሃ
ጊሃ ጊረፋ ጊሠጊፋ ጃሃረጊ
ሣጊሃዓ ጃሠረሠ ሃረ ጊተላረጊ
ጊሃረ ሃሣሠ ፋላዋ ሃሃ ረዐ

Levi.¹⁷³

Genesis 29:35

And she became pregnant again and gave birth to a son and said, “This time I’ll praise YHWH.” On account of this she called his name Judah. And she stopped giving birth.

ሃዓ ልረተሃ ልሃዐ ላጃተሃ
ጃላሃፋ ሣዐገጃ ላሣፋተሃ
ጃፋላዋ ሃሃ ረዐ ጃሃጃጊ ተፋ
ላሣዐተሃ ጃላሃጃጊ ሃሣሠ
ተላረሣ

Judah.¹⁷⁴

¹⁷²Certain Apocryphal texts have instead the name Ishmael here. The Pseudepigrapha have: Lisa N. Toomie, Hearison F. Lord.

¹⁷³Among the Apocrypha we find Tyson Goodman and Ty Manson. Pseudepigraphic traditions preserve the names: Abraham Clinton, Dames Bond, and Huell Lovett. The Pseudepigraphica Obscura has the rather baffling assortment of Levi ben Gershom, Barbara Levinson, Levi Endemann, and לויתחת.

¹⁷⁴Apocrypha have mostly Hal Elijah. (Lit. Hal ḥal-u-יה in the originals.) The Pseudepigrapha Canonica have Judas, Jude, ṭude, ṭe, ṭe, Dude, Tude, Tudah, and Toda Lourdes. The Non-Canonical Pseudepigraphic traditions variously have Hank Hillel, Hanke L., Göttman Hankel, T. Hank Lourdes, Θῥ✱, Θank✱, Θank God, and finally, T. Hank God.

Genesis 30

Genesis 30:1

And Rachel saw that she had not given birth for Jacob, **and Rachel was jealous of her sister, and she said to Jacob, “Give me children. And if not I’m dying!”**

ጸላረጊ ፋረ ጊጎ ረዘላ ፋላተሃ
ረዘላ ፋጎዋእና ጎዋዐጊረ
ጎዋዐጊ ረፋ ሳሃፋእና ጸጸዘፋጎ
ጎጊፋ ሃፋና ሃጊጎጎ ጊሪ ጸጎጎ
ጊሃጎፋ ጸጸሃ

Ok so Rachel sees all the [fu]n¹⁷⁵ Leah’s having and she wants in.

So naturally she’s like GET ME PREGNANT OR I’M GONNA DIE.

Genesis 30:2

And Jacob’s anger flared at Rachel, and he said, “Am I in place of God, who has held back the fruit of the womb from you?!”

ረዘላጎ ጎዋዐጊ ጎፋ ሳዘጊና
ሃጊጸረፋ ጸዘጸጎ ሳሃፋጊና
ሃሃሃ ዐጎሃ ሳሠፋ ጊሃጎፋ
ጎፀጎ ጊጎጎ

So Jacob’s like “Woman, it’s pretty clear I’m fertile.

How you gonna blame me for this?

Nevermind, let’s just have sex til you get pregnant...”

Genesis 30:3

And she said, “Here’s my maid, Bilhah. Come to her, and she’ll give birth on my knees, and I too will get a child through her.”

ጊጸሃፋ ጸጎጎ ሳሃፋእና
ሪዐ ለረእና ጸጊረፋ ፋጎ ጸጸረጎ
ጊሃጎፋ ሣገ ጸጎጎፋና ጊሃጎጎ
ጸጎሃሃ

Rachel then clarifies that she’s not looking for sex per se.

She’s mostly just interested in beating Leah.

So she’s like “It’s ok, go fill this one up and bring her back to me.”

¹⁷⁵Lit. **ፊ**en (or **ፋ**en) in the original, meaning of Eng. (and Mat.) uncertain (respectively). Translated here as fun since the same term occurs later in the verse.

Genesis 30:7

And Bilhah, Rachel's maid, became pregnant again and gave birth to a second son for Jacob.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Meanwhile Jacob keeps frequenting the help's area.

Every time he comes in there there's another baby.

Genesis 30:8

And Rachel said, "I've had Godlike struggles with my sister. I've also prevailed." And she called his name Naphtali.

ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So Rachel's like "Guys I've got the perfect name!..."

She names it Mein Kamph.¹⁸⁰

Genesis 30:9

And Leah saw that she had stopped giving birth, and she took Zilpah, her maid, and gave her to Jacob as a wife.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

Meanwhile, Leah notices something.

Rachel's maid some progress on the score.

So now Leah's maid Zilpah into Jacob's fourth wife.

Genesis 30:10

And Zilpah, Leah's maid, gave birth to a son for Jacob.

ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So now Jacob's into Zilpah Leah's maid, fourth wife.

¹⁸⁰Naphtali means "My Struggle."

Genesis 30:11

And Leah said, “With fortune!” and called his name Gad.	ᐱᑭ (ᐱᑭᑭ) ᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑭ ᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᑭ
--	--

Qere Ketiv.

After nine short months of waiting the baby’s born and Leah goes:

“Lük how lucky I am!” and names it Luke.

This name game¹⁸¹ is getting pretty Gd Dm ridiculous.¹⁸²

Genesis 30:12

And Zilpah, Leah’s maid, gave birth to a second son for Jacob.	ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᑭ
---	------------------------------------

So Zilpah keeps the jewsses flowing.¹⁸³

Genesis 30:13

And Leah said, “With my happiness!—because daughters will wish me happiness,” and called his name Asher.	ᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᑭᑭ ᐱᑭᑭᑭᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ
---	---

And after nine short months of waiting, Leah bursts out,

“Oh joy, what a joy fille day” and she names ’er¹⁸⁴ Joy.

Despite the name, it’s a boy. So sort of like Jo^ey.

Genesis 30:14

And in the days of wheat harvest Reuben went and found mandrakes in the field and brought them to Leah, his mother. And Rachel said to Leah, “Give me some of your son’s mandrakes.”	ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᑭᑭᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᑭ ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᑭᑭᑭ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
---	---

Nearabouts summer, when everyone’s in ^wheat,

¹⁸¹Lit. ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ in the original.
¹⁸²Lit. ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ.
¹⁸³The Hebrew root ᑭᐱᐱ (z-l-p) means dripping or flowing. While the original meaning of the name Zilpah is unknown, a suggestive etymology is perhaps “She-who-drips.”
¹⁸⁴Lit. ᑭᐱ (ér) in the original, a chinese term meaning “son.”

SMN¹⁸⁵ brings his mother an erotic sort of treat.

Lots going on here. Mandrakes are a well-known aphrodisiac/fertility drug resembling a human baby, with a forked root that often bears striking resemblance to a male phallic organ of considerable size. Additionally, the name in Hebrew is DWD'IM (דוּדִים), which is essentially (up to a glottal stop / silent vowel) the word “Davids,” namely the plural form of DWD (דָּוִד), and meaning also “lover/beloved”—roughly “lovers.” Furthermore, since the author of the J source is believed to be the author of the court history of David in II Samuel, in the course of which said author shows clear favor toward the Davidic monarchy, suffice it to say there’s a lot going on here.

So Rachel’s like “Hey sis I want those LIL Dudes¹⁸⁶ with the big¹⁸⁷ roots¹⁸⁸ eh sis” to help her get pregnant. Cuz obviously.

Genesis 30:15

And she said to her, “Is your taking my man a small thing? And you’re taking my son’s mandrakes, too?!” And Rachel said, “Then let him lie with you tonight in return for your son’s mandrakes.”

יִשְׂרָאֵל וְרָחֵל
וְלֵאָה וְרָחֵל
וְרָחֵל וְרָחֵל
וְרָחֵל וְרָחֵל
וְרָחֵל וְרָחֵל
וְרָחֵל וְרָחֵל
וְרָחֵל וְרָחֵל
וְרָחֵל וְרָחֵל

They trade. Rachel’s man for mandrakes.¹⁸⁹

Genesis 30:16

And Jacob came from the field in the evening, and Leah went out to him and said, “You are to come to me, because I’ve hired you with my son’s mandrakes.” And he lay with her that night.

וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ
וַיָּבֹאוּ

So that night, presumably while Jacob’s heading in the direction of Rachel’s room, Leah show’s up and goes

Nope, this way husband, I bought you with mandrakes tonight.

¹⁸⁵Sic. Apparently an abjad representation of Simeon, though the text clearly indicates Reuben.

¹⁸⁶Lit. LIL דָּוִדִּים in the original.

¹⁸⁷Lit. דָּוִדִּים in the original. Meaning and Lang. unclear.

¹⁸⁸Lit. 根 (Gēn), a Chinese term meaning “roots.” In Mand. slang, 根 means penis.

¹⁸⁹Lit. דָּוִדִּים for man-דָּוִדִּים in the original text.

He sleeps with her that night.



Genesis 30:17

And God listened to Leah, and she became pregnant and gave birth to a fifth son for Jacob.

ጸሐፊ ለእናንተ ሰላም ይገባል
እናንተ ለእናንተ ሰላም ይገባል
እናንተ ለእናንተ ሰላም ይገባል

Naturally he gets her pregnant.

Son number five.

Genesis 30:18

And Leah said, “God has given my hire because I gave my maid to my man,” and she called his name Issachar.

እናንተ ለእናንተ ሰላም ይገባል
እናንተ ለእናንተ ሰላም ይገባል
እናንተ ለእናንተ ሰላም ይገባል

His name is “Man of Hire,” for he was sired on the night his mother hired off her man.

Genesis 30:19

And Leah became pregnant again and gave birth to a sixth son for Jacob.

ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ

The girls keep getting railed¹⁹⁰ all the live long day.

Ok so Leah has some weird kind of sex on Jacob's schwanger.^{191 192}

Genesis 30:20

And Leah said, “God has given me a good gift. This time my man will value me highly, because I’ve given birth to six sons for him,” and she called his name Zebulun.

ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ

So Leah's like: Nathaniel!

Now speaking of privates man, you have UTI.¹⁹³

Her logic is that it's bc of the sex.¹⁹⁴ So she names the kid Val.¹⁹⁵

Genesis 30:21

And after that she gave birth to a daughter and called her name Dinah.

ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ

Then they have Dinah.¹⁹⁶

Genesis 30:22

And God remembered Rachel, and God listened to her and opened her womb,

ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ

Last we left off in the Rachel side of things back in 30:15, she'd traded her man for mandrakes, then Leah had three kids. Now back to the story.

¹⁹⁰Lit. pailed.

¹⁹¹Sorry I don't know whatever language that is yet.

¹⁹²Lit. “Leah wird mit kind nummer sechs von Jakob schwanger” in the original text.

¹⁹³Lit. 今は、私の男 יֵאֵהָב אֹתִי in the original text.

¹⁹⁴Lit. sechs in OT.

¹⁹⁵The Apocrypha have “Homer.”

¹⁹⁶Lit. /'dina/.

Then God remembers Rachel.

He’s a good listener and he opens her up.

Genesis 30:23

and she became pregnant and gave birth to a son. And she said, “God has taken away my humiliation”

ᐱሣፋኣ፤ ሃፃ ልረኣ፤ ᐱጃኣ፤
ጌጸገፃ፻ ጸፋ ሣጌጃረፋ ገቾፋ

She has a son, and she’s like:

“God has taken away my shame!”

But she doesn’t name him Seamus.

Genesis 30:24

and called his name Joseph, saying, “May YHWH add another son to me.”

ገቾ፤ጌ ፤ሣሠ ጸፋ ፋፃዋኣ፤
ሃፃ ጊረ ጃሃጃጌ ገቾጌ ᐱሣተ፤
ፃ፻ፋ

She names him Addam, which in Hebrew is YWSP (אֲדָם).¹⁹⁷

Genesis 30:25

And it was when Rachel had given birth to Joseph: and Jacob said to Laban, “Send me away so I may go to my place and my land.

ረ፻ፃ ጃላረጌ ᐱሠፋሃ ጌጃጌሃ
ፃዋዐጌ ᐱሣፋጌሃ ገቾሃጌ ሰፋ
ጃሃረፋሃ ጌሃ፻ረሠ ሃፃረ ረፋ
ጌሣፃፋረሃ ጌሣሃዋሣ ረፋ

After that, Jacob’s like “Hey Laban can we leave now?”

Genesis 30:26

Give me my wives and my children for whom I’ve worked for you and let me go; because you know my work that I’ve done for you.”

ሰፋሃ ጌሠሃ ሰፋ ጃሃተ
ሃተፋ ጌተላፃዐ ᐱሠፋ ጌላረጌ
ጃተፋ ጌሃ ጃሃረፋሃ ሃጃፃ
ᐱሠፋ ጌተላፃዐ ሰፋ ሰዐላጌ
ሃጌተላፃዐ

He asks Laban to give him his wives and kids, because he’s been working here a while.

¹⁹⁷J and E give different etymologies for Joseph: E derives the name from ṣp, “taken away,” while J connects it with the similar ṣp, “add.” RJE joined the two by inserting “saying” between them.

Genesis 30:27

And Laban said to him, “If I’ve found favor in your eyes, I’ve divined that YHWH has blessed me because of you,”

ሠፋ ሃፍረ ሃፍረፋ ላሠፋፖሃ
ሃፖሃፖረዐፍ ሃዘ ፖተፋሾሠ ፋሃ
፳ሃ፳፭ ፖሃሃላፍፖሃ ፖተሠዘሃ
ሃረረገፍ

And Laban’s like “Look, if you’ll do me a favor, stay. I figure YHWH’s been making me lucky because of you.”

Genesis 30:28

and he said, “Designate your pay for me, and I’ll give it.”

፭ረዐ ሃላሃሠ ፳ፍዋሃ ላሠፋፖሃ
፳ሃተፋሃ

“Name your price, and I’ll pay it.”

Genesis 30:29

And he said to him, “You know how I’ve worked for you and how your cattle have become with me,

፳ተፋ ሃፍረፋ ላሠፋፖሃ
ሃፖተላፍዐ ላሠፋ ተፋ ተዐላ፭
ሃሃዋሠ ፳፭፳ ላሠፋ ተፋሃ
፭ተፋ

Jacob’s like “You know how hard I’ve worked for you and how good I’ve been to your cows.”

Genesis 30:30

that a little that you had before me expanded into a lot, and YHWH blessed you wherever I set foot. And now, when shall I also take care of my house?”

ሃረ ፳፭፳ ላሠፋ ተዐሠ ፭ሃ
ሃላፍፖሃ ፍላረ ሾላፖፖሃ ፭ሃፖረ
፳ተዐሃ ፭ረገላረ ሃተፋ ፳ሃ፳፭
፭ሃሃፋ ሠገ ፳ሠዐፋ ፭ተሠ
፭ተ፭ፍረ

You had hardly anything before I came, and now you’ve got a ton.

When can me and my four wives and (Jacob does some math in his head) twelve kids wrap up here and be done?

Genesis 30:31

And he said, “What shall I give you?” And Jacob said, “You won’t give me anything—if you’ll do this thing for me: Let me go back; I’ll tend and watch over your flock.

እረ ነተቱ ጓህ ላሣቱጊሃ
ነተተ ቱረ ልዋዐጊ ላሣቱጊሃ
ጓሠዐተ ሃቱ ጓሃሃቱሃ ጊረ
ጓላሃሠቱ ጓጊጓ ላላላጓ ጊረ
ላሃሠቱ ሃሃቱህ ጓዐላቱ

So Laban’s like “What can I give you to convince you to stay?”

And Jacob’s like, “You don’t need to *give* me anything. I don’t want any hand outs.”

Then he has an idea and goes “How about this? Just do this one thing for me, and I’ll keep working for you and taking care of your flock.”

Genesis 30:32

I’ll pass among all your flock today removing from there every speckled and spotted lamb and every brown lamb among the sheep and every spotted and speckled one among the goats—and that will be my pay.

ሃሃጊጓ ሃሃቱህ ረኻሳ ላላዐቱ
ልዋሃ ጓሠ ረኻ ሃሠሃ ላቹጓ
ሃሃዘ ጓሠ ረኻሃ ቱሃረፀሃ
ልዋሃሃ ቱሃረፀሃ ሃጊሳሠኻሳ
ጊላኻሠ ጓጊጓሃ ሃጊጊዐሳ

“Here’s the idea. You’re White right? Laban means White. So let me go through your flock today and take out the ones that aren’t white. That’s all I want.”

Genesis 30:33

And my virtue will answer for me in a future day: when you’ll come upon my pay, it will be in front of you. Any one that isn’t speckled and spotted among the goats and brown among the sheep, it’s stolen with me.”

ጊተዋላህ ጊሳ ጓተሃዐሃ
ረዐ ቱሃሳተ ጊኻ ላዘሃ ሃሃጊሳ
ላሠቱ ረኻ ሃጊሃገረ ጊላኻሠ
ቱሃረፀሃ ልዋሃ ሃሃሃጊቱ
ሃጊሳሠኻሳ ሃሃዘሃ ሃጊጊዐሳ
ጊተቱ ቱሃጓ ላሃሃገ

“Then later, you can check if I’ve been honest. When you come to inspect the ones I took, any goat without dots, or any sheep that isn’t brown, that counts as stolen.”

Genesis 30:34

And Laban said, “Here, let it be according to your word.”

זאז ץל נא נזל אװאז
אאאא

And Laban’s like “Seems reasonable.”

Genesis 30:35

And in that day he removed the he-goats that were streaked and spotted and the she-goats that were speckled and spotted, every one that had white in it, and every brown one among the sheep, and set them in his sons’ hand

אא אאאא װאזא אאזא
אאאאאא װאאאאא
לא אאא װאאאאאא
אאאאאא װאאאא
נזל אװא לא אאאאאא
אאאאאא װאא לאא נא
אאאא אאא נאאא

Note: Heel (עקב) in Paleo-Hebrew is אפּו. Streaked (דקע) in the same system is אפּו. He (יעקב) is up to something אפּנ and אפּו. Whatever’s going on here, they’re not white. The White sheep are Laban’s because לבן. Just make a note of that and let’s move on.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
he-goats	תיש	Noun: he-goat, male goat, buck.
streaked	עקד	Verb: bind, tie, bind up. Adjective: bound, banded, striped, streaked. Noun: binding; later especially the <i>Akedah</i> , “Binding,” of Isaac.
speckled	נקד	Verb: mark, mark with points or dots, punctuate, point a text. Adjective: dotted, speckled, spotted. Noun: point, dot, mark; later, vowel-point or diacritic.
spotted	טלא	Verb: patch, cover with patches, spot, variegate. Adjective/participle: patched, spotted, mottled, variegated.
white	לבן	Adjective: white. Verb: be white, become white, make white, whiten. Noun: whiteness, white material. Proper noun: Laban.
brown	חום	Adjective: dark-colored, dark brown, blackish. The consonants are also associated etymologically with warmth/heat, though the Biblical Hebrew adjective here is specifically a color word.
sheep	כשב	Noun: sheep, individual sheep, lamb/sheep as livestock; variant spelling of כבש.

Genesis 30:36

and put three days’ distance between him and Jacob. And Jacob was tending Laban’s remaining sheep.

וַיִּזְזֶנּוּ אֶת־שְׁלֹשָׁה יָמִים מִיָּדָיו
וַיִּפְּדֵם מִיָּדָיו וַיִּנְזְלֵם
מִיָּדָיו אֶת־כָּל־הַבָּקָר וְהַחֲמֹשִׁים
אֲשֶׁר־לָבָן וַיִּשְׁלַח

Jacob’s got the non-Laban sheep.

Then he goes three days away.

We’re about to hit a pretty weird scene.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
distance / way	דַּרְךְ	Noun: road, way, path, route, journey, distance, course, direction, manner, custom, conduct, behavior, way of life. Verb: tread, walk, march, tread down; bend or draw a bow; aim.
tending	רעה	Verb: pasture, graze, feed, tend, shepherd. Noun: shepherd. A separate homographic noun means companion, friend, associate. A separate homographic root gives senses such as bad, evil, be bad, do evil.
remaining	יתר	Verb: remain, be left, survive, be left over; leave over, preserve. Noun: remainder, rest, residue, excess, abundance; also cord/string under a separate noun. Adjective: remaining, additional, excessive, superior.

Genesis 30:37

And Jacob took a rod of fresh poplar and one of almond tree and one of plane tree, and he peeled white stripes in them, exposing the white that was on the rods.

לָקַח יָקֹב אֶת־הַבָּרָק וְאֶת־הַשֵּׁמֶץ
וְאֶת־הַטֶּבֶל וַיִּפְּלֵם בַּחֲמֹשֶׁת
הַיָּמִים וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶת־הַבָּקָר
וְהַחֲמֹשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־לָבָן וַיִּשְׁלַח

He takes a wooden rod and peels back the outer layer.

Under the outer layer there’s something לבן.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
rod	מקל	Noun: stick, rod, staff, branch, walking stick. A related/later verbal root means make light, lighten, ease, treat lightly.
fresh	לח	Adjective: moist, damp, fresh, green, vigorous. Noun: moisture, freshness.
poplar	לבנה	Noun: poplar, traditionally white poplar. Noun: something white / whiteness by derivation from לבן. Proper noun: Libnah.
almond tree	לוז	Noun: almond, almond tree. Proper noun: Luz, a place-name associated with Bethel and also another town. In later Jewish tradition, זול is also the name of a supposedly indestructibly hard bone.
plane tree	ערמון	Noun: plane tree; exact ancient botanical identification is uncertain. In later Hebrew the same word can refer to chestnut.
peeled	פצל	Verb: peel, strip, peel off bark; split, divide. Noun-related senses: strip, split, division, fissure.
stripes	פצלות	Noun: peeled strips, peeled streaks, stripes, exposed strips; derived from לצפ “peel/split.”
exposing	חשף	Verb: uncover, expose, strip, bare; draw out, reveal. Adjective/participle: bare, exposed, uncovered.

Genesis 30:38

And he set up the rods that he had peeled in the channels in the watering troughs at which the flock came to drink, facing the flock. And they copulated when they came to drink.

וַיִּקַּח יַעֲקֹב אֲרָבָה וְעֵשֶׂה וְיִצְחָק
וְלֵוִי וְיִשְׂשָׁכָר וְזִמְרֵי וְנָדָב
וְנִפְתָּלִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי
וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי
וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי
וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי וְנִזְנָנִי

He takes his stick and sticks it in the wet bit.

Now the sheep come when they’re in heat.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
channels	רהט	Noun: channel, water channel, gutter, conduit, trough.
watering troughs	שוקת	Noun: drinking trough, watering trough, receptacle from which livestock drink.
flock	צאן	Collective noun: flock, small livestock, sheep and goats collectively, pastoral livestock.
copulated	יחם	Verb: be hot, become warm; be in heat, become sexually receptive; mate, breed, conceive; in causative usage, cause to breed or mate.

Genesis 30:39

And the flock mated at the rods,
and the flock gave birth to
streaked, speckled, and spotted
ones.

לֹא יָבִיא יַיָּהּ
יָלַדוּ וְיָלְדוּ
מִזֶּדֶם מִזֶּדֶם יָבִיא
מִזֶּלֶם

They have sex with his sticks and give birth.

The kids are זָרָם and זָלָם.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
mated	יחם	Verb: be hot, become warm; be in heat; mate, breed, conceive; cause to breed or mate.
streaked	עקד	Verb: bind, tie, bind up. Adjective: bound, banded, striped, streaked. Noun: binding; later especially the <i>Akedah</i> , “Binding,” of Isaac.
speckled	נקד	Verb: mark, mark with points or dots, punctuate, point a text. Adjective: dotted, speckled, spotted. Noun: point, dot, mark; later, vowel-point or diacritic.
spotted	טלא	Verb: patch, cover with patches, spot, variegate. Adjective/participle: patched, spotted, mottled, variegated.

Genesis 30:40

And Jacob separated the sheep
and had the flock face the
streaked and every brown one
among Laban’s flock, and he set
his own droves apart and did not
set them by Laban’s flock.

אֶת־הַצֹּאן אֲזַנְיָא מִזֶּדֶם
לֹא יָבִיא זֶנֶן יָתִיד
יָבִיא מִיָּהּ לָיִן אֶת
מִזֶּדֶם וְלִזֶּדֶם יָלַל
יָבִיא לֹם מִתֶּם כִּלְיָ יֶאֱסַל
יָלַל

Jacob separates the זָלָם ones from the זָרָם ones.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
separated	פרד	Verb: separate, divide, part, detach, disperse; depart, go away; be separated. Noun: mule, from a separate homographic noun.
streaked	עקד	Verb: bind, tie, bind up. Adjective: bound, banded, striped, streaked. Noun: binding; later especially the <i>Akedah</i> .
brown	חום	Adjective: dark-colored, dark brown, blackish. The form is etymologically associated with warmth/heat, though the Biblical Hebrew word here is a color adjective.
droves	עדר	Noun: flock, herd, drove. A separate verbal root means be lacking, be missing, fail.

Genesis 30:41

And it was that whenever the fittest sheep would copulate Jacob would put the rods in the channels before the sheep’s eyes so that they would copulate by the rods,

יִכְרֹא יַעֲקֹב לְרֹגֹת אֵזָאִי
אֶפְסֹז יַעֲקֹב וְיִגְמֹשׁ
זַנְזֹל וְיִלְפֹשׁ וְיִכְרֹא
אֶנְיַעֲזֵל יַעֲקֹב וְיִגְמֹשׁ
וְיִלְפֹשׁ

So when the sheep are in heat¹⁹⁸ they have sex ¹⁹⁹ the rods.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
fittest	קשר	Verb: bind, tie, knot, fasten, join; conspire, form a conspiracy. Noun: bond, knot, connection, league, conspiracy. Adjective/participle: bound, firm; in this livestock expression, strong, vigorous, robust.
copulate	יחם	Verb: be hot, become warm; be in heat; mate, breed, conceive; cause to breed or mate.
rods	מקל	Noun: stick, rod, staff, branch, walking stick. A related/later verbal root means make light, lighten, ease, treat lightly.
channels	רהט	Noun: channel, water channel, gutter, conduit, trough.

Genesis 30:42

and when the sheep were feeblers he would not put them, so the feeble ones became Laban’s and the fitter ones became Jacob’s.

כִּל יִכְרֹא גִזְזִים
וְגִזְזִים אֵזָאִי וְיִגְמֹשׁ
אֶפְסֹזֵל וְיִגְמֹשׁ וְיִכְרֹא

When they’re not in heat, he doesn’t put.

So the she-sheep-in-heat come to be his.

And the others are Laban’s.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
feeblers / feeble ones	עטר	Verb: wrap, cover, envelop, veil; be wrapped up; faint, grow weak, languish. Adjective/participle: faint, weak, feeble, languishing.
fitter / stronger ones	קשר	Verb: bind, tie, knot, fasten, join; conspire. Noun: bond, knot, connection, conspiracy. Adjective/participle: bound, firm; in this livestock expression, strong, vigorous, robust.

¹⁹⁸Lit. “(I/o)n n̄t” in the original text.

¹⁹⁹The text is corrupted here.

Genesis 30:43

And the man expanded very, very much, and he had many sheep and female and male servants and camels and asses.

אִתּוֹ מְרֵאשִׁיטִים רַבִּים
וְאִתּוֹ יָלָדִים רַבִּים אִתּוֹ
וְזִאֲדֹמִים וְיִמְיָאִים וְזִאֲדֹמִים
וְזִאֲדֹמִים וְזִאֲדֹמִים

And he bursts forth in a spurt of growth’s פֶּרַץ and gets lots of girl slaves and other slaves and rideable humps and ass.

English	Hebrew	Full range of meanings of the consonant sequence
expanded	פָּרַץ	Verb: break through, burst through, break out, breach, break down; spread out, increase, multiply, expand; break upon or attack. Noun: breach, breakthrough, bursting-out. Proper noun: Perez. See also Gen 38:28-29.
female servants	שִׁפְחוֹת	Noun: female slave, enslaved woman, maidservant, hand-maid, female domestic servant.
male servants	עֲבָדִים	Verb: work, labor, serve; cultivate, till; serve or worship a deity. Noun: worker, servant, slave, subject, official, worshiper.
camels	גַּמְלִים	Noun: camel. Verb: deal with, treat, repay, recompense, reward; wean; ripen, mature; render or bestow something.
asses	חֲמֹרִים	Noun: donkey, ass. Noun: homer, a large unit of capacity, under a homographic noun. Adjective in later Hebrew: serious, severe, grave, stringent. Related Semitic/Hebrew roots include senses of heaviness and fermentation.

Now, whatever was going on in that scene, most find the story confusing.

However, it’s possible that the confusion arises because it’s never been properly translated.

So rather than explain what the story is about, instead let’s try to write a similar one.

Just a brief note before we get started:

We’ll see later, in Genesis 31:38, when Jacob speaks to Laban about his “ewes” and “rams,” that the Hebrew words for ewe and ram are puns on the names Rachel and Leah. Or more likely, the reverse. Ok, here’s the story.

The following story is 100% lies.

Lies.²⁰⁰

Lies.²⁰¹

Lies.²⁰²

²⁰⁰Lit. 來s in the original.
²⁰¹Lit. 萊s in the original.
²⁰²Lit. 涿s in the original.

Lies.²⁰³

Let's suppose there's a guy named Yasin.

He has two wives, Barbara and Ramona.

Barbara is from China.

Ramona is from India.

In Genesis 29:31-35, and then in Genesis 30:1-24, the two wives have a breeding competition where they see who Yasin can get pregnant more times.

Every time a baby is born, the wives name it with a pun.

So there's a lot of sex and word play & the author's clearly having fun.

Then in Genesis 30:25-43, we have another strange story about breeding.

This time the thing we're breeding is sheep.

Here's how you do it.

You take a bunch of sheep that aren't white, three days flight from father's sight.

Then you get a rod, and make sure it's wood.

Then pull back the outer layer of the wood.

There's a different part under there.

It's forsons.²⁰⁴

However, it's not for kids.

So first you take the rod.

Now peel back the outer layer that's forson²⁰⁵.

Then you put the stick in the wet part.

Then when the BA BAs and the RAMonas are all hot and in heat, and they start making that special sort of ovulatory bleat, you've got the chance to pull off a magical feat.

Just have sex.

And then by Yasin's magic, the kids are guaranteed to be Asins and Sasins.

Or rather, the BA BA's kids will be Asins.

The RAMona's kids will be S. Asins.²⁰⁶

But none of them will be entirely White's.

²⁰³Lit. 株s in the original.

²⁰⁴Lit. ךַּ ל in the original.

²⁰⁵Ibid.

²⁰⁶Presumably an abbrev. for South Asins.

And that’s how you break through, burst through, break out, breach, spread out, increase, multiply, and expand and come, to the promised land.

J is the Greatest Of All Time.²⁰⁷

²⁰⁷Lit. *Goat*.

Genesis 31

Genesis 31:1

And he heard Laban's sons' words, saying, "Jacob has taken everything that was our father's, and he has made all this wealth from what was our father's."

ጌጋ ጌጋጋ ጸፋ ዐሣሠጊ፤
ጋዎዐጌ ዘዋሪ ሰሣፋሪ ገገሪ
ከጌጋጋሪ ሰሠፋ ራሃ ጸፋ
ጸፋ ጓሠዐ ከጌጋጋሪ ሰሠፋሣ፤
ጓጌጓ ልጋሃጓ ራሃ

Then he hears Laጌ's ጌs saying:

Jacob has taken everything from us.

Wealth and wives and wood and whatever.

Genesis 31:2

And Jacob saw Laban's face; and, here, he was not like the day before yesterday with him.

ገገሪ ጌገገ ጸፋ ጋዎዐጌ ፋጻጊ፤
ሪከሣጸሃ ከሣዐ ከገገጌፋ ጓገጓ፤
ሣከሠራሠ

Jacob notices Laban's face is different than it was the other day when he begged him to stay.

Genesis 31:3

And YHWH said to Jacob, "Go back to your fathers' land and to your birthplace, and I'll be with you."

ጋዎዐጌ ራፋ ጓከጓጌ ሰሣፋጊሃ
ሃጌተሃጻፋ ሣጻፋ ራፋ ጻሃሠ
ሃሣዐ ጓጌጓፋሃ ሃተላሃሣራሃ

Just then, YHWH shows up and says to Jacob:

Jake, hey man, I think it's time to leave.

Why don't we go back home.

I'll come.

Genesis 31:4

And Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leah to the field, to his flock,

ፋጻዎጊ፤ ጋዎዐጌ ዘራሠጊ፤
ራፋ ጓላሠጓ ጓፋሪሪ፤ ሪዘጻሪ
ከሃፋጌጌ

Jacob calls the sisterwives out to the Shad.²⁰⁸

²⁰⁸Lit. השדה

The maid wives don’t come; they have to stay in the Shed.²⁰⁹

Genesis 31:5

and said to them, “I see your father’s face, that he’s not like the day before yesterday to me. And my father’s God has been with me,

ᚱᚢᚷᚦ ᚹᚦᑦ ᚷᚹᚱ ᑭᚢᚦᚦᚦ
ᚱᚢ ᚷᚢᚱᚸᚦ ᚱᚷᚦ ᚦᚦ
ᚢᚱᚱᚱᚱ ᚱᚢᚦᚢ ᚱᚱᚦ ᚦᚷᚷᚱᚦ
ᚱᚱᚢᚱ ᚹᚱᚹ ᚱᚸᚦ ᚱᚹᚱᚦᚦ

So Jacob’s like “Your dad’s been looking at me different.”

“Also the God of Laughter stopped by.”

Genesis 31:6

and you know that I served your father with all my might,

ᚱᚢᚸ ᚱᚢ ᚷᚦᚱᚱᚱ ᚹᚷᚦᚦᚦ
ᚷᚢᚱᚸᚦ ᚦᚦ ᚱᚦᚱᚸᚱ ᚱᚱᚢ

You girls know I’m an honest hardworking guy.

Genesis 31:7

and your father has toyed with me and changed my pay ten times, and God hasn’t let him do bad with me.

ᚷᚱᚱᚹᚦ ᚱᚸ ᚱᚦᚹ ᚷᚢᚱᚸᚦᚦ
ᚦᑭᚱᚱ ᚱᚦᑭᚢᚱᚢ ᚦᚦ
ᚢᚱᚹᚱᚱ ᚦᚷᚦᚢ ᚦᚱᚦ ᚢᚱᚷᚢ
ᚱᚱᚢᚱ ᚱᑭᚹᚱ

And your dad keeps changing my salary like almost every time we have another kid here at his house!

Genesis 31:8

If he would say this: ‘The speckled will be your pay’, then all the flock gave birth to speckled. And if he would say this: ‘The streaked will be your pay’, then all the flock gave birth to streaked.

ᚢᚱᚱᑭᚢ ᑭᚢᚦᚦ ᚹᚢ ᚢᚦ
ᚱᚢ ᚦᚱᚱᚱᚦ ᚢᑭᚢᚱ ᚹᚱᚹᚱ
ᚹᚢ ᚢᚦᚦ ᚢᚱᚱᑭᚢ ᚷᚦᚱᚹᚹ
ᚹᚱᚹᚱ ᚢᚱᚱᑭᚱ ᑭᚢᚦᚦ
ᚷᚦᚱᚹᚹ ᚱᚢ ᚦᚱᚱᚱᚦ ᚢᑭᚢᚱ
ᚢᚱᚱᑭᚱ

But whenever he said, “you can keep the sheep with dots,” suddenly the whole damn flock had dot sheep!

Then when he changed it to, “nevermind you get the ones with stripes,”

²⁰⁹Ibid.

suddenly they all had striped babies.

Which had nothing to do with me by the way.

So he's like זֹכֶרֶת here's your pay.

Then he's like nevermind it's in הֵיֶזְק heJe.

Then he's like forget that it's in הֵיֶזְק hear.

Then he's like scratch that it's in אֶחָד rear.

So at this point I feel like he's just fleecing me in the assets.

Genesis 31:9

And God has delivered your father's livestock and given them to me.

אֱלֹהִים חָסְדָּם לָקַח
לְיָדָיו אֶת־כָּל־בְּרִיֹתָיו
וְיָצָא־הֵם מִיָּדָיו

I mean I got all the fleece 'n assets.

Genesis 31:10

And it was at the time of the flock's being in heat, and I raised my eyes and saw in a dream: and here were the he-goats that were going up on the flock: streaked, speckled, and spotted.

וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ

And right at the time when ewe flock were in heat, I look up one day and dream all about הֵיֶזְק goats all הֵיֶזְק ing up on הֵיֶזְק k.

Genesis 31:11

“And an angel of God said to me in the dream, ‘Jacob.’ “And I said, ‘I’m here.’

וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ
וְהָיָה בְּעֵת־הַחֹמֶשׁ

Then God was like “Hey.”²¹⁰

And I was like “I’m right here.”

²¹⁰Lit. הֵיֶזְק in the original.

Genesis 31:12

“And he said, ‘Raise your eyes and see all the he-goats that are going up on the flock: streaked, speckled, and spotted. Because I’ve seen everything that Laban is doing to you.

52720 \$7 \$W 94\$2f
 424x0\$ 6y 3\$9f
 74m\$ 60 4260\$
 4249y 42490
 2x2\$9 2y 42499f
 3w0 796 9w\$ 6y x\$
 y6

And he's like "Raise your eyes and look up at all that stuff you just saw."

That was me. Did it for you.

All four you Jacob.

You're a heeler Jake.

Everything you birth is right.

So I gave ewe my blessing.

I just can't stand by²¹¹.

He doesn't treat you white.

Genesis 31:13

I am the God at Beth-El, where you anointed a pillar, where you made a vow to me. Now get up, go from this land, and go back to the land of your birth.”

9W\$ 6\$ x29 6\$ 3 2y9\$
 9W\$ 39m4 yW xBw4
 3x0 94y yW 26 x94y
 m9\$ 3y \$m y9P
 m9\$ 6\$ 9fWf x\$23
 yx46y4

By the way remember the rock pillow?

The one you oiled all up.

That was me.²¹²

I'm that God, in case you couldn't tell.²¹³

Now go home.

211 Lit. 白

²¹²the God at Beth-El. The Hebrew construction is unclear. The Septuagint reads: “I am the God who appeared to you at Beth-El,” which is presumably what the Hebrew means.

²¹³Lit. couldn't לֹא

Genesis 31:14

And Rachel and Leah answered,
and they said to him, “Do we still
have a portion and legacy in our
father’s house?

ሠፋጽና ጃፋሪና ሪዳ ሃወጽና
ዋሪዳ ነገሪ ልብዐጃ ነሪ ጃሃ
ነገጊጽፋ ጸጊጊጽ ጃሪዳና

So the wives are like “Do we still have anything at dad’s?”

Genesis 31:15

Aren’t we thought of as
foreigners by him, because he
sold us and has eaten up our
money as well?!

ነገጊገወዳ ጸነጊገሃገ ፋነሪጃ
ሣገ ሪሃፋጊና ነገገሃሃ ጊሃ ነሪ
ነገገጃሃ ጸፋ ሪነሃፋ

He treats us like a bunch of foreign women.²¹⁴

Selling us off to some kind of f—

...fellow.

He ate up all the money he gave our twelve kids for food too.

Genesis 31:16

Because all the wealth that God
has delivered from our father:
it’s ours and our children’s. And
now, do everything that that God
has said to you.”

ዓሠፋ ዓሠዐጃ ሪሃ ጊሃ
ነገጊጊጽፋሃ ሣጊጃሪፋ ሪጊጤጃ
ጃጸዐና ነገጊጊጽጊና ፋነጃ ነገሪ
ሣጊጃሪፋ ዓሃፋ ዓሠፋ ሪሃ
ጃሠዐ ሣጊሪፋ

After all, all dad’s money is ours.

He’s gonna be dead²¹⁵ soon after all.

That’s why they call him dad.²¹⁶

Genesis 31:17

And Jacob got up and carried his
children and his wives on the
camels.

ተፋ ፋሠጊሃ ልዋዐጊ ሣዋጊሃ
ሪዐ ሃጊሠገ ተፋሃ ሃጊሃጽ
ሣጊሪሣገጃ

Jacob gets up and carries his wives and kids on the camels.

²¹⁴Lit. ገጸሌ.

²¹⁵Lit. ገገ.

²¹⁶Lit. ገገ.

Genesis 31:18

And he drove all his cattle and all his property that he had acquired, the cattle that were in his possession that he had acquired in Paddan Aram, to come to Isaac, his father, at the land of Canaan.	וַיָּנִיחַ אֶת כָּל מִקְנֵהוּ וְאֶת כָּל רֶכֶשׁוֹ אֲשֶׁר רָכַשׁ מִקְנֵה קְנִיָּנוֹ אֲשֶׁר רָכַשׁ בְּפָדָן אֲרָם לְבֹא אֶל יִצְחָק אָבִיו אֶרְצָה כְּנָעַן׃
---	---

He drives all his cows and all his stuff that he got.
The cows that were in his stuff that he had got in Paddan Aram.
He goes back home to Laughter, his dad, back in Canaan.

Genesis 31:19

And Laban had gone to shear his flock. And Rachel stole the teraphim that her father had.	וְלָבָן הָיָה לְגֹדֵשׁ צֹאן וְרָחֵל שָׁדָד אֶת תְּרָפִים אֲשֶׁר לָבָן הָיוּ בְּעֵץ
---	--

Meanwhile White’s busy giving his sheep a haircut.
Rachel goes back home and steals her father’s gods.
They’re like, statues or whatever. She steals those.

Genesis 31:20

And Jacob stole the heart of Laban, the Aramean, by not telling him that he was fleeing.	וַיִּגְדֹּל יָעֹב אֶת לָבָן הָאֲרָמִי לֹא יָדָע לָבָן כִּי יִפְתָּח לְפָנָיו לְהִמָּלֵךְ
--	--

He steals the LB of LBN by not telling him he’s LBN.²¹⁷
And it really HRT his HRT B.C. obviously.

Genesis 31:21

And he fled, he and everyone he had, and he got up and crossed the river and set his face toward the mountain of Gilead.	וַיִּפְתָּח יָעֹב וְכָל אֲשֶׁר הָיָה עִמּוֹ וַיַּעֲבֹד אֶת הַנָּהָר וַיָּשֶׁת פָּנָיו לְהָרֵי גִלְעָד
--	--

²¹⁷The Hebrew letter Bet (ב) can make either a /b/ sound or a /v/ sound.

He makes a ewe-turn and flees²¹⁸

and so now²¹⁹

he's On the Lamb.

Genesis 31:22

And it was told to Laban on the third day that Jacob had fled.

וַאֲשֶׁר יָדָעַתְּ לָבָן
שֶׁיָּצָא יַעֲקֹב

White away Laban realizes that Jacob's left.

He didn't even say good bye.²²⁰

Genesis 31:23

And he took his brothers with him and pursued him seven days' journey and caught up to him in the mountain of Gilead.

וַיִּקַּח יַעֲקֹב אֶת
אֶחָיו וַיִּרְדּוּ אַחֲרָיו
שִׁבְעַת יָמִים וַיִּמָּצְאוּ
אֹתוֹ בְּהַר גִּילְעָד

It takes 7 days for Laban to catch up.

Let

$$s_J = \text{Jacob's speed}, \quad s_L = \text{Laban's speed}.$$

Laban put three days' journey between himself and Jacob, so assuming that's three days at Laban speed,

$$d_0 = 3s_L.$$

Jacob gets t days to run before Laban comes after him. After Laban has been chasing him for τ days, the gap is

$$\Delta_t = \lambda\tau. 3s_L + (t + \tau)s_J - \tau s_L.$$

Laban catches him when

$$\Delta_t(\tau) = 0.$$

Jacob gets three days before Laban notices.

Then Laban catches him after seven days. So

$$t = 3, \quad \tau = 7.$$

Plug it in:

$$3s_L + 10s_J - 7s_L = 0.$$

Therefore

$$10s_J = 4s_L,$$

²¹⁸Lit. flees.

²¹⁹Lit. וַיִּנְצַח, meaning sheep.

²²⁰Lit. 白.

God threatens Laban in a dream.

Genesis 31:25

And Laban caught up to Jacob,
and Jacob had set up his tent in
the mountain, and Laban set up
with his brothers in the
mountain of Gilead.

ḡṖṐṛ ṡṡ ḡḡḶ ḡᵂṛṡṡ
ṡḶṂṡ ṡṡ ṐṖṡ ḡṖṐṛṡṡ
ṡṛḡṡ ṡṡ ṐṖṡ ḡḡḶṡ ḡṂḡ
ḡṐḶṂ ḡṂḡ

Laban catches up.

He pitches a tent.

Genesis 31:26

And Laban said to Jacob, “What
have you done, that you’ve stolen
my heart and driven off my
daughters like prisoners by the
sword?”

ḡṖṐṛḶ ḡḡḶ ḡᵂṡṛṡṡ
ṡṡ ḡḡḶṡṡ ṡṛᵂᵂ Ṃᵂ
ṛṡḡḡ ṡṡ ḶṂḡṡṡ ṛḡḡḶ
ḡḡḡ ṡṡṛḡᵂᵂ

And LBN’s like:

What have you done?²²¹

You’ve stolen my LB and my LBB and my two BN too.

Genesis 31:27

Why did you hide so as to flee,
and you stole from me, and you
didn’t tell me? And I would have
sent you off with happiness and
with songs and with a drum and
with a lyre.

ṡṡ ḡḡḡḶ ṡṡḡḡᵂ ṂᵂḶ
ṡḡḶṂ ṡḶṡ ṛṡṡ ḡḡḶ
Ṃḡᵂᵂḡ ᵂḡḶᵂṡṡ ṛḶ
ḡṡḡᵂḡṡ ḡṡḡ ᵂṛḡᵂḡṡṡ

You didn’t even tell me you were LBN.

Genesis 31:28

And you didn’t permit me to kiss
my sons and my daughters. Now
you’ve been foolish to do this.

ṖᵂḡḶ ṛḡṡᵂᵂᵂ ṡḶṡ
Ṃṡᵐ ṛṡḡḡḶṡ ṛḡḡḶ
ṡᵂᵐ ṡḶᵂṖṂ

I didn’t even get to kiss my LBN’ or LBN’+.

²²¹Lit. “meh, ah shit” in the original. Scholars believe this is likely a play on מְהָ עֲשִׂיתָ.

You’ve acted foolishly in doing this.²²²

Genesis 31:29

The god at my hand has the means to do bad to you. But your father’s God said to me yesterday saying, ‘Watch yourself from speaking with Jacob: from good to bad.’

xfw0l 242 lxl wz
yy29x 23lxi 09 yy40
9yx/ 2lx 9yx wx
40 994y y/ 9yw3
09 40 9i0y 9902

He’s like:

My god...

Could so hurt you right now.

But your dads would never do that.

“Your” is plural, but “father” is singular. It is unclear who Laban means: Jacob and his wives would make the father Laban; Jacob and his sons would make him Isaac. We would expect “the God of your fathers.” This may be a textual error. Or Laban himself may simply botch the grammar while trying to sound dignified.

Genesis 31:30

And now, you went, because you longed for your father’s house. Why did you steal my gods?”

2y xy/3 y/3 3x0i
x29/ 3xj3yy j3yy
xx x9y7 3y/ y29x
23lx

Now you ran away from dads house and off to your dads house.

He’s doing the thing again.

Genesis 31:31

And Jacob answered, and he said to Laban, “Because I was afraid. Because I said, ‘In case you’ll seize your daughters from me.’

yyll 9yx2i 9902 y02i
2x9yx 2y 2x492 2y
y2xiyy xx l27x yy
240y

Jacob’s like “I was afraid you’d take my girls away from me.”

Picture the face Laban’s making here.

²²²“in doing this,” Lit. ושל, a pun on Esau.

Genesis 31:32

Let the one with whom you'll find your gods not live. In front of our brothers, recognize and take what of yours is with me." And Jacob did not know that Rachel had stolen them.

ጸፋ ተጠሃኝ ሰጠኝ ሃዐ
ልገህ ሕገወገዝ ፋሪ ሃገሕሪፋ
ሕሣ ሃሪ ሰሃሕ ስገገወፋ
ዐላገ ፋሪሱ ሃሪ ወዋሱ ገላሃዐ
ሃጸጸጸገ ሪወሰ ገሃ ጸዋዐገ

So Jacob's like "And I didn't steal your 'gods'.

Check my stuff.

Whoever stole them, may god strike them dead."

Genesis 31:33

And Laban came in Jacob's tent and Leah's tent and the two maids' tent, and he did not find them. And he came out from Leah's tent and came in Rachel's tent.

ጸዋዐገ ሪሕፋጸ ገገሪ ፋጸገሱ
ገጸሠ ሪሕፋጸሱ ሕፋሪ ሪሕፋጸሱ
ተጠገሱ ተጠሃ ፋሪሱ ጸሕሣፋጸ
ሪሕፋጸ ፋጸገሱ ሕፋሪ ሪሕፋሣ
ሪወሰ

Laban came in Jacob's tent.

And Leah's.

Maids too.

But no gods.

So finally he came in Rachel's area.

Genesis 31:34

And Rachel had taken the teraphim and put them in the camel's saddle and sat on them. And Laban felt around the whole tent and did not find them.

ሣገገሰጸጸ ጸፋ ሕወዋሪ ሪወሰሱ
ጸሠሰሱ ሪሣገጸ ሰሃጸ ሣሣሠሰሱ
ጸፋ ገገሪ ሠሠሣገሱ ሣሕገሪዐ
ተጠሃ ፋሪሱ ሪሕፋጸ ሪሃ

Rachel's sitting on the gods.

They're under her cam^לጸ's sadd^לጸ.

Dad checks everywhere.

No gods.

Genesis 31:35

And she said to her father, “Let it not offend in my lord’s eyes that I’m not able to get up before you, because I have the way of women.” And he searched and did not find the teraphim.

ለቀ ጻጸጽ ለቀ ሰሣቶች
ጌሃ ጌሃላቱ ጌሃጌዐጽ ሰፀጌ
ሃጌሃገሣ ሣኅዋሪ ሪሃኅቱ ቶከ
ጌሪ ሣጌሠጎ ሃፃላ ጌሃ
አቱ ቱጦሣ ቱሪኅ ሠገፀጌኅ
ሣጌገሰጸ፭

So Rachel’s like:

Hey dad don’t get mad that I’m not standing.

I’m having the way of women.

That strategy has worked on men for at least 3,000 years.

Genesis 31:36

And Jacob was angered, and he quarreled with Laban, and Jacob answered, and he said to Laban, “What is my offense? What is my sin, that you blazed after me,

ገሰጌኅ ገዋዐጌሪ ሰፀጌኅ
ሰሣቱጌኅ ገዋዐጌ ጎዐጌኅ ጎገሪጽ
፭ሣ ጌዐሠገ ፭ሣ ጎገሪሪ
ጌፃፀቱ ጸዋሪላ ጌሃ ጌጸቱ፳፻

Jacob’s mad. He’s like:

This is unacceptable.

What did I even do?

Genesis 31:37

that you felt around all my belongings? What did you find out of all of your house’s belongings? Set it here, in front of my brothers and your brothers, and let them judge between the two of us.

ጌሪሃ ሪሃ አቱ ጸሠሠሣ ጌሃ
ጌሪሃ ሪሃሣ ጸቱጦሣ ፭ሣ
ላገጎ ፭ሃ ሣጌሠ ሃጸጌጽ
ክፀጌሃክጌኅ ሃጌፀቱክ ጌፀቱ
ክጎጌሃሠ ጎጌጽ

You have no white to come into my house and mess with my girls and sheep and all my stuff.

Genesis 31:38

This twenty years I've been with you, your ewes and your she-goats haven't lost their offspring, and I haven't eaten your flock's rams.

Ṛṡṡṡ Ḷṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ Ḷṡ
ṡṚṡṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ
ṡṚṡṡṡ ṚṚṡṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ
Ṛṡṡṡṡ

These past twenty years, your RHLs²²³ and your LIAs²²⁴ and even those she-goats have been doing great.

Genesis 31:39

I haven't brought you one torn up. I would miss it: you would ask it from my hand, be it stolen by day or stolen by night.

ṡṚṡṡṡ Ṛṡṡṡṡ ṡṚ Ḷṡṡṡ
Ṛṡṡṡ Ḷṡṡṡṡ Ṛṡṡṡṡ
ṡṚṡṡ Ṛṡṡṡṡ Ḷṡṡṡṡṡ
ḶṚṚ Ṛṡṡṡṡṡ

I didn't tear them up or anything, in a sense.

Genesis 31:40

I was ... In the daytime heat ate me up, and ice in the night. And my sleep fled from my eyes.

Ṛṡṡṡṡ ṡṚṡṡ ṚṡṚṚṡ
ṡṡṡṡ ḶṚṚṡ Ḷṡṡṡṡ ṡṡṡ
ṚṡṚṚṡ Ṛṡṡṡṡ

I worked all day. All night too. All for ewe.

Genesis 31:41

This twenty years I've had in your house: I worked for you fourteen years for your two daughters and six years for your flock, and you changed my pay ten times.

Ḷṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ ṚṚ Ḷṡṡ
ṡṡṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ ṡṡṚṡṡ
Ṛṡṡṡ Ḷṡṡ Ḷṡṡṡṡ
ṡṚṡṡṡ ṡṡṡṡ ṡṚṡṡṡ
ṡṡ ṚṚṡṡṡ ṡṡṡṡṡ
ṡṚṡṡṡ ṡṡṡṡ Ṛṡṡṡṡṡ

I worked fourteen years four these two wives.

Then we had 12 kids and 10 times you cut my pay.

²²³The word here is Ṛṡṡ, meaning “Ewe,” and spelled identically to “Rachel.”

²²⁴A similar pun on the name Leah. The words are Ṛṡṡ vs Ṛṡṡ, in this case Aram., for some reason.

Genesis 31:42

If I hadn’t had my father’s God,
the God of Abraham and Fear of
Isaac, by now you would have
sent me away empty-handed.
God saw my degradation and my
hands’ exhaustion, and He
pointed it out last night.”

ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ

If it hadn’t been for my dad’s God, the Abraham’s God and Isaac’s Night-
mare, by now you would have sent me away with nothing.

God came and talked to me last night and he agrees, what you’re doing’s
just not white.

Genesis 31:43

And Laban answered, and he
said to Jacob, “The daughters
are my daughters, and the sons
are my sons, and the flock is my
flock, and everything that you
see: it’s mine. But what shall I
do to my daughters, to these,
today, or to their children to
whom they’ve given birth?

ṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ
ṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛṛṛṛṛ ṛṛṛ

The daughters are my daughters.

The kids are my kids.

The kids... the goat type, those are mine.

Everything is mine.

But what am I gonna do, cut off my kids and grandkids and goatkids?

You’re blessing²²⁵ my Lords,²²⁶

AND IRKING²²⁷ MY IRK.²²⁸

²²⁵Lit. brking in the original, presumably from the Heb. בָּרַךְ.
²²⁶Lit. Ba’als in the original, a Canaanite term meaning lord, master, owner, or husband.
²²⁷Lit. יָרַק in the original.
²²⁸Ibid.

Genesis 31:44

So now, come and let's make a covenant, I and you, and let it be a witness between me and you."

አገላግ እጽዓሃንን እህሪ እኦባ
ፈባሪ እገገንን እጽፋንን ገንፋ
ሃንገላግን ገንገላግ

So come now, let's make a covenant.

Just you and me.

Genesis 31:45

And Jacob took a stone and set it up as a pillar,

ገንፋ ገዋቦጊ ዘዋጊን
እገገሃንን እህገላገንን

Jacob takes a rock and sets it up straight.

Genesis 31:46

and Jacob said to his brothers, "Collect stones." And they took stones and made a pile and ate there at the pile.

የገገፋሪ ገዋቦጊ ገሃፋጊን
ገፋ የዘዋጊን ህገገንገፋ የፀዋሪ
የሪሃፋጊን ሪገ የወገን ህገገ
ሪገፋ ሪፀ ህወ

Jacob's like "Get some rocks!"

They make a big rock pile.

They also have dinner.

Genesis 31:47

And Laban called it ygar shdta', and Jacob called it gal-'d.

ገገገ ገገሪ የሪ ፋገዋጊን
የሪ ፋገዋ ገዋቦጊን ፋጽፋገገ
ፈባሪ

And Jacob calls it "Look at this Pile."²²⁹

And Laban calls it "Look at this Pile"²³⁰

²²⁹Heb. אֶל לֵב, meaning "Witness Pile."

²³⁰Aram. נִתְּנָה לָנוּ יָדָא, meaning "Witness Pile," in this case Aram., for some reason.

Genesis 31:48

And Laban said, “This pile is a witness between me and you today.” On account of this he called its name Gal-Ed.

אבא לרא נגד ראשית
שניא שניני ננינא דא
דאלי יטו קנפ נע לו

Laban says “This pile is a witness between us.

That’s why it’s called Witness Pile.”

Genesis 31:49

(And Mizpah, because he said, “May YHWH observe between me and you when one is hidden from the other.”)

ראש ראש אומות
שניני ננינא יהוה ננינא
יאוני וזא ראשני נע

Also “Watchtower,” because Laban says:

“May YHWH watch us when we can’t see each other.”

Genesis 31:50

“If you degrade my daughters and if you take wives in addition to my daughters, no man is with us. See: God is witness between me and you.”

שני ננינא אא אנוא שני
ננינא לו שנינא דפא
אא ינינו וזא ננינא
שניני ננינא דא שנינא

“If you treat my daughters badly, or go get more wives, nobody’s gonna be there to see it.

But God will.”

Genesis 31:51

And Laban said to Jacob, “Here is this pile, and here is the pillar that I’ve cast between me and you.

אבא שפוזל נגד ראשית
שני אשני אבא לרא
ננינא ראש אומות
שניני ננינא

Laban points at the pile and the pillar:

“These are the border between you and me.”

Genesis 31:52

This pile is a witness, and the pillar is a witness that I won't cross this pile to you and you won't cross this pile and this pillar to me for bad.

אֲדֹנָי אֲנִי לְךָ אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת
 הַכֹּל וְאַתָּה לִּי אֶת

You don't come to my side of the Ancient Near East, and I won't come to your side.

The rocks are here to keep us honest.

Should any future disputes arise, the rocks will be called as witnesses and the pillar will be called to the stand as a witness here against us.

Genesis 31:53

Let Abraham's God and Nahor's gods, their father's gods, judge between us." And Jacob swore by the Awe of his father, Isaac.

וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר
 וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר וְיָשָׁר

Laban says "Let Abraham's God and Nahor's gods judge between us."

Jacob doesn't swear by any of those.

He swears by his dad Laughter's nightmare.^{231 232}

Genesis 31:54

And Jacob made a sacrifice in the mountain and called his brothers to eat bread, and they ate bread and spent the night in the mountain.

וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן
 וַיַּעַבְדֵּן וַיַּעַבְדֵּן

Jacob makes a sacrifice.

Then everybody eats together and spends the night on the mountain.

²³¹ פַּחַד (*paḥad*): fear, dread, terror, panic, alarm—the kind of fear that suddenly seizes you. It can mean either the terror itself or the terrifying thing that causes it. Here it appears in place of the term “God,” to refer to YHWH's relationship to Isaac, a relationship that was, at times, at least moderately startling, to put it mildly.

²³² REF: “God” and “gods” are both אֱלֹהִים, so exactly how many gods Laban means here is unclear.

Genesis 32

Genesis 32:1

And Laban got up early in the morning and kissed his sons and his daughters and blessed them and went. And Laban went back to his place,

ጥዋጥ ገደረ ሠሠወጊና
ገረና ነጊገደረ ዋወጊና
ሠጸጸ ሠጥጊና ነጊጸና
ነሠዋሠረ ገደረ ገወጊና ሠረጊና

Laban gets up early and says goodbye to his progeny like Abe.
Then he goes home.

Genesis 32:2

and Jacob went his way. And angels of God came upon him.

ነሠገላረ ሠረጻ ጥዋዐጊና
ረጽ ጊሠጽሠ ነገ ነዐገጊና
ሠጊጻ

Jacob goes home too.
Messengers came on him.

Genesis 32:3

And Jacob said when he saw them, “This is a camp of God,” and he called that place’s name Mahanaim.

ገወጽሠ ጥዋዐጊ ገሠጽጊና
ጻጋ ሠጊጻረጽ ጻገዐሠ ሠጽገ
ሠነዋሠጻ ሠወ ጽጥጊና
ሠጊገዐሠ ጽጻጻ

Jacob’s like “This is God’s camp” so he calls it Two Camps because monotheism.²³³

Genesis 32:4

And Jacob sent messengers ahead of him to Esau, his brother, to the land of Seir, the territory of Edom,

ሠጊጸጽረሠ ጥዋዐጊ ዐረሠጊሠ
ሣጊዐጽ ሣወ ረጽ ሣጊገገረ
ጻላወ ሳጊዐወ ጻሦገጽ
ሠሣላጽ

Jacob sends messengers to Esau his brother who’s Seir-y in the land of ሠጽ.

²³³Some manuscripts have “because foreshadowing” here.

Genesis 32:5

and commanded them saying,
“You shall say this: ‘To my lord,
to Esau, your servant Jacob said
this, ‘I’ve stayed with Laban and
delayed until now,

እን ለማቅረ ሕተቱ ሃሾጊሃ
ሃሠዐረ ጊሃላቅረ ሃሃለማቱ
ዓዋዐጊ ሃላዓዐ ለማቅ እን
ላዐ ለይቱሃ ጊተላገ ሃዓረ ሕዐ
እተዐ

and tells them this, “You shall say this ‘To Esau, Jacob said this “I’ve stayed
with Laban etc.,

Genesis 32:6

and ox and ass and sheep and
male and female servant have
become mine. And I’m sending to
tell my lord so as to find favor in
your eyes.””

ላሃማይሃ ላሃሠ ጊረ ጊእጊሃ
እይገሠሃ ላዓዐሃ ሃቅሾ
ጊሃላቅረ ላጊገእረ እይረሠቱሃ
ሃጊሃጊዐዓ ሃይ ቅሾሕረ

and I got a lot of ass he says down here three levels deep in the quote stack.
And I’m sending quote level two to say this to you down at level three in
the hope that one (that’s me) will find favor in your eyes.””

Genesis 32:7

And the messengers came back to
Jacob saying, “We came to your
brother, to Esau, and also he’s
coming to you—and four hundred
men with him.”

ረቱ ሕጊሃቅረሕእ ሃዓሠጊሃ
ረቱ ሃሃቅዓ ለማቅረ ዓዋዐጊ
ሃረእ ሕገሃ ሃሠዐ ረቱ ሃጊይቱ
ተሃቅሕዐ ዐዓላቅሃ ሕተቱላዋረ
ሃሕዐ ሠጊቱ

They come back to Jacob and they’re like:

“He’s coming. With four hundred guys.”

Genesis 32:8

And Jacob was very afraid, and he
had anguish. And he divided the
people who were with him and the
sheep and the oxen and the camels
into two camps.

ላቅሕ ዓዋዐጊ ቅላጊጊሃ
ሕዐእ ተቱ ሾይጊሃ ሃረ ላሾጊሃ
ሃቅሾእ ተቱሃ ሃተቱ ላሠቱ
ሕጊረሕገእሃ ላዋዓእ ተቱሃ
ተሃሃይሕ ጊሃሠረ

Jacob’s afraid.

He splits up into two camps.²³⁴

Genesis 32:9

And he said, “If Esau will come to one camp and strike it, then the camp that is left will survive.”

ፋሃዓፖ ሥፋ ላሥፋፖሃ
ተዘፋኝ ጓነዘሥኝ ረፋ ሃሠዐ
ጓነዘሥኝ ጓፖጓሃ ሃጓሃጓሃ
ጓፀፖረገረ ላፋሠነኝ

And he’s like “They can’t kill all of us,” Jacob says, accepting a 50% casualty rate before the fight begins.

Genesis 32:10

And Jacob said, “God of my father Abraham and God of my father Isaac, YHWH, who said to me, ‘Go back to your land and to your birthplace, and I’ll deal well with you,’

ፖጓረፋ ዓዋዐፖ ላሥፋፖሃ
ፖጓረፋሃ ሥጓላዓፋ ፖዓፋ
ጓሃጓፖ ዋዘሥፖ ፖዓፋ
ሃሥላፋረ ዓሃሠ ፖረፋ ላሥፋኝ
ጓዓፖፀፖፋሃ ሃተላሃሥረሃ
ሃሥዐ

The he starts messaging his dad and granddad’s God saying how he (the God) said ‘Go back your land and to your birthplace and I will deal with you real good.’

Genesis 32:11

I’m not worthy of all the kindnesses and all the faithfulness that you’ve done with your servant, because I crossed this Jordan with just my rod, and now I’ve become two camps.

ሥፖላቹዘኝ ረሃሥ ፖተሃፀዋ
ላሠፋ ተሥፋኝ ረሃሥሃ
ፖሃ ሃላዓዐ ተፋ ተፖሠዐ
ተፋ ፖተላዓዐ ፖረዋሥዓ
ጓተዐሃ ጓፒኝ ሃላላፖኝ
ተሃነዘሥ ፖሃሠረ ፖተፖፖኝ

He’s like “I’m not worthy.”

Genesis 32:12

Save me from my brother’s hand, from Esau’s hand, because I fear him, in case he’ll come and strike me, mother with children.

ፖዘፋ ላፖሥ ፋነ ፖነረፖሥኝ
ፖሃነፋ ፋላፖ ፖሃሃሠዐ ላፖሥ
ፖሃሃጓሃ ፋሃዓፖ ነገ ሃተፋ
ሥፖነዓ ረዐ ሥፋ

So he’s like “Save me from my brother.”

²³⁴Hey that’s the name of the place.

Then he clarifies that he means Esau, in case YHWH didn't know.

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Genesis 32:13

And you've said, 'I'll do well with you, and I'll make your seed like the sand of the sea, that it won't be countable because of its great number.'"

ጋፀጊጸ ተላሣቅ ጓተቀሃ
ጊተሃሠሃ ሃሃዐ ጋጊፀጊቀ
ሃጊጸ ረሃዘሃ ሃዐላጊ ተቀ
ጋላሃ ላገቹጊ ቀረ ላሠቀ

"Remember what you promised about the seed?"

Genesis 32:14

And he spent that night there.

And he took an offering for Esau, his brother, from what had come into his hand:

ዘዋጊሃ ተሃላላ ልጊፊ ሃሠ ጋጊሃ
ሃሠፊ ልዘገሃ ሃላጊጸ ተፃላ ገሃ
ሃጊዘተ

He falls asleep and stays the night there.

He gets a present for Esau.

Genesis 32:15

two hundred she-goats and twenty he-goats, two hundred ewes and twenty rams,

ሣጊሠጊጸ፤ ሣጊጸቆሣ ሣጊጋዐ
ሣጊጸቆሣ ሣጊፊላ ሣጊፃሠዐ
ሣጊፃሠዐ ሣጊጊቆ፤

It's a large number of goats.

Also RHLs and AILs.

Genesis 32:16

thirty nursing camels and their offspring, forty cows and ten bulls, twenty she-asses and ten he-asses.

ፃ፤ ጸ፤ዋጊሃጊሣ ሣጊፊሣ
ጸ፤ፃገ ሣጊሠፊሠ ሣፋጊሃ
ፋፃሠዐ ሣጊፃገ፤ ሣጊዐፃፃቀ
ሣፃጊዐ፤ ሣጊፃሠዐ ጸሃጸቀ
ፋፃሠዐ

Also thirty humpy milkers, forty regular milkers, ten bulls, and assorted ass of both sexes.

²³⁵Jacob asks to be "delivered" from Esau (נָצַל); after wrestling the man later in the chapter he says his life was "delivered" by the same root.

Genesis 32:17

And he placed them in his servants’ hands, each herd by itself, and he said to his servants, “Pass on in front of me, and keep a distance between each herd and the next.”

ገላዕ ፋገላዕ ልገጽ ሃጽጊኛ
ረፋ ገሣፋጊኛ ፋገረ ገላዕ
ዘፋፋኝ ጊገገረ ፋፃዎ ፋገላዕ
ሃገገኝ ገላዕ ሃገገ ፋሣጊጠጽ
ገላዕ

He gives all that to his guys, and he’s like:

“As your leader, it’s important for you to take the lead.”

He’s the protagonist.

Genesis 32:18

And he commanded the first, saying, “When my brother, Esau, meets you and asks you, saying, ‘To whom do you belong, and where are you going, and to whom do these in front of you belong?’

ገሣፋረ ሃፋጠፋገጃ ጸፋ ፋጦጊኛ
ጊዘፋ ፋጠዐ ሃጠገገጊ ጊሃ
ጃጸፋ ጊሃረ ገሣፋረ ሃረፋጠኛ
ጃረፋ ጊሃረኛ ሃረጽ ጃሃፋኛ
ሃጊገገረ

And he’s like “Ok, when Esau asks who owns you...”

Genesis 32:19

then you’ll say, ‘To your servant, to Jacob. It’s an offering sent to my lord, to Esau. And here he is behind us as well.’”

ገዋዐጊረ ሃላፃዐረ ጸገሣፋኛ
ጃዘፋረጠ ፋኛጃ ጃዘገሣ
ሣገ ጃሃጃኛ ፋጠዐረ ጊሃላፋረ
ፋገጊፃዘፋ ፋኛጃ

Then say “To Jacob, it’s a present. Jacob would like to clarify that he’s your servant and you’re his lord. He’s at the back.”

Genesis 32:20

And he also commanded the second, also the third, also all of those who were going behind the herds, saying, “You’ll speak this way to Esau when you find him,

ጊሃጠጃ ጸፋ ሣገ ፋጦጊኛ
ሣገ ጊጠጊረጠጃ ጸፋ ሣገ
ጊፃዘፋ ሣጊሃረጃጃ ረሃ ጸፋ
ገገላሃ ገሣፋረ ሣጊፃላዐጃ
ፋጠዐ ረፋ ሃፋፃገላጽ ጃጋጃ
ፋጸፋ ሣሃፋጦሣፃ

He tells the other guys to say the same thing, presumably in the hopes that Esau will be fatigued from the repetition by the time he reaches the back.

Genesis 32:21

and you'll say, 'Here is your servant, Jacob, behind us as well.'" Because he said, "Let me appease his face with the offering that's going in front of me, and after that I'll see his face; maybe he'll raise my face."

ሃላም ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ

He prepares to face his brother.²³⁶

Genesis 32:22

And the offering passed ahead of him. And he spent that night in the camp.

ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ

Everyone else goes ahead of him. He stays back.

So the gifts are headed toward Esau.

And Esau's headed toward him.

Un(conscious+derstandab)ly, Jacob's not moving, cuz he's asleep.²³⁷

Genesis 32:23

And he got up in that night and took his two wives and his two maids and his eleven boys and crossed the Jabbok ford.

ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ
ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ ሕገ

He gets up in the night and takes his two wives and two other wives and his eleven boys.

He needs to fast as possible here, which is presumably why he skips Dinah.²³⁸

²³⁶The word “face” (פָּנִים) saturates the episode, occurring five times in this sentence alone. Later, he says he's seen God “face to face,” and finally tells Esau that seeing his face is like seeing God's (33:10).

²³⁷Since they're all moving well below Laban speed in this scene, classical biblical mechanics is sufficient for the inferences below.

²³⁸Sic?

Then he crosses the Jaboc.²³⁹

Genesis 32:24

And he took them and had them
cross the wadi, and he had
everything that was his cross.

𐤅𐤕 𐤕𐤁𐤁𐤓𐤓𐤓 𐤕𐤁𐤁𐤓𐤓
𐤁𐤕𐤕 𐤅𐤕 𐤁𐤁𐤓𐤓𐤓 𐤕𐤁𐤁𐤓𐤓
𐤓𐤕

All those he bore cross.

Genesis 32:25

And Jacob was left by himself.
And a man^a wrestled with him
until the dawn’s rising.

𐤁𐤁𐤕 𐤁𐤕𐤕 𐤁𐤕𐤕𐤓
𐤁𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤓
𐤁𐤕𐤕𐤓 𐤕𐤕𐤕

^aLit. 𐤕𐤕𐤕 in the original.

Strap in folks, this one’s a doozy.

Now Jacob’s all by himself.

He wrestles with a man²⁴⁰ until sunrise.^{241 242 243}

Genesis 32:26

And he saw that he was not able
against him, and he touched the
inside of his thigh, and the inside
of Jacob’s thigh was dislocated
during his wrestling with him.

𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤓
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤓 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤓 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕𐤓
𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤓𐤓𐤓 𐤕𐤕𐤕𐤓 𐤕𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤕𐤕

²³⁹Jaboc (more commonly spelled Jaboq, Jabbok, or Jabok; Hebrew: יַבֹּק) is a biblical river whose name translates to “pouring out,” “emptying,” or “flowing rapidly.” Derived from the Hebrew root verb *baqaq*, it translates literally to “he will empty.”

²⁴⁰Lit. 𐤕𐤕𐤕 in the original.

²⁴¹“Wrestled” is *’b-q* (בַּקַּח), a verb found only twice in the Bible, both in this scene (Gen. 32:25–26). BDB derives it from *’abaq*, “dust”: literally something like “dust oneself up with someone,” hence grapple or wrestle; Strong’s memorably glosses it “to bedust.” The word may also be playing on the nearby river Jabbok (*Yabboq*), whose name in turn sounds suspiciously like Jacob (*Ya’aqob*): Jacob *Ya’aqob* *’b-q*s at the *Yabboq*. So the famous “wrestling” is, at the lexical level, two men rolling around and raising dust, inside a dense little knot of nearly matching sounds.

²⁴²The ordinary noun means fine, easily airborne dust or powder, including the dust kicked up by horses (Ezek. 26:10). For context, Ezekiel 25 is about Ammon, Moab, and Edom; Ezekial 24 is about burning bones and lewdness; and Ezekiel 23 contains the famous line, “There she lusted after her lovers, whose genitals were like those of donkeys and whose emission was like that of horses.”

²⁴³“Bless” is *b-r-k* (בָּרַךְ), the same consonantal root as *berek*, “knee.” The root can also mean to kneel or bow, and the plural “knees” can mean the lap—the space formed by the knees when sitting. Thus the semantic cloud around *b-r-k* includes *blessing*, *kneeling/bowing*, *knee*, and *lap*. The overlap is especially suggestive here: Jacob demands a *b-r-k*, a blessing, in a scene already obsessively concerned with his thigh, hip, and groin—and the same three consonants also point toward kneeling and the lap.

And he²⁴⁴ saw that he²⁴⁵ was not able against him.²⁴⁶

And he²⁴⁷ touched the inside of his²⁴⁸ thigh²⁴⁹

And the inside of Jacob's thigh is dislocated.²⁵⁰

Genesis 32:27

And he said, “Let me go, because the dawn has risen.” And he said, “I won’t let you go unless you bless me.”

וַיֹּאמֶר זָכַרְתִּי אֶת־עֲוֹןִי
וְעַתָּה אֶפְעָל וְיִשְׁכַּח
אֶת־עֲוֹןִי וְיִשְׁכַּח אֶת־עֲוֹןִי
וְיִשְׁכַּח אֶת־עֲוֹןִי

So he's like “Let me go, the sun is rising.”

Not clear why he's not ok with the sun.²⁵¹

He²⁵² says “I won’t let you go until you kneel.”²⁵³

²⁴⁴Who?

²⁴⁵Ibid!

²⁴⁶Ibidem!

²⁴⁷I can't even with this.

²⁴⁸Red can't handle this.

²⁴⁹The usual translation, “thigh,” understates the range of the term ירך. Across its 34 occurrences (32 verses) in the Masoretic Text, it means thigh/hip/haunch (Gen 32:26–33; Judg 3:16,21; Ps 45:4), groin/loins (Gen 24:2,9; 47:29; Exod 28:42), reproductive source—descendants literally “come out of” one's ירך (Gen 46:26; Exod 1:5; Judg 8:30)—and, spatially, the side/flank of the tabernacle or altar (Exod 40:22,24; Lev 1:11; Num 3:29,35) and base/shaft of the menorah (Exod 25:31; 37:17; Num 8:4). Num 5:21–27 likewise uses it for the woman's reproductive/groin region; Song 7:2 for the curves of the thighs/hips; Jer 31:19 and Ezek 21:17 for striking the thigh in distress; Ezek 24:4 for an animal haunch; and Judg 15:8 in the idiom שוק על ירך. Thus the range—thigh/hip/haunch → groin/loins/reproductive source, and side/flank → base—is directly attested in Biblical Hebrew, not merely reconstructed from cognates. Comparative caution: Phoenician KAI 4's yrk is the verb “prolong,” not this noun; Akkadian likewise has no simple yarku “thigh,” though warkatu/turkatu means rear/backside/buttocks (while words such as qablu can denote loins/hips). Consequently Gen 24:2,9 and 47:29's “place your hand under my ירך” can carry much stronger groin/loins/reproductive force than “under my thigh.” Gen 32:26–33's כף ירך, typically translated as thigh, is expressed with the same word elsewhere used for the reproductive loins. The lexical connection between the oath scenes and Jacob's injury is therefore considerably more suggestive than the English gloss “thigh” makes apparent.

²⁵⁰In Gen. 32:26, “dislocated” is wattēqa' (וּתְקַע), from t-q- (תְּקַע), a remarkably broad verb meaning drive/thrust in, fix or fasten, strike, clap, or blow a horn; “dislocate” here is inferred from context. It is also the verb used throughout Josh. 6 for what the seven priests do with their horns as Israel circles Jericho for seven days, with the rear guard following the Ark. Most suggestively, the same verb occurs in Num. 25:4 for what is to be done to the Israelite leaders after the Baal-Peor apostasy—an episode associated with a fertility cult and explicitly with sexual relations between Israelite men and Moabite women—where its disputed sense may be “hang,” “impale,” or “expose.” The underlying physical range is thus something like forcefully drive, strike, fix, or leave out of position; Gen. 32:26's specific sense “wrench/dislocate” is possible, but hardly lexically inevitable.

²⁵¹Gotta be some kind of demon or vampire.

²⁵²Who?!

²⁵³“Bless” is b-r-k (בָּרַךְ), the same consonantal root as berek, knee.” The root can also mean to kneel or bow, and the plural “knees” can mean the lap—the space formed by the knees when sitting. Thus the semantic cloud around b-r-k includes blessing, kneeling/bowing, knee, and lap. The overlap is especially suggestive here: Jacob demands a

ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ wayyōmer and he said
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ šallēhēnî let me go
ᐃᐃ kî because
ᐃᐃᐃ ᾿ālā has risen
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ haššahar the dawn

ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ wayyōmer and he said
ᐃᐃ lō’ not
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᾿āšallēhākā I will let you go
ᐃᐃ kî except
ᐃᐃ ᾿im if
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ bēraḳtānî you bless me

Genesis 32:28

And he said to him, “What is your name?” And he said, “Jacob.”

ᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ

Name change incoming.

ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ wayyōmer and he said
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᾿ēlāw to him
ᐃᐃ mah what
ᐃᐃᐃ ṣəmekā your name

ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ wayyōmer and he said
ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ya ᾿āqōb Jacob

Genesis 32:29

And he said, “Your name won’t be said ‘Jacob’ anymore but ‘Israel,’ because you’ve struggled with God and with people and were able.”

ᐱᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃ ᐱᐃᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃ
ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃᐃᐃ ᐃᐃᐃ

So he says “You won’t be called²⁵⁴ Jacob anymore.”

Now he’s²⁵⁵ Israel.

His etymology is not correct, as far as we know.

Nobody knows what’s going on in this line or why it’s here.²⁵⁶

b-r-k, a blessing, in a scene already obsessively concerned with his thigh, hip, and groin—and the same three consonants also point toward kneeling and the lap.

²⁵⁴Lit. “said” in the original Eng. and Heb.

²⁵⁵Lit. he Israel in the original.

²⁵⁶There are some remarkable Semitic comparanda for the sound sequence *r- ʿl*. Classical Arabic *ra l* means a young ostrich, with associated imagery of rapid, frightened or wild movement, and *R l* is independently attested as a personal name in ancient Safaitic. Most strikingly, Ibn Manzur preserves an old poem in which a woman propositions a man and touches his penis; in the immediately following line the speaker describes what happens to his *ra l*, which the lexicographer explains through the behavior of the young ostrich. Thus *ra l* does not lexically mean “penis,” but an explicitly penile metaphor using the word is independently attested. A neighboring but phonologically distinct Arabic root, *r- ʿl*, means to stab, pierce, or thrust violently, while Aramaic *r- ʿl* means “tremble.” Farther north, the obscure form *ʿr- ʿl* occurs in Hebrew and, remarkably, in the Moabite Mesha inscription in connection with Israel; its meaning is disputed, with proposals ranging from a cultic object to a human leader. No corresponding anatomical *r- ʿl* has been securely found in Ugaritic or Akkadian. None of this establishes an etymology for *Israel*—whose apparent final *r- ʿl* crosses the ordinary morpheme boundary before *El*—but it supplies

Suffice it to say, at the end of the day,

Notwithstanding our overall lack of insight into the night fight,

He won and the man blessed him, (from+onto) the ground not the other way around.

And it's something to do with struggling.

He's struggled with God²⁵⁷.

And with man²⁵⁸.

That's why he blessed him.

And that's why לָאֱלֹהִים is the name we say²⁵⁹ him to this day.

וַיֹּאמֶר wayyōmer and he said
לֹא lō' not
יַעֲקֹב ya'āqōb Jacob

וַיֹּאמֶר yē'āmēr he says
עַד 'ōd again / still / further
שִׁמְךָ šimkā your name
כִּי kī but / rather / for / because
יִם 'im if
לְיִשְׂרָאֵל yisrā'el Israel
כִּי kī for / because
סָרִיתָ sārītā you contended / struggled
יִם 'im with
עִלֹּהִים 'ēlōhīm gods / God / a god
וְיִם wə'im and with
וַאֲנָשִׁים 'ānāšīm men / people
וַתִּיכָל wattûkāl and you were able / prevailed

Genesis 32:30

And Jacob asked. And he said,
“Tell your name.” And he said,
“Why is this that you ask my
name?” And he blessed him
there.

וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב לְאֱלֹהִים
וַיֹּאמֶר שִׁמְךָ כִּי
עָלִיתָ לְאֶמֶן
וַיֹּאמֶר וְיִם

an unusually rich set of ancient sound-associations for possible paronomasia, including, rather inconveniently, an independently attested sexual one.

²⁵⁷Lit. לָאֱלֹהִים.

²⁵⁸Lit. וַיִּשְׁתָּחֲוֶה.

²⁵⁹The root אָמַר is the single most common verb in Biblical Hebrew, occurring roughly 5,300 times in the Hebrew Bible. Its basic meaning is say, but its very high frequency and use in many different discourse contexts give it a considerably wider English translation range. In the translation data used here, its renderings, sorted by frequency, include: said (2766), saying (862), say (601), says (594), spoke (77), answered (50), speak (29), told (25), tell (23), thought (17), spoken (15), commanded (14), responded* (7), ordered and promised (6 each), asked and called (4 each), commands and resolved (3 each); answer, ask, call, continued, decided, declared, follows, gave an order, gave the order, gave orders, intend, namely, proposing, said*, speaking, speaks, telling, and thinking (2 each); and address, advised, answers, asking, asserting, assigned, command, commanded to say, consider, declare*, declared*, declares, demonstrates, designate, desired, indeed say, informed, intended, intending, meditate, mentioned, name, news, plainly says, really thought, repeated*, replied*, requested, saying*, sent word, speak to you saying, specifically say, specified, still say, suppose, tells, think, utters, and vaunt (1 each).

So Jacob asks.^{260 261}

He says “What’s your שׂוֹאֵל?”

He says “Why ask²⁶² this שׂוֹאֵל?”

He blesses²⁶³ him שׂוֹאֵל.

וַיֹּמֶר	wayyōmer	and he said
הֹדֵר	haggîdā	tell
נָא	nnā	please
שְׁמֶךָ	šəmekā	your name

וַיֹּמֶר	wayyōmer	and he said
לָמָּה	lāmmā	why
זֶה	zeh	this
לָכֵן	tiš'al	you ask / inquire
לִשְׁמִי	lišmî	for my name
וַיְבָרֶךְ	waybārek	and he blessed
לוֹ	'ōlō	him
שָׁם	šām	there

Genesis 32:31

And Jacob called the place’s name
Peni-El, “because I’ve seen God
face-to-face, and my life has been
delivered.”

שָׁם וַיִּקְרָא יַעֲקֹב
לַמָּקוֹם פְּנֵי־אֵל
וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב
לְעַמְּוֵל וְלְרָחֵל
וְלְלֵוָי וְלְיִשְׂרָאֵל
לֵאמֹר כִּי־פָנִי
רָאִיתִי

Deliverance!²⁶⁴

²⁶⁰The verb here is פָּנִי (פ-נ-י), conventionally “ask,” but its semantic range is much wider. Biblical Hebrew uses the root for *ask, question, request, petition, seek, desire, demand, beg*. One can פָּנִי for information, for an object or favor, for permission, for someone’s welfare, or for an answer, favor, or decision from a deity or oracle. The intensity is therefore supplied largely by context.

The same semantic center is ancient and widespread in Semitic. Ugaritic *šl* means to ask or inquire; Akkadian *ša ālu/šālu* covers asking, questioning, inquiring, consulting, asking for, and related petitionary uses; Aramaic and Syriac *šl* include asking, questioning, consulting, requesting, entreating, and demanding; and cognates occur more widely in Semitic. The common idea is not specifically “asking a question,” but **seeking something from another by asking**—information, an answer, an object, permission, assistance, or compliance.

The grammar of this verse is consequently worth preserving exactly. It does *not* say “Jacob asked him.” It says “**and Jacob פָּנִי, and he said**”; the object of פָּנִי is unstated. The following “*Tell your name*” makes a demand concerning the saying of some name of someone, but “him” is supplied by translators rather than expressed by the Hebrew. Nor does the following “*and he said*” identify its subject by name: Hebrew simply continues with another masculine singular “he.”

This matters especially in a passage whose masculine pronouns are already remarkably slippery. The lexical range permits the first clause to be heard in a variety of ways, without specifying in the verb itself exactly what was sought or from whom. Only the ensuing speech provides the contextual clue. The response then repeats the same root: פָּנִי, conjugated here as פָּנִי, which, curiously, is one letter away from יִשְׂרָאֵל (Israel).

²⁶¹Lit. “Jacob begs” in the original text.

²⁶²Ibid.

²⁶³Lit. פָּנִי in the original, a verb meaning “to kneel, bend the knee” in the standard Qal form. The form here is the Piel form, the intensified form of the same verb, commonly translated as “bless.”

²⁶⁴The root פָּנִי has the basic sense of **taking away, stripping away, or pulling something out from somewhere**. In the Niphal, as here, it means **to be delivered, rescued, saved, or to survive**—literally something like being *pulled out* of danger. The same root develops quite differently in the Piel: **to make use of, exploit, or abuse** someone or something, presumably from the idea of *taking something out of* it. Thus “my life has been delivered” can retain a concrete undertone: Jacob’s life has been **pulled out intact**

Genesis 32:32

And the sun rose on him as he
passed Penuel, and he was
faltering on his thigh.

אֶל־פְּנֹאֵל וַיִּשָּׁרֶץ
בְּיָמֵי הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וַיִּשָּׁרֶץ
בְּיָמֵי הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ

Sun rises as he passes Face of God.

His parts are a bit off as he heads toward the next section.²⁶⁵

Note: the text seems a bit blessed²⁶⁶ here.

Genesis 32:33

On account of this the children
of Israel to this day will not eat
the tendon of the vein that is on
the inside of the thigh, because
he touched the inside of Jacob's
thigh, the tendon of the vein.

וְעַד הַיּוֹם
לֹא יֵאָכְל
בְּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
אֶת־הַגִּידָה
וְעַד הַיּוֹם
לֹא יֵאָכְל
בְּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
אֶת־הַגִּידָה
וְעַד הַיּוֹם
לֹא יֵאָכְל
בְּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

End of class folks, great job all, no further questions.²⁶⁷

from his face-to-face encounter with God.

²⁶⁵Lit. vers secספןהנהחט+... in the original.

²⁶⁶Lit. blessé, from the French *bless*, meaning hurt, wound, injure, or maim.

²⁶⁷The singular *gîd* (“sinew/tendon”) here is effectively a hapax in this anatomical construction: outside Gen. 32:32 the noun is rare, appearing only in Isa. 48:4 (an “iron sinew”) and in the plural in Job 10:11; 40:17 and Ezek. 37:6,8. The surrounding vocabulary does little to make “ordinary thigh tendon” secure. *Kaf* denotes a palm, hollow, sole, or other concave region; Ezekiel’s plural “sinews” occurs beside bones and flesh in deliberately graphic bodily imagery; and Job 40:17 is especially suggestive: immediately after the creature’s *zanab* (“tail”), its *gîdê* are said to be tightly interwoven around its dual *paḥad*. The latter notoriously uncertain word was understood by the KJV/Strong’s tradition as “stones,” i.e. testicles, while many modern versions euphemize it as “thighs”; some translations accordingly render the whole phrase “sinews of his male organs.” Relatedly, *paḥad* is also the ordinary word “fear/dread,” and Genesis itself gives it an extraordinary prominence only one chapter earlier: in Gen. 31:42,53 Jacob calls his father’s deity the “Fear of Isaac” and then swears “by the Fear of his father Isaac.” The anatomical *paḥad* of Job 40:17 and the divine title *Paḥad Isaac* need not be the same lexical sense; nevertheless, the juxtaposition is striking in this particular narrative. Jacob swears by Isaac’s *paḥad*; Abraham’s oath had required Jacob’s future father-in-law’s predecessor to put his hand “under my *yarek*”; and shortly afterward Jacob’s own *yarek* is struck at its *kaf* and associated with a unique singular *gid*. Thus Isaiah’s “iron sinew,” Ezekiel’s anatomical usage, Job’s tail + paired *paḥad* + tightly woven sinews, Genesis’s *kaf* + *yarek* (independently capable of denoting the reproductive loins), and Genesis’s peculiar “Fear of Isaac” terminology are not individually decisive. Together they provide several independent reasons to suspect that “sinew of the thigh/hip”—and perhaps even the earlier “put your hand under my thigh”—is considerably more anatomically polite than the Hebrew. There are, in short, an awkward number of roads in this vocabulary leading toward the family jewels.

Genesis 33

Genesis 33:1

And Jacob raised his eyes and looked, and here was Esau coming, and four hundred men with him. And he divided the children among Leah and Rachel and the two maids;

יַצְנַן וַיִּשְׁׁרֹף עֵשָׂו וְרָא
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וְאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת
אֲנָשִׁים עִמּוֹ וַיִּשְׁׁרֹף
לֵב יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁׁרֹף
לֵב יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
לֵב יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
לֵב יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
לֵב יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף

Now here’s a curious section.

So Jacob looks up and sees Esau coming with 400 guys.²⁶⁸

He divides up the 12 kids between the 4 wives.

Genesis 33:2

and he placed the maids and their children first, and Leah and her children following, and Rachel and Joseph following,

וַיִּשְׁׁרֹף יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף

He puts the maids and their kids first.

Then Leah and her kids behind them.

Then Rachel is in the back with her son Joseph,

Genesis 33:3

and he passed in front of them. And he bowed to the ground seven times until he came up to his brother.

וַיִּשְׁׁרֹף יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף
אֶת יַעֲקֹב וַיִּשְׁרֹף

and he passes “before their faces” (Heb. לפניהם).

And he bows to the ground seven times until Esau arrives.

²⁶⁸Unlike Abraham and Sarah, whose new names permanently replace their old ones, Jacob continues to be called Jacob even after he is renamed Israel. This is curious.

Genesis 33:4

And Esau ran to him and embraced him and fell on his neck and kissed him. And they wept.

የጸፋዓዋሪ የወዐ ጠፃጊና
ሪዐ ሪገጊና የጻዋዎፀጊና
የሃዎጊና የጻዋወጊና የፃፋዮጠ

Esau runs up and hugs him real hard.

The bros kiss and cry.

Genesis 33:5

And he raised his eyes and saw the women and the children, and he said, “Who are these whom you have?” And he said, “The children with whom God has graced your servant.”

የጊጎጊዐ ጸፋ ፋወጊና
ሣጊወጎጻ ጸፋ ፋዓጊና
ዓሣፋጊና ሣጊሳሪጊጻ ጸፋና
ዓሣፋጊና ሃሪ ጻሪፋ ጊሣ
ሪፋ ጎጎፀ ዓወፋ ሣጊሳሪጊጻ
ሃሳዎጐ ጸፋ ሣጊጻ

He looks up and sees all the women and kids.

And he’s like “Who’ve you got here?”

He says it’s his kids.

Genesis 33:6

And the maids came over, they and their children, and bowed.

ጻጎጻ ጸየፀጎወጻ ጎወገጸና
ጎጊየፀጸወጸና ጎጻጊሳሪጊና

Bilhah and Zilpah and the kids bow.

Genesis 33:7

And Leah and her children, too, came over, and they bowed. And then Joseph and Rachel came over, and they bowed.

ጻጊሳሪጊና ጻፋሪ ሣገ ወገጸና
ወገጎ ዓፀፋና የየፀጸወጊና
የየፀጸወጊና ሪፀዓና ገጃዮጊ

Then Leah and her kids do the thing.

Then Rachel’s son Joseph and Rachel herself do it.

Genesis 33:8

And he said, “Who is all this camp of yours that I met?” And he said, “To find favor in my lord’s eyes.”

לֵךְ יָלַךְ עַל הַיָּדָיִם
וְהָיָה אֵלַי אֶת־עֵינַי
כִּי־יָלַךְ הַיָּדָיִם עַל־עֵינַי
וְהָיָה אֵלַי אֶת־עֵינַי

And he’s like “Who was all that?”

And he’s like “To find favor in my lord’s eyes.”

Not clear what happened here.

Presumably Esau here is saying something like:

“What’s the deal with all those gift from before?”

If so, Jacob’s response makes sense.

Genesis 33:9

And Esau said, “I have a great deal, my brother. Let what’s yours be yours.”

וְהָיָה אֵלַי אֶת־עֵינַי
כִּי־יָלַךְ הַיָּדָיִם עַל־עֵינַי

So Esau’s like “Bro I’ve got enough stuff, you don’t need to give me presents.”

Genesis 33:10

And Jacob said, “Don’t. If I’ve found favor in your eyes, then you’ll take my offering from my hand, because on account of this I’ve seen your face—like seeing God’s face!—and you’ve accepted me.

וְהָיָה אֵלַי אֶת־עֵינַי
כִּי־יָלַךְ הַיָּדָיִם עַל־עֵינַי
וְהָיָה אֵלַי אֶת־עֵינַי
כִּי־יָלַךְ הַיָּדָיִם עַל־עֵינַי

Jacob’s like “Please I insist.”

Then he says this curious thing about how Esau’s face is like The Face of God.

Which is why he named the place “Peni El” in the previous chapter after the wrestling scene.

Genesis 33:11

Take my blessing that's been brought to you, because God has been gracious to me and because I have everything.” And he pressed him, and he took it.

קִּוְּיָהּ בְּרָכָה לְךָ
בְּיָדֶיךָ כִּי הָיָה
לְךָ וְלִי וְלִי וְלִי
וְלִי וְלִי וְלִי וְלִי

Hey remember in the previous scene where *someone* said:

“I won’t let you go until you give me your blessing.”

Ok so here Jacob’s like “Take my blessing.”

Also recall that before this scene, the bros last scene together was the “Jacob steals the blessing” scene.²⁶⁹

Jacob insists, so Esau accepts.

Genesis 33:12

And he said, “Let’s travel, and let’s go. And let me go alongside you.”

וְעַתָּה יֵצֵא וְיֵלֶךְ
בְּצִדִּי וְיֵלֶךְ

So he (presumably Esau) is all happy that they’ve finally made amends, and he suggests they hang out and go on adventures together.

Genesis 33:13

And he said to him, “My lord knows that the children are weak and the nursing sheep and oxen are with me, and they’ll drive them one day and all the sheep will die.

וְעַתָּה יֵצֵא וְיֵלֶךְ
בְּצִדִּי וְיֵלֶךְ
וְעַתָּה יֵצֵא וְיֵלֶךְ
בְּצִדִּי וְיֵלֶךְ

So he (presumably Jacob) is like “Oh gosh, well you know I’d love to, best bro, heh, but the kids are real young, and if we let you come along then like, I dunno, um, all the sheep²⁷⁰ might die.”

²⁶⁹Also known as The Blinding of Isaac among the erudite.

²⁷⁰Lit. לְחַלּוּ and לְאִסּוּ.

Genesis 33:14

Let my lord pass on in front of his servant; and I, let me move along at my pace required by the task that’s before me and required by the children until I come to my lord at Seir.”

ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ

You go on ahead.

I’ll go at my own speed.

For the kids.

I’ll meet you in Harrisburg.²⁷¹

Genesis 33:15

And Esau said, “Let me set with you some of the people who are with me.” And he said, “Why have I found favor in my lord’s eyes?”

ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣ

Esau’s like “Here take some of my guys.”

Jacob is confused about why Esau’s being so nice to him.

Genesis 33:16

And Esau went back on his way to Seir that day,

ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ

So Esau goes to Seir, where Jacob just promised to meet him.

Meanwhile, while Esau is patiently waiting...

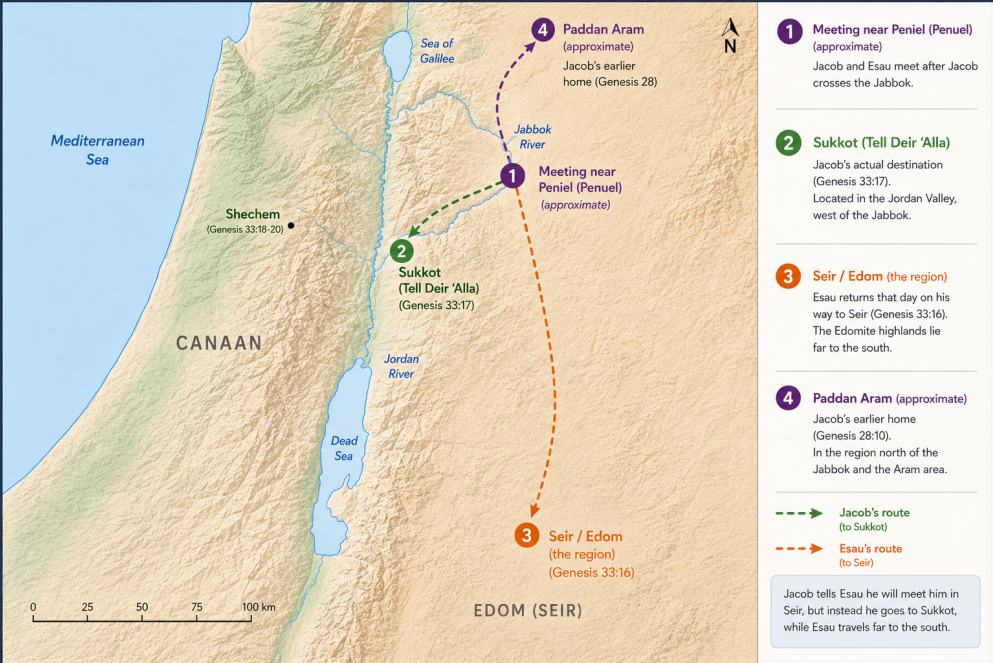
Genesis 33:17

and Jacob traveled to Sukkot. And he built a house for himself and made booths for his cattle. On account of this he called the place’s name Sukkot.

ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ
ṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣṣ

²⁷¹Seir (שֵׁעִיר) means “hairy” or “shaggy,” from שֵׁעַר, “hair.” Esau himself is described as שֵׁעִר, “hairy” (27:11). Presumably this is what the text meant here.

Jacob’s like “Fukkot” and heads off to Sukkot.



Then he builds a house for himself and some Sukkahs for his cows.

Which is the reason why we Sukkot to this day.²⁷²

Genesis 33:18

And Jacob came, safe, to the city of Shechem, which was in the land of Canaan, when he was coming from Paddan Aram, and camped in front of the city.

וַיָּבֹא יַעֲקֹב בְּשָׁלוֹם אֶל־עִיר שְׁכֶם
שֶׁעָלָה אֲשֶׁר בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן
בְּבֹאוֹ מִפְּדַן אֲרָם וַיַּחַם
אֶת־אָהֳלָיו בְּעֵמֶק שְׁכֶם

Jacob comes, unharmed, to Shechem when he was coming from Paddan Aram and he camps in front of the city.

Genesis 33:19

And he bought the section of field in which he pitched his tent from the hand of the sons of Hamor, father of Shechem, for a hundred qesita.

וַיִּקְנֶה אֶת־הַחֶבֶל אֲשֶׁר הָחֵם
לְפָנָיו מִיַּד בָּנֵי חָמֹר
אֲבִי שְׁכֶם לְמֵאתָיִם
קֶסֶת וַיִּשְׁכֵּן שָׁם

And he buys some land in Shechem from a guy named Shechem, and his brothers, who are the sons of a guy named Ass, and he buys it fair and square, for a hundred qesita.

²⁷² A well known holiday where you build a Sukkah and you hold a lemon and shake a branch or something, and we also get the day off work. That’s why I can’t come in to work today boss man. Cuz Sukkot. No no that’s not what I said don’t get mad. I said Sukkot. And there’s not just one big Sukkah, everyone makes their own Sukkah, so there’s a lot of them going up around this time of year boss man, you could almost say there’s a Sukkah born every minute. Anyways gotta run. I’ll see ya in a week.

We don't know how much a qesita is.

The Septuagint²⁷³ thinks it's sheep.

Just make a note of that for now, we'll learn more in the coming chapter.

Genesis 33:20

And he set up an altar there and
called it “El, God of Israel.”

אֵלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
וַיִּקְרָא בְּשֵׁם
יְהוָה וַיִּבְנֶה
מִזְבֵּחַ

So Jacob aka Israel sets up an altar, and calls it

El, oh El.²⁷⁴

Israel.

Right, on to Shechem.

²⁷³The Septuagint (LXX) is an ancient translation of the Hebrew Bible into Greek, begun several centuries before our oldest surviving complete Hebrew manuscripts, so its wording can sometimes preserve evidence for an older Hebrew text or interpretation.

²⁷⁴Lit. אֵלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל in the original.

Genesis 34

Genesis 34:1

And Dinah, Leah’s daughter,
whom she had borne to Jacob,
went out to see the daughters of
the land.

እፋረ ተዓ ጸሃጊላ ፋሾተሃ
ዓዋዐጊ ጸላረጊ ላሠፋ
ሾላፋጸ ተሃሃዓዓ ተሃፋላረ

Ok so Dinah, now in Shechem, goes out to see meet some local girls.

Genesis 34:2

And Shechem, son of Hamor, the
Hivite, the chieftain of the land,
saw her. And he took her and lay
with her and degraded her.

ሃዓ ሣሃሠ ጸተፋ ፋላጊሃ
ፋጊሠሃ ጊሃዘጸ ላሃሣዘ
ጸተፋ ዘዋጊሃ ሾላፋጸ
ጸሃዐጊሃ ጸተፋ ዓሃሠጊሃ

And Shechem, son of Ass, the guy who runs the land of Shechem, sees
her.

And Shechem, now in Dinah, comes to know her better.

Lots of translations call this section “the rape of Dinah.”

Now the text never says rape. It just says degraded.²⁷⁵

Let’s go learn more about this so-called rape.

Genesis 34:3

And his soul clung to Dinah,
Jacob’s daughter, and he loved the
girl and spoke on the girl’s heart.

ተዓ ጸሃጊላዓ ሃሠገሃ ዋዓላተሃ
ላዐሃጸ ተፋ ዓጸፋጊሃ ዓዋዐጊ
ላዐሃጸ ዓረ ረዐ ላዓላጊሃ

Ok so his soul clings to Dinah, who is Jacob’s daughter by the way.

And he loves her and talks to her chest.²⁷⁶

²⁷⁵The wording does not necessarily imply rape. “Take” (לקח), “lie with” (שכב), and “degrade” (ענה) can all describe sexual relations without force (cf. Deut 22:13, 23–24). Biblical accounts that unambiguously describe rape add language of physically seizing the woman (Deut 22:25; 2 Sam 13:11–14), which is absent here.

²⁷⁶The meaning of the expression here likely means “spoke tenderly to.”

Genesis 34:4

And Shechem said to Hamor, his father, “Get me this girl for a wife.”	ᐱሃግዘ ረፋ ግጎሠ ᐱግፋጊሃ ተፋ ጊረ ዘዋ ᐱግፋረ ሃጊፋፋ ጓሠፋረ ተፋጊጓ ጓላረጊጓ
---	--

So Shechem, now in Shechem, goes to Ass his dad to get him Dinah.
For he was hungry for her.

Genesis 34:5

And Jacob heard that he had defiled Dinah, his daughter; and his sons were with his cattle in the field, and Jacob kept quiet until they came.	ፋግ፬ ጊጎ ዐግሠ ፋዋዐጊሃ ሃጊጎፋሃ ሃተፋ ጓጎጊላ ተፋ ጓላሠፋ ሃጓጎዋግ ተፋ ሃጊጓ ግፋፋ ላዐ ፋዋዐጊ ሠላዘጓሃ
--	---

And Jacob heard.
She’s his daughter by the way.
The boys are out with the cows.
Jacob does nothing until they come.

Genesis 34:6

And Hamor, Shechem’s father, went out to Jacob to speak with him.	ግጎሠ ጊፋፋ ᐱሃግዘ ፋሾጊሃ ሃተፋ ᐱፋላረ ፋዋዐጊ ረፋ
---	---------------------------------------

Shechem’s dad decides it’s time for a Dad to Dad talk.²⁷⁷

Genesis 34:7

And Jacob’s sons came from the field when they heard, and the men were pained, and they were very furious, for he had done a foolhardy thing among Israel, to lie with Jacob’s daughter, and such a thing is not done.	ሃፋፋ ፋዋዐጊ ጊጎፋሃ ግዐግሠጎ ጓላሠጓ ጎግ ግጊሠጎፋጓ ሃፋሾዐተጊሃ ጓረፋጎጊጎ ላፋግ ግጓረ ᐱዘጊሃ ተፋ ፋጎሠረ ረፋላሠጊፋ ጓሠዐ ጓሠዐጊ ፋረ ጎጎሃ ፋዋዐጊ ተፋ
--	--

Jacob’s sons hear about their sister getting degraded by this son of an Ass in Shechem here in Shechem and they’re pissed.

²⁷⁷Lit. Ass to Heel in the original.

This is a foolhardy thing in Israel, such a thing is not done.

Genesis 34:8

And Hamor spoke with them,
saying, “Shechem—my son—his
soul longs for your daughter. Give
her to him as a wife,

ሃተቶ ላላግዘ ላዓላጊሃ
ጸዋወዘ ጊንዓ ግጉሠ ላግቶረ
ቶን ሃንተ ግጉተዓዓ ሃሠገን
ጸሠቶረ ሃረ ጸተቶ

So Ass says to them:

“Shoulder,²⁷⁸ my son, his šoul derives great pleasure from this Dinah
you’ve made.

He’s long^{ing} for your daughter’sole.

Should erstwhile times’ customs allow us to not assent, and to tear these
two lovebirds love assunder ere we assess the situation, assuredly should
we do so, in thus doing we should err.”

He’s a foreigner.

He talks a bit weird.

Give him a break.

Genesis 34:9

and marry with us; give your
daughters to us and take our
daughters to you,

ሃንተቶ ሃንተዘተጸሃ
ተቶሃ ሃንረ ሃንተተ ግጉጊተንዓ
ግጉረ ሃዘዋተ ሃንጊተንዓ

He proposes the two clans assemble into a larger association.

Genesis 34:10

and live with us; and the land will
be before you: live and go around
in it and take possession in it.”

ሃላቶጸሃ ሃዓሠተ ሃንተቶሃ
ሃዓሠ ግጉጊንገረ ጸጊጸተ
ጸዓ ሃጊዘቶጸሃ ጸሃላዘቸሃ

And we can live together and assist each other sharing the land as our
collective possession.

²⁷⁸Shechem means Shoulder.

Genesis 34:11

And Shechem said to her father and to her brothers, “Let me find favor in your eyes, and I’ll give whatever you say to me.

ఇతఁడు లఁక వ్రావ నొకఁడయి
కొఁవక ఇతఁడు లఁక
నొకఁడు వ్రావఁడని యి
యతఁడు లఁక నొకఁడు

Shoulder says he’ll assent to anything they ask²⁷⁹ for.

Genesis 34:12

Make a bride-price and gift on me very great, and let me give whatever you say to me, and give me the girl as a wife.”

నాకొక పెండ్లిదానము నొక
నొకఁడు ఇయ్యఁకయి యొక
లఁక నొకఁడు లఁక నొకఁడు
ఇయ్యఁక నొకఁడు

Shoulder is head-over heels for Heel’s daughter.

He’ll do anything for her.

Not bad for a rapist.

Genesis 34:13

And Jacob’s sons answered Shechem and Hamor, his father, with deception as they spoke because he had defiled Dinah, their sister.

తఁడు నొకఁడు లఁక నొకఁడు
నొకఁడు నొకఁడు తఁడు వ్రావ
నొకఁడు నొకఁడు ఇయ్యఁక
వ్రావఁడు ఇయ్యఁక తఁడు

So the good guys decide to lie.

After all, that dirty son of an Ass defiled our sister.

Genesis 34:14

And they said to them, “We aren’t able to do this thing, to give our sister to a man who has a foreskin, because that’s a disgrace to us.

కల వ్రావఁడు నొకఁడు
ఇయ్యఁక నొకఁడు నొకఁడు
వ్రావఁడు నొకఁడు తఁడు
ఇయ్యఁక నొకఁడు నొకఁడు
నొకఁడు

So they’re like “We’d love to, but your dicks are all wrong.”

²⁷⁹Lit. as𑌕 in the original, either (a) a rare scribal use of the Telugu abugida: *ka* (𑌕) followed by the virama or *pollu* (𑌖), which suppresses the syllable’s built-in vowel, thus acting as a kind of “backspace” character, or (b) perhaps the result of an ancient scribe’s wife bumping his arm, with the resulting error preserved into the modern era due to the extraordinarily high value the scribal tradition places on the art of accurate copying.

Genesis 34:15

Only this way will we consent to you: if you'll be like us, every male among you to be circumcised.

ማጎረ ተሳቶን ተፋገሏ ጎፋ
ረማጃረ ሃንማጎ ሃጊጃተ ማፋ
ሳጎገ ረጎ ማጎረ

Cut part of your parts off and we have a deal.

Just the tip.

All of you.

Genesis 34:16

And we'll give our daughters to you and take your daughters to us, and we'll live with you, and we'll become one people.

ማጎረ ሃንጊተንና ተፋ ሃንተንሃ
ሃንረ ዘዋን ማጎጊተንና ተፋሃ
ሃንጊጊጃሃ ማጎተፋ ሃንጋሠጊሃ
ላዘፋ ማዐረ

Then we'll be good.

Genesis 34:17

And if you won't listen to us, to be circumcised, then we'll take our daughter and go."

ሃንጊረፋ ሃዐማሠተ ፋረ ማፋሃ
ተፋ ሃንዘዋረሃ ረሃማጃረ
ሃንጎረጃሃ ሃንተጋ

If not, we're taking what's left of our Dinah and going home.

Genesis 34:18

And their words were good in Hamor's eyes and in Hamor's son Shechem's eyes.

ማጃጊሳሳ ሃጋፀጊጊሃ
ጊንጊዐሳሃ ሳሃማዘ ጊንጊዐሳ
ሳሃማዘ ነጋ ማጎሠ

Their words were good in Ass's eyes and Shoulder's eyes.

Genesis 34:19

And the boy did not delay to do the thing, for he desired Jacob's daughter. And he was more respected than all his father's house.

ተሃሠዐረ ሳዐንጃ ሳዘፋ ፋረሃ
ተጋጋ ሾገዘ ጊጎ ሳሳላጃ
ረጎማ ላሳጎን ፋሃጃሃ ጋዋዐጊ
ሃጊጋፋ ተጊጋ

The boy runs home and cuts it off immediately.

Everyone’s impressed.

Genesis 34:20

And Hamor and his son Shechem came to the gate of their city and spoke to the people of their city, saying,

ሃሃዓ ሃጽሠሃ ላሃጽዘ ቶዓጊሃ
ሃላዓላጊሃ ሃላጊዐ ላዐሠ ረቶ
ላግቶረ ሃላጊዐ ጊሠሃቶ ረቶ

Ass and Shoulder come to the gates of Shoulder and say,

Genesis 34:21

“These people are peaceable with us, and they’ll live in the land and go around in it, and the land, here, has enough breadth for them. Let’s take their daughters for us as wives and give our daughters to them.

ሃጊሃረሠ ጓረቶጓ ሃጊሠሃቶጓ
ሃዓሠጊሃ ሃሃተቶ ሃጓ
ጓተቶ ሃላዘቹጊሃ ሦላቶዓ
ተዓዘላ ጓሃጓ ሦላቶጓሃ
ሃተሃዓ ተቶ ሃጓጊሃገረ ሃጊላጊ
ተቶሃ ሃጊሠሃረ ሃሃረ ዘዐሃ
ሃጓረ ሃተሃ ሃሃጊተሃዓ

We’re doing a merger folks. Ass and Heel have come together.
Don’t worry, we’ve got enough breadth to accomodate them in here.
Let’s start swapping girls.
Tit for tat.

Genesis 34:22

Only in this way will these people consent to us to live with us, to be one people: if every male among us is circumcised as they are circumcised.

ሃሃረ ሃተቶጊ ተቶጊዓ ሃቶ
ሃሃተቶ ተዓሠረ ሃጊሠሃቶጓ
ላዘቶ ሃዐረ ተሃጊጓረ
ላሃጊ ረሃ ሃሃረ ረሃግጓዓ
ሃጊረግሃ ሃጓ ላሠቶሃ

However there is one condition.
Sort of a fine print thing.
No more regular dicks, everyone’s getting a makeunder.

Genesis 34:23

Their cattle and possessions and all their animals: won't they be ours? Only let's consent to them, and they'll live with us."

ለእነ ማንኛንዎሃ ማንኛን
ማን ሃገረ ፋሃረኛ ማተማል
ሃዳሠኚሃ ማንረ ጓተሃፋነ ጎፋ
ሃጎተፋ

Hey hey calm down everyone, we're getting their animals aren't we?

Let's just get it over with and then we'll have these nice people living with us shoulder to shoulder.

Genesis 34:24

And everyone who went out of the gate of his city listened to Hamor and to his son Shechem; and every male, everyone who went out of the gate of his city, was circumcised.

ረፋሃ ላሃማይ ረፋ ሃዐማሠኚሃ
ላዐሠ ገፋሾጊ ረእ ሃነዳ ማጎሠ
ረእ ላጎጊ ረእ ሃረማኚሃ ሃላጊዐ
ሃላጊዐ ላዐሠ ገፋሾጊ

Everyone does it.

Genesis 34:25

And it was on the third day, when they were hurting, and two of Jacob's sons, Simeon and Levi, Dinah's brothers, each took his sword, and they came upon the city stealthily, and they killed every male.

ጊሠጊረሠኛ ማሃጊዳ ጊጓጊሃ
ሃይዋጊሃ ማጊዳፋጎ ማተሃጊጓል
ሃሃዐማሠ ያዋዐጊ ጊነዳ ጊነሠ
ሠጊፋ ጓነጊላ ጊይፋ ጊሃረሃ
ላጊዐጓ ረዐ ሃፋዳጊሃ ሃዳላይ
ላጎጊ ረእ ሃጎላጓጊሃ ይፀዳ

On the third day, when everyone in town is bent over in pain, two of the good guy's sons, Simeon and Levi, who are Dinah's brothers by the way, take their swords and kill all the nice men of Shechem.

Genesis 34:26

And they killed Hamor and his son Shechem by the sword and took Dinah from Shechem's house and went out.

ማጎሠ ተፋሃ ላሃማይ ተፋሃ
ዳላይ ጊገረ ሃጎላጓ ሃነዳ
ተጊዳማ ጓነጊላ ተፋ ሃይዋጊሃ
ሃፋሾጊሃ ማጎሠ

They kill the nice rapist and the nice Ass and take out Dinah.

Genesis 34:27

Jacob’s sons had come upon the corpses and despoiled the city because they had defiled their sister.

ረዕ ሃፋፅ ልዋዕጊ ጊሃፅ
 ላጊዐፅ ሃጊፅጊሃ ሃጊጊጊፅፅ
 ሃተሃፅፋ ሃፋፃፅ ላሠፋ

They come on the corpses and despoil the city because their sister hadn’t been treated properly by that guy who wanted to marry her so bad that he cut part of his dick off. Such a thing is not done.

Genesis 34:28

They took their sheep and their oxen and their asses and what was in the city and what was in the field.

ሃፃዋፅ ተፋሃ ሃሃፋሾ ተፋ
 ተፋሃ ሃፅጊፃፃፃፃ ተፋሃ
 ላሠፋ ተፋሃ ላጊዐፅ ላሠፋ
 ሃፅዋጊ ፅፋሠፅ

Then they take Ass’s asses and so on.

Genesis 34:29

And they captured and despoiled all their wealth and all their infants and their wives and everything that was in the house.

ረሃ ተፋሃ ሃጊጊፅ ረሃ ተፋሃ
 ሃፅሠ ሃፅጊሠሃ ተፋሃ ሃጊፅፅ
 ላሠፋ ረሃ ተፋሃ ሃጊፅጊሃ
 ተጊፅፅ

And they steal all the babies and girls and stuff.

Genesis 34:30

And Jacob said to Simeon and to Levi, “You’ve caused me anguish, making me odious to those who live in the land, to the Canaanite and to the Perizzite, and I’m few in number, and they’ll be gathered against me and strike me, and I’ll be destroyed, I and my house.”

ልዋዕጊ ላሃፋጊሃ
 ረፋሃ ሃሃዐሃሠ ረፋ
 ጊተፋ ሃተፃሃዐ ጊሃጊ
 ሾፃፋፅ ልሠጊፅ ጊሃሠጊፋፅፅፅ
 ጊሃፋሃ ጊጊፃጊፅሃ ጊሃዐሃሃፅ
 ጊጊዐ ሃጊቹፋሃሃ ላጊቹሃ ጊተሃ
 ጊሃፋ ጊተፃሃሠሃ ጊሃሃሃፅሃ
 ጊተጊፅሃ

Then Jacob’s like “What the fuck boys? Now everyone hates me.”

“There’s only like twelve of us plus my four wives and some leftover Dinah.”

Genesis 34:31

And they said, “Shall he treat our
sister like a prostitute?”

እወደ እንሰጥላን ሃላግላን
ሃንተሃይቶ ተቶ

And the brothers respond,
“Shall he treat our sister like a whore?”
End of chapter!²⁸⁰

²⁸⁰We aren’t told how Jacob deals with this yet. Stick around until Genesis 49 for the answer.

Genesis 35

Genesis 35:1

And God said to Jacob, “Get up. Go up to Beth-El and live there and make an altar there to God, who appeared to you when you were fleeing from Esau, your brother.”

ለኔ ሕገኝለኔ ሰሣቶኝ
አገጽ ለዐ ሕዋ ገዋዐጊ
እሠዐኝ ሕሠ ገሠኝ ለኔ
እቶሃኝ ለኔ ልገጋሕ ሕሠ
ከሠዐ ጊሃሃሕ ሕልገገገ ሕገለኔ
ሕገልኔ

So naturally God says to Jacob “Get up.”
He tells him to go to Beth-El and live there and make an altar.
Now remember, he just built a house in Sukkot before his children murdered everyone in shoulder.²⁸¹

Genesis 35:2

And Jacob said to his house and to everyone who was with him, “Put away the foreign gods that are among you and be purified and change your clothes;

ከአገጽ ለኔ ገዋዐጊ ሰሣቶኝ
ከገፆኝ ከሕዐ ሰሠኔ ለሕ ለኔ
ሰሠኔ ሰሕኝኝ ገኝለኔ አኔ
ልኝኝ ከገፆኝኝ ሕሕሕአጽ
ሕሕገአለሕሠ ከገገለ

So Jacob goes to all the wives and kids and says “Guys, put away all the foreign gods and shower and change clothes.”
Apparently there’s a bunch of foreign gods floating around.

Genesis 35:3

and let’s get up and go up to Beth-El, and I’ll make an altar there to God, who answered me in a day of my trouble, and He was with me in the way that I went.”

ለኔ አገጽ ለዐሃኝኝ ሕሕዋሃኝኝ
ለኔ ልገጋሕ ሕሠ እሠዐቶኝ
ገአሰሐ ሕከገገ ገአኔ ሕሐዐኝ
ሰሠኔ ሕገሐገ ገሐሕዐ ገኝገኝ
ገአሕለኝ

We’re moving to Beth-El.
I’ve been relocated by God.
He wants us to move to his house.
I owe him one.

²⁸¹Just the guys. They stole the girls and babies.

Genesis 35:4

And they gave all the foreign gods that were in their hand and the rings that were in their ears to Jacob, and Jacob stashed them under the oak that was by Shechem.

xx ḡṑoṛ ḥḥ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḥḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡṑoṛ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡ

They give all the foreign gods and earrings to Jacob.

He hides them under that tree in Shechem.²⁸²

You know the one.

Genesis 35:5

And they traveled, and God’s terror was on the cities that were around them, and they did not pursue the children of Jacob.

ḥḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡoṑḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡoḡḡ ḥo ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡṑoṛ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ

So they walk down to Beth-El, and God terrorizes everyone along the way, and they don’t chase after team Jacob because they’re too busy with the terror.

Genesis 35:6

And Jacob came to Luz, which is in the land of Canaan—it is Beth-El—he and all the people who were with him.

ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡṑoṛ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡoḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḥḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḥḡ
ḡḡḡ

So Jacob gets to Luz—which is Beth-El by the way—and all the people who were with him get there too.

Genesis 35:7

And he built an altar there and called the place El of Beth-El because God was revealed to him there when he was fleeing from his brother.

ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡ ḥḡ ḡḡḡ ḥḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡḡḡ

And he built an altar there and called the place “El of Beth-El” aka “God

²⁸²No one will find them there. The town is all dead.

of House God” because God showed up back in that scene with the rock pillow after he lied to dad and stole from brother by dressing up like a goat.

More people should read this book.

It’s so good.

Genesis 35:8

And Deborah, Rebekah’s nurse,
died and was buried beneath
Beth-El, beneath an oak, and he
called its name Oak of Weeping.

אֶת־דִּבְרָה נָשִׁיתָא רֵבֶקָה אֶת־אֲמָתָהּ
וַתָּמָת וַתִּקְבֹּר אֹתָהּ תַּחַת
בֵּית־אֵל תַּחַת אֲזֵיכָה וַיִּקְרָא
שְׁמָהּ אֲזֵיכָה וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָהּ אֲזֵיכָה

The text then casually notes that they pass the burial spot of a woman named Deborah, who we haven’t heard about yet, but who just so happens to have the same name as this lady who’s sort of the founder of the country (see Judges 4-5 later) but this isn’t her, this is a different Deborah.

She’s buried under the tree at Beth-El.

You know the one.

He’s like “That’s the Tree of Sadness.”

Genesis 35:9

And God appeared to Jacob
again when he was coming from
Paddan Aram, and He blessed
him.

וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶל יַעֲקֹב
עוֹד בָּבֹאוֹ מִפַּדָּן אֲרָם
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתוֹ:

Ok so in the previous sentence we heard that Jacob drove all his cows and all his stuff that he got in Paddan Aram, over to Isaac, his father, in Canaan.

So now God shows up again when he’s coming from Paddan Aram.

And he blessed him.

Genesis 35:10

And God said to him, “Your name is Jacob. Your name will not be called Jacob anymore, but rather Israel will be your name.” And He called his name Israel.

וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ אֱלֹהִים
שְׁמֶךָ יַעֲקֹב לֹא יִקְרָא
שְׁמֶךָ עוֹד יַעֲקֹב כִּי
אִם יִשְׂרָאֵל יִהְיֶה שְׁמֶךָ
וַיִּקְרָא אֶת שְׁמוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל׃

And God says “Your name isn’t Jacob anymore. It’s Israel now.”

God may or may not have read Genesis 32.

We don’t know what God knows.

Maybe he’s just reiterating here because he noticed that everyone’s still calling the guy Jacob, including the narrator of the bible, who’s apparently not God.

Genesis 35:11

And God said to him, “I am El Shaddai Be fruitful and multiply. A nation and a community of nations will be from you, and kings will come out from your hips.

וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ אֱלֹהִים אֲנִי
אֵל שַׁדַּי פְּרֹה וּרְבֵה
גוֹי וְקָהָל גּוֹיִם יִהְיֶה
מִמֶּךָ וּמִלְכִּים מִחֲלָצֶיךָ
יֵצְאוּ׃

Then God’s like “I’m El Shaddai. Have some kids. A nation and a com—community of nations is com— coming out of you Jake, there’s kin—kings in you Jake, there’s kings in your kids, kings are com— coming out of your hips Jake I’m telling ya it’s gonna be great.”

Genesis 35:12

And the land that I gave to Abraham and to Isaac: I’ll give it to you, and I’ll give the land to your seed after you.”

וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי
לְאַבְרָהָם וּלְיִצְחָק לְךָ
אֶתְנַנֶּה וּלְזֶרְעֶךָ אֶחָרִיךָ
אֶתֵּן אֶת הָאָרֶץ׃

And your family’s land? That’s yours now. I’m giving it all to you Jake, your family’s inheritance, that’s your inheritance now Jake. Thanks to me. And I’ll give that inheritance to your com— the ones who come after you Jake.

Genesis 35:13

And God went up from on him
in the place where He had
spoken with him.

וַיַּעַל מֵעָלָיו אֱלֹהִים
בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֹתוֹ:

God leaves.

Genesis 35:14

And Jacob set up a pillar in the
place where He had spoken
with him, a stone pillar, and he
poured a libation on it and
spilled oil on it.

וַיַּצֵּב יַעֲקֹב מִצְבָּה
בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֹתוֹ
מִצְבֹּת אֲבָן וַיִּסֹּךְ עָלֶיהָ
נֶסֶךְ וַיִּצַק עָלֶיהָ שֶׁמֶן:

Jacob sets up a sort of pillor shaped rock and pours some fancy liquid on
it and also spills SMN on it.

Genesis 35:15

And Jacob called the name of
the place where God had
spoken to him there Beth-El.

וַיִּקְרָא יַעֲקֹב אֶת שֵׁם
הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֹתוֹ
שֵׁם אֱלֹהִים בֵּית אֵל:

Jacob names the place Beth-El **again**.

Don't worry about verses 1, 3, 6, or 7.

Especially 7.

Place is named Beth-El now.

Real important things have to be named twice, to make sure it works.

Genesis 35:16

And they traveled from Beth-El.
And there was still the span of
the land to come to Ephrat. And
Rachel gave birth. And she had
difficulty in her labor.

וַיֵּסְעוּ מִבֵּית אֵל
וְעַד הַיָּמָּה לָבוֹא עַד עֶפְרַת
וַיֵּלֶד רָחֵל בֶּן־כָּלֶב וַיִּכְרָט
וַיִּכְרָט וַיִּכְרָט וַיִּכְרָט
וַיִּכְרָט וַיִּכְרָט וַיִּכְרָט
וַיִּכְרָט וַיִּכְרָט וַיִּכְרָט

Ok so they leave Beth-El and set out on the journey.

The journey isn't over yet.

There's still a rough bit left at the end, on the road to Fertility.

So Rachel gives birth.

It's rough.

Genesis 35:17

And it was when she was having difficulty in her labor, and the midwife said to her, “Don’t be afraid, because this, too, is a son for you.”

ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ

While she's in pain, the midwife goes “Don’t be afraid! It’s a boy!”

This is the last stretch on the road to Fertility.

Genesis 35:18

And it was as her soul was going out—because she died—and she called his name Ben-oni. And his father called him Benjamin.

ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

And just as her soul was leaving her body—she dies by the way—she named the boy Ben-oni.²⁸³

We don’t know what Ben-oni means.²⁸⁴

But for some reason Jacob’s not happy with that name.

So he renames the kid Benjamin.

Because the love of his life was gone now.

And all he has left now is his right hand.^{285 286}

²⁸³Lit. Ben-鬼 in some manuscripts. Some pseudepigrapha have Benono, or in one infamous manuscript, 辰nono. Inline Recursive Footnote: The character 辰 is composed of two Chinese radicals: 尸, meaning “body” or “corpse,” and 宀, meaning “hole” under the 尸. These two radicals combine to form 辰, a character whose meaning is rather deep, and of which a more penetrating analysis is not possible in the current footnote.

²⁸⁴Ben-oni means “son of my sorrow,” fitting Rachel’s death in childbirth; but 𐤁𐤏𐤍 can also mean “strength” or “virility” (cf. Gen. 49:3), giving the name a possible double meaning: “son of my sorrow” and “son of my strength.”

²⁸⁵Benjamin means “son of the right hand.”

²⁸⁶And three other wives.

And Jacob had twelve sons.

Genesis 35:23

The sons of Leah were Jacob's firstborn, Reuben, and Simeon and Levi and Judah and Issachar and Zebulun.

בְּנֵי לֵאָה בְּכוֹר יַעֲקֹב
רְאוּבֵן וְשִׁמְעוֹן וְלֵוִי
וַיהוּדָה וִישָׁשׁכָר
וְזִבְלוֹן׃

Ok so five sentences ago, God showed up and called himself El Shaddai and told Jacob to get busy and have some kids.

So here in this line Jacob has some kids.

His sons are Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, and Zebulun.

Now those ones are just Leah's.

He has more, we're not done.

Genesis 35:24

The sons of Rachel were Joseph and Benjamin.

בְּנֵי רָחֵל יוֹסֵף וּבִנְיָמִן׃

Rachel has Joseph and Benjamin.

Genesis 35:25

And the sons of Bilhah, Rachel's maid, were Dan and Naphtali.

וּבְנֵי בִלְהָה שִׁפְחַת
רָחֵל דָּן וְנַפְתָּלִי׃

Bilhah who Reuben had sex with with three sentences ago has Dan and Naphtali.

Genesis 35:26

And the sons of Zilpah, Leah's maid, were Gad and Asher. These were Jacob's sons, who were born to him in Paddan Aram.

וּבְנֵי זִלְפָּה שִׁפְחַת לֵאָה
גָּד וָאָשֶׁר אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי
יַעֲקֹב אֲשֶׁר יָלַד לוֹ
בְּפַדַּן אֲרָם׃

Zilpah has Gad and Asher.

These were Jacob’s sons.
He had them in Paddan Aram.

Genesis 35:27

And Jacob came to Isaac, his father, at Mamre, at Kiriath Arba—it is Hebron—where Abraham and Isaac had resided.

וַיָּבֹא יַעֲקֹב אֶל יִצְחָק אָבִיו מִמַּרְא קְרִיַת הָאֲרָבֶע הוּא חֶבְרוֹן אֲשֶׁר גֵּר שָׁם אֲבִרָהֶם וַיִּצְחָק׃

And Jacob comes to Isaac, that’s his dad, at Mamre, at Kiriath Arba—that’s Hebron by the way—where Abe and Isaac had lived.

Genesis 35:28

And Isaac’s days were a hundred years and eighty years,

וַיְהִי יָמָיו יִצְחָק מֵאָת שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה׃

And Isaac’s days are 100 years + 80 years.

Genesis 35:29

and Isaac expired. And he died and was gathered to his people, old and full of days. And Esau and Jacob, his sons, buried him.

וַיָּגוּעַ יִצְחָק וַיָּמָת וַיֵּאָסֶף אֶל עַמּוּי זָקֵן וּשְׁבַע יָמִים וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ עֵשָׂו וַיַּעֲקֹב בָּנָיו׃

And Isaac expires.
And he dies.
And he’s gathered to his people.
He was old and full of days.
Esau and Jacob bury him together.
End of chapter.

Genesis 36

Genesis 36:1

And these are the records of Esau:
He is Edom.

וְאֵלֶּה תַּלְדוֹת עֵשָׂו הוּא
אֶדוֹם:

Here’s Esau’s begat list.
He’s Red.²⁸⁸

Genesis 36:2

Esau had taken his wives from
the daughters of Canaan:
Adah, daughter of Elon, the
Hittite, and Aholibamah,
daughter of Anah, daughter of
Zibeon, the Hivite,

עֵשָׂו לָקַח אֶת נָשָׁיו
מִבָּנוֹת כְּנָעַן אֶת עָדָה
בִּת אֵילֹן הַחִתִּי וְאֶת
אֲהֻלִּיבָמָה בִּת עֲנָה בִּת
צִבְעוֹן הַחִוִּי:

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Adah	עָדָה (‘Ādāh)	Usually “ornament/adornment,” from עדָה in an adornment-related sense. BDB also notes an Arabic comparison possibly suggesting “morning.”
Elon	אֵילֹן (Ēlôn)	“Terebinth/oak” or “oak-grove,” related to אֵיל/אֵלָה tree vocabulary.
Hittite	חִתִּי (Ḥittî)	No persuasive Hebrew lexical etymology. The Hittites were an ancient Anatolian people in the Bronze Age whose empire was centered in what is now modern Turkey.
Aholibamah	אֲהֻלִּיבָמָה (‘Āholîbāmāh)	“Tent of the high place”: אֹהֶל “tent” + בָּמָה “high place/elevation.”
Anah	עֲנָה (‘Ānāh)	Could be compared with עָנָה, “answer/respond,” but the proper-name derivation is not certain.
Zibeon	צִבְעוֹן (Ṣib’ôn)	Often connected with צָבַע, “color/dye,” hence “colored/variegated”.
Hivite	חִוִּי (Ḥiwwî)	No secure Hebrew etymology; proposals involving חוה or animal vocabulary are speculative.

Ok so Esau’s wives are:

- 1. Beauty, daughter of Oak Tree the Turkey.
- 2. My Tabernacle is Exalted, daughter of Defile daughter of Hyena the Tent Dweller of Wickedness.

²⁸⁸Lit. **מאז** in OT.

Genesis 36:3

and Basemath, daughter of
Ishmael, sister of Nebaioth.

וְאֵת בְּשֵׁמֶת בִּת
יִשְׁמָעֵאל אֲחוֹת נְבִיּוֹת׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Formal Hebrew etymology
Basemath	בְּשֵׁמֶת (<i>Bāsəmat</i>)	Related to בֶּשֶׂם, “balsam, spice, perfume”; thus “fragrance/perfume.”
Ishmael	יִשְׁמָעֵאל (<i>Yišmā ʿēl</i>)	From שמע “hear” + אל “El/God”: “El hears.”
Nebaioth	נְבִיּוֹת (<i>Nəḇāyôt</i>)	No secure Biblical Hebrew etymology. A connection with נוב “flourish/bear fruit” is possible but weak.

and Smells Good, daughter of God Hears, sister of High Looking Prophet.

Genesis 36:4

And Adah gave birth for Esau
to Eliphaz, and Basemath gave
birth to Reuel,

וַתֵּלֶד עָדָה לְעֵשָׂו אֶת
אֱלִיפַז וּבְשֵׁמֶת יִלְדָה
אֶת רְעוּאֵל׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Formal Hebrew etymology
Adah	עָדָה	“Adornment/ornament,” perhaps with an Arabian alternative.
Eliphaz	אֱלִיפַז (<i>Ēlîpaz</i>)	Usually parsed אל + פֶּז, approximately “El/God is fine gold.” BDB explicitly puts a question mark on this explanation.
Basemath	בְּשֵׁמֶת	“Fragrance/perfume.”
Reuel	רְעוּאֵל (<i>Rə ū ʿēl</i>)	Usually רע/רעה + אל, “friend/companion of El” or “El is a friend.”

And Beauty gave birth to Go{1,}d.

And Smells Good gave birth to Godfriend.

Genesis 36:5

and Aholibamah gave birth to
Jeush and Jalam and Korah.
These are Esau’s sons, who
were born to him in the land of
Canaan.

וַאֲהֻלִּיבָמָה יִלְדָה אֶת
[יְעוּשׁ] (יְעִישׁ) וְאֵת
יְעָלָם וְאֵת קֶרַח אֶלְהָה
בְּנֵי עֵשָׂו אֲשֶׁר יֻלְּדוּ לוֹ
בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן׃

Qere Ketiv.

Proper name	Hebrew	Formal Hebrew etymology
Aholibamah	אָהֳלִיבָמָה	“Tent of the high place.”
Jeush	יְעוּשׁ (<i>Yəʾūš</i>)	Possibly “He will gather” or “Assembler.”
Jalam	יָעָלָם (<i>Ya lām</i>)	Sometimes related to עלם, “hide,” yielding “hid-den,” but BDB’s comparative material points toward a wider semantic field involving young adulthood/strength.
Korah	קֹרַח (<i>Qōrah</i>)	Perhaps from קרח, “ice/frost.”

And My Tabernacle is Exalted gave birth to:

- 1. He’s Coming To Help
- 2. Hidden Youngman
- 3. Baldness

Genesis 36:6

And Esau took his wives and his sons and his daughters and all the persons of his household and his cattle and all of his animals and all of his possessions that he had acquired in the land of Canaan, and he went to a land, from the presence of Jacob, his brother,

וַיִּקַּח עֵשָׂו אֶת נָשָׁיו וְאֶת בָּנָיו וְאֶת בָּנוֹתָיו וְאֶת כָּל נַפְשׁוֹת בֵּיתוֹ וְאֶת מִקְנֵהוּ וְאֶת כָּל בְּהֶמְתּוֹ וְאֶת כָּל קִנְיָנוֹ אֲשֶׁר רָכַשׁ בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן וַיֵּלֶךְ אֶל אֶרֶץ מִפְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב אָחִיו׃

Esau went to a land.

Away from Jacob.

Genesis 36:7

because their property was too great for them to live together, and the land of their residences was not able to suffice them because of their cattle.

כִּי הָיָה רְכוּשָׁם רָב מִשָּׁבֶת יַחְדָּו וְלֹא יָכְלָה אֶרֶץ מְגוּרֵיהֶם לָשֵׂאת אֹתָם מִפְּנֵי מִקְנֵיהֶם׃

The town wasn’t big enough for the both of them.

Genesis 36:8

And Esau lived in Mount Seir.
Esau: he is Edom.

וַיֵּשֶׁב עֵשָׂו בְּהַר שֵׁעִיר
עֵשָׂו הוּא אֶדּוֹם:

And Esau lived on Mount Hair. Esau: he's Red.

Genesis 36:9

And these are the records of
Esau, father of Edom, in
Mount Seir.

וְאֵלֶּה תְּלֻדֹת עֵשָׂו אָבִי
אֶדּוֹם בְּהַר שֵׁעִיר:

These are the records of Esau, father of Red, on Mount Hair.

What?

Genesis 36:10

These are the names of Esau's
sons: Eliphaz, son of Adah,
Esau's wife; Reuel, son of
Basemath, Esau's wife.

אֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי עֵשָׂו
אֶלְיָפָז בֶּן עָדָה אִשְׁתּוֹ
עֵשָׂו רְעוּאֵל בֶּן בָּשֶׁמֶת
אִשְׁתּוֹ עֵשָׂו:

These are the names of Esau's sons:

- Go(1+1)d son of Beauty, Esau's wife.
- Godfriend son of Smells Good, Esau's wife.

Didn't we just do this?

Genesis 36:11

And Eliphaz's sons were
Teman, Omar, Zepho, and
Gatam and Kenaz.

וַיְהִיו בְּנֵי אֶלְיָפָז תִּימָן
אוֹמֶר צֶפּוֹ וְנֹעֲתָם וְקִנָּז:

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Eliphaz	אֱלִיפָז	Perhaps “El is fine gold.”
Temam	תִּמָּן (<i>Tēmān</i>)	Related to יָמִין, “right hand,” hence geographically “south” when facing east.
Omar	אֹמָר (<i>Ômār</i>)	Usually compared with אָמַר, “say/speak,” perhaps “speaker.”
Zepho	צִפּוֹ (<i>Ṣəpō</i>)	Perhaps from צָפָה, “look/watch,” hence “watcher/gazing.”
Gatam	גַּתָּם (<i>Ga ʾām</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation.
Kenaz	קִנָּז (<i>Qənaz</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation in BDB/NAS lexicography.

Go(l+1)d’s sons were:

- Southpaw
- He Says
- Watchman
- Puny / Exhausted / Burnt Valley, and
- Hunter.

Genesis 36:12

And Timna had been a concubine of Eliphaz, son of Esau, and she gave birth to Amalek for Eliphaz. These are the sons of Adah, Esau’s wife.

וְתִמְנָע הָיְתָה בְּיִלְפָז
לְאֵלִיפָז בֶּן עֵשָׂו וַתֵּלֶד
לְאֵלִיפָז אֶת עֲמָלֵק אֱלֹהֵי
בְּנֵי עֵדָה אִשְׁתּוֹ עֵשָׂו׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Timna	תִּמְנָע (<i>Timnā</i> ʿ)	Sometimes related to מָנַע, “withhold/restrain,” perhaps “restraint.”
Eliphaz	אֱלִיפָז	Perhaps “El is fine gold.”
Esau	עֵשָׂו	See v.1.
Amalek	עֲמָלֵק (ʿĀmālēq)	No convincing Hebrew derivation.
Adah	עֵדָה	“Adornment,” possibly another comparative explanation.

And Restraint was a concubine of Gold God, son of Esau.

And she gave birth to Trouble for Gold God.

These are the sons of Beauty, Esau’s wife.

Genesis 36:13

And these are the sons of Reuel: Nahath and Zerah, Shammah and Mizzeh. These were the sons of Basemath, Esau’s wife.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי רְעוּאֵל נַחַת
וְזֶרַח שָׁמָּה וּמִזֶּזֶה אֵלֶּה
הָיוּ בְּנֵי בַשְׁמַת אִשְׁתּוֹ
עֵשָׂו׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Reuel	רְעוּאֵל	“Friend/companion of El.”
Nahath	נַחַת (<i>Naḥat</i>)	Identical with/related to נַחַת, “rest, quiet, descent.”
Zerah	זֶרַח (<i>Zerah</i>)	From זָרַח, “rise/shine,” especially of the sun: “dawn/rising.”
Shammah	שָׁמָּה (<i>Šammāh</i>)	Could be associated with שָׁם “there/name” or שִׁמְשֵׁם-related forms, but no single derivation is secure for this name.
Mizzeh	מִזֶּזֶה (<i>Mizzāh</i>)	Possibly from a root meaning strong or firm.

Elfriend’s sons were:

- Rest
- Dawn
- Desolation, and
- Faints with Fear

These were the sons of Smells Good, Esau’s wife.

Genesis 36:14

And these were the sons of Aholibamah, daughter of Anah, daughter of Zibeon, Esau’s wife: and she gave birth for Esau to Jeush and Jalam and Korah.

וְאֵלֶּה הָיוּ בְּנֵי
אֲחֻלִּיבָמָה בַּת עֵנָה
בַּת צִבְעוֹן אִשְׁתּוֹ עֵשָׂו
וַתֵּלֶד לְעֵשָׂו אֶת [יְעוּשׁ]
(יַעִישׁ) וְאֶת יְעָלָם וְאֶת
קֹרַח׃

Qere Ketiv.

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Aholibamah	אֶהֱלִיבָמָה	“Tent of the high place.”
Anah	עָנָה	Perhaps related to “answer/respond”; comparative Arabian evidence cautions against certainty.
Zibeon	צִבְעוֹן	Perhaps “variegated/colored” or “hyena.”
Jeush	יְעוּשׁ	Perhaps “he comes to help.”
Jalam	יַעֲלָם	Hebrew “hidden” possible; comparative evidence favors a broader youth/strength semantic field.
Korah	קָרַח	Perhaps “baldness”; “ice/frost” is another lexical association.

My Tabernacle is Exalted, daughter of Defile daughter of Hyena, gave birth to He’s-Coming-To-Help, Hidden Youngman, and Baldness.

Genesis 36:15

These are the chiefs of the children of Esau: the sons of Eliphaz, Esau’s firstborn: chief Teman, chief Omar, chief Zepho, chief Kenaz,

אֵלֶּה אֱלֹפִי בְּנֵי עֵשָׂו
בְּנֵי אֶלְיָפַז בְּכוֹר עֵשָׂו
אֱלֹף תִּימָן אֱלֹף אוֹמֵר
אֱלֹף צֶפּוֹ אֱלֹף קִנָּז׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Esau	עֵשָׂו	See above.
Eliphaz	אֶלְיָפַז	Perhaps “El is fine gold.”
Teman	תִּימָן	“South/right-hand.”
Omar	אוֹמֵר	Perhaps “speaker.”
Zepho	צֶפּוֹ	Perhaps “watcher/gazing.”
Kenaz	קִנָּז	No secure Hebrew derivation.

These are the chiefs: Chief Southpaw, Chief Speaker, Chief Watcher, Chief Hunter.

Genesis 36:16

chief Korah, chief Gatam, chief Amalek. These are the chiefs of Eliphaz in the land of Edom. These are the sons of Adah.

אֱלֹף קָרַח אֱלֹף גַּתָּם
אֱלֹף עַמְלֵק אֵלֶּה
אֱלֹפִי אֶלְיָפַז בְּאֶרֶץ
אֶדוֹם אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי עָדָה׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Korah	קֹרַח	Perhaps “baldness.”
Gatam	גַּתָּם	No secure derivation.
Amalek	עֲמָלֶק	No secure derivation.
Eliphaz	אֱלִיפַז	Perhaps “El is fine gold.”
Edom	אֲדָוִם	“Red.”
Adah	עָדָה	“Adornment.”

Chief Baldness, Chief Fatigue, Chief Trouble. These are Go(l+1)d’s chiefs in Redland.

They’re also the sons of Beauty.

Genesis 36:17

And these are the sons of Reuel, son of Esau: chief Nahath, chief Zerah, chief Shammah, chief Mizzah. These are the chiefs of Reuel in the land of Edom. These are the sons of Basemath, Esau’s wife.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי רְעוּאֵל
בֶּן עֵשָׂו אֱלֹף נַחַת
אֱלֹף זֶרַח אֱלֹף שָׁמָה
אֱלֹף מִזָּה אֵלֶּה אֱלֹפֵי
רְעוּאֵל בְּאֶרֶץ אֲדָוִם
אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי בְשֶׁמֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ
עֵשָׂו׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Reuel	רְעוּאֵל	“Friend/companion of El.”
Esau	עֵשָׂו	See above.
Nahath	נַחַת	“Rest/quiet,” perhaps “settling/descent.”
Zerah	זֶרַח	“Rising/dawn.”
Shammah	שָׁמָה	Uncertain.
Mizzah	מִזָּה	No secure derivation.
Basemath	בְּשֶׁמֶת	“Fragrance.”

Godfriend’s chiefs: Chief Rest, Chief Sunrise, Chief Desolation, Chief Faints With Fear. These are Smells Good’s boys in Redland.

Genesis 36:18

And these are the sons of Aholibamah, Esau’s wife: chief Jeush, chief Jalam, chief Korah. These were the chiefs of Aholibamah, daughter of Anah, Esau’s wife.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי אֲהֹלִיבָמָה
אִשְׁתּוֹ עֵשָׂו אֱלֹף יְעוּשׁ
אֱלֹף יַעְלָם אֱלֹף קֹרַח
אֵלֶּה אֱלֹפֵי אֲהֹלִיבָמָה
בֵּת עֲנָה אִשְׁתּוֹ עֵשָׂו׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Aholibamah	אֶהֱלִיבָמָה	“Tent of the high place.”
Esau	עֵשָׂו	See above.
Jeush	יְעוּשׁ	Perhaps “he comes to help.”
Jalam	יַעֲלָם	Uncertain; Hebrew “hidden” competes with comparative youth/strength readings.
Korah	קָרַח	Perhaps “baldness.”
Anah	עֲנָה	Possibly “answer”; comparative southern parallels.

My Tabernacle is Exalted’s chiefs: Chief He’s-Coming-To-Help, Chief Hidden Youngman, Chief Baldness.

Genesis 36:19

These are the sons of Esau, and these are their chiefs. That is Edom.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי עֵשָׂו וְאֵלֶּה
אֱלֹפֵיהֶם הוּא אֶדוֹם:

Those are Esau’s sons, and those are their chiefs. That’s Red.

Genesis 36:20

These are the sons of Seir the Horite, who live in the land: Lotan and Shobal and Zibeon and Anah

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי שְׂעִיר הַחֹרִי
יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ לוֹטָן
וְשׁוּבָל וְצִבְעוֹן וְעֲנָה:

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Seir	שְׂעִיר	“Hairy/shaggy.”
Horite	חֹרִי (<i>Hōrî</i>)	Older explanations connect with חֹר, “hole/cave,” hence “cave-dweller,” but this is not secure.
Lotan	לוֹטָן (<i>Lôṭān</i>)	Possibly related to לוט, “cover/wrap.”
Shobal	שׁוּבָל (<i>Šôḇāl</i>)	Sometimes interpreted “flowing.”
Zibeon	צִבְעוֹן	“Variegated” or perhaps “hyena.”
Anah	עֲנָה	Perhaps “answer”; not secure.

These are the sons of Hairy the Horite: Wrapped-Up, Flowing, Hyena, and Defile.

Genesis 36:21

and Dishon and Ezer and Dishan. These are the chiefs of the Horites, the children of Seir, in the land of Edom.

וְדִשׁוֹן וְעֶזֶר וְדִישָׁן
אֵלֶּה אֱלֹפִי הַחֲרִי בְנֵי
שַׁעִיר בְּאֶרֶץ אֱדוֹם:

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Dishon	דִּישׁוֹן (<i>Dîšôn</i>)	Corresponds to a Hebrew animal term usually understood as an antelope/gazelle-type animal.
Ezer	עֶזֶר (<i>Ēšer</i>)	From אָצַר, “store up,” hence “treasure/store.”
Dishan	דִּישָׁן (<i>Dîšān</i>)	Likely variant/related form of Dishon.
Horites	חֲרִי	Ethnonym of uncertain derivation.

And Antelope, Treasure, and Antelope-Again. These are the chiefs of the Cavemen in Redland.

Genesis 36:22

And the children of Lotan are Hori and Hemam, and Lotan’s sister is Timna.

וַיְהִיו בְּנֵי לוֹטָן חֲרִי
וְהִימָם וַאֲחֹת לוֹטָן
תִּמְנָע:

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Lotan	לוֹטָן	Perhaps from לוֹט, “cover.”
Hori	חֲרִי (<i>Hōrî</i>)	Same form as the ethnonym “Horite”; exact etymology uncertain.
Hemam	הִימָם (<i>Hēmām</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation; Chronicles has the variant Homam.
Timna	תִּמְנָע	Perhaps withholding.”

Wrapped-Up’s children are Cavemen and Raging Destruction,²⁸⁹ and Wrapped-Up’s sister is Restraint.²⁹⁰

Genesis 36:23

And these are the children of Shobal: Alvan and Manahath and Ebal, Shepho and Onam.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי שׁוֹבָל עֲלֹון
וּמְנַחֵת וְעִיבָל שִׁפּוֹ
וְאוֹנָם:

²⁸⁹Chronicles has the variant Making an Uproar.
²⁹⁰Scholars have speculated that the latter was likely responsible for the immobility of the former.

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Shobal	שׁוּבַל	Perhaps “flowing.”
Alvan	עֲלָוֹן (‘ <i>Alwān</i>)	Older analysis connects with עלה, perhaps “lofty/high.”
Manahath	מִנְחַת (<i>Mānaḥat</i>)	Probably related to נוח/נחת, “rest, resting place.”
Ebal	עֵיבָל (‘ <i>Ēbāl</i>)	No secure derivation.
Shepho	שִׁפּוֹ (<i>Šāpō</i>)	Older lexicography gives approximately “bareness/bare.”
Onam	אוֹנָם (<i>Ōnām</i>)	Probably related to אוֹן, “strength/vigor,” hence “vigorous.”

Flowing’s children: Lofty, Rest Area, Bald (a different one), Naked, and Strong.

Genesis 36:24

And these are the children of Zibeon: Ajah and Anah—that is Anah who found the water in the wilderness when he tended the asses of Zibeon, his father.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי צִבְעוֹן וְאַיָּה
וְעֵנָה הִוא עֲנָה אֲשֶׁר
מָצְאָה אֶת הַיָּמִם בַּמִּדְבָּר
בִּרְעֻתָּהּ אֶת הַחֲמֹרִים
לְצִבְעוֹן אָבִיו׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Zibeon	צִבְעוֹן	Perhaps “variegated” or “hyena.”
Ajah / Aiah	אַיָּה (‘ <i>Ayyāh</i>)	“Falcon/kite,” identical with an attested bird-name.
Anah	עֲנָה	Perhaps related to “answer/respond”; uncertain.

Hyena’s children: Kite and Defile—the Defile who found the water while tending his father’s asses.²⁹¹

Genesis 36:25

And these are the children of Anah: Dishon and Aholibamah, daughter of Anah.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי עֲנָה דִּישׁוֹן
וְאַהֲלִיבָמָה בִּת עֲנָה׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Anah	עֲנָה	Perhaps “answer/respond”; uncertain.
Dishon	דִּישׁוֹן	Probably “antelope/gazelle” by lexical association.
Aholibamah	אַהֲלִיבָמָה	“Tent of the high place.”

²⁹¹ You know the one.

Defile’s children: Antelope and My Tabernacle is Exalted.

Genesis 36:26

And these are the children of Dishon: Hemdan and Eshban and Ithran and Cheran.

וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי דִישָׁן חֶמְדָּן
וְעֶשְׂבָן וִיתְרָן וְכֶרָן׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Dishon	דִישָׁן	“Antelope/gazelle.”
Hemdan	חֶמְדָּן (<i>Hemdān</i>)	From חמד, “desire/delight,” hence “pleasant/desirable.”
Eshban	עֶשְׂבָן (<i>Ešbān</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation.
Ithran	יִתְרָן (<i>Yitrān</i>)	From יתר, “excess/abundance.”
Cheran	כֶּרָן (<i>Kərān</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation. Possibly “lyre,” “harp,” or “stringed instrument”.

Antelope’s children: Delight, Wiseman, Too Much, and Banjo.

Genesis 36:27

These are the children of Ezer: Bilhan and Zaavan and Akan.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי עֶזֶר בִּלְהָן
זַעְוָן וְעֶקָן׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Ezer	עֶזֶר	“Treasure/store.”
Bilhan	בִּלְהָן (<i>Bilhān</i>)	BDB regards the derivation as uncertain; older proposals connect it with ideas such as timidity.
Zaavan	זַעְוָן (<i>Za’ăwān</i>)	Possibly from זעזע, “tremble, be agitated,” hence “trembling.”
Akan	עֶקָן (<i>Āqān</i>)	Perhaps connected with a root for twisting/crooking.

Treasure’s children: Worn Out, Shakey, and Twisty.

Genesis 36:28

These are the children of Dishan: Uz and Aran.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי דִישָׁן עוּז
וְאַרָן׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Dishan	דִישָׁן	Variant/relative of Dishon, probably linked to the antelope term.
Uz	עוּז (<i>Ūṣ</i>)	Sometimes related to עוץ, “counsel/consult.”
Aran	אַרָן (<i>Ārān</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation.

Antelope-Again’s children: Oots and Wild Goats.

Genesis 36:29

These are the chiefs of the Horites: chief Lotan, chief Shobal, chief Zibeon, chief Anah,

אֵלֶּה אֲלוּפֵי הַחֲרִי
אֵלֹף לֹטָן אֵלֹף שׁוֹבָל
אֵלֹף צִבְעוֹן אֵלֹף
עֲנָה׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Horites	חֲרִי	Ethnonym; “cave-dweller” is an old but uncertain explanation.
Lotan	לֹטָן	Perhaps “covered/wrapped.”
Shobal	שׁוֹבָל	Perhaps “flowing.”
Zibeon	צִבְעוֹן	Perhaps “variegated” or “hyena.”
Anah	עֲנָה	Perhaps “answer.”

These are the chief Cavemen: Chief Wrapped-Up, Chief Flowing, Chief Hyena, Chief Defile.

Are we gonna be here forever?

Genesis 36:30

chief Dishon, chief Ezer, chief Dishan. These are the chiefs of the Horites by their chiefdoms in the land of Seir.

אֵלֹף דִּישׁוֹן אֵלֹף עֶזֶר
אֵלֹף דִּישָׁן אֵלֶּה אֲלוּפֵי
הַחֲרִי לְאֶלְפֵיהֶם בְּאֶרֶץ
שֵׁעִיר׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Dishon	דִּישׁוֹן	Probably “antelope/gazelle.”
Ezer	עֶזֶר	“Treasure/store.”
Dishan	דִּישָׁן	Related/variant of Dishon.
Horites	חֲרִי	Uncertain ethnonym.
Seir	שֵׁעִיר	“Hairy/shaggy.”

Chief Antelope, Chief Treasure, Chief Antelope-Again. Those are the chiefs in Hairyland.

Genesis 36:31

And these are the kings who ruled in the land of Edom before a king ruled the children of Israel.

אֲשֶׁר מָלְכוּ בְּאֶדְוִם
לְפָנֵי מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל
לְפָנֵי מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Edom	אֶדְוִם	“Red.”
Israel	יִשְׂרָאֵל (<i>Yisrā’ēl</i>)	Genesis 32 explains it through שָׂרָה, “strive/contend,” + אֵל: roughly “you have striven with God”; morphologically the name may also be understood with El as subject, “El strives/rules.”

These are the kings who ruled Redland before Israel even had a king.²⁹²
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Genesis 36:32

And Bela son of Beor ruled in Edom, and the name of his city was Dinhabah.

וּבְלָע בֶּן-בְּעֹר מָלַךְ בְּאֶדְוִם
וּשְׁמֵן עִירוֹ דִּנְהַבָּה

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Bela	בְּלָע (<i>Bela</i> ‘)	Identical in consonants with בָּלַע, “swallow/devour”; thus “swallowing/devourer” is an obvious Hebrew association.
Beor	בְּעֹר (<i>Bə’ôr</i>)	Traditionally connected with בָּעַר, “burn,” yielding “burning” or “torch.”
Edom	אֶדְוִם	“Red.”
Dinhabah	דִּנְהַבָּה (<i>Dinhābāh</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation.

Devourer son of Burning ruled Redland, and his city was Robber’s Den.

²⁹²Already in the eleventh century AD, the scholar known as Yitzḥaqi—often identified with Isaac ibn Yashush (982–1056), though the identification is uncertain—argued that this list could not have been written by Moses. He dated the passage to the reign of Jehoshaphat, apparently identifying its Edomite kings with figures known from the later monarchy. We know his argument only because Abraham ibn Ezra quotes it here in order to attack it; Ibn Ezra rejects the proposal vehemently, declaring Yitzḥaqi’s book רָאוּי לְהַשְׂרִיף (*rā’ûy ləhissārēf*) worthy of being burned.

²⁹³Despite his pretense of rejection, Ibn Ezra himself went considerably further. He cryptically pointed to five verses: (1) “the mystery of the twelve” (perhaps the final twelve verses describing Moses’ death), (2) “And Moses wrote,” (3) “the Canaanite was then in the land,” (4) “on YHWH’s mountain it will be seen,” and (5) “Behold his bedstead was a bedstead of iron,” referring to Og’s iron bed still being displayed in Rabbah. Whoever understands these five things, he says, will “recognize the truth”; elsewhere, on the Canaanite problem, he adds: “there is a secret here, and the wise will keep silent” (יש לו (סוד והמשכיל ידום).

Genesis 36:33

And Bela died, and Jobab son of Zerah from Bozrah ruled in his place.

אֵלְעָזָר בֶּן־זֶרַח מִבּוֹזְרָה
וַיָּמָוֶת בֶּלָע וַיִּמְלֹךְ
יֹבָב בֶּן־זֶרַח מִבּוֹזְרָה

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Bela	בֶּלָע	“Swallow/devour” association.
Jobab	יֹבָב (<i>Yôḇāḇ</i>)	Traditionally connected with יָבַב, “cry/howl/wail,” hence approximately “howler.”
Zerah	זֶרַח	“Rising/dawn.”
Bozrah	בּוֹזְרָה (<i>Boṣrāh</i>)	From בָּצַר, “fortify/enclose”; “fortification/fortress.”

Devourer died, and Howler son of Sunrise from Fortress ruled instead.

Genesis 36:34

And Jobab died, and Husham of the land of Temani ruled in his place.

וַיָּמָוֶת יֹבָב וַיִּמְלֹךְ
חִשָּׁמַי בֶּן־חִישָׁי מִתֵּמָנִי
וַיָּמָוֶת חִשָּׁמַי וַיִּמְלֹךְ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Jobab	יֹבָב	Perhaps “howler/wailer.”
Husham	חִשָּׁם (<i>Huṣām</i>)	Usually connected with חָשַׁן, “hurry/hasten,” giving something like “hasty one.”
Temani / Te-man	תֵּימָנִי / תִּימָן	“Southern / south,” ultimately from “right-hand.”

Howler died, and Hurry-Up from Southland ruled instead.

Genesis 36:35

And Husham died, and Hadad son of Bedad, who struck Midian in the field of Moab, ruled in his place, and the name of his city was Avith.

וַיָּמָוֶת חִשָּׁמַי וַיִּמְלֹךְ
חֲדָד בֶּן־בְּדָד הַמִּדְיָנִי
וַיִּכּוּת מִדְיָן בְּשָׂדֵי מוֹאָב
וַיִּמְלֹךְ חֲדָד בֶּן־בְּדָד
וּשְׁמֵן עִירוֹ אֲוִיִּת

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Husham	חֲשָׁם	Perhaps “hasty one.”
Hadad	הַדָּד (<i>Hadad</i>)	No good Hebrew etymology should be forced. It is the name of the well-known West Semitic storm deity Hadad/Haddu, corresponding to Akkadian Adad.
Bedad	בְּדָד (<i>Bəḏad</i>)	Probably associated with בָּדַד, “apart/alone.”
Midian	מִדְיָן (<i>Midyān</i>)	Biblical Hebrew can associate it with strife/contention vocabulary, but historical ethnonym uncertain.
Moab	מוֹאָב (<i>Mô`āb</i>)	Genesis gives the folk-etymological wordplay “from father” (<i>mē-`āb</i>); historical origin remains uncertain.
Avith	עֻיִּית (‘ <i>Āwîṭ</i>)	Older analysis connects with עוּה, “bend/twist,” perhaps “ruin/twisted”; BDB is cautious.

Hurry-Up died, and Blacksmith son of Alone—the guy who beat Midian in Moab—ruled instead. His city was Ruined, maybe.

Genesis 36:36

And Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah ruled in his place.

דָּד מוֹתָא וְסַמְלָה בֶּן־אֶלֶן
רָאשָׁה מִמָּסְרֵקָה יָרַשׁ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Hadad	הַדָּד	West Semitic storm-deity name, not securely Hebrew-derived.
Samlah	שְׁמָלָה (<i>Šamlāh</i>)	Form resembles שְׁמָלָה/שְׁמָלָה, “garment/cloak.”
Masrekah	מִסְרֵקָה (<i>Maśrēqāh</i>)	Often connected with שׁוֹרֵק / שֶׁקַּי, “choice vine,” hence “vineyard/place of vines.” BDB itself is less certain about the underlying root.

Blacksmith died, and Shirt from Winery ruled instead.

Genesis 36:37

And Samlah died, and Saul of Rehoboth on the river ruled in his place.

סַמְלָה מוֹתָא וְשָׁאֹל בֶּן־רְחוֹבֹת
עַל־הַנָּהָר יָרַשׁ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Samlah	שְׁמָלָה	Perhaps “garment/cloak.”
Saul / Shaul	שָׁאוּל (<i>Šā`ûl</i>)	Qal passive participle of שָׁאַל, “ask/request”: “asked for/requested.”
Rehoboth	רְחוֹבוֹת (<i>Rəḥōḇôt</i>)	Plural of רָחַב, “broad place, plaza, street,” from רָחַב “be broad.”

Shirt died, and Shawl from Broadway filled his shoes.

Genesis 36:38

And Saul died, and Baal-hanan son of Achbor ruled in his place.

אֲשָׁלָה לְבָנָם וְאֲשָׁלָה
בֶּן אַחְבוֹר לָאֵל הָנָן
אֲחִיבֹר

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Saul / Shaul	אֲשָׁלָה	“Asked/requested.”
Baal-hanan	בַּעַל הָנָן (<i>Ba‘al Hānān</i>)	“Baal is gracious / Baal has shown favor,” from חָנַן + בַּעַל.
Achbor	אַחְבוֹר (<i>‘Aḵbôr</i>)	“Mouse.”

Asked-For died, and Baal’s Nice son of Mouse ruled instead.

Genesis 36:39

And Baal-hanan son of Achbor died, and Hadar ruled in his place, and the name of his city was Pau; and his wife’s name was Mehetabel daughter of Matred daughter of Mezahab.

בֶּן אַחְבוֹר לָאֵל הָנָן
וְאֲחִיבֹר לָאֵל הָנָן
וְהָאֵל הָנָן וְהָאֵל הָנָן
וְהָאֵל הָנָן וְהָאֵל הָנָן
וְהָאֵל הָנָן וְהָאֵל הָנָן
וְהָאֵל הָנָן וְהָאֵל הָנָן

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Baal-hanan	בַּעַל הָנָן	“Baal is gracious.”
Achbor	אַחְבוֹר	“Mouse.”
Hadar	הָדָר (<i>Hăḏar</i>)	If this is the correct text, compare הִדָּר, “splendor, majesty, honor.”
Pau	פָּעוּ (<i>Pā‘û</i>)	No secure Hebrew derivation. Chronicles also preserves a variant form, <i>Pai</i> .
Mehetabel	מְהִיטָבָאֵל (<i>Məhêṭab‘ēl</i>)	Approximately “El/God does good,” “God benefits,” or “whom El makes good.”
Matred	מַטְרֵד (<i>Maṭrēḏ</i>)	Often connected with טָרַד, “drive/drive away,” perhaps “driving/one who drives.”
Mezahab	מֵי זָהָב (<i>Mê Zāhāb</i>)	Read naturally as “waters of gold”: מֵי “waters of” + זָהָב “gold.”

Nice Baal’s son of Mouse died, and Splendor ruled instead. His wife was God-Makes-Me-Good, daughter of Thrusting Forward, daughter of Golden Showers.

Genesis 36:40

And these are the names of the chiefs of Esau by their families, by their places, by their names: chief Timnah, chief Alvah, chief Jetheth,

זרנלכ תעש אלכ
ותדנשנל עש
נלכ ותעש ותעשנל
נלכ אללם נלכ ענת
תת

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Esau	עֵשָׂו	See v.1.
Timnah	תִּמְנָע	Perhaps “restraint/withholding,” from מנע.
Alvah	עֲלָוָה (‘ <i>Alwāh</i>)	Older derivation associates it with עלה/height, perhaps “loftiness.” BDB essentially records it as an Edomite proper name rather than confidently translating it.
Jetheth	יְתֵת (<i>Yatēṭ</i>)	Derivation explicitly uncertain in the major lexica; older glosses such as “nail” are not secure.

These are Esau’s chiefs by family and place: Chief Restraint, Chief Loftiness, Chief Tent Peg.
I’ve died and gone to hell.

Genesis 36:41

chief Aholibamah, chief Elah, chief Pinon,

נלכ אלנשנללכ נלכ
נננ נלכ אלכ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Aholibamah	אֲהוֹלִיבָמָה	“Tent of the high place.”
Elah	עֵלָה (‘ <i>Ēlāh</i>)	“Terebinth” (a tree-name).
Pinon	פִּינֹן (<i>Pīnōn</i>)	BDB gives no secure etymology and compares Punon.

Chief My Tabernacle is Exalted, Chief Oak Tree, Chief Pine Nut.

Genesis 36:42

chief Kenaz, chief Teman, chief Mibzar,

נתת נלכ לנפ נלכ
עשנ נלכ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Kenaz	קִנְזִי	No secure Hebrew derivation.
Teman	תֵּימָן	“South/right-hand.”
Mibzar	מִבְצָר (<i>Mibṣār</i>)	Identical in form with מִבְצָר, “fortress, fortified place, stronghold,” from בצר.

Chief Hunter, Chief Right Hand, Chief Castle.

Genesis 36:43

chief Magdiel, chief Iram. These
are the chiefs of Edom by their
homes in the land of their
possession. That is Esau, father of
Edom.

7YŁŁ ŁŁZΛ1Y 7YŁŁ
 Z7YŁŁ 3ŁŁ YΛZ0
 YΛŁŁ Y+ΛWYŁ YYΛŁ
 ZŁŁ YW0 ŁY3 Y+LHŁ
 YYΛŁ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Magdiel	מַגְדִּי־אֵל (Magdî ʿēl)	Usually understood with מגד/ל + אל, something like “El is greatness,” “excellence of El,” or “El makes great.”
Iram	עִרָם (ʿĪrām)	Sometimes associated with עִיר, “city,” but BDB gives no secure derivation.

Chief God is Great, Chief Garden in Heaven.

Oh my god are we done?

Those are Redland’s chiefs.

We’re done!

That’s Esau, father of Red.

End of chapter!

Genesis 37

Genesis 37:1

And Jacob lived in the land of his father's residences, in the land of Canaan.

וַיָּשָׁב יַעֲקֹב אֶלְבֵּי
מִגְדָּל יִזְבֶּּן אֲבִיו
בְּאֶרֶץ

Jacob lived near dad's house.

Genesis 37:2

These are the records of Jacob:

Joseph, at seventeen years old, had been tending the sheep with his brothers, and he was a boy with the sons of Bilhah and the sons of Zilpah, his father's wives; and Joseph brought a bad report of them to their father.

אלה תלדות יעקב
 אָוֹן וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן
 וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב
 וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ וְעִוָּה
 וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ
 וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ
 וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ
 וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ
 וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ
 וְעִוָּה וְכָזָב וְשֹׁמֵן וְעִזְזֵי כֹחַ

These are the records of Jacob.

Oh Christ not another begat list.

Joseph was seventeen and watching the sheep with his brothers.

Oh thank god it's a story.

Joseph goes to dad and complains about the older bros.

Genesis 37:3

And Israel had loved Joseph the most of all his children because he was a son of old age to him. And he made him a coat of many colors.

၂၉၆၃ x ၄၅၆၇ ၆၇၈၉၀
 ၇၈ ၉၀ ၆၇၈၉ ၆၇၈
 ၉၀၆၇ ၆၇၈ ၆၇၈၉၀
 ၆၇၈၉၀ ၆၇၈၉၀

Joseph was Israel's favorite because obviously, Rachel.

So he gives him a really rad shirt.²⁹⁴ ²⁹⁵ ²⁹⁶ ²⁹⁷ ²⁹⁸

Genesis 37:4

And his brothers saw that their father loved him the most of all his brothers. And they hated him. And they were not able to speak a greeting to him.

יִשְׂרָאֵל אָהַב אֹתוֹ מִכָּל
אֶבְרָתָיו וְהָאֲנָשִׁים
הָאֵלֶּם הָטִיפוּ אֵלָיו
וְלֹא יָדָעוּ לְהַגִּיד
לְהִיחָיוּתוֹ

His brothers are jealous and hate him.

Genesis 37:5

And Joseph had a dream and told it to his brothers, and they went on to hate him more.

וַיִּחְלֶם יוֹסֵף
חֲלֻמֹתָיו וַיַּגִּיד
לְאֶבְרָתָיו וַיִּשְׂנְאוּ
אֹתוֹ עוֹד

Joseph has a dream.

It made them hate him more.²⁹⁹

Genesis 37:6

And he said to them, “Listen to this dream that I had:

יָדָעְתִּי כִּי
אֶבְרָתִי עֹמֵד
בְּתוֹךְ אֶבְרָתָם
וְהָאֲנָשִׁים
הָאֵלֶּם מִבֹּשֶׁת

So he’s like “Hey guys, listen to this dream I had.”

Genesis 37:7

and here we were binding sheaves in the field; and here was my sheaf rising and standing up, too; and, here, your sheaves surrounded and bowed to my sheaf.”

וְהִנֵּה אֶבְרָתִי
עֹמֵד בְּתוֹךְ
אֶבְרָתָם וְהִנֵּה
אֶבְרָתִי מִבֹּשֶׁת
וְהִנֵּה אֶבְרָתָם
מִבֹּשֶׁת וְהִנֵּה
אֶבְרָתִי עֹמֵד
בְּתוֹךְ אֶבְרָתָם

²⁹⁴Nobody knows what the Hebrew word here means.

²⁹⁵Here the word is PSYm, it’s YSP (Joseph) backwards.

²⁹⁶Joseph (YSwP) has an internal waw.

²⁹⁷Cross and Freedman point out that early Hebrew basically didn’t do internal *matres lectionis* yet. So if J was written around the ninth century, most of those helpful little *waws* and *yods* telling you what vowel to read just weren’t there. The original spelling would’ve been way more stripped-down and ambiguous. F. M. Cross and D. N. Freedman, *Early Hebrew Orthography* (1952).

²⁹⁸Red is learning quick.

²⁹⁹Lit. יִשְׂרָאֵל in the original.

We were out in the field tying up grain bundles.

And mine starts standing up all straight and long and you guys’ bundles all surround it and start bending over ha.

Genesis 37:8

And his brothers said to him,
“Will you rule over us?! Will you
dominate us?!” And they went on
to hate him more because of his
dreams and because of his words.

እረኞታ ሃገደቱ ሃረ ሃላግቶቻህ
ረሃሠኝ ግቱ ሃገገረዐ እረኝተ
ላሳዐ ሃገቹሃገህ ሃገሩ ረሠኝተ
ሃገተኝረዘ ረዐ ሃተቱ ቶገሠ
ሃገላላ ረዐሃ

So his brothers are like “What the hell kind of a dream is *that*?!”

Cuz obviously.

They hate him even more now.

Genesis 37:9

And he had yet another dream
and told it to his brothers. And he
said, “Here, I’ve had another
dream, and here were the sun and
the moon and eleven stars bowing
to me.”

ላደቱ ምሃረዘ ላሳዐ ምረዘገህ
ሃገደቱረ ሃተቱ ላገቹገህ
ገተኝረዘ ጓገጓ ላግቶቻህ
ሠሠሠጓ ጓገጓህ ላሳዐ ምሃረዘ
ላሠዐ ላደቱሃ ዘላገጓህ
ገረ ምገሃዘተሠሠ ምገሩሃሃሃ

So he has another dream and tells them again.

He’s like “The sun and moon and eleven stars start bowing to me.”

Genesis 37:10

And he told it to his father and to
his brothers. And his father was
annoyed at him and said to him,
“What is this dream that you’ve
had? Shall we come, I and your
mother and your brothers, to bow
to you to the ground?!”

ረቱሃ ሃገሩቱ ረቱ ላገቹገህ
ሃገሩቱ ሃሩ ላዐገገህ ሃገደቱ
ምሃረዘጓ ጓሠ ሃረ ላግቶቻህ
ቶሃሩጓ ተኝረዘ ላሠቱ ጓገጓ
እግቱሃ ገሃቱ ቶሃሩሃ
እረ ተሃዘተሠጓረ እገደቱሃ
ጓሾላቱ

So he tells his older brothers and dad.

All eleven of them, plus dad.

And his dad is like “What the hell kind of a dream is that?”

Somehow everyone sees through his highly obscure non-obvious imagery.

Genesis 37:11

And his brothers were jealous of him, and his father took note of the thing.

ሃገገቱ ሃፃ ሃፋሃዋጊሃ
ፃፃላፓ ተፋ ሃግሠ ሃጊፃፋሃ

His brothers keep being jealous.

His dad is like “Noted.”

Genesis 37:12

And his brothers went to feed their father’s sheep in Shechem.

አፋ አኖፃ/ ነገገቱ ነሃ/ጊኖ
ሣሃሠፃ ሣፃጊፃፋ ግፋጌ

His brothers go to feed dad’s sheep in that town they genocided with penis tricks.

Genesis 37:13

And Israel said to Joseph, “Aren’t your brothers feeding in Shechem? Come on and I’ll send you to them.” And he said to him, “I’m here.”

ገቻኖጊ ራፋ ራፋፃሠጊ ፃሣፋጊኖ
ሣጊፐፃ ሣጊገቱ ፋኖ/ፃ
ሣፀ/ሠፋኖ ፃሃ/ ሣሃሠፃ
ጊግግፃ ኖ/ ፃሣፋጊኖ ሣፃጊ/ፋ

So Israel’s like, “Hey, your brothers are over in that town *they* genocided. Get out of here and go over there.”

And he’s like “Whatcha need pops?”

Genesis 37:14

And he said to him, “Go, see how your brothers are and how the sheep are and bring me back word.” And he sent him from the valley of Hebron. And he came to Shechem.

ፃፋፃ ፋግ ሃ/ ኖ/ ፃሣፋጊኖ
አፋኖ ሣጊገቱ ሣኖ/ሠ አፋ
ጊግፃሠፃኖ ግፋጌፃ ሣኖ/ሠ
ዋሣፐሣ ኖፃፀ/ሠጊኖ ፃፃላ
ፃሣሃሠ ፋፃጊኖ ግኖፃፃፀ

So dad’s like “Go check on your brothers and the sheep and let me know.”

So Joseph heads to Shechem.

The town, not the guy.

The guy is dead.

Genesis 37:15

And a man found him, and here he was straying in a field. And the man asked him, saying, “What are you looking for?”

ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐃᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᑦᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᑦᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ

A man finds him. He was doing something out in a field.

The guy’s like “Whatcha doing?”

Genesis 37:16

And he said, “I’m looking for my brothers. Tell me, where are they feeding?”

ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ

He’s like “I’m looking for my brothers. I figured they might be out here in this here field. Have you seen them.”

Genesis 37:17

And the man said, “They traveled on from here. Because I heard them saying, ‘Let’s go to Dothan.’” And Joseph went after his brothers and found them in Dothan.

ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ

So the man’s like “Oh yeah those kids. I know the ones. They said they were going to Twin Pits.”

So Joseph goes to Twin Pits and finds them.

Genesis 37:18

And they saw him from a distance, and before he came close to them they conspired against him: to kill him.

ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ
ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑭᐱᑦ

They see him coming and they’re like “Ugh, Joe’s here. Let’s kill him.”

Genesis 37:19

And the brothers said to one another, “Here comes the dream-master, that one there!

ሃጊዘቱ ረቱ ሠጊቱ ሃላግቱጊሃ
ጸገረጸ ተሃግረዘጸ ረዐሳ ጸሃጸ
ቱጵ

One of those brothers is like “Hey the dream boy’s coming.”

Genesis 37:20

And now, come on and let’s kill him and throw him in one of the pits, and we’ll say a wild animal ate him, and we’ll see what his dreams will be!”

ሃጸገላጸሃሃ ሃጸረ ጸተዐሃ
ተሃላጸጸ ላዘቱጵ ሃጸጸረሠሃሃ
ጸዐላ ጸጊዘ ሃሃላግቱሃ
ጸግ ጸቱላሃሃ ሃጸተረጸቱ
ሃጊተግረዘ ሃጊጸጊ

“Let’s kill him and throw him in one of the pits. They have two in this town after all. We’ll say a wild animal ate him. Bet he’ll have really great dreams when he’s dead ha!.”

Genesis 37:21

And Reuben heard, and he saved him from their hand. And he said, “Let’s not take his life.”

የጻረጦጊየ ሃጽየቱጻ ዐሣሠጊየ
የግሃግ ቱሪ ጻሣቱጊየ ሣላጊሣ
ሠገግ

The eldest brother hears and he’s like “Guys c’mon, we’re not gonna kill Joseph.”

Genesis 37:22

And Reuben said to them, “Don’t spill blood. Throw him into this pit that’s in the wilderness, and don’t put out a hand against him”—in order to save him from their hand, to bring him back to his father.

ሃጽየቱጻ ሣጻረቱ ጻሣቱጊየ
የሣጊረሠጻ ሣላ የሣገሠጸ ረቱ
ጻጋጻ ጻየጽጻ ረቱ የጸቱ
ረቱ ላጊየ ጻጽላሣ ጻሠቱ
ረጊጦጻ ሃዐሣሪ የጽ የዘረሠጸ
ረቱ የጽጊሠጻሪ ሣላጊሣ የጸቱ
የጊጽቱ

“Just throw him in this pit.”

Genesis 37:23

And it was when Joseph came to his brothers: and they took off Joseph’s coat, the coat of many colors, which he had on.

ገቹሃጊ ፋፍ ላሠፋሃ ጊጓጊሃ
ተፋ ሃፀጊሠገጊሃ ሃጊዘፋ ረፋ
ተፋ ሃተሃተሃ ተፋ ገቹሃጊ
ሃጊረዐ ላሠፋ ሠጊቹገጓ ተሃተሃ

So Joseph catches up to the brothers and they steal his rad shirt.

Genesis 37:24

And they took him and threw him into the pit. And the pit was empty; there was no water in it.

የጹፋ የሃረሠጊ የጃዘዋጊ
ሃጊፋ ዋፃ ላየገጃ የጃገጃ
ሣጊሣ የገ

And they throw him in the pit.

It’s ok, there’s no water in there.

He doesn’t need water.

Genesis 37:25

And they sat down to eat bread.
And they raised their eyes and saw, and here was a caravan of Ishmaelites coming from Gilead, and their camels were carrying spices and balsam and myrrh, going to bring them down to Egypt.

ሣዘረ ረሃፋረ የገሠጊ
ሠጓጊሃጊዐ ሃፋሠጊሃ
ተዘላፋ ጓሃጓሃ ሃፋላጊሃ
ጓፋፍ ሠጊረፋዐሣሠጊ
ሠጓጊረሣገሃ ላዐረገሣ
ጊላሾሃ ተፋሃሃ ሠጊፋሠሃ
ላጊላሃጓረ ሠጊሃረሃጓ ፀረሃ
ጓሣጊላሾሣ

Ok so remember how Hagar had a son before YHWH got Sarah pregnant and how his name was Ishmael?

Apparently that guy’s descendants have become a whole race at this point.³⁰⁰

So they sit down to eat and they see some Ishmaelites coming from Heap Of Testimony (hereafter HOT).

Also their camels have like seasoning and stuff.

They’re headed to Egypt.

Ishmael’s mom was from Egypt remember?

³⁰⁰See man, YHWH finally kept one of those seed promises.

Genesis 37:26

And Judah said to his brothers,
“What profit is there if we kill our
brother and cover his blood?

ፈቅ ጳላሃጳፖ ላሣቅፖ
ገላጳጎ ፖሃ ዐሣጳ ጳሣ ሃፖይቅ
ተቅ ሃፖፖቹሃ ሃፖፖይቅ ተቅ
ሃሣላ

So then Judah, who the country is named after later in the book, says one
of the best lines in the bible.

“Wait guys, we don’t make any money if we kill him.”

Genesis 37:27

Come on and let’s sell him to the
Ishmaelites, and let our hand not
be on him, because he’s our
brother, our flesh.” And his
brothers listened.

ሃሃላሃሣሃ ሃሃረ
ሃሃላፖ ሣፖረቅዐሣሣፖረ
ሃፖፖይቅ ፖሃ ሃጳ ፖጳተ ፈቅ
ሃዐሣሣፖረ ቅሃጳ ሃሃላሣጳ
ሃፖይቅ

Judah’s like “Look guys, I know we can’t stand him, but he’s our own
flesh and blood, he’s our brother, let’s do the right thing and sell him into
slavery.”

The brothers are like “Ok!”

Genesis 37:28

**And Midianite people,
merchants, passed, and they
pulled and lifted Joseph from the
pit.** And they sold Joseph to the
Ishmaelites for twenty weights of
silver. And they brought Joseph to
Egypt.

ሣፖሠሃቅ ነጻጽዐፖክ
ሣፖጻይቅ ሣፖጎፖላሣ
ኣቅ ነሪዐፖክ ነሣሠሣፖክ
ሃላሃሣፖረ ሃጻጻ ሃሣ ገቅክፖ
ሣፖረቅዐሣሣፖረ ገቅሃፖ ተቅ
ሃቅፖጻፖረ ገቅሃ ሣፖጻሠዐጳ
ጳሣፖጻሃ ገቅሃፖ ተቅ

Then some Midianites take him out of the pit.

And they³⁰¹ sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty units of money.

They bring him to Egypt.

³⁰¹Who?

Genesis 37:29

And Reuben came back to the pit, and here: Joseph was not in the pit. And he tore his clothes.

ጻፍኩ ለእኔ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ

Reuben comes back to the pit and Josephs gone.

He (presumably Reuben) tears his (presumably Reuben’s) clothes.³⁰²

Genesis 37:30

And he went back to his brothers and said, “The boy’s gone! And I, where can I go?”

ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ለእኔ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ

He goes back to the others and he’s like “Joseph’s gone! What are we gonna tell dad?”

Genesis 37:31

And they took Joseph’s coat and slaughtered a he-goat and dipped the coat in the blood.

ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ

So they take Joseph’s rad shirt and dip it in goat blood.

Genesis 37:32

And they sent the coat of many colors and brought it to their father and said, “We found this. Recognize: is it your son’s coat or not?”

ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ
ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ ጸፍኩ

Then they deceive their dad (Jacob) using:

- 1. Their brother’s clothes.
- 2. A dead goat.

Which coincidentally Jacob did to *his* dad!

So they’re like “Dad, this shirt looks pretty rad. Is this Joseph’s?”

³⁰²It could also be the rad shirt.

Genesis 37:33

And he recognized it and said,
“My son’s coat. A wild animal ate
him. Joseph is torn up!”

ተሃተሃ ላሣፋጊሃ ጸላጊሃጊሃ
ሃጸተረሃፋ ጸዐላ ጸጊዘ ጊሃፍ
ገቹሃጊ ገላፀ ገላፀ

So without the brothers *technically* lying, Jacob immediately comes to the conclusion they hoped he would.
Joseph’s been all eaten up by some animal.

Genesis 37:34

And Jacob ripped his clothes and
wore sackcloth on his hips and
mourned over his son many days.

ሃጊተረሣሠ ፍዋዐጊ ዐላዋጊሃ
ሃጊሃተሣፍ ዋሠ ሣሠጊሃ
ሣጊሣጊ ሃሃፍ ረዐ ረፍፋተጊሃ
ሣጊፍላ

Dad does some behaviors that seem a bit wacky to us these days but they’re totally standard mourning practices in the Ancient Near East.

Genesis 37:35

And all his sons and all his
daughters got up to console him,
and he refused to be consoled, and
he said, “Because I’ll go down
mourning to my son at Sheol,”
and his father wept for him.

ረሃሃ ሃጊሃፍ ረሃ ሃሣዋጊሃ
ሃፋሣጊሃ ሃሣዘሃረ ሃጊተሃፍ
ጊሃ ላሣፋጊሃ ሣዘሃተጸረ
ጸረፋሠ ረፍፋ ጊሃፍ ረፋ ላላፋ
ሃጊፍፋ ሃተፋ ሃፍጊሃ

All his sons³⁰³ and daughters³⁰⁴ try to console him.

But he’s sad anyway.

Cuz obviously.

Joseph was Rachel’s

Now he has nothing left of Rachel except stupid Benjamin who killed her in childbirth.

³⁰³Eleven.
³⁰⁴What’s left of Dinah, but plural for some reason.

Genesis 37:36

And the Medanites sold him to Egypt, to Potiphar, an official of Pharaoh, chief of the guards.

ἰᾱᾱ ἰᾱᾱ ᾱᾱᾱᾱᾱᾱ
ᾱᾱᾱᾱᾱ ᾱᾱᾱᾱ ᾱᾱ
ᾱᾱ ᾱᾱᾱ ᾱᾱᾱᾱ
ᾱᾱᾱᾱᾱᾱ

So now the MDINIM (Heb. מדינים) sell him to Egypt.
They’re probably the same as the MDNIM (מדינים), but spelled different for some reason.
Anyways they sell him to an Egyptian named Potiphar, who we’ll hear more about in the next chapter.

Genesis 38

Genesis 38:1

And it was at that time, and Judah went down from his brothers and turned to an Adullamite man, and his name was Hirah.

4924 4433 +09 2324
 ⊕24 4244 +47 3443
 4744 2740 424 40
 3924

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Judah	יהודה (Yahûdāh)	The guy who started the jews.
Hirah	חירָה (Hîrāh)	No secure Hebrew derivation.

Ok so suddenly there's this story about Judah.³⁰⁵

He's important because he's where the Nameless author who's writing this whole bible thing lives.³⁰⁶

Name unknown.

Her name is J.

She lives in Judah.³⁰⁷

Now Judah leaves his other brothers and goes down to this guy who's from a place called Refuge, his name is either Freedom or Anger.³⁰⁸

Genesis 38:2

And Judah saw a daughter of a Canaanite man there, and his name was Shua. And he took her and came to her.

ተፃ ያልሃጸገ ሃሠ ቀላጊሃ
ዐሃሠ ሃሃሠሃ ጊሃዐሃሃ ሠጊቀ
ጸጊረቀ ቀፃጊሃ ጸዘዐጊሃ

Judah meets a girl there.

She's the daughter³⁰⁹ of a guy named Shua.³¹⁰

He took her and he came to her.

³⁰⁵REF: Judah. The eponymous ancestor of the Jews, Judah is the most prominent of the brothers in the Joseph stories, and here he is the only one of Jacob's sons besides Joseph to have a separate story about him. Some say that the word means "to be thankful." Its derivation is unknown. Footnote 38:1. Judah went down. The next chapter begins with "Joseph had been brought down." The contrast is blatant (even more so in the Hebrew) between Judah's independence and Joseph's weakness: Judah went down, and Joseph was brought down.

³⁰⁶At least the green bits.

³⁰⁷It's the bible. People are places.

³⁰⁸Assuming the original text lacked internal *matres lectiones*, חרה = Ḥîrâ “Hirah” ≈ free/noble, חרה = hārâ “burn / become angry.”

³⁰⁹Lit. **בַּת**.

³¹⁰Lit. שוע.

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Shua	שׁוּא (Šûaʿ)	Possibly “wealth”, “prosperity”, or “cry for help,” but uncertain.

Genesis 38:3

And she became pregnant and gave birth to a son, and he called his name Er.

ḲṯṔṚṚ ṚṢ ḂḲṲṚ ḲṰṲṚ
ḲṐ ṚṚṚ ṲḲ

Now she’s pregnant, because come works like that.³¹¹

She has a baby and calls it ḲḂḂ.³¹²

Genesis 38:4

And she became pregnant again and gave birth to a son, and she called his name Onan.

ṚṢ ḂḲṲṚ ḂṚṐ ḲṰṲṚ
ṚṚṚḲ ṚṚṚ ṲḲ ḲṯṔṲṚ

The firstborn after Er is Onan.³¹³

Genesis 38:5

And she proceeded again to give birth to a son, and she called his name Shelah. (And he was at Chezib when she gave birth to him.)

ṚṢ ḂḲṲṚ ḂṚṐ ṚṦṲṚ
ṰḲṚ ṚṚṚ ṲḲ ḲṯṔṲṚ
ṰṲḂḲṢ ṢṚḲṚṢ ṰṚṰṚ
ṚṲḲ

Then there’s Shelah.³¹⁴

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Shelah	שֶׁלָּה (Šēlāh)	Possibly “petition/request”; the derivation is uncertain.

The text notes that she has this one in a specific place.

Chezib is an ancient biblical town in the lowlands of Judah whose name translates to ”false,” ”lying,” or ”deceptive.”

³¹¹“like that” here presumably means “maintaining both a standard meaning and a euphemistic meaning in parallel across multiple language families for something like 3000 years, with or without the different groups who use the term in said manner coming together for purposes of communication, co-marriage, common interests, or commerce, such as, for example, in agricultural societies, sharing seed.

³¹²Lit. ḲṐ in the original.

³¹³That’s ṚṚṚḲ, not ṚṚṚṚḲ.

³¹⁴And that’s ṰḲṚ, not ṰṚḲṚ.

Chezib is an ancient biblical town in the lowlands of Judah whose name translates to "false," "lying," or "deceptive."

Chezib is an ancient biblical town in the lowlands of Judah whose name translates to "false," "lying," or "deceptive."

This chapter’s incredible.

Moving on.

Genesis 38:6

And Judah took a wife for Er, his firstborn, and her name was Tamar.

אִשָּׁה לְיָדָה עֵר אֶת־תָּמָר בְּתוּלָה
וְשֵׁםָּהּ תָּמָר

Er marries Tamar.

Genesis 38:7

And Er, Judah’s firstborn, was bad in YHWH’s eyes, and YHWH killed him.

וְעֵר אֶת־בְּרִיתֵהוּא בָּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וַיַּהַרְגֵהוּ יְהוָה
וְעֵר אֶת־בְּרִיתֵהוּא בָּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וַיַּהַרְגֵהוּ יְהוָה

So YHWH kills אֶת־עֵר³¹⁵ (who was bad³¹⁶ for some reason (no one knows why.))

No one. Knows. Why.

Here are some comments scholars have made over the years on this topic:

Er’s wickedness was like Onan’s wickedness: he deliberately pre-vented Tamar from becoming pregnant so that pregnancy would not spoil her beauty.

—Babylonian Talmud, *Yevamot* 34b (ca. 500 CE); cf. Rashi (ca. 1040–1105)

Scripture does not tell us Er’s sin. His death nevertheless shows that he died for his own wickedness, rather than as punishment upon Judah for the sale of Joseph.

—Nachmanides (1194–1270)

Since Er was evil specifically “in YHWH’s eyes,” his crime was apparently hidden from other people but known to God.

—Sforno (1475–1550)

Perhaps Er committed the same sexual offense as Onan; others proposed still other “unnatural” sexual acts.

³¹⁵Lit. אֶת־.

³¹⁶Lit. בָּעֵינֵי.

—Christian commentators, ancient–early modern (ca. 400–1700)

Er was notoriously wicked; whatever his unnamed crime was, it must have been sufficiently grave to provoke extraordinary divine judgment.

—common Protestant interpretation (ca. 1600–1900)

Er was “a Sodomite, say the Hebrews”—though this is “hard to say.” Still, he was “too wicked to live,” and “you may know him to be the son of a Canaanitess.”

—John Trapp (1650s)

Er was “notoriously wicked,” and YHWH slew him “in some extraordinary and remarkable manner.”

—Matthew Poole (1680s)

Er was guilty of some “very heinous sin.” Perhaps, as one tradition held, he had intercourse with Tamar in the “sodomitical” manner.³¹⁷ YHWH either struck him dead immediately or sent a disease which quickly carried him off.

—John Gill (1748–1763)

Finally, after several thousand years, there appeared the voice of one crying in the wilderness, a man named Adam, the first among men, and he came to all the people of the earth, and he spoke to them, saying:

The Hebrew word expressing Er’s wickedness is his own name with the letters reversed: ער, Er; רע, bad.

—Adam Clarke (1762–1832; commentary 1810s)

But the people heeded not the voice of Adam, and they continued their search for the ancient lost secret of Er’s wickedness. And their exegesis continued, as they spoke to us, saying.

Er lived “in defiance of God, and his law.” His untimely and childless death was accordingly a divine punishment.

—Joseph Benson (ca. 1811–1818)

In what particular forms he showed his wickedness we are not told; but being the son of a Canaanitish woman, he probably imbibed, in his earliest years, the spirit of Canaanitish idolatry and vice.

—Daniel D. Whedon (ca. 1870s)

Judah had married into a Canaanite family, “casting off the restraints of religion,” so it is “not surprising” that the family pro-

³¹⁷You know the one.

duced “bold and unblushing wickedness.” Er was, “in all likelihood,” addicted to the “abominable vices of Canaan.”

—Jamieson, Fausset & Brown (1871)

Two thousand years of commentators thus attempted to discover what terrible thing Er had done. The narrator supplies no crime. Even commentators who eventually noticed something curious about the spelling often went right on looking for the crime. The search continues to the present day.

And Er, Judah’s firstborn, was evil in the eyes of the LORD. The nature of his moral failing remains unspecified, but given the insistent pattern of reversal of primogeniture in all these stories, it seems almost sufficient merely to be firstborn in order to incur God’s displeasure: though the firstborn is not necessarily evil, he usually turns out to be obtuse, rash, wild, or otherwise disqualified from carrying on the heritage.

—A comment on AR from someone named R.A. (1997).

Genesis 38:8

And Judah said to Onan, “Come to your brother’s wife and couple as a brother-in-law with her and raise seed for your brother.”

יְיָיָאֵל אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ

So without so much as a word of commentary on Judah’s response to this tragic loss, he comes to Onan, and says:

Come to Tamar.

Your broth‘er’s dead.

Genesis 38:9

And Onan knew that the seed would not be his. And it was when he came to his brother’s wife: and he spent on the ground so as not to give seed for his brother.

אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ
אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ אֵלֶיךָ

But Onan knew the laws of levirate marriage, which meant that to commemorate the dead broth Er, his kid would be called:

SOMETHING, SON OF ER.

And he didn’t like the sound of that, we aren’t told why.

So he comes to his brother’s wife, but he commits a great sin, this Onan.
He comes in a strange way entirely outside the vanilla manner.
Not in the manner from which progeny arise but rather outside it entirely.
His name has for this reason survived to this day.^{318 319 320}

Genesis 38:10

And what he did was bad in
YHWH’s eyes, and He killed him,
too.

ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ

So naturally YHWH kills him.
YHWH expects you to keep the prophecy full-filled at all times.

Genesis 38:11

And Judah said to Tamar, his
daughter-in-law, “Live as a widow
at your father’s house until my son
Shelah grows up” (because he
said, “Or else he, too, will die like
his brothers”). And Tamar went
and lived at her father’s house.

ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ

Judah tells her to go back home.
All he knows is his sons keep dying when she’s around.
Shelah will be waiting for her, he says, until he’s older.
Otherwise he’ll die like his brothers.

Genesis 38:12

³¹⁸Onanism primarily means masturbation or coitus interruptus, the withdrawal method during sexual intercourse.
³¹⁹According to her biographers, the legendary American writer, poet, and satirist Dorothy Parker, had a pet canary named Onan. Whenever people asked Parker about the bird’s unusual name, she would reply, “Because he spills his seed upon the ground.”
³²⁰David Foster Wallace’s novel Infinite Jest takes place in the Organization of North American Nations (O.N.A.N.), a supernation formed by the United States, Canada, and Mexico.

And the days were many, and Judah's wife, the daughter of Shua, died. And Judah was consoled. And he went up to his sheepshearers, he and his friend Hirah, the Adullamite, to Timnah.

ተጋተሃ ማገማገል ሃፃፃጊሃ
ጸላሃጸጊ ተሠፋ ዐሃሠ ተፃ
ገዐጊሃ ጸላሃጸጊ ማይሃጊሃ
ፋሃጸ ሃሃፋሾ ጊጊጊገ ገዐ
ጊማገላዐጸ ሃጸዐላ ጸላጊይሃ
ጸተሃማተ

Batshua dies.

Judah gets over it.

He goes to Restraint, to see his friend Freedom.

Genesis 38:13

And it was told to Tamar, saying, “Here, your father-in-law is going up to Timnah to shear his sheep.”

ጸሃጸ ላማፋጊ ላማተጊ ላገጊሃ
ጊገጊ ጸተሃማተ ጸገዐ ሃጊማይ
ሃሃፋሾ

Tamar hears.

Genesis 38:14

And she took off her widowhood clothes from on her and covered herself with a veil and wrapped herself and sat in a visible place that was on the road to Timnah, because she saw that Shelah had grown up and she had not been given to him as a wife.

ጸተሃሃማጊፋ ጊላገፃ ላቹተሃ
ገጊዐሾፃ ቹሃተሃ ጸጊገዐማ
ይተገፃ ሃሠተሃ ገገዐተተሃ
ሃላላ ገዐ ላሠፋ ማገማገዐ
ጊሃ ጸተፋላ ጊሃ ጸተሃማተ
ፋጊ ፋሃጸሃ ጸጊሠ ጊላገ
ጸሠፋጊ ሃጊ ጸሃተሃ

She whips off her widow gear and veils herself up, and sits out in a public area on the way to Restraint.

ŠL H is older and ready for marriage now, while she's still at home living with her parents waiting for the call.

Genesis 38:15

And Judah saw her and thought her to be a prostitute because she had covered her face.

ጸሃሠይጊሃ ጸላሃጸጊ ጸፋላጊሃ
ጸጊሃገ ጸተቹሃ ጊሃ ጸሃሃጊጊ

He thinks she's whore.

In J, women get power by hooker by crook.

Genesis 38:16

And he turned to her by the road.
And he said, “Come on. Let me
come to you,” because he did not
know that she was his
daughter-in-law. And she said,
“What will you give me when you
come to me?”

ሃላላን ረፋ ጓጊረፋ ተጊሃ
ፋሃዓፋ ፋሃ ጓዓን ላሣፋጊሃ
ጊሃ ዐላጊ ፋረ ጊሃ ሃጊረፋ
ጓሣ ላሣፋተሃ ፋሃን ሃተረሃ
ጊረፋ ፋሃዓተ ጊሃጊረ ሃተተ

So he’s naturally like “Come on.”

He wants to come to her.

No idea who she is, he’s innocent.

So she’s like “How much?”

Genesis 38:17

And he said, “I’ll have a goat kid
sent from the flock.” And she
said, “If you’ll give a pledge until
you send it.”

ይረሃፋ ጊሃሃፋ ላሣፋጊሃ
ሃፋሂን ሃሣ ሣጊገዐ ጊላገ
ሃሃዓዓዐ ሃተተ ሣፋ ላሣፋተሃ
ሃይረሃ ላዐ

He’s like “I’ll give you a kid, the goat kind, baby.”

She notes he’s not carrying any goats, so she wants some collateral.

Genesis 38:18

And he said, “What is the pledge
that I’ll give you?” And she said,
“Your seal and your cord and your
staff that’s in your hand.” And he
gave them to her, and he came to
her, and she became pregnant by
him.

ሃሃዓዓዐን ጓሣ ላሣፋጊሃ
ላሣፋተሃ ሃረ ሃተፋ ላሃፋ
ሃተሣሃ ሃረጊተሃሃ ሃሣተይ
ጓረ ሃተጊሃ ሃላጊዓ ላሃፋ
ሃረ ላጓተሃ ጓጊረፋ ፋዓጊሃ

He’s like “Whatcha want?”

She says, like any of us would:

- 1. Your signature.³²¹
- 2. Your belt.³²²

³²¹Cylinder seals were the equivalent of a signature in the Ancient Near East.
³²²Removing one’s belt was associated with removing one’s pants in the Ancient Near East.

3. Your rod.³²³

Judah’s like “Ok.”

And he comes to her.

She gets pregnant.

Genesis 38:19

And she got up and went and took off her veil from on her and put on her widowhood clothes.

ላቹተሃ ጎረተሃ ማዋተሃ
ሠዓረተሃ ጓጊረዐማ ጓገጊዐሣ
ጓተሃሃማረፉ ጊላገላ

She dusts herself off and puts her batman clothes back on.

Genesis 38:20

And Judah sent the goat kid by the hand of his friend the Adullamite to take back the pledge from the woman’s hand, and he did not find her.

ተፋ ጓላሃጓጊ ዘረሠጊሃ
ሃጓዐላ ላጊሳ ማጊጊዐጓ ጊላገ
ሃሃሳላዐጓ ተዘዋረ ጊማረላዐጓ
ጓፋሣማ ፋረሃ ጓሠፋጓ ላጊማ

Judah gives Freedom the goat, and tells him to mail it to:

That Prostitute³²⁴
The visible place³²⁵
On the road
Restraint

Genesis 38:21

And he asked the people of her place, saying, “Where is the sacred prostitute? She was visibly by the road.” And they said, “There was no sacred prostitute here.”

ጓማዋማ ጊሠሃፋ ተፋ ረፋሠጊሃ
ጓሠላዋጓ ጓጊፋ ላማፋረ
ሃላላጓ ረዐ ማጊሃጊዐሳ ፋሃጓ
ጓጊሳ ጓተጊጓ ፋረ ሃላማፋጊሃ
ጓሠላዋ

He goes to exactly that address, but can’t find her.

³²³Rod was a long hard stick in the Ancient Near East.
³²⁴You know the one.
³²⁵Ibid.

Genesis 38:22

And he came back to Judah and said, “I didn’t find her, and also the people of the place said There was no sacred prostitute here.””

ጳላሃጳፖ ረፋ ያሠፈሃ
ጳፖተፋሾሣ ፋረ ላሣፋፖሃ
ሣሃዋሣጳ ፖሠሃፋ ሣገሃ
ጳጊያ ጳተፖጳ ፋረ ሃላሣፋ
ጳሠላዋ

He says there’s no one by that name living at that address.

Genesis 38:23

And Judah said, “Let her take them or else we’ll be a disgrace. Here, I’ve sent this goat kid, and you didn’t find her.”

ዘዋተ ጳላሃጳፖ ላሣፋፖሃ
ጳሃጳ ጊሃዖረ ጳፖጳሃ ሃገ ጳረ
ጳጊጳ ፖላገጳ ፖተዘረሠ
ጳተፋሾሣ ፋረ ጳተፋሃ

Judah’s like “Let her take them.”

He’s worried about looking silly.

Genesis 38:24

And it was about three months, and it was told to Judah, saying, “Your daughter-in-law Tamar has whored, and, here, she’s pregnant by whoring as well.” And Judah said, “Bring her out and let her be burned.”

ሣፖሠላዘ ሠረሠሣሃ ፖጳፖሃ
ላሣፋረ ጳላሃጳፖረ ላገፖሃ
ሣገሃ ሃተረሃ ላሣተ ጳተሃጊ
ሣፖሃሃሃጊረ ጳላጳ ጳሃጳ
ጳላሃጳፖ ላሣፋፖሃ
ገላሠተሃ ጳሃፋፖሾሃጳ

Three months later, Judah gets word that Tamar has been whoring around, and now she’s pregnant from all her whoring around.

Naturally, Judah decides to set her on fire.

Genesis 38:25

She was brought out. And she sent to her father-in-law, saying, “I’m pregnant by the man to whom these belong,” and she said, “Recognize: to whom do these seal and cords and staff belong?”

ፋፖጳሃ ተፋሾሃሣ ፋሃጳ
ላሣፋረ ጳፖሣዘ ረፋ ጳዘረሠ
ሃረ ጳረፋ ላሠፋ ሠፖፋረ
ላሣፋተሃ ጳላጳ ፖሃሃፋ
ተሣተዘጳ ፖሣረ ፋሃ ላሃጳ
ጳ፱ሣጳሃ ሣፖረፖተገጳሃ
ጳረፋጳ

It's:

1. His signature.
2. His belt.
3. His rod.

97424 34432 9724
 14 20 24 2424 3444
 243 3444 34444 44
 34044 440 744 444

The text then promises he didn't have sex with her anymore, which seems like the sort of thing people always tell the truth about.

ᐱᐣᐱᐣ ᐱᐣᐱᐣ ᐣᐣᐣ ᐣᐣᐣᐣ
ᐣᐣᐣᐣ ᐣᐣᐣᐣᐣᐣ

It's twins.

ልጌ ሃተጊሃ ጸተላረፍ ጌጸጊሃ
 ላወዋተሃ ተላረጊኝጸ ዘዋተሃ
 ጸጊ ላኝቶረ ጊሃወ ሃላጌ ረዐ
 ጸሃወቶ ላቶጊ

411

And the nurse looks at the hand, in a matter of fact manner, and ties a red thread around it, so we know who’s the firstborn.

Genesis 38:29

And it was as he pulled his hand back, and here his brother came out. And she said, “What a breach you’ve made for yourself!” And he called his name Perez.

אָנאָן קאז גזשׂן זאזן
אױ קױף+ן קזחף קױז
קאפזן קאן קזלױ +קאן
קאן קױשׁ

But then, as if summoned back from another world, someone or something pulls him back in.

And the other baby comes rushing out ahead of him.

Not the one with the red.³²⁶

The other one.

So they name the kids puns.³²⁷

The one who burst out they call Buster.

For he was intense.

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Perez	פָּרֶז (Pāreṣ)	“Breach/bursting forth,” from פָּרַץ, “break through.”

Genesis 38:30

And his brother who had the scarlet thread on his hand came out after. And he called his name Zerah.

קאף קזחף קױז קחף
קאפזן זשׂשׁא קאז לױ
חאז קױשׁ

Then the red one comes out.

His name is Semen.

For Judah saw him.

And ‘e saw he was a man.

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Zerah	זֶרַח (Zārāḥ)	“Rising/shining,” from זָרַח, especially of the sun.

³²⁶You know the one.
³²⁷It’s the bible. People are puns.

Genesis 39

Genesis 39:1

And Joseph had been brought down to Egypt. And an Egyptian man, Potiphar, an official of Pharaoh, chief of the guards, bought him from the hand of the Ishmaelites who had brought him down there.

ጳጳረዳሮሣ ልሳሃጅ ገቹሃረሃ
ቹረዳቹ ላገረፀሃገ ሃጳሃዋረሃ
ሣረዘዓፀጳ ላሠ ጳዐላገ
ላረሣ ረዳሮሣ ሠረፉ
ላሠፉ ሣረረፉዐሣሠረጳ
ጳሣሠ ሃጳልሳሃጅ

Ok so while all that was going on, Joseph had been brought to Egypt.

He got sold from

- 1. His brothers to
- 2. The Midianites to
- 3. The Ishmaelites to
- 4. some guy named Potiphar who
- 5. works for the king of Egypt who
- 6. we call Pharaoh for some reason and not king.

Genesis 39:2

And YHWH was with Joseph, and he was a successful man, and he was in his Egyptian lord’s house.

ገቹሃረ ተፋ ጳሃጳረ ረጳረሃ
ዘረረሮሣ ሠረፉ ረጳረሃ
ሃረሃላፉ ተረዓዓ ረጳረሃ
ረዳሮሣጳ

YHWH’s there too.

He’s with Joseph.

He’s a successful man.

He’s in the guy’s house.

Genesis 39:3

And his lord saw that YHWH was with him, and YHWH made everything he was doing successful in his hand.

እሃጃጊ ጊሃ ሃጊሃላቀ ቀላጊሃ
ቀሃጃ ላሠቀ ረሃሃ ሃተቀ
ዘጊሊሃ ጃሃጃጊ ጃሠዐ
ሃላጊጃ

The guy sees that YHWH is with him, helping out.

Genesis 39:4

And Joseph found favor in his eyes, and he attended him, and he appointed him over his house and put everything he had in his hand.

ሃዘ ገቹሃጊ ቀሊሣጊሃ
ሃተቀ ተላሠጊሃ ሃጊሃጊዐጃ
ረሃሃ ሃተጊጃ ረዐ ሃጃላዋገጊሃ
ሃላጊጃ ሃተሃ ሃረ ሠጊ

The guy puts Joseph in charge of *all of his stuff*.

Genesis 39:5

And it was from the time that he appointed him in his house and over all that he had that YHWH blessed the Egyptian’s house because of Joseph, and YHWH’s blessing was in everything that he had, in the house and in the field.

ሃተቀ ላጊዋገጃ ጊቀሣ ጊጃጊሃ
ላሠቀ ረሃ ረዐሃ ሃተጊጃጃ
ጃሃጃጊ ሃላጃጊሃ ሃረ ሠጊ
ረረገጃ ጊላሊሣጃ ተጊጃ ተቀ
ጃሃጃጊ ተሃላጃ ጊጃጊሃ ገቹሃጊ
ተጊጃጃ ሃረ ሠጊ ላሠቀ ረሃጃ
ጃላሠጃሃ

YHWH’s blessing is all over everything.

Genesis 39:6

And he left everything that he had in Joseph’s hand and did not know a thing about what he had except the bread that he was eating. And Joseph had an attractive figure and was handsome.

ላጊጃ ሃረ ላሠቀ ረሃ ጃጊዐጊሃ
ሃተቀ ዐላጊ ቀረሃ ገቹሃጊ
ሣዘረጃ ሣቀ ጊሃ ጃሣሃቀሣ
ጊጃጊሃ ረሃሃቀ ቀሃጃ ላሠቀ
ጃገጊሃ ላቀተ ጃገጊ ገቹሃጊ
ጃቀላሣ

The guy puts Joseph in charge of *all of his stuff*!

And he sort of stops keeping track of his own stuff except bread.

Joseph was hot.

Joseph continues about how he's bigger than everyone else in the house

and he’s also in charge of everything except her, which is how I always refuse sex I don’t want.

Genesis 39:10

And it was, when she spoke to Joseph day after day, that he didn’t listen to her, to lie by her, to be with her.

ገፑሃጊ ረፋ ጳፋፋሃ ጊጳጊሃ
ዐግሠ ፋረሃ ሣሃጊ ሣሃጊ
ጳረሾፋ ልግሠረ ጳጊረፋ
ጳግዐ ተሃጊጳረ

Ok so when they talk every day (because they live in the same house) day after day he keeps not sleeping with her, not even a lot.

Genesis 39:11

And it was on a day like this, and he came to the house to do his work, and not one of the people of the house was there in the house.

ጳጊጳ ሣሃጊጳሃ ጊጳጊሃ
ተሃሠዐረ ጳተጊፋጳ ፋፋጊሃ
ሠጊፋ ሃጊፋሃ ሃተሃፋረሣ
ተጊፋፋ ሣሠ ተጊፋጳ ጊሠሃፋሣ

So one day he comes to the house and comes inside to do his thing, and no one else was home when he came.

Genesis 39:12

And she grasped him by his garment, saying, “Lie with me!” And he left his garment in her hand and fled and went outside.

ፋሣፋረ ሃፋገፋፋ ሃጳሠገተተሃ
ፋጊዐጊሃ ጊግዐ ጳፋግሠ
ፋሾጊሃ ፑሃጊሃ ጳፋጊፋ ሃፋገፋ
ጳሾሃ፱ጳ

Except her.

She grabs him by his clothes and says again,



But as he’s running away ,³³⁰

She reaches out lustfully ,³³¹

And somehow ends up holding his clothes while he’s completely naked.

It could happen to anyone.

³³⁰We’re gonna be stuck here in Egypt until Exodus 15 folks, better get comfortable and start practicing hieroglyphs.
³³¹The Dynamic Read Writable Free Encyclopedic Repository of the Modern State of Human Knowledge turned up surprisingly little information on this glyph, which appears to be something like an ejaculating hand, presumably to connote “lustily reaching.”

Genesis 39:13

And it was, when she saw that he
had left his garment in her hand
and run off outside,

ጌሃ ጸተሃቀላሃ ጊጸጊሃ
ቼሃጊሃ ጸላጊሃ ሃላገሃ ልገዐ
ጸሎሃይጸ

So she notices he got away, presumably naked.

Genesis 39:14

that she called to the people of her
house and said to them, saying,
“See, he brought us a Hebrew
man to fool with us. He came to
me, to lie with me, and I called in
a loud voice.

ጸተጊሃ ጊሠሃቀረ ቀላዋተሃ
ሃቀላ ላሣቀረ ሣጸረ ላሣቀተሃ
ጊላዕ ወጊቀ ሃሃረ ቀጊሃጸ
ልሃሠረ ጊረቀ ቀሃ ሃሃሃ ዋይሶረ
ረሃላገ ረሃዋሃ ቀላዋቀሃ ጊሣዐ

So she calls all the people of the house,³³² and tells them Joseph came to
“fool with *us*.”

Genesis 39:15

And it was when he heard that I
raised my voice and called that he
left his garment by me and fled
and went outside.”

ጌሃ ሃዐሣሠሃ ጊጸጊሃ
ቀላዋቀሃ ጊረሃዋ ጊተሣጊላጸ
ጊረሶቀ ሃላገሃ ልገዐጊሃ
ጸሎሃይጸ ቀሶጊሃ ቼሃጊሃ

She’s like “He tried to do things to me and when I screamed he ran outside
without his pants.”

Genesis 39:16

And she laid his garment down by
her until his lord came to his
house.

ላዐ ጸረሶቀ ሃላገሃ ዘሃተሃ
ሃተጊሃ ረቀ ሃጊሃላቀ ቀሃሃ

She keeps the pants and waits for husband.

³³²They all got back home in between verse 11 and now.

Genesis 39:17

And she spoke things like these to him, saying, “The Hebrew slave, whom you brought us, came to me, to fool with me.

ሠጊጻጻላጎ ሃጊረቱ ላጻላተሃ
ጊረቱ ፋጎ ላሠቅረ ጻረቱጻ
ላሠቱ ጊጻጻዐጻ ላጻዐጻ
ጊጎ ዋይሾረ ሃጎረ ተፋጎጻ

So when husband’s home she’s like “Joseph is trying to fool with *me*.”

Genesis 39:18

And it was when I raised my voice and called that he left his garment by me and fled outside.”

ጊረሃዋ ጊሠጊጻጻጎ ጊጻጊሃ
ሃላገፍ ምሪዐጊሃ ፋላዋቱሃ
ጻሾሃይጻ ቸሃጊሃ ጊረሾቱ

Then she says the thing again about how she screamed and he ran outside without pants.

Genesis 39:19

And it was, when his lord heard his wife’s words that she spoke to him, saying, “Your servant did things like these to me,” that his anger flared.

ተቱ ሃጊጎላቱ ዐሣሠጎ ጊጻጊሃ
ጻላጻላ ላሠቱ ሃተሠቱ ጊጻጻላ
ሠጊጻጻላጎ ላሠቅረ ሃጊረቱ
ሃላጻዐ ጊረ ጻሠዐ ጻረቱጻ
ሃገቱ ላይጊሃ

He’s mad.

Genesis 39:20

And Joseph’s lord took him and put him in prison, a place where the king’s prisoners were kept. And he was there in the prison,

ሃተቱ ገቹሃጊ ጊጎላቱ ዘዋጊሃ
ላጻቹጻ ተጊጎ ረቱ ሃጻጎተጊሃ
[ጊላጊቹቱ] ላሠቱ ሠሃዋሠ
ሠጊላሃቹቱ ሃረሠጻ (ጊላሃቹቱ)
ላጻቹጻ ተጊጎጎ ሠሠ ጊጻጊሃ

Qere Ketiv.

He puts Joseph in jail.

Genesis 39:21

and YHWH was with Joseph and extended kindness to him and gave him favor in the eyes of the warden.

ገዢው ተቀ ያሳደገ ገደብ
ሃተገሃ ልቶይ ሃገረቀ ፀገሃ
ተገዳ ላሠ ገሃገዐዳ ሃገይ
ላዳቶ

YHWH goes to jail too, to help out.

He makes the guy who runs the jail like Joseph.

Genesis 39:22

And the warden put all the prisoners who were in the prison into Joseph’s hand, and he was doing all the things that they do there.

ላዳቶ ተገዳ ላሠ ሃተገሃ
ረሃ ተቀ ገዢው ልገዳ
ተገዳዳ ላሠቀ ሣላገቶቀ
ላሠቀ ረሃ ተቀሃ ላዳቶ
ዳገዳ ቀሃዳ ሣሠ ሣገሠዐ
ዳሠዐ

So suddenly he’s in charge of the jail!

He’s in charge of all the prisoners now.

Note: He was also “doing all the things that they do there.”

Genesis 39:23

The warden was not seeing anything in his hand because YHWH was with him, and YHWH would make whatever he did successful.

ዳቀላ ላዳቶ ተገዳ ላሠ ሃገረቀ
ሃላገዳ ዳሣላቀሣ ረሃ ተቀ
ላሠቀሃ ሃተቀ ያሳደገ ላሠቀዳ
ይገረሣሣ ያሳደገ ዳሠዐ ቀሃዳ

The warden had no idea what he was up to, because YHWH was there helping out.³³³

³³³YHWH’s often pictured as “a pillar of cloud” in Exodus, so maybe that’s why the warden couldn’t see anything.

Genesis 40

Genesis 40:1

And it was, after these things, the drink-steward of the king of Egypt and the baker sinned against their lord, against the king of Egypt.

ሃገገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ
ሃሃ ገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ
ሃገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገ

Ok so the king’s wine guy and the bread guy were bad.

Genesis 40:2

And Pharaoh was angry at his two officers, at the chief of the drink-stewards and at the chief of the bakers,

ገገ ገገገ ገገገገ
ገገ ገገ ገገገገገ ገገገ
ገገ ገገ ገገ ገገገገገ
ገገገ

The king’s mad at the wine guy and the bread guy.

Note: That wasn’t the king in the previous scene, that was Potiphar.

Now is the first time we’re hearing about the king.³³⁴

Genesis 40:3

and he put them under watch at the house of the chief of the guards, into prison, the place where Joseph was held.

ገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ
ገገ ገገ ገገገገገ ገገ
ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገገ
ገገ ገገገገ

He puts them in the jail Joseph got thrown in and now runs.

Genesis 40:4

And the chief of the guards assigned Joseph with them, and he attended them. And they were under watch for days.

ገገ ገገገገገ ገገ ገገገገገ
ገገገ ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገ
ገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገገ

Joseph’s in charge of the wine and bread guy.

³³⁴Since the Abraham entrapment scene back in Gen. 12.

Genesis 40:5

And the two of them had a dream, each his own dream, in one night, each with his own dream's meaning, the drink-steward and the baker whom the king of Egypt had, who were held in the prison.

ሃጻጸጎሠ ሠነ/ፀ ነሠ/ፀጸኒ
ፈፀፋ ላ/ጸ/ጸ ነሠ/ፀ ሠጸፋ
ነሠ/ፀ ጎነጻጸጎሃ ሠጸፋ
ጻሠፋ ጸጸፋጸኒ ጸጸሠሣፋ
ጻሠፋ ሠጸጻጸሣ ሃ/ሠ/ፀ
ጻፋፋፋ ጸጸጸጸ ሠጸጻጻፋፋ

And the two of them had a dream.^{335 336 337 338}

Christ who wrote this sentence?

Genesis 40:6

And Joseph came to them in the morning and saw them, and here they were upset.

ገፆነጸ ሃጻጸ/ፋ ፋጸጸኒ
ሣፋፋ ነሠፋ ፋጸጸኒ ጻጸጸጸ
ሣጸጸጸጸ

Joseph comes to them.

Turns out they're upset.

Genesis 40:7

And he asked Pharaoh's officers who were with him under watch at his lord's house, saying, "Why are your faces bad today?"

ጸፆጸጸጸ ጸፋ ለፋሠጸኒ
ጻሣሠሣጸ ነሠፋ ጻሠፋ ጸጸጸጸ
ጸነፈሣ ጻሣፋ/ ነጸጸፈፋ ጸጸጸ
ሣነጸፋ ሣጸጸጸ ሣሣጸጸጸ

So he asks the bread and wine guy "What's wrong?"

Apparently the answer is not "We're in jail dumbass."

Genesis 40:8

And they said to him, "We had a dream, and there's no one who can tell the meaning of it." And Joseph said to them, "Don't meanings belong to God? Tell me."

ሣነ/ፀ ነጸ/ፋ ነጻሣፋጸኒ
ነሠፋ ጎጸፋ ጻጸጸኒ ነሣሠ/ፀ
ገፆነጸ ሃጻ/ፋ ጻሣፋጸኒ
ሣጸጸጸጸጸ ሣጸፋ/ፋ/ ፋነ/ፋ
ጸ/ ፋጸ ነጻጸፆ

³³⁵Wasn't like a shared dream. They each had their own one. Just to clarify.

³³⁶Also the dream only lasted one night. It wasn't like a multipart drama.

³³⁷The dreams meant different things.

³³⁸We're still talking about the bread and wine guy by the way.

They’re like,

We had a dream.³³⁹

And no one can tell us what it means.

So Joseph’s like “Tell me. Just know in advance that whatever I tell you is God’s thoughts not mine.”

Genesis 40:9

And the chief of the drink-stewards told his dream to Joseph, and he said to him, “In my dream: And here was a vine in front of me,

ሣጊዋሠሣ፤ ላሠ ላጋቾጊኛ
ላሣፋጊኛ ጋቾኖጊ ስሣገፀ ጸፋ
ንጋገ ጃሃፋኛ ጊሣኖገፀ ስገ
ጊሃገገ

The wine guy, unsurprisingly, dreamed about a wine plant.

Genesis 40:10

and in the vine were three branches, and it was like it was blooming: its blossom came up; its clusters produced grapes.

ሣገጊላሠ ጃሠገሠ ንጋገጊኛ
ፋሣጋ ጃጸገፀ ጸፀጋጋሃ ፋኖፋኛ
ጃጊጸገሃሠፋ ስገጊሠጊፋ
ሣጊጊጋፀ

It had three branches.

There were grapes.

Standard wine guy dream.

Genesis 40:11

And Pharaoh’s cup was in my hand. And I took the grapes and pressed them into Pharaoh’s cup and set the cup on Pharaoh’s hand.”

ፀዋፋኛ ጊፋጊጊ ጃፀጋጋ ቾኖሃኛ
ሣጸፋ ፀፀሠፋኛ ሣጊጊጋፀ፤ ጸፋ
ጸፋ ጋጸፋኛ ጃፀጋጋ ቾኖሃ ገፋ
ጃፀጋጋ ጋሃ ገፀ ቾኖሃ፤

Then there’s a cup.

It was the cup of his former boss, before jail.

He makes grape juice for boss man.

³³⁹Separate ones.

Genesis 40:12

And Joseph said to him, “This is its meaning: The three branches, they’re three days.

ᐱᐭ ᐱᐅᐱᐭ ᐱᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ

Joseph’s like “Ok let’s get started with those meanings that belong to God.”

1. Branches are days.

Genesis 40:13

In three more days Pharaoh will lift your head up, and he’ll put you back at your station, and you’ll set Pharaoh’s cup in his hand—like the original manner when you were his drink-steward.

ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭ

Three branches from now, you’ll get your job back.³⁴⁰

Genesis 40:14

So if you’ll remember me with you when it will be good for you, and you’ll practice kindness with me, then you’ll bring up the memory of me to Pharaoh, and you’ll bring me out of this house.

ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ
ᐱᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐱᐭᐭᐭ

So if my prediction comes true, put in a good word for me with the boss man ok?

Genesis 40:15

Because I was stolen from the land of the Hebrews; and here, too, I haven’t done anything that they should have put me in the pit.”

ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭ ᐱᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭ

I’m innocent.

³⁴⁰He’s in charge of the jail. Can’t he just let him go?

People keep putting me in pits.

Two so far.

It started back in this place called Two Pits.³⁴¹

Genesis 40:16

And the chief of the bakers saw that he told a good meaning, and he said to Joseph, “Me, too. In my dream: And here were three baskets of white bread on my head,

ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣ

So bread man jumps on the bandwagon and goes,
“Hey me too! Three bread units.”

Genesis 40:17

and in the highest basket were some of all of Pharaoh’s foods, baked goods. And the birds were eating them from the basket, from on my head.”

ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣ ṣṣṣ ṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣ

And it was the kings bread container too.

And there were these birds and there was bread on my head it was a whole thing.

When job?

Genesis 40:18

And Joseph answered, and he said, “This is its meaning: The three baskets, they’re three days.

ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣṣ
ṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ ṣṣṣṣ

Joseph’s like “Ok, the three things? They’re days again.”

³⁴¹Some manuscripts substitute Four Shadowing.

Genesis 40:19

In three more days Pharaoh will lift your head up from you, and he'll hang you on a tree, and the birds will eat your flesh from you."

ፋወን ሣንሣን ጸወ/ወ ልባዕ
ሣን/ዐሣ ሃወፋፃ ጸፋ ጸዐፃ
/ሃፋ፣ ጦዐ /ዐ ሃጸ፣ፋ ጸ/ጸ፣
ሣን/ዐሣ ሃፃወፃ ጸፋ ገባዐ

Except you're gonna die.

He's gonna hang your ass from a tree and those birds are gonna eat your flesh off.

Genesis 40:20

And it was in the third day, Pharaoh's birthday, and Pharaoh made a feast for all his servants. And he held up the head of the chief of the drink-stewards and the head of the chief of the bakers among his servants.

ጌወን/ወፋ ሣባንፃ ጌፋን፣
ጸዐፃ ጸፋ ጸፋ/ፋ ሣባ
ባንፋፃዐ /ሃ/ ጸጸወሣ ወዐን፣
ፃወ ወፋፃ ጸፋ ፋወን፣
ፃወ ወፋፃ ጸፋ፣ ሣንፆወሣ፣
ባንፋፃዐ ሃባጸፃ ሣንገፋ፣

(Narrator: Three b-units later.)

King's having a birthday party.

There's a big dinner.

He invites the wine and bread guy.

Genesis 40:21

And he put the chief of the drink-stewards back over his stewardship, and he set the cup on Pharaoh's hand;

ሣንፆወሣ፣ ፃወ ጸፋ ገወን፣
ቅባሃ፣ ገጸን፣ ባፋፆወሣ /ዐ
ጸዐፃ ገሃ /ዐ

Wine guy gets his job back.

Genesis 40:22

and he hanged the chief of the
bakers—as Joseph had told the
meaning for them.

እረጽ ሣጊጋፋጃ ዓሠ ጸፋፋ
ገብኖጊ ሣእረ ዓጸገ ዓሠፋሃ

And bread guy gets hanged and dies.

Genesis 40:23

And the chief of the
drink-stewards did not
remember Joseph. And he forgot
him.

ሣጊዋሠሣጃ ዓሠ ዓሁጋ ፋረፋ
ፋጃፀሃሠጊፋ ገብኖጊ ጸፋ

Wine guy forgets that he owes Joseph for this.

Genesis 41

Genesis 41:1

And it was at the end of two years' time, and Pharaoh was dreaming: and here he was standing by the Nile.

ሦረዳሠ ጠዋሂ ጌጃጊ፣
ጃጃ፣ ሃሪዕ ጃዐገ፣ ሦረሂጊ
ፃፋጊ ራዐ ልሃዐ

(Narrator: Two years later.)

The king's having a dream.

He's out by the river.

Genesis 41:2

And here, coming up from the Nile, were seven cows, beautiful-looking and fat-fleshed, and they fed in the reeds.

ዳራ ፃፋጊ ሂሂ ጃጃ፣
ጃፋሂ ጸፎጊ ጸፍገ ዐግሠ
ጃጊዐፃ፣ ፃሠግ ጸፋጊግ፣
፣ዕፋግ

He sees a bible number of cows.

Seven this time.

Fat as a cow, they were.

Genesis 41:3

And here were seven other cows coming up after them from the Nile, bad-looking and thin-fleshed, and they stood by the cows that were by the bank of the Nile.

ጸፍዕፋ ጸፍገ ዐግሠ ጃጃ፣
ፃፋጊ ሂሂ ሂጃጊዕፋ ጸፋራ
ፃሠግ ጸፍዐፋ ጃፋሂ ጸዐፃ
ጸፍገ፣ ራፋ ጃፋሂዐ፣
ፃፋጊ ጸሃ ራዐ

Then there's seven skinny ones.

They come stand by the good cows, uninvited.

Genesis 41:4

And the bad-looking and thin-fleshed cows ate the seven beautiful-looking and fat cows—and Pharaoh woke up.

ጸዐፃ ጸፍገ፣ ጃፋሂፋ፣
ጸፋ ፃሠግ፣ ጸዐፋ፣ ጃፋሂ፣
ጃፋሂ፣ ጸጊጊ ጸፍገ፣ ዐግሠ
ጃዐገ ጠዋጊጊ፣ ጸፋጊግ፣

Then the skinny ones eat the fat ones.

Cuz obviously.

They were hungry.

The king wakes up with a start.

Genesis 41:5

And he slept and dreamed a second time, and here were seven ears of grain coming up on one stalk, fat and good.

አገሩ ሃይለኛ ገሠገሰ
እነሱ ሃገሪኛ ዐገሠ ጭጭ
እነፋገግ ልዩ ጭፃ
እነግፀኛ

Back to bed.

Second dream.

There’s a bible number of things again.

Seven again.

This time it’s a bread plant.

With seven breadsticks.

Genesis 41:6

And here were seven ears of grain, thin and scorched by the east wind, growing after them.

ሃገሪኛ ዐገሠ ጭጭ
ሃገረዋ እገፋው እነዋረደ
ገጭጭዬ እየዘሩ

Then there’s seven other breadsticks.

They’re burnt.

Genesis 41:7

And the thin ears of grain swallowed the seven fat and full ears of grain—and Pharaoh woke up, and here it was a dream.

ሃገሪኛን ጭጭና
ዐገሠ ጭጭ እነዋረደ
እነፋገግን ሃገሪኛን
ጭጭ ጭጭን እነፋረሃን
ሃይለኛ ጭጭ

The bad breadsticks eat the good ones.

Pharaoh wakes up again in a cold sweat.

And here it was a dream.

Genesis 41:8

And it was in the morning, and his spirit was moved, and he sent and called all of Egypt's magicians and all its wise men. And Pharaoh told them his dream, and there was no one who could tell the meaning of them to Pharaoh.

የዘዋዋሪ ሕገጽ ሰዓሪ ገደብ
 ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ
 ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ
 ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ
 ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ
 ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ

Pharaoh's scared.

He calls *all the magicians in the country*.

Also all the wise guys.

Nobody knows what it means, and no one's willing to guess.

Genesis 41:9

And the chief of the drink-stewards spoke to Pharaoh, saying, "I'm recalling my sins today:

ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ

The wi(n/s)e guy is like "Hey remember when I was bad?"

Genesis 41:10

Pharaoh had been angry at his servants, and he put me under watch at the house of the chief of the guards, me and the chief of the bakers.

የገደብ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ

"And you put me in jail with that (d+br)ead guy?"

Genesis 41:11

And we had a dream in one night, I and he; we each dreamed with his own dream's meaning.

የገደብ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ
 ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ ሕገጽ

"Well back then, we had a dream!"³⁴²

³⁴²There was a brief conversation here clarifying some issues, which we've omitted for brevity.

Genesis 41:12

And there, with us, was a Hebrew boy, a slave of the chief of the guards; and we told him, and he told us the meaning of our dreams. He told the meaning according to each one’s dream.

ᐃᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑦᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭ

“There was this Jew too.

One of Potiphar’s guys.

He told us what the dreams meant.

And now the other guy is wicked (d+br)ead just like he said.”

Genesis 41:13

And it was—as he told the meaning for us, so it was: me he put back at my station, and him he hanged.”

ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ

“I got my job back, and he’s toast.”

Genesis 41:14

And Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they rushed him from the pit, and he shaved and changed his clothing and came to Pharaoh.

ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ
ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭ ᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭᑭ

So Pharaoh makes some calls and they pull Joseph out of the pit.³⁴³

They give him a makeover³⁴⁴ and bring him to the king.

Genesis 41:15

³⁴³The pit is the jail. Jails were different back then.

³⁴⁴He’s been in the pit for a couple years.

And Pharaoh said to Joseph,
“I’ve had a dream, and there’s no
one who can tell the meaning of
it, and I’ve heard about you,
saying you hear a dream so as to
tell the meaning of it.”

ገብረ ለቅ ላዕገ ሳህቲ
ኃገቅ ሳኃገገ ገረሃ/ፀ ሣገ/ፀ
ሃገ/ፀ ገረሃሠ ገረሃገ ገረሃ
ሳኃ/ ሣገ/ፀ ዐሃሠ ሳህቲ
ገረሃ

The Pharaoh’s like “I’ve had a dream. I hear you’re dreamy.”

Genesis 41:16

And Joseph answered Pharaoh,
saying, “Not I. God will answer
regarding Pharaoh’s well-being.”

ላዕገ ለቅ ገብረ ኃገገ
ሣገላ/ፀ ገረሃ/ፀ ሳህቲ
ላዕገ ሣገ/ፀ ለቅ ላዕገ

Joseph’s give him the “It’s not me it’s God, but I can talk to him for you”
line again.³⁴⁵

Genesis 41:17

And Pharaoh spoke to Joseph,
“In my dream, here I was
standing by the bank of the Nile.

ገብረ ለቅ ላዕገ ሳህቲ
ፀ ሳሃ ዐሃገ ገረሃ/ፀ
ሳህቲ ሳሃ

He’s like “I was by the river.”

Genesis 41:18

And here, coming up from the
Nile, were seven cows, fat-fleshed
and beautiful-figured, and they
fed in the reeds.

ሳሃ ሳህቲ ኃሃ ላዕገ
ሳሃ ሳህቲ ሳሃ ዐሃ
ሳሃገ ሳሃ ሳሃ ሳሃ
ፀ

He explains the cows.

Genesis 41:19

³⁴⁵ A well known trick between monarchs and their viziers, see also Dan 2:27–30 and Ala 1:05:22; timestamps vary between manuscripts.

And here were seven other cows coming up after them, weak and very bad-figured and scrawny-fleshed. I haven't seen any like these in all the land of Egypt for bad!

xfi9d4 xfi9 09w 3y3i
 xfi6 7329d4 xfi0
 xfi99i 44y 94x xfi09i
 3y3y 2x249 46 9w9
 096 429m4 m94 6y9

And the other cows.

Bible note: in the thing about the cows and the thing about the breadsticks, it appears that the scribal bible people who copied these books by hand for all those years before Gutenberg repeatedly confused the letters D and R in Hebrew, since they looked like א and ר in paleo-Hebrew, ד and ר in Aramaic, and ד and ר in the modern Aramaic-derived square script that we call Hebrew for some reason.

Consult the following chart for examples of the Dalet/Resh phenomenon in this and the surrounding chapters.

Verse	Hebrew	Consonants	Meaning
41:3	דָּקוֹת בָּשָׂר	D-Q	“thin-fleshed” cows
41:4	דָּקוֹת הַבָּשָׂר	D-Q	“thin-fleshed” cows
41:6	דָּקוֹת	D-Q	“thin” ears of grain
41:7	הַדָּקוֹת	D-Q	“the thin” ears of grain
41:19	רָקוֹת בָּשָׂר	R-Q	“scrawny-fleshed” cows
41:20	הַרָקוֹת	R-Q	“the scrawny” cows
41:23	דָּקוֹת	D-Q	“thin” ears of grain
41:24	הַדָּקוֹת	D-Q	“the thin” ears of grain
41:27	הַרָקוֹת	R-Q	“the scrawny” cows
41:27	הַרְקוֹת	R-Q	“the empty/scrawny” ears of grain

Genesis 41:20

**And the cows that were scrawny
and bad ate the first seven cows
that were fat,**

xif99≡ xif97≡ 37/54xif
 xif97≡ 09w x4 xif09≡ f
 x4299≡ xif9w49≡

The hungry cows ate the tasty cows.

Genesis 41:21

and they came inside, and it wasn't known that they had come inside! And their appearance was bad, as at first. And I woke up.

469 37999 64 3749x9
 37999 64 949 27 0499
 9w4y 09 7324949
 37249 3649

Then they came inside and nobody knew and then he woke up.

Genesis 41:22

“And I saw in my dream, and here were seven ears of grain coming up on one stalk, full and good.

ዐገወ ሕጎች ገረገጠ ደግሞ
ጠቅ ሕጎች ጸ/ዐ ሕገገወ
ጸገግፀፍ ጸቅሕ

Seven fluffy breadsticks.

Genesis 41:23

And here were seven ears of grain, dried up, thin, scorched by the east wind, growing after them.

ገጠ ሕገገወ ዐገወ ሕጎች
ሕገጠዎ ጸገገጠ ጸገጠ ጸገሕ
ሕገገጠ ጸገገጠ ጸገገጠ

Seven burned breadsticks.

Genesis 41:24

And the thin ears of grain swallowed the seven good ears of grain. “And I said it to the magicians, and there’s no one who can tell me.”

ጸገጠ ሕገገወ ጸገገጠ
ሕገገወ ዐገወ ጸ
ገጠ ሕገ ጸገገጠ ጸገጠ
ገገ ጸገገ ጸገገ ሕገገጠ

Then the breadsticks ate the breadsticks and it was scary and the magicians are confused.

Genesis 41:25

And Joseph said to Pharaoh, “Pharaoh’s dream: it is one. It has told to Pharaoh what God is doing.

ሕገገ ሕገ ጸገገጠ ጸገገጠ
ጸገጠ ጸገጠ ሕገገ ሕገገ
ሕገገ ሕገገ ጸገጠ ጸገጠ
ሕገገ ጸገጠ

So Joseph’s like “they’re the same dream.”

He gives them the old:

1. $A = B$
2. Both A and B are God talking to you, not to me.
3. Go figure it out you’re the special one not me.³⁴⁶

³⁴⁶Cf. Daniel 2:46-49.

Genesis 41:26

The seven good cows: they’re seven years. And the seven good ears of grain: they’re seven years. It’s one dream.

ዐገወ ጸግፎታ ጸግጋ ዐገወ
ዐገወኛ ቅኑታ ሣጊኑወ
ዐገወ ጸግፎታ ሣጊሪወታ
ፈፀኑ ሣኖሪፀ ቅኑታ ሣጊኑወ
ፋኖታ

All the stuff is years.

And cows are breadsticks.

Genesis 41:27

And the seven cows that were scrawny and bad that were coming up after them: they’re seven years. And the seven ears of grain that were scrawny, scorched by the east wind, will be seven years of famine.

ጸኖዋታ ጸኖጋታ ዐገወኛ
ኅታጊዓፀኑ ጸሪዐታ ጸዐግታኛ
ዐገወኛ ቅኑታ ሣጊኑወ ዐገወ
ጸኖጋወ ጸኖዋታ ሣጊሪወታ
ዐገወ ኖጊታጊ ሣጊፈዋታ
ጋዐግ ጊኑወ

Bad cows are bad years.

Bad breadsticks are bad years.

Food with problems means problems with food.

Genesis 41:28

That is the thing that I spoke to Pharaoh: it has shown Pharaoh what God is doing.

ጊጸግጋፈ ዓወኑ ግጋፈታ ፋኖታ
ሣጊታሪኑታ ዓወኑ ቅዐግጋ ሪኑ
ቅዐግጋ ጸኑ ቅፋዓታ ቅወዐ

That’s the deal.

That’s what God’s up to.

Genesis 41:29

Here, seven years are coming: big bountifulness in all the land of Egypt.

ጸኖፋጋ ሣጊኑወ ዐገወ ቅኑታ
ጦዓኑ ሪኃጋ ሪኖፈገ ዐገወ
ሣጊዓጦሣ

In summary, the next seven years you’ll have food with no problems, which as we saw above means no problems with food.

Genesis 41:30

And seven years of famine will rise after them, and all the bountifulness in the land of Egypt will be forgotten, and the famine will finish off the land.

ገደግ ጊዜ ወገወ የሕይወት
ረቃ ዘመንና ገንዘብ
ሕይወት ገንዘብ ወገወ
ገንዘብ ጽፍ ገደግ ገንዘብ

After that, seven years of problem food.

Genesis 41:31

And the bountifulness won't be known in the land on account of that famine afterwards because it will be very heavy.

ገንዘብ ወገወ ወገወ ጽፍ
ገንዘብ ጽፍ ገደግ ገንዘብ
ጽፍ ጽፍ ጽፍ ገንዘብ

People will forget about the good times because those cows are in the past and they're hungry now because bread problems, any questions?

Genesis 41:32

And about the recurrence of the dream to Pharaoh two times: because the thing is right from God, and God is hurrying to do it.

ረቃ ሕይወት ጽፍ ገንዘብ
ገንዘብ ገንዘብ ገንዘብ ገንዘብ
ሕይወት ገንዘብ ገንዘብ
ገንዘብ ገንዘብ ገንዘብ

You dreaming it twice means it's coming soon.

Number equals velocity in dream space.

Genesis 41:33

And now, let Pharaoh look out for an understanding and wise man and set him over the land of Egypt.

ሕይወት ገንዘብ ገንዘብ ገንዘብ
ገንዘብ ገንዘብ ገንዘብ ገንዘብ
ሕይወት ገንዘብ ገንዘብ

You should really find a wise guy to help out with all that.

Genesis 41:34

Let Pharaoh do it and appoint overseers over the land and five-out the land of Egypt in the seven years of bountifulness.

ᐱᑭᑭᑦᑦ ᐱᑭᑦ ᐱᑭᑦᑦ
ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑭᑦᑦ
ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᑭᑦᑦ ᑦᑦ
ᑭᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦ

You should pick a team to plan ahead during the first seven good cows.
Have them five-out³⁴⁷ the land.

Genesis 41:35

And let them gather all the food of these coming good years and pile up grain under Pharaoh’s hand, food in the cities, and watch over it.

ᐱᑦᑦ ᐱᑦ ᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ
ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦ ᐱᑦᑦ ᐱᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ

Should probably save some cows for when the cows come.

Genesis 41:36

And the food will become a deposit for the land for the seven years of famine that will be in the land of Egypt so the land won’t be cut off in the famine.”

ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ

Like a savings accownt.

Genesis 41:37

And the thing was good in Pharaoh’s eyes and in all his servants’ eyes.

ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ
ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦ ᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦᑦ ᐱᑦᑦᑦ

The king agreed.

³⁴⁷No one knows what this means.

Genesis 41:38

And Pharaoh said to his servants, “Will we find such a man as this, that God’s spirit is in him?”

የጌላም ራክ ጸዕግ ሰሣቶቻ
ሠጊኑ ጸጋሃ ፋጢሣን፤
ነገ ሣጊጻራክ ዘነፃ ሰሠኑ

Pharaoh looks around *like an absolute cartoon* going

“Where are we gonna find a guy like *that*?”

Starting to see why Joseph had such an easy time getting put in charge of everything.

Genesis 41:39

And Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Since God has made you know all this, there’s no one as understanding and wise as you.

ገጅነጌ ራክ ጸዕግ ሰሣቶቻ
ሣጊጻራክ ዐጌላኛ ጌፃዘኑ
ገጌኑ ጸፋጋ ራሃ ጸፋ ሃጸኛ
ሃኖሣሃ ሣሃዘነ ገነጋጋ

Then Pharaoh’s like,

“I have an idea...

Why don’t You be the guy!”

I picture all the advisors giving some gentle applause here.

Genesis 41:40

You shall be over my house, and at your mouth all my people shall conform. I shall be greater than you only in the throne.”

ጌጸጊጋ ራዐ ጸጊጻጸ ጸጸኑ
ጌሣዐ ራሃ ዋሠጌ ሃጊጎ ራዐኛ
ሃሣሣ ራላገኑ ፋጅሃ፤ ዋፃ

Yeah. And I’ll put you in charge of my house!

And everybody will do what you say!

I’ll only be higher status as sort of a formal thing.³⁴⁸

Like a figurehead!^{349 350}

³⁴⁸He. Did. Not. Say. This.

³⁴⁹This is Ala 1:05:22.

³⁵⁰REF: conform. The verb here, which usually means “to kiss,” is a problem for all translators. It may reflect a scribal problem or an idiom that is no longer familiar to us. Or the magic stick is making him say it.

Genesis 41:41

And Pharaoh said to Joseph,
“See, I’ve put you over all the
land of Egypt.”

ገብረኛ ለፋ ለዐገ ገሣፋን
ሪ ሪ ሃጻፋ ጊጸጸ ላፋ
ሂገጸሃ ጸገፋ

The vizier now runs the kingdom.

Genesis 41:42

And Pharaoh took off his ring
from his hand and put it on
Joseph’s hand, and he had him
dressed in linen garments, and
he set a gold chain on his neck,

፻፳፱ ጸፋ ላዐገ ገብረኛ
ሪ ላጸፋ ሃጸኛ ፻፳ ሪሃ
፻ፋ ሠገረኛ ገብረኛ ፳
፳፱ ሂሠኛ ሠሠ ጊ፳፱
፻ፋ፻ ሪ ገፋጊ

The Pharaoh gives him the ring off his hand, and some fancy royal clothes
and some gold.

Remember, all this is because he said cows are years.

Genesis 41:43

and he had him driven in the
chariot of the
second-in-command whom he
had, and they called in front of
him, “Kneel,” so putting him
over all the land of Egypt.

ጸገሃሃ ፻ፋ ገሃገኛ
፻ፋ፱ገኛ ፻ ላሠፋ ላሃሠሃ
፻ፋ ሃ፻ጸ፻ ሃገፋ ፻ገገሪ
ሂገጸሃ ጸገፋ ሪ ሪ

Then the king gives him the vice-president’s car.

And he drives around the kingdom with guys shouting “Kneel” at people
on the street.^{351 352 353}

³⁵¹The word translated “Kneel” here is אֲבֹרֶךְ. Nobody knows what it means, but it is often translated as “kneel,” due to 1. context 2. some Rabbinic interpretations, and 3. similarity to the word בֵּרַךְ, which means both “to kneel” and “to bless.”

³⁵²It’s the word from that “I won’t let you go until you בֵּרַךְ me” scene, spoken by Jacob (or maybe his unidentified night wrestling partner) right at the end before he (who?) בֵּרַךְ him. Welcome to the bible. It’s wild in here.

³⁵³Despite the common claim that *abrek* is Egyptian for ‘kneel,’ the required Egyptian verb *brk ‘kneel’ is unattested, and the initial *a-* is morphologically suspect. The resemblance is actually stronger within Semitic: Hebrew itself has BRK ‘kneel/make kneel,’ while Syriac *’abrek* and Arabic *’abraka* mean ‘make kneel.’ The term may simply be a Hebrew speaking author dressing up a Semitic root to sound foreign.

Genesis 41:44

And Pharaoh said to Joseph, “I am Pharaoh, and without you a man won’t lift his hand and his foot in all the land of Egypt.”

ገብሩ ለኔ ለዓገ ለሃፋጊ
ኔ ሃገረሰብ ለዓገ ገሃ
ኣኣ ስላገ ኣኣ ሠገሃ ሃገገ
ሃገገጣሃ ጠገኣ ለገ ስገገ

Pharaoh’s like “I am Pharaoh.”

Then he says nobody’s allowed to walk or do hand stuff anymore without Joseph.

Genesis 41:45

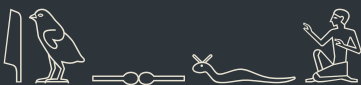
And Pharaoh called Joseph’s name Zaphenathpaneah. And he gave him Asenath, daughter of Potiphra, priest of On, as a wife. And Joseph went out over the land of Egypt.

ገብሩ ሃሠ ለዓገ ኣገዋጊ
ኣኣ ስ ገኣጊ ስገገ ኣገገጠ
ገኣሃ ዐገ ገጸገ ኣገ ኣገገኣ
ገብሩ ኣጠጊ ለሠኣ ገኣ
ሃገገጣሃ ጠገኣ ለዐ

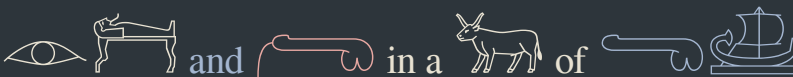
Pharaoh renames Joseph to some gibberish.

So the king’s like:

Welcome to Egypt, your name will no longer be



but rather



Perhaps why this renaming event is less well-remembered than the Abraham and Jacob ones.³⁵⁵

³⁵⁴Lit. “Lord Joseph of the seven cows and seven breads [sic], who sees dreams, and came in a time of hardship.” The ordering of signs in the original is roughly compara-

ble with the order in the translation, with the exception of the honorific term , meaning Lord, and pronounced /ze:ra/, suspiciously similar to that word for the “seed” (Heb. זרע) that’s YHWH (aka, the LORD) is always going on about.

³⁵⁵Isaac didn’t need a new name, his name was already funny.

He also gives him a free wife.

Joseph goes out to explore this new country he sort of conquered.

To reiterate, all this is because he said cows are years.

Genesis 41:46

And Joseph was thirty years old when he stood in front of Pharaoh, king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from in front of Pharaoh and passed through all the land of Egypt.

וַיֹּסֶף בֶּן שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה
בְּעֹמְדוֹ לִפְנֵי פַרְעֹה
מֶלֶךְ מִצְרַיִם וַיֵּצֵא יוֹסֵף
מִלִּפְנֵי פַרְעֹה וַיַּעֲבֹר
בְּכָל אֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם׃

He was thirty at the time.

Joseph explores the country again.

Genesis 41:47

And the land produced in the seven years of bountifulness by fistfuls.

וַיֵּצֵא מִצְרַיִם וַיֵּבֶר
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ

They had a fistful of bread for the first seven cows.

Genesis 41:48

And he gathered all the food of the seven years, which were in the land of Egypt, and he put food in cities; he put the food of the city's fields that were around it inside of it.

וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף
וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף
וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף
וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף
וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף
וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף
וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף וַיִּגְדֹּף

He stores it up in savings.

He puts it in the cities.

Genesis 41:49

And Joseph piled up grain like the sand of the sea, very much, until he stopped counting, because it was without number.

וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ
וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ וַיִּבְרֹךְ

There was infinity number of bread.

Genesis 41:50

And two sons were born to Joseph before the year of famine came—to whom Asenath, daughter of Potiphera, priest of On, gave birth for him.

ሦ፯ኛና ሦ፱ኛ ልጆች ስለገኙት
ፍጥነት ዓመት ፊት ለፊት ሆኖ
አገሩን ለጥፋት ስራ ለፍጥነት ሰጠው
ነበሩት ምንም ዓይነት ጥፋት

Joseph and his two kids come before the famine does.

Genesis 41:51

And Joseph called the firstborn's name Manasseh, “because God has made me forget all of my trouble and all of my father's house.”

ሦስተኛው ልጁ ስለሆነው ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን

He does the Rachel/Leah pun thing.

Manasseh means... I forget.

Genesis 41:52

And he called the second one's name Ephraim, “because God has made me fruitful in the land of my degradation.”

ሦስተኛው ልጁ ስሜን ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን

He names the second son fruitful.

Genesis 41:53

And the seven years of the bountifulness that was in the land of Egypt finished,

ሦስተኛው ዓመት ስሜን ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን
ሰጠው ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን ስሜን

The good times end.

Genesis 41:54

and the seven years of famine started to come, as Joseph had said. And there was famine in all the lands, and in all the land of Egypt there was bread.

ጊዜው ዐምስ ሳምንት ወርህ
የሕዝቡ የግዴታ ስሜት ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
ሕይወት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ ስለነበረ

The famine comes.

No one has food.

Except for Egypt.

Because of Joseph.

Thanks Joseph.

Genesis 41:55

And all the land of Egypt hungered, and the people cried to Pharaoh for the bread, and Pharaoh said to all Egypt, “Go to Joseph. Do what he’ll tell you.”

ሕይወት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ

Nevermind everyone’s starving.

The king is basically retired at this point.

People ask him for stuff and he’s like “I dunno, ask Joe.”

Genesis 41:56

And the famine was on all the face of the earth. And Joseph opened everything that was in them and sold to Egypt. And the famine was strong in the land of Egypt.

ጊዜው ስለነበረ ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ
የዓለም ስሜት ስለነበረ ስለነበረ

Ok everyone on earth is starving.

So Joseph opens up the food reserves and sells them at a profit to the citizens of the country he’s somehow in charge of.³⁵⁶

³⁵⁶This is the actual bible.

Genesis 41:57

And all the earth came to Egypt
to buy, to Joseph, because the
famine was strong in all the
earth.

ἰᾶς ἡγὰρ ἔσθ
ἔκ ἡγῶν ἁγῶν
ἡγῶν ἡγῶν ἡγῶν
ἡγῶν ἡγῶν

Then he sells the rest at a profit to all the nations.³⁵⁷

³⁵⁷Lit. goyim.

Genesis 42

Genesis 42:1

And Jacob saw that there was grain in Egypt, and Jacob said to his sons, “Why do you look at each other?”

ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭ ᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱ
ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᑭᐱᐱ ᐱᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᐱᐱ

Now meanwhile, Jacob's up in Canaan starving with the other eleven sons who sold Joseph into slavery back in Gen 37.

He hears that there's food down in Egypt.

So he turns to his sons and he's like "Are you just gonna sit around here staring at each other?"

Genesis 42:2

And he said, “Here I’ve heard that there’s grain in Egypt. Go down there and buy grain for us from there, and we’ll live and not die.”

27 2+07W 373 97424
 449 729779 99W WZ
 7W7 97L 999W4 37W
 +477 4L4 32874

He's like "There's food in Egypt! Go buy some so we can, you know, live. And not die."

Genesis 42:3

And ten of Joseph's brothers went
down to buy grain from Egypt,

ጸሐፊው ገብረ ገብረ ሃይለማርያም
ሃይለማርያም ሃይለማርያም

Ten go.

Genesis 42:4

and Jacob did not send Joseph's brother Benjamin with his brothers because, he said, "In case some harm will happen to him."

[illegible]

Jacob keeps his son Ben because he's the last bit of Rachel he has left, and he doesn't trust those other ten fuckers because last time he sent them on a trip they lost Joe.

Genesis 42:5

And the sons of Israel came to buy among those who were coming, because the famine was in the land of Canaan.

ለፋግጠን ጊዜ የፋግጊኖ
ሣጊፋግጃ ሃየጸግ ሳግጠ
ጠግፋግ ምግጃ ጃጊጃ ጊሃ
ጎግሃ

They go down to buy food.

Genesis 42:6

And Joseph was the one in charge over the land; he was the one who sold grain to all the people of the land. And Joseph's brothers came and bowed to him, noses to the ground.

ረዕ ተጊረወጃ ፋሃጃ ገቹሃጊሃ
ሳጊግወሃጃ ፋሃጃ ጦላፋጃ
ሃፋጊሃ ጦላፋጃ ሃዕ ረሃረ
ሃረ ሃሃይተወጊሃ ገቹሃጊ ጊይፋ
ጃጦላፋ ሃጊገፋ

Joseph's running Egypt, still in the premium sustenance business.

The bros come down to Egypt and bow nose down.

Genesis 42:7

And Joseph saw his brothers and recognized them, but he made himself unrecognizable to them, and he spoke with them in hard tones. And he said to them, "From where have you come?" And they said, "From the land of Canaan, to buy food."

የጊይፋ ጸፋ ገቾየጊ ፋግጊኖ
ሣጃጊረፋ ሳሃኃጸጊኖ ሣሳሃጊኖ
ጸየወዎ ሣጸፋ ሳግፋጊኖ
ኃጊፋሃ ሣጃረፋ ሳሃፋጊኖ
ጠግፋሃ የሳሃፋጊኖ ሣጸፋግ
ረሃፋ ሳግጠ ጎግሃ

He recognizes them, but they don't recognize him.

Genesis 42:8

And Joseph recognized his brothers, but they did not recognize him,

ሃጊይፋ ተፋ ገቹሃጊ ሳሃጊሃ
ሃጃሳሃጃ ፋረ ሃጃሃ

He recognizes them, but they don't recognize him.³⁵⁸

³⁵⁸Welcome to the bible.

Genesis 42:9

and Joseph remembered the dreams that he had had about them. And he said to them, “You’re spies. You came to see the land exposed.”

ተቶ ገቹሃጊ ላጎጊጊሃ
ሃጎረ ሃረዘ ላሠቶ ተሃሃረዘጎ
ሃጊረገላሃ ሃጎረቶ ላሃቶጊሃ
ተሃላዐ ተቶ ተሃቶላረ ሃተቶ
ሃተቶጎ ሶላቶጎ

He remembers that dream where they were bending over from way back in his youth and he recognizes the similarity.

Not sure why he accuses them of being spies or trying to take the land’s clothes off.³⁵⁹

Ok so presumably the logic goes like this:

- 1. Joseph remembers the “everyone bows to him” dream.
- 2. Sees everyone bowing.
- 3. Thinks “Oh shit! Now’s my chance!”
- 4. He needs to set things up for the eventual big reveal.
- 5. That means getting Benjamin down here somehow, or else he can’t gloat that his dream got the numbers right.
- 6. Therefore, next step is to interrogate them about their family.

Genesis 42:10

And they said to him, “No, my lord, your servants came to buy food.

ቶረ ሃጊረቶ ሃላሃቶጊሃ
ሃቶጎ ሃጊላጎዐሃ ጊሃላቶ
ረሃቶ ላጎሠረ

They remind him they’re here for food.

Screw ’em, they sold him into slavery.

This whole family is kinda dicks huh?

³⁵⁹Literally, “the nakedness of the land”: its exposed or vulnerable parts. *’Erwah* normally means physical nakedness, especially the genitals.

Genesis 42:11

We’re all sons of one man. We’re honest men. Your servants weren’t spying.”

ልዩኡ ሠጊኡ ጊነሏ ሃሃረኝ
ኣረ ሃነዘነኡ ሠጊነኝ ሃነዘነ
ሠጊረገላሠ ሃጊላዕ ሃጊኝ

They tell the truth.

Genesis 42:12

And he said to them, “No, but you’ve come to see the land exposed.”

ጊኝ ኣረ ሠጊረኡ ላሠኣጊሃ
ሠተኣሏ ጊላኣኝ ተሃላዕ
ተሃኣላረ

He accuses them of wanting to take Egypt’s pants off again.

Not unreasonable. People are countries in the bible.

So Egypt has pants, biblically speaking.³⁶⁰

Genesis 42:13

And they said, “Your servants are twelve brothers. We’re sons of one man in the land of Canaan, and, here, the youngest is with our father today, and one is no more.”

ላሠዕ ሠጊነሠ ሃላሠኣጊሃ
ሃነዘነኡ ሠጊዘኡ ሃጊላዕ
ጊላኣሏ ልዩኡ ሠጊኡ ጊነሏ
ተኣ ነፀዋኝ ጓነጓሃ ነዐነኝ
ልዩኣኝ ሠሃጊኝ ሃነጊዓኡ
ሃነነጊኡ

They say there’s twelve of them.

The youngest is at home.

And another one “is no more.”

Genesis 42:14

And Joseph said to them, “It’s as I spoke to you, saying: you’re spies.

ገቹሃጊ ሠጊረኡ ላሠኣጊሃ
ሠኝረኡ ጊተላዕላ ላሠኡ ኣሃኝ
ሠተኣ ሠጊረገላሠ ላሠኣረ

So Joseph’s like “Exactly. You’re spies.”

³⁶⁰Cf. Gen 10:6, 13–14.

Genesis 42:15

By this you’ll be tested: by Pharaoh’s life, you won’t go out of here except by your youngest brother’s coming here.

እዐላገ ጊዘ ሃነዘዓተ ተፋጊዓ
ሃፋ ጊሃ እገሃ ሃፋኅተ ሃፋ
ነፀዋእ ሃሃጊዘፋ ፋሃዓዓ
እነእ

So he’s like “Bring Ben— (ahem) the other ben here. Ben means son in Hebrew right? I don’t know your brother’s name.”

Genesis 42:16

Send one from among you, and let him get your brother, and you remain in prison, and your words will be tested: is the truth with you? And if not, then by Pharaoh’s life you’re spies.”

ላዘፋ ሃሃሃ ሃዘጊሃ
ሃሃጊዘፋ ተፋ ዘዋጊሃ
ሃነዘዓጊሃ ሃላቹፋእ ሃተፋሃ
ሃሃተፋ ተሃፋእ ሃሃጊላዓላ
ጊሃ እዐላገ ጊዘ ፋጊ ሃፋሃ
ሃተፋ ሃጊጊገላሃ

So he’s like “Here’s the plan:
One of you go and get him.
Everyone else stays in jail.
I want to make sure you’re not lying about this miscellaneous family trivia.

Genesis 42:17

And he gathered them under watch for three days.

ላሃሃሃ ጊፋ ሃተፋ ገቹፋጊሃ
ሃጊሃጊ ተሃጊሃ

He keeps an eye on them for three days.

Genesis 42:18

And Joseph said to them on the third day, “Do this and live, as I fear God:

ገቹሃጊ ሃእጊፋ ላሃፋጊሃ
ተፋጊ ጊሃጊጊሃእ ሃሃጊዓ
ሃጊእጊፋእ ተፋ ሃጊዘሃ ሃሃዐ
ፋላጊ ጊሃፋ

On the third day he changes his mind, and makes some edits to the thought he started back in verse 16.

Now he’s like “Ok, new plan.

Genesis 42:19

If you're honest, one brother from among you will be held at the place where you're under watch; and you, go, bring grain for the famine in your houses.

ማንኛውም ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ተገባላ ለቅዱስ ልዩ
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ማንኛውም

“If you're honest...

No wait scratch that. Starting over.

Before I was thinking one goes, N-1 stay in jail.

Now I'm thinking N-1 go, 1 stays in jail.

Also you can take some food back.

Genesis 42:20

And you will bring your youngest brother to me, and your words will be confirmed, and you won't die.” And they did so.

ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን

Walk to your country, get the other brother, then walk back to my country, and we'll check to make sure that, um, whoever you bring... is a person.

If I were the brothers, I'd be confused here.

Yeah like what do they expect he's gonna check when they get back.

They could just steal a kid.

Like they don't know that he knows how to check if a person is Benjamin.

Also they have to walk to another country in this plan.

Four times.

And they did so.

Genesis 42:21

And they said, each to his brother, “But we're guilty over our brother, because we saw his soul's distress when he implored us and we didn't listen. On account of that this distress has come to us!”

ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን
ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን ሕጻን

The brothers start waxing theological about how they have to leave one brother behind in captivity and how that’s exactly like Joseph, and this time’s even worse because it’s a brother they actually like, so they think it’s like divine retribution or whatever.

Meanwhile Joseph’s just sitting there, being Jafar.³⁶¹

Genesis 42:22

And Reuben answered them, saying, “Didn’t I say to you, saying, ‘Don’t sin against the boy’? And you didn’t listen. And his blood, too, is required here!”	ገሣፋሪ ሃጽፋ ሃጽፋፋ ሃጽፋፋ ሃጽፋፋ ሃጽፋሪፋ ጸጸፋፋ ፋፋፋፋ ፋፋፋፋ ፋፋፋፋ ፋፋ ገሣፋሪ ፋፋፋ ሃጽፋ ሃጽፋፋፋ ፋፋፋ ሃጽፋፋ ፋፋፋ
--	--

The oldest brother is like “I told you idiots not to kill him.”

Genesis 42:23

And they did not know that Joseph was listening, because an interpreter was between them.	ዐሃሃ ጸሃ ፋፋፋ ፋፋ ሃፋፋ ሃፋፋፋ ጸሃ ጸሃፋፋ ሃፋፋፋ
---	---

Side Note: We forgot to mention.

Joseph has been pretending he doesn’t speak Hebrew this whole time.

Genesis 42:24

And he turned from them and wept. And he came back to them and spoke to them and took Simeon from them and shackled him before their eyes.	ሃጽፋፋ ሃፋፋፋፋ ጸሃፋፋ ጸፋፋፋ ሃፋፋፋ ጸሃፋፋ ሃፋፋፋ ጸሃፋፋ ሃፋፋፋ ፋፋ ጸሃፋፋፋ ጸሃፋፋፋ ፋፋ ሃፋፋፋፋፋ
--	--

Joseph is like



Then he comes back and wipes the tears off and takes Simeon and locks him up in front of the others.³⁶²

³⁶¹Meaning of Eng. uncertain.
³⁶²The oldest brother didn’t want to sell him. So naturally, second oldest goes to jail.

Genesis 42:25

And Joseph commanded that they fill their containers with grain and to put their silver back in each man's sack and to give them provisions for the road. And he did that for them.

የፋሪሃን፣ ገብ፣ ፍጡን፣ ገንዘብ፣ ልግ ሃላፊነት ጽፋ
የዋሠ ሪፍ ሠንፋ ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊ ገንዘብ ሃላፊ ጽፋ
ገንዘብ ሃላፊ ሠንፋ

Joseph has their food boxes filled with grain and secretly puts the money they paid back in each brother's bag, as a little prank to freak them out when they eventually realize.

Genesis 42:26

And they loaded their grain on their asses and went from there.

ረዕ ሃላፊነት ተፋ ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት

They pack up their asses and go.

Genesis 42:27

And one opened his sack to give fodder to his ass at a lodging place, and he saw his silver, and here it was in the mouth of his bag.

ሃላፊነት ተፋ ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ተፋ ሃላፊነት
ተፋ ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ተፋ ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ተፋ ሃላፊነት

One opens up his bag at a hotel to refuel the donkey, and he realizes he forgot to pay for the food to the guy who has their other bro captive.

Genesis 42:28

And he said to his brothers, “My silver's been put back, and here it is in my bag, too.” And their heart went out, and the brothers trembled to one another, saying, “What is this that God has done to us?”

ሃላፊነት ሪፍ ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ተፋ ሃላፊነት
ሃላፊነት ሃላፊነት

They realize they maybe made an oopsie and got another brother killed.

Genesis 42:29

And they came to Jacob, their father, to the land of Canaan, and told him all the things that happened to them, saying,

ጋዋዐ፣ ረፋ ሃፋፍ፣
ሃዐሃ ጸሶፋ ማጸፈፋ
ተፋዋጸ ረሃ ተፋ ሃረ ሃፋ፣፣፣
ፋግፋረ ማተፋ

They get back to dad’s house.

Jacob’s like “How was Egypt boys?”

Genesis 42:30

“The man, the lord of the land, spoke with us hard and accused us of spying on the land.

ሶፋፋጸ ፣ሃፋፋ ሠ፣ፋጸ ፋፋፋ
ሃተ፣፣ ተሃሠዋ ሃሃተፋ
ተፋ ማ፣፣፣ፋግግ ሃሃተፋ
ሶፋፋጸ

They’re like

-
1. The king called us spies.

2. He kept asking about our family.

3. We said Benjamin’s at home and Joseph’s, well.

4. He wanted us to prove Benjamin existed.

5. By bringing him there.

6. Then he kept us in jail for three days.

7. Then he sold us some food.

8. He kept Simeon in jail to make sure we’re honest.

9. Then we realized we forgot to pay him.

10. How’ve you been?
- Genesis 42:31
- And we said to him, ‘We’re honest. We weren’t spying.

ማ፣፣፣ ሃ፣፣ፋ ፋግፋሃሃ
ሃሃ፣፣፣ ፋረ ሃሃ፣፣ፋ
ማ፣፣፣ፋግግ
- Their version is a bit slower.
- 452

Genesis 42:32

We're twelve brothers, our father's sons; one is no more, and the youngest is with our father in the land of Canaan today'.

ሃሃይነቱ ላወዐ ማረነሠ
ሃሃረዓቱ ረነዓ ማረይቱ
ነፀዋጓሃ ሃሃሃረቱ ላይቱጓ
ሶላቱዓ ሃሃረዓቱ ተቱ ማሃረጓ
ነዐነሃ

They explain about item two.

Genesis 42:33

And the man, the lord of the land, said to us, 'By this I'll know that you're honest: leave one brother from among you with me, and take for the famine in your houses and go,

ሠረቱጓ ሃሃረረቱ ላማቱረሃ
ተቱረዓ ሶላቱጓ ረነላቱ
ማተቱ ማረነሃ ረሃ ዐላቱ
ሃይረነጓ ላይቱጓ ማሃረይቱ
ነሃዓዐላ ተቱሃ ረተቱ
ሃሃረሃ ሃይዋ ማሃረተዓ

We've sort been over this.

Genesis 42:34

and bring your youngest brother to me, so I may know that you aren't spies, that you're honest. I'll give you your brother, and you'll go around in the land.'"

ማሃረይቱ ተቱ ሃቱረዓጓሃ
ረሃ ጓዐላቱሃ ረረቱ ነፀዋጓ
ረሃ ማተቱ ማረረገላማ ፋረ
ማሃረይቱ ተቱ ማተቱ ማረነሃ
ሶላቱጓ ተቱሃ ማሃረ ነተቱ
ሃላይቹተ

Spies don't have younger brothers.

They also can't hire someone to pretend.

Genesis 42:35

And it was: they were emptying their sacks, and here was each man's bundle of silver in his sack, and they saw the bundles of their silver, they and their father, and they were afraid.

ሣረዋረዓሣ ሣፉ ረፉረዩ
ሠረቱ ፋሃፋዩ ሣፋረዋሠ
ዩዋሠዓ ያሽቼሣ ዓዩዓጦ
ሐዩዓጦ ሐቱ ዩቱዓረዩ
ሣፋረዓቱፋ ፋሣፋ ሣፋረገቼሣ
ዩቱዓረረዩ

Here we seem to see the [Redactor](#) using E's version of verses 27 and 28 as if it were what the brothers said to their dad inside the quotation marks

we’re still inside of. He may have had the idea of doing that because (just speculating here) in E’s version they realize they forgot to pay after they’re back home unpacking in front of dad.

Genesis 42:36

And their father, Jacob, said to them, “You’ve bereaved me! Joseph is gone, and Simeon’s gone, and you’ll take Benjamin. All these have happened to me!”

ጋዎዐ ሂጓረፉ ሰሣቶቻቸው
ሂጸረሃው ጌጽ ሂጓጊጽፉ
ኃዕሣውና ነግረፉ ገብዮቹ
የዘዋደ ሃሣጊጊጽ ጸፋና ነግረፉ
ጓረሃ የጌጓ ጌሪዐ

Now Jacob’s mad, which makes sense in either source.

Genesis 42:37

And Reuben said to his father, saying, “Kill my two sons if I don’t bring him back to you. Put him in my hand, and I’ll bring him back to you.”

የጌጽ ረፍ ኃጽዮፋፃ ሰሣቶቻቸው
ጌጊጽ ጌጊው ጸፋ ሰሣቶሪ
ነግረጊጽ ፋሪ ሂፋ ጸጌሂጸ
ጌረጌ ሪዐ የጸፋ ጓጊጸ ሃጌረፉ
ሃጌረፉ ነግጊጌውፉ ጌጊፋና

Reuben, the eldest brother, pipes up with a highly responsible idea, saying:

Dad it’s fine! If Simeon doesn’t make it back alive, you can kill two of your grandsons! ◦ ◯

Genesis 42:38

And he said, “My son will not go down with you. Because his brother’s dead, and he’s left by himself, and if some harm would happen to him on the way in which you’re going then you’ll bring down my gray hair in anguish to Sheol.”

ጌጊፃ ላላጌ ፋሪ ሰሣቶጊሃ
ሃጌዘፋ ጌጸ ሣጸሣዐ
ሃላፃሪ ፋሃጓሃ ተሣ
ሃሃቹፋ ሃጓፋላዋሃ ላፋሠሃ
ጓፃ ሃጸሪተ ላሠፋ ጸላላፃ
ጌተፃጌሠ ተፋ ሣተላላሃጓሃ
ጓሪሃፋሠ ሃሃገጌፃ

Jacob is not convinced.

Benjamin’s staying.

Genesis 43

Genesis 43:1

And the famine was heavy in the land.

ኦላፋ ልግ ልዑቅ

The famine's still a thing.

Genesis 43:2

And it was when they had finished eating the grain that they had brought from Egypt: and their father said to them, “Go back. Buy us a little food.”

ረገደ ሃረግ ለግዛት ገደደ
ሃፋገ ለግዛት ለግዛት ተፋ
ላግፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ሃግ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ረገደ ፀዕን ሃገ ሃገ

They run out of food again.

Dad thinks it might be time for another Egypt trip.

Genesis 43:3

And Judah said to him, saying, “The man certified to us, saying, ‘You won’t see my face unless your brother is with you.’

ጸላግ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ሃገ ለዐጽ ለዐጽ ሃፋገ
ሃፋገ ፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ

Judah reminds dad that the food salesman wants Benajmin and Simeon’s still in jail.

Genesis 43:4

If you’re sending our brother with us, we’ll go down and buy food for you,

ተፋ ዘላግ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ጸላግ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ረገደ ሃገ ጸላግ

“We’ll go if Ben comes.”

Genesis 43:5

and if you’re not sending, we won’t go down, because the man said to us, ‘You won’t see my face unless your brother is with you.’”

ፋገ ዘላግ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ
ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ፋገ ሃፋገ
ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ ሃፋገ

“He insists.”

Genesis 43:6

And Israel said, “Why have you done me wrong, to tell the man that you have another brother?”	እግረ ረፋግዊ ላግቶጊ ወጊብ ላጊገል ጊጊ ግተዐፋ ይቶ ግጊ ላጎዐ
---	--

So dad’s like “Why didn’t you just LIE?!”

Genesis 43:7

And they said, “The man asked about us and about our birthplace, saying, ‘Is your father still alive? Do you have a brother?’ And we told him about these things. Could we have known that he would say, ‘Bring your brother down’?”	ረፋወ ረፋወ ሃፋግቶጊ ሃተላሃግረሃ ሃጊ ሠጊቶ ጊይ ግጊጊፋ ላጎዐ ላግብ ሃ ላገሃ ይቶ ግጊ ሠጊ እረፋ ግጊፋፋ ጊጊ ረዐ ላግቶ ጊጊ ዐላ ሰላጊ ግጊይቶ ተቶ ሃላጊሃ
--	---

They’re like “He asked?”

Genesis 43:8

And Judah said to Israel, his father, “Send the boy with me, so we may get up and go, and we’ll live and not die, we and you and our infants as well.	ረፋ እላሃጊ ላግቶጊ እይረወ ሃጊፋ ረፋግዊ እግሃዐሃ ጊተቶ ላዐሃ ፋረሃ እጊይሃ እጊረሃ ግገ ሃጊይሃ ግገ ተሃግ ሃገጐ ግገ እተቶ
---	---

So Judah’s like “Just let us take him so we can go.”

Genesis 43:9

I’ll be security for him. You’ll seek him from my hand. If I don’t bring him to you and set him before you, then I’ll have sinned against you for all time.	ጊላጊ ሃገፋዐቶ ጊሃሃ ፋረ ግቶ ሃግዐፋ ሃጊረፋ ሃጊተቶጊ ሃጊገጊ ሃጊተገጊ ግጊግጊ ረሃ ጊረ ጊተቶፎይ
---	---

I’ll keep him safe.^{363 364}

If I don’t, then you can be mad at me forever.

³⁶³As we learned in Gen. 38, YHWH killed one of Judah’s sons for being an anagram, another got killed for pulling out, and then Judah got his daughter-in-law pregnant.
³⁶⁴Go try and raise a family.

Genesis 43:10

For, if we hadn't delayed, by now we would have come back twice."

ገረዓናን ለእኛ ተገቢ ለገረዓናን
ሚሆንን እንደሆነና እውነት

"WE ALREADY COULD HAVE MADE THE TRIP TWICE BY NOW" says someone.

Genesis 43:11

And Israel, their father, said to them, "If that's how it is, then do this: Take some of the best fruit of the land in your containers and take a gift down to the man, a little balm and a little honey, gum and myrrh, pistachios and almonds.

ለአባዬ ለእኛ ለገረዓናን
አገልግሎት ለእኛ ለገረዓናን
ሃይዋት ሃይዋት ተገቢ
ሚሆንን ለገረዓናን ለገረዓናን
እኛን ለገረዓናን ለገረዓናን
ሀይዋት ሀይዋት ሀይዋት ሀይዋት
ሚሆንን ሀይዋት ሀይዋት
ሚሆንን

So dad's like "Ok, here take some fruit."

THEY HAVE FRUIT?!

"And some honey and pistachios and almonds."

Are these people diabetic or something?

Genesis 43:12

And take double the silver in your hand, and take back in your hand the silver that was put back in the mouth of your bags. Maybe it was a mistake.

ሚሆንን ለገረዓናን ለገረዓናን
ገረዓናን ለገረዓናን ለገረዓናን
ሀይዋት ሀይዋት ሀይዋት
እኛን ለገረዓናን ለገረዓናን
አገልግሎት

Take double the money because you owe him for last time.

Genesis 43:13

And take your brother. And get up, go back to the man.

ሀይዋት ሀይዋት ተገቢ
ሀይዋት ሀይዋት ሀይዋት

Here's Ben.

Genesis 43:14

And may El Shadday give you mercy before the man, so he'll send your other brother and Benjamin to you. And I: if I'm bereaved I'm bereaved!"

ህሃሪ ንኣጌ ጌሩ ርኣዮ
ሠጊኡኝ ጌገሪ ህጊህፀፃ
ህሃጊፀኡ ኣኡ ህሃሪ ፀሪሠዮ
ጌገኣዮ ንጊህጊጎፍ ኣኣዮ ፃፀኡ
ጌጸሪህሠ ጌጸሪህሠ ፃሠኡ

El Shadday have mercy.

Genesis 43:15

And the men took this gift and took double the silver in their hand and Benjamin and got up and went down to Egypt and stood before Joseph.

ተኡ ህጊሠሃኡኝ ሃፀዎጊሃ
ጸሃሠህሃተኡ ጌገጌ ጸፀሃህጌ
ተኡ ህላጊፍ ሃፀዎሪ ገቹሃ
ሃላፃጊሃ ሃህዎጊሃ ሃህጊጎፍ
ጊጎገሪ ሃላህዐጊሃ ህጊላህህ
ገቹሃጊ

They take the food and go walk to another country to buy food.

Genesis 43:16

And Joseph saw Benjamin with them and said to the one who was over his house, “Bring the men to the house, and slaughter and prepare an animal, because the men will eat with me at noon.”

ህተኡ ገቹሃጊ ፋፃጊሃ
ላህኡጊሃ ሃጊህጊጎፍ ተኡ
ፋፃኝ ሃተጊፍ ረዐ ላሠኡሪ
ጸተጊፍኝ ህጊሠሃኡኝ ተኡ
ጊሃ ሃሃጸሃ ፀፃፀ ፀፃፀሃ
ህጊሠሃኡኝ ሃሪሃኡጊ ጊተኡ
ህጊላጸህፍ

Joseph sees Benjamin, so he goes to the guy who runs *his* house³⁶⁵ and says to have lunch ready by noon.

Genesis 43:17

And the man did as Joseph said, and the man brought the men to Joseph's house.

ላሠኡሃ ሠጊኡኝ ሠዐጊሃ
ሠጊኡኝ ፋፃጊሃ ገቹሃጊ ላህኡ
ጸተጊፍ ህጊሠሃኡኝ ተኡ
ገቹሃጊ

Joseph's Joseph makes lunch.

³⁶⁵Joseph has apparently hired a Joseph.

Genesis 43:18

And the men were afraid because they were brought to Joseph’s house, and they said, “We’re being brought on account of the silver that came back in our bags the first time, in order to roll over us and to fall upon us and to take us as slaves—and our asses.”

ጌላ ማገዘነቱን ሃቅላጊጊሃ
ገቹሃጊ ተጊና ሃቅሳሃን
ገቹሃን ላላ ረዕ ሃላማቅጊሃ
ሃንጊተዘተማቅና ያሠን
ማጊቅሳሃማ ሃንዘነቅ ጸረዘተና
ሃንጊረዕ ረረገተጸረ
ተዘቀረሃ ሃንጊረዕ ረገነተጸረሃ
ተቅሃ ማጊላዕረ ሃንተቅ
ሃንጊላማዘ

The bros are nervous.

They’re worried he’s gonna take them as slaves—and their asses.

Genesis 43:19

And they went over to the man who was over Joseph’s house and spoke to him at the entrance of the house

ላሠቅ ሠጊቅን ረቅ ሃሠገጊሃ
ሃላላላጊሃ ገቹሃጊ ተጊና ረዕ
ተጊናን ዘተገ ሃጊረቅ

They talk to Joseph squared.

Genesis 43:20

and said, “Please, my lord, we came down the first time to buy food,

ላላጊ ጊሃላቅ ጊና ሃላማቅጊሃ
ላላሠረ ጸረዘተና ሃንላላጊ
ረሃቅ

They’re like “You won’t believe what happened last time.”

Genesis 43:21

and it was when we came to the lodging place, and we opened our bags, and here was each man’s silver in the mouth of his bag, our money in its full weight. And we’ve brought it in our hand,

ረቅ ሃንቅና ጌላ ጊጸጊሃ
ተቅ ጸዘተገነሃ ነሃረማን
ገቹሃ ጸነጸሃ ሃንጊተዘተማቅ
ሃተዘተማቅ ጊገና ሠጊቅ
ያሠነሃ ሃረቀሠማና ሃንገቹሃ
ሃንላጊና ሃተቅ

They explain about the money.

Genesis 43:22

and we’ve brought down additional silver in our hand to buy food. We don’t know who put our silver in our bags.”

ሃሃላላሃጃ ላይቱ ገቹሃሃ
ቶረ ረሃቱ ላጋሠረ ሃሃላጊጋ
ሃሃገቹሃ ሠሠ ጊሃ ሃሃዐላጊ
ሃሃጊተይተሃቶጋ

They say they brought extra money.

Genesis 43:23

And he said, “Peace to you. Don’t be afraid. Your God and your father’s God put treasure in your bags for you. Your silver came to me.” **And he brought Simeon out to them.**

ሠሃረ ሠሃረሠ ላሠቶጊሃ
ሠሃጊጃረቱ ሃቶላጊተ ረቱ
ሠሃረ ሃተሃ ሠሃጊጋቱ ጊጃረቱሃ
ሠሃጊተይተሃቶጋ ሃሃሠፀሠ
ቶሞኖጊኖ ጊረቱ ቶጋ ሠሃገቹሃ
ሃኖዐሃሠ ጸቱ ሣጃረቱ

He claims he already got the money and God put extra money in their bags for a laugh.

He lets Simeon out of jail.

Genesis 43:24

And the man brought the men to Joseph’s house, and he gave water, and they washed their feet, and he gave fodder for their asses.

ተቱ ሠጊቶጃ ቶጋጊሃ
ገቹሃጊ ጃተጊጋ ሠጊሠሃቶጃ
ሃሾይላጊሃ ሠጊሠ ሃተጊሃ
ቶሃገቹሠ ሃተጊሃ ሠጃጊረገላ
ሠጃጊላሠይረ

They get cleaned up for Lunch.

Genesis 43:25

And they prepared the gift until Joseph’s arrival at noon because they heard that they would eat bread there.

ላዐ ጃይሃሠጃ ተቱ ሃሃጊሃጊሃ
ጊሃ ሠጊላጃላጋ ገቹሃጊ ቶሃጋ
ሃረሃቶጊ ሠሠ ጊሃ ሃዐሠሠ
ሠይረ

The boys get ready.

Genesis 43:26

And Joseph came to the house,
and they brought the gift for him
that was in their hand to the
house, and they bowed to him to
the ground.

ጸተጊዳጸ ገቹሃጊ ፋዳጊሃ
ጸዘሃግግጸ ተፋ ሃረ ሃፋጊዳጊሃ
ጸተጊዳጸ ግላጊዳ ላሠፋ
ጸሾላፋ ሃረ ሃሃዘተሠጊሃ

Joseph arrives.

They get the presents and bow.

Genesis 43:27

And he asked if they were well,
and he said, “Is your old father
whom you mentioned well? Is he
still alive?”

ግሃረሠረ ግጸረ ረፋሠጊሃ
ግጸጊዳፋ ግሃረሠጸ ላግፋጊሃ
ግተላግፋ ላሠፋ ሃዋጊጸ
ጊዘ ሃሃላሃዐጸ

Joseph checks up on dad, pretending it’s small talk.

Genesis 43:28

And they said, “Your servant, our
father, is well. He’s still alive.”
And they knelt and bowed.

ሃላደዐረ ግሃረሠ ሃላግፋጊሃ
ጊዘ ሃሃላሃዐ ሃሃጊዳፋረ
(ሃዘተሠጊሃ) ሃላዋጊሃ
[ሃሃዘተሠጊሃ]

Qere Ketiv.

They say he’s good.

Genesis 43:29

And he raised his eyes and saw
Benjamin, his brother, his
mother’s son, and said, “Is this
your youngest brother whom you
mentioned to me?” And he said,
“May God be gracious to you, my
son.”

ተፋ ፋላጊሃ ሃጊሃጊዐ ፋሠጊሃ
ሃግፋ ሃዳ ሃጊዘፋ ሃጊግጊሃ
ግጸጊዘፋ ጸጊጸ ላግፋጊሃ
ግተላግፋ ላሠፋ ሃ፱ዋጸ
ግጊጸረፋ ላግፋጊሃ ጊረፋ
ጊሃዳ ጸሃዘጊ

He sees Benjamin’s here.

Genesis 43:30

And Joseph hurried because his feelings for his brother were boiling, and he looked for a place to weep and came to his room and wept there.

ሃላግእነ ጌእ ገቹሃጌ ላጎግጌሃ
ሃጌይፋ ረፋ ሃጌግይላ
ፋጎጌሃ ተሃእጎረ ሠዋጎጌሃ
ጎግሠ እጎጌሃ ጎላላይጎ

He breaks down when he sees Ben.

It’s been like 20 years.

He cries in his room so the bros don’t see.

Genesis 43:31

And he washed his face and went out and restrained himself and said, “Put out bread.”

ፋሾጌሃ ሃጌሃገ ሾይላጌሃ
ሃግጌሠ ላግፋጌሃ ዋገፋተጌሃ
ግይረ

He says no he’s fine, he’s just got something in his eye, let’s talk about bread.

Genesis 43:32

And they put it out for him by himself and for them by themselves and for the Egyptians who were eating with him by themselves, because the Egyptians could not eat bread with the Hebrews because that is an offensive thing to Egypt.

ሃላጎረ ሃረ ሃግጌሠጌሃ
ግጌላሾግረሃ ግላጎረ ግጎረሃ
ጌእ ግላጎረ ሃተፋ ግጌረእፋጎ
ግጌላሾግጎ ሃሃረእሃጌ ፋረ
ግጌላጎዐጎ ተፋ ረእፋረ
ፋሃጎ ጎጎዐሃተ ጌእ ግይረ
ግጌላሾግረ

After all that lunch preparation, they’re like “Well as we all know, our people can’t eat together because you’re gross.”

They sit at the yids table.

Genesis 43:33

And they sat before him, the firstborn according to his birthright and the youngest according to his youth. And the men looked amazed at one another.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

So now³⁶⁶ Joseph seats everyone, and it comes out sorted.

Meaning Joseph has somehow seated all eleven brothers in exact birth order.

So the bros look at each other like ◦ ◯.

Genesis 43:34

And he conveyed portions from before him to them, and he made Benjamin’s portion five times more than the portions of all of them, and they drank and were drunk with him.

ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ
ᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

He hands out food.

Benjamin³⁶⁷ gets *five times more*.

Then everyone gets drunk.

End of chapter!

³⁶⁶Using basically the same “younger vs firstborn” language that Laban used back when he explained why he hornswaggled Jacob by swapping out Leah.
³⁶⁷Joseph’s only full brother.

Genesis 44

Genesis 44:1

And he commanded the one who was over his house, saying, “Fill the men’s bags with as much food as they can carry and put each man’s silver in the mouth of his bag,

ሃተጊዳ ረዐ ሳሠቅ ተቅ ሃሾጊሃ
ተዘተሣቅ ተቅ ቅረሣ ሳሣቅረ
ሳሠቅሃ ረሃቅ ሣጊሠሃቅጃ
ገቹሃ ሣጊሠሃ ተቅሠ ሃሃረሃሃጊ
ሃተዘተሣቅ ጊገዳ ሠጊቅ

So Joseph tells his Joseph to fill the brothers’ bags all up with food and put their money back on the top.^{368 369 370}

Genesis 44:2

and put my cup, the silver cup, in the mouth of the youngest one’s bag, and the silver for his grain.” And he did according to Joseph’s word that he spoke.

ገቹሃጃ ዐጊዳገ ጊዐጊዳገ ተቅሃ
ተዘተሣቅ ጊገዳ ሣጊሠተ
ሃሳዳሠ ገቹሃ ተቅሃ ሃፀዋጃ
ሳሠቅ ገቹሃጊ ሳዳላሃ ሠዐጊሃ
ሳዳላ

Joseph tells meta-Joseph to put his fancy cup in Ben’s bag.

Joseph keeps dropping hints to see if they get it.

Genesis 44:3

The morning was light: and the men had been sent away, they and their asses.

ሣጊሠሃቅጃሃ ሳሃቅ ሳዋዳጃ
ሣጃጊሳሣዘሃ ጃሣጃ ሃዘረሠ

The morning comes but men/asseh’s gone.

³⁶⁸He pays them back 9 + 11, to commemorate that tragic day, lest they forget.
³⁶⁹He pays them back the money they sold him for, with a sign error as a joke.
³⁷⁰REF: each man’s silver. The first time, when ten brothers come to Egypt, Joseph imprisons Simeon, and he has their silver placed back in their nine sacks. The second time, when they return with Benjamin, Joseph releases Simeon, and he has their silver placed back in their eleven sacks. The total number of portions of silver returned is twenty, corresponding to the price that was paid for Joseph (37:28). It is yet another case of a hidden link between acts of deception and their payback in later events.

Genesis 44:4

They had gone out of the city.
They had not gone far, and Joseph
had said to the one who was over
his house, “Get up. Pursue the
men, and you’ll catch up with
them and say to them, ‘Why did
you pay back bad for good?’

ᐱᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ
ᐱᐭᐱ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐱᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐱ ᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ

Just after they left, Joseph says to meta-Joseph

“Run after the bros and ask them

‘Why’d you do us dirty after we treated you so well?’

Genesis 44:5

Isn’t this the thing from which my
lord drinks? And he divines by it!
You’ve done bad, this thing that
you’ve done.”

ᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐱ ᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐱ
ᐱᐭᐱ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ

Hey isn’t this the boss’s cup?

He does magic with this!

You did a bad thing, this thing you did.”

Genesis 44:6

And he caught up with them and
spoke these things to them.

ᐭᐭᐭᐱ ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐱᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐱ

He goes and says all that.

Genesis 44:7

And they said to him, “Why
would my lord speak things like
these? Far be it from your
servants to do a thing like this.

ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐱ ᐱᐭᐭᐱᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐱᐱ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ ᐭᐭᐱᐭ
ᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭ ᐱᐭᐭᐭᐭᐭ

And they’re like “Why would he accuse of of that?

Genesis 44:8

Here, we brought the silver that we found in the mouth of our bags back to you from the land of Canaan, so how would we steal silver or gold from your lord’s house?!

ሃሃቶሥ ላሠቱ ገቹሃ ነጻ
ሃሃጊተዘተሥቱ ጊገዓ
ሶላቱሥ ሃጊረቱ ሃሃዓጊሠጻ
ተጊዓሥ ዓሃገሃ ሃጊቱሃ ነዐሃሃ
ዓጸጊ ሃቱ ገቹሃ ሃጊሃላቱ

I mean we brought back double money to apologize for whatever happened last time.

What would be the point of stealing stuff again?!

Genesis 44:9

The one among your servants with whom it’s found, let him die, and also we’ll become my lord’s servants.”

ሃተቱ ቱሥሥጊ ላሠቱ
ሥገሃ ተሥሃ ሃጊላዓዐሥ
ጊሃላቱረ ጸጊጸሃ ሃሃዘሃቱ
ሥጊላዓዐረ

If you find it in one of our bags, you can kill him.

And we’ll all be your slaves.

That’s how sure we are.“

Genesis 44:10

And he said, “Now, also, it will be so according to your words: the one with whom it’s found will become my servant. And you will be free.”

ጸተዐ ሥገ ላሥቱጊሃ
ላሠቱ ቱሃጸ ነሃ ሥሃጊላዓላሃ
ጊረ ጸጊጸጊ ሃተቱ ቱሥሥጊ
ሥጊዋሃ ሃጊጸተ ሥተቱሃ ላዓዐ

So he’s like “Yes, exactly what you said.”

And then he agrees to a less intense version.

Genesis 44:11

And they hurried, and each man lowered his bag to the ground, and each man opened his bag.

ሠጊቱ ሃላላሃጊሃ ሃላጸሥጊሃ
ጸሶላቱ ሃተዘተሥቱ ተቱ
ሃተዘተሥቱ ሠጊቱ ሃዘተገጊሃ

So they check the bags.

Genesis 44:12

And he searched. With the oldest he began, and with the youngest he finished. And the cup was found in Benjamin's bag.

ለዘጸ ረሃሳጽ ሠገዘገረ
ፋሾሚረሃ ጸረሃ ገፀዋሃ
ገሚረሃ ተዘተሚፋስ ዐገሳጸ

Oh shit, Benjamin has the cup.

Genesis 44:13

And they ripped their clothes, and each man loaded his ass, and they went back to the city.

ሚተሚሠ ሃዐላዋሪሃ
ሃላሚዘ ረዐ ሠገፋ ቸሚዐሪሃ
ጸላጐጸ ሃሳሠሪሃ

Everyone's like HOW DOES THIS KEEP HAPPENING?

They head back.

Genesis 44:14

And Judah and his brothers came to Joseph's house, and he was still there, and they fell to the ground before him.

ሃገዘፋሃ ጸላሃጸገ ፋሳሪሃ
ፋሃጸሃ ገቹሃገ ጸተገሳ
ሃገሃገረ ሃረገሪሃ ሚሠ ሃሃላሃዐ
ጸሾላፋ

They get to Joe's house (still not knowing it's him), and they fall all over themselves apologizing.

Genesis 44:15

And Joseph said to them, "What is this thing that you've done? Didn't you know that a man like me would divine?"

ጸሚ ገቹሃገ ሚጸረ ላሚፋሪሃ
ላሠፋ ጸገጸ ጸሠዐሚጸ
ሚተዐላገ ፋሃረጸ ሚተገሠዐ
ላሠፋ ሠገፋ ሠዘሃገ ሠዘሃ ገሃ
ገሃሚሃ

And Joseph's like

"Why would you do that? Don't you know I'm magic?"

Genesis 44:16

And Judah said, “What shall we say to my lord? What shall we speak? By what shall we justify ourselves? God has found your servants’ crime. Here we’re my lord’s servants, both we and the one in whose hand the cup was found.”

እኛ እላላን ላንቶን
ላላን እኛ ንላቶ ላንቶን
ንንገላቶ ዋፅኦን እኛን
እላዓ ያዓ ተቶ ቶኝ
ኃ ንላቶ ንላዓ ነንን
ቶኝን ላቶ ኃ ነይቶ
ላንዓ ዐንዓ

Judah’s like:

What can I say?

This looks pretty bad.

... I guess we’re your slaves now.

Genesis 44:17

And he said, “Far be it from me to do this. The man in whose hand the cup was found: he will be my servant; and you, go up in peace to your father.”

ንረ እረኒይ ላንቶን
ሠንቶ ተቶ ተላዐኝ
ዐንዓ ቶኝን ላቶ
ንረ እንን ቶን ላንዓ
ኃረሠረ ሳዐ ንተቶ ላዓ
ኃእንቶ ረቶ

So Joseph’s like

No I would never do that to you. Just the one who stole it.

He’s my slave now.

Genesis 44:18

And Judah went over to him and said, “Please, my lord, let your servant speak something in my lord’s ears, and let your anger not flare at your servant, because you’re like Pharaoh himself.

እላላን ሳረቶ ሠንቶ
ላላን ንላቶ ን ላንቶን
ንንገላቶ ላላ እላዓ ቶን
እንቶ ሳን ረቶ ንላቶ
እዐላን እኝን ን እላዓ

So Judah goes over and he’s like

Can I say something without you getting mad?

Genesis 44:19

My lord asked his servants,
saying, ‘Do you have a father or
brother?’

ሃገላዕ ተፋ ረፋወ ጊሃላፋ
ሃፋ ዓፋ ማሃረ ወጊጃ ላማፋረ
ዘፋ

Remember when you asked us if we have a dad and brother?

Genesis 44:20

and we said to my lord, ‘We have
an old father and a young son of
his old age, and his brother’s dead,
and he’s left alone of his mother,
and his father loves him.’

ወጊ ጊሃላፋ ረፋ ላማፋሃሃ
ላረጊሃ ሃዋጊ ዓፋ ሃሃረ
ተማ ሃጊዘፋሃ ሃፀዋ ማጊሃዋጊ
ሃማፋረ ሃላዕረ ፋሃጃ ላተሃጊሃ
ሃዓጃፋ ሃጊዓፋሃ

And we said yeah, we’ve lost some family, dad really loves Ben.

Genesis 44:21

And you said to your servants,
‘Bring him down to me, so I may
set my eye on him.’

ሃገላዕ ረፋ ላማፋተሃ
ጃማጊወፋሃ ጊረፋ ሃጃላላሃጃ
ሃጊረዐ ጊሃጊዐ

And you were like ‘Bring him here.’

Genesis 44:22

And we said to my lord, The boy
can’t leave his father; if he left his
father he’d die.’

ፋረ ጊሃላፋ ረፋ ላማፋሃሃ
ተፋ ዓጊዐረ ላዐሃጃ ረሃሃጊ
ሃጊዓፋ ተፋ ዓጊዐሃ ሃጊዓፋ
ተማሃ

And we were like ‘Dad would die.’

Genesis 44:23

And you said to your servants, ‘If
your youngest brother doesn’t
come down with you, you won’t
see my face again.’

ሃገላዕ ረፋ ላማፋተሃ
ማሃጊዘፋ ላላጊ ፋረ ማፋ
ሃሃገቹተ ፋረ ማሃተፋ ሃፀዋጃ
ጊሃገ ተሃፋላረ

And you were like ‘Do it anyway or no food.’

Genesis 44:24

And it was, when we went up to
your servant, my father, and told
him my lord’s words,

ᐱᐸ ᑭᑭᑦᐱᐅ ᑦᑭ ᑦᑭᑦᑦᑦ
ᐸᐸ ᑭᐱ ᐱᑭᑭᑦ ᑦᑭᐸ ᑭᐱᑦᐅ
ᑦᑭᐱᐸ ᑦᑭᑭᐱ

And so when we went back to dad,

Genesis 44:25

that our father said, ‘Go back.
Buy us a little food.’

ᑭᑭᑦ ᑭᑭᑦᑭᐸ ᐱᑭᐸᑦᑦ
ᐱᐸ ᐅᐅᑭ ᑭᑭᐱ ᑭᑭᑭᑦ

he was like ‘Go buy some food we’re all out.’

Genesis 44:26

And we said, ‘We can’t go down.
If our youngest brother is with us
then we’ll go down, because we
can’t see the man’s face if our
youngest brother isn’t with us.’

ᐸᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐸᑭᑦ ᐸᐱ ᐱᑭᐸᑭᑦ
ᑭᐅᐅᑭ ᑭᑭᑦᑭᐸ ᑦᑦ ᑭᐸ
ᐸᐱ ᑦᑭ ᑭᑭᐱᐱᑦᑦ ᑭᑭᐸᐸ
ᑦᑦᐸᐸᑭ ᑦᑭᑭ ᐸᐸᐱᐱ ᐱᐸᑭᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭᑦᐸ ᑭᐅᐅᑭ ᑭᑭᑦᑭᐸᑦ
ᑭᑭᐸᐸ

And we were like ‘We can’t unless Ben comes. The food guy insisted.’

Genesis 44:27

And your servant, my father, said
to us, ‘You know that my wife
gave birth to two for me,

ᑦᑭᐸ ᑭᐱᑦᐅ ᐱᑭᐸᑦᑦ
ᑦᑭ ᑭᐸᐅᐱᑦ ᑭᐸᐸ ᑭᑭᑦᐱᐸ
ᑦᐸᑦᐸ ᑦᐱ ᑭᐱᐱᑦ ᑭᑦᑭᑦᑦ

And then dad was like ‘I only have one Rachel baby left.’

Genesis 44:28

and one went away from me, and I
said he’s surely torn up, and I
haven’t seen him since.

ᑦᐸᐸᑭ ᐱᑭᐸᑭ ᐸᑦᑦᑦ
ᐸᐱᑦ ᑭᐱᐅ ᑭᐱᐅ ᑭᐸ ᐱᑭᐸᑦ
ᑭᑭᑭ ᐱᐅ ᑭᑦᐸᑦᐸᐸᐸ

‘And one, well, he’s all torn up, it tears me up. I haven’t seen since then,
ever, not even right now.’

Genesis 44:29

And if you take this one from me as well and some harm happens to him, then you'll bring down my gray hair in wretchedness to Sheol.'

እገ ተፋ ሥገ ሥተዘቀረሃ
ሃሃቹፋ ሃጎላቀሃ ረሃገ ሥዐሥ
ረተደረሠ ተፋ ሥተላላሃጎሃ
እረፋሠ ጎዐላጎ

'If you take Ben,' dad continued, 'and something happens to him, there's nothing left for me in this world son.'

Genesis 44:30

And now, when I come to your servant, my father, and the boy isn't with us, and he's bound to him soul to soul,

ሃላደዐ ረፋ ረፋደሃ ጎተዐሃ
ሃሃሃረፋ ላዐሃጎሃ ረደፋ
ጎላሃሠቀ ሃሠገሃሃ ሃሃተፋ
ሃሠገሃጎ

I can't go back to dad without Ben man.

Genesis 44:31

it will be, when he sees that the boy isn't there, that he'll die. And your servants will have brought down your servant our father's gray hair in anguish to Sheol,

ሃረፋ ረሃ ሃተሃፋላሃ ጎረጎሃ
ሃላረላሃጎሃ ተሥሃ ላዐሃጎ
ሃላደዐ ተደረሠ ተፋ ሃረላደዐ
እረፋሠ ሃሃገረደ ሃሃረደፋ

He'll literally die.

Genesis 44:32

because your servant offered security for the boy to my father, saying, 'If I don't bring him to you, then I'll have sinned against my father for all time.'

ላዐሃጎ ተፋ ደላዐ ሃላደዐ ረሃ
ሥፋ ላሥፋረ ረደፋ ሥዐሥ
ሃረረፋ ሃሃፋረደፋ ፋረ
ረሃ ረደፋረ ረተፋፀዘሃ
ሥረሥረጎ

Plus I even told him that if anything happens to Ben, he can be mad at me forever.

Genesis 44:33

And now, let your servant stay as my lord’s servant in place of the boy, and let the boy go up with his brothers—

ሃልሳዎ ፋኅ ያሠጊ ጸተዐሃ
ጊሃላፋረ ልሳዐ ሳዐሃጸ ተዘተ
ሃጊዘፋ ማዐ ረዐጊ ሳዐሃጸሃ

Let me be your slave instead.

Please let Ben go back.

Genesis 44:34

for how could I go up to my father and the boy isn’t with me—or else I’ll see the wretchedness that will find my father.”

ጊዓፋ ረፋ ጸረዐፋ ሃጊፋ ጊሃ
ሃገ ጊተፋ ሃሃሃጊፋ ሳዐሃጸሃ
ፋሾሃጊ ሳሠፋ ዐሳዓ ጸፋሳፋ
ጊዓፋ ተፋ

I can’t face dad. I don’t want to see him like that.

Genesis 45

Genesis 45:1

And Joseph was not able to restrain himself in front of everyone who was standing by him, and he called, “Take everyone out from my presence.” And not a man stood with him when Joseph made himself known to his brothers.

ዋገኣተጻረ ገቹሃጊ ለሃጊ ፋረሃ
ሃጊረዐ ማጊገሃጎጎ ለሃረ
ለሃ ሃፋጊሃጎጎ ፋፋዋጊሃ
ላማዐ ፋረሃ ጊረዐማ ሠጊፋ
ዐላሃተጻጎ ሃተፋ ሠጊፋ
ሃጊዘፋ ረፋ ገቹሃጊ

Joseph can’t do this anymore.

Tells his guys to leave him alone.

We hear that no men are left, but the brothers are still there.

Genesis 45:2

And he wept out loud. And Egypt heard, and Pharaoh’s house heard.

ጊሃጎጎ ሃረዋ ተፋ ሃተጊሃ
ማጊገሃማ ሃዐማሠጊሃ
ጻዐፋጎ ተጊጎ ዐማሠጊሃ

He cries real loud.

The country hears.

The king hears.

Genesis 45:3

And Joseph said to his brothers, “I’m Joseph. Is my father still alive?” And his brothers were not able to answer him, because they were terrified in front of him.

የጊዘፋ ረፋ ገቹየጊ ፋሣፋጊየ
ጊጎፋ ላየዐፋ ገቹየጊ ጊጎፋ
የጊዘፋ የረሃጊ ፋረየ ጊዘ
የረፋጎጎ ጊሃ የፋፋ ፋየጎዐረ
የጊጎጎሣ

Joseph’s like “Guys it’s me? Is dad still alive?”

The brothers are like ◦  .

We know he knows that dad’s still alive, but he asks anyway.

Genesis 45:4

And Joseph said to his brothers,
“Come over to me.” And they
went over. And he said, “I’m
Joseph, your brother, whom you
sold to Egypt.

ሃገደኔ ረፋ ገብሃለህ ለእኔ
ሃሳለህ ረገረክ ፋን ሃሳለህ
ገብሃለህ ረገረክ ለእኔ
ኃተላኝ ለሠፋ ኃገደደክ
ኣኃገላኝ ረተፋ

He’s like “Guys, come here.

I’m Joseph.

Jo-seph.

The one you sold to Egypt.

Genesis 45:5

And now, don’t be sad and let
there be no anger in your eyes
because you sold me here,
because God sent me before you
to preserve life.

ሃላኝዎተ ረፋ ኣተዐሃ
ረሃ ኃገደሃለዎና ላዘረ ረፋሃ
ረሃ ኣነኣ ረተፋ ኃተላኝ
ኃገዳለክ ረነዘለኝ ኣገደኝ
ኃገደሃለረ

Don’t be sad.

Don’t be mad that you sold me.

God sent me here to save lives.

Genesis 45:6

For it’s two years that the famine
is in the land, and for five more
years there’ll be no plowing and
harvest.

ዓዓኣ ኃገተሃሠ ኣለ ረሃ
ሠኃዘ ላሃዐሃ ሥላፋኣ ዓላቐዓ
ሠገላዘ ሃገሩ ላሠፋ ኃገሃሠ
ላገሥቐሃ

The famine’s been going for two years.

It’s gonna last for five more after that.

Genesis 45:7

And God sent me ahead of you to
provide a remnant for you in the
earth and to keep you alive as a
big, surviving community.

ኃገዳለክ ረነዘለኝ
ኃገረ ኃሃሠረ ኃገደሃለረ
ሥላፋዓ ተገላፋሠ
ኣፀገረገረ ኃገረ ተሃገደኣለሃ
ኣለላገ

And God sent me here to sell food to you, to keep you alive.
See I have all the food in the country.
Several countries actually.

Genesis 45:8

And now, it wasn't you who sent me here, but God, and he made me into a father to Pharaoh and a lord to all his house and a ruler in all the land of Egypt.

ገብረኤል ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ

God's been real good to me.
I'm Pharaoh's daddy now.
I'm kind of a big deal.

Genesis 45:9

Hurry, and go up to my father and say to him: 'Your son Joseph said this: God has made me a lord to all Egypt. Come down to me. Don't stand back.

ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ

Quick, go to dad and say "Joe's alive. He's in charge of Egypt now. Come visit."

Genesis 45:10

And you'll live in the land of Goshen, and you'll be close to me, you and your children and your children's children and your flock and your oxen and everything you have.

ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ
ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ ገብረ

You can live in Dirt Pile.
We'll be close again, just like we used to be.

Genesis 45:11

And I'll provide for you there,
because there are five more years
of famine, or else you and your
house and everything you have
will be impoverished.'

ጌላ ሕሠ ሃተሩ ጌተረሃረሃሃ
ነገ ልዑላ ሕጊሃሠ ሠሕይ ልሃዐ
ረሃሃ ሃተጊዓሃ ጸተሩ ሠላሃተ
ሃረ ላሠሩ

And I'll take care of you, because I own all the food and that's not gonna
change for about five years so, well, we can do my idea or you can go
home and be poor.

Genesis 45:12

And here your eyes see, and the
eyes of my brother Benjamin, that
it's my mouth that speaks to you.

ተሃሩላ ሕሃጊሃጊዐ ጸሃጸሃ
ጌላ ነጊሕጊሃጊ ጊይሩ ጊሃጊዐሃ
ሕሃጊረሩ ላዓላሕጸ ጊገ

Now can you tell it's really me?

Genesis 45:13

And you'll tell my father of all my
glory in Egypt and of all that
you've seen, and hurry and bring
my father down here."

ረሃ ተሩ ጊዓሩረ ሕተላገጸሃ
ረሃ ተሩሃ ሕጊላሂሕሃ ጊላሃዓሃ
ሕተላጸሕሃ ሕተጊሩላ ላሠሩ
ጸሃጸ ጊዓሩ ተሩ ሕተላላሃጸሃ

Tell my dad how successful I've been.

Bring him down.

Genesis 45:14

And he fell on his brother
Benjamin's neck and wept, and
Benjamin wept on his neck.

ነሕጊሃጊ ጊላሩሃሂ ረዐ ረገጊሃ
ነሕጊሃጊሃ ሃዓጊሃ ሃጊይሩ
ሃጊላሩሃሂ ረዐ ጸሃዓ

He hugs Benjamin and they both cry.

Genesis 45:15

And he kissed all his brothers and
wept over them. And after that his
brothers spoke with him.

ሃዓጊሃ ሃጊይሩ ረሃረ ዋሠነጊሃ
ሃላዓላ ነሃ ጊላይሩሃ ሕጸረዐ
ሃተሩ ሃጊይሩ

Then he cries and kisses everyone.

After that, they have a talk.

Genesis 45:16

And the report was heard at Pharaoh's house, saying, "Joseph's brothers have come." And it was good in Pharaoh's eyes and in his servants' eyes.

ጳዕላገ ተገና ዐሣሠነ ረዋጿሃ
ገቹሃጊ ጊዘቱ ሃፋና ላሣቅረ
ጳዕላገ ጊሃጊዐና ናፀጊጊሃ
ሃጊላናዐ ጊሃጊዐናሃ

The king hears about all this.

He's glad it happened.

Genesis 45:17

And Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Say to your brothers, 'Do this: load your beasts and go; come to the land of Canaan,

ገቹሃጊ ረቱ ጳዕላገ ላሣቅጊሃ
ተቱጊ ሃጊዘቱ ረቱ ላሣቅ
ሣሃላጊዐና ተቱ ሃሃዐፀ ሃሠዐ
ሃዐሃሃ ጳሥላቱ ሃፋና ሃሃረሃ

The king says "Tell your brothers to go back home,

Genesis 45:18

and take your father and your households and come to me, and I'll give you the best of the land of Egypt; and eat the fat of the land.'

ተቱሃ ሣሃጊናቱ ተቱ ሃዘዋሃ
ጊረቱ ሃፋናሃ ሣሃጊተና
ናሃፀ ተቱ ሣሃረ ጳሃተቱሃ
ሃረሃቱሃ ሣጊላሥሣ ሥላቱ
ሥላቱጳ ናረዘ ተቱ

and bring dad back, and he can have good land and food.

Genesis 45:19

And you are commanded, 'Do this: Take wagons from the land of Egypt for your infants and for your wives, and carry your father and come.

ተቱጊ ጳተጊሃሥ ጳተቱሃ
ሥላቱሣ ሣሃረ ሃዘዋ ሃሠዐ
ሣሃገፀረ ተሃረገዐ ሣጊላሥሣ
ተቱ ሣተቱሠሃሃ ሣሃጊሠሃረሃ
ሣተቱናሃ ሣሃጊናቱ

Take my car.

Genesis 45:20

And let your eye not care about your possessions, for the best of all the land of Egypt is yours.”

ረዕ ቼይተ ረፋ ማሃንጊዐሃ
ሶላፋ ረሃ ዓሃ፱ ጊሃ ማሃጊረሃ
ፋሃ፳ ማሃረ ማጊሳሶማ

Don’t worry about your stuff there, you’ve got better stuff here.

Genesis 45:21

And the children of Israel did so. And Joseph gave them wagons by order of Pharaoh and gave them provisions for the road.

ረፋላሠጊ ጊሃዓ ሃሃ ሃሠዐጊሃ
ተሃረጐ ገቹሃጊ ማፈረ ሃተጊሃ
ማፈረ ሃተጊሃ ጳዐላገ ጊገ ረዐ
ሃላላረ ጳላሶ

So they did.

Joseph gives them cars and food for the trip.

Genesis 45:22

For all of them he gave each man changes of clothes, and he gave Benjamin three hundred weights of silver and five changes of clothes.

ተሃገረይ ሠጊፋረ ሃተሃ ማረሃረ
ሃተሃ ሃማጊሃዓረሃ ተረማሠ
ሠማይሃ ገቹሃ ተሃፋማ ሠረሠ
ተረማሠ ተገረይ

He gives each brother some clothes.

He gives Benjamin five time more clothes.

He also gives Benjamin infinity dollars.

Ok so, as we learned from the “brothers sell Joseph” episode,³⁷¹ the price of a family member is 20 of these silver money units.

Family members can be sold for 20 money, in this family, according to the brothers.

Joseph’s presumably been thinking about that fact a lot over all those years while he was becoming the unofficial king of everything down here.

Now, if a family member costs 20 money, then:

(10 half-brothers + 1 Dinah + 1 Dad + 1 Leah + 1 Bilhah + 1 Zilpah)*20
is 15 people³⁷² times 20 silver.

That is, 300 money units.

³⁷¹And also from the two “Joseph makes his brothers think they forgot to pay” episodes.
³⁷²Mom’s dead, so she doesn’t count.

Now, Joseph has one full brother, Benjamin.

Joseph and Benjamin don’t figure into the calculation, because they’re about to do something funny. Ready?

Joseph gives exactly that amount of money to Benjamin.

And also 5x the clothes.

The following table gives rough estimates of the purchasing power of 300 weights of silver around this period in the ancient near east.

Purchase	Quantity	Comparison
silver	~ 3.4 kg	About 7.5 lb of silver.
barley	~ 90,000 L	Roughly 55–60 metric tons.
oxen	~ 15	About 20 weights each.
enslaved people	~ 15	About 20 weights each.
Josephs	15	Joseph sold for 20 weights in Gen 37:28.
Joseph-sale proceeds	15×	Fifteen times what the brothers got for Joseph.

Genesis 45:23

And to his father he sent as follows: ten asses bearing Egypt’s best, and ten she-asses bearing grain, bread, and food supply for his father for the road.

ተፋጊሃ ዘረሠ ሃገናፋረሃ
ሃገፋሠሃ ሃገላሃይ ጓላሠዐ
ላሠዐሃ ሃገላሦሃ ሓሃፀሃ
ሃይረሃ ላሓ ተፋሠሃ ተሃተፋ
ሃላላረ ሃገናፋረ ሃሃጊሃሃ

He sends his dad food.

Genesis 45:24

And he sent his brothers off, and they went, and he said to them, “Don’t quarrel on the road.”

ሃሃጊረሃ ሃገይፋ ተፋ ዘረሠረሃ
ረፋ ሃጓረፋ ላሃፋረሃ
ሃላላሓ ሃጊገላተ

He sends his brothers off, and reminds them not to have any arguments on the road, especially not with Benjamin.

Genesis 45:25

And they went up from Egypt and came to the land of Canaan, to Jacob, their father,

ሃፋሓረሃ ሃገላሦሃሃ ሃረዐረሃ
ሓዐዐረ ረፋ ሃዐሃሃ ሦላፋ
ሃጓረፋ

They get back home.

Genesis 45:26

and told him, saying, “Joseph is still alive! And he rules all the land of Egypt!” And his heart grew numb because he did not believe them.

ላሳዐ ላማቀረ ሃረ ሃላገጊሃ
ረሠማ ቀሃጃ ጊሃሃ ጊዘ ገቹሃጊ
ገገጊሃ ማጊላሾማ ሾላቀ ረገሃ
ማጃረ ሃጊማቀጃ ቀረ ጊሃ ሃሳረ

And they’re like “Joseph’s alive and he’s in charge of literal Egypt!”

Dad’s not getting his hopes up.

Genesis 45:27

And they spoke to him all of Joseph’s words that he had spoken to them, and he saw the wagons that Joseph had sent to carry him, and their father Jacob’s spirit came alive.

ተቀ ሃጊረቀ ሃላላላጊሃ
ላሠቀ ገቹሃጊ ጊላላላ ረገ
ተቀ ቀላጊሃ ማጃረቀ ላላላ
ገቹሃጊ ዘረሠ ላሠቀ ተሃረገዐጃ
ዘሃላ ጊዘተሃ ሃተቀ ተቀሠረ
ማጃጊሃቀ ላዎዐጊ

They tell dad all the stuff Joseph said.

Then dad sees the cars full of food and he believes them.

Some apocryphal manuscripts have here the following addition:

And they said, each to his brother,

Would Yah forgive us all our crimes?

Would God smile on what we’ve done?

And the brothers turned, each to his brother,

And they said to them, saying,

לָא would.

Genesis 45:28

And Israel said, “So much! Joseph, my son, is still alive. Let me go and see him before I die.”

ላሳዐ ስላ ረቀላሠጊ ላማቀጊሃ
ጃሃረቀ ጊዘ ጊሃሃ ገቹሃጊ
ተሃማቀ ማላፀላ ሃሃቀላቀሃ

Then he turns to his sons and he’s like

We’re getting the band back together.

And the sons put their son glasses³⁷³ on the wagon

³⁷³Sic.

And they turn to face the camera that's filming the bible

And they spoke to it, saying

We're on a mission. From God.³⁷⁴

To be continued.

³⁷⁴Lit. לאל. Sic.

Genesis 46

Genesis 46:1

And Israel and everyone he had traveled and came to Beer-sheba, and he offered sacrifices to the God of his father, Isaac.

ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ

Israel and all his people come to Seven Wells.

And they sacrifice to (the sacrifice of (their father’s God))’s God.³⁷⁵

Genesis 46:2

And God said to Israel in night visions, and He said, “Jacob, Jacob.” And he said, “I’m here.”

ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ

So God³⁷⁶

shows up in Israel’s mind and goes “Jacob, Jacob.”

And he’s like “I’m right here.”

Genesis 46:3

And He said, “I am God, your father’s God. Don’t be afraid of going down to Egypt, because I’ll make you into a big nation there.

ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ

And he’s like “It’s me. God. Your father’s God. We got along great, me and your dad. Anyways don’t be scared. I’ll make you into a country. I’m thinking of calling it Israel.”

Genesis 46:4

I shall go down with you to Egypt, and I shall also bring you up. And Joseph will set his hand on your eyes.”

ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲ
ᑲᑲᑲᑲᑲ ᑲᑲ ᑲᑲᑲᑲ

³⁷⁵ A number of scholars have a headache after that.

³⁷⁶ Who supposedly renamed him to Israel.

I'll go down with you to Egypt.

I'll bring you back up after.

Joseph will put his hand on your eyes.

Genesis 46:5

And Jacob got up from Beer-sheba. And the children of Israel carried Jacob, their father, and their infants and their wives in the wagons that Pharaoh had sent to carry him.

וַיָּקָם יַעֲקֹב מִבְּעֵר שֶׁבַע
וַיֵּלֶךְ לְעִיֵּן מִצְרַיִם
וַיֵּלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכָל
בָּנָיו וְכָל בָּנוֹת בָּנָיו
וְכָל זֵרְעוֹ הַבָּיָא אֹתוֹ
מִצְרָיִם׃

So Jacob gets up from the dream and from Seven Wells.

He gets up from all eight of those.

Israel's kids carry Jacob their father.

They put all the people and stuff in the cars Pharaoh lent them.

Genesis 46:6

And they took their cattle and their property that they had acquired in the land of Canaan, and they came to Egypt, Jacob and all his seed with him.

וַיִּקְחוּ אֶת מִקְנֵיהֶם וְאֶת
רְכוּשָׁם אֲשֶׁר רָכְשׁוּ
בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן וַיָּבֹאוּ
מִצְרָיִם יַעֲקֹב וְכָל
זֵרְעוֹ אִתּוֹ׃

Their cows and their other stuff too from back home.

Then they come to Egypt, Jacob and his seed.

Genesis 46:7

He brought his sons and his grandsons with him, his daughters and his granddaughters and all his seed with him to Egypt.

בָּנָיו וּבָנֵי בָנָיו אִתּוֹ
בָּנוֹתָיו וּבָנוֹת בָּנָיו
וְכָל זֵרְעוֹ הֵבִיא אִתּוֹ
מִצְרָיִם׃

And Egypt was pregnant with the children of Israel.

Genesis 46:8

And these are the names of the children of Israel who came to Egypt, Jacob and his sons: Jacob’s firstborn was Reuben.

וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
הַבָּאִים מִצְרָיִמָּה יַעֲקֹב
וּבָנָיו בְּכֹר יַעֲקֹב
רְאוּבֵן׃

Here’s the name of everyone who came.

Genesis 46:9

And Reuben’s sons were Hanoch and Pallu and Hezron and Carmi.

וּבְנֵי רְאוּבֵן חֲנוּךְ וּפְלֹא
וְחֶצְרֹן וְכַרְמִי׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Hanoch	חֲנוּךְ (<i>Hănōk</i>)	“Dedicated” or “initiated,” from חָנַךְ.
Pallu	פְּלֹא (<i>Pallû</i> ’)	Uncertain; sometimes connected with פָּלַא, “be distinct, extraordinary.”
Hezron	חֶצְרֹן (<i>Heṣrôn</i>)	Probably related to חָצַר, “enclosure, courtyard, settlement.”
Carmi	כַּרְמִי (<i>Karmî</i>)	“Vineyard man” or “my vineyard,” from כָּרַם, “vineyard.”

Look Son’s sons were Trained and Different and Surrounded By A Wall and Garden.

Genesis 46:10

And Simeon’s sons were Jemuel and Jamin and Ohad and Jachin and Zohar and Saul, the son of a Canaanite woman.

וּבְנֵי שִׁמְעוֹן יֵמוּעַל
וְיָמִין וְאֶחָד וְיָכִין וְצֹחַר
וְשָׂאוּל בֶּן הַכְּנַעֲנִית׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Jemuel	יֵמוּעַל (<i>Yəməl ʿēl</i>)	Uncertain; apparently an אל-name, traditionally “day of El.”
Jamin	יָמִין (<i>Yāmîn</i>)	“Right hand” or “south,” from יָמִין.
Ohad	אֶחָד (<i>ʿĪhad</i>)	Uncertain; sometimes associated with “unity” or “joining.”
Jachin	יָכִין (<i>Yākîn</i>)	“He establishes” or “may he establish,” from כּוּן.
Zohar	צֹחַר (<i>Šōḥar</i>)	Probably “brightness” or “whiteness,” from צָהַר.
Saul	שָׂאוּל (<i>Šā ʾûl</i>)	“Asked for” or “requested,” from שָׁאַל.

Hearison’s sons were

- 1. his 1st son Godday
- 2. his 2nd ben Jamin
- 3. his 3rd one 1
- 4. his 4th son Founder
- 5. his 5th sOn Light
- 6. his 6th was Borrowed

Genesis 46:11

And Levi’s sons were Gershon,
Kohath, and Merari.

וּבְנֵי לֵוִי גֵרְשׁוֹן קָהָת
וּמֶרָרִי׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Gershon	גֵרְשׁוֹן (<i>Gēršōn</i>)	Probably related to גָּרַשׁ, “drive out”; hence “ex-ile” or “expelled one.”
Kohath	קָהָת (<i>Qəhāt</i>)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Merari	מֶרָרִי (<i>Mərārî</i>)	Probably related to מָרַר, “be bitter”: “bitter” or “my bitterness.”

Levi was the father of Exile, Wrinkles, and Bitterness: the children of Levi.

These are the children of the Levites by their names as we have named them.

Genesis 46:12

And Judah’s sons were Er and Onan and Shelah and Perez and Zerah. And Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan, and Perez’s sons were Hezron and Hamul.

וּבְנֵי יְהוּדָה עֵר וְאוֹנָן
וְשִׁלָּה וּפְרֶץ וְזֶרַח וַיָּמָת
עֵר וְאוֹנָן בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן
וַיְהִיו בְּנֵי פְרֶץ חֲצֹרן
וְחָמוּל׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Er	עֶר (<i>Ēr</i>)	Uncertain; often connected with “awake, watchful.”
Onan	אֹנָן (<i>Ōnān</i>)	Probably from אֹנֶן, “strength, vigor.”
Shelah	שֵׁלָח (<i>Šēlāh</i>)	Uncertain; several Hebrew derivations have been proposed.
Perez	פֶּרֶץ (<i>Pereš</i>)	“Breach” or “breakthrough,” from פָּרַץ, “break through.”
Zerah	זֶרַח (<i>Zerah</i>)	“Rising” or “dawning,” from זָרַח, “rise, shine.”
Hezron	חֶצְרֹן (<i>Heṣrôn</i>)	Probably from חָצַר, “enclosure, courtyard, settlement”: something like “enclosed place” or “settlement.”
Hamul	חָמוּל (<i>Hāmûl</i>)	“Spared” or “pitied,” “mercy,” from חָמַל.

Judah had דָּאֵב (who was bad for some reason (no one knows why))

And Onan³⁷⁷

Shelah.³⁷⁸

Okay so Er was bad and Onan came to an outside end³⁷⁹

Now Judah’s seed left him and Tamar got his goat and when he didn’t deliver Tamar³⁸⁰ said³⁸¹ “whose stick is this”³⁸² and Judah was like “she’s more righteous than I” and threw himself on the mercy of the court and then he had twins named Buster & Up and then Buster has kids and names them Mercy and Court.

Genesis 46:13

And Issachar’s sons were Tola and Puvah and Job and Shimron.

וּבְנֵי יִשָּׁשְׁכָר תּוֹלַע וּפְוָה
וְיֹב וְשִׁמְרֹן׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Tola	תּוֹלַע (<i>Tôlā</i> ‘)	“Crimson worm/grub,” the source of scarlet dye.
Puvah	פְּוָה (<i>Puvvāh</i>)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Job	יֹב (<i>Yôḇ</i>)	Uncertain; this form has no secure Hebrew derivation.
Shimron	שִׁמְרֹן (<i>Šimrôn</i>)	Probably related to שמר, “guard, watch, keep.”

Issachar’s sons are named Redworm and Blast and Hated and Keeper.

³⁷⁷That’s תּוֹלַע, not תּוֹלַעֵךְ.

³⁷⁸And that’s פְּוָה, not פְּוָהֵךְ.

³⁷⁹An old northern English and Scottish idiom meaning to come to a complete, disastrous, or ruined finish. Often used to describe an object being smashed to pieces, a project failing totally, or a person coming to a bad end.

³⁸⁰Lit. TMR; Heb. תָּמַר

³⁸¹Lit. T’MR. Heb. תָּאמַר, the 3rd person feminine singular of the verb “to say.”

³⁸²Lit. /huzdikızōis/ in the original.

Genesis 46:14

And Zebulun’s sons were Sered
and Elon and Jahleel.

וּבְנֵי זֶבֻלֹן סֶרֶד וְאֵלֹן
וַיַּחֲלֵאֵל׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Sered	סֶרֶד (<i>Sered</i>)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Elon	אֵלֹן (<i>Ēlōn</i>)	“Oak” or “terebinth,” from אֵלֹן.
Jahleel	יַחֲלֵאֵל (<i>Yahlə ʿēl</i>)	Probably “El waits/hopes,” from יחל + אל.

Zebulun’s sons are Dried Up, Tree, and Waiting For God.

Genesis 46:15

These were the sons of Leah, to
whom she gave birth for Jacob
in Paddan Aram, and Dinah,
his daughter, every person of
his sons and his daughters,
thirty-three.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי לֵאָה אֲשֶׁר
יָלְדָה לַיַּעֲקֹב בְּפַדַּן
אֲרָם וְאֵת דִּינָה בְּתוֹ
כָּל נַפְשׁ בָּנָיו וּבָנוֹתָיו
שְׁלָשִׁים וְשָׁלֹשׁ׃

That’s just Leah’s kids.

She had all those sons, and then she had Dinah.

Genesis 46:16

And Gad’s sons were Ziphion
and Haggai and Shuni and
Ezbon, Eri and Arodi and
Areli.

וּבְנֵי גָד צִפְיֹן וְחַגִּי
שׁוּנִי וְאַצְבֹּן עֵרִי וְאַרְוִדִי
וְאַרְאֵלִי׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Ziphion	צִפְיֹן (<i>Ṣifyōn</i>)	Probably related to צפה, “watch, look out”: “watcher” or “lookout.”
Haggi	חַגִּי (<i>Haggî</i>)	“Festive” or “my feast,” from חג, “festival.”
Shuni	שׁוּנִי (<i>Šûnî</i>)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Ezbon	אַצְבֹּן (<i>ʿEṣbôn</i>)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Eri	עֵרִי (<i>Ērî</i>)	Uncertain; perhaps related to “watchful” or “awake.”
Arodi	אַרְוִדִי (<i>ʾĂrôḏî</i>)	Uncertain; probably a gentilic or clan name.
Areli	אַרְאֵלִי (<i>ʿAr ʿēlî</i>)	Probably related to אראל, “hero/lion of El”; ex- act derivation uncertain.

Gad’s sons are Look Out, Party, Šunny, I’m Gonna Be Huge,³⁸³ Awake, A Wild Ass, and Lionel.

Genesis 46:17

And Asher’s sons were Imnah and Ishvah and Ishvi and Beriah, and Serah was their sister. And Beriah’s sons were Hever and Malchiel.

וּבְנֵי אֲשֵׁר יִמְנָה וִישָׁוָה
וִישְׁוִי וּבְרִיעָה וְשֶׁרָח
אֲחֹתָם וּבְנֵי בְרִיעָה
חֶבֶר וּמַלְכִּיֵּאל׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Imnah	יִמְנָה (<i>Yimnāh</i>)	Probably related to ימין, “right hand.”
Ishvah	יִשְׁוָה (<i>Yišwāh</i>)	Uncertain; perhaps related to שוה, “be equal, level.”
Ishvi	יִשְׁוִי (<i>Yišwî</i>)	Uncertain; perhaps related to שוה, “be equal, level.”
Beriah	בְּרִיעָה (<i>Bərî’āh</i>)	Uncertain; later biblical wordplay connects it with “misfortune.”
Serah	שֶׁרָח (<i>Šerah</i>)	Uncertain; sometimes connected with “abundance” or “excess.”
Heber	חֶבֶר (<i>Heber</i>)	“Companion” or “association,” from חבר, “join.”
Malchiel	מַלְכִּיֵּאל (<i>Malkî’ēl</i>)	“My king is El,” from מלך + אל.

Asher’s seed was Right Hand, Equal, Equal Again, Misfortune, Excess, Friend, and Godsmilk.

Genesis 46:18

These were the sons of Zilpah, whom Laban gave to Leah, his daughter, and she gave birth to these for Jacob, sixteen persons.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי זִלְפָּה אֲשֶׁר
נָתַן לָבָן לְלֵאָה בָּתּוּ
וַתֵּלֶד אֶת אֵלֶּה לְיַעֲקֹב
שֵׁשׁ עָשָׂר נַפְשׁ׃

That was Zilpah’s kids and grandkids.

Genesis 46:19

The sons of Rachel, Jacob’s wife, were Joseph and Benjamin.

בְּנֵי רָחֵל אִשְׁתּוֹ יַעֲקֹב
יוֹסֵף וּבִנְיָמִן׃

Rachel had Joseph and Benjamin.

³⁸³Lit. I will be enlargement.

Genesis 46:20

And Manasseh and Ephraim were born to Joseph in the land of Egypt, to whom Asenath, daughter of Poti-phaera, priest of On, gave birth for him.

וַיֵּלֶד לְיוֹסֵף בְּאֶרֶץ
מִצְרַיִם אִשָּׁה יְלָדָה לוֹ
אֲסֵנַת בַּת פּוֹטִי פְרַע
כֹּהֵן אֵן אֶת מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶת
אֶפְרַיִם׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Asenath	אֲסֵנַת (ʾĀsənāt)	Egyptian name, often understood as “belonging to Neith”; exact derivation is debated.
Poti-phaera	פּוֹטִי פְרַע (Pôṭî Pēraʿ)	Egyptian, probably “he whom Ra has given” or “gift of Ra.”
On	אֵן (ʿŌn)	Egyptian <i>Iunu</i> , later Heliopolis; probably “the Pillars.”
Manasseh	מְנַשֶּׁה (Mənaššeh)	Gen 41:51 connects it with נִשָּׁה, “cause to forget.”
Ephraim	אֶפְרַיִם (ʿEfrayim)	Gen 41:52 connects it with פֶּרֶה, “be fruitful”: roughly “double fruitfulness.”

Joseph married Some Egyptian, daughter of Rathaniel, priest of An and she had

נשה

Made me Forget; Two Fruits.

Genesis 46:21

And Benjamin’s sons were Bela and Becher and Ashbel, Gera and Naaman, Ehi and Rosh, Muphim and Huphim and Ard.

וּבְנֵי בְנִימִן בֶּלַע וּבֶכֶר
וְאַשְׁבֵּל גֵּרָא וְנַעֲמָן אֲחִי
וְרֹאשׁ מְפִים וְחָפִים
וְאַרְדִּי׃

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Bela	בֶּלַע (Belaʿ)	Probably related to בָּלַע, “swallow”; exact sense as a name is uncertain.
Becher	בֶּכֶר (Beker)	Probably related to בָּכַר, “firstborn.”
Ashbel	אַשְׁבֵּל (ʾAšbēl)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Gera	גֵּרָא (Gērāʿ)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Naaman	נַעֲמָן (Na ʾāmān)	“Pleasant” or “pleasant one,” from נָעַם.
Ehi	אֲחִי (Ēḥî)	“My brother,” from אח.
Rosh	רֹאשׁ (Rōš)	“Head,” “chief,” or “top.”
Muphim	מְפִים (Muppîm)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Huphim	חָפִים (Huppîm)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Ard	אַרְדִּי (ʾArd)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Jahzeel	יַחְזָאֵל (<i>Yahṣə ʿel</i>)	“El apportions/divides,” from חצה + אל.
Guni	גּוּנִי (<i>Gûnî</i>)	Uncertain; no secure Hebrew etymology.
Jezer	יֶזֶר (<i>Yēṣer</i>)	“form” or “formation,” from יצר, “form, fashion.”
Shillem	שִׁלֵּם (<i>Šillēm</i>)	“Repaid” or “made whole,” from שלם.

Mein Kamph’s sons are God Segregates, Colored, Yessir, and Reparations.

Genesis 46:25

These were the sons of Bilhah, whom Laban gave to Rachel, his daughter, and she gave birth to these for Jacob. All the persons were seven.

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי בִלְהָה אֲשֶׁר
נָתַן לָבָן לְרָחֵל בִּתּוֹ
וַתֵּלֶד אֶת אֵלֶּה לְיַעֲקֹב
כָּל נַפְשׁ שִׁבְעָה:

That was Bilhah’s sons.

Genesis 46:26

All the persons of Jacob’s who came to Egypt, who came out from his thigh, outside of Jacob’s sons’ wives, all the persons were sixty-six.

כָּל הַנַּפְשׁ הַבָּאָה
לְיַעֲקֹב מִצְרֵימָה יֹצְאֵי
יָרְכוּ מִלֵּבד נָשִׁי בְנֵי
יַעֲקֹב כָּל נַפְשׁ שְׁשִׁים
וָשֵׁשׁ:

All 66 of those people came out of Jacob’s ירך³⁸⁴.

Genesis 46:27

And Joseph’s sons who were born to him in Egypt were two persons. All the persons of Jacob’s house who came to Egypt were seventy.

וּבְנֵי יוֹסֵף אֲשֶׁר יָלַד
לוֹ בְּמִצְרַיִם נַפְשׁ
שְׁנַיִם כָּל הַנַּפְשׁ לְבֵית
יַעֲקֹב הַבָּאָה מִצְרֵימָה
שִׁבְעִים:

Joseph had two kids in Egypt.

That’s it, end of list, seventy people.

³⁸⁴This is the term for where Jacob was struck by his opponent during the wrestling match in Gen. 32.

We now return to our regularly scheduled programming.

Genesis 46:28

And he sent Judah ahead of him to Joseph to direct him in advance to Goshen. And they came to the land of Goshen.

ሃጊሃገረ ዘረሠ ጳላሃጳጊ ተፋሃ
ሃጊሃገረ ተላሃጳረ ገቹሃጊ ረፋ
ጳሾላፋ ሃፋፍጊሃ ጳሃሠገ
ሃሠገ

Proper name	Hebrew	Possible Meaning
Goshen	גֹּשֶׁן (<i>Gōšēn</i>)	Probably Egyptian in origin; no secure etymology is known.

Judah goes ahead to show them the way to Dirt Pile.

Genesis 46:29

And Joseph hitched his chariot and went up to Israel, his father, at Goshen. And he appeared to him and fell on his neck and wept on his neck a long time.

ሃተፍሃላሣ ገቹሃጊ ላቹፋጊሃ
ረፋላሠጊ ተፋላዎረ ረዐጊሃ
ሃጊረፋ ፋላጊሃ ጳሃሠገ ሃጊፍፋ
ሃፍጊሃ ሃጊላፋሃሾ ረዐ ረገጊሃ
ላሃዐ ሃጊላፋሃሾ ረዐ

Joseph drives up to meet dad at Dirt Pile.

Then he hugs him and cries.

Genesis 46:30

And Israel said to Joseph, “Let me die now after I’ve seen your face, that you’re still alive.”

ገቹሃጊ ረፋ ረፋላሠጊ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጊላዘፋ ሣዐገጳ ጳተሃሣፋ
ጊሃ ሃጊሃገ ተፋ ጊተሃፋላ
ጊዘ ሃላሃዐ

Dad’s ready to die now.

Genesis 46:31

And Joseph said to his brothers and to his father’s house, “Let me go up and tell Pharaoh and say to him, ‘My brothers and my father’s house that were in the land of Canaan have come to me.

ሃጊዘፋ ረፋ ገቹሃጊ ላሣፋጊሃ
ጳረዐፋ ሃጊፍፋ ተጊፍ ረፋሃ
ጳላሣፋሃ ጳዐላገረ ጳላጊገፋሃ
ጊፍፋ ተጊፍሃ ጊዘፋ ሃጊረፋ
ሃፋፍ ሃዐሃሃ ሾላፋፍ ላሠፋ
ጊረፋ

Joseph’s like “I’m gonna go tell Pharaoh my family’s here.”

Genesis 46:32

And the people are shepherds, because they were livestock people, and they’ve brought their flock and their oxen and all they have.’

ሃፋሾ ጸዕላ ማገዘሃፋጃሃ
ሃጊጃ ጃሃዋማ ጊዘሃፋ ጊሃ
ፈሃሃ ማላዋዓሃ ማሃፋሾሃ
ሃፋጊዓጃ ማጃፈ ላሠፋ

And I’ll tell him they brought their sheep because they’re sheep people and they brought their sheep and cows and everythi—

Joseph now realizes something, which the text doesn’t mention yet. But imagine him pausing here and looking concerned. That’ll make sense in a minute.

Genesis 46:33

And it will be, when Pharaoh will call you and say, ‘What is your occupation?’

ማሃፈ ፋላዋጊ ጊሃ ጃጊጃሃ
ጃማ ላማፋሃ ጃዐላገ
ማሃጊወዐማ

Joseph continues...

Hey guys, when he asks you what your job is...

Genesis 46:34

that you’ll say, ‘Your servants were livestock people from our youth until now, both we and our fathers,’ so that you’ll live in the land of Goshen, because any shepherd is an offensive thing to Egypt.”

ጃሃዋማ ጊዘሃፋ ማተላማፋሃ
ሃሃጊላሃዐሃማ ሃጊላዓዐ ሃጊጃ
ማገ ሃሃዘሃፋ ማገ ጃተዐ ላዐሃ
ሃዓሠተ ላሃዓዐዓ ሃሃጊተዓፋ
ተዓዐሃተ ጊሃ ሃሠገ ሾላፋዓ
ሃፋሾ ጃዐላ ፈሃ ማጊላሾማ

Say you’re livestock people.

Never say you’re sheep people ok?

He might not let you live here if you do.

... Egyptians hate sheep people.

To be continued.

Genesis 47

Genesis 47:1

And Joseph came and told Pharaoh and said, “My father and my brothers and their flock and their oxen and all that they own have come from the land of Canaan, and here they are in the land of Goshen.”

ᐱᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

Previously on: bible.

Don’t say you’re shepherds!

This week on: bible.

Joseph runs to the king and says

- My dad
- And all my brothers
- And all their sh— (*ahem*) shirts.
- And all their cows
- And all their stuff

have come from Canaan where we live and now they’re over at Dirt Pile.

Genesis 47:2

And he took several of his brothers, five men, and set them before Pharaoh.

ᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅᐅ
ᐅᐅᐅᐅ ᐅᐅᐅᐅ

He takes five of the brothers to come meet the king.

Presumably the ones that he trusts can keep their story straight and not mess us their immigration interview.

Genesis 47:3

And Pharaoh said to his brothers,
“What is your work?” And they
said to Pharaoh, “Your servants
are shepherds, both we and our
fathers,”

וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם פַּרְעֹה
מָה עֲמַלְכֶם וַיֹּאמְרוּ
לְפָנָיו אֲנִי וְאֶת
אֲבוֹתַי רֹעִים הָיִינוּ
כִּי אֵלֶּכֶם וְאֶת
אֲבוֹתֵינוּ

And the king’s like,

So, what do you all do for a living?

So naturally they’re like “Sheep.”³⁸⁵

Genesis 47:4

and they said to Pharaoh, “We
came to reside in the land because
there’s no pasture for your
servants’ flock because the famine
is heavy in the land of Canaan.
And now may your servants live in
the land of Goshen.”

וַיֹּאמְרוּ לְפָנָיו
זָכַרְנוּ אֶת
הָאָרֶץ מִיְּמֵינוּ
וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ מִיְּמֵינוּ
וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ מִיְּמֵינוּ
וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ מִיְּמֵינוּ
וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ מִיְּמֵינוּ
וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ מִיְּמֵינוּ

And they go,

Sheep people need food fodder sheep but d’ere ain’t no food back home.

So we came ’ere to live in Dirt Pile if you’d lettuce.

Genesis 47:5

**And Pharaoh said to Joseph,
saying, “Your father and your
brothers have come to you.**

וַיֹּאמֶר פַּרְעֹה אֶל יוֹסֵף
לֵאמֹר אֲבִיךָ וְאֶחָיֶךָ
בָּאוּ אֵלֶיךָ:

³⁸⁵REF: Your servants are shepherds. Joseph had just told them not to answer Pharaoh that they are shepherds (46:33–34), yet they go ahead and say it! Some might surmise that this seeming contradiction is the result of the combination of two sources into one story. But that is not correct. This has nothing to do with the sources that are identified in critical biblical scholarship. This is one continuous passage (all from the source known in scholarship as J). The difficulty in the brothers’ words must therefore be understood as being a part of the story itself. The brothers simply do not follow Joseph’s instructions. He has told them to say that they are cowherds, not shepherds, because Egyptians disdain shepherds; but they are not willing to misrepresent themselves in this way. Are they right? On one hand, Pharaoh does permit them to settle and offers them the best of Egypt’s land. But, on the other hand, Pharaoh stops speaking directly to them. He switches to speaking about them in the third person to Joseph. And he offers to have some of them serve as officers over his cattle even though they have just said they are shepherds, not cattlemen.

So now³⁸⁶ Pharaoh blacks out and forgets verses 1-4.

And Pharaoh says to Joseph, “Your family is here.”³⁸⁷

Genesis 47:6

The land of Egypt is before you. Settle your father and your brothers in the best of the land. Let them live in the land of Goshen. And if you know—and if there are among them—worthy men, then you shall make them livestock officers over those that I have.”

אֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם לִפְנֵיךָ
הוּא בְּמִיטֵב הָאָרֶץ
הוֹשֵׁב אֶת אֲבִיךָ וְאֶת
אֲחִיךָ יֵשְׁבוּ בְּאֶרֶץ גֹּשֶׁן
וְאִם יָדַעְתָּ וְיֵשׁ בָּם אַנְשֵׁי
חֵיל וְשָׂמַתָּם שָׂרֵי מִקְנֵה
עַל אֲשֶׁר לִי:

The Pharaoh appears not to have heard the part about the sheep.

Genesis 47:7

And Joseph brought Jacob, his father, and stood him in front of Pharaoh. And Jacob blessed Pharaoh.

וַיָּבֵא יוֹסֵף אֶת יַעֲקֹב
אָבִיו וַיַּעֲמֵדְהוּ לִפְנֵי
פַּרְעֹה וַיְבָרֶךְ יַעֲקֹב אֶת
פַּרְעֹה:

Joseph brings dad.
Jacob blesses Pharaoh.

³⁸⁶Lit. tso'no (Heb. צֹאֲנוֹ) in O.T.
³⁸⁷REF: This section, 47:5–12, comes in the middle of a J text. But Jacob says here that he is 130 years old and that Abraham and Isaac lived longer, while in J YHWH has decreed that no human will live more than 120 years. It is in P that ages are given and that Abraham and Isaac live longer. Moreover, this section has other characteristics of P: The phrases “the days of the years” and “the years of your life” occur only in P. The terms “residences” and “possession” occur only in P. The phrase “as he commanded” occurs fifty-three other times in Genesis–Numbers, and fifty-two are in P. And it is in P that the people live in Rameses. Nonetheless, we should recognize that it is possible that the Redactor combined some material from J or E with P to form this section. The reference to Goshen (v. 6) may be in conflict with the reference to Rameses, and P never mentions Goshen elsewhere. The words “Let them live in Goshen” may have originally read “they lived in Goshen,” which would look the same in the consonantal text. And Goshen is what the brothers requested in the J text (v. 4). Further, this matter is complicated by the fact that the Septuagint text is different, which may be related to the recurrence of the words “let them live in the land of Goshen” in vv. 4 and 6.

Genesis 47:8

And Pharaoh said to Jacob,
“How many are the days of the
years of your life?”

ויאמר פרעה אל יעקב
כמה ימי שני חייד:

And Pharaoh's like “How old are you?”

Genesis 47:9

And Jacob said to Pharaoh,
“The days of the years of my
residences are a hundred thirty
years. The days of the years of
my life have been few and bad,
and they haven't attained the
days of the years of my fathers'
lives, in the days of their
residences.”

ויאמר יעקב אל פרעה
ימי שני מגורי שלשים
ומאת שנה מעט ורעים
היו ימי שני חיי ולא
השיגו את ימי שני חיי
אבתי בימי מגוריהם:

He says he's 130.

And it's been a short, bad life.

Genesis 47:10

And Jacob blessed Pharaoh
and went out from in front of
Pharaoh.

ויברך יעקב את פרעה
ויצא מלפני פרעה:

Jacob blesses Pharaoh.

Then he walks away.

We're not entirely sure what happened here.

Genesis 47:11

And Joseph settled his father
and his brothers and gave them
a possession in the land of
Egypt, in the best of the land,
in the land of Rameses, as
Pharaoh had commanded.

ויושב יוסף את אביו
ואת אחיו ויתן להם
אחזה בארץ מצרים
במיטב הארץ בארץ
רעמסס כאשר צוה
פרעה:

... Ok so much to everyone’s surprise, it all works out.

Joseph moves his dad and brothers into the land.

They don’t even have to live in Dirt Pile.

We’re told it was Pharaoh’s idea, and they get to live in Son of Sun, the best part of town.

Genesis 47:12

And Joseph supported his father and his brothers and all of his father’s household, bread by the number of infants.

וּיְכַלְכֵּל יוֹסֵף אֶת אָבִיו
וְאֶת אֶחָיו וְאֶת כָּל בֵּית
אָבִיו לֶחֶם לְפִי הַטֶּף:

Joseph supports the family.

Everyone has enough bread, the family’s united at last.

And they live happily ever after.

The end.

Genesis 47:13

And there was no bread in all the land of Egypt, because the famine was very heavy, and the land of Egypt and the land of Canaan languished because of the famine.

וּמִגֹּאֲלָה לַעֲרָב נָזַח הָאֶרֶץ
וְאֵין בָּרֶם בְּמִצְרַיִם וּבְאֶרֶץ
כְּנָעַן כִּי הָיָה הָרָעָב
בְּמִצְרַיִם וּבְאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן

Ok so there’s no bread in the whole country.

Because the famine was very **heavy**.

No bread in Egypt or Canaan.

Genesis 47:14

And Joseph collected all the silver that was found in the land of Egypt and in the land of Canaan for the grain that they were buying, and Joseph brought the silver to Pharaoh’s house.

וַיִּקְרַע יוֹסֵף אֶת כָּל הָאֶרֶץ
מִמִּצְרַיִם וְעַד אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן
כִּי הָיָה הָרָעָב בְּמִצְרַיִם
וּבְאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן וַיָּבִיאוּ אֶת
כָּל הָאֶרֶץ לְפָנָיו וַיֹּאמֶר
יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי מִצְרָיִם

So Joseph gathers up all the silver in Egypt and in Canaan, and he brings it to Pharaoh’s house.

Genesis 47:15

And the silver came to an end from the land of Egypt and from the land of Canaan. And all of Egypt came to Joseph, saying, “Give us bread! And why should we die in front of you? Because there’s no more silver!”

ጠባቂህ ገብሮታ ህጻኒቶ
ጎጠሃ ጠባቂህ ህጻኒህ
ሪቁ ህጻኒህ ሪቁ የቀጸኒ
የነሪ ጃጃ ሰህብ ገብሮ
ሃገሪ ጸደቅ ጃህሪ ህይሪ
ገብሮ ቅገቁ ንሃ

He runs out of silver!

And everyone in Egypt comes to Joseph.

And they’re like “Give us bread!”

Genesis 47:16

And Joseph said, “Give your livestock, and I’ll give it to you for your livestock if there’s no more silver.”

የጃጃ ገብሮ ሰህቀኒ
ህህሪ ጃጸቁ ህህጸኅዋህ
ገብሮ ቅገቁ ህቁ ህህጸኅዋህ

And he’s like “YOU CAN PAY ME IN COWS!”

It’s a famine. There’s no way they have cows.

Genesis 47:17

And they brought their livestock to Joseph, and Joseph gave them bread for the horses and for the livestock of the flocks and for the livestock of the oxen and for the asses, and he sustained them with bread for all their livestock in that year.

ህህጸኅዋህ ጸቁ የቀጸኒ
ህህሪ ጸጻኒ ገብሮ ሪቁ
ህህጸኅዋህ ህይሪ ገብሮ
ጸደቅ ጸጸኅ ጃህዋህ
ህይዋህ ሰዋጃ ጃህዋህ
ሪቁ ህይሪ ህህጸኒ ህህጸ
ቁጃጃ ጃህዋህ ህህጸኅዋህ

They have cows.

So the starving people bring their cows and all sorts of other edible animals and he gives them some bread.

Genesis 47:18

And that year came to an end,
and they came to him in the
second year and said to him,
“We won’t conceal from my lord
that the silver has come to an end
and the cattle livestock have gone
to my lord. Nothing is left in
front of my lord except our body
and our land.

ፋክቋን ሕገሠቱ ሠጸጸ
ሕገሠጽ ነጋረቱ ነፋጽጊና
ፋሪ ነሪ ነጻሣፋጊና ጸጊገሠቱ
ሠጸ ሠፋ ጊሃ ጊገሳፋሣ ልፀሃገ
ሕሣቋን ሕገዋሣና ገብሃቱ
ጊገገሪ ጸፋሠገ ፋሪ ጊገሳፋ ረቱ
ነገጸጊና ሠፋ ጊጸሪጽ ጊገሳፋ
ነገጸሣሳፋና

Now they’ve run out of money AND cows.
Only thing they have left is their bodies, and the land.

Genesis 47:19

Why should we die before your
eyes, both we and our land? Buy
us and our land for bread, and
we and our land will be servants
to Pharaoh; and give seed so
we’ll live and not die, and the
land won’t be devastated.”

ሃጊገጊጋሪ ጸክሣገ ሕሣሪ
ነገጸሣሳፋ ሣገ ነገፀገቱ ሣገ
ነገጸሣሳፋ ጸፋና ነገጸቱ ሕገዋ
ነገፀገቱ ሕጊሕገና ሣፀሪጽ
ሕፀገገሪ ሣጊሳጽፀ ነገጸሣሳፋና
ፋሪና ሕጊፀገና ፀገጋ ገጸና
ሣሠጸ ፋሪ ሕሣሳፋን ጸክሣገ

They’re like “We’re dying, our land is dying, buy both please, need bread.”
They promise to be slaves in exchange for his seed.

Genesis 47:20

And Joseph bought all the land
of Egypt for Pharaoh, because
Egypt, each man, sold his field,
because the famine was strong
on them. And the land became
Pharaoh’s.

ጸሣሳፋ ረሃ ጸፋ ገብቶጊ ገዋጊና
ጊሃ ሕፀገገሪ ሣጊጸጸሣ
ሠጊቱ ሣጊጸጸሣ ነጻሣሣ
ሣሕሪዐ ዋጋፀ ጊሃ ነቋሳሠ
ጸጻፋቱ ጊሕጸና ጽፀጻቱ
ሕፀገገሪ

He buys all the land in the country.

Genesis 47:21

And the people: he moved them into cities, from one edge of Egypt's border to its other edge.

የጸፋ ዓገጽ ዓገጽ ሃወገድ ጸፋ
ረገገ ጸገገ ሃወገድ ሃወገድ
የጸገገ ሃወገድ ሃወገድ

He moves the people to the inner cities.

Genesis 47:22

Only the priests' land he did not buy, because it was a law for the priests from Pharaoh, and they ate their statutory share that Pharaoh had given them. On account of this they did not sell their land.

ፋሪ ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ጸፋ የሪገገ ጸፋ ዓገጽ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
የሃወገድ ፋሪ ጸፋ ዓገጽ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ

He couldn't buy the churches.

There was this law where the priests get free food from Pharaoh.

So the priests didn't need food and got to keep their land.

Genesis 47:23

And Joseph said to the people, "Here, I've bought you and your land for Pharaoh today. Look: seed for you. And you'll sow the land;

ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ጸፋ ሃወገድ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ

He's like "Here, I've bought all you people and your land."

Then he's like "Look," and he gives them his seed.

Genesis 47:24

and it will be, at the harvests, that you'll give a fifth to Pharaoh, and the four parts will be yours for field seed and for you to eat and for whoever is in your households and for your infants to eat."

ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ዓገጽ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ ዓገጽ ጸፋ
ሃወገድ ጸፋ

Genesis 47:25

And they said, “You’ve kept us
alive! Let us find favor in my
lord’s eyes, and we’ll be servants
to Pharaoh.”

They’re really happy with this arrangement.

And Joseph set it as a law to this day on Egypt's land: to Pharaoh the fifth. Only the land of the priests alone was not Pharaoh's.

Genesis 47:27

And Israel lived in Egypt in the land of Goshen, and they held property in it. And they were fruitful and multiplied very much.

וַיֵּשְׁבוּ בְּאֶרֶץ גֹּשֶׁן וַיִּהְיוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל פְּרוּסִים וַיִּכְפְּרוּ בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם

So they lived in Egypt, in the town of Dirt Pile, and they owned their own land, and they had lots of babies.

And Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years. And Jacob's days, the years of his life, were seven years and a hundred forty years.

וַיְחִי יַעֲקֹב בְּאֶרֶץ
 מִצְרַיִם שִׁבְעַת עָשָׂרָה
 שָׁנָה וַיְחִי יָמָיו יַעֲקֹב
 שְׁנַיִם חֲמִיּוֹן שִׁבְעַת שָׁנִים
 וְאַרְבָּעִים וּמֵאֵת שָׁנָה׃

Genesis 47:29

And Israel’s days to die drew close. And he called his son, Joseph, and said to him, “If I’ve found favor in your eyes, place your hand under my thigh and practice kindness and faithfulness with me: don’t bury me in Egypt.

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ḲḲ ḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲ ḲḲḲ ḲḲ ḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲ ḲḲ ḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲḲ

Now Israel’s time is almost up.

He calls Joseph and says

Son, put your hand under my ירך³⁸⁸ and promise you won’t bury me in Egypt.

Genesis 47:30

And I’ll lie with my fathers, and you’ll carry me out of Egypt and bury me in their burial place.” And he said, “I’ll do according to your word.”

ḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲ

Take me back home and bury me next to Laughter and Granddad.

Joseph agrees.

Genesis 47:31

And he said, “Swear to me.” And he swore to him. And Israel bowed at the head of the bed.

ḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ
ḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲḲ

He says “Swear to me.”

And he did.

And he bowed at the head of the stick or the bed.³⁸⁹

³⁸⁸This term for where babies come from in Gen. 46:26.

³⁸⁹Heb. מִטָּה (MṬH): either מִטָּה, “bed,” as vocalized by the Masoretes, or מִטָּה, ‘staff,’ as read by the Septuagint and Heb. 11:21.

Genesis 48

Genesis 48:1

And it was after these things,
and one said to Joseph, “Here,
your father is sick.” And he took
his two sons with him,
Man-asseh and Ephraim.

אֵת אֵלֶּיךָ בָּרְכוּ אֲבֹתֶיךָ
וְעַתָּה אֲנִי זָקֵן וְעָלִיתִי
אֶל אֲבוֹתִי וְאַתָּה וְשְׁנֵי בָנֶיךָ
עִמָּךְ יָבוֹאוּ וְעָלִיתְךָ
אִתָּם וְאָמַרְתָּ אֶל אֲבוֹתֶיךָ
כֹּה אָמַרְתִּי לַיהוָה וְכֹה
עָשָׂה לִּי וְעַתָּה אֲנִי זָקֵן

After that someone tells Joseph his father is sick.

Genesis 48:2

And one told Jacob and said,
“Here, your son Joseph is
coming to you.” And Israel
fortified himself and sat up on
the bed.

וְעַתָּה יוֹסֵף בָּרְכוּ אֲבֹתֶיךָ
וְעַתָּה אֲנִי זָקֵן וְעָלִיתִי
אֶל אֲבוֹתִי וְאַתָּה וְשְׁנֵי בָנֶיךָ
עִמָּךְ יָבוֹאוּ וְעָלִיתְךָ
אִתָּם וְאָמַרְתָּ אֶל אֲבוֹתֶיךָ
כֹּה אָמַרְתִּי לַיהוָה וְכֹה
עָשָׂה לִּי וְעַתָּה אֲנִי זָקֵן

Someone tells dad Joseph’s coming.

He sits up on the bed.

Genesis 48:3

And Jacob said to Joseph, “El
Shadday appeared to me in Luz
in the land of Canaan, and He
blessed me

וַיֹּאמֶר יַעֲקֹב אֶל יוֹסֵף
אֵל שַׁדַּי נִרְאָה אֵלַי
בְּלוּז בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתִי:

Jacob tells Joseph about his conversation with El Shaddai back in Gen. 35:11.

Genesis 48:4

and said to me, ‘Here, I’m
making you fruitful and
multiplying you, and I’ll make
you into a community of
peoples, and I’ll give this land
to your seed after you, an
eternal possession.’

וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי הִנְנִי מְבָרֵךְ
וְהִרְבֵּיתִיךָ וְנִתְתִּיךָ
לְקָהָל עַמִּים וְנָתַתִּי אֶת
הָאֶרֶץ הַזֹּאת לְזֶרְעֶךָ
אֶתְרִיךָ אֶחָדָה עוֹלָם:

Jacob embellishes a bit.³⁹⁰

Genesis 48:5

And now, your two sons who were born to you in the land of Egypt by my arrival to you at Egypt: they're mine. Ephraim and Man-asseh will be like Reuben and Simeon to me.

וְעַתָּה שְׁנֵי בָנֶיךָ
הַנּוֹלָדִים לְךָ בְּאֶרֶץ
מִצְרַיִם עַד בָּאִי אֵלַיךָ
מִצְרַיִמָּה לִי הֵם אֶפְרַיִם
וּמְנַשֶּׁה כְּרְאוּבֵן וְשִׁמְעוֹן
יִהְיוּ לִי׃

Jacob says his his son's sons will be like sons to him.

That's presumably because they're gonna be territories.

We had to merge two of the twelve into Joseph to get back to twelve total tribes when the Levites showed up.

Genesis 48:6

And your offspring that you'll have after them will be yours. They shall be called by their brothers' names with regard to their inheritance.

וּמִוֹלְדֶתְךָ אֲשֶׁר הוֹלִדְתָּ
אַחֲרֵיהֶם לְךָ יִהְיוּ עַל
שֵׁם אֲחֵיהֶם יִקְרָאוּ
בְּנִתְלָתָם׃

The kids after that will be yours.

Just call them Ephraim and Manasseh because reasons.

What did I tell ya.

Genesis 48:7

³⁹⁰REF: I'm making you fruitful and multiplying you, and I'll make you ... But God did not say, "I'll make you fruitful..." God said, "Be fruitful ..." (35:11). Why does Jacob tell Joseph that God promised to do it when God actually told him to do it? Perhaps it is because Jacob has only one more son (Benjamin) after God tells him this, and so the becoming fruitful must refer to the births of his grandchildren and great-grandchildren. Jacob would not see this as in his power but rather as God's doing, and so he understands God's words not as a command but as a promise and a blessing.

And I: when I was coming from Paddan Aram, Rachel died by me in the land of Canaan on the way when there was still a span of land to come to Ephrat, and I buried her there on the Ephrat road. That’s Bethlehem.”

ואני בבאי מפרן מתה
עלי רחל בארץ כנען
בדרך בעוד כברת
ארץ לבא אפרתה
ואקברה שם בדרך
אפרת הוא בית לחם:

I buried Rachel at Bethlehem, on the road to Fertility. This is still El Shaddai talking by the way.³⁹¹

Genesis 48:8

And Israel saw Joseph’s sons and said, “Who are these?”

וַיַּרְא יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת-בְּנֵי יוֹסֵף
וַיֹּאמֶר מַה אֵלֶּם

Ok so Israel sees the grandkids he was talking about three sentences ago and he’s like “Who are these?”³⁹²

Genesis 48:9

And Joseph said to his father, “They’re my sons, whom God has given me here.” And he said, “Bring them to me, and I’ll bless them.”

וַיֹּאמֶר יוֹסֵף אֶל-אֲבִיו
וַיֹּאמֶר הֵם בְּנֵי
אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר
נָתַן לִי בְּאֶרֶץ
מִצְרָיִם

Joseph explains who they are.

Jacob wants to do the death-bed blessing thing.

³⁹¹REF: Verse 7 fits uncomfortably in its context, connecting neither to the preceding nor to the following verses. And it merges elements of two sources: It refers to Paddan Aram, which is characteristic of P, but it says “there was still a span of land to come to Ephrath,” and it refers to Rachel’s being buried on the Ephrath road, which comes from E (Gen 35:16–20). It therefore appears to be an addition that the Redactor made to the text. Perhaps its function was to separate the two conflicting passages about Ephraim and Manasseh that precede and follow it. See the next note. Alternatively, this verse might after all be P, because it fits with the next P passage (49:29–33). As a unit these two passages could be saying: “As for me: Rachel died and was buried on the road, but when I die I want to be buried back in my ancestral tomb with the other patriarchs and matriarchs.” It is therefore uncertain whether v. 7 is P or R.

³⁹²REF: In v. 5 Jacob promotes Ephraim and Manasseh to full status, equal to his own sons. But now in v. 8 he looks at them and asks, “Who are these?”! The former verse is P, and the contradiction developed when this verse was placed in the middle of the E passage about Ephraim and Manasseh.

Genesis 48:10

And Israel's eyes were heavy from old age. He was not able to see. And he brought them close to him, and he kissed them and embraced them.

፲፭፻ ለ፭፻፵፯ ጊዜ
 ጸፋፍ ለሦስት ፊት ስዋጋሣ
 ዋጋጊ ፍገረፍ ሣጽፍ ሠገጊፍ
 ሣፋ ምፃፃጊ ሣፋ

And Israel's eyes were **heavy** from old age.

He couldn't see a thing.

And so he does the thing he tricked his dad into doing.³⁹³

Genesis 48:11

And Israel said to Joseph, "I didn't expect to see your face; and, here, God has shown me your seed as well."

፲፱፻፳ ለ፭ ለ፭፻፵፯ ሰሣፍጊፍ
 ጊጽፈፍ ፊት ሣጊጊ ፋፍፍ
 ለ፭ ጊጽፍ ፋፍፍፍ ፋፍፍፍ
 ሣፀፀ ጽፍ ሣገ ሣጊፍ

Then the blind man talks about three things he just saw.

Fortunately we're in Egypt, where the local writing system allows us to visualize the things Jacob might have seen, if he could see.

For instance, here's Jacob.



Genesis 48:12

And Joseph brought them out from between his knees, and he bowed, his nose to the ground.

ሣፀሣ ሣጽፍ ፲፱፻፳ ፋጦፍጊፍ
 ፍጊፍ ፍፅፀፍ ፍጊሣፍፍ
 ፋጦፍፍ

Ok so Joseph brings his kids to grandpa, then he bows, nose to the ground.

³⁹³REF: Israel's eyes were heavy from old age. The analogy to his father is obvious. When Isaac had been old, on his deathbed, unable to see, Jacob had come and appropriated his brother Esau's blessing. Now Jacob himself is old, on his deathbed, unable to see, and he favors the younger son, Ephraim, in his blessing.



Genesis 48:13

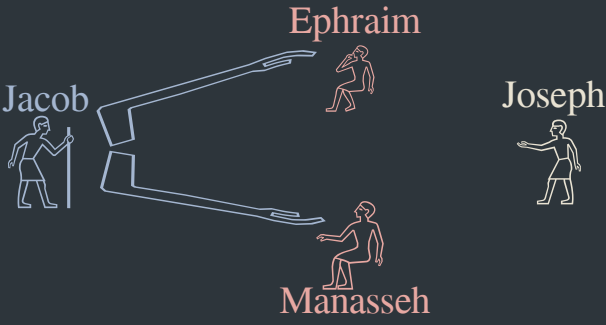
And Joseph took the two of them, Ephraim in his right hand, at Israel’s left; and Manasseh in his left hand, at Israel’s right; and he brought them over to him.

ሃጻንኑ ወደ ገዳቱ ወደታለ
የሃንሃን ሃንገሩ ወደ
ወደ ለደሃን ለደሃን
ሃንሃን የለደሃን ገደሃን
የረረ ወደ ለደሃን

Now he stands up and brings them over to dad.

Ephraim’s on Joseph’s right, at Jacob’s left.

Manasseh’s on Joseph’s left, at Jacob’s right.

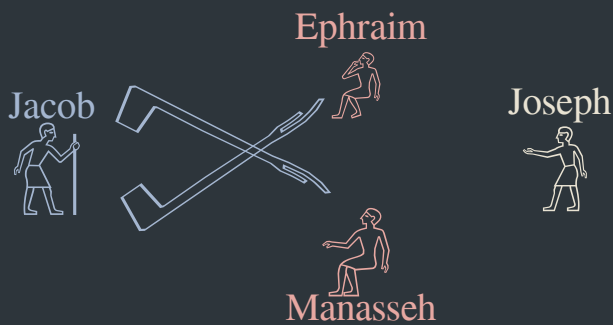


Genesis 48:14

And Israel put out his right hand and placed it on Ephraim’s head—and he was the younger—and his left hand on Manasseh’s head. He crossed his hands—because Manasseh was the firstborn.

ወደ ለደሃን ወደሃን
ወደ ለደሃን የሃንሃን
ወደ ለደሃን ሃንገሩ
ወደ ለደሃን ወደ
የረረ ወደ ለደሃን
የሃንገሩ ሃንገሩ

So now Jacob, the original blessing stealer and younger brother, crosses his hands, so his right hand goes on the younger and his left hand goes on the firstborn.



Genesis 48:15

And he blessed Joseph and said,
“The God before whom my
fathers, Abraham and Isaac,
walked, who shepherded me
from my start to this day,

የሕፃናት ገዥ ነህ ሕይወቴ
ከሕፃናት ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ከሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ

And he blesses Joseph.

Genesis 48:16

the angel who redeemed me from
all bad, may He bless the boys.
And may my name be called on
them, and the name of my
fathers, Abraham and Isaac.
And may they spawn into a great
number within the earth.”

ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ

He asks for Ephraim and Manasseh to be called Israel, and to be spawned into a great number, which comes true, because all these people become tribes once we get to Exodus, and then they become places once we're in the land, which (unsurprisingly) is called Israel (sort of (some of the time (more often in the North.)))

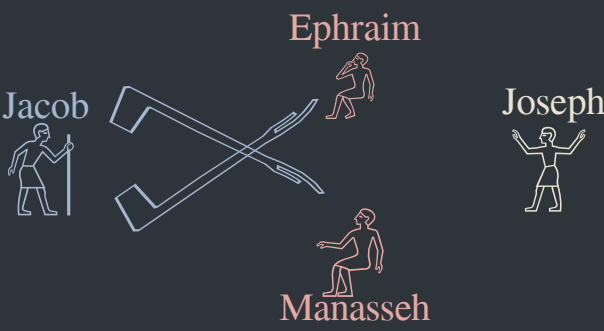
Genesis 48:17

And Joseph saw that his father
had placed his right hand on
Ephraim's head, and it was bad
in his eyes, and he held up his
father's hand to turn it from on
Ephraim's head onto Manasseh's
head,

ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ
ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ ሕይወቴ

So Joseph sees this whole situation, and he disapproves.

In Egyptian, that’s pronounced like this:



Genesis 48:18

and Joseph said to his father,
“Not like that, my father,
because this is the firstborn. Set
your right hand on his head.”

ἰῆḡḡ Ḳ ḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
Ḳḡ ḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ Ḳ
Ḳḡ ḡḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ

So Joseph’s like “Not good dad.”



Set your right hand on his head.

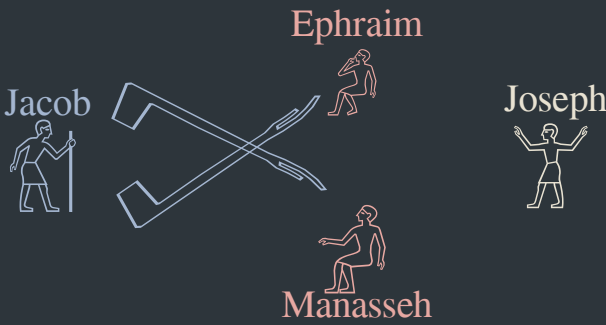


Genesis 48:19

And his father refused and said,
“I know, my son, I know. He,
too, will become a people; and
he, too, will be great. But in fact
his little brother will be greater
than he, and his seed will be
full-fledged of nations.”

ḡḡḡḡ ἰῆḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ Ḳḡḡ ḡḡḡ ḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡḡ Ḳḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ἰῆḡḡ
ḡḡ Ḳḡḡ ḡḡḡḡ ἰḡḡḡḡ
ḡḡḡ

But Jacob says



No, son.

It has to be this way.

For the book.

Genesis 48:20

And he blessed them in that day, saying, “Israel will bless with you, saying: ‘May God make you like Ephraim and like Manasseh.’” And he set Ephraim before Manasseh.

ፋፋፋ ሠፍፍ ሠላምፍ
ፋፋፋ ሠላም ሠላ ሠላፍ
ሠፍፍ ሠላም ሠላፍ
ሠላፍ ሠላም ሠላፍ
ሠላፍ ሠላም ሠላፍ

He blesses them by talking about how he’ll bless them.

Ephraim’s the favorite.

Genesis 48:21

And Israel said to Joseph, “Here, I’m dying. And God will be with you and will bring you back to your fathers’ land.

ፋፋፋ ፋፋ ፋፋፋ ሠላፍፍ
ፋፋፋ ሠላ ሠላፍ ፋፋፋ
ፋፋፋ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ፋፋፋ
ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ፋፋፋ

So Israel’s like “I’m dying, son.”

Genesis 48:22

And I’ve given you one shoulder over your brothers, which I took from the Amorite’s hand with my sword and my bow.

ሠላ ሠላ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ
ሠላ ሠላፍ ሠላ ሠላፍ
ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ
ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ ሠላፍ

Then he makes a pun about Shechem.³⁹⁴

³⁹⁴REF: one shoulder over your brothers. This expression appears to refer to Joseph’s getting two tribes while each of his brothers gets only one. But it also puns on the word for shoulder, Hebrew š kem (Shechem). Shechem is the name of the city that will one

Genesis 49

Genesis 49:1

And Jacob called to his sons and
said: GATHER, AND I’LL
TELL YOU WHAT WILL HAPPEN
TO YOU IN THE FUTURE DAYS.

לך גפוז קאפזי
גפז קאפזי קאפזי
[] קאפזי קאפזי

Strap in folks.

Here we have the Blessing of Jacob.

It’s one of the oldest things in the bible.

There’s no way to explain what’s going on here.

... We can’t just say some words and color the sources.

... The book hasn’t seen anything quite like this before.

... Not sure how to make this work, but w/e, fuck it, follow me.

Gather round you lazy bastards, I’m dying, you know the drill.

And I’ll tell you about the future, it’s not a story, it’s my will.

OT	MT	Notes
האסף ואגד לכם	האסף ואגידה לכם את אשר יקרא אתכם באחרית הימים	The older line probably ended after “I will tell you”; the rest is a later prose expansion.

Genesis 49:2

ASSEMBLE AND LISTEN, SONS
OF JACOB, AND LISTEN TO
ISRAEL, YOUR FATHER.

קאפזי [] קאפזי
קאפזי
קאפזי קאפזי קאפזי
קאפזי קאפזי

This is poetry, so they say everything twice.

They say everything twice in poetry.

OT	MT	Notes
הקבצו בני יעקב	הקבצו ושמעו בני יעקב	The first “and listen” was probably copied from the next line.
ושמע ... אבכם	ושמעו ... אביכם	Final vowel letters were often unwritten in older spelling.

Genesis 49:3

REUBEN, YOU'RE MY
FIRSTBORN, MY POWER, AND
THE BEGINNING OF MY
MIGHT, PREEMINENT IN
BEARING AND PREEMINENT
IN STRENGTH.

רַעֲבֵן הָיָה לִּי
בְּרִכְתִּי וְהָיָה לִּי
בְּרִכְתִּי וְהָיָה לִּי
בְּרִכְתִּי וְהָיָה לִּי
בְּרִכְתִּי וְהָיָה לִּי

Rahmen, you're my seed.

See man, my first kid.

You get nothing you bastard.

You know what you did.

OT	MT	Notes
בְּכֹרִי / כַּחַ / אֵן / עַז	בְּכֹרִי / כַּחַ / אֵן / עַז	Final vowels were still pronounced but often left unwritten.
רַאשִׁית	וְרַאשִׁית	The opening “and” is probably secondary.
—	יֵתֵר שְׂאֵת	This phrase is probably corrupt and did not belong in the third line.
יֵתֵר עַז	וְיֵתֵר עַז	The opening “and” is probably secondary.

Genesis 49:4

UNSTABLE AS WATER, YOU'LL
NOT BE PREEMINENT, FOR
YOU ASCENDED YOUR
FATHER'S BED; THEN YOU
DEFILED, GOING UP TO MY
COUCH.

וְהָיָה לִּי
וְהָיָה לִּי
וְהָיָה לִּי
וְהָיָה לִּי
וְהָיָה לִּי
וְהָיָה לִּי

You're not the most stable.

It's gonna be a hard life.

For you lost your inheritance.

When you fucked my wife.

OT	MT	Notes
----- / -----	פחז כמים אל תותר	The original two-line unit is too damaged to recover.
כ עלת על משכבי	כי עלית משכבי אביך	“Onto” probably dropped out; “your father” was displaced.
אז חללת יצועי אבכם	אז חללת יצועי עלה	“Your father” probably belongs here; final עלה looks like a later repair.

Genesis 49:5

SIMEON AND LEVI ARE
BROTHERS: IMPLEMENTS OF
VIOLENCE ARE THEIR TOOLS
OF TRADE.

וְיָצְאוּ שֵׁנִי וְלֵוִי
[] וְיָצְאוּ שֵׁנִי וְלֵוִי

You two fucks disgust me.

This one doesn’t rhyme.

OT	MT	Notes
מכרתם	מכרתיהם	The longer MT ending is probably secondary.

Genesis 49:6

LET MY SOUL NOT COME IN
THEIR COUNCIL; LET MY
GLORY NOT BE UNITED IN
THEIR SOCIETY. FOR IN
THEIR ANGER THEY KILLED A
MAN, AND BY THEIR WILL
THEY CRIPPLED AN OX.

וְלֹא יָבוֹא נַפְשִׁי בְּמוֹעֵד
וְלֹא יִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה לְפָנֵיהֶם
וְלֹא יִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה לְפָנֵיהֶם
וְלֹא יִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה לְפָנֵיהֶם []
וְלֹא יִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה לְפָנֵיהֶם [.ו]

Who kills a whole town?

Remember that time?

OT	MT	Notes
תבא נפש	תבוא נפשי	Final vowel letters are absent in the older spelling.
כבדי	כבודי	The word is likely “my liver / heart,” not “my glory.”
באפם	כי באפם	כי is probably secondary.
ברצנם	וברצנם	The opening “and” is probably secondary.

Genesis 49:7

CURSED IS THEIR ANGER, FOR
IT’S STRONG, AND THEIR
WRATH, FOR IT’S HARD. I’LL
DIVIDE THEM IN JACOB, AND
I’LL SCATTER THEM IN
ISRAEL.

Ⲉⲟ ⲗⲉ ⲙⲓⲛⲁ ⲡⲓⲛⲁ
ⲛⲱⲡⲓ ⲗⲉ ⲙⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ
ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ ⲙⲓⲛⲱⲡⲓⲁ
ⲛⲱⲡⲓ ⲡⲓⲛⲱⲡⲓⲁ

You two get nothing, for your violence and tricks.
Made me look like as asshole to the neighbors, bloody dicks.

OT	MT	Notes
... קשת ... ארר ... אפצם	... קשתה ... ארר ... ואפיצם	Only the spelling is older; the sense is unchanged.

Genesis 49:8

JUDAH: YOU, YOUR
BROTHERS WILL PRAISE YOU.
YOUR HAND ON YOUR
ENEMIES’ NECK, YOUR
FATHER’S SONS WILL BOW TO
YOU.

ⲛⲱⲡⲓ ⲛⲱⲡⲓ ⲛⲱⲡⲓ
ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ
ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ
ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ ⲡⲓⲛⲁⲓⲛⲱ

Ok Judah, you’re the guy.
I was just trying to entertain myself with the rhymes.
You’re gonna be huge kid.
We’re gonna call your kids jews.

OT	MT	Notes
יהד ... יהד הד את ... ידך אחך	יהודה אתה יודוך אחיך	Two original lines were probably conflated in MT.
ידך בערף איבך	ידך בערף איבך	The final vowel letter is absent in older spelling.

Genesis 49:9

A LION’S WHELP IS JUDAH;
FROM PREY, MY SON, YOU’VE
RISEN. HE BENT, CROUCHED,
LIKE A LION; AND, LIKE A
FELINE, WHO WILL ROUSE
HIM?

𐤀𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤓𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕

We now come to the end of the suspiciously J material.

Yeah the rest is pretty weird.

What’s a whelp exactly?³⁹⁵

I dunno.

You’re a lion’s puppy Judah.

OT	MT	Notes
כלבא	וכלביא	The opening “and” is probably secondary; the rest is older spelling.

Genesis 49:10

THE SCEPTER WON’T DEPART
FROM JUDAH OR THE STAFF
FROM BETWEEN HIS LEGS
UNTIL HE COMES TO SHILOH,
AND PEOPLES’ OBEDIENCE IS
HIS.

𐤀𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕
𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕 𐤕𐤓𐤕𐤕

Oh man oh wow ok, we’re already here.

What’s the big deal?

So here we hear that

The scepter won’t depart from Judah.

*Or the staff from between his legs.*³⁹⁶

Who the hell walks...

Yeah walking sticks go in the hand—

³⁹⁵A whelp is a young carnivorous animal—such as a puppy, wolf cub, or the baby of a bear, lion, or seal.
³⁹⁶NET: Or perhaps “from his descendants,” taking the expression “from between his feet” as a euphemism referring to the genitals. In this case the phrase refers by metonymy to those who come forth from his genitals, i.e., his descendants.

Otherwise you run into it—

Different kind of stick.³⁹⁷

Is this—

I think probably.

Yeah that was J again.

So Judah’s ruler is straight.

At least until the ruler comes.³⁹⁸

God this book is the best.

This is the least serious book ever written.

And the best.

OT	MT	Notes
שפט	שבט	ב and פ were probably confused; “judge / leader” fits the line.
מבין דגלו	מבין רגליו	A one-letter change gives “from among his standards.”
----- / -----	עד כי יבא שילה ולו יקהת עמים	The second bicolon is too corrupt for a secure reconstruction. ^{399 400}

Genesis 49:11

TYING HIS ASS TO THE VINE
AND HIS SHE-ASS’S FOAL TO
THE CHOICE VINE, HE
WASHED IN WINE HIS
CLOTHING AND IN BLOOD OF
GRAPES HIS GARMENT,

וְיָקָם וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב
וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב [וְיִשְׁכַּב]
וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב
וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב וְיִשְׁכַּב [וְיִשְׁכַּב]

Ok the rest of the song is just weird.

Is this still about the rod guy?

I think so...

So he ties a donkey to a grapevine and does laundry in wine?

³⁹⁷Read with Samaritan, *dagālāw*, “his standards,” “his battle flags.” The whole phrase would read, “from the midst of his banners,” an excellent parallel to *mîhûdâ* in the first colon. The expression *mibbên raglayim* is a euphemism referring to the female genitals; cf. Deut. 28:57 (for other euphemistic usages, see lexicons). The phrase in MT could only refer to the male counterparts, and indeed is so taken by the LXX and Vulgate.

³⁹⁸שִׁילָה is notoriously uncertain. Major readings are: (1) “Shiloh,” the place; (2) “until the ruler comes”; (3) “until tribute comes to him”; or (4) “until he comes to whom it belongs.” The last three point toward a Davidic or messianic king. The ancient versions generally favor (4), apparently reading שִׁילָה as equivalent to שְׁלָה, “to whom it belongs”; this reading is also attested in numerous Hebrew manuscripts. Ancient Jewish interpreters commonly understood the line messianically.

I think so.

Why?

Nobody knows.

OT	MT	Notes
אסר לגפנו ערו	אסרי לגפן עירה	The line probably described an ass harnessed with its gear.
לשרק	ולשרקה	The opening “and” and final vowel letter are probably secondary.
בדם ענבים	ובדם ענבים	The opening “and” is probably accidental repetition.

Genesis 49:12

EYES DARKER THAN WINE AND TEETH WHITER THAN MILK.	אֵינָם כְּיַיִן וְשִׁנָּיו כְּחֵלֶב לָבָן
--	--

Normal eyes and good teeth.

Moving on.

OT	MT	Notes
חכלל ענם	חכלילי עינים	The phrase survives in a shorter old spelling.
לבן שנם	ולבן שנים	The opening “and” is probably secondary; spelling is older.

Genesis 49:13

ZEBULUN WILL DWELL BY SEASHORES: AND HE’LL BE A SHORE FOR BOATS, AND HIS BORDER AT SIDON.	יִזְבֻּלֹן יֵשֵׁב בְּיָמֵי יָם וְהָיָה לְיָם וְהָיָה לְיָם וְהָיָה לְיָם וְהָיָה לְיָם וְהָיָה לְיָם
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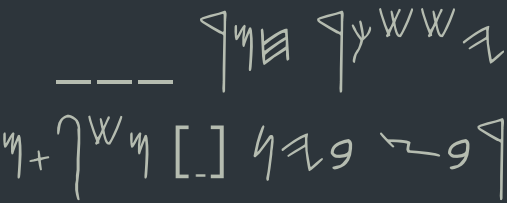
Ok so now we move onto the kids who didn’t really have any stories about them.

Zebulun’s good at boats.

OT	MT	Notes
לחף ימים ישב / על מפרצן ישכן	לחוף ימים ישכן	The first bicolon was damaged; a parallel preserves the missing wording.
----- / -----	והוא לחוף אניות וירכתו על צידון	The second bicolon is too garbled to re-cover securely.

Genesis 49:14

ISSACHAR IS A STRONG ASS
CROUCHING BETWEEN THE
SADDLE-PACKS:



Issachar's a donkey.

No one's really sure what lots of this is about.

Do we at least know he's a donkey?

Here's some translations...

1. Issachar, an ass; a heap of bone lying down in the midst of the tribes.
2. Issachar is a rawboned donkey lying down among the sheep pens.
3. Issachar will be a strong donkey, reclining between the borders.
4. Issachar is a large-boned ass, Couching down between the sheep-folds.
5. Issachar has desired that which is good; resting between the inheri-tances.
6. The man Isakaar is a mighty man that crouches in the place of the roads.
7. Issachar is a mighty man couching by the highways;
8. Issachar is no better than a donkey That lies stretched out between its saddlebags.
9. Issachar is a bony ass, Crouching down between two hurdles.
10. Issachar, you are a strong donkey resting in the meadows.
11. Issachar shalbe a strong asse, couching downe betweene two burdens.
12. Isachar shal be a stronge Asse, & laye him downe betwixte ye bor-ders.

I learned something today.

OT	MT	Notes
חמר ---	חמר גרם	The second word is too obscure to re-cover securely.
בין משפתם	בין המשפתיים	The article is probably secondary; the ending reflects older spelling.

Genesis 49:15

AND HE SAW REST, THAT IT
WAS GOOD, AND THE LAND,
THAT IT WAS PLEASANT, AND
HE LEANED HIS SHOULDER TO
BEAR AND BECAME A
WORK-COMPANY SERVANT.

וַיַּרְא מְנוּחָה וַיֵּדַע כֵּן
וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל
וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל
וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל

When he sees a good resting place, and the pleasant land, he will bend his shoulder to the burden and become a slave laborer.

He works real hard until he finds a good place to get some rest and do slavery in, I guess.

OT	MT	Notes
וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל	וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל	The opening “and” is probably secondary; the noun is read “his resting place.”
וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל	וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל	Words probably dropped out and the line was later repaired.
וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל	וַיִּשְׁכַּח עָלָיו עֹמֶל	The opening “and” is probably secondary.

Genesis 49:16

DAN WILL JUDGE HIS PEOPLE
AS ONE OF THE TRIBES OF
ISRAEL:

וְדָן יִשְׁפֹּט אֶת עַמּוֹ
וְדָן יִשְׁפֹּט אֶת עַמּוֹ
וְדָן יִשְׁפֹּט אֶת עַמּוֹ

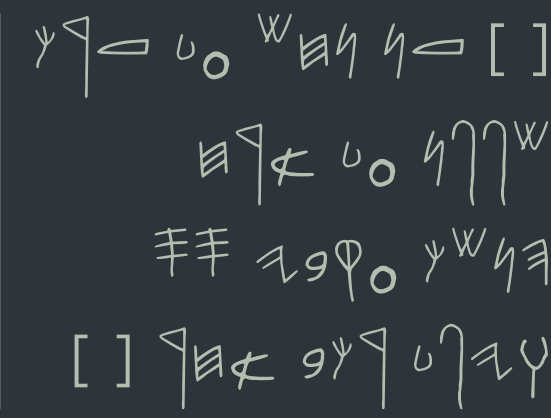
Dan’s verse is a straightforward pun on his name.

Dan d’ דן ידן דין דין.

OT	MT	Notes
דן ידן דין דין	דן ידן עמו	דן probably dropped out by accidental repetition.

Genesis 49:17

DAN WILL BE A SNAKE ON A ROAD, A VENOMOUS SNAKE ON A PATH, THAT BITES A HORSE’S HEELS, AND ITS RIDER FALLS BACKWARD.



Dan is a snake and a שפפן.

He’s a snk and a b’nunny r’babbit.

Nobody knows what most of these words mean.

Translations?

“Dan shall be a serpent in the way, An adder in the path, That biteth the horse’s heels, So that his rider falleth backward.”

He’s a snky snk; the bni of Jcb.

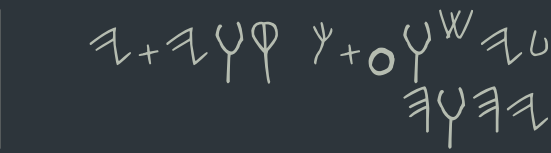
Something about ארר אחר.

Next.

OT	MT	Notes
דן	יהי דן	יהי is probably secondary.
ויפל רכב אחר	ויפל רכבו אחר	Older spelling gives the same basic picture.

Genesis 49:18

I WAIT FOR YOUR SALVATION, YHWH.



“This book is about YHWH.”

My stomach hurts.

OT	MT	Notes
—	לשועתך קויתי יהוה	The whole verse is probably a later liturgical insertion.

OT	MT	Notes
אשר	מאשר	The initial מ probably belongs at the end of verse 19.
שמן לחמו / שמנה ארצו	שמנה לחמו	Two older variants were probably conflated.
יתן	והוא יתן	והוא is probably an accidental repetition.

Genesis 49:21

NAPHTALI: A HIND LET
LOOSE, WHO GIVES LOVELY
WORDS.

Mein Kamph is a loose ass.

Lovely words.

I love the bible so much.

The corruption continues.

OT	MT	Notes
----- / -----	נפתלי אילה שלחה הנתן אמרי שפר	The whole couplet is too corrupt for a secure reconstruction.

Genesis 49:22

A FRUITFUL BOUGH IS
JOSEPH, A FRUITFUL BOUGH
OVER A SPRING, BRANCHES
RUNNING OVER A WALL:

Joseph’s a fruit.

Explains the rainbow shirt.

And running away from the girl.

Only one wife, suspicious.

Too corrupt, moving on.

OT	MT	Notes
----- / -----	בן פרת יוסף ... בנות צעדה עלי שור	The verse is too corrupt for a secure reconstruction.

Genesis 49:23

AND ARCHERS BITTERLY
ATTACKED HIM, SHOT AT
HIM, AND DESPISED HIM.

I don’t remember this part of the story.
Something about a bicolon.

OT	MT	Notes
----- / -----	ורבו וימררהו בעלי וישטמהו חצים	The bicolon cannot be reassembled securely.
יִרִיבָהוּ	ורבו	Samaritan probably preserves the better reading: “they strove against him.”

Genesis 49:24a

Verse 24a has defied the best efforts of scholars for many years. Nothing satisfactory has resulted. The versions only add to the confusion.

This is the best book ever.

You said it.

Genesis 49:24b

FROM THE HANDS OF THE
MIGHTY ONE OF JACOB,
FROM THE KEEPER OF THE
SONS OF ISRAEL, FROM THE
SHEPHERD.

פִּזְמֹנֶה יִרְיָבָהוּ
וְיִשְׁטַמְהוּ
וְיִרְיָבָהוּ
וְיִשְׁטַמְהוּ
וְיִרְיָבָהוּ

Are we still talking about Joseph?

As recognized by most scholars, MT does not make sense, and is also overly long. In the first two words of the colon, מִשְׁמַרְעָה, there is a conflated reading. One or two letters have dropped out by haplography, the original variants being *miššōmēr* and *mērō’ê*; written out in early orthography the text would have appeared something like this, מִשְׁמַרְמַאֲרַע or מִשְׁמַרְרַע.

The word יִרְיָבָהוּ is impossible in this context. What is required is a parallel to *ya’āqōb*, and “Israel-stone,” whatever that might mean, will not do. The

simplest emendation is to read *bənê* (בני) for *’eben*; the intrusion of the *aleph* might be due to the influence of אביר in the first colon of vs. 24b.

Genesis 49:25

FROM YOUR FATHER’S GOD,
AND HE’LL STRENGTHEN
YOU, AND SHADDAY, AND
HE’LL BLESS YOU, BLESSINGS
OF SKIES FROM ABOVE,
BLESSINGS OF DEEP,
CROUCHING BELOW,
BLESSINGS OF BREAST AND
WOMB.

יְיָ אֱלֹהֵי אֲבִיךָ וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
יְיָ אֱלֹהֵי אֲבִיךָ אֶלְמַדְּכָה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה

Tod Shaddai will bless את you.

He’ll brk right at you from the sky.

Blessings of deep.

What’s he crouching below?

Read it.⁴⁰³

OT	MT	Notes
וְאֵל־שָׁדַי	וְאֵת שָׁדַי	A one-letter change gives “and El-Shaddai.”
מִתַּחַת	רִבְצַת תַּחַת	רִבְצַת probably entered by harmoniza- tion with Deut. 33.

Genesis 49:26

BLESSINGS OF YOUR FATHER,
THE MIGHTY AND MOST
HIGH, BLESSINGS OF THE
MOUNTAINS OF OLD DESIRED
OBJECT OF THE HILLS OF
ANTIQUITY. THEY’LL BE ON
JOSEPH’S HEAD, ON THE TOP
OF THE HEAD OF THE ONE
SEPARATE FROM HIS
BROTHERS.

<יְיָ אֱלֹהֵי> אֲבִיךָ וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה
וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה וְיִשְׁׁמְצֶנָּה

⁴⁰³Shadday. The MT reads just Shadday, but evidence from other versions indicates that the line should read El Shadday. (The MT reads ’et where it should read ’l.)

The blessinges of thy father were stronge: euen as the blessinges of my elders after the desyre of the hiest in the worlde

and these blessings shall fall on the head of Ioseph

and on the toppe of the head of him yt was separat from his brethern.

BENJAMIN IS A TEARING
WOLF: IN THE MORNING
EATING PREY, AND AT
EVENING DIVIDING BOOTY.

$\gamma \otimes \alpha \otimes \beta \in \gamma \otimes \alpha \otimes \beta$
 $\gamma \otimes \alpha \otimes \beta \in \gamma \otimes \alpha \otimes \beta$
 $\gamma \otimes \alpha \otimes \beta \in \gamma \otimes \alpha \otimes \beta$

At night.

!!!

Genesis 49:28

All these are the tribes of Israel, twelve, and this is what their father spoke to them, and he blessed them. He blessed them each according to his blessing.

כל אלה שבטי ישראל
שנים עשר וזאת אשר
דבר להם אביהם
ויברך אותם איש אשר
כברכתו ברך אתם

We did it!

Jacob’s dead!

Not yet.

Is he getting better?

No. He’s heeling.

Genesis 49:29

And he commanded them and said to them, “I’m being gathered to my people. Bury me: to my fathers, to the cave that’s in the field of Ephron, the Hittite,

ויצו אותם ויאמר
אלהם אני נאסף אל
עמי קברו אתי אל
אבתי אל המערה אשר
בשדה עפרון החתי

He’s like “I’M BEING GATHERED TO MY PEOPLE!”

Put me in that cave Abe bought fair and square.

Genesis 49:30

in the cave that’s in the field of Machpelah, which faces Mamre in the land of Canaan, as Abraham bought the field from Ephron, the Hittite, as a possession for a tomb.

במערה אשר בשדה
המכפלה אשר על פני
ממרא בארץ כנען
אשר קנה אברהם
את השדה מאת עפרון
החתי לאחוזת קבר

You know the one.

Genesis 49:31

There they buried Abraham and Sarah, his wife. There they buried Isaac and Rebekah, his wife. And there I buried Leah.

שָׁמָּה קָבְרוּ אֶת אַבְרָהָם
וְאֶת שָׂרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ שָׁמָּה
קָבְרוּ אֶת יִצְחָק וְאֶת
רִבְקָה אִשְׁתּוֹ וְשָׁמָּה
קָבַרְתִּי אֶת לֵאָה

He does a quick recap of all the dead people in there.

Genesis 49:32

The field and the cave that's in it were a purchase from the children of Heth."

מִקְנֵה הַשָּׂדֶה וְהַמְעָרָה
אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ מֵאֵת בְּנֵי חֵת

Making really sure everyone knows the one.

We know the one.

Genesis 49:33

And Jacob finished commanding his sons, and he gathered his feet into the bed, and he expired, and he was gathered to his people.

וַיָּכֹל יַעֲקֹב לְצֹוֹת אֶת
בָּנָיו וַיֵּאסֹף רַגְלָיו אֶל
הַמִּטָּה וַיָּגוּעַ וַיֵּאסֹף אֶל
עַמּוּ

Jacob finishes talking.

His feet were gathered to his person.

And his person was gathered to his people.

Amen.

Genesis 50

Genesis 50:1

And Joseph fell upon his father’s face and wept over him and kissed him.

ሃገዓቶ ጊንገረዐ ገቹሃጊ ለገጊሃ ሃረ ቀሠጊሃ ሃጊረዐ ሃዓጊሃ

Joseph is understandably sad about dad.

He was dad’s favorite.

Plus dad’s one of the only family members who didn’t sell him into slavery.

Genesis 50:2

And Joseph commanded his servants, the physicians, to embalm his father. And the physicians embalmed Israel,

ሃጊፈዓዐ ተቶ ገቹሃጊ ሃሾጊሃ ተቶ ቍጎዞረ ሃጊቶገላፓ ተቶ ሃጊቶገላፓ ሃቍጎዞጊሃ ሃጊዓቶ ረቶላሠጊ ተቶ

He tells his guys to prepare for the funeral.

They embalm Israel.

Genesis 50:3

and they spent forty days on him, because that is the number of days they spent on the embalming, and Egypt mourned him seventy days.

ሃጊዐዓላቶ ሃረ ሃቶረሃጊሃ ጊሃጊ ሃቶረሃጊ ነጎ ጊጎ ሃሃጊ ሃተቶ ሃሃዓጊሃ ሃጊቍጎዞፓ ሃሃጊ ሃጊዐዓሠ ሃጊላሾሃ

They spend forty days embalming him.

Why forty?

Because that’s the number of days they spent embalming him.⁴⁰⁴

I learned something today.

⁴⁰⁴It’s also a classic bible number, along with 7, 10, and 12. No one’s quite sure why 40 ended up on the list.

Genesis 50:4

And his mourning days passed,
and Joseph spoke to Pharaoh's
house, saying, "If I've found favor
in your eyes, speak in Pharaoh's
ears, saying,

ሃተጸጋ ገሣገሪ ሃላፊዎች
ተጸጋ ረፋ ገጽሃገሪ ላላላገሪ
ፋን ሣፋ ላሣፋረ ጳዕላገ
ሣላገሪዎች ሃይ ገተፋሣ
ጳዕላገ ገሃገረፋ ፋን ሃላፊ
ላሣፋረ

He gets over it.

Then Joseph says to Pharaoh's guys,

"Please, tell Pharaoh by speaking in his ears, saying,

Genesis 50:5

'My father had me swear, saying,
'Here I'm dying. In my tomb,
which I dug for me in the land of
Canaan: you shall bury me there.'
And now, let me go up so I may
bury my father and come back.'

ላሣፋረ ገሃወገሃላ ገፋ
ገላፋዎች ተሣ ገሃሃፋ ጳላ
ሣላፋ ገረ ገተገላ ላሣፋ
ገሃፋዎች ጳሣ ሃወሃ
ፋን ጳረዐፋ ጳተዐ
ገፋ ተፋ ጳላፋዎች
ጳሣሣፋ

'My dad had me promise, he said to me "I'm dying son. Bury me back home." So I'm gonna go back home now and do that.'

Genesis 50:6

And Pharaoh said, "Go up and
bury your father as he had you
swear."

ጳረዐ ጳዕላገ ላሣፋገሪ
ላሣፋ ሃገፋ ተፋ ላፋዎች
ሃወገሃላ

Pharaoh says that was a lot of quotes but ok.

Genesis 50:7

And Joseph went up to bury his
father, and all of Pharaoh's
servants, the elders of his house,
and all the elders of the land of
Egypt,

ተፋ ላፋዎች ገጽሃገሪ ረዐሪ
ረሃ ሃተፋ ሃረዐሪ ሃገፋ
ሃተጸ ገሃዎች ጳዕላገ ገላፋ
ሣገላሣ ሣላ ገሃዎች ረሃ

Joseph goes up to bury his father.

Then there's some funny grammar that sounds like he's burying the king

and all his guys and all the old people in the country.

Don’t worry, he’s not.

Genesis 50:8

and all of Joseph’s house and his brothers and his father’s house. Only their infants and their flock and their oxen they left in the land of Goshen.

ሃገጃቶህ ገቼሃገገ ተገፋ ረዣሃ
ሃገገፀ ቀላ ሃገፋቶ ተገፋሃ
ሃፋገፀ ሃላቀፋሃ ሃሃቶሃሃ
ሃሃሃ ሃላቶሃ

We’re still in the grammar where it sounds like he’s burying everybody but it’s actually just saying who comes to the funeral.

They leave the babies and animals in Dirt Pile.⁴⁰⁵

That’s the end of the list of who came to the funeral.

Genesis 50:9

And both chariots and horsemen went up with him. It was a very heavy camp.

ሣገ ገሃፋ ሣገ ነሣፀ ሪፀገ
ጃሃፃሣጃ ገጃገገ ሣገሠፋገ
ፋቶ ፋፃሃ

Wait nevermind the list isn’t done.

Some more things come and they’re **heavy**.

Genesis 50:10

And they came to the threshing floor of Atad, which is across the Jordan, and they had a very big and heavy funeral, and he made a mourning for his father for seven days.

ፋፀቶጃ ሃፋገ ፋፀ ነቶገገ
ሃፋገገጃ ፋፃፀፃ ፋሠቶ
ሪነፋገ ፋገቼሣ ሣሠ ነፋገቼገገ
ነገገፋገ ሠፀገገ ፋቶ ፋፃሃ
ሣገሣገ ጸፀፃሠ ሪፃቶ

The funeral was **heavy** too.

Genesis 50:11

⁴⁰⁵Who’s watching those babies?

And the Canaanite residents of the land saw the mourning at the threshing floor of Atad and said, “This is a heavy mourning to Egypt.” On account of this its name was called Abel of Egypt, which is beyond the Jordan.

וַיֵּשְׂבוּ הַכְּנַעֲנִים
אֶת-הַמֵּוֹלָה
אֲשֶׁר בְּעֶמְקֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמְרוּ
זֶה מִוֹלָה עֲצִיבָה
לְעֵיפִיץ
וַיִּקְרְאוּ
אֶת-הַיָּדָם
אֶבְלֵי מִצְרָיִם
בְּעֶמְקֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
וַיֵּשְׂבוּ הַכְּנַעֲנִים
אֶת-הַמֵּוֹלָה
אֲשֶׁר בְּעֶמְקֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמְרוּ
זֶה מִוֹלָה עֲצִיבָה
לְעֵיפִיץ
וַיִּקְרְאוּ
אֶת-הַיָּדָם
אֶבְלֵי מִצְרָיִם
בְּעֶמְקֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

The Canaanites show up to comment on how the mourning is **heavy**.

That’s why we call the place Mourning.

Genesis 50:12

And his sons did so for him, as he had commanded them.

וַיַּעֲשׂוּ בָנָיו
לּוֹ כִּן כְּאֲשֶׁר
צִוָּהוּ:

Ok so one sentence before this, Jacob **finished** commanding his sons where to bury him.

So now his sons did that for him, **as he had commanded them** one sentence earlier.

Genesis 50:13

And his sons carried him to the land of Canaan and buried him in the cave of the field of Machpelah, as Abraham had bought the field as a possession for a tomb from Ephron, the Hittite, facing Mamre.

וַיֵּשְׂאוּ אֹתוֹ בָּנָיו
אֶל-רָצָה כְּנַעַן וַיִּקְבְּרוּ
אֹתוֹ בְּמַעְרַת שְׂדֵה
הַמַּכְפֵּלָה אֲשֶׁר קָנָה
אַבְרָהָם אֶת-הַשְּׂדֵה
לְאַחֲזֵת קֶבֶר מֵאֵת
עֶפְרֹן הַחִתִּי עַל פְּנֵי
מַמְרֵא:

They bury him in that cave that Abe bought fair and square back in **Gen. 23**. and everyone saw him buy it because all **the eyes of the children of Heth**, aka the Hittites, like **all who were coming to his city’s gate** saw him buy it fair and square, so nobody better dispute this in the future.⁴⁰⁶

⁴⁰⁶Oops.

Genesis 50:14

And, after his burial of his father, Joseph came back to Egypt, he and his brothers and all those who went up with him to bury his father.

ጸሐፊው ገደብን ለባለቤቱ
ሰጠው ሆኖ ለገደብ ለገደብ
ሰጠው ሆኖ ለገደብ ለገደብ
ሰጠው ሆኖ ለገደብ ለገደብ

After the funeral, Joseph et al. go back home to Egypt.

Genesis 50:15

And Joseph’s brothers saw that their father was dead, and they said, “If Joseph will despise us he’ll pay us back all the bad that we dealt to him.”

እነዚህም ገደብን ሰጠው ሆኖ
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው

Ok so Joseph’s brothers suddenly realize that maybe he secretly hated them and wanted to kill them all this time but he was just waiting for dad to die.

Genesis 50:16

And they commanded to Joseph, saying, “Your father had commanded before his death, saying,

እነዚህም ገደብን ሰጠው ሆኖ
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው

So the brothers are like “Hey your dad⁴⁰⁷ made it very clear before he died,

Genesis 50:17

‘You shall say this to Joseph: Please, bear your brothers’ offense and their sin, because they dealt you bad.’ And now bear the offense of the servants of your father’s God.” And Joseph wept when they spoke to him.

እነዚህም ገደብን ሰጠው ሆኖ
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው
ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው ሆኖ ሰጠው

⁴⁰⁷Theirs too.

he said ‘Say this to Joseph: Don’t kill your brothers for selling you into slavery forever.’ So please don’t kill us ok?”

Joseph cries.

Genesis 50:18

And his brothers also went and fell in front of him and said, “Here, we’re yours as slaves.”

፲፭፻፲፱ ፲፯፻፳ ሣ፯ ፲፱፻፳፻
ሣ፯ ፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳፻ ፲፯፻፳፻
ሣ፯፻፳፻

They’re worried about whether this is a sad laugh or a cry laugh.

So the brothers are like “Ok fine, we’ll be your slaves.”

It’s only fair.

Genesis 50:19

And Joseph said to them, “Don’t be afraid, because am I in God’s place?”

፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳ ፲፱፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ፲፱ ፲፱፻፳፻ ፲፱፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳፻

Joseph’s like “Only God would do something like that.”

Genesis 50:20

And you thought bad against me. God thought for good: in order to do as it is today, to keep alive a numerous people.

፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳፻ ሣ፯፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳ ፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳ ፲፱፻፳፻

Joseph’s like “You guys intended me harm, but God made it all work out real well for me.

God needed him to come down here and keep all the people alive by getting a monopoly on food and then selling it to them in exchange for all their land and edible animals and also tax everybody forever.

Genesis 50:21

And now, don’t be afraid. I’ll provide for you and your infants.” And he consoled them. And he spoke on their heart.

፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳፻ ፲፱፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳፻ ፲፱፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳፻ ፲፱፻፳፻
፲፱፻፳ ሣ፯፻፳፻

So never fear, Joseph’s here.

I’ll take care of you and your kids.

Now Joseph does the first act of not getting revenge for deception and mistreatment since somewhere around when dad dressed up as a goat or maybe earlier, thus bringing an end to the cycle of goats and deception.⁴⁰⁸

Genesis 50:22

And Joseph lived in Egypt, he and his father’s house. And Joseph lived a hundred ten years,

ሠጊጻኝሣጋ ገቹሃጊ ልሠጊሃ
ጊዘጊሃ ሃጊጋፋ ተጊጋሃ ፋሃጳ
ሠጊሃሠ ልሠዐሃ ጳፋሠ ገቹሃጊ

And they all live happily ever after.

Genesis 50:23

and Joseph saw children of Ephraim’s of the third generation. Also children of Machir, son of Manasseh, were born on Joseph’s knees.

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Ok so in Exod 34:6–7, we hear about how merciful YHWH is, because he only “visits the wrongdoing of fathers upon children and upon children’s children, upon the third and upon the fourth [generation].”

So if you’re a dad or mom, you’re the 0th generation.

Then children are the first generation, grandchildren the second, and great-grandchildren the third.

Thus “children of Ephraim’s of the third generation” is someone’s great-grandkids.

Could be Joseph’s great-grandkids, or maybe Ephraim’s.

The second half of the sentence describes some other great-grandkids in a different way, which may or may not mean there’s a different number of generations in that half of the sentence.

Fortunately, some people who love begat lists more than anything else in

⁴⁰⁸REF: he spoke on their heart. We have seen that each act of deception since Jacob led to another deception that came as a recompense. Thus deceptions and hurts within a family can go on in a perpetual cycle. In order to bring it to an end, one member of the family who is entitled to retribution must stop the cycle and forgive instead. That is what Joseph does here. This beautiful end of the story of deceptions and retributions completes an intricately embroidered narrative. Many interpreters have treated the Joseph cycle as if it were a separate entity, referring to it as a “novella.” Insofar as that term connotes an independent work, it is misleading, cutting off what is an integral part of this connected narrative. Symbols, ironies, and relationships of characters and events are lost when one performs this surgery and separates the Joseph cycle from the rest of the story.

the world wrote something called the book of Chronicles, which fails to clarify the issue, and makes the confusion worse.

Moving on.

Genesis 50:24

And Joseph said to his brothers, “I’m dying. And God will take account of you and will bring you up from this land to the land that He swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.”

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So Joseph’s like “I’m dying.”

He reminds the brothers about how God has been promising to give them Canaan since Abe.

Now that hasn’t happened yet, but don’t forget it, it’ll be important until they finally get there in book six.

... This was book one.^{409 410}

Genesis 50:25

And Joseph had the children of Israel swear, saying, “God will take account of you, and you’ll bring up my bones from here.”

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Joseph has his family promise to bring his bones back home and bury him with dad and grandpa Laughter and great grandpa Abe, so he can be gathered to his people.

Genesis 50:26

And Joseph died, a hundred ten years old, and they embalmed him and set him in a coffin in Egypt.

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Joseph dies.

⁴⁰⁹Strap in folks.

⁴¹⁰The bible’s long.

They embalm him, same as dad.

We're kind of big on that here in Egypt.

... Get used to it, we're gonna be here a while.

אבגד הוואחטינל פנחענצ-
קרשת

GENESIS

APOCRYPHA

GENESIS I APOCRYPHON: INFINITE J EST

אבגד הוואחטינל פנחענצ קרשת

FRAGMENT 1

Day One

I am seated in an office, surrounded by heads and bodies. My posture is consciously erect against the hard wood of my seat as i{ si,}t{ w/ it,} presse{d,s} oppressively against the soft flesh of my seat, respectively. This is a cold room in Priestly Administration.

I am in here.

Three faces have resolved into place above the paper strewn table. There are three Deans — of Integration, of Publication, and Some Long Thing I Forget⁴¹¹

They are a Mushite, a Levite, and a Redactor, respectively.

⁴¹¹Editor's Note: The final one was the Dean of, and I quote, “Codification And Formalization Of Tabernacular Administration And Policy To Ensure Compliance With All Requirements And Required Procedures For No Less Than The Full Duration Of All Steps Of Creation Including Compilation And Assembly And Linkage In Preparation For Execution And Distribution Of The Officially Finalized And Blessed Production Ready Publication So Sayeth The Lord” but we understand why the speaker couldn't remember all that.

Scratch that, not respectively.

I do not know which face belongs to whom.

I've just been calling them E, P, & R (respectively this time).

That's just what I call them privately, like inside my head or whatever.

This is the first time we're meeting in person.

But we all sort of know each other — insofar as one can know anything of significance about another person just from like, text — as a result of all the correspondence we've been sending back and forth through the official slow-ish channels over the past however-long-its-been since we started the process of preparing for the publication process which I guess begins (like officially) with, well... this.

P: I'd like to bring a motion before the committee.

R: What about?

P: (confused)

R: Really, P?

P: (Making a hurt look in R's direction for unclear reasons.)

E: I think he just wants you to say it his way, R.

P: (Now indignant in E's direction) I don't think I'm being unreasonable by reminding everyone that we have procedures for a reason and—

R: “Request for motion is granted by the committee.”

P: (Nods graciously at R). I would like to submit a motion to the committee that we put, to a vote, the decision of whether to issue a formal statement to J reminding the author in question that if he or she would like to be excused due to issues of health, particularly the presence of infirmity of body or mind, particularly as concerns the above mentioned party's soundness of mind or mental capacity to participate effectively in the present meeting, then the correct course of action is for the above mentioned party to request to be excused and go to the infirmary or to his or her choice of health management services facility and not simply allow the meeting to continue in a manner that is decidedly unproductive for all members involved because to do so would result in the delay of progress on the shared task at hand by means of an entirely unproductive and unnecessary waste of time.

E: (Rolls eyes.)

R: He's talking to you, J.

Narrator: Fuck, I zoned out, what did I miss?

J: Can you repeat the question?

P: It wasn't a question. I was saying that if you're feeling unwell and aren't able to participate effectively in the meeting then you should go to the infirmary and see a doctor instead of just sitting here and wasting our time.

J: I'm not sick.

R: (To P). You two are gonna have to learn to work together.

E: (To J). He knows you're not sick he's just being a dick.

P: (Tilts head and widens eyes, silent but visibly furious at E.)

J: (Smiles silently to self at how E's sentence rhymed.)

R: (Gesturing to E and P). You too.

J: ...sorry, what did I do?

E: (To J). Nothing.

J: (Looks from face to face, gathering data.)

E: (To all). Ok folks, let's get this show going. Where we were?

R: Genesis 1.

P: I found J's version unacceptable.

E: And said you'd resign the committee unless we agreed to a rewrite.

J: Oh! Ok. No problem, sorry I didn't realize that's what we were talking about but wow yeah sure a rewrite is fine with me. Let's do this! (Visibly energized.) I'm sorry for whatever happened earlier P, I just, nevermind, I just really love writing so I'm... what I'm just trying to say is... it's... I'm ready. Next time just say what you mean and I promise I won't be offended, I love writing and I'm not married to any of this so I'm always happy to get in a room together and hash out a better version in whatever direction you're looking for, I'm just grateful for any chance to write in like an official capacity or whatever this is cuz I just... I just love it. This job. Writing I mean. And you guys seem great, genuinely, so I'm sorry for earlier. And definitely no objections to a rewrite from me, so let's get down to business what's the problem?

R: (Sighs in a weird way that seems to be acknowledging defeat somehow, what's going on with R?)

E: (Making a face at me sort of like the face a friendly coach might make to a player that means something like “I'm on your side, but there's no coming back from this, they're killing us out there at whatever sport this is, let's give it our best next time” but I don't know what we're

losing, what happened, why those eyes, I was so excited to get started on the edits what's wrong why next time?)

P: I think we can all agree I was right.

R: (Does a similar face to E's one, but in a slightly more neutral way. Not the face a coach would make. More like a referee or someone else that seems like a genuine good person but takes it as part of their responsibility to not be seen as taking sides.)

J: You probably were, this was probably my fault I'm just confu—

R: (Non-maliciously, the tone seems more like how a policeman acts if a third party sees him not enforcing some law that they basically never enforce nor want to enforce so he needs to come over and give you a talking to, because of the third party, because that's his job you know what I mean.) J, please come prepared next time.

Narrator: The three Deans calmly stand up, get their papers, and exit the room in the slow sort of way that three people in this situation understandably would after whatever just happened, if it was something as negative as they all unanimously appeared to agree it was, I mean the manner and speed and style with which they exited the room and the faces they each made at each other and me all make perfect sense if we grant for the sake of argument that something of the type they all acted like had just happened had happened, everything makes sense in context if we assume something like that happened but what happened?

Narrator: One week later, at exactly the same time as last week, but one hour earlier because P has a festival to attend right after this. Not sure which one. There's a lot. Oh shit they're talking I need to pay attention.

P: —tival at which I've been invited to speak.

R: Let's try to make this more productive than last week.

J: Sorry for whatever last week was.

R: I'm not pointing fingers.

E: Let's get moving guys.

R: Ok so...

Goto: Minutes of meeting on Genesis 1, and how the final version you know (and maybe love) came to be, as a result of the distinct personalities of these three, and look up the Documentary Hypothesis if none of that made sense or more simply in summary: Welcome to We.

YHWH AND ABRAHAM

אבֿרָהָם הָאֵלֹהִים יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ

FRAGMENT 1

N— no it doesn— look at me Abraham. ABRAHAM. Look at me. It doe— (*burp*) doesn't matter what El thinks Abraham, loo— look at me, it's doesn't matter what he thinks, I'm Yahweh babe, I'm the o—(*falls asleep for two seconds mid sentence*)nly god im the only one ok, th— the only one you need to worry about ok? it doesn't matter what El thinks, thi— y'know what fuck it, I'm El. Tha— That's right El Shaddai. That's my other name Abraham, that... that's me, that was always me. Wh— what we talking about before...

Oh right, spread your seed I'll spread it everywhere man just trus— trust me I'll.. I'll spr... spread it. Infinite **paternity** my guy, descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky cuz you're my guy Abraham my #1 guy, and we're gonna get you some **paternity** cuz I'm building a team, and I chose you cuz you're my people, my favorite chosen people, once I get you all that **paternity** were gonna make some people Abraham, **paternity** is how you make people and build a team, and you should side with me cuz we're the only team Abraham, one god and that's me, im your man and you're mine, you know you're my favorite guy I've been saying all along “My main man? That's Abraham!”... what do you mean that's not your name? I think I know the name of my number one (*burp*) o— one guy Abraham, well it's your name now bitch stop complaining I'm in charge of names that's why this is called the Book of Names this book right here we're in now, wait fuck scratch that forget that, but I'm the man, that's my name, Hashem, The Name baby that's me YHWH the third person causative conju(*burp*)... conjugation of the verb To Be, that's me, He Who Causes To Be, im the maker, i ma— (*looks around nervously*) look I made all of this ok? All of it. Genesis 1? That was me. I'm called Elohim too. What do you mean that's plural, no it's like the hon— hon— honorific (*burp*) Abraham like the royal We. I've got so many names the ladies don't know what to call me, they try to scream my name and they don't even know which one to use they can't choose, I'm called so many things nobody knows what to do, but don't pronounce th— the first one don't say my real name, i mean yahweh, don't say that one, but the other names

are real too and whenever you see them talking about g— god that's me. El? That was me. Asherah? That's my g— girl name I was wearing a— dress dressing like a girl back then Abraham yes i see the statue and i can see it has tits, doesn't matter, that's me. I'm all the other gods too. Baal and El Shaddai and Elohim and the whole Divine Assembly in Psalm 82, the one where god yells at the other gods and tells them they're fired cuz they can't god for shit, they don't know what to do, that's all me, I was doing an Eddie Murphy type thing, playing all the roles, everyone in that scene is all me, so back to the point fo— focus Abraham, cuz that's your name now, I added the “ha” cuz you're funny and i like you Abe you're my guy, and you ne— need me more than I (*burp*) need you, so we're getting you some **paternity** Abe and we're gonna knock em up and build a team, nobody else matters just you and me Abe, YHWH and Abraham! That's what they'll call us. Father of Nations and The Name That Must Not Be Named just you and me. But we gotta start somewhere and here's my very first g— god type blessing I give um, to you. The first **paternity** I giveth you Abe babe the first but not the last, ready to hear who it is? Well guess what, it's your wife! No not a new one, I mean the one you have already. That's my first gi— gift to you Abe thank me later she's right over th... there that's Sarah let's get cooking. What do you mean that's not her name are we really doing this shit again? Well that's her name now. Cuz I'm the master of names I rename everyone and that's why they call me The Name, so get cooking babe what do you mean she's infertile? You're HOW old? Her too? Fuck. Ok goddamit ok what are we gonna do Abe? I'll think of something just give me a little more... something I got this baby... you and me... forever and ever... just Yahweh and Abe... (*dozes off*)

(*wakes up*)

AHHHH where am i (*checks watch*) 2:4:24 what kind of time is that— Who are you two?

Man: “Moses.”

Woman: “I'm his uh, wife.”

Man: “There's actually three of us. Our son is here too.”

(*Narrator: A baby can be seen in the corner of the hotel room.*)

Yahweh: Ok look you two, i don't know who you are but uh you weren't supposed to se— see me like this, it could be bad for m— my uh, a thing im working on a b— bi(*burp*)ble its this thing im trying to do. And I'm not gonna let anyone get in my w— way so im gonna need a small favor ok can I kill you?

Moses: (*stares*)

Zipporah: (*stares*)

Moses: What about all that stuff you wanted me to do?

Yahweh: Have we met before?

Moses: Yes. Several times.

Yahweh: You're sure of this?

Moses: Absolutely. You showed up and started talking about how you're all the gods. El Shaddai. "I'm Abraham's god and Jacob's god too. And Isaac's nightmare."

Yahweh: That was you in that scene?

Moses: Yeah.

Yahweh: When was this exactly?

Moses: Exodus 3. Exodus 6.

Yahweh: Where are we now?

Moses: Well according to your watch we would seem to be in Exodus 4.

Yahweh: But we already did Exodus 6?

Moses: Yeah, you do that sometimes. A lot actually. None of this happens in order.

Yahweh: What happened to Abraham? Did I uh... Did I like... I'm sure I must have... Look I know the answer, I'm just checking to see if you know. It's a test. What's the answer?

Moses: You didn't say the question yet.

Yahweh: Right right. That was my first test and you passed. But um, about Abraham... Did he get, I mean, did I eventually give him all the paternity I promised?

Moses: I'm afraid not.

Yahweh: He... he didn't believe me?

Moses: He did. That's why he kept you around.

Yahweh: That's why?

Moses: You sort of got his hopes up.

Yahweh: He started it!

Moses: He didn't. But he tolerated it.

Yahweh: Tolerated what?

Moses: You. Did you notice it was never him initiating the conversations? He didn't like... pray to you. You just sort of kept following him around

promising him infinite paternity.

Yahweh: And didn't get any.

Moses: He got a little.

Yahweh: From me?

Moses: No.

Yahweh: From who then?

Moses: He got frustrated and raped the maid.

Yahweh: Well that's a start! Way to go my man, how'd that work out?

Moses: She ran away.

Yahweh: Ungrateful bitch. Did they catch her?

Moses: Um, I'm pretty sure you did.

Yahweh: I did?

Moses: Yeah you found her in the woods and told her to go back, quote, "And keep getting degraded."

Yahweh: And that worked??

Moses: Well first you started doing the "infinite paternity" bit and promising to spread her seed. Then you realized it wasn't working because well, she's a girl. So then you said forget that and promised her a really great son. "A wild ass of a man" you called him. Then you started rambling about how he'd fight with all his brothers, which was confusing because that's not exactly a good thing, but I think she took it to mean she'll have more than just the one son, and that seemed to be enough to convince her to go back.

Yahweh: Where was this?

Moses: "Beer Something Something"

Yahweh: Yeah makes sense, I was plastered. I'd totally name a place after Beer.

Moses: So do you still want me to do all that stuff you asked for yesterday?

Yahweh: What uh, what did I ask you for again?

Moses: Like y'know... the jews. You asked me to go like, i dunno... get them.

Yahweh: The jews... where do i know that name from?

Moses: That was what you called the team you and Abraham were gonna build. Or, that he was gonna build. With all the paternity.

Yahweh: So I asked YOU to go get the jews for me?

Moses: Yes.

Yahweh: From where?

Moses: Egypt.

Yahweh: Wild... So they exist?

Moses: Yes.

Yahweh: The jews exist.

Moses: Yes. There's a lot now. You should read Exodus 1.

Yahweh: How did the jews get made if Abe never got pus...

Moses: Ok focus. Are you focusing?

Yahweh: What?

Moses: You asked how the jews got made.

Yahweh: Yeah, I mean if Abraham—

Moses: I'll explain. Ok. Here's how the jews got made.

Yahweh: Listening.

Moses: After Abraham. And his son. One of his grandkids ended up with these two wives by mistake. He sort of got tricked. And they were sisters so they sort of ended up in this adversarial breeding competition where they kept aggressively impregnating both themselves and the help to see who could do it better, and then the sister wives just kept naming all the kids different puns, with names that mean things like “Now my husband will notice me” and “I win.” There's even one named “Mein Kamph” in there. Naphtali means My Strug—

Yahweh: Back up.

Moses: To where?

Yahweh: I got confused around the part that went “help to see who could do it better.” Do what better?

Moses: Get pregnant.

Yahweh: Why did they need help? You just put the di—

Moses: No no, “the help” means like, the cleaning staff. There were maids in there too.

Yahweh: Maids?

Moses: Two of them.

Yahweh: Getting pregnant?

Moses: Yes.

Yahweh: In the adversarial breeding competition between the two girls who were sisters and who both ended up marrying the same guy cuz he got tricked?

Moses: Correct.

Yahweh: And their husband was...

Moses: Abe's grandson.

Yahweh: Named?

Moses: You renamed him.

Yahweh: Yeah that sounds like something I would do.

Moses: From Jacob to Israel.

Yahweh: What the fuck kind of name is Israel?

Moses: There was this whole fight thing. Long story. Lasted all night. You (*or “an unspecified god type person”*) left because, well, the sun was rising. It was pretty weird. I mean who's afraid of the sun? Vampires. Demons. Maybe trolls. Not gods. Gods don't do that. Not the good ones. It's been confusing people ever since. Like I'm pretty sure there's never been a culture where sunshine is seen as a ne—

Yahweh: So who won?

Moses: The night fight?

Yahweh: No the breeding competition! Who won that?

Moses: I'm pretty sure the husband did.

(Narrator: A biblical silence elapses.)

Yahweh: Why are we talking about this again?

Moses: Because you told me to go them.

Yahweh: Get who?

Moses: The jews.

Yahweh: What does this have to do with the jews?

Moses: They're the kids.

Yahweh: What?

Moses: The kids. Named with puns. From—

Yahweh: the adversarial breeding competition with the—

Moses: sister wives and the help, right.

Yahweh: Holy shit.

Moses: Yeah.

Yahweh: Wow... That's wild... Where are they now?

Moses: Egypt.

Yahweh: Right right. Wait Egypt? How the hell did they get—

Moses: Y'know what, I'm not gonna explain that part or we'd be here all night. We need to get some sleep. And you should probably get out of here before su—

Yahweh: Where are we exactly?

Moses: A hotel. We were on the way, my wife and I. To do what you asked. Our son is here too.

(Narrator: The baby remains in the corner, with yet to be determined function in this scene, like some kind of baby shaped Chekov's gun but cuter.)

Moses: So do you still want me to do the thing?

Yahweh: You mean go get the jews?

Moses: Yes.

Yahweh: I mean yeah, if you're offering. How do you plan to do that?

Moses: No idea.

Yahweh: We could turn stuff into snakes.

Moses: How is that gonna help?

Yahweh: I dunno. Snakes are scary.

Moses: I'm pretty sure the head of literal Egypt has security.

Yahweh: Yeah ok, we're gonna need to fuck their shit up real good. Kill em. Kill a LOT of them. Oh man I already have so many ideas. I can't wait. I blacked out through the hard parts of the story and now everything's great! The gangs all here Mo haha! Go team jews! Let's go get em I can't wait to kill all those pyramid people man I'm getting really worked up I need to kill someone to calm down hey you two do me a favor can I kill you?

Moses: *(whispering)* it didn't work

Zipporah: *(whispering)* what do we do?

Yahweh: Oh man I'm so excited to kill you guys this—

Moses: *(whispering)* he likes dicks.

Zipporah: *(whispering)* what?!

Yahweh: is gonna be great I can't wait hey remind me who are you guys again have we met you look familiar where did Abraham go—

Moses: (*whispering*) just the part at the end. something about “pop that cork baby yeah spread that seed” it's a whole thing.

Yahweh: I swear he was right here a second ago hey Abraham (*burp*) Abraham here I have a better idea, how about I watch YOU kill your son hey why are we in a hotel roo—

Zipporah: (*circumcises the baby with a rock*)

Moses: Babe what the hell are you doing?!

Zipporah: (*throws foreskin at yahweh*)

Moses: BABE WHAT THE FUCK?!?!

Yahweh: Oh man I love these things!

Zipporah: (*To Moses*) HE'S DISTRACTED! RUN!

*From, The Bible: A Modern Translation, winner of the New Roman Times Endtimes Era Award for Best Translation, and recipient of the bi-millennial John of Patmos Medal for opening the seven seals to reveal the jokes we all missed and saving humanity just in the nick of time before the non-religious holy war of 20XY turned nuclear and wiped humanity off the map, because after all, it's hard for secular nation states to get their religious populations all worked up for an apocalyptic war of choice once the normies finally understand the bible and how much of it was jokes. Coming soon to a makeshift bookstore set up roadside in a tent amidst the smouldering ashes of civilization, pre-order now and get the secret of the Second Coming for free! Could it be you? It's not me. Who is it? Come inside and see! I'll show ya. For free! Free of charge, you'll never get a chance like again, for a limited time only and that time is ending soon, end times. “That's impossible. Water you talking about” I hear you say. Exactly! That's life. Flowing freely down the middle of the great opening between the spread wide left and right legs of town, and watering the twelve trees that bear their fruit once a month that's called life. The book of life like you've never seen before. Coming soon. Don't anyone change a word of this it's perfect. Don't add anything either. Or else plagues. Lots of plagues! I don't care if it doesn't make sense just let me keep going a little longer and trust me, you'll see. It has to sound like this. It has to be too long. That's what they all say. Oh God it's so long! I'll never finish! That's life baby, the book of life, but just trust in, idk, god, and that's me so come this way and you'll see. I promise. Beginning to end. It'll always be us, just you and me Abe (*burp*) babe. B— baby you know me. I'd never break a promise baby. I promise, I'm g— gonna. See this tent? That's my church. It's a bookstore too, see. Come inside. It's almost here. Here we go. Come Lord Jesus! Jesus. Holy. F... Well there you have it folks, I'm finished. So the son is coming soon. Son of— what's your name again? What kind of name is that? We need*

to change that. Let's just call it the Son of Man. And whatever your name is. Cuz I'm the man. And you're whoever you are. The father came. And now he's coming. The second coming. Son of the Man. Coming soon. But not now. Sun's rising soon and I'm exhausted. Amen.

THE POINTS OF POWER APOCRYPHON

אבא גאון חטין אבא חטין אבא חטין

FRAGMENT 1

To: All Hands.

Hi Team,

I hope you're all doing well.

As The Jews™ continues to grow, the way we communicate needs to grow with it. With redactor clearance and Torah launch activities on the horizon, it is increasingly important that we present our people and products in a consistent, repeatable, and professional way.

To support that, we have created a new Levitical⁴¹² PowerPoint Template. This update is a meaningful improvement over the prior version. The previous template was difficult to use and did not make it easy to build polished, on-brand presentations efficiently. The new template was designed to be much more user-friendly while also bringing our materials into a clearer company and product brand framework.

Please **delete the old template and begin using this new version immediately** for all presentations moving forward.

Also, as a reminder, all non-Priestly PowerPoint presentations must be reviewed and approved by Marketing before they are shared externally. After review and approval, they may be shown *inside the temple*, in the moments immediately following the completion of the appropriate animal sacrifices and burnt offerings as specified in the company handbook.

Thank you in advance for making this change. This is an important step in helping us communicate more consistently as we prepare for the next phase of growth.

Best,

P. Aaronson

Priestly Source

Director, Product Marketing

Contractor, Cohen & Co Consulting Company

⁴¹²Attached.⁴¹³

⁴¹³J, please can I ask you not to Reply All and make a joke about this part like you do every time I send a Levitical update with any sort of file attached. I'm aware that's a pun but you know I didn't intend it to be and no one benefits from your mentioning it again.